

A TABLETOP RPG BY REBECCA KJELLIN

FROSTMARK



FROSTMARK RPG

Player's Guide

Playtest 0.3.7

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Most inhabitants of Frostmark believe that their World consists of one continent, eleven kingdoms, and one faith with one supreme god. The Church has made it clear what is fairytales and what is not, lords and ladies have established their power, and guilds further the sentiment that the true worth of a man is his purse.

One unassuming day all of this will change. The Fiery Barrier is withering, and when it breaks, all manners of fabled creatures will penetrate the fallen defense, feral or advanced, nefarious, or civil. Magic will once more establish itself within the temptations of man, with its fantastical display and bloody truth. Six outcasts and hungry gods will turn their primordial eyes onto humanity, ravenous to partake in the feast. That the self-proclaimed monotheistic god has enjoyed for far too long. Human souls. The power balance of Frostmark and its people's fundamental beliefs will be forever and irrevocably be changed, with all the discord and corpses that follow it.

When gods wage war, you can either be a pawn in their games or strive to attain the power to tip the scales of fate. You may have what it takes to shape your reality. You might be the difference between victory and defeat in warfare for territory, ideals, or truth, the voice that inspires the masses, the eyes that explores the World's deepest secrets, or the direct conduit of a god's will. Will you defend the Church or seek a new purpose? Will you cut a bloody swathe through the World, in warfare, or in magic to forge your will into reality, or will you simply take advantage of the chaos to fully enjoy the fleeting life of a mortal?

Let's discover the fate of the new age together.

INTRODUCTION

Frostmark is a tabletop role-playing game (RPG) system and setting with a strong emphasis on narrative and setting. If this is not your first rodeo in the RPG world then you will feel right at home within these pages as Frostmark takes a lot of inspiration from a popular RPG. If this is the first time you are picking up an RPG book and you have no knowledge of the basics of an RPG, before anything else, familiarize yourself with the fundamentals.

Frostmark is primarily for players who want to enjoy a long-running campaign set within the premise of Frostmark's setting. The intended Frostmark campaign starts with several human kingdoms coming to terms with a change of worldview and adapting to new external sources of power and intentions, to the conclusion of the consequences of this momentous change (see more in the GM's section). Though, do not hesitate to mix things up, running another kind of campaign or changing the rules to your wishes. Frostmark seeks to provide you with the tools to tell and enjoy a story between you and your friends.

In the Frostmark Playtest you will find all that you require to stress test and enjoy the experience. It includes the lore created so far, character creation, how to play, a lot of human adversaries and a few monstrous ones. Everything here is subject to change. With your help playtesting, we can find mistakes, issues, and improvements to this material.

If you find Frostmark enjoyable, please do not hesitate to support it further so more content can be created for it. Thanks!

A BURNING BEGINNING

Winter had come to Greenfield, bringing with it snow and a biting chill that had driven birds south and bears into hibernation. A lone campfire defied the freezing weather, while one of the five weary travellers around it – Justus – defied the deathlike silence with his enthusiastic and fast-paced talk. The simple but lovingly cooked meat stew in his lap had grown cold, but Justus could not help elaborating further and further upon the mysteries and the intricacies behind the craft known as magic – for once, someone had asked him a question and maintained interest in his answer for more than a mere minute.

Though most of Justus' comrades were entirely preoccupied with their last meal before the end of the day, the hunter Miruna regarded him with interest. She was one of the newest additions to Justus's exploration party and since she had lived a mostly solitary life, far from the dwellings of priests, she had never seen magic in use until she met Justus. It was this curiosity of hers, once it was spoken, that had opened the floodgates to Justus's cesspool of knowledge.

Eventually, his impromptu lecture was cut short as another comrade, Heron, asked: "Aren't the stars beautiful tonight?" Heron was a man of gloom, and he made no attempt to hide the remark for what it was: a diplomatic call for silence. Justus could not blame him. Heron was – or had been – a priest, as the Mark on his forehead revealed. This knowledge was only given out to those Heron trusted; the truth was otherwise hidden behind his mask. He knew all there was to know about magic and more importantly, he knew the excruciating price he had paid for learning more about it than the Inquisition deemed fit.

Respecting this desire of Heron's to end the conversation, Justus fell silent and rested his gaze upon the heavens. However, in the corner of his eye, he noticed something strange about one of the gleaming diamonds far off in the sky. One particular star was

swelling and shrinking, the light around it rising and falling in a pulsating motion.

"Whatever Siv put in that stew," Miruna said calmly, "it ain't good."

"There are no bad stews, only bad manners," Siv chided in her own defense, waving her spoon at Miruna. For a hardened Beornish raider, the elderly woman was of a rather motherly disposition.

"Are you also seeing it?" Justus asked Miruna.

"You may want to be a little more specific." However, Miruna evidently understood exactly what Justus was asking about, as she added: "There's something about that star, isn't there?"

Gunteric, the hulking mercenary that Justus had hired for protection during the journey, roused himself from his solitude and sprang to his feet, his hair whipping around furiously in his search for the source of their fascination. "What star?" he barked. "What's wrong?"

Heron was next to take interest in the mystery, though he asked no questions – he simply tracked where Justus and Miruna's eyes were directed and followed. After a moment of squinting at the strange light, Heron murmured something under his breath.

The peculiar corona flared one last time, then fled from its eternal seat and shot across the sky like a loosened arrow.

"And so another light falls to the Mad Devil," Justus lamented.

"If the Church is to be believed," muttered Heron.

"Pay it no mind," was Siv's advice. "Plenty of them left, aren't there? We'll manage without that one."

Just then, the star fell out of sight and in that moment the sky – the entire world, perhaps – appeared to be enveloped by a tightly woven net, spined out of intense sunlight. And like the sun, it burned – soon the heavens were ablaze and though the forest

remained cold, the red light bathed the snow in an infernal glow.

"By the Devils," Miruna cursed, breaking the silence.

Gunteric tore his eyes away and rushed at Heron, grabbing his shoulders and shaking him. "You!" he bellowed. "You must know what's happening!"

Heron had faced the skies with no more than a concerned frown, but now terror invaded his otherwise stoic demeanour. Shaken, he failed to answer.

Siv came to Heron's rescue, slapping Gunteric over the hand with her spoon. "What have we said about shaking people, Gunteric?"

Despite his intimidating and aggressive nature, even Gunteric listened when Siv spoke, and he backed off from Heron. "What is going on?" he asked. Stripped of the explosive anger, the mercenary now revealed his underlying anxiety, and to his further frustration, no one seemed to have an answer.

On any other occasion Justus would have been talking just as much as all his comrades combined, but under these burning skies, he found himself speechless. He could not look away from the phenomenon, although his thoughts ran all over the place as he searched for an explanation for this mystery. He recalled an ancient book, in particular, a chapter detailing the crowning of Empress Leana. Translations differed in one passage, detailing how the world had known that it had been blessed with the light of Riahn. Some had described that the sky had brightened, others that it had been set aflame.

First it was a relieving thought, that this imposing imagery could be a sign of Riahn's protection, but just as Justus was about to

reassure his companions, the flames flickered and piece by piece, the intricate net began to burn away, crumble and fall. Like sparks from a kindle, they died out in their journey through the air and when the last golden thread had faded, the sky was back to normal, though it remained bereft of its renegade star.

All of them were silent now. Relief and dread intermingled in the tense air around them until Miruna slumped down by the fire and seized a bottle of beer. "Whatever that was, I'm going to forget all about it." She took a few gulps and extended the bottle to the rest of the group. "Anyone else?"

Heron silently sat down by Miruna, took the offered beer, and drank. Deeply.

"How can you drink at a time like this?" Gunteric banged his fist into his palm. "The bloody sky was burning!"

"Dearie," Siv said and patted Gunteric on the back, "that's why it's a great time to drink. Not much we can do if the sky's angry, is there? Let me get you more stew. Nothing like food and drink to settle a troubled mind. Justus! That goes for you, too."

Justus realized then that he had not moved a muscle since the star fell, and he turned to his comrades with a smile. "Of course! A spectacular sight like that is well worth a toast!" Contrary to this show of enthusiasm, however, Justus spent what little was left of their waking evening in horror. If what he had read about Leana's crowning had anything to do with the event of tonight, he could only infer that what they had seen was the protection of Riahn breaking down. Whether their god had failed or forsaken them, Justus feared they were nearing the last days of Frostmark if such was the case.

But these were not the end times. This was the beginning.



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CHARACTER CREATION

In this section, we will explore how to create a player character for a Frostmark campaign. A character in a roleplaying game is a personality (a person you create and bring to life) as well as several statistics (their talents, capabilities, and weaknesses). You create your character with your imagination and your sources of inspiration, with the only limitation that the character has to make sense in the game world. Nonetheless, the most crucial thing is to bring a character to the table that you will enjoy playing as. If you have no clue what kind of character you want to create, read through the Ability Origins options, the backgrounds, the general lore, or even search for inspiration outside of the game.

Before you begin, ask your GM what kind of campaign you will be playing and if your GM has any limitations or wishes regarding character creation. Maybe it is a classical Frostmark campaign that starts on Frostmark with only human characters, or maybe it is a realm-jumping high fantasy adventure where you are free to choose any character type. Maybe the campaign is not based within the Frostmark lore at all. When you have the necessary knowledge at hand, use the rest of this book to begin your Frostmark adventure.

CHARACTER CREATION GUIDE

Before getting into the specifics of character creation, create a concept in your mind of what kind of character you want to play. Towards this end, you can scan through options and powers presented in this book, you can explore some lore of the Frostmark universe if your campaign is set there, and you can enlist your GM and/or fellow players for brainstorming advice. If the character you are creating grows up in the world of Frostmark, understanding the lore and weaving it into the concept as well as backstory of your character will properly cement your character into the world and the narrative.

As the Frostmark character creation system offers significant freedom for character customization and optimization, possessing a solid concept of a character before assigning statistics will aid you in several ways. There will be many choices coming your way down the path of character creation, therefore, a solid character concept will help you navigate the different options not only more efficiently, but also quicker. Secondly, within this significant freedom offered when customizing your character lies a temptation of min-maxxing. A Frostmark character is meant to be capable yes, but the goal of character customization freedom offered in Frostmark is to facilitate diversity of builds so hopefully all character concepts may come to life - not a contest of power-optimization. When keeping that initial character concept in mind, it will help you to make an immersion motivated choice, rather than a power motivated one. Part of this is sharing this concept with your GM and deciding upon with them which Ability Origins makes sense with them. As such, that's the first step in the step-by-step character creation guide below;

Step 1

Create your concept as explained above. Decide your ability origins (AOs) with your GM.
(Page 13, ability origin lists)

Step 2

Determine your character's race.
(Page 18, Races)

Step 3

Decide which background suits your character the best.
(Page 57, Backgrounds)

Step 4

Determine your ability scores.
(Page 95, ability scores)

Step 5

Purchase Accomplishments (proficiencies, skill points, and extra starting money).
(Page 100, Accomplishment table)

Step 6

Level your character in the Ability Origin list, selecting abilities between your ability origins and activate their tags.
(Page 111, ability origins)

Step 7

Tally and spend your Potential.
(Page 239, Exaltation and Potential)

Step 8

Spend your money on equipment, arms, and armor.
(Page 251, Equipment)

Step 9

Calculate your HP, your AV, and other important statistics.
(Page 290, Important Values)

Step 10

Do some finishing touches. Make sure your character is ready, and your backstory is finished.
(Page 291, Backstory)

LEVELING UP GUIDE

Your GM decides when your character levels up. Read more about this in the "For the GM" chapter.

Step 1

Pick an ability from one of your ability origins of your choice. If you are leveling up to level 2 or 3, note that you receive two selections, but only the Primary Selection ability activates your tags.

Step 2

Activate your HD tag for the level and add it to your HP total.

Step 3

Check if it is the first time you pick an AO with "Bonus Skill Points: Extra" if so, follow the instructions found under ability origin tags. If it is the fifth, the ninth, the thirteenth, or the seventeenth time you pick an AO with the "Bonus Skill Points: Extra," follow the instructions found under Ability Origin Tags.

Step 4

Tally your new Potential gained from the spellcasting tag for the level. With the Potential, you may purchase Exaltation in game, or if you possess spellcasting, you may purchase cantrips, spells known, and spell slots.

STEP 1 – ABILITY ORIGINS

Presented below are the Ability Origins currently available in Frostmark. An Ability Origin is a group of thematic abilities that helps to describe what source your character's powers come from. The blurbs of text accompanying the Ability Origins below paint a picture of what kind of people tend to gravitate towards that particular origin of power. You're of course welcome to put your own spin on it with your GM's involvement and allowance.

To help you create a base picture of your character in your head before embarking upon the twists and turns of the meat of character creation, establishing which sources of power your character leans upon will create a solid guard rail to combat choice exhaustion and limit the temptation of none-immersive optimization. Deciding upon which Ability Origins your character starts out with, one to four of them, is the only formal choice you'll have to make before carrying on to the next steps but feel encouraged to flesh out your base theme of your character further - for the reasons explained above.

[Artistry]

Artistry can take many forms. Jacks of all trades, scholars, performers, scoundrels, bards, or a mixture of all; those with an **[Artistry]** talent possess a quick wit. They also have an uncanny ability to know more than they should and use what they learn to keep themselves and their allies ever one step ahead of danger.

Professionally trained entertainers from Sirendale or charismatic tricksters from Stormholme often possess levels in **[Artistry]**.

[Devotion]

The reasons are always individual, but taking this path expresses a devotion to an Enneade and their teachings. These powers are given as rewards and boons for service and continued devotion. Devoted to the tenets of the religions and philosophies that inspire them, these ecclesiastics quest to spread the knowledge and influence of their faith.

[Devotion] is a common AO among priests of Riahn or the rare heretic worshiper of one of the forgotten Enneade.

[Discipline]

Followers of Discipline harness the power within their own Souls to create supernatural effects and exceed their bodies' physical capabilities. Some of their special moves can even hinder the flow of Soul Energies in their opponents. Using Soul Mastery, followers of Discipline channel incredible speed and strength into their unarmed strikes. As they gain experience, their martial training and their mastery of their own Soul gives them more power over their bodies and the bodies of their foes.

In Frostmark, **[Discipline]** is a rare occurrence in this age. Its cultural origins hail from Eastcreek, where some traditionalistic tribespeople still practice the ancient art. However, some military organizations facing great odds have rediscovered some of the **[Discipline]** teachings, such as the Watch in Greenfield and the Iron Barricade Defenders in Oldwood. The Lowcloaks guild has "acquired" some of its secrets for the benefit of their operatives.

[Divine Oath]

Those who can take this path have made a sacred oath to an Enneade, which can't be easily broken. In exchange for this service, the holder of the Oath gains different powers from their patron. Different Oath-takers focus on various aspects of their Enneade's philosophy and creed, but all are bound by the oaths that grant them the power to do their sacred work.

Elite knights of the Sacred Arms may have unlocked several levels of [**Divine Oath**], most common in Crowhill but can also be found in Karthmere and Greenfield. Like [**Devotion**], exotic humans or traveling Enna can possess levels in [**Divine Oath**] as well.

[Finesse]

Never knowing what to expect, practitioners of Finesse prepare for everything, becoming masters of a wide variety of skills, training themselves to be adept manipulators, agile acrobats, shadowy stalkers, or masters of any of dozens of other professions or talents. Thieves and gamblers, fast talkers and diplomats, bandits and bounty hunters, and explorers and investigators all might be considered practitioners of Finesse, as well as countless other professions that rely upon wits, prowess, luck, and most of all, finesse.

[**Finesse**] is exceptionally prevalent among bandits and thieves of all kinds. However, some organized military groups, like the Thainian Skirmishers or Gravian Light Cavalry, also utilize the quick and precise prowess of [**Finesse**].

[Occult Student]

Wild and enigmatic, varied in form and function, the power of magic draws students who seek to master its mysteries. Some aspire to become like the gods, shaping reality itself. Though the casting of a typical spell requires merely the utterance of a few Words in Copta, fleeting gestures, and Potency, these surface components barely hint at the expertise attained after years of apprenticeship and countless hours of study.

Fortunate humans who stumble upon a spellbook or similar arcane knowledge sources and have the talent to learn from it may pick up levels in [**Occult Student**]. Otherwise, Enna, who study magic without the meddling of the Enneade, often possess levels in [**Occult Student**].

[Pact]

This path is defined by a pact with an otherworldly being. Sometimes this relationship with the patron is like that of a cleric and a deity, though the beings that serve as patrons for those who enter these pacts are not gods. Someone with a pact might lead a cult dedicated to a powerful Demon, Devil, or an utterly exotic entity—beings not typically served by common, devoted followers. More often, though, the arrangement is similar to that between a master and an apprentice. The Pact taker learns and grows in power, at the cost of occasional services performed on the patron's behalf.

Varied in origin and purpose, fortunate or unfortunate humans can be contacted by an otherworldly being as the Fiery Barrier is weakening or has fallen. The question "Why?" can only be answered by the patron.

[Power]

Abilities in the Power category are offensive and aggressive in nature. It's all about overpowering your opponent hard and fast. Savages, hired muscle, masters of vicious martial techniques, they are creatures of slaughter and spirits of war.

Whenever a person must overcome a physical obstacle and only relying upon their primal instinct, muscles, and willpower to do so, they may discover **[Power]** within themselves. **[Power]** is more typical in less civilized areas, such as Eastcreek, Oldwood, and Beornhelm.

[Predator]

Be they scouts, trackers, or bounty hunters, Predators share much in common: unique mastery of specialized weapons, skill at stalking even the most elusive game, and the expertise to defeat a wide range of quarries. Knowledgeable, patient, and skilled hunters, these rangers hound man, beast, and monster alike, gaining insight into the way of the predator, skill in varied environments, and ever more lethal martial prowess.

Hunters of both game and humanoids, characters who focus their attention on a specific group of creatures, belong in the **[Predator]** category. Examples of predators in Frostmark include the Wardens from Applegate and the Inquisitors from Crowhill.

[Soul Oath]

While many warriors strive to perfect their art, spending all of their time honing their martial arts skills, others spend as much effort dedicating themselves to a cause. These warriors swear themselves to a purpose, serving it above all else. Their true power comes from the conviction of their ideals, the oaths that they swear, and the challenges they make.

Any character who has sworn a great personal oath may pick up **[Soul Oath]**. The most prevailing use of this AO is chivalric knights who have sworn the Sacred Code.

[Soul Weapon]

Some spend their lives poring over ancient tomes and texts, unlocking the power of magic, and some spend their time perfecting the use of individual weapons, becoming masters without equal. Those who follow this path are students of both philosophies, blending magical ability and martial prowess into something unique, a discipline in which both spell and steel are used to devastating effect.

Users of **[Soul Weapon]** are either martial characters who want to broaden their magical prowess or characters blessed with magic who want to increase their martial capabilities. What they share in common, however, is the will to weave magic and weapons in tandem.

[Tactics]

Far more than mere thugs, those skilled in Tactics reveal the true deadliness of their weapons, turning hunks of metal into arms capable of taming kingdoms, slaughtering monsters, and rousing the hearts of armies.

[Tactics] is primarily learned through focused martial training with intent. It is also a physical ability applied through strategy and preparation. **[Tactics]** is a common AO found typical among guards and soldiers of a majority of the kingdoms of Frostmark.

[Unique Ancestry]

Scions of innately magical bloodlines, those with [Unique Ancestry] look within themselves for arcane prowess and draw forth might few mortals can imagine. These magic-touched souls endlessly indulge in and refine their mysterious abilities, gradually learning how to harness their birthright and coax forth ever greater arcane feats.

Lingering unique ancestries may still reside in some humans in Frostmark, most dormant, somehow surviving over the centuries of isolation. Most of the unique bloodlines were eradicated by the Sacred Arms. Members of them were considered corrupted to the core and thus promptly extinguished. One particular kind of [Unique Ancestry] was in most cases allowed to go on, Celestial bloodlines, as long as they agreed to serve as priests. Today, these bloodlines are instead considered to be chosen by Riahn. Most members, if not all, serve in the upper echelon of the Church.

[World Magic]

Some students of magic turn to divine knowledge, other to pure occult theory, and yet others to the most elusive path yet; World Magic. The Enneade may have created the World, but after so many divine deaths, the World absorbed dozens of "Spheres of Influence" and has become its own powerhouse, though one without a conscious mind. The remaining Enneade would never admit their existence, but World Magicians try to tap into the World's latent power and understand it.

Magic, outside of the Rianish priesthood, is scarce in this day and age of Frostmark, and [World Magic] is the most elusive of all. But that is changing. As the other Enneade have been cut off from Frostmark, curious minds searching for the divinity that is not Riahn may encounter the presence of the World itself. This entity can't be completely hindered by the Fiery Barrier. This is especially prevalent among the naturalists, shamans, and tribal doctors who possess a keen mind for the natural world.

STEP 1 – CHARACTER CREATION EXAMPLES

In this section you'll find two player characters, Helos and Rogath, go through the first step in character creation.

“Helos”

Step 1

Eve wants to create a priest of Riahn character, so she starts to tinker with the broad-strokes of her character's backstory;

Helos Alkis is a young but gifted man. Born and raised in Goldbank, the headquarters of the Church of Riahn in Crowhill. Helos grew up in the social cast of the Warmth, which ensured him a solid education. His piety and talent allowed him to seek a career within the Church of Riahn. As an apprentice priest, he discovers that he possesses a hidden heritage, celestial blood. Helos became elated and believed himself to be one of Riahn's chosen. A few years later, Helos graduates as a full-fledged priest, ready to accept any position and duty he is given.

Helos' player, Eve, and her GM together decide upon [Devotion] and [Unique Ancestry] for Helos' starting AOs.

“Rogath”

Step 1

Carl wants to create a character that is not from Frostmark and who is martial in his theme. Eventually, he comes with this character concept to his GM;

Rogath is a black dragonborn from Borias' Realm of Kess'Aai. He was born in a small, but capable, dragonborn village on one of the smaller islands in the archipelagos on Kess'Aai. The village had a strong martial background, teaching all citizens who could hold a weapon to defend themselves. Rogath was born with great talent, and he quickly surpassed his peers when he was but a child. From an early age, all Rogath knew was achievement and praise, so he grew quickly prideful. In his late teenage years, the village felt boring for him as he felt his progression stagnate in the lack of challenge. Despite the villagers begging him to not go, either because of familial love or fear of the loss of a great warrior, Rogath still set out on his own. He seeks to challenge and the limit of his own potential.

Carl and his GM decide that Rogath has [Tactics] and [Soul Oath] as his ability origins due to his martial background and focused mindset.

STEP 2 – RACES

The next step is establishing which race your character will be. The races left in Frostmark in the Age of Riahn are, perhaps almost, exclusively humans. Through Geanor's conquest, and later, through the great machine of the Empire and the Sacred Arms, all other races were removed from Frostmark. Riahn then created the Fiery Barrier – a wall around Frostmark, which prevented anyone from traveling through the Stellar Expanse to Frostmark, and vice versa. However, over the hundreds of years, the other six gods have applied pressure on the Fiery Barrier, weakening it and may eventually break it. Maybe, just maybe, an Enna could have slipped through the defenses early.

If you're playing an adventure or campaign outside of Frostmark's setting, inquire with your GM if they have any wishes or thoughts upon the selection of races available.

Racial Traits

The description of each race includes racial traits that are common to members of that race. The following categories of traits may apply to your character's race;

Ability Score Change

Every race modifies one or more of the ability scores your character possesses. Add your racial bonus on top of your bought ability scores.

Age

The age entry notes the age when a member of the race is considered an adult, as well as the race's expected lifespan.

Size

Characters of most races are Medium, a size category including creatures that are roughly between 1.3 to 2.5 m tall. Members of a few races belong to the size category Small, between 0.6 and 1.3 m tall, which results in that certain rules of the game affect them differently. The most significant rule change for Small characters is that they have trouble wielding heavy weapons, as explained in the "Equipment" section.

Speed

Your speed determines how far you can move when traveling and fighting.

Language

By virtue of your race, your character knows certain languages. This may include speaking, reading, and writing these languages, but it doesn't have to. If your character could not learn how to write, you may treat your languages as only spoken. Maybe you have a character who was deaf from birth, then you may be able to read and write, but not speak. How you treat your character's knowledge of a language is up to you. You can find the available languages under the "Languages" section. When a racial trait grants your character a language, your character's competence level is Academics: Language rank 2, which means that they can speak, read, and/or write it like a native.

Subraces

Some races have subraces. Members of a subrace have the traits of the parent race in addition to the traits specified for their subrace.

Human

Age: Humans possess a lifespan of about 85 years. Culturally and biologically, they reach adulthood in their late teens.

Characteristics: +1 to two different ability scores of your choice

Language: Modern Markish

Size: Humans average weight is 60 to 90 kg, and their average height is 1.5 to 1.9 m. Your size is Medium.

Speed: 6 m base walking speed

Feats: Pick a feat of your choice. You must fulfill the requirement of it if necessary.

Freedom of Devotion: You are free to devote yourself to any of the Enneade or the World. If you haven't devoted yourself to the Enneade, your Soul will automatically empower the World.

Dragonborn

Creator Enneade: Suphis and Devistra

Current Realm and Enneade: Eternal Suns, Progenitor, Kess'Aai, Mirrormark, Qedseba and Inet'Saret

Age: Dragonborn possesses a lifespan of about 80 years. Culturally and biologically, they reach adulthood around the age of 15.

Characteristics: Brawn +2, Presence +1, Resolve +1

Languages: Ancient Markish, your home Realm's language, and Draconic

Size: Dragonborn's average weight is 110 to 150 kg, and their average height is 2.3 to 2.9 m. Your size is Medium.

Speed: 6 m base walking speed

Damage Resistance: You have resistance to the damage type your Draconic Breath deals.

Darkvision: You can see in dim light within 12 m of you as if it were bright light, and in darkness as if it were dim light. You can't discern color in darkness, only shades of gray.

Draconic Breath: Like your draconic kin, you possess a breath weapon. Find the breath-weapon your dragonborn character possesses in the table below after you have chosen a color for your dragonborn. Once per short or long rest, you can use your Draconic Breath as an action. Each creature in the area must make either a Dexterity or Vitality saving throw depending upon your dragonborn's color. The creatures take 2d6 damage of a type determined by your dragonborn's color on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one. The DV for this saving throw equals 8 + your Vitality modifier + your proficiency bonus. The damage increases to 3d6 at 6th total level, 4d6 at 11th total level, and 5d6 at 16th total level.

Color	Damage Type	Area of Effect
Black	Acid	1 by 6 m line (Dexterity save)
Blue	Lightning	1 by 6 m line (Dexterity save)
Brass	Fire	1 by 6 m line (Dexterity save)
Bronze	Lightning	1 by 6 m line (Dexterity save)
Copper	Acid	1 by 6 m line (Dexterity save)

Gold	Fire	3 m cone (Dexterity save)
Green	Poison	3 m cone (Vitality save)
Red	Fire	3 m cone (Vitality save)
Silver	Cold	3 m cone (Vitality save)
White	Cold	3 m cone (Vitality save)

Dragonborn has the appearance of a humanoid dragon without wings or a tail. The first dragonborn were created in the image of one of the chromatic or metallic dragons, with hues and elemental breaths to match. Their skin is covered in scales of different sizes and hardness. A dragonborn's hand possesses three fingers and one thumb in the faint shape of talons. Their bone structure is sturdy and heavier than that of humans, which gives them impressive and staunch frames.

The Dragon Lovers and the Dragonborn

From the very first time Devistra, the Enneade of egoism, and Suphis, the Enneade of magnanimity, met each other, a roaring fire was lit. They quickly lost themselves in each other. For thousands of years, after the Enneade emerged from the void, Devistra and Suphis were seldom seen by the other Enneade. After the first Enna was created, these two Enneade shifted their attention to creation. Together they explored, planned, and created the draconic Soul aspect, which they both found to be the most beautiful and perfect shape of life. Both Devistra and Suphis adorned themselves in the visage of mighty dragons. As the first tentative experiment, they created the race of the kobolds, and then on to other modest draconic forms, such as the wyvern. All the while, they were patiently learning and building upon what they thought would be the perfect draconic Enna.

Just how instant and fiery their tryst started, it ended very much the same. As the centuries passed they slowly realized that their philosophies could never align, but they did their best to ignore such matters to keep their harmony. Their dynamic irrevocably transformed with the caretaking of their newborn Enna. Devistra wanted one thing for their Enna, and Suphis wanted the other. The conflict between them rose and rose, to the point it became infected and passionate fascination turned to hateful loathing. They turned into a bickering couple that would be icy cold to each other for a decade, find ways to frustrate the other through petty means, and then explode and fight for another decade.

During this time of turmoil between Devistra and Suphis, who had been nicknamed “the Dragon Lovers” by now, they finalized their last, perfect draconic Enna on their own, the metallic and chromatic dragons. This creation was truly fearsome, creatures with great elemental breaths, scales as hard as the finest armors, and vast intellect. They also shared many aspects with their creator Enneade, pride, wisdom, and love of hoarding, be it gold, slaves, wealth, or any other form. But Suphis and Devistra created this Enna out of a spiteful need to make the other jealous and went overboard in one critical aspect; Will. As the dragons grew older and more powerful, these dragons displayed a worrying ability to resist Devistra's or Suphis' commands, and the oldest even being able to reject them entirely. This disobedience turned many Enneade worried. Not only was

the dragons fearsome in their own right, but the fact that they were able to ignore their creators made many feet cold.

As the Enneade realized a war between them was looming on the horizon, pact and groups solidified from paranoia and safety. Devistra and Suphis knew they were targets because as much the metallic and chromatic dragons were powerful, as much the other Enneade lusted to eradicate their creation or claim them for their own. Still, whenever another Enneade or group of Enneade came with brave offers of alliance, they always refused. They could not stand being beholden to anyone other than each other. As the threat rose, desperation brought them together once more. Out of fear of being destroyed, the only other Enneade they could stand in the end was each other. This alliance wasn't without its occasional argument, however. Together they formed one last creation, the dragonborn, a warrior race imbued with the specific quality of loyalty, to protect them from attacking Enneade's Enna as they feared their dragons would not come to their defense.

War of Collapse

Despite their preparations, when the War of Collapse broke out, it didn't take long before Devistra and Suphis were overrun and eliminated. The victorious Enneade quickly attempted to take control of their Enna. While the dragonborn were young and easily manipulated at this time, the chromatic and metallic dragons turned out to be as hard to control as they feared, and the consequences were always mixed for the victor. Throughout the War of Collapse, the dragonborn switched masters quite often as every new Enneade believed themselves capable of controlling the powerful Enna of the Dragon Lovers. Unsurprisingly, this impacted the developing dragonborn culture heavily. Their given trait of loyalty evolved only to encompass their own family and clan, rather than any Enneade patron. Their experiences with the Enneade that later informed their cultural opinions have left them pessimistic towards the gods. They secretly find them all to be incompetent and self-absorbed.

The dragonborn instead sought to defend themselves and carve their path in the World. But not all could agree upon which direction to take. Clans were formed, and after the War of Collapse, they went their separate ways. The clans were most commonly made up of one to three dominant colors. Clans with more colors tend to fail as the varying personalities break the unity from within the community. However, all dragonborn have the potential to be more selfless like Suphis and more selfish like Devistra, no matter the color of their skin. The dragonborn also developed cultural laws of breeding. To retain the history and tradition of the dragonborn colors, two different colored dragonborn are usually not allowed to have kids together. They can still love each other, but no offspring is permitted. This often leads to exile and, in extreme cases, termination of newly born children.

Dragonborn often strive towards mastery of a skill or a profession, as well as to be self-sufficient. Competence and merit matter more than lofty titles and empty promises. They also possess a particular thick-headed brand of stubbornness. When a dragonborn decides on a goal, a skill, or a profession, they often prefer to run themselves into misery before changing their mind. There is nothing else a dragonborn hates more than the act of giving up.

It does not happen often. But when a dragonborn recognizes they require help, they seek help from their own family first, clan second, other clans fourth, and only the gods last. The clan is essential in a dragonborn's life. They take great care to conduct

themselves in a manner that brings honor and prosperity to their clan. Exile from the clan is culturally equated to death in many dragonborn's minds.

Draconic Enna

The color of the dragonborn's skin or the blood type that is the most dominant within the dragonborn decides which elemental type their breath will be and also will influence a dragonborn's personality. This heritage doesn't mean that a golden dragonborn will always be a smaller copy of a gold dragon, but you'll find at least one or two similarities. If you are playing a dragonborn, read through the trait of your preferred color. You don't need to copy, only to be inspired.

Black

Black colored dragonborn are often brutal to their enemies, they rather die than be enslaved, and they enjoy keeping trophies or rewards for defeating enemies or succeeding at tasks.

Blue

Blue dragonborns are impressively patient and calm until they are insulted. They like to patronize the arts and have a love of collecting glittering gems and beautiful jewelry.

Brass

Curious and usually more talkative than their brethren, brass dragonborns respect those who find their conversation enjoyable. They are generous with sharing their knowledge and enjoy collecting magical items, or items that are conversation starters. The best kind of treasure is a talking magical item.

Bronze

The dragonborn of the bronze color is known for their haughtiness, loyalty to a cause, and honorable conduct. Cheating, manipulation, or blackmail never comes to mind for a Bronze dragonborn, and they vehemently punish those that do. Bronze dragonborn loves water, sailing, and the ocean's many treasures.

Copper

Copper-colored dragonborn love pranks. They enjoy a good story, a good laugh, and are known to be generous hosts. They often come to dislike anyone unable to appreciate the humor. Copper dragonborn have a sweet-tooth for beautiful objects made of precious metals.

Gold

The golden dragonborn prides themselves on their incredible sense of integrity. They value their privacy immensely. Gold colored dragonborn have the potential to grow tremendously wise but have a hard time using their gifts as they often fall prey to pessimism or distractions. They enjoy luxurious foods most of all.

Green

Many green dragonborn possess a talent for manipulation, trickery, and subtlety. They enjoy being a part of a smaller group, their undying loyalty worth more to them than the stars in the sky. More insidious green dragonborn likes keeping slaves or servants instead.

Red

Dragonborn of the red color are exceptionally passionate and quick to anger. Red dragonborn are often skilled leaders, and they covet both material and political power.

Silver

The silver dragonborns are known for their charity, gregariousness, and friendliness. They love making new friends and being helpful. Out of all the dragonborns, the silvers are the most curious about other races and places and like to collect, what they consider, exotic things.

White

The white dragonborn's first instinct to obstacles is the most practical and straightforward solution. They never forget a friendly hand or an insult. The white-colored dragonborn is usually the most introverted of all the colors. They treasure particular objects that are tied to specific moments in their past.

Dwarf

Creator Enneade: Moqatri

Current Realm and Enneade: Eternal Suns, Tuat, Atlas, Kess'Aai, Mirrormark, Qedseba, and Inet'Saret

Age: Dwarves possess a lifespan of about 350 years. They reach adulthood biologically as fast as humans do, but they are considered adults culturally around 50.

Characteristics: Vitality +2

Languages: Ancient Markish, your home Realm's language, and Dwarven

Size: Dwarves' average weight is 70 kg, and their average height is 1 to 1.5 m. Your size is Medium.

Speed: 5 m base walking speed. Your speed can not be reduced by wearing heavy armor.

Darkvision: You can see in dim light within 12 m of you as if it were bright light, and in darkness as if it were dim light. You can't discern color in darkness, only shades of gray.

Dwarven Resilience: You have advantage on saving throws against poison, and you have resistance against poison damage.

Crafty: You gain two skill points in Arts & Crafts (A craft of your choice).

Choose one subrace

Hill Dwarf

Characteristics: Cunning +2

Dwarven Toughness: Your health point maximum increases by 1, and it increases by 1 every time you gain a level. You gain advantage on any saving throw made to resist being shoved or knocked prone. In addition, if any effect would force you to move 2 m or more, you only move half that distance.

Mountain Dwarf

Characteristics: Brawn +2

Forge Familiarity: You gain resistance to fire damage. In addition, you don't suffer exhaustion from the heat of a forge or the heat of a desert day.

While a **dwarf** seldom reaches heights above 1.5 m, and their stout frames make them heavier in the perspective of their weight than many other playable races. Their shape allows the dwarves to endure, hardy, and live comfortably in subarctic climates. Their facial features are very similar to that of a human, except for their ability to grow hair. Dwarves grow long and mighty beards during their lifetime. Females grow beards too, but they don't end up as thick as a male's beard. Depending upon the clan or the disposition of the female dwarf, they can have a tradition of shaving their beards. However, what is a universal trait across dwarf tribes is if the individual possesses a beard, it is well-groomed as a matter of pride and hygiene. Dwarf hair color ranges from blond to red, to all shades of brown, and their skin color from pale to light brown.

Moqatri and the Dwarves

Moqatri, as the Enneade of the forge, has always had a passion for creation. Not necessarily the Soul creation that Gera was devoting herself to, even if that greatly fascinated her, but to manipulate the World's materials that the Enneade created. To transform them into new combinations and forms. Indeed, rumor has it that Moqatri was part of the process of creating stones and metals in the early days of the World's creation. Moqatri wanted to create a race that shared her love of innovation and the forge, which could utilize the vast resources of minerals in the earth.

When the dwarves were born, they indeed displayed a prominent talent and a love of creation, just as Moqatri wanted. Their love for stone and metal was not as successful, to Moqatri's dismay. This love could quickly turn to greed and avarice for an individual dwarf. Despite this, the creation of the dwarves was a joyous event for Moqatri, and she spent a lot of time teaching her creation her craft and wisdom. The dwarves came to live in grand halls within mountains and underneath the surface, innovating wonder after wonder in their great forges.

More traits of Moqatri were transferred over to the dwarves than what she originally intended. They picked up her stubbornness, her courage, and her loyalty. These traits she was proud to see. But there were other traits within her she was saddened to see in her offspring, her wariness of strangers, her difficulties with offering forgiveness, and the negative consequences of her great stubbornness and loyalty.

Dwarves and Duergar

With the combined power of Moqatri, the Enneade of the dwarves, Isismia, the Enneade of the Elves, Tot, the Enneade of the gnomes, and Neter, the Enneade of the halflings, they created a Realm together. Neferia. These four Enneade later came to be named "the Patrons" Neferia grew to become the World's largest and most popular than even the Mark in the late Age of Genesis. Several continents dotted the Realm of Neferia, and its nature was varied to allow many different Enna to thrive. Its central and most populated area came to be the central trading hub of all Enna in the World before the War of Collapse. Due to the traffic and the importance of trade access into this Realm, several lesser Enneade negotiated with the Patrons for safe passage into the Realm, have their Enna live their lives on Neferia, and be able to influence Neferia. These deals became so numerous that the Patrons had to relinquish their control of Neferia, and the Realm became owned by all Enneade in existence.

This turned the Patrons into influential players within the power structure of the Enneade at this time. The numerous deals they made with other Enneade often benefited their beloved Enna creations. This favor ensured that the elves, the dwarves, the halflings, and the gnomes were free to come and go as they please on various

Realms. Hence, to this day, these four races possess vast populations in the surviving Realms. However, the open borders to Neferia also opened up a path for the more nefarious of Enneade. Fiends and other monstrosities, with their respective Enneade, started to populate Neferia, preying on its inhabitants. Some Enneade concocted devious plans to steal worshippers from each other. Some succeeded, others did not. But what happened to the dwarves might have been the greatest of victories or the most terrible of tragedies, depending upon who you ask.

By this time, most dwarves of Neferia had settled into a comfortable existence in their respective mountain halls with respectable troves of treasure to their name. However, the clan of duergar was singled out by Amaknuphis, the Enneade of oppression and leader of the Enneade alliance of the Seven Masters of Devils. He had helped create dwellings for some of his psionically gifted race of Enna far beneath the surface of Neferia, the Nuphians. While Moqatri was occupied elsewhere, Amaknuphis strengthened the Nuphian's mental capabilities to ensure that their manipulative whispers reached the ears of the duergar clan far, far above them. Amaknuphis, through his Enna, preyed on the dwarves' lust for material wealth and slowly but surely created an obsession in them that just one more pick swung away deeper into their mountain, a treasure like no other awaits them. The duergar clan, in the end, lost all connection to the surface and dedicated themselves to this single goal. Lower and lower, they dug, and ultimately they reached the finish line, but it was not what they had imagined. Far away and hidden from Moqatri's gaze, the duergar clan was swiftly subjugated by the Nuphian's psychic powers and came to be forever lost from their old patron's embrace of protection.

The duergar clan was heavily experimented upon by their Nuphian masters, and after several generations, they had been altered beyond return. The traits of Moqatri that had brightly colored the dwarves' Souls to shine with loyalty, vigilance, and love of creation had turned ashen grey with the colors of Amaknuphis instead. The duergar turned weak-willed, hateful and selfish, but had also gained minor psychic abilities from their masters. However, in no way had the duergar clan been rendered weak, and their masters underestimated them. All it took was for a leader to arise, someone to bolster the duergar's fighting will. Lysistrata rallied the duergar against the Nuphians by making a contract with Amaknuphis that they would forever serve him faithfully if Amaknuphis gave them a fighting chance against their masters. Amaknuphis agreed and passively supervised the battle. It was a bloody one, and many duergar lost their lives, but they were triumphant in the end and free of the psychic subjugation.

Lysistrata led the survivors up towards the surface again. What they discovered was a dwarven society that had forgotten them, declared them dead centuries before, and a god that had failed to help them. The duergar turned furious and bitter and lashed out at their lost brothers and sisters. This was the spark for a conflict of hostility and hate, still raging on to this day. Wherever the dwarves chiseled out their homes, the duergar followed, hellbent to enact their revenge and take everything that belonged to Moqatri's dwarves, just as everything was taken from them. Due to their limited numbers, the duergar focuses on guerilla warfare. They were to target isolated groups of dwarves and surprise attacks from below their halls. The duergar also targets the dwarves' treasury, planning grand heists to steal their precious gold.

The dwarves, on the other hand, while incredibly bitter themselves after centuries of war and loss, still experience a measure of both guilt and sympathy for their lost kin, and therefore large-scale counterattacks are uncommon practice. They focus mostly on

their defenses to minimize their losses. Scouting parties commonly gather intelligence of the duergar's movements and intentions and extraction teams who attempt to recover any treasure lost.

Death of Moqatri

During the war, the Patrons of Neferia voted for a passive strategy, something that frustrated Moqatri to no end. She wanted both to take a more active stance in the war to defeat the more sinister Enneade and bring down her hammer upon Amaknuphis in revenge. Isismia, Tot, and Neter initially out-voted her with a more neutral strategy. No one believed the war to become as tragic and deadly as it did. For a long time, the Patrons thought that neutrality would benefit them the most when the war was over. But Moqatri was able to keep herself somewhat occupied by secretly crafting arms and armor for her preferred champions, both Enneade and Enna, in the war. When more than half of the Enneade population perished, Tot, Isismia, and Neter started to doubt their position, but the situation was turning more chaotic by the second, and all the while, Moqatri became more and more agitated as her friends continued to be indecisive when her convictions only grew.

In the end phases of the War of Collapse, Amaknuphis was able to gather a powerful force under his name of the survivors of his faction as well as broken pieces of fallen factions, both Enna and Enneade. To not be hunted down and destroyed one after the other, the remaining Enneade had no other choice than to band together. Two sides, seemingly equally powerful, waiting for the other to make a move. This Moqatri ended. Amaknuphis called her out to the battlefield, taunting and tormenting her with her failure to protect her dwarves from him. Her friends tried to calm her down and begged her to see reason. It was a trap. But Moqatri wouldn't have it, her patience ran out, and she charged. The last free Enneade in the loose coalition had no other choice than to follow her. Even one dead Enneade on either side could open up a weakness, and so when Moqatri charged, Neter, Isismia, and Tot decisively charged with her.

Moqatri and Amaknuphis fought hard and long, but Amaknuphis, having absorbed other Enneade prior, was simply too powerful. Moqatri lost, but just as Amaknuphis stood over her corpse to absorb her power out of spite, Suhlmi jumped into the fray, pushed him aside, and stole his prize. That was the end of the story of Moqatri, and even if most dwarves look back at this event as a day of sorrow, as most races who lost their creator Enneade do, slowly but surely most of them grew to accept Suhlmi as their master and migrated to her Realm of Mirrormark after the war. Even if Suhlmi does not share all the qualities of what makes a dwarf a dwarf, they consider Suhlmi in a fair light, with the spheres of passion, wealth, artistry, and the forge, as well as saving their creator Enneade from Amaknuphis' vile grip in her death, Suhlmi has gained some respect from this race of Enna.

Now, most dwarves can be found in great mountain halls in Mirrormark. Instead, a minority choose other Realms for their reasons, where they continue their crafts and attempt to keep the dwarvish culture alive the best they can.

Choose one Subrace

Hill Dwarf

As a hill dwarf, your ancestors lived closer to the surface and other settlements than the mountain dwarves. Instead of bunkering down deep within a solitary mountain and striving to achieve self-sufficiency, the hill dwarves opted to make more shallow homes closer to other civilizations. Out of all dwarf subraces, the hill dwarves were the least suspicious of outsiders and foreigners, and some could even enjoy the company of the other races. Their homes are usually constructed in several hills, instead of one main homestead as it would present itself within a mountain. Some hill dwarves live in larger towns and cities and have given up entirely on the subterranean tradition by living in "normal homes." This diverting path have given hill dwarves some experience in diplomacy and street-smarts, joining in on trade and other interracial behaviors. Due to their more vulnerable position, not relishing a mountain hall's safety, the more sturdy hill dwarves have carried their ancestry forward.

Mountain Dwarf

The mountain dwarves pride themselves on being the true keepers of dwarven culture and heritage. They have burdened themselves with upholding and safeguarding dwarven history and chide the hill dwarves for failing. Most mountain dwarves can be found in Suhlmi's Realm, and then a very select few in Tuat and Qed'Seba. It is the opinion of the majority of the mountain dwarves that it is their religious duty to follow Suhlmi as the successor of Moqatri.

The mountain dwarf is the most stereotypical subrace of dwarf, at least according to other races. They are the wariest of foreigners, somewhat secluding themselves from the rest of the World, and devote their time to religion, tradition, craft, and wealth. The mountain dwarf is the tallest of all the subraces, usually slightly more muscular than their cousins and basic martial training is mandatory.

Elf

Creator Enneade: Isismia

Current Realm and Enneade: Eternal Suns, Progenitor, Tuat, Atlas, Kess'Aai, Mirrormark, Qedseba and Inet'Saret

Age: Elves possess a lifespan of about 750 years. They reach adulthood biologically as fast as humans do, but they are considered adults culturally around 100.

Characteristics: Dexterity +2

Languages: Ancient Markish, your home Realm's language, and Elvish.

Size: Elves' average weight is 45 to 65 kg, and their average height is 1.5 to 2 m. Your size is Medium.

Speed: 6 m base walking speed

Darkvision: You can see in dim light within 12 m of you as if it were bright light, and in darkness as if it were dim light. You can't discern color in darkness, only shades of gray.

Keen Senses: You gain 2 skill points in Perception.

Fey Aspect: You have advantage on saving throws against being charmed, and magic can't put you to sleep.

Trance: Elves don't need to sleep. Instead, they meditate deeply, remaining semiconscious, for 4 hours a day. While you are in this trance, you are in a dream state that you control. After resting in this way, you gain the same benefit that a human does from 8 hours of sleep.

Choose one Subrace

Garden

Characteristics: Intelligence +1

Mental Acumen: You gain four skill points that you can assign in Academics, Arts & Craft, Medicine, or Occult in a manner of your choice.

Cantrip: You can cast one cantrip of your choice from the spell list as Soul Mastery.

Wood

Characteristics: Cunning or Composure +1

Fleet of Foot: 7 m base walking speed

Mask of the Wild: You can attempt to hide even when you are only lightly obscured by foliage, heavy rain, falling snow, mist, and other natural phenomena.

Woodland Athleticism: You gain a climbing speed equal to your movement speed. In addition, you gain one skill point with Athletics.

Isismia, the Enneade of grace and austerity, created the **elves** in her preferred image. Slender, beautiful, with cat-like agility and grace, and a long life to reach maturity and wisdom, they represent their creator's spirit marvelously. Yet, Isismia seldom clad herself in the form of an elf when she came visiting her creation. She favors the ephemeral. The playfulness of a forest stream, the patterns of a flock of birds in flight, or the twinkling blanket of dew on a misty spring morning are forms she has clad herself in the past.

Elves possess the same range of eye color and hair color as humans do, but they can also be born with eye color of spun silver or gold and hair color of vibrant green or blue. On average, they are slightly shorter than humans, more slender, and can display bluish and copper skin tones. They are unable to grow facial hair. The fact that elves enter into a deep trance rather than sleep is quite the unique trait amongst the Enna. The trance is a deep meditation where the elf is still aware of their surroundings but lost inside their own minds. Depending upon the elf's age, these dreams are usually memories that the elf revisits or experiences repeatedly. Some memories can be conjured up by will, like fond memories of people long lost or knowledge gained long ago. Others are like nightmares that plague the elf over and over again until they reconcile with their past. Sometimes, the memories aren't even their own, but their Soul's long lost memories of a past life.

Childhood

As elven children are uncommon, they usually grow up with only adult companionship. The elves don't view the birth of a child with as much joy as other races might. The elves are very much aware of the circle of Souls, and they know that through the trance and the elven child's life, they will experience much pain. The spark infused into the babe could have been as serene as part of the World or an Enneade, rather than coalescing into a single living being.

In their childhood, the elven community helps prepare the child for adulthood, taking great care of their education and moral growth. During this time, the elven child exclusively dreams of a past life. Conveyed to them through the most dominant fragment of their Soul that had in a past life. The dreams can be a great source of advice and guidance or be a grave warning.

Adolescence

As soon as the elven child experiences a dream in their trance that is not of another lifetime, but of their own memory, they have officially transcended into adolescence, now considered to be a full-fledged member of elven society. Typically this occurs when the elf is about 30 years old. During the elven adolescence, the trance will, as the years pass, show less and less of the past lifetime, and in the end, only encompass the elf's own memories. Most elves in adolescence experience an intense lust for discovery and exploration. These feelings do not have to be expressed as a lust for adventure or travel. It can also be a lust to explore different professions or subjects. How this burning curiosity expresses itself depends upon the specific individual's quirks.

Adulthood

The transformation into elven adulthood is harder to determine. As the elf matures, the lust for adventure will temper and, in the end, fizzle out. This is a process that can take a hundred years or up to three centuries. This maturity usually entails a sense of homesickness, a need to settle down and slow down. As the elves' life has roughly run half its course, most elven adults aspire to create a permanent effect on the World, a mark that future generations of elves, or other races, will remember after they are gone. Some elves choose to continue adventuring or traveling even at this age, but now with a clear purpose.

Late Years

As the elves' life starts to come to an end, adulthood's slow placating process comes to its climax. Some elves lose all sense of time and interest in the mortal world. As a result, others grow agitated at their nature and resist the best they can to scramble to achieve as much as possible before this time is over. Throughout this stage in their lifespan, the elven body slowly but surely starts losing its vitality, wilting away. The elf will also experience mental exhaustion, their sharp mind of 600 to 700 years inevitably starting to fog and muddle up. What is also iconic for this stage is that the trance once again changes nature. When an elf begins to dream about other lives' than their own once again, they know that this is the first sign of their eventual end. These memories increase in frequency and strength as the years' pass and are joined by other lifetimes that smaller Soul fragments in their Soul have experienced. The elf can even start to dream about the experiences of alive Enna, as sometimes Soul fragments can have been divided between the elf and the other Enna. The elf remains in this stage from a few months to a century.

Death

If the elf hasn't died of natural causes before the last stage of their life, their body and mind will continue wilting until nothing is left. Before the situation becomes so dire, traditionally, the elf will offer its Soul to its Enneade patron and let them release their Soul from their body. On some extreme occasions, when an elf has failed to perform this ritual, the family releases the Soul of their kin for them. At some point, the body stops working entirely for solitary elves who refuse to give up their Soul, and they simply remain in place and over the centuries join with nature, turning into a meadow, a tree, a bed of mushrooms, etc., and their Soul slowly seeps out of them until there is nothing left.

Isismia and the Elves

Early on in the World's creation, "The Three Sisters" banded together for support and sisterly love. Gera, the Enneade of animals and nature, had the oldest sister's personality and was ambitious and opinionated. Isismia became the stable and supportive middle

sister, and Imenta, the Enneade of mischief, took the creative and playful little sister's role. Imenta and Isismia supported Gera every step of the way as she experimented with plants, animals, and later the feat of creating the human. Some would say that without their undying support to Gera, humans would have never come to be. Similarly, the sisters helped each other with all their early Enna creations, like Isismia's varied form of the elf and Imenta's various species of the "fey." Indeed, the minor fey aspect within the Soul of the elf hails from Imenta's direct influence.

Isismia intended her elves to be regal and solemn, but to her dismay, Imenta's involvement added playfulness and passion within the elf, which has become the cause of many internal struggles for the race. Their primary personality contradicts itself. They vie for dominance throughout an elf's life. How an elf handles the tension between passion and restraint colors their life experiences.

The three sisters created Progenitor together, though Gera, who was at the time the strongest of the three, certainly had a more heavy hand in the process. Progenitor was back then only home for Gera's beasts, Imenta's fey creatures, and Isismia's elves. The elves preferred to find their homes in beautiful forest groves and built elegant and lofty white homes.

The elves' long lives affect their attitude toward mortal life. They seldom get emotionally attached to material belongings. Even a piece of jewelry or a sword succumbs to the ravages of time in the end. Contrary, elves become easily fascinated with the ephemeral, such as the flight of a bee, eclipses, artistic performances, etc. Such an event might only be experienced once but will forever visit the elf in their trance of dreams. Relationships with other races can be hard for elves, not just because of their shorter lifespans, but also because it takes a long time to form a close bond of friendship with an elf, a century is believed to be an excellent foundation to forge close relationships.

Elves can seem emotionless and cold, and especially in the face of tragedy. Elves feel emotions the same way other races of highly intelligent Enna does, but they also understand from experience that feelings are fleeting. More importantly, if an elf becomes too emotionally invested or loses control of their austerity, they will forever relive their loss, mistakes, and regrets through the elven trance. This was the start of the rift between the Three Sisters. Isismia later came to regret letting Imenta assist her in the creation of the elves. Imenta's lack of wisdom introduced too much passion in the elven Soul, which contradicted Isismia's wishes with her elven race, what she wanted to be her masterpiece of creation.

In the presence of the mischievous and playful fey, many elves suffered mental issues. The fey creatures often tempt elves to let go of their self-control. Most fey thinking innocently they are teaching them how to have a good time. Those elves who fell prey would forever be tormented by their experiences through their dreams. Isismia became increasingly dismayed, and the elves could feel that their God was disappointed with them. This created further melancholy. The frequency of the scathing tirades Isismia unleashed on Imenta only increased, and Gera often felt she had to step in and defuse the situation. But Gera did not hide that she often took Imenta's side. Unsurprisingly, Isismia felt less and less like she belonged with the Three Sisters.

And one day, she did. After a few centuries, she entered into a new alliance with Tot, the creator Enneade of the gnomes, Neter, the creator Enneade of the halflings, and Moqatri, the creator Enneade of the dwarves. Together they created the world of

Neferia, which grew to become the most important trading hub in all of the World before the War of Collapse (read more about it in the dwarf section). Isismia hoped that her elves could learn from the other races and outgrow their issues.

Death of Isismia

The elves proved to be an essential resource for Isismia, Moqatri, Tot, and Neter, as the elven might with both sword and magic proved to be competent defenders as their Enneade patron's held and bickered over their neutral stance in the war. When the time came where staying neutral was no longer a choice, and Amaknuphis taunted Moqatri to launch an attack, Isismia joined the fray with her companions she could now proudly call her friends. Isismia was struck down, her powers absorbed by the World as no one opted to claim it during the battle. The elves were now without a loving mother, and a collective sadness spread amongst them, not only because Isismia fell but also because the elves believe that she died, still being discontent in her creation.

After the battle, the elves were divided concerning which of the Enneade to beg for patronage of and spread like the wind between the surviving Realms. But all united in the quest to find a new purpose.

Dusk Elves

One group of elves turned their melancholy to resentment, rejected Isismia's teachings and traditions, banded together, and gave their undying devotion to Borias. To the dusk elves, Borias proved his superiority over Isismia as he is the only Enneade survivor who had a hand in her death. These elves allowed and welcomed Borias influence upon their elven Souls, and they turned into the very young elven subrace of the dusk elves. The dusk elves created their empires in the bowels of Kess'Aai, now preferring the darkness and the cold of the underground tunnels more than their past bright forest homes. The dusk elves evolved to worship strength and power overall, which has affected their elven society profoundly. The dusk elves despise their conservative elven kin for being weak in their pathetic sadness and scoff at their inability to move on from Isismia's frail teachings. The dusk elves' most significant disagreement with Isismia was the thought that their creation was a mistake. The dusk elves only see their superiority, that their many strengths as elves give them the right and the might to rule over other weaker races. When a garden elf, wood elf, or others come upon a loyal dusk elf, the meeting usually ends in insults at best.

Subraces

Garden

All elves possess a fair shot to become well versed with magic, but the garden subrace came to be by exceptional magical talent. Those who count heritage to this subrace are born with a sharp intellect and a keen sense of magic. The garden elves are one of the two most common subraces of elves, the other being the wood elf. Compared to the wood elves, the garden elf is usually even more delicate and often slightly shorter. With their brilliant minds, the garden elves have often ended up as leaders of the elven communities. This has created a sense of superiority in some elven individuals, believing the garden elves to be the greatest of the elven subraces.

Wood

The wood elves were shaped by their focus on their physical prowess rather than intellectual or magical pursuits. They stand the tallest of all elven subraces and the sturdiest, which is still lean compared to most humans' physiques. The wood elves stand united with a peculiar love of forests, as this subrace has for thousands of years made

their homes hidden in its foliage. The wood elves are often down to earth, practical, quick, and possess the uncanny ability to blend into natural environments.

Genasi

Creator Enneade: Aemun, Ghebsis, Hadget & Tefei

Current Realm and Enneade: Eternal Suns, Progenitor, Tuat, Atlas, Kess'Aai, Mirrormark, Qedseba and Inet'Saret

Age: Genasi possess a lifespan of about 120 years. Culturally and biologically, they reach adulthood as fast as humans do.

Characteristics: Vitality +2.

Languages: Ancient Markish, your home Realm's language, and Primordial (one of the four dialects)

Size: Genasi have the same body type as Humans. Your size is Medium.

Speed: 6 m base walking speed

Choose one Subrace

Air Genasi

Characteristics: Dexterity +1.

Unending Breath: You can hold your breath indefinitely while you're not incapacitated.

Mingle with the Wind: Once per long rest, you can cast Levitate as Soul Mastery.

Earth Genasi

Characteristics: Brawn +1.

Earth Walk: You can move across difficult terrain made of earth or stone without expending extra movement.

Merge with Stone: Once per long rest, you can cast Pass Without Trace as Soul Mastery.

Fire Genasi

Characteristics: Resolve +1.

Fire Resistance: You have resistance to fire damage.

Reach to the Blaze: You can cast Create Bonfire as Soul Mastery. Once you reach 3rd total level, you can cast Burning Hands as a 1st level spell as Soul Mastery once per long rest.

Water Genasi

Characteristics: Composure +1.

Acid Resistance: You have resistance to acid damage.

Amphibious: You can breathe air and water.

Swimming Speed: You have a swimming speed of 6 m.

Call to the Wave: You can cast Shape Water as Soul Mastery. Once you reach 3rd total level, you can cast Create or Destroy Food and Water as a 2nd level spell as Soul Mastery once per long rest.

Born of elemental power, the **genasi** are humanoids with distinct features. The genasi are divided into four subraces, one for each element of air, earth, fire, and water. From afar, the genasi can be confused for a human, but the heritage is apparent once up close. Each subrace of genasi has its own skin color, blue to gray for air, green to brown for earth, red to black for fire, and steel blue to turquoise for water. Their stature also

differs, where earth and water tend to be heavier and taller, and fire and air members tend to be shorter and lighter.

Individualistic to a Fault

Like many other humanoid Enna, the genasi was a reactionary creation in response to the human. The primary elemental gods of air, earth, fire, and water (Aemun, Ghebsis, Hedjet, and Tefei), the creators of the elementals, were the parents of the Genasi. Surprisingly, the elemental Enna not only wanted to infuse their creation with potent elemental energy but also as much independence as possible. All other Enneade went the other direction, wanting their Enna to be as loyal as possible. Aemun, Ghebsis, Hedjet, and Tefei had different opinions. They were important voices for protecting the human race when the human capacity of freedom of devotion came into question. These Enneade did not find the trait to be problematic. However, the elemental Enneade couldn't recreate the human trait of freedom of devotion as such was beyond the scope of their combined powers, but they certainly tried.

The result was an Enna race that still couldn't choose another Enneade to devote themselves to or none. The genasi were still bound to their creator. However, their choices and personality are almost unaffected by their Enneade. The genasi turned out to be remarkably individualistic and self-reliant. Consequently, the genasi traveled all over the World, finding their paths and purpose. The genasi never formed a coherent community of their own. Instead, they joined whichever community, organization, or ideology they pleased. Even if the elemental Enneade was proud of their creation, as they value freedom, individuality, and strength of character, the genasi did become troublesome for them as most didn't come to their aid during the War of Collapse, most not seeing the fight as their own. Likewise, almost no genasi returned to take sides when the elemental conflict between air and earth started. Therefore the genasi does not share the bitterness from the elemental conflict between air and earth as many other elemental Enna do.

Self-Assured

For the benefit of their individualistic nature, the genasi certainly does not lack self-confidence. But it manifests individually. It could be everything from quiet determination to boastful arrogance. Genasi are weak to risk, often believing themselves able to face any challenge. However, the genasi aren't fools. They are always searching for opportunities to improve themselves to live up to their self-expectations.

Another consequence of their nature is the unfortunately common occurrence of neglect of their offspring. Many genasi want to have children, but once they are born, the parents want them to become self-sufficient. Besides, they don't want to be tied down by their offspring for too long. This can make genasi children hungry for attention, appreciation, and devotion.

Genasi can be found everywhere, from the most common of places to the most unlikely. Yet, because they are so spread out and forming families is not as common as it is for many other humanoid races, the genasi has become a bit of a rarity.

Air Genasi

Air genasi are prone to quick changes in their emotional state, but anger and other negative emotions do not tend to stay long. They are often very tolerant, curious, and light-hearted.

Earth Genasi

Earth genasi tend to possess a practical and calm mindset. They are often hardworking, patient, and diligent.

Fire Genasi

Fire genasi, on the other hand, are commonly impulsive and decisive. They are often passionate, stubborn, and warm-hearted.

Water Genasi

The water genasi usually possess empathetic and progressive minds. They are often adaptable, sensitive, and serene. However, if you somehow manage to anger a water genasi, their hatred of you will be bottomless and pitch black.

Gnome

Creator Enneade: Tot

Current Realm and Enneade: Eternal Suns, Tuat, Atlas, Kess'Aai, Mirrormark, Qedseba, and Inet'Saret

Age: Gnomes possess a lifespan of about 500 years. They reach adulthood biologically as fast as humans do, but they are considered adults culturally around 40.

Characteristics: Intelligence +2

Languages: Ancient Markish, your home Realm's language, and Gnomish

Size: Gnomes' average weight is 20 kg, and their average height is 1 to 1.2 m. Your size is Small.

Speed: 5 m base walking speed

Darkvision: You can see in dim light within 12 m of you as if it were bright light, and in darkness as if it were dim light. You can't discern color in darkness, only shades of gray.

Gnome's Cunning: You have advantage on all Composure and Resolve saving throws against magic.

Choose a Subrace

Forest Gnome

Characteristics: Dexterity +1

Beast Whisperer: Once per long rest, you can cast Animal Connection as Soul Mastery.

Natural Illusionist: You can cast Minor Illusion as Soul Mastery.

Rock Gnome

Characteristics: Vitality +1.

Artificer's Lore: Whenever you make an Academics: History check related to magic items, alchemical objects, or technological devices, you can add twice your proficiency bonus, instead of any proficiency bonus you normally apply.

Tinker: You gain two skill points with Academics (tinkering). Using Tinkers' Tools, you can spend 1 hour and 10 gp worth of materials to construct a Tiny clockwork device (AV 5, 1 hp). The device ceases to function after 24 hours (unless you spend 1 hour repairing it to keep the device functioning), or when you use your action to dismantle it; at that time, you can reclaim the materials used to create it. You can have up to three such devices active at a time.

When you create a device, choose one of the following options:

- **Clockwork Toy:** This toy is a clockwork animal, monster, or person, such as a frog, mouse, bird, dragon, or soldier. When placed on the ground, the toy moves 1 m across the ground on each of your turns in a random direction. It makes noises as appropriate to the creature it represents.
- **Fire Starter:** The device produces a miniature flame, which you can use to light a candle, torch, or campfire. Using the device requires your action.
- **Music Box:** When opened, this music box plays a single song at a moderate volume. The box stops playing when it reaches the song's end or when it is closed.

Standing at only about 1 m and clocking in at only about 18 to 20 kg, the **gnomes** are full of energy and curiosity, despite their tiny stature. “Expressive” noses are common, and their fair hair has a habit of being unruly. It is common for male gnomes to spend an impressive amount of effort and time to trim and style their beards into curious and eccentric styles. All gnomes have a skin color that ranges from tan to brown, and their eyes can be any shade of brown.

Tot and the Gnomes

If it weren't for Tot's best friend Neter, the Enneade of Halflings, Tot would probably have frustrated and agitated another Enneade to the point of severe retaliation. As the Enneade of curiosity and trickery, Tot had a propensity to get himself into trouble. But Neter, and later Moqatri and Isismia, was always there to drag him out of it. Tot desired to know how the World worked and loved inventing. He was often busy interrogating other Enneade about their body of knowledge, trying his best not to become too annoying. Common victims were Vegomo, Moqatri, Vettias, and several members of the Primordial Accord. Moqatri quickly learned to enjoy his presence, despite his quirks, and they often spent their time together in her smithy. His nature of trickery was expressed in harmless ways to prank and cheer up his friends or destructively against their enemies.

Tot created the race of gnomes to assist him in his explorations, adventures and inventing sprees. Some gnomes even served as his laboratory assistants, which was considered a great honor among the gnomes. Like himself, he wanted his gnomes to be truth-seekers, but not a boring kind. This was expressed in a level of irrepressible curiosity and mischievous behavior. Though gnomes love jokes and pranks, they are still serious about their research and projects. For a gnome, the journey matters more than the goal. For one, success is only the stepping stone to another. Similarly, failure does not affect most gnomes, you can usually try again, and there is always something to learn. All the while, Tot visited successful gnomes to hear about their inventions or discoveries, spurring them on and congratulating them. The gnomes' success was in part Neferia's success, the Realm that Moqatri, Isismia, and Neter created together. There the greater races of Enna and humans could enjoy their latest inventions and live in a contemporary style.

Most gnomes prefer to make their homes in hilly woodlands. They burrow into these hills to create burrows of varying sizes. Unlike the dwarves, though, they enjoy fresh air, commonly venturing out of their homes to enjoy the surface world. Like the halflings, they mostly adopt a peaceful approach to the world, protecting their homes through creative construction and illusions. Gnomes who settle in towns are commonly gem cutters, engineers, sages, or tinkerers. Some Enna families specifically hire gnome

tutors, ensuring that their pupils enjoy a mix of serious learning and delighted enjoyment.

The Hunt for the Golden Egg

When the Dragon Lovers, Devistra, and Suphis, the creator Enneade of the dragons, allied before the War of Collapse, many Enneade were covertly worried about their reunion. Their creations were known to be exceptionally powerful. Even if the Patrons of Neferia had all the intentions to remain neutral in the coming strife, Tot saw a fun opportunity to slow their progress down a bit, maybe. The kobolds, the Dragon Lover's first creation, have always amused Tot. Using their desire to please Devistra, who only saw them as simple slaves, he concocted a plan.

He secretly presented them with the image of a golden egg, intricate and glowing. He claimed that this egg was the lost egg of Devistra, and if they could find it, they would be filled with phenomenal and incarnate draconic powers. Devistra would have no choice but to be grateful and admire the transformed kobolds. An epic goose chase ensued, where Tot dropped hints and clues, brought the egg within their arms' reach only to have a development whisk it away again. In the end, he was forced to quit his puppet play as Devistra discovered he was behind the unruly kobolds' behavior. She threatened to come after Tot and the Patrons with her vengeance. When the kobolds realized it was only a prank, they swore revenge against the gnomes as they endured Devistra's punishment for being so gullible and foolish. But Tot's stories supplied the Patron and their Enna with an unending supply of mirth and laughter amid the war's grim prelude.

Death of Tot

Like many other Enna, when the gnomes lost their Enneade, it was a dreadful experience. Tot fell in the later stages of the war as the Patrons of Neferia had no choice but to join the fray. Neter defended Tot to his dying breath, so Tot could continue to use his contraptions and magic on their enemy, but when Neter fell, Tot rushed in enraged after his friend and met the same fate. For the gnomes' cleverness, they were welcomed to relocate to any of the victors' Realms, except Progenitor. Gera refuses to welcome anyone who cannot control themselves from creating dangerous mechanical devices and unbridled curiosity. After the gnomes had settled into their new homes, it was themselves at their work to not have to face their collective mourning. They agreed that being themselves and continuing crafting was the way to honor their lost Patron.

Forest Gnome

Tot created his forest gnomes after the rock gnomes. In one most rare moment, Tot found himself tired of his inventions and resting in his favorite forest grove of Isismia. There, amongst the chirping birds, dancing leaves, and scuttling of forest critters, he created another kind of gnome—a gnome for his love for practicality and his love of the natural world. The forest gnomes are still curious creatures who love crafting and inventing, but their pursuits are often more down to earth with more practical usability. A rock gnome strives to create a talking mechanical bird, whereas a forest gnome tries to find a more efficient design for a cooking pot. Masters in woodworking, stone-chiseling, and alchemy are the most common amongst the forest gnomes.

Forest gnomes prefer to make their home shallow burrows in forested areas, where individual families within the community are intricately connected through tunnels. They have a unique bond to small birds, critters, and other small animals and beasts, almost a symbiotic relationship. The gnomes help and support the animals living around their burrows, and in return, the critters bring news and warn them of any threats. The

forest gnomes also inherited Tot's talent for illusion magic, and now the use of such magic is deeply ingrained in forest gnome culture, be it either for defense, storytelling, or experimentation. Together with their burrowed homes, woodland support, and aptitude with illusion magic, it is a challenge to find a forest gnome community who does not want to reveal themselves to you. But if you can catch their curiosity, treat their land and animals right, and earn their respect, they can become formidable neighbors. Elves and halflings have historically created strong alliances with any neighboring forest gnome dwelling.

Rock Gnome

A rock gnome warren is full of life and the sounds of invention, curiosity, and affection. Rock gnomes are considered by outsiders the most “gnomish” of all gnome subraces, as they are the most obsessed with invention and experimentation. But they cannot devote all their time to experiment as they require many resources to fuel their hobbies. Resource gathering is usually the most common activity for a rock gnome warren. What they can't scavenge on their own they trade for by selling their inventions.

Two common areas of experimentation among the rock gnomes are mechanics and alchemy. These inventors can focus on everything from the simplest of inventions, like a new and improved shovel, items with exceptional power, or creations with no obvious usefulness just for their beauty and complexity. Once they set their eyes on a goal, they become obsessed with their idea and almost impossible to distract from their task, which has often proven itself dangerous. Walking into walls or rivers is a surprisingly common occurrence. A smart rock gnome stays within their home or with trusted friends that can keep an eye on them when they enter into this obsessive state.

Goliath

Creator Enneade: Ourike

Current Realm and Enneade: Progenitor, Kess'Aai, and Inet'Saret

Age: Goliath possesses a lifespan of about 90 years. Culturally and biologically, they reach adulthood as fast as humans do.

Characteristics: Brawn +2, Vitality +1

Languages: Giant and your home Realm's language

Size: Goliaths' average weight is 130 to 150 kg, and their average height is 2 to 2.5 m. Your size is Medium.

Speed: 6 m base walking speed

Natural Athlete: 2 skill points in the Athletics skill

Stone's Endurance: Once per short rest, when you take damage, you can use your reaction to roll a d12. Add your Vitality modifier to the number rolled, and reduce the damage by that total.

Powerful Build: You count as one size larger when determining your carrying capacity and the weight you can push, drag, or lift.

Mountain Born: You're acclimated to high altitude and naturally adapted to cold climates. In addition, you gain resistance to cold damage.

Goliath's match their home climate well; tough, fair, and competitive. Standing between 2.0 to 2.5 meters tall and weighing between 120 to 150 kg, these humanoid behemoths have an aspect of the giant in their Soul. The goliath race is unable to grow any body hair. Their skin color is ashen grey, and they are decorated from birth with black marks, almost like a tattoo that runs all over their bodies in individual patterns.

Ourike and Goliaths

Ourike, the mother of mountains, has always worshipped strength and fortitude. She was the first creator of the giant, the ogre. She taught her fellow members of the Primordial Accord the formula for the giant's Soul so they could also have their variations of the giant. Even though her creation was ferocious and mighty like herself, she was mocked by other Enneade that the ogre was nothing but a big and dumb brute. Driven to prove them wrong, she created the goliath next, which inherited the giant's strength but was as developed as the other great humanoid Enna races.

Ourike wanted her goliaths to be competitive, so they could challenge those who would look down upon the Primordial Accord as nothing more than creators of dead earth and sea. Undoubtedly instrumental in creating the World, but the new life making era of the Age of Genesis, no longer essential for the World's development. Even if most Enneade disagreed with this opinion, many in the Primordial Accord felt unappreciated. Thus the goliaths became obsessed with their accomplishments, often tallying their deeds and searching to outdo themselves to reach even further heights. Competition is more than just a game for goliaths. It practices and measures an individual's effort and talent, which can be vital for the continuing survival of their tribe.

Goliath's seek to win, but there are not necessarily bad losers. Wise goliaths realize that there is much to learn in failure. Still, it is common that goliaths die young, always seeking more power. Old goliaths are an uncommon sight. Members who do not contribute are exiled. The goliaths refuse to include someone in their tribe who does not pull their weight. Usually, before it can come to that, members who notice their skills and physical health leaving them to prefer to leave the tribe of their own volition to seek an honorable death. Though many goliaths wish to meet their end far before their edge leaves them, in battle or adventure, dreading the experience of their power waning. A goliath tribe often lacks experienced leadership, as most members die before they can accumulate the wisdom that comes with age. The goliath community is not cruel, however, the wounded and the sick are taken care of, but even they are expected to do whatever they can for the tribe even in their weakened state.

Ourike also wanted her goliath to be resourceful and uncomplacent. She ordered her newborn race to carve their home in harsh and cold mountainous environments. There, the goliath tribes grew up to become self-sustaining and collaborative, as a single mistake could bring catastrophe to a whole tribe, and you could never take food, water, and shelter for granted. It also taught them that they could not utterly rely upon material things, like that of money or items, as it can be easily removed. Therefore goliath find societies with inherited influence, titles, and power, to be misguided and erroneous. A goliath can't understand why they should show respect to someone who hasn't earned their glory, nor do they understand why other people follow undeserving rulers. This has often set apart the goliaths from multiracial communities as they often refuse to follow other authorities.

The War of Earth and Air

The reasons why some members of the Primordial Accord turned on each other is not something the goliaths remember. All they know is that the Enneade of Air, Aemun, Verhet, and Zerah, fought against their creator Ourike and her allies Qebnos and Ghebsis. As this conflict was the reason for Ourike's death, they blame the air Enneade for her destruction.

The conflict took place in the middle of the War of Collapse events, and it ripped the ancient alliance of the Primordial Accord apart. It was a bloody affair, where elemental turned on elemental. The goliaths, in particular, were pitted against Zerah's forces of aarakocra. Ourike and the goliaths won, Ourike slew Zerah and the goliaths eradicated the aarakocra. However, her allies weren't as lucky. In the end, it was unclear whether earth or air had won, and the losses were disastrous. When it was all over, those who survived the civil war, both Enneade and Enna, now had to defend themselves against Enneade and Enna taking advantage of their weakened state. Ourike and her goliaths survived until the final showdown between the forces of Amaknuphis and those who would oppose him. In this final battle, Ourike fell, and Borias absorbed her power in the middle of the fight.

After the death of their creator and the end of the War, most of the goliaths sought protection from Borias, as he was the successor of Ourike and also had a philosophy that the goliaths respected. The rest asked Gera for protection, tired of death, and battle the thought that Progenitor would allow them to live in peace and honor for the rest of their existence. The old conflict between air and earth is still a festering wound within the hearts of the goliaths. Bloodshed is common whenever they cross paths with an ally of the air.

Half-elf

Creator Enneade: Isismia & the Lost Seven creator Enneade of humans

Current Realm and Enneade: Eternal Suns, Progenitor, Tuat, Atlas, Kess'Aai, Mirrormark, Qedseba and Inet'Saret

Age: Half-elves possess a lifespan of about 180 years. Culturally and biologically, they reach adulthood as fast as humans do.

Characteristics: Manipulation +2, and two other ability scores of your choice increases by +1

Languages: Ancient Markish, your home Realm's language, and Elvish

Size: Half-elves have the same body type as Humans. Your size is Medium.

Speed: 6 m base walking speed

Darkvision: You can see in dim light within 12 m of you as if it were bright light, and in darkness as if it were dim light. You can't discern color in darkness, only shades of gray.

Fey Aspect: You have advantage on saving throws against being charmed, and magic can't put you to sleep.

Skill Versatility: You gain 4 skill points.

Spawned from the union of human and elf, the **half-elf** combines traits from both races. Slender, but not as slender as the elves. Long-lived but not as long-lived as the elves. Elven features, but not as distinct as the elves. Half-elves hair, skin, and eyes can have any shade that an elf or a human can be born with. Male half-elves can have facial hair, but it does not grow as thick as it does for a human male. The half-elf does not enter into the elven trance when they sleep. However, the half-elven sleeping pattern is dominated by the dreaming phase, where their memories and imagination mingle. Just like humans, half-elves do not usually remember their dreams after they have awoken.

Children of Love and Loss

The encounters between humans and elves in the Age of Genesis sometimes resulted in half-elven children, but never the creation of the half-elven race. The reason why elves and humans can have children with each other is because of Gera. Gera was one of the

seven who created the human race and then instructed her ally, Isismia, on the secret of life. The unconscious result was biological compatibility for children. Something unique for Enna and humans. During this age, the half-elves never amassed enough members to replenish the half-elven race; instead, half-elves were created and lost.

If the half-elves would live with the elven community, the chances of further reproduction were slim. Half-elves in human societies usually fizzled out the elven heritage after two generations. Many elves blame their fey kinship for their lack of judgment regarding their involvement with humans. Whenever their fey nature gets the better of them when they are amongst humans, the creation of half-elves can become a reality. The elves would usually never cultivate romance with humans, knowing what fate they will bring upon their offspring and their human mate. Few find themselves able to emotionally deal with a child and a human partner who will inescapably die before them. Often the elven parent leaves the child in the hands of their human parent and tries as hard as possible to forget both of them.

In theory, the half-elven race seems ideal, blending the elven traits of patience, artistry, and refinement with humanity's passion and drive, but the reality was far more often tragic. Stuck on the border of two kingdoms, few half-elves felt at home in elven or human communities. Half-elves in human cultures were often mistrusted and somewhat excluded from the group, mostly due to their emotional differences. Half-elves also distanced themselves, usually after they lived for a century, as they watched their human friends and family grow old and die. It is common for old half-elves to have trouble forging bonds with humans. In elven communities, their fervor and zeal could be frustrating for both them and other elves. Many half-elves describe their ordeal of living with an elven community as if they and the elves experienced time differently. Childhood elven friends that the half-elf grows up with become alien to them in the end. They became adults while their peers remained children. It was typical that half-elves escaped their childhood homes to search for a place they belonged. Consequently, it is typical for half-elves to devote themselves to an organization or a cause, viewing their newfound purpose as their family, rather than choosing between the human or elven community. Even so, half-elves have always struggled to find their place in society. This forces the half-elven child to become at least adept with their social skills quickly.

The Seven's Attention

After the War of Collapse, as Frostmark turned into a prison for the humans, the half-elven race was almost extinct. But as the Seven controlled their share of the human population, they realized one after the other that they had made no such promises for the half-elven race. As half-human, half-elven, there were unanswered questions regarding the half-elven Soul. Maybe they inherited a part of the unique qualities of the human Soul? Indeed, as a race with no Enneade as a clear creator, half-elves choose which Enneade to devote themselves to, just like humans. Hence, the Seven started to experiment, facilitating half-elven children's births and then transferring them over to their respective Realm. Once there, the Seven allowed them to flourish and build their numbers.

From being a rarity, the half-elven race amassed stable populations. If circumstances do not change, they will become the dominant species one day in the other Realms due to their human nature. Somewhere along this process, the Seven realized, one after the other, that the half-elves do possess stronger Souls than other Enna. However, the difference is so meager that it doesn't have any profound impact on the power of the Enneade. Furthermore, the half-elf does possess the opportunity to choose their

Enneade, but it is not the same as a human's free will. The half-elf's Soul intrinsically yearns for a purpose and a patron, and thus they often attach themselves to the first best thing that comes their way, while a human can go without worshipping an Enneade their whole life.

After the Age of Collapse, the half-elves have become a force to be reckoned with. Because of their passion and devotion to the causes they serve, as well as their patience and perspective to make wise choices. They also possess an absolute resolve to protect and nourish the budding half-elven communities that are starting to emerge—a novelty in their history as a race.

Halfling

Creator Enneade: Neter

Current Realm and Enneade: Eternal Suns, Progenitor, Tuat, Atlas, Mirrormark, Qedseba, and Inet'Saret

Age: Halfling possess a lifespan of about 250 years. Culturally and biologically, they reach adulthood as fast as humans do.

Characteristics: Dexterity +2

Languages: Ancient Markish, your home Realm's language, and Halfling

Size: Halflings' average weight is 20 kg, and their average height is 1 to 1.1 m. Your size is Small.

Speed: 5 m base walking speed

Lucky: When you roll a 1 on the d20 for an attack roll, ability check, or saving throw, you can reroll the die and must use the new roll.

Brave: You have advantage on saving throws against being frightened.

Halfling Nimbleness: You can move through the space of any creature that is of a size larger than yours.

Choose one subrace

Lightfoot

Characteristics: Manipulation +1.

Naturally Stealthy: You can attempt to hide even when you are obscured only by a creature that is at least one size larger than you.

Stout

Characteristics: Vitality +1

Stout Resilience: You have advantage on saving throws against poison, and you have resistance against poison damage.

The **halflings'** appearance is like that of a very short human. They seldom grow past 110 cm tall and generally weigh no more than 18 to 20 kg. Their skin tone ranges from pale to sun-touched. Their eyes and wavy hair are usually colored in the brown spectrum, from the darkest of shades to hazel. Beards are uncommon culturally, but some male halflings like to style their outgrowth to sideburns.

Neter and the Halflings

Their creator Enneade, Neter, the protector of hearth and hospitality, created the halflings in his image. Neter himself, unlike many of the other Enneade, was uninterested in flaunting his power and riches. He preferred to show himself in a small and straightforward form whenever he made his presence known. Early on in the world's history, he and Tot, the gnomes' Enneade, became fast friends. There is no denying the similarities between the halflings and the gnomes. Neter also instilled many of his positive qualities in his creation. He wanted them to value family and home more so than conquest and riches. Curiously the halflings became one of the most tolerant, innocent, and friendly races in the World, welcoming anyone to their hearth if they believed they had good intentions.

Halflings aren't cowards however, they protect their community and family fiercely if they have to, but usually, there is no need. Furthermore, Neter has always watched over his creation and invested a lot of his power and attention for their sake. Many halflings would claim that Neter, out of all the Enneade, loved his creation the most.

A halfling community is ordinarily not more than 100 members, thriving on what the land can provide in the form of agriculture and husbandry, and, if they are lucky, maybe some trade with other communities. Cooperation is therefore critical for halflings, both within their community and without. They like to make their homes out of simple stone and wood buildings or create cozy underground homes in sizable hills, outside major cities, or in the countryside. They usually stay out of politics and conflicts, preferring to avoid danger rather than invite it. Instead, most halflings like to live for the day, helping their community to blossom by their trade and spending their free time socializing or performing some kind of hobby. A halfling community often does not have a leader. Instead, they collectively listen and adhere to the wisdom of its oldest members. Storytelling is the most common practice to grant some form of formal education to younger members of the community. When the day's work is over, and supper is over, it is common for the community to gather in a common room, where elders step forward to tell stories of past halflings, interweaving history, geography, and moral teachings into the stories. It is a beloved tradition for the halflings, and foreigners should count themselves lucky to experience such an evening.

Neferia

After Tot and Neter came to see Moqatri, the Enneade of the dwarves, and Isismia, the elves' Enneade, as dear friends, the four Enneade created the wondrous world of Neferia together and became the Patrons of Neferia. After the halflings had made their home in Neferia and other Enna races migrated to join them in the bustling world, the halflings were inevitably influenced. From interacting with other Enna races, some halflings developed a lust for exploration. Some halfling families started to view the road as their home and carved out a livelihood in caravans or boats, exploring Neferia and beyond. Others became curious about the various cities growing on Neferia and moved from their rural homes to busy towns, earning coin through their professions or hobbies. These halflings routinely became pioneers for other halflings who wanted to migrate to the city as well. Many members of a halflings community find it easier to move into a city if there is already a halflings presence there. In some cities, halfling neighborhoods were established as the halflings prefer to live close to their kin.

Death of Neter

Neter and the halflings were the strongest voice for neutrality within the Patrons of Neferia during the Age of Collapse. After all, it had so far worked well for the halflings,

and they collectively thought that they could ride out this storm too by standing safely on the sidelines. But the war came anyway to the Patrons. By the end of the war, the handful of Enneade that were left divided themselves into two camps. Those who stood with Amaknuphis and those who stood against it. The Patrons couldn't support someone so vile as Amaknuphis, so standing against him became inevitable. During the final conflict, when Moqatri charged into battle from Amaknuphis's insults, the Patrons' fates were sealed. Neter himself fought ferociously, and many Enneade underestimated his ability. But it wasn't enough. Eventually, Neter died defending his best friend, Tot.

Like many other Enna, the event of their creator Enneade's death is a terrible experience that shook the halflings to their core. No longer would they have such a valiant and loving defender on their side. Ironically, their strategy of friendly existence and focus on base food production was very much needed after the war, and all of the surviving Enneade welcomed them to do just that, except Borias. The halflings' non-confrontational nature makes Borias dislike the halflings and vice versa.

The halfling communities became even tighter than before, and they realized that having a member or two of the community who could defend them was imperative for their survival. These days, the community sends out a few promising individuals to gather experience and strength. Still, despite their small stature and innocent behavior, halflings have been able to thrive in the aftermath of the War of Collapse. They seem to possess an uncanny level of luck that helps to keep them out of trouble. Some halflings claim that Neter, in his dying breath, sacrificed all of his power to protect his creation out of love. Even if he is dead, Neter is still a very beloved and worshipped Enneade by all halfling communities.

Choose one Subrace

Lightfoot

This subrace of halfling is the least common of the bunch in this new age. They are the most curious and explorative. A trait that does not always have a happy ending. They are the most common halflings in cities and towns, found on the open road or even out on an adventure. The Lightfoots are incidentally also the smallest of the subraces but possess an impressive talent to go unnoticed.

Stout

In comparison to the lightfoots, the stout is the backbone of the halfling communities. They are the most common subrace and make up the bulk of the more traditional countryside communities. They are known to be prudent and a very uncommon sight to find on the open road unless they are traveling to a close-by market or village to trade.

Half-Orc

Creator Enneade: Hierchon & the Lost Seven creator Enneade of humans

Current Realm and Enneade: Progenitor, Tuat, Kess'Aai, Mirrormark, and Inet'Saret

Age: Half-orcs possess a lifespan of about 75 years. Culturally and biologically, they reach adulthood a bit faster than humans do.

Characteristics: Brawn +2, Vitality +1, Resolve +2, Composure -2

Languages: Orcish, your home Realm's language, and one language of your choice

Size: Half-orcs average weight is 90 to 120 kg, and their average height is 1.5 to 2.1 m. Your size is Medium.

Speed: 6 m base walking speed

Darkvision: You can see in dim light within 12 m of you as if it were bright light, and in darkness as if it were dim light. You can't discern color in darkness, only shades of gray.

Menacing: Even if you have no ranks in Deception and Persuasion, whenever you attempt to intimidate someone, you are considered to at least possess rank 2 in both skills. If you have gained 4 ranks in either Deception and Persuasion, whenever you attempt to intimidate, you are considered to have 5 ranks instead.

Relentless Endurance: When you are reduced to 0 health points but not killed outright, you can drop to 1 health point instead. You can't use this trait again until you finish a long rest.

Savage Attacks: When you score a critical hit with a melee weapon attack, you can roll one of the weapon's damage dice one additional time and add it to the extra damage of the critical hit.

Artificially created by the Keepers of Soul Mysteries, a group of highly esteemed archivists, academics, arcanists, scientists, and theologians from Mirrormark, the **half-orc** is created in the image of a half-human, half-orc. They weigh between 90 to 120 kg and range between 1.5 to 2.1 m tall, with prominent teeth, forward jaws, and skin color between gray to greenish-gray. Scars are a common feature for these Enna, either earned in battle or suffered by orcs' hands to harden their skin and hearts.

Born for Battle

The Golden Pantheon, led by Riahn, suffered some early setbacks in the War of Collapse after attacking the Dragon Lovers, Suphis, and Devistra. They exposed themselves and had to play heavy defense as the League of Discord tried to capitalize on their weakness. Hierchon, a prominent member of the alliance and being the Enneade of warfare, had many a desperate plea come his way to create something that could protect them and push the enemy back. In that stressful environment, Hierchon created the race of the orcs. The orcs were created to be the ultimate war-machine, born and bred for battle and designed to be cannon fodder for the Golden Pantheon to hide behind. The orcs were not used in combat for the sake of the Golden Pantheon for long, as soon afterward, the Golden Pantheon broke apart by infighting where members turned on members. Hierchon died during this event. However, the orcs were a popular creation and were quickly picked up by the remaining members of the Seven Master of Devils and the League of Discord.

When the Age of Collapse came to its end, no one knew what hidden threat the orcs would become. Gera, Teranis, Borias, and Suhlmi welcomed the race to their Realms, accepting them for their own respective reasons. But without a war to cull the orcs' numbers, they spread like wildfire, terrorizing and pillaging everything they came across. The orcs grew their numbers with impressive speed. As part of the Hierchon's design, the orc was blessed and cursed with exceptional reproduction ability for the explicit purpose of replenishing their ranks quickly. This does not only extend to reproduction between orcs but also when an orc would involve themselves with another humanoid (elves, dwarves, half-elves, goliath, etc.). Curiously, the orcs possessed the unique trait of having children with many different humanoid Enna races. These children didn't end up half-orc, half something else, but a full orc every time.

Orcs became quite the menace. In Progenitor, the free races fought back in whatever way they could while Gera saw it as merely natural selection. In Tuat, orcs just became another faction in the perpetual wars in the battle-scarred Realm. In Kess'Aai, the new

challenger was met with a level of enthusiasm as it was something to shake the normal state of affairs. But in Mirrormark, factions banded together to find a solution, viewing the orc problem as a plague. With their magical and technological prowess, the civilized and allied races of Mirrormark mounted their offense together, but the orcs recuperated their losses rapidly and were never discouraged from launching more attacks.

A group stepped forward and offered a solution, a faction that seldom took center stage in politics. The Keeper of Soul Mysteries, a society of Soul researchers, claimed that they could change the orcs from within and thereupon pluck the roots of the issue rather than cut off leaves every year. Many doubted the Keepers' claims, some even laughed, but they were allowed to begin experimentation anyway, just to explore every possible solution. Years went by, and the bloodshed continued, but in the end, the Keepers had a miraculous breakthrough. In their possession was a secret stash of a handful of Soul Gems with a particular kind of Souls within them, human Souls. With these Soul Gems at hand, they had captured a sizable tribe of orcs and had experimented on them for years. In the end, they did the unthinkable. They extracted a part of the orc Soul only to replace it with the contents of one of the Soul Gems and thus artificially created a new race, something in between that of an orc and a human, creating the half-orcs. Further, they were able to repurpose their incredible ability of reproduction. A half-orc child didn't turn out to become an orc, but a half-orc instead, and that was true when the half-orc reproduced with another orc as well.

The desire was that the half-orcs would be more civilized and peaceful than their orc kin. And the hope was that the half-orcs would slowly but surely exchange the orcs, and in the meantime, they could use their might to help defend the free and allied races of Mirrormark. After presenting their success and creation to the other factions of Mirrormark, the half-orcs were soon deployed in battle to fight back against their ancestors. The threat of the orcs decreased every passing year as the half-orc's population grew.

Claiming their Freedom

As the war raged on, now with the presence of the half-orcs, more and more of the free and allied races of Mirrormark refocused from the war, both calling back troops and dividing their attention elsewhere. After all, they had suffered many losses. Any possibility of a break from the war was highly sought after. The half-orcs, on the other hand, experienced their behavior very differently. They started to complain to their superiors and raise their voices to question. Why were they the bulk of the forces defending everyone else against this threat while the other factions of Mirrormark hide behind their walls and technology? What was first an infant race yearning for a purpose and guidance was now entering into their metaphorical teenage years. The Keeper of Soul Mysteries did not handle the situation well, as hindsight would eventually confirm. The Keepers continued their manipulation, with all their smoke and mirrors.

Tension continued to escalate until a substantial number of the half-orcs had enough. They rose against their creators in a roar of destruction. The half-orcs destroyed their research, their facilities, and their very lives. The factions of Mirrormark were unsurprisingly dismayed with the outcome and met the rebelling forces with mostly criticism and threats. In return, the half-orcs fiercely described the reality they had to endure and claimed that their cause was justified. Some factions and individuals were swayed by their words and felt sympathy for their fate. Heated discussions lasted for months between the factions. In the end, the consensus was that the half-orcs that had taken up arms against the Keepers had to be exiled from Mirrormark. Otherwise, there

had to be military retaliation. The half-orcs that had remained loyal were free to stay, but henceforth conscription into their armies would be voluntary for the half-orcs.

Many half-orcs left their home searching for a new purpose in the other Realms under threat of their lives or loved ones. Some, who weren't accused, stayed behind, unable to leave their established lives. In Mirrormark or beyond, a few half-orcs shifted to live with orcs instead of the more civilized communities. Some were curious about their orc heritage, while others preferred their sensibilities over the other humanoid races.

Half-Orcs in the World

Even if the human part of their Souls tempers the orcish part, half-orcs can't run away from their nature. Through discipline, half-orcs can learn to restrain themselves quite successfully, but emotions always lie dangerously close to the surface, waiting for a moment of weakness to break free. Half-orcs are emotionally ready at all times to take action. The simple pleasures in life do not go unappreciated by this race. Half-orcs are impulsive, easy to read, and often relatively easy to persuade. They have a specific weakness for desperate people or causes in need. There is something inherently sympathetic in their Soul that draws them towards underdogs, rebellions, or doomed enterprises.

In orcish societies, half-orcs need to fight twice as hard as their orcish peers, as the orcs generally see them as naturally weaker. Some half-orcs can survive in such a harsh world or even thrive as chiefs due to their cunning. Half-orcs living in civilized settlements usually turn to adventure, mercenary work, or devote themselves to a cause, usually not the most powerful or popular one, however. Despite their empathic and sensitive nature, half-orcs are often met by paranoia and suspicions. The scars of orcs still run deep in the memories of many civilized races, and the half-orcs are usually easy to blame for both their ancestor race's actions as well as every other bad thing that befalls a village.

Malakhim

Creator Enneade: The Celestial Conclave (Acheren, Cassya, Hanimaat, Hazius, Nemaneres, Sephem & Zakdian)

Current Realm and Enneade: Eternal Suns, Tuat, Mirrormark, Qedseba, and Inet'Saret

Age: Malakhim possess a lifespan of about 160 years. Culturally and biologically, they reach adulthood as fast as humans do.

Characteristics: Presence +2

Languages: Ancient Markish, your home Realm's language and Celestial

Size: Malakhims have the same body type as Humans but usually a bit taller. Your size is Medium.

Speed: 6 m base walking speed

Darkvision: You can see in dim light within 12 meters of you as if it were bright light, and in darkness as if it were dim light. You can't discern color in darkness, only shades of gray.

Celestial Resistance: You have resistance to radiant damage.

Healing Hands: As an action, you can touch a creature and cause it to regain a number of health points equal to your total level. Once you use this trait, you can't use it again until you finish a long rest.

Choose one subrace

Acheren

Characteristics: Composure +1

Radiant Soul: Starting at 3rd total level, you can use your action to gain the [Finesse] ability Evasion with two saving throws of your choice. Your transformation lasts for 1 minute or until you end it as a bonus action. During it, if you roll one of the chosen saving throws against any effect that would deal damage to you, you take no damage if you succeed on the saving throw and only half damage if you fail. In addition, once on each of your turns, you can deal extra radiant damage to one target when you deal damage to it with an attack or a spell. The extra radiant damage equals half your total level (minimum 1, rounded up). Once you use this trait, you can't use it again until you finish a long rest.

Cassya

Characteristics: Dexterity +1

Radiant Soul: Starting at 3rd total level, you can use your action to conjure a celestial armor. Your transformation lasts for 1 minute or until you end it as a bonus action. During it, you gain +1 AV and +2 to all saving throws, and once on each of your turns, you can deal extra radiant damage to one target when you deal damage to it with an attack or a spell. The extra radiant damage equals half your total level (minimum 1, rounded up). Once you use this trait, you can't use it again until you finish a long rest.

Hanimaat

Characteristics: Intelligence +1

Radiant Soul: Starting at 3rd total level, you can use your action to potentially save an ally from a devastating attack. Your transformation lasts for 1 minute or until you end it as a bonus action. Once during this duration, when an ally within 12 m of you takes damage from one source, you may spend your reaction to take the damage instead. You gain resistance to this damage. During it, once on each of your turns, you can deal extra radiant damage to one target when you deal damage to it with an attack or a spell. The extra radiant damage equals half your total level (minimum 1, rounded up). Once you use this trait, you can't use it again until you finish a long rest.

Hazius

Characteristics: Cunning +1

Radiant Soul: Starting at 3rd total level, you can use your action to activate a 2 m radius healing aura. Your transformation lasts for 1 minute or until you end it as a bonus action. During it, whenever an ally ends their turn within your aura, they regain 1d4 health points, and once on each of your turns, you can deal extra radiant damage to one target when you deal damage to it with an attack or a spell. The extra radiant damage equals half your total level (minimum 1, rounded up). Once you use this trait, you can't use it again until you finish a long rest.

Nemaneres

Characteristics: Brawn +1

Radiant Soul: Starting at 3rd total level, you can use your action to gain advantage on Resolve and Composure saving throws. In addition, you cast Zone of Truth as Soul Mastery. Your transformation lasts for 1 minute or until you end it as a bonus action. Zone of Truth has a duration of 1 minute when you cast it this way. During it, once on each of your turns, you can deal extra radiant damage to one target when you deal

damage to it with an attack or a spell. The extra radiant damage equals half your total level (minimum 1, rounded up). Once you use this trait, you can't use it again until you finish a long rest.

Sephem

Characteristics: Manipulation +1

Radiant Soul: Starting at 3rd total level, you can use your action to conjure spectral wings.

Your transformation lasts for 1 minute or until you end it as a bonus action. During it, you have a flying speed of 6 m, and once on each of your turns, you can deal extra radiant damage to one target when you deal damage to it with an attack or a spell. The extra radiant damage equals half your total level (minimum 1, rounded up). Once you use this trait, you can't use it again until you finish a long rest.

Zakdian

Characteristics: Vitality +1

Radiant Soul: Starting at 3rd total level, you can use your action to shine in divine light. Your transformation lasts for 1 minute or until you end it as a bonus action. During it, you shed bright light in a 2 m radius and dim light for an additional 2 m, and at the end of each of your turns, you and each creature within 2 m of you take radiant damage equal to half your level (rounded up). In addition, once on each of your turns, you can deal extra radiant damage to one target when you deal damage to it with an attack or a spell. The extra radiant damage equals half your total level (minimum 1, rounded up). Once you use this trait, you can't use it again until you finish a long rest.

Redemption Malakhim

Characteristics: Resolve +1

Radiant Soul: Starting at 3rd total level, you can use your action to conjure spectral wings. The instant you transform, other creatures within 2 m of you that can see you must each succeed on a Resolve saving throw (DV 8 + your proficiency bonus + your Resolve modifier) or become frightened of you until the end of your next turn.

Your transformation lasts for 1 minute or until you end it as a bonus action. During it, once on each of your turns, you can deal extra radiant damage to one target when you deal damage to it with an attack or a spell. The extra radiant damage equals half your total level (minimum 1, rounded up). Once you use this trait, you can't use it again until you finish a long rest.

Malakhim's celestial heritage might not be as noticeable as a Tiefling's fiendish features, yet, once up close, the angelic appearance becomes apparent. Their hair, skin, and eye color can be of any color that a human can be born with, but they usually come with a metallic sheen to them. Eyes can be even more extreme, in some cases resembling liquid silver or gold. Furthermore, the eyes can be unnerving to gaze into as malakhim lack pupils. Their body type is the same as a human, except that malakhim tend to be slightly taller. All malakhim tend to be fine-featured and possess two small spots of feathers on their back, where an angel's wings would have sprouted from.

The Celestial Conclave's Reward

When the human was born in the Age of Genesis, they turned their newborn and curious eyes to the plethora of Enneade around them. Some remained undevoted for their reasons. In contrast, most of the growing human population found patronage and ethical guidelines with a group of Enneade or a single god. Due to their generous and

protective nature, the Enneade of the Celestial Conclave was a popular option. But just as humans have favorites among the Enneade, the Enneade had favorites among the humans too. Exceptional individuals of their choice, paragons of virtue, bravery, selflessness, etc., became the Celestial Conclave's champions. Despite the brilliance of these select few individuals, the Celestial Conclave was not wholly pleased. They still saw the human's weakness, no matter how minuscule it was. Every single champion had to wrestle with their temptations. The Celestial Conclave pitied their champions and the whole human race for their character flaws, or at least that is how the Celestial Enneade saw it.

It was not surprising that the Celestial Conclave wanted to rescue the human race from itself, but they couldn't affect the unwilling humans, and their power wasn't infinite. The Celestial Conclave discussed the matter for several years before they settled on a solution. Each Enneade of the Celestial Conclave chose three of their champions and their most mighty third-order angel. Then each Enneade performed a powerful ritual, moving a part of the angel's Soul into the human, making room within the human Soul by using a part of it as power for the ritual. Henceforth, the human was turned into something else. The Soul was still mostly human, but a significant portion was now celestial. These individuals were the first twenty-one malakhim. Their features changed slightly, but the most significant changes were internal. The malakhim have an easier time than humans being brave, selfless, and compassionate.

To further guide the malakhim towards the angelic virtues, they gained a special connection to the third-order angel they had received a soul fragment from. At any point and from any distance, the angel could check in on their bonded malakhim and converse with them telepathically. The third order angel was named the malakhim's "celestial mentor." The Enneade of the Celestial Conclave was finally content with their champions. It wasn't completely perfect, but they saw incredible improvement. This satisfaction did not last for long, however. The Celestial Conclave failed to realize that human children still have their individual personality traits despite being very malleable. Of course, the malakhim was born with a higher chance of fulfilling the expectations of the Enneade of the Celestial Conclave, due to their celestial kinship, careful upbringing, and celestial mentor, in comparison to humans. But sometimes, a new malakhim rejected their teachings more or less severely. An issue that would only increase as the malakhim population grew.

Flourish or Wilt

From the perspective of the malakhim, we see a human child with some celestial properties born into a very compassionate and loving community, yet burdened with great responsibility and expectations. Indeed, the celestials expected all malakhim to become paragons of celestial virtue and either caregiver for the celestial community or martial champions to guard against fiendish influences. Some malakhim flourished underneath this particular kind of nurture, evolving into what their peers want them to be. But not all personalities take to this treatment as well. Some malakhim children implode from the pressure, either early on or after several years of trying to cope and survive. Others would lash out against the celestial hierarchy, rejecting them altogether. This was most common during the teenage years.

As the malakhim grew more numerous, the same third angel parent for each bloodline of the malakhim couldn't pay attention to all the new members. They had to delegate the responsibility of being celestial mentors to other angels. However, it was ensured that a malakhim child was given a celestial mentor from the same Celestial Conclave Enneade's

fold. Not all of these new celestial mentors were as suitable or prepared to chaperon a malakhim child, and sometimes personalities would simply clash. This did not improve the chances for malakhim children to embrace the celestial's lifestyle.

Due to the quite judgemental existence of the Enneade of the Celestial Conclave and their celestial creations, these children were treated rather inhumanely. If a malakhim child failed to live up to the expectations or, worse, rejected them, they were exiled from the celestial hierarchy, their community and their celestial mentor would stop communicating with them. This is a traumatic ordeal for a malakhim child, as they are forced to leave their family, their safety and lose that voice that has always looked out for them since they were small children. Their only chance of rejoining their community is repenting, but after the initial failure, the celestials would lift the qualification bar even higher up, so the malakhim would decisively prove they deserve the celestial's protection. Some malakhim search their whole life for redemption, seeking what they lost. In comparison, others were happy to make their own lives. But a malakhim's life without the protection of the Celestial Conclave was often tricky, both before and after the War of Collapse.

The Collapse of the Celestial Conclave

Because the Celestial Conclave busied themselves greatly babysitting and molding their malakhim Enna, they were unprepared for the War of Collapse. When it was clear that the Seven Master of Devils had joined the fray, the Celestial Conclave arrogantly overestimated themselves. These two factions of Enneade have always been on the verge of war since almost the creation of the gods. Thus, they were at each other's throats practically instantly. The Celestial Conclave's creation of malakhim was pitted against the Seven Masters' creation of the tiefling. A battle the malakhim lost for one simple reason. Even if the malakhim was superior in their skill, the difference in population size was too vast. Since the Celestial Conclave only accepted malakhim that met their expectations, a significant portion of them had been exiled before the war.

Both Enneade factions were decimated after the initial skirmishes. But what was left of the Seven Masters were the victors in the end. One reason why the scales tipped in the Masters' favor was the victory of their tieflings. Only Hazius survived in the end in the Celestial Conclave, and he protected as many angels and malakhim that he could as he sought new alliances with other Enneade that would stand against Amaknuphis, his surviving Seven Master allies, and other Enneade allies. At the end of the War of Collapse, only two factions remained. Those who had allied with Amaknuphis and those who would stand against him. Hazius fell in the last battle, but so did Amaknuphis. The angels were welcomed by five of the surviving Enneade, as they are still a fearsome and useful race of Enna, and the malakhim followed them.

Today, the angels still try to uphold the Celestial conclave's old practices but are slightly more relaxed than before. Still, some malakhim are exiled from their respective communities if they do not satisfy their celestial mentor, but now there is usually at least one warning before the decision is made. In Eternal Suns, the celestial hierarchy is a powerful faction within the Eye's hierarchy, especially law enforcement, the courts, and the hospitals. Exiled malakhim become second class citizens, as they suffer much economically and culturally. But there are poor but compassionate communities of malakhim in the eye that make sure that the rejected malakhim does not have to be alone. In Tuat, exiled malakhim are forced to find a way to survive on the battlefield between the celestial forces and the fiendish forces. It is common for fiendish troops to track down and pray upon desolated malakhim.

It is common to find malakhim in dangerous environments or search of great deeds, either sent on a quest by their celestial mentor or trying to find their redemption to return to their family and home.

Celestial Influence

As the original twenty-one malakhim was infused with a Soul fragment of a third-order angel created by one of the seven Enneade of the Celestial Conclave, the malakhim's personality traits are influenced by which Celestial Conclave Enneade they are made from.

Acheren

Malakhims that possess a Soul fragment of Acheren are known for their patience and cautiousness. They tend to ponder their words before they utter them, and they are meticulous planners. Acheren's malakhim often excel as guards or community leaders.

Cassya

Malakhims that possess a Soul fragment of Cassya are known for their self-control and discipline. They never overindulge and often dedicate themselves to complex but rewarding tasks. Cassya's malakhim often excel as scholars or teachers.

Hanimaat

Malakhims that possess a Soul fragment of Hanimaat are known for their humble nature and generosity. They seldom overestimate themselves, and prefer to live simply and plainly. Hanimaat's malakhim often excel with professions that make up the backbone of a community.

Hazius

Malakhims that possess a Soul fragment of Hazius are known for their obsessive need to fix broken things. They are fastidious as well as orderly, and they suffer when their environment does not mirror this. Hazius' malakhim often excel as medical practitioners, gardeners, or crafters.

Nemaneres

Malakhim that possess a Soul fragment of Nemaneres are known for their honesty and sincerity. Lying and deceit is very uncommon among this subrace, and they are also known for their adamant principles. Nemaneres' malakhim often excel as law practitioners, investigators, and lawmakers.

Sephem

Malakhim that possess a Soul fragment of Sephem are known for their empathetic minds and hearts. They tend to seek harmony over discord, solutions over condemnation, and they can sympathize with even the vilest of beings. Sephem's malakhim often excel as diplomats, food producers, attorneys, and entertainers.

Zakdian

Malakhim that possess a Soul fragment of Zakdian are known for their altruism and their courage. This subrace vehemently opposes tyranny, and they are always known to volunteer to take actions against injustice and abuse. This subrace is by far the most common to be exiled. Zakdian's malakhim excel as soldiers, prosecutors, and activists.

Redemption Malakhim

Malakhim exiled from the celestial community and cut off from their connection with their celestial mentor experienced the personality traits of their celestial Soul fragment's origin to dim and weaken somewhat. They still possess the quirks they received from their specific "bloodline" from the Celestial Conclave, but they fade more and more over time.

Tiefling

Creator Enneade: All the Seven Masters of Devils

Current Realm and Enneade: Tuat, Kess'Aai, Mirrormark, Qedseba, and Inet'Saret

Age: Tieflings possess a lifespan of about 100 years. Culturally and biologically, they reach adulthood as fast as humans do.

Characteristics: Cunning +1, Presence +1

Languages: Ancient Markish, your home Realm's language, and Infernal

Size: Tieflings have the same body type as Humans. Your size is Medium.

Speed: 6 m base walking speed

Darkvision: You can see in dim light within 12 m of you as if it were bright light, and in darkness as if it were dim light. You can't discern color in darkness, only shades of gray.

Choose a Subrace

Amaknuphis

Characteristics: Resolve +1

Hellish Resistance: You gain resistance to necrotic damage.

Infernal Legacy: You can cast Chill Touch as Soul Mastery. When you reach 3rd total level, you can cast the Suggestion spell as a 2nd-level spell once as Soul Mastery and regain the ability to do so when you finish a long rest. When you reach 5th total level, you can cast the Ray of Enfeeblement spell once as Soul Mastery and regain the ability to do so when you finish a long rest.

Bazilius

Characteristics: Manipulation +1

Hellish Resistance: You gain resistance to poison damage.

Infernal Legacy: You can cast Poison Spray as Soul Mastery. When you reach 3rd total level, you can cast the Blur spell as a 2nd-level spell once as Soul Mastery and regain the ability to do so when you finish a long rest. When you reach 5th total level, you can cast the Invisibility spell once as Soul Mastery and regain the ability to do so when you finish a long rest.

Djosqet

Characteristics: Intelligence +1

Hellish Resistance: You gain resistance to cold damage.

Infernal Legacy: You can cast Frostbite as Soul Mastery. When you reach 3rd total level, you can cast the Armor of Life spell as a 2nd-level spell once as Soul Mastery and regain the ability to do so when you finish a long rest. When you reach 5th total level, you can cast the Enhance Ability spell once as Soul Mastery and regain the ability to do so when you finish a long rest.

Galene

Characteristics: Brawn +1

Hellish Resistance: You gain resistance to lightning damage.

Tempest Strike: Once per long rest, the tiefling can imbue an unarmed or a melee weapon attack with an additional 1d6 thunder damage. At 5th total level, this increases to 2d6 and the tiefling can use this ability twice per long rest, at 11th total level it increases to 3d6 and thrice per long rest, and on 17th total level, it increases to 4d6 and can be used four times per long rest. In addition, the tiefling may treat any hit against an object as a critical hit once per long rest.

Hori

Characteristics: Presence +1

Hellish Resistance: You roll with advantage when resisting the charm and frighten conditions.

Infernal Legacy: You can cast Prestidigitation as Soul Mastery. When you reach 3rd total level, you can cast the Enthrall spell as a 2nd-level spell once as Soul Mastery and regain the ability to do so when you finish a long rest. When you reach 5th total level, you can cast the Alter Self spell once as Soul Mastery and regain the ability to do so when you finish a long rest.

Melanthiosia

Characteristics: Dexterity +1

Hellish Resistance: You have resistance to fire damage

Infernal Legacy: You can cast Thaumaturgy as Soul Mastery. When you reach 3rd total level, you can cast the Hellish Rebuke spell as a 2nd-level spell once as Soul Mastery and regain the ability to do so when you finish a long rest. When you reach 5th total level, you can cast the Darkness spell once as Soul Mastery and regain the ability to do so when you finish a long rest.

Mennem

Characteristics: Vitality +1

Hellish Resistance: Whenever you roll a Vitality saving throw, you do so with advantage.

Infernal Legacy: You can cast Guidance as Soul Mastery. When you reach 3rd total level, you can cast the Augury spell as a 2nd-level spell once as Soul Mastery and regain the ability to do so when you finish a long rest. When you reach 5th total level, you can cast the Locate Object spell once as Soul Mastery and regain the ability to do so when you finish a long rest.

Tieflings look like humans with fiendish characteristics due to their mixed heritage. Their skin color can be that of a human or sport various shades of red or purple. Similarly, their hair color can be red, purple, or blue, or more typical colors like brown or black, but all shades are of a darker tone. Tieflings also have sharp pointed teeth. There is no visible pupil or sclera, the tieflings eyes are one solid color of either gold, silver, black or red. In addition, they have a long and thick tail of 1 to 1.5 m, as well as horns which shape and length are highly individual.

A Fiendish Background

Amaknuphis frequently searched for ways to gain advantages and more followers, and the emergence of the human race didn't escape his scheming mind. Over the centuries from the beginning of time, he and his fellow members of the Seven Masters of Devils facilitated human cults that they could harvest at any time for quick Soul power. They

whispered to the humans empty promises of rewards if they devoted themselves to the Masters. When the time came, they were either sucked for their Souls, used as agents for a specific purpose or turned into tieflings. The Seven Masters had discovered a ritual to exchange a soul fragment of an individual of a particular race with another Soul fragment from another race. The Seven Masters of Devils used this ritual to “reward” willing humans with power by exchanging a Soul fragment of theirs for that of a devil. The devil Soul template is unique in one aspect. Built within the Soul of the devil is the personality trait of submission to devilish authority. When the cultists agreed to accept the power the Masters bequeathed onto them, they decided to give up their freedom. However, since the devilish influence was just a Soul fragment within the tieflings more dominating human Soul, it didn’t impact the tieflings as much as it did “pure” devils. This is where the Seven Masters stepped in. The Enneade of the devils spent a small amount of attention and energy to put pressure on the tieflings. He was holding them in an iron grip of tyranny. Humans turned into tieflings often had no choice but to submit to the will and orders from any devil higher up in the fiendish hierarchy because of this.

Many tieflings were turned into cannon fodder and blunt instruments for conflict and war. Most of these early tieflings were destroyed at the same speed they were created. But some tieflings turned into servants of the Seven Masters and powerful Enna devils. Even if they endured incredible suffering in their demanding servitude, it ensured this new Enna race’s survival.

The Unexpected Freedom

The tieflings almost went extinct in the War of Collapse as the Seven Masters flung everything they had to push for victory. Throughout all of their history, most tieflings haven’t had the opportunity to think for themselves, so when the dust cleared and all their Masters lay dead (and the celestial Enneade as well who they feared would smite them out of existence if they won), it came as a shock for the survivors. They were now free to choose their path. Unfortunately, many of the tieflings had grown accustomed to their chains or even loved them. These tieflings followed their surviving devil superiors into the Realm of Tuat to continue the war against the celestials. Or into the Realm of Kess’Aai to rule. However, both Teranis and Borias didn’t care to enforce complete and utter obedience from the tieflings, and so the tieflings were now free to fight against their submissive streak.

A tiefling’s life is hard. It is a constant struggle against their fiendish nature to not fall prey to the old paradigm of the devil lifestyle. Tieflings who give up the battle and give in to their fiendish Soul fragment become susceptible to subjugation by other mightier tieflings or other creatures who share the fiendish Soul template. As long as the tiefling has not given in to their fiendish nature, the tiefling’s behavior and personality is that of a human, and therefore, as varied. The internal war is always more hard-fought within those Realms where devils and demons are common, as they apply tremendous pressure on tieflings’ Souls. Many generations of tieflings within Kess’Aai and Tuat curse their ancestors’ weakness, choosing their tyrants over freedom. Their choice makes it so much harder for the tieflings today to be free.

Devilish Heritage

Tieflings who let their fiendish nature rule them often acquire new or stronger personality traits. They also become susceptible to devilish influences and may be used as servants or pawns by them. This does not turn all tieflings into horrible and twisted beings, however, it only colors their behavior and personality heavily. The nature of this change depends upon the creator Enneade of the tiefling.

Amaknuphis

The tiefling finds it challenging to be incorrect or weaker than those they meet. Bad losers, they do everything in their power to be seen as superior.

Bazilius

The tiefling finds satisfaction and pleasure in lies. They find it difficult to share personal information about themselves.

Djosqet

The tiefling doesn't experience sympathy like before. The tendency to be calculating and cold increases in magnitude.

Galene

The tiefling's temper shortens, and they tend to lose their restraint when they become angry.

Hori

The tiefling experiences extreme mood swings that sway between energetic and happy, too tired and gloomy.

Melanthiosia

The tiefling embellishes themselves in conversation and can't stand insults. When they encounter someone they idolize, the tiefling attempts to become them, copying everything about them.

Mennem

The tiefling becomes obsessed with hoarding a specific item or category of items. Once the tiefling has acquired something they value, the Mennem tiefling become distressed if they lose it and find themselves unable to give the item to somebody else.

STEP 2 – CHARACTER CREATION EXAMPLES

In this section you'll find two player characters, Helos and Rogath, go through the second step in character creation.

“Helos”

Step 2

Eve decides that Helos is a human and notes down what he gains from the race;

- ❖ Resolve ability score +1
- ❖ Manipulation ability score +1
- ❖ Helos devotes his Soul to Riahn.
- ❖ Helos picks the feat Theologian;
 - Increase Intelligence ability score by +1
 - Helos gains one skill point in Academics (Church of Riahn)
 - Helos gains three Soul Mastery spells, Thaumaturgy, Ceremony, and Sanctuary. He can cast Ceremony and Sanctuary at level 1 once per long rest.

Eve wanted to create a priest from Crowhill, so the race of "human" is the only race that makes sense with the setting and her wishes. Humans receive two +1 in two ability scores of their choice, so Eve considers what would fit for Helos. Helos has exceptional faith, so

Eve argues that his Resolve score should gain one +1. Eve also wants Helos to be an excellent public speaker and gives Manipulation +1. As for the "Freedom of Devotion" trait that humans obtain, Eve decides that Helos has devoted his Soul to Riahn. The Theologian feat fits Helos' background the best, in Eve's opinion, so she notes down that his Intelligence score gain +1, it gives him a skill point in Academics (Church of Riahn), and he learns three Soul Mastery spells.

“Rogath”

Step 2

Carl decides that Rogath is a black dragonborn and notes down what Rogath receives from the race:

- ❖ Brawn ability score +2
- ❖ Resolve ability score +1
- ❖ Presence ability score +1
- ❖ Darkvision 12 m
- ❖ Rogath has a Draconic Breath that deals acid damage (2d6, 6 m line, DV 13 Dex ST)
- ❖ Rogath gains resistance to acid damage.

Carl had a pretty clear picture of wanting to create a theme of a "black knight." The black dragonborn is not only physically a perfect match for this but also emotionally suitable. Dragonborn are stubborn and goal-oriented, and the black variant is especially competitive - perfect for the personality and backstory of Rogath.

STEP 3 – BACKGROUNDS

When you create your character, you gain one background of your choice. A background is essentially a rudimentary description of the character's past, as well as skills, benefits (or drawbacks), and items they have gained from their hobbies, profession, status, etc., they had before play. A background cannot be changed once you have selected one.

Down below, you'll find a selection of backgrounds for your character. They are sorted between two categories; general backgrounds and kingdom-specific backgrounds. The general backgrounds can usually be found in all of Frostmark unless the background states otherwise or comes from another realm. On the other hand, the kingdom-specific backgrounds are only available in one kingdom on Frostmark. They can only be chosen if your character spent a considerable amount of time in that particular kingdom.

A background cannot contradict your backstory. Instead, these two elements should work in tandem to represent your character's past. You can use the background for inspiration when you create your backstory. Especially the kingdom specific backgrounds offer a lot of insight into interesting professions and fates in the realm of Frostmark. If you already have a specific backstory in mind that does not align with any background presented below, transform a background or create a background to fit with your backstory if the GM finds the backstory plausible in his or her game. If any background offers skills, equipment, and traits that represent your character's backstory well, but the overview is not harmonious with it, just change the description of the overview. If no background trait fits your backstory, you and your GM can work together to create a background tailored for your character.

The backgrounds possess these elements:

Origin: Describes in which kingdom or kingdoms the background can be found in the Realm of Frostmark.

Overview: An introduction and explanation of the particular background. By no means is it a full backstory for your character, but a source of inspiration and a set of parameters. Work with your GM to determine further details about your upbringing and current lot in life.

Skill Points: This section grants your character free skill points. Some backgrounds give you a pool of skill points that you can spend on your desired skills. Others specify which skills you can spend your pool of skill points in. And some give you specific points. Remember that the level requirement for rank 3, 4, and 5 still applies.

Equipment: Your character gains the objects listed and adds them to their character sheet. If there is a choice presented to you, such as "choose one tool of your choice", navigate to the Equipment section and find the table for which it refers to and make your selection. You also gain several coins in the form of gp that you can decide to save for active play or purchase equipment with before starting the game.

Background Trait: You gain a background trait that often entails social or economic benefits. In the end, it is up to the GM how these powers can aid you, but it is your responsibility as a player to remind the GM of these benefits when they could potentially be used.

Bond: A bond is something that burdens your character, which can have dire consequences in the wrong circumstances. Selecting a background with a bond results in gaining extra benefits to offset the disadvantage and can create more opportunities for roleplay. Like the background traits, it is up to the GM to mold them into their world and campaign, but it is ultimately your responsibility as a player to keep track and remind the GM of your bond's contents (if you have any).

Some bonds only activate when a certain trigger happens, for instance, "if you are found out, you will be hunted", which can be an adventure of its own. Others can state you feel responsible for a cause, a place, or a group. These are always active and can only be broken by the character if the GM allows it through roleplaying. There are also a few bonds that the player can actively choose with the background and thereby gain some extra starting benefits.

Reference Guide for Lore Terms

Some of the explanations for different backgrounds include specific terms found in the particular kingdom's lore section, but here is a cheat list to remind you of some of the terms.

Chieftain Idris: A particular ambitious female chieftain from Beornhelm currently occupying almost half of Greenfield with her forces.

Duke Grimcolt: A regional noble of northern Oldwood. Lost his brother to the Beornish threat. He has turned his back on the crown to protect the northern border in his way.

Dukes of the Empire: The governors of the 10 administration areas of Frostmark in the Imperial years. These areas later transformed into the kingdoms of Frostmark.

Geanor: A champion of Riahn who conquered and claimed all of Frostmark. He laid the foundations for the Empire that his daughter, Empress Leana, finalized.

Journeyman: A title for an aspiring artist or crafter from Sirendale. A Journeyman is a Practitioner who has started their journey to become a Master.

Lysander: The royal family of Sirendale that about a hundred years ago gave away a crown's sibling to rule in Oldwood too. The royal family in Sirendale was eradicated by a Beornish raid.

Master: A title for a master artist or crafter in Sirendale. To become a Master, you must become a Journeyman first and then impress a council of other Masters to gain the title. The title also comes with the duties of a noble ever since the Empire's influenced Siren society.

Nodensia: An island to the southwest of Karthmere, controlled by Stormholme but usually quite isolated.

Practitioner: A graduated apprentice artist or crafter in Sirendale. A Practitioner has the right to open a shop and do business without the oversight of a school or Master.

Ravenmoor: A noble couple of southeastern Oldwood who have seized power in the region and have thrown out the Church of Riahn from their lands.

Sacred Arms: A military force that was originally the army of Geanor. After the Empire fell, the Sacred Arms' headquarters is now situated in Crowhill and functions as the Church's private army.

Shaman: A title for any particular wise man or woman of Beornhelm.

Unmarked, Diligent, and Valiant: Titles of social ranks in Armathain.

Vision: The name of a tribe's chieftain in Eastcreek.

Vocation: A category word for a theme of professions in Malgrave. A student is given a Vocation to practice that suits their talents after they have graduated from school.

Vocation Explorer: The name of the category for all scientist professions in Malgrave.

Vocation Protector: The name of the category for all military and police professions in Malgrave.

Warchieftain: The chieftain of chieftains in Beornhelm.

Wayfarer: An ancient shamanistic organization of the Oldberry woods.

General Backgrounds

These backgrounds are general and universal – capable of fitting into any Realm or any campaign setting.

Artist / Crafter

Origin: Anywhere

You earn a livelihood by the grace of your skill in a particular art or craft. You may have learned on your own by trial and error, obtaining expertise where you can, visiting other villages, or even traveling to other practitioners for a lesson here and there. You may have studied as an apprentice, alone, or one of many under a master. Or you can be a wanderer, traveling to expand your horizons and your craft.

Skill Points: You gain Arts & Crafts (your choice) rank 2, Empathy rank 1, Persuasion rank 1, and you gain three skill points that you can assign in any skills of your choice.

Equipment: A set of Artisan's Tools of your choice, a trinket from the Random Trinket table, a set of commoner's clothes, a set of traveler's clothes, and a belt pouch containing 20 gp.

Background Trait: Earned Respect

- ❖ **Income:** You earn a modest lifestyle if you practice your art or your craft.
- ❖ **Reputation:** You become a household name in the village or neighborhood you are practicing your art or craft in.

Bounty Hunter

Origin: Beornhelm, Eastcreek, Greenfield, Karthmere, Oldwood, Sirendale, Stormholme
Your trade-in people and items, performing the dirty work your employers find too difficult, too dangerous, or too nasty. No matter your justification and reasons for partaking in this profession, the payment, and the thrill make it worthwhile to you. In some kingdoms, you have to hide your illegal activities, which also increases the thrill and the reward for you.

In Stormholme, you can walk proudly in daylight. You are far from the worst kind who walk the streets of Stormholme with no persecution. In Eastcreek, the Church can employ you to track down and drag tribal resistance members to justice. In Karthmere and Sirendale, you would have to be sleek and discreet, but there are always rich nobles and merchants who would love to employ you. Greenfield, you can thrive, there are always victims you can sell to either side of the conflict and plenty of people in the middle to take advantage of. In Oldwood, it all depends upon where you are. In some towns, you can declare your profession loudly, and no one would bat an eye, and in other towns, you will be hunted by the town's guard if they ever found you out. Beornhelm is another story. Bounty hunting is considered a dishonorable trade, and you might be killed on sight if you show your face in front of the bastions of tradition in Beornhelm. But if you hide out in the wild and let your customers come to you in secret, there can even be riches to acquire in that cold land.

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in the Deception, Investigation, and Persuasion skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: Thieves' Tools, ink bottle, a set of traveler's clothes, ink pen, 5 pages of parchment, 3 trinkets from previous bounties by rolling on the Random Trinket table, and a belt pouch containing 10 gp.

Background Trait: Names, Faces, and Places

You possess a remarkable memory surrounding the details of your quarry. You can recall specific details in conversations, remember the written text, and sketch faces and places with impressive accuracy. After some time hunting a bounty, you gain the uncanny gift of being able to think one step ahead of your quarry, just like you were life-long friends.

Charlatan

Origin: Anywhere, but most often than not, from Karthmere or Stormholme
You have always had a certain way with people, intrinsically knowing their motivations and emotions. Due to the circumstances of your economic situation or your delight, you decided to use your gift for your gain. You can be a fortune teller, operating where the church can't see you or does not care. A merchant overselling their goods, or even paddles false ones. Or you can be interested in even greater heists, spinning elaborate nets of lies around you.

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in the Deception, Empathy, and Subterfuge in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: Disguise Kit, Forgery Kit, a set of fine clothes, tools of the con of your choice (ten stoppered bottles filled with colored liquid, a set of weighted dice, a deck of marked cards, or a signet ring of an imaginary duke), and a belt pouch containing 15 gp.

Background Trait: Second Life

- **Official:** You possess a certain knack for falsifying documentation.
- **Second Identity:** You have created a second identity for yourself, including all the backstory, disguise, and paperwork you need to make it near immaculate.

Criminal

Origin: Anywhere

You possess a rich history of breaking the law, and you are certainly not a puppy in the seeding underbelly of society. You also gained some criminal contacts through your exploits, even if you have decided to distance yourself from your old life. Or you might still be in full swing, trying to thrive in a world you can only describe as cutthroat.

Skill Points: You gain five skill points, assign them in the Athletics, Deception, Perception, Subterfuge, and Stealth in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: Thieves' Tools, a gaming set of your choice, a set of dark common clothes including a hood, and a belt pouch containing 15 gp.

Background Trait: Criminal Contacts

Your criminal contacts may come in handy in many different situations. You know how to communicate with your contacts, even over vast distances, as you can easily recognize which caravaner, sailor, or message service you can trust. You may have several minor and untrustworthy contacts and one significant contact that is reliable.

Bond: Criminal Activity

If the authorities learn of your activities they will attempt to apprehend you and punish you for your crimes.

Cultist

Origin: Anywhere

You are a member of a cult, either presently or formerly. You have sacrificed much for your faith or your service, risking your own life and forcing you into a life in the shadows or far from the urban areas of Frostmark. Work with your GM to establish just whom or what you have worshipped and what characteristics your cult has. Maybe you are directly working for your cult, or you have been sent out on an important mission. Perhaps you have left your cult, unable to continue with their practices, or living with the consequences.

Skill Points: You gain five skill points, assign them in the Academics (a language of your choice), Academics (religion of your choice), Arts & Crafts (your choice), Deception, Occult, Perception, and Subterfuge skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A symbol relating to membership in your cult, Tattoo Kit, dark hooded vestments (or others that relate to your cult), a set of common clothes, and a pouch containing 15 gp.

Background Trait: Cult's Embrace

- ❖ **Aid:** While at or near your cult's home, you can call upon fellow cultists for assistance, so long as it does not require them to engage in an overly-hazardous task, and you remain in good standing with your cult.

- ❖ **Knowledge Abound:** You have advantage on any Occult or Academics checks that directly involve your object of worship.

Bond: Heretic

If your participation with the occult would come to light, the Sacred Arms inquisitorial agents will attempt to hunt you down and silence you.

Entertainer

Origin: Anywhere

A happy and attentive audience is food to you, it nourishes your soul. From an early age, you have drawn pleasure from being the center of attention, and you have always felt at home on a stage. You can be born with or develop some arts on your own, serving as maybe your village local comedy genius or nighttime singer. Other arts and stages require more formal education. A master, college, or group of performers are some of your options. Some of these entities require tuition, others you must prove your worth to before they accept you as a pupil, and in sporadic cases, your genius might be discovered by a local or traveling practitioner of the arts.

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in the Arts & Crafts (your choice), Athletics, Deception, or Persuasion in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: Disguise Kit, a musical instrument, the favor of an admirer (love letter, a lock of hair, or trinket), a costume, common clothes, and a belt pouch containing 15 gp.

Background Trait: Perks of Popularity

- ❖ **Income/Residence:** As long as you enrich the establishment you are visiting, they will often supply you with food, a place to stay, and coin the form of a modest to a comfortable lifestyle.
- ❖ **Reputation:** Your skill within your particular field of the arts have made you desirable wherever you go. In places you have already performed you might have become a local figure, known for your prowess. In most villages, towns, and cities you are welcome to perform in their various establishments, be it theaters, courts, inn, or taverns.

Far Traveler

Origin: Either a native Creek or hailing from another Realm

Most people on Frostmark don't travel far from their home region. Those that do often possess professions that enable such, like merchants and Journeymen. Even so, most larger communities have seen many cultures, Stormers make trade in Sirendale, Beornish warriors hired as mercenaries in Karthmere, and on and on. Although, there is one culture on Frostmark that rarely travels outside of their country's borders, the Creekish.

You may be one of the few Creeks that has traveled outside of Eastcreek. Or you can be a wonder to Frostmark as your origin stems from another Realm. The journey ahead will be an adventure for both you and the people that encounter you.

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in any skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A gaming set of your choice or a musical instrument of your choice. One set of traveler's clothes, poorly wrought maps from your homeland, a small piece of jewelry worth 10 gp in the style of your homeland's craftsmanship, and a pouch containing 5 gp.

Background Trait: Outsider

If you do not disguise yourself, the fact that you are a curiosity is obvious to other people. This can attract attention both good and bad, those that search for a way to exploit you and those who would want to help you.

Bond - optional: Out Of This World

If you choose to come from another Realm, you might not be welcomed anywhere the Church of Riahn holds influence over. Should you walk into one of their agents, if equipped, they might try to exterminate you. You gain an additional skill point of your choice and extra 5 gp in your purse.

Guard

Origin: All Realms

You have worked as a guard in your hometown or a town you have traveled to. In comparison to military folk, as a guard, your mission was to ensure peace and order within the community you served. But not all communities enjoy principled and courageous guard forces. In Beornhelm, guards are equivalent to huscarls, full-time warriors who act like their chieftain's right arm. In Stormholme, it would be mercenaries or guild enforcers employed by one of the guilds, imposing guild law over a community. Establish where your character served as a guard, how "principled" they were, and whether or not they still feel responsible for their community.

Skill Points: You gain five skill points, assign them in the Animal Handling, Athletics, Empathy, Investigation, Leadership, Perception, and Persuasion skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A uniform in the style of your unit and indicative of your rank, a horn with which to summon help, a set of manacles, and a pouch containing 10 gp.

Background Trait: Overwatch

- ❖ **Aid:** You can ask your colleagues, former or not, for aid, so long as it does not require them to engage in overly-hazardous tasks, and you remain in good standing with the organization.
- ❖ **Familiarity:** From your experience with both the bastion of law and the den of criminality, you can readily recognize both institutions, and their activity, in an urban environment. You also possess a propensity for danger, reading the atmosphere in a room or a situation far faster than most.
- ❖ **Income:** As long as you serve as a guard you gain a modest lifestyle from those who you protect or directly from the crown.
- ❖ **Residence:** You may find a dry bed within a barracks of the guard organization you have served.

Bond: Eternal Watch

You feel responsible for the town you guard, even if you have left your post. When trouble brews there, you feel you have to offer aid.

Hermit

Origin: Anywhere

Either by choice or force, you have lived far outside of society from an early age or senior year. You learned valuable lessons about survival and solitude. One day, you stumbled upon a great mystery.

Skill Points: You gain three skill points, assign them to any skills of your choice. Additionally, you gain Medicine rank 1 and Survival rank 1.

Equipment: A scroll case stuffed full of notes or a trinket from your earlier life, a winter blanket, a set of common clothes, and Herbalism Kit, and 5 gp.

Background Trait: Mystery

During your time as a hermit, you came across a great secret. The quiet seclusion of your extended hermitage gave you access to a unique and powerful discovery. This discovery can be a revelation about the World, the Enneade, or something political. It may be a forgotten place or a discarded relic. Work with your GM to determine the details of your discovery and its impact on the campaign.

Hunter

Origin: Anywhere

You are a hunter. You spent several years mastering your craft. Tracking, stealth, trapping, shooting or crafting, whatever your tactics are, you know your way around wilderness and its inhabitants. You might be a hunter for trade, using your skills to find food and earn coins. You could be employed by a noble house, tending to an area of wilderness for them and aiding them in their hunts. Or even a beast hunter in Beornhelm or Oldwood charged to remove threats to your community.

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in the Animal Handling, Arts & Craft (Leatherworking or Carpentry), Athletics, Perception, Stealth, and Survival skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: Leatherworker's Tools, woodcarver's tools, or Herbalism Kit. A trophy from your most glorious hunt (a piece of a tooth, antler or claw, etc.) and a small pouch containing 10 gp.

Background Trait: Expert Survivalist

- ❖ **Expert Tracker:** Your experience with naming tracks is so vast that you can by a simple glance determine its origin, granted the track is native to your region.
- ❖ **Feeder:** Finding food has become second nature for you, and you are automatically able to provide enough food for one day to a number of people equal to your proficiency bonus, including yourself. Provided that the land offers berries, small game, water, and so forth.
- ❖ **Income:** You can earn a poor lifestyle but you provide your food.

Noble

Origin: Anywhere except Beornhelm, Eastcreek, Malgrave, Sirendale, and Stormholme
You have been born with or granted a noble title. You are familiar with influence, duty, privilege, collecting taxes, and owning land. Work with your GM to establish the general history and members of your noble house. Or maybe you performed some kind of heroic deed, perhaps as a knight, that elevated you to landowner and nobility.

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in the Academics, Animal Handling, Leadership, and Persuasion skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A set of fine clothes, a signet ring, a scroll of pedigree, and a purse containing 25 gp.

Background Trait: High Society

- ❖ **Income:** If you are still in good standing with your taxpayers, you can earn a comfortable lifestyle.
- ❖ **Reputation:** By the grace of your noble title you wield influence in society. Those lower than you in the social hierarchy tries their best to serve you and not displease you. The higher social ranks see you as one of their own and you are granted access into their circles.

Variant: Knight

Another path to nobility is a knighthood. From heroic acts of service or many years of singular dedicated service, a soldier or civilian may be granted knighthood, equivalent to the lowest rank of nobility. As a knight, you are given some land that you have the right to tax. However, higher nobility might still view you as more of a commoner rather than equals. If you select this variant, exchange your background trait High Society to the Attendant trait below.

Variant Background Trait: Attendant

When you select the Noble as your background, you may choose this trait instead of High Society.

- ❖ **Followers:** In your employ, there are three attendants dedicated to you and your household. You decide how these attendants serve, but examples could include squire, majordomo, stable hand, servant, cook, messenger, etc. The attendants are commoners who will not join you in battle or endanger themselves, but they will perform mundane tasks for you as long as they are paid. They will leave their service if they are frequently endangered or abused.
- ❖ **Income:** As long as you remain in good standing with your taxpayers you earn a comfortable lifestyle. After your attendant's salaries have been paid, your effective lifestyle becomes modest instead.

Bond (Not a requirement): My Name

You may select this bond to gain two extra skill points to distribute between the skills provided by the Noble background. You feel responsible for your noble house, at every turn trying to increase its influence and protect its name.

Outlander

Origin: Anywhere but Malgrave

As an outlander, you have lived away from civilization, alone or in a small community. You have learned how to live in tandem with nature. You might be a part of a hunter-gatherer community, a gang of outlaws, or maybe even a small explorer unit.

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in the Animal Handling, Arts & Crafts (your choice), Athletics, Medicine, Perception, Stealth, and Survival skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A staff, a hunting trap, a trophy from an animal you killed, a musical instrument or an Herbalism Kit, a set of traveler's clothes, and a belt pouch containing 10 gp.

Background Trait: Nomad

- ❖ **Provider:** From your extensive experience with surviving in the wild, you have gained a knack for finding food. If the land can provide, you can procure food for one day to a number of creatures (including yourself) equal to your proficiency bonus.
- ❖ **Wild Memory:** You gain an impressive ability to be able to recall natural features, terrain, settlements, and other geographical layouts.

Priest

Origin: Any kingdom except for Beornhelm and Stormholme

You have spent most of your life in the service of the Church of Riahn, conducting rites and ceremonies for worshippers. You have lived a relatively protected life, either as one of the few small community priests or serving a larger abbey or cathedral. You've also studied the sacred texts of the Radiance of Geanor.

What function did you fill in your service? Are you one of several noble offspring sent to gather more influence for your family or simply a village kid with talent that the local priest took in as an apprentice? Maybe you were a high priest who was called to serve Riahn differently?

Skill Points: You gain Academics (Rianish) rank 1 and Academics (The Church of Riahn) rank 2. You gain Empathy rank 1 or Medicine rank 1, your choice.

Equipment: The holy symbol of Riahn (a gift to you when you entered the priesthood), a prayer book, a Tattoo Kit, vestments, a set of common clothes, and a belt pouch containing 15 gp.

Background Trait: Partial Soul Drain Ritual

You have been taught how to perform a Partial Soul Drain ritual, but chances are that you don't know the true nature of it. You may combine Soul Fragments and Soul Power to reform Soul pieces to 2 Soul Power or more.

Background Trait: Shelter of the Faithful

- ❖ **Aid:** If you ask your fellow priests for aid they would offer it, provided the assistance is not hazardous and you remain in good standing with your church.
- ❖ **Income:** You command respect among those who share your faith. As long as you work as a priest you gain a modest lifestyle.
- ❖ **Residence:** You can expect free healing and care at any establishment of the Riahn faith. In the church or abbey you are serving in, you gain a permanent residence. You may also be borrowed a residence in an establishment of Riahn in your travels.

Bond: Devotion To The Sun

You have devoted your Soul and work to Riahn and his Church.

Scholar

Origin: Anywhere but Beornhelm

You spent years learning the lore of the World, provided what information is accessible. You scoured manuscripts, studied scrolls, and listened to the greatest experts on the subjects that interest you. Your efforts have made you a master in your fields of study.

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in the Academics (your choice), Investigation, Medicine, and Perception skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A bottle of black ink, a quill, a small knife, a letter from a dead colleague posing a question you have not yet been able to answer, a set of common clothes, and a belt pouch containing 10 gp.

Background Trait: Inquiry

From years of working as a scholar, you have learned how to obtain information. Be it from a library, university, interview with the right person, etc. Whenever you do not know a piece of information, your intuition tells you where you could find it. The GM can rule that some information is not obtainable through normal means and might require dedicated effort in several sessions or through a whole campaign to learn.

Background Trait Variant: Tutor

You are a teacher of some sort, sharing your knowledge with your community. You could either be a private tutor for a noble or part of a government initiative to teach the general population what they need to know. This is a common life path in Malgrave. You also gain an extra 5 gp in your pouch when you take this trait instead of Researcher. Instead of the Researcher trait displayed above, you instead gain the ability to teach.

- ❖ **Teacher:** You can impart a skill point you know onto others by spending at least 1-hour instruction sessions with them for a total of 100 hours.
- ❖ **Income:** If you find work as a tutor you may earn a modest lifestyle.

Sailor

Origin: Anywhere but Malgrave and Greenfield

You have served on a sea vessel as a sailor and gained extensive experience with the harsh mistress of the ocean or the risky business that plagues Frostmark's lakes and rivers. You may have been a fisherman on your boat or a part of a larger fisherman company. You might have been a river or lake trader, operating on the large lakes or extensive river networks of Frostmark. Or you might have served on imposing military vessels in Karthmere or Stormholme.

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in the Academics (navigation), Arts & Crafts (carpentry), Athletics, Medicine, and Perception skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A belaying pin (club), 15 m of silk rope, a lucky charm or a random trinket from the Random Trinkets table, a set of common clothes, and a belt pouch containing 10 gp.

Background Trait: Maritime Familiarity

- ❖ **Aid:** You can ask your fellow sailors for assistance and they would mostly answer to your benefit, provided the assistance is not hazardous and you remain in good standing with them.

- ❖ **Familiarity:** You and your companions can sail with your old crew or a crew you know for free. You would be expected to work during the stay and you will have to accept the possible inconvenience of the ship not immediately sailing where you want it to.
- ❖ **Income:** You can find work as a sailor, and can earn a poor lifestyle through it.

Bond (Not a requirement): Second Family

You have sailed with a particular ship and crew for a long time and it has become your family. You care greatly for their wellbeing and would offer assistance if they asked you for it. You gain one extra skill point if you take this bond.

Soldier

Origin: Armathain, Crowhill, Greenfield, Karthmere, Malgrave, Oldwood or Sirendale
 Maybe you wanted glory when you signed up to become a soldier. Perhaps you felt you simply wanted to do the right thing, protecting your great nation or an organization you admire. Or maybe you had no other choice, forced conscription or an empty stomach. You were trained to hold your own with your weapon, how to follow orders, and march as one. Work with your GM to establish which military organization you were a part of, some of your experiences as a soldier, and how far you advanced through the ranks.

Skill Points: You gain Athletics rank 2, and gain three skill points, assign them in the Animal Handling, Deception, Empathy, Leadership, Medicine, Perception, Persuasion, and Survival skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: An insignia of rank, a trophy/memento taken from a fallen enemy/friend (a dagger, broken blade, or piece of a banner) or a trinket from the Random Trinket table, a gaming set of your choice, a set of common clothes, and a belt pouch containing 15 gp.

Background Trait: Army Hierarchy

- ❖ **Familiarity:** You possess inside knowledge of your military organization's operations, as well its strengths and weaknesses.
- ❖ **Income:** As long as you serve your military organization you earn a modest lifestyle.
- ❖ **Jurisdiction:** You possess a military rank, and soldiers of lower rank recognize your authority.
- ❖ **Residence:** You are welcome in any establishment of your military organization and you might be able to acquire simple equipment from it.

Bond: Military Service

No matter your rank and your circumstances, your oath to your military organization might demand active service from you. At any point in the campaign, the military organization will ask for loyalty and work from you.

Trader

Origin: Anywhere

Traveling merchants can be found roaming every corner of the world. From the crowded marketplaces of massive cities to caravans wending through thick forests or across difficult swamps to isolated settlements, villages, and trading posts scattered in the wilderness. Traveling merchants study the traditions, needs, and exports of cultures from across the land, giving them a broad view of the world. You have worked on a merchant caravan. Whatever role you assumed in the merchant caravan, you learned the

ins and outs of commerce in a way few people understand. This knowledge can prove invaluable for those who pursue the adventuring life.

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in the Academics (your choice), Animal Handling, Arts & Crafts (your choice), Deception, Empathy, Perception, and Persuasion skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A set of Artisan's Tools of your choice or a musical instrument of your choice, a magnifying glass, a set of traveler's clothes, and a pouch containing 20 gp.

Background Trait: Trader's Etiquette

- ❖ **Income:** If you have the means you may earn a comfortable lifestyle through your profession.
- ❖ **Smooth:** As long as you do not wish to insult, your experience dealing with different cultures and people have left you informed of cultural quirks and incessantly polite. You can avoid, and to an extent help your companions to avoid, breaking etiquette or unwittingly offend another person or faction.

Unassuming

Origin: Anywhere

Most people in your past didn't believe in you. You grow up in a poor to a modest lifestyle, destined to perform some kind of manual labor. Perhaps you were a farmer, a herder, a cobbler - frankly, someone who wasn't special. You may come from any village, town, or city, but nothing grandiose has happened in your life so far. This is how most people live on Frostmark, and they are usually satisfied with their life, but you weren't. You wanted greatness. You wanted to see more of the world than in your hometown. You wanted to become someone. So you set out, trying to find adventure and glory, picking up skills as you went. Depending upon your skills and location, you can earn a modest to poor lifestyle, the GM's choice.

Skill Points: You gain eight skill points, assign them to any skills of your choice, but at least two points must represent your past profession.

Equipment: One kit, tool, or musical instrument of your choice, common clothes, a random trinket from the Random Trinket table, and a pouch containing 10 gp.

Urchin

Origin: Anywhere

You grew up as an urchin, fighting every single day for your continued existence. You might have been orphaned or kicked out due to desperation or shame. You learned early how to survive in an urban setting, begging at the right places and times, stealing without getting caught, finding a place to sleep safely from the elements in alleys and rooftops. You know the city you grew up in better than most other citizens. Somehow you have saved up or come upon 10 gp, enough to break you free from your squalid existence. How did you gain this money? What is your goal now?

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in the Athletics, Deception, Perception, Stealth, and Subterfuge skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A small knife, a map of the city you grew up in, a pet mouse, a token to remember your parents by, a set of common clothes, and a belt pouch containing 10 gp.

Background Trait: Key To The City

Through your years living on the streets, you can navigate your cityscapes with grace and cunning. You, and any possible company you keep, can travel from one place to another twice as fast it would normally take, provided you are not in combat.

Kingdom Specific Backgrounds

These backgrounds are specifically tailored to fit with the various kingdoms of Frostmark in the current era of the continent. However, if one would find inspiration with any of these within a campaign that is not placed in Frostmark in this time – talk to your GM! Perhaps it can be edited to suit your character and campaign.

Bloodhound**Origin:** Applegate

You belong to a special archetype of the watch of Applegate, called the Bloodhounds. The Bloodhounds are considered an authority in Applegate, tasked by their communities to root out any kind of corruption in Peeler society. They are highly respected and unofficially possess the same rank as a captain of the guard. Part of a Bloodhound's job is to stalk suspicious foreigners, guard diplomats, and follow caravans, both those that Applegate sends out and those who visit Applegate. If they point someone out as a troublemaker, they are quickly disposed of or exiled.

The Bloodhound is a watchful defender, paired with a loyal and intelligent dog. The Bloodhounds, and their families, are breeders and dog trainers who create stalwart and imposing hounds with remarkable tracking capabilities. The hound and the human fight together if the situation calls for it. The hound finds and pushes the target out in the open, and the human uses either a spear or bow to force them to surrender or simply end them on the spot.

Skill Points: You gain five skill points, assign them in the Animal Handling, Athletics, Empathy, Investigation, Perception, and Persuasion skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A set of manacles, the insignia of the Bloodhounds, five dog treats, a dog toy, a uniform, and a pouch containing 15 gp.

Background Trait: Root Out Threats

- ❖ **Aid:** You can ask for aid from any other Bloodhound operative as long as the task is not too dangerous and you remain in good standing in Applegate.
- ❖ **Income:** The people of Applegate supply you with a modest lifestyle as long as you work for their interests.
- ❖ **Jurisdiction:** As a Bloodhound, you possess jurisdiction in almost all of Applegate. You have the right to enter private houses, go through any gate without paying the tithe, and have the right to inspect any shipment or storage on Peeler land. Sometimes this applies in other kingdoms as well, but only under the flag of official Peeler business.
- ❖ **Residence:** There is always a comfortable bed waiting for you as you travel within Applegate.

Bond: For The New Applegate

You believe in the new Applegate and its community. You see it as your responsibility to protect this growing new kingdom.

Peeler Priest

Origin: Applegate

As a priest of Applegate, you fulfill a lot of different functions in society. As this war-torn kingdom's infrastructure is still suffering, there is a general lack of educators and doctors in Applegate. The priesthood, either sent here from Crowhill to live and work or native Peelers trained by the Church of Riahn, is the Applegate's religious authority. Though the Church's agents, most often than not, serve as the village doctor, educator, and advisor.

Applegate supplies the Church with food and labor, and in return is repaid with aid in rebuilding but also supplying and paying these priests. Most priests serve alone in their respective communities, some fortunate enough to harbor an assistant or an apprentice to lessen their responsibilities. Due to these priests' varied workload, religious sermons and duties are generally conducted only when it is a necessity.

Skill Points: You gain three skill points, assign them in the Academics (your choice), Animal Handling, Arts & Crafts (your choice), Empathy, Leadership, Medicine, and Persuasion skills in a manner of your choice. You gain 1 rank in the Academics (Rianish) skill and 2 skill points in the Academics (Church of Riahn) skill.

Equipment: The holy symbol of Riahn (a gift to you when you entered the priesthood), a prayer book, a tool of your choice, a Tattoo Kit, a set of common clothes, and a belt pouch containing 15 gp.

Background Trait: Partial Soul Drain Ritual

You have been taught how to perform the Partial Soul Drain ritual, but chances are that you don't know the true nature of it. You may combine Soul fragments and Soul power beyond the Soul power of level 1.

Background Trait: Priest Of All Trades

- ❖ **Aid:** In the area, you are serving as a priest, or have served, the population treats you with respect and will offer aid if the task is not hazardous and you remain in good standing with them.
- ❖ **Dynamic Mind:** You gain half your Cunning modifier (minimum 1) to any skills you do not possess points in.
- ❖ **Income:** As long as you serve your community and the Church or Riahn you may earn a modest lifestyle.

Bond: Devotion To The Sun

You have devoted your Soul and work to Riahn and his Church. You are sanctified to perform religious ceremonies of Riahn.

Warden

Origin: Applegate

You belong to the ancient order of the Wardens - a group of forest defenders whose origins are said to have come from Geanor's swift and brutal archer units. The Wardens were the original elite bodyguards of the Duke of Applegate, assigned when the Empire was formed. Applegate was originally an administrative area covered in leaf forest, but it has been transformed gradually to be dominated by agricultural fields.

When the Empire fell, the Wardens swore to protect the royal family of Applegate instead. Nowadays, only a few natural forest patches remain, and there is no Duke or royal family to guard anymore for the order. Thus, only a few members still practice the ancient ways, mostly for tradition than anything else. The Wardens were excellent shock and guerilla units, who hid in forested areas and surprised their enemy with traps, bows, and axes. Today's Wardens have to pick up additional work to make ends meet as they are not funded by any government or community anymore.

Skill Points: You gain six skill points, assign them in the Animal Handling, Arts & Crafts (your choice), Athletics, Empathy, Perception, Subterfuge, Stealth, and Survival skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: An insignia of the Wardens, a random trinket from the Random Trinket table. A tool, a kit, or a musical instrument of your choice, a set of traveler's clothes, and a pouch containing 10 gp.

Background Trait: Death From Above
You gain the Skulker feature.

Bond: Ancient Oath
As a Warden, you have sworn an oath to protect the sovereignty of Applegate.

Knight of Valiant

Origin: Armathain

You weren't your noble parents' first child, and thus, you weren't tasked with the administrative duty of one day ruling over the family name. Instead, as a younger sibling, your talents were explored to discover how you could best serve your house. You showed an aptitude for combat. Thus, you were initiated to become a Knight, an elite warrior of Armathain.

The Knights are the last defenders of the crown and the noble houses of Armathain. You are given the best Armathainian steel to make you equally protected as you are intimidating, as well as a well-armored warhorse to carry you into battle. They teach you how to ride, how to conduct yourself with authority, and how to swing a weapon. You are seldom deployed on the battlefield, but if you are, you wade through the enemy lines to break their spirits and their formation. To protect your back and to serve you, you are assigned two squires of the Integrity mark, sworn to your side. Out of battle, you serve as a bodyguard for noble scions and diplomatic envoys, keeping the ruling tier of Armathain safe. To keep your edge, there are often tournaments and other knightly games for the Knights.

Skill Points: You gain 1 rank in Animal Handling, Athletics, and the Leadership skill.

Equipment: A set of fine clothes, an insignia of your rank, a scroll of pedigree, and a purse containing 20 gp.

Background Trait: Squires

- ❖ **Followers:** You are served by two squires who have sworn to protect you. The squires are capable in their own right and can both perform mundane tasks as well as handle conflict. The squires' CR rating equals your level divided by 5 (minimum ½, rounded down) and they possess [**Tactics**] as their AO. You and

your GM create the character sheets together, but you control them in battle. The squires can leave your service if you frequently abuse them or if you break your bond.

- ❖ **Income:** As long as you serve as a Knight of Armathain you may earn a comfortable lifestyle.

Bond: Oath Of The Knight

You have sworn an oath to protect your charge, be chivalrous and defend Armathain and its crown.

Arbalist

Origin: Armathain

As an Arbalist of Armathain, you have been placed in a peculiar position. You are an absolute necessity to protect your lord against the Knights, but at the same time, you are viciously despised, not only by your enemy but also by your lord. You are plucked from the Diligent Mark's ranks by the grace of your loyalty and trained to use the heavy crossbow. In a skirmish between the nobles, you and your fellow Arbalists might be the only ones who can stop the enemy's Knight. Since you have this purpose on the battlefield, you are often accused of dishonor, and many soldiers, regardless of rank, want little to do with you. Even if your effectiveness is vital in Armathain, your numbers are limited to only a handful per influential noble to limit your power.

Skill Points: You gain five skill points, assign them in the Athletics, Deception, Perception, Stealth, and Subterfuge skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A gaming set of your choice, a random trinket from the Random Trinket table, a set of common clothes, and a pouch containing 20 gp.

Background Trait: A Double-Sided Sword

- ❖ **Income:** As long as you are assigned as an Arbalist you may earn a comfortable lifestyle.
- ❖ **Reputation:** Even if you are socially mistrusted, you are a commodity amongst nobles. They fear disloyalty and assassination attempts more than the social backlash of hiring you, so you enjoy a better lifestyle than most people in the Diligent Mark. You are not given more influence or improved rights than others in your status, but you are treated better by your lord and given more coin than your brothers and sisters in arms.

Bond: Forced Subterfuge

At the threat of termination of your employment or other punishments, a lord can attempt to persuade you to accept more shady assignments, like spying or even assassination.

Unmarked Insurgent

Origin: Armathain

You are Unmarked and unsatisfied with your lot in life. You live outside society in squalor, and there are no prospects to rise beyond your living conditions. There is no hope for you and thousands of others like you. You find the Mark system to be both unfair and horrid. Whilst the highest of nobles live in decadent palaces, you have to fight for scraps of food, and you are often exploited to do the dirty work of the higher marks. You have decided to take action and do whatever you can to fight back. You may be a

part of a bigger network of people with similar thoughts, or you may be alone. But you are determined to do something.

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in the Athletics, Deception, Perception, Stealth, Subterfuge, and Survival skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A small knife, a gaming set of your choice, Thieves' Tools, a random trinket from the Random Trinket table, a set of common clothes, and a pouch containing 5 gp.

Background Trait: The Downtrodden's Embrace

- ❖ **Familiarity:** You have lived your life amongst the poor and wretched and you know your way around this world. Even in other kingdoms, you know how to act in similar environments of criminals and the wretched, even aptly befriending them. You know where to find shelter, protection from the authorities, and special equipment.
- ❖ **Residence:** You are known by the Unmarked to fight for their cause and thus you can always find a secluded place to sleep, some food, and tightly closed lips amongst your kindred.

Bond - optional: The Rise Of The Unmarked

For two additional skill points to assign between the selection of skills provided above, you have sworn a personal oath to fight for and protect your fellow Unmarked. You wish to see another world where they are treated fairly.

Chieftain

Origin: Beornhelm

You may have risen in ranks as a talented warrior and leader or taken the title by force. Either way, you were a Chieftain over a small community in Beornhelm. You commanded respect from your subjects and your warriors, and you may have been more or less loyal towards the Warchieftain. Work with your GM to establish whether you suddenly left your position as Chieftain and why. Or maybe you lost the position to another, and you somehow survived? Or maybe your tribe was wiped out? Nevertheless, you aren't a Chieftain anymore.

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in the Animal Handling, Athletics, Leadership, Perception, Persuasion, and Survival skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A trophy taken from a fallen enemy, a random trinket from the Random Trinket table, a set of traveler's clothes, and 20 gp.

Background Trait: Chieftain's Presence

Gain the Menacing feature.

Bond - optional: Holding on to Power

Disregard the questions of how you lost your chieftain status in the overview because you are still a chieftain. Instead, work with your GM to flesh out your chiefdom.

- ❖ **Competition:** Any competitors you might have will constantly search for any sign of weakness to strike and take what you have. Be warned.
- ❖ **Duty:** You are responsible for executing the law, planning the economy, and overseeing the wellbeing of those who live in your chiefdom. The Warchieftain

may issue orders to you, and if you do not follow them your territory will be conquered by the Warchieftain.

- ❖ **Income:** If you choose to take this bond, you gain a wealthy lifestyle, and a village of people (thralls, peasants of different kinds, crafters, some warriors, and maybe a shaman) that follows your orders.

Raider

Origin: Beornhelm

You are a raider and warrior of Beornhelm who has joined in on campaigns to bring wealth and thralls home to your community. You could have raided Greenfield, Sirendale, Oldwood, or even joined one of Warchieftain Kynemund's ambitious raids to Karthmere and Armathain. You might have a second profession on the side during the winters, like a farm and a homestead to come back to. Or you might have been a full-time warrior, acting as a bodyguard for your Chieftain or even the Warchieftain.

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in the Animal Handling, Arts & Crafts (your choice), Athletics, Perception, and Survival skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A trophy taken from a fallen enemy, a random trinket from the Random Trinket table, a set of traveler's clothes, and 15 gp.

Background Trait: Savage Onslaught

- ❖ **Familiarity:** You are familiar with the terrain of the regions you have raided in the past.
- ❖ **Feature:** You gain the Savage Attack feature.
- ❖ **Income:** If you would find work as a bodyguard you earn a modest lifestyle.

Shaman

Origin: Beornhelm

Originally, the shamans were a part of the Wayfarers, the caretakers and guides of the Oldberry Woods, the pine forest that stretches from the peaks of Beornhelm down to northern Eastcreek. The Wayfarers have sworn to not engage in political agendas, but many of them broke their oaths to fight the war against Geanor in Beornhelm. These oath breakers became the shamans, a new organization that was more active in their respective communities.

Some mysteries of the Wayfarers became lost to the shamans, but they created plenty of their own too. They also picked up several utility functions, acting as advisors and doctors. After the purge of magic in Frostmark, most of the shamans today are naturalists of different kinds. Serving as tutors, healers, and advisors to their communities and their Chieftains. They stand both in high regard and stand outside the general law of Beornhelm. Only another shaman can accuse and judge another shaman. Though, in the far-reaching tundra, high mountains, and deep forests of Beornhelm, there might be a few shamans who are still able to practice the ancient ways.

Skill Points: You gain seven skill points, assign them in the Academics (nature), Academics (religion), Animal Handling, Arts & Crafts (your choice), Empathy, Medicine, Occult, Persuasion, and Survival skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A staff, a Herbalism Kit, a Tattoo Kit, a set of bone dice, a set of traveler's clothes, and a pouch containing 15 gp.

Background Trait: A Shaman's Role

- ❖ **Income:** The shamans have evolved to not have a common goal anymore, some simply worship the land and make right by it, others aiding the freedom of Beornhelm and its people, and some devoting themselves to a lost god. As long as you serve your community you may earn a modest lifestyle.
- ❖ **Jurisdiction:** You can't be judged by the law of man in Beornhelm, thus you have almost free reign to roam and to practice your craft. It is only when you directly oppose a chieftain or is judged by another shaman that you must answer for your actions.

Bond: Servant of the Community

The shamans enjoy a lot of freedom and respect because of their invaluable service to the community they serve. They act as spiritual guides, advisors, and doctors. If the community of a shaman believes that they have broken this contract, the community can appeal to neighboring shamans. If those shamans believe those concerns to be true, they will first issue a warning. If that is not heeded the shaman in question will either be exiled or executed for their crimes. An exiled shaman finds no home in any Beornish community and loses all benefits of the background trait above.

Crow Priest**Origin:** Crowhill

As a priest from Crowhill, you have a unique perspective and relationship to the Church. In addition to their spiritual duties, most of the priesthood in Crowhill also manage the administrative work of the Church. These duties include overseeing the food imports from Applegate, the pressure on the House of Representatives in Karthmere, the salvation of Eastcreek, the initiatives to regain popularity in Oldwood and Malgrave, the strong diplomatic ties with Armathain, etc. Besides working as a priest in Crowhill, you can be a missionary in another kingdom, a priest independently conducting their investigations about troubling news, a priest sent out on a mission, a priest who experienced a call from Riahn, or even a priest who has defected the Church for his or her reasons.

Skill Points: You gain two skill points, assign them in the Academics (your choice), Empathy, Investigation, Occult, and Persuasion skills in a manner of your choice. You gain 1 rank in the Academics (Church of Riahn) skill and 1 rank in the Academics (Rianish) skill.

Equipment: The holy symbol of Riahn (a gift to you when you entered the priesthood), a prayer book, a copy of the Radiance of Geanor, vestments, a Tattoo Kit, a set of common clothes, and a belt pouch containing 15 gp.

Background Trait: Partial Soul Drain Ritual

You have been taught how to perform the Partial Soul Drain ritual, but chances are that you don't know the true nature of it. You may combine Soul fragments and Soul power beyond Soul power of level 1.

Background Trait: Priest Of The Sun God

- ❖ **Aid:** If you ask your fellow priests for aid they would offer it, provided the assistance is not hazardous and you remain in good standing with your church.
- ❖ **Familiarity:** The Crow Priest has unique insight into the Church's administrative system and operations.

- ❖ **Income:** You command respect among those who share your faith. As long as you work as a priest you gain a comfortable lifestyle.
- ❖ **Residence:** You can expect free healing and care at any establishment of the Riahn faith. In the church or abbey you are serving in, you gain a permanent residence. You may also be borrowed a residence in an establishment of Riahn in your travels.

Bond: Devotion To The Sun

You have devoted your Soul and work to Riahn and his Church. You are sanctified to perform religious ceremonies of Riahn.

Sacred Arms Agent

Origin: Crowhill

As an agent of the Sacred Arms' civilian branch, your origins do not matter because they don't exist anymore. Your past has been erased, both on paper and in your mind. Now only the cause remains. There are several paths within Sacred Arms, but yours were selected for you after determining your usefulness and talents.

If you had a head for numbers, you might have become an administrative assistant in a secret headquarters. If you had an aptitude for going unnoticed, they trained you to become a spy. If you had a knack for people, they would turn you into an inquisitor. If you had the stomach for blood, you were turned into a mindless instrument of violence. Depending upon your skills, you might have become more or less independent in your work, only needing to report back here and there. You might have been sent on a specific or deep infiltration mission. Or you could have tried to escape, attempting to evade your former colleagues.

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in the manner of your choice.

Equipment: Two tools or kits of your choice, a set of common clothes, a set of traveler's clothes and a set of fine clothes, and a pouch containing 10 gp.

Background Trait: Plucked from all Paths of Life

- ❖ **Feature:** Choose a feature that you are eligible for.
- ❖ **Income:** As long as you continue your service you earn a comfortable lifestyle.
- ❖ **Jurisdiction:** If you are still a member of the organization or can accurately fake it, you have special jurisdiction in some kingdoms. In Applegate, Crowhill, Eastcreek, Greenfield, and Karthmere, you do not answer to local authorities and can not be punished for executing your mission. In Armathain, Malgrave, and Sirendale, the agent must first ask for permission to enact their task or be treated as a criminal. In Beornhelm and Oldwood any Sacred Arms presence is considered unwelcomed and local authorities will be openly hostile if you reveal your identity.

Bond: If not, then Death

As an agent of the Inquisition, you enjoy a lot of freedom, except the Inquisition itself. A mission failed, or a string of mistakes might lead to the Sacred Arms terminating you as a liability. If you disobey and refuse orders, they have no time for dissenters and will, once again, attempt to terminate you. If you try to escape their clutches, they will try to hunt you down and destroy you as the threat you are and everyone you might have revealed your identity to, or worse.

Sacred Arms Soldier

Origin: Crowhill

You are a soldier in the Sacred Arms, the personal army of the Church of Riahn. Sacred Arms is notorious for its rigid training and its extensive traditions and rituals. A soldier of the Sacred Arms is foremost tasked with protecting the Church in Crowhill and all their diplomatic envoys, serving as bodyguards. They are also the main peacekeeping force in Eastcreek today after the successful occupation. You may be a personal bodyguard of a church official in their travels, an active soldier in Eastcreek, a captain stationed in Crowhill who experiences a call from Riahn, or you could have even deserted for your reasons.

Skill Points: You gain five skill points, assign them in the Animal Handling, Athletics, Investigation, Leadership, Medicine, Perception, and Persuasion skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: An insignia of rank, a trinket from the Random Trinket table, a set of traveler's clothes, and a belt pouch containing 20 gp.

Background Trait: Army Hierarchy

- ❖ **Familiarity:** You possess inside knowledge of Sacred Arms' operations, as well its strengths and weaknesses.
- ❖ **Income:** As long as you serve the Sacred Arms you earn a modest lifestyle.
- ❖ **Jurisdiction:** You possess a military rank in Sacred Arms, and soldiers of lower rank recognize your authority.
- ❖ **Residence:** You are welcome in any establishment of the Sacred Arms and you might be able to acquire simple equipment from the organization.

Bond: In the Service Of The Sacred Arms

- ❖ **No Resignations:** You have sworn an oath to Riahn and his church. If you have defected from Sacred Arms you will be met with hostility if you ever come across them again, you will be barred from any Church of Riahn, and if you're not careful with what you do and say, the Inquisition may come knocking on your door.
- ❖ **Service:** No matter your rank and your circumstances, your oath to Sacred Arms might demand active service from you. At any point in the campaign, Sacred Arms will ask for loyalty and work from you.

Naturalist

Origin: Eastcreek

Naturalists can have many different names, and many paths can lead you to become a naturalist in Eastcreek. Essentially, a naturalist is someone who has devoted their life to the land. You can be a religious figure of Gera, a technically outlawed profession but a tradition that is barely surviving through the use of deception. Or you can be someone who worships the World itself. You can be a healer, someone who studies the earth and its plants and animals, or a wise advisor to a Vision.

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in the Academics (nature), Animal Handling, Deception, Investigation, Medicine, Occult, Perception, and Survival skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A quarterstaff, a Herbalism Kit, a Tattoo Kit, a set of traveler's clothes, a holy symbol, or a random trinket from the Random Trinket table, and a pouch containing 10 gp.

Background Trait: Let Nature Guide You

You have a special kind of relationship with nature that allows you to gain simple premonitions or questions answered by searching in the right place. Once per seven days and if you spend an hour, observing how the river fish jump, the clouds play on a windy sky or how a fowl is born, you can glean some insight into the natural realm. This works as a very basic form of divination, where the GM is free to reveal as much as they like to and in what manner.

Rider

Origin: Eastcreek

You are a mounted warrior from one of the clans of Eastcreek, or you defected your crumbling clan to one of the surviving ones. Choose one of the remaining clans, Red Stag, Iron Crow, or Swift Fox. As a clan member, you have ridden horses all your life and know them like the back of your hand. And as a warrior, you have trained to turn your horsemanship into a deadly weapon. Maybe you are still fighting for the clans' survival in your way, or maybe you have left Eastcreek for your reasons.

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in the Animal Handling, Athletics, Perception, and Stealth skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A riding horse, bit and bridle, a saddle pack, feed for two days, a set of traveler's clothes, and a pouch containing 5 gp.

Background Trait: Horse Lord

You gain the Mounted Combat feature.

Flowing River Duelist

Origin: Eastcreek

The Flowing River is more than just a fighting style that disciplines you to awaken your Soul Mastery. It is also a way of living and thinking, heavily tied into the traditions of Eastcreek. Respect for nature and its animals, humility, wisdom, and mental strength are some valued traits of the Flowing River. Most practitioners of the Flowing River live as clansmen, traveling with the seasons, making do with what the earth gives them, taking care of their clan, and honing their body and mind in the way of the Flowing River. The Flowing River is only supposed to be used in ceremonial duels and self-defense, but some practitioners use it for selfless means, or so the masters in Flowing River would claim. You are one of these rash children who have decided to set out and use what you have learned.

Skill Points: You gain five skill points, assign them in the Animal Handling, Arts & Crafts (your choice), Athletics, Empathy, Perception, and Survival skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A staff, a random trinket from the Random Trinket table, a set of traveler's clothes, and a pouch containing 5 gp.

Background Trait: Disciplined Body
You gain the Acrobat feature.

Defector Warrior

Origin: Greenfield

You were one of the unfortunate souls whose life was forever changed when the Beornish chieftain Idris decided to do more in Greenfield than just raid. The Beornish had some use for you, as you can replenish their ranks. Perhaps you were one of the few survivors of the bastions of civilization and defense in the northern parts of Greenfield, and you were spared the ax by swearing to join Idris instead. Or you left your post before the incoming doom, deserting your fellow soldiers to join the winning side. You might have even lived in the southern parts of Greenfield but journeyed north to take advantage of the lay of the land. Either way, now you belong to neither camp. You are not a full-fledged Beornish raider, even if you have assimilated well with them, and you are certainly not as patriotic and principled as you once were as a fieldish.

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in the Animal Handling, Athletics, Deception, Perception skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A trinket to remind you of your past life (an old insignia of your rank, a keepsake from your hometown, something that reminds you of the family you left behind, etc.), a gaming set of your choice, a set of traveler's clothes and a belt pouch containing 15 gp.

Background Trait: One of You

Your experiences, and the fact that you were embraced by the Beornish at all, speaks of your ability to be adaptable. You have learned how to fit amongst the Beornish, absorbing their culture and mannerisms to a degree it might be hard to tell you apart. Now you are certain you can test this in any culture, provided you have the right means. This trait allows you, only after a day or two of observing and preparing your look, to go unnoticed in another culture. Of course, you would potentially have to get your hands on the right papers and craft a believable story, but no one will think twice about seeing you walk down the street or small talking with you.

Opportunist

Origin: Greenfield

Many view Greenfield's situation to be a tragedy, but you see it as an opportunity to do business. And the shady kind at that. The powers that be in Greenfield and how they are busy eradicating each other has left little time and resources for either to police their lands and the no man's land in between them. There are plenty of people who are desperate enough to swindle, exploit, and manipulate. Many would pay a pretty coin to be smuggled out of the northern area to the south, but somehow they end up on the black market of Stormholme instead of through ports in Oldwood. Funny how that works. There are targets without sufficient protection that can be robbed, and some Beornish raiders can be more than arrogant in their vigilance.

Perhaps you were always an outlaw, just thriving in the current climate. Perhaps you came from another bandit clan from somewhere else and traveled here for the opportunity. Or you were simply a normal citizen who had no other choice than to prey on others to survive.

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in the Animal Handling, Arts & Crafts (your choice), Athletics, Deception, Perception, Stealth, Subterfuge, and Survival skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A tool or kit of your choice, a gaming set of your choice, traveler's clothes, and a belt pouch containing 10 gp.

Background Trait: Slippery

You are impressively slippery when avoiding the authorities out in the wild. You know how to scout the scouts, find weak points in guard patrols and how to slip over borders whilst going unnoticed. As long as you travel in a group that is as large or smaller than your proficiency times 3, animals of burden included, you and your group gain an advantage on all checks made to avoid notice whilst you are out in the wild.

Royal Vanguard

Origin: Greenfield

You are one of the last bastions of defense of Greenfield. You belong to the Sacred Arms' green branch, the division that decided to stay here after the Empire fell and not a journey to Crowhill, as many did around Frostmark. The green branch of Sacred Arms is almost the same as the real deal, but it is not as strict for many reasons when it comes to rules and regulations. As the Greenfielders have nicknamed them, many of the Royal Vanguard have fallen in the war against Beornhelm. Only a few hundred remain now, and most of them have fallen back to protect bigger cities or the King himself, the symbol of Greenfield. The Royal Vanguard is known for their stubborn loyalty, and they are a reason why this kingdom is still holding together.

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in the Academics (Church of Riahn), Animal Handling, Athletics, Investigation, Leadership, Medicine, Perception, and Persuasion skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: An insignia of rank, a trinket from the Random Trinket table, a set of fine clothes, and a belt pouch containing 15 gp.

Background Trait: Loyalty Goes a Long Way

- ❖ **Familiarity:** You possess inside knowledge of the military of Greenfield's operations, as well as its strengths and weaknesses.
- ❖ **Income:** As long as you remain in service to the Green Arms, you earn a comfortable lifestyle.
- ❖ **Jurisdiction:** You possess a military rank in Greenfield, and soldiers of lower rank recognize your authority. You can acquire simple equipment from the organization. You can move almost unhindered in the southern parts of Greenfield, the people always believing the best about you.
- ❖ **Residence:** As Royal Vanguard of Greenfield, people view you with the utmost respect. You can find a bed, support, and aid, as long as it is not hazardous, amongst Greenfielders who are still allied with the King. Furthermore, you are welcome in any military establishment controlled by Greenfield.

Bond: In the Service of the Green Arms

- ❖ **No Resignations:** If you have defected from the Green Arms you will be met with hostility if you ever come across them again, you will be barred from any Church

of Riahn, and if you're not careful with what you do and say, the Inquisition may come knocking on your door.

- ❖ **Service:** No matter your rank and your circumstances, your oath to Greenfield's Sacred Arms might demand active service from you. At any point in the campaign, the Royal Vanguard will ask for loyalty and work from you. In addition, you have sworn an oath to Riahn and his Church.

Guild Artisan

Origin: Karthmere

You are a member of an artisan's guild in Karthmere, skilled in a particular field of arts and crafts. You are a well-established part of the mercantile world in Karthmere, freed by talent and wealth from the constraints of a feudal social order. You learned your skills as an apprentice under a master through your guild's sponsorship until you became a master in your own right. As a member of your guild, you know the skills needed to create finished items from raw materials (provided that you have access to the right kind of Artisan's Tools), as well as the principles of trade and good business practices. The question now is whether you abandon your trade for the story's narrative or take on the extra effort to weave adventure and trade together.

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in the Academics (your choice), Arts & Crafts (your choice), Empathy, and Persuasion skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A set of Artisan's Tools (one of your choice), a letter of introduction from your guild, a set of traveler's clothes, and a belt pouch containing 15 gp.

Background Traits: Guild Membership

As an established and respected member of your guild, you gain certain benefits that your membership provides.

- ❖ **Income:** As long as you practice your craft or trade, you earn a comfortable lifestyle.
- ❖ **Jurisdiction:** Guilds in Karthmere wields a modicum of political power. If you are accused of a crime, your guild might support you if it is worth their time and/or your innocence is easily proven. You might be able to gain access to powerful figures through the guild if you are a member in good standing. Such connections might require payment from the guild, in the form of donations of coins or valuable items to the guild's coffers.
- ❖ **Residence:** Your fellow guild members will provide you with lodging and food if necessary. In some cities and towns, a guildhall offers a central place to meet other members of your profession, which can be a good place to meet potential patrons, allies, or hirelings.

Bond: Monthly Fee

You must pay dues of 5 gp per month to the guild. If you miss payments, you must make up back dues to remain in the guild's good graces.

Guild Merchant

Origin: Karthmere

You might belong to a guild of traders, caravan masters, or shopkeepers. You don't craft items yourself but earn a living by buying and selling others' works (or the raw materials artisans need to practice their craft). Your guild might be a large merchant consortium (or family) with interests across Karthmere and beyond. Perhaps you transported goods

from one place to another, by ship, wagon, or caravan, or bought them from traveling traders and sold them in your little shop.

Skill Points: You gain four skill points, assign them in the Academics (your choice) Animal Handling, Deception, Empathy, and Persuasion skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A set of fine clothes, a letter of introduction from your guild, a mule and cart, and a purse containing 15 gp.

Background Traits: Guild Membership

As an established and respected member of your guild, you gain certain benefits that your membership provides.

- ❖ **Income:** As long as you practice your craft or trade, you earn a comfortable lifestyle.
- ❖ **Jurisdiction:** Guilds in Karthmere wields a modicum of political power. If you are accused of a crime, your guild might support you if it is worth their time and/or your innocence is easily proven. You might be able to gain access to powerful figures through the guild if you are a member in good standing. Such connections might require payment from the guild, in the form of donations of coins or valuable items to the guild's coffers.
- ❖ **Residence:** Your fellow guild members will provide you with lodging and food if necessary. In some cities and towns, a guildhall offers a central place to meet other members of your profession, which can be a good place to meet potential patrons, allies, or hirelings.

Bond: Monthly Fee

You must pay dues of 5 gp per month to the guild. If you miss payments, you must make up back dues to remain in the guild's good graces.

Questing Knight

Origin: Karthmere

You are the romantic questing knight, traveling around Karthmere trying to solve problems, earn coin and fame. You might be a child of a minor noble, or a sibling of a higher one, or even just a hero of the people given the title of knight. What all of these paths have in common, though, is that you do not possess any land to use your noble title to collect taxes and solidify your influence. Land is also hard to come by in the greatly populated Karthmere. Questing knights, therefore, take the road, trying to gather resources and glory to buy or be gifted land to settle down.

Skill Points: You gain five skill points, assign them in the Animal Handling, Athletics, Perception, and Persuasion skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A riding horse with a bit and bridle, a riding saddle, and saddlebag. A set of traveler's clothes, a scroll of pedigree, and a purse containing 10 gp

Background Trait: Fame and Fortune

- ❖ **Followers:** You are followed by one retainer who has sworn to serve you. The retainer will perform mundane tasks for you, but will not fight for you. They will not follow you into obviously dangerous areas and will leave if they are frequently endangered or abused.

- ❖ **Income:** As long as you serve as a Knight of Karthmere you may earn a comfortable lifestyle.
- ❖ **Reputation:** You have gathered a bit of a reputation around and in your hometown and as you play you may attempt to increase this fame. If you are located in an area you are famous in, people will recognize, respect you and try to not displease you. You gain access to important local figures, may be offered lower prices and you can seek aid if it is non-hazardous.

Bond: Chivalric Code

You have sworn the Sacred Code to king and kingdom.

Development Diplomat

Origin: Malgrave

You belong to the Department of Development, the Department that handles foreign relations, science, and projects. Your particular Vocation is or was that of Mediator, a diplomat, serving Malgrave's interest in other kingdoms. Establish what kind of work you have done so far and where.

Skill Points: You gain five skill points, assign them in the Academics (your choice), Deception, Empathy, Investigation, and Persuasion skills in a manner of choice.

Equipment: A trinket from the Random Trinket table, a grant for your diplomatic position, a set of fine clothes, and a belt pouch containing 20 gp.

Background Trait: Diplomatic Immunity

As long as you can prove, either to Malgrave or the kingdom you are visiting, that you are still serving as a diplomat you gain certain benefits.

- ❖ **Income:** You earn a comfortable lifestyle whilst working as a diplomat for Malgrave.
- ❖ **Jurisdiction:** You can gain access to most areas and people in other kingdoms, you are excused for most crimes due to your immunity and those who know of your position will attempt to accommodate you and not displease you.

Military Engineer

Origin: Malgrave

As a born and bred military engineer of Malgrave, you are among the sharpest militaristic minds in Frostmark. As a child, you showed an aptitude for both body and mind and were moved into the Protection Vocation. You were first trained for a short time as a soldier to ensure you could handle yourself on the battlefield and give you insight into the military's baseline operations. But your greatest weapon was your mind, and thus you advanced to the status of a military engineer. Your character's specialty can be defensive architecture, arms and armor smithing, siege equipment, etc.

Skill Points: You gain Academics (engineering) rank 2 and Arts & Crafts (your choice) rank 2. You gain one skill point that you can assign in one skill of your choice.

Equipment: Memorabilia from the field, two sets of tools, a set of common clothes, and a pouch containing 10 gp

Background Trait: My Religion is Efficiency

As an engineer, you care greatly for efficiency. From your Malgravian background, you are simply better than most other engineers in Frostmark. Whenever you build something or oversee something being built, you can either decrease the material weight by 25%, time by 25%, or coin by 25%, your choice.

Unhindered Explorer**Origin:** Malgrave

The Malgravian school system early discovered your intelligence. Hence you advanced quickly and easily to a position in the Explorer Vocation. As an Explorer of Malgrave, you are given a certain amount of freedom and leverage to practice your skill. The Development Department funds you, and you are free to explore whatever topic you please, as long as you can argue to the Development Department its value for the Malgravian society. Still, the Explorers' freedom is restrained by ethical limitations and a level of oversight. Some scientists find them irritating enough that they migrate to Greenfield to conduct their experiments in peace. Due to the vast political pressure, Malgrave is exerting on Greenfield, Greenfield cannot complain fully about the Explorers' practices.

You can be an Explorer in the sense of the word, exploring other kingdoms or people for some kind of social studies. Work with your GM to determine your area of expertise, some of your accomplishments, and your place in the narrative.

Skill Points: You gain five skill points, assign them in the Academics (your choice), Arts & Crafts (your choice), Investigation, Medicine, Occult, Perception, and Persuasion in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A tool of your choice, a bottle of black ink, a quill, an almost empty book you are using for notes, a set of common clothes, and a belt pouch containing 10 gp.

Background Trait: Quick Study

- ❖ **Fast Mind:** Others may mock your obsession, but your dedication has paid off. It takes you half the time it normally would identify, repair, or glean information from an object, a specimen, or writings related to your field of study.
- ❖ **Income:** As long as you serve the Development Department in Malgrave you earn a comfortable lifestyle. However, if you have moved to Greenfield, considering the Department's extra costs purchasing property for you there, as well as ensuring your safety, the Department lowers your salary to Modest.

Iron Barricade Defender**Origin:** Oldwood

You have had enough with how Beornhelm has been allowed to torment northern Oldwood for so long. You are determined to fight back and properly defend northern Oldwood against Beornhelm. You follow Duke Grimcolt, the leader of this initiative, and you support his methods. You are not, however, one of the mere civilians building the new defenses, you are a competent warrior. Maybe you joined Grimcolt's army after he announced his goals, or you were one of his soldiers even before his brother died.

Skill Points: You gain six skill points, assign them in the Animal Handling, Athletics, Deception, Medicine, and Perception skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A gaming set of your choice, a random trinket from the Random Trinket table or a battle trophy, a set of traveler's clothes, and a belt pouch containing 10 gp.

Background Trait: Northerner's Gratitude

Oldwood has historically been chilly and somewhat uncooperative with outsiders, but with Duke Grimcolt they are banding together like never before.

- ❖ **Familiarity:** You have also studied the way of the Beornish and sharing your knowledge with your brothers and sisters in arms. You have gained a unique insight into Beornish tactics and society.
- ❖ **Income:** As long as you remain in service to Duke Grimcolt, you earn a poor lifestyle.
- ❖ **Reputation:** As an Iron Defender you are highly respected amongst the people of the north, and even some folk in the south feel the same about you.
- ❖ **Residence:** You can find bedding, protection, and aid, provided it is non-hazardous for them, in northern Oldwood. Furthermore, you are welcome in any military establishment controlled by the Duke.

Bond: Almost a Deserter

You are not in open rebellion against the crown of Oldwood, but under Duke Grimcolt, you have certainly ignored its commands. If you were recognized by the southern authorities loyal to the crown, you would be apprehended and imprisoned. The crown does not execute northern soldiers as of yet, instead, they are quite confused about what to do with them.

Ravenmoor Operative

Origin: Oldwood

How you find yourself in west Oldwood, nor your past, matters not to the Ravenmoors, now only what you can do for them is of importance. You possess talents that interest them, and thus you were one day picked up by their soldiers, trained and instructed, and sent on your way to perform whatever task they had you do. Work with your GM to establish some details about your past and your work for the Ravenmoors, and what you could be up to now.

Skill Points: You gain six skill points, assign them in the manner of your choice.

Equipment: One tool or kit of your choice, two sets of clothes of your choice, a trinket from the Random Trinket table or memorabilia that reminds you of your past, and a belt pouch containing 20 gp.

Background Trait: Unnatural Luck

- ❖ **Feat:** Ever since your contract with Ravenmoor you have experienced unnatural luck. You gain the Luck feature.
- ❖ **Income:** So long as you stay in their good graces you are paid a modest lifestyle for your service.

Bond: Risky Business

The missions you are sent to perform can be completely harmless and legal, but it doesn't have to be. If caught, they will deny any connection with you and won't help you escape your fate. Similarly, if you become a liability for them or even escape the contract without their consent, they will send others like you after you.

Wayfarer

Origin: Oldwood

You are one of the last Wayfarers of the Oldberry. As a child, a Wayfarer came into your town or village and picked you out of a group of many. It was quite the event for you, as you most likely didn't understand why you had to leave your home for barely a hut in the woods and never visit your family again. But you resigned yourself to your fate, and the Wayfarer became like a parent for you instead. They taught you how to survive out in the wilds, and most importantly, the mysteries of the Wayfarers.

A lot of knowledge of the Wayfarers has been lost, however, and most of the few that exist still today do not dabble in magic or do not even know how to. Most likely, you were taught herbalism, how to rudimentary defend yourself, and various secrets of the land. Your Wayfarer patron would also instill reluctant respect in you for the Sacred Arms and teach you to avoid them, and if you can't, how to appease them. Work with your GM to establish how your apprenticeship went, what kind of Wayfarer became your patron, and how you came to divert from them. Were you given a higher calling? Did they die before you could complete your training, and you felt lost or revengeful? Or did you simply think that the things they have taught you can be better used in another way?

Skill Points: You gain six skill points, assign them in the Academics (nature), Animal Handling, Athletics, Deception, Investigation, Occult, Medicine, and Survival skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A staff, a set of bone dice, an Herbalism Kit, a Tattoo Kit, a set of traveler's clothes, and a belt pouch containing 10 gp.

Background Trait: My Home is Nature
You gain the Naturalist feature.

Bond: Under Scrutiny

If you ever come across an agent of the Church, you must act like a simple tribal shaman and not reveal the true breadth of your knowledge, or else Sacred Arms will come after you. As a "paltry deceiver" you are probably not welcome in any establishment owned by the Church.

Journeyman

Origin: Sirendale

You have learned a great deal from your Master, or the school of art or craft that you attended, and you have practiced your craft as a Practitioner for some time, but you feel like you want to take the next step in your career and become a master. Or maybe you were more motivated by the idea of traveling around Frostmark, and maybe becoming a Journeyman was your goal all along.

A Journeyman takes their craft or art to the road, searching for inspiration, serving in other kingdoms' courts, or learning from other master crafters or artists. Once you feel properly enriched, you can return to Sirendale and take your Master's test in front of a council of other Masters. If you would somehow pass this legendary test, you would be granted the title of Master, given the same status as a low noble, and be counted as the very pinnacle of your art and craft in Frostmark in your time.

Most Journeymen fail to impress the judges and return to their travels. Some accept it and return to the position of Practitioner in Sirendale. Some Journeymen do not want to return home, even if their craft or art rivals that of the Masters in Sirendale. Some want to continue traveling, or maybe they have found their new home in another kingdom. Perhaps working for a wealthy noble and earning a comfortable and fulfilling life is enough for you.

Skill Points: You gain Arts & Crafts (your choice) rank 2, and two skill points to assign in any skills of your choice.

Equipment: A traveling document detailing your profession to enter markets, guilds, and cross borders, a tool or kit of your choice, traveler's clothes, and a belt pouch containing 15 gp.

Background Trait: Been There

- ❖ **Familiarity:** You have been a little bit over all of Frostmark in your journey for the title of Master and thus you can roughly navigate your way in most kingdoms. You may know the basic information about the kingdoms and their rulers you have visited and the GM may supply you with random tidbits of information when it pleases them. Work with your GM to establish which kingdoms you have predominantly visited.
- ❖ **Income:** When you find an opportunity to work your craft or art you earn a comfortable lifestyle.

Master Noble

Origin: Sirendale

As a Master of Sirendale, you have advanced from Apprentice to Practitioner, to Journeyman to finally Master in your specific art or craft. In most other kingdoms on Frostmark, this would simply earn you reputation and coin, but in Sirendale, it also grants you a noble title. You do not have to fulfill any administrative duties yourself, you can hire people for that, but you are burdened with at least some partial responsibility for your home region. The people refer to your's and your fellow artisan's wisdom to protect and steer the kingdom towards prosperity.

Skill Points: You gain Arts & Crafts (your choice) rank 3, and two skill points to assign in any skills of your choice.

Equipment: A tool or kit of your choice, a grant of your title as both Master and Noble, a trinket from the Random Trinket table, a set of fine clothes, and a pouch containing 25 gp.

Background Trait: Noble by Effort

- ❖ **Income:** As long as you can work your craft or art you earn a comfortable lifestyle.
- ❖ **Jurisdiction:** Thanks to your noble and Master title, people are inclined to think the best of you. You are welcome in high society, and people assume you have the right to be wherever you are. The common folk and merchants make every effort to accommodate you and avoid your displeasure, and other people of high status treat you as a member of the same social sphere. You can secure an audience with local powerful people if you need to.

Bond: Position of Responsibility

As a Master Artist or Crafter of Sirendale, people's hope falls on you. You are given the responsibility to help protect the kingdom and enrichen it, even if you do not want it. In addition, as a Master, you are also expected to start your own school to share your knowledge with the next generation. If you abandoned the very minimum of these requirements, you would be shunned by Siren society. No one would trade with you, buy your creations, or even make conversation with you.

Light of Lysander Rebel**Origin:** Sirendale

Whatever profession or background you may have, you are politically interested in the fate of Sirendale. You find the kingdom to be vulnerable to other kingdom's influences, as shown by both Beornhelm and Armathain, and you want these foreign powers to not exploit Sirendale. Thus, it was natural for you to join an organization that felt the same, Light of Lysander.

The Light of Lysander is a political activist group that is not afraid to get dirty by committing criminal acts. They believe that if Sirendale could rally behind a true ruler, instead of being divided between the three unofficial regional nobles, they could cast out both Armathain and Beornhelm from their country. Lysander was the family name of the royal household of Sirendale that perished during the great ransack of Beornhelm, but a branch of it still exists in Oldwood today. The Light of Lysander is not just opposing Armathain where they can in the south, protecting the north from Beornish raids. Still, they are also negotiating with Greenfield and Oldwood to initiate their pact of the Northern Front again and help each other once more.

Skill Points: You gain five skill points, assign them in the Arts & Crafts (your choice), Athletics, Deception, Perception, Stealth, and Subterfuge skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A tool of your choice, a small knife, a gaming set of your choice, common clothes, and a belt pouch containing 10 gp.

Background Trait: Like the Back of My Hand

- **Familiarity:** You know your way around the cities of Sirendale, indeed, like the back of your hand. You know how to avoid prying eyes, where to run to if you were chased, where to set up headquarters, move materials, and how to move quickly from one side of the city to the other.
- **Residence:** Your brothers and sisters in arms and those who are loyal to your cause will offer a place to stay, tightly closed lips, support, and aid, as long as it is not hazardous for the civilian or overly hazardous for your colleagues.

Bond: No Loose Ends

The Light of Lysander group tries to protect their members, but if you would become a threat to them if you deserted or would become apprehended and interrogated by Armathain.

Lowcloaks' Investigator

Origin: Stormholme

You are a member of the Lowcloaks guild as some kind of investigator. You may have been picked up through one of their charity schooling projects as a talented subject, you may have been a promising scion of a respected family who has been a part of the Lowcloaks Guild as long as anyone can remember, or you simply just agreed with the guild's philosophy and joined on your own volition and merit. You rose in the ranks from the lowest of apprentice and assistant to hold some independence in your current position. An investigator of the Lowcloaks can be a tutor, a researcher, an explorer, a spy, an infiltrator, an archivist, etc.

Skill Points: You gain five skill points, assign them in the Academics (your choice), Empathy, Investigation, Medicine, Occult, and Persuasion skills in a manner of choice.

Equipment: An insignia of your guild and rank, a random trinket from the Random Trinket table, a bottle of black ink, a quill, an almost empty book you are using for notes, a set of common clothes, and a belt pouch containing 15 gp.

Background Trait: Guild Membership

As an established and respected member of your guild, you gain certain benefits that your membership provides.

- ❖ **Income:** As long as you practice your craft or trade, you earn a modest lifestyle.
- ❖ **Jurisdiction:** The Lowcloaks guild wields tremendous political power. They may offer you aid if it is worth their time. You might be able to gain access to powerful figures through the guild if you are a member in good standing. Such connections might require payment from the guild, in the form of donations of coins or valuable items to the guild's coffers.
- ❖ **Residence:** Your fellow guild members will provide you with lodging and food if necessary. In some cities and towns, a guildhall offers a central place to meet other members of your profession, which can be a good place to meet potential patrons, allies, or hirelings. In the cities that the Lowcloaks own there are several guild establishments that you gain full access to.

Bond: In The Guild Books

Your name is written in your guild's manifest, along with your hometown, your characteristics, loved ones, exploits, and talents. The guilds of Stormholme's most crucial demand of you is your loyalty. If they consider this loyalty to be broken, they will punish you. Worst case scenario, you pissed them off somehow and now they are coming for you to silence you.

Nightstriders' Dropper

Origin: Stormholme

You are among the many thugs and enforcers the Guild owns. You may have been picked up as a sturdy urchin from a gutter somewhere, you might have been indebted or in trouble with the Guild, and this is your only salvation, or you simply liked the thought of being strong enough to be the bully, not the bullied. You can be a bodyguard to the guild merchants, and businessmen, an operative performing shady tasks in the shadows, or even an assassin hired for someone else in some corner of Frostmark. You know how to take care of yourself, and as long as other people wind up dead rather than you, you can continue to earn your pretty coins.

Skill Points: You gain six skill points, assign them in the Athletics, Deception, Stealth, and Subterfuge in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A random trinket from the Trinket Random table, an insignia of your guild and rank, a trophy from a fallen enemy, a set of traveler's clothes, and a belt pouch containing 15 gp.

Background Trait: Guild Membership

As an established and respected member of your guild, you gain certain benefits that your membership provides.

- ❖ **Income:** As long as you practice your craft or trade, you earn a modest lifestyle.
- ❖ **Jurisdiction:** The Nightstriders guild wield tremendous political power. They may offer you aid if it is worth their time. You might be able to gain access to powerful figures through the guild if you are a member in good standing. Such connections might require payment from the guild, in the form of donations of coins or valuable items to the guild's coffers.
- ❖ **Residence:** Your fellow guild members will provide you with lodging and food if necessary. In some cities and towns, a guildhall offers a central place to meet other members of your profession, which can be a good place to meet potential patrons, allies, or hirelings. In the cities that the Nightstriders own there are several guild establishments that you gain full access to.

Bond: In The Guild Books

Your name is written in your guild's manifest, along with your hometown, your characteristics, loved ones, exploits, and talents. The guilds of Stormholme's most crucial demand of you is your loyalty. If they consider this loyalty to be broken, they will punish you. Worst case scenario, you pissed them off somehow, and now they are coming for you to silence you.

Steelshade Mercenary

Origin: Stormholme

As an enforcer for the Steelshade Guild, you may be a crafter, a soldier, or a hybrid between the two. In the Steelshade Guild, it is vital to be hard-working, sturdy, and productive, even if your art is cutting down other people. As a crafter, you may be working directly for your guild and earning a livelihood by letting the guild sell your craft, or you can be hired by another kingdom or faction and work for their industry as a liaison. As a soldier, you may be a guard, or along with several of your brothers and sisters, be hired as a highly disciplined and costly mercenary unit for kingdoms and leaders in desperate need.

Skill Points: You gain six skill points, assign them in the Arts & Crafts (your choice), Athletics, Leadership, Medicine, and Persuasion skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A random trinket from the Trinket Random table, an insignia of your guild and rank, a tool or kit of your choice, a set of common clothes, and a belt pouch containing 15 gp.

Background Trait: Guild Membership

As an established and respected member of your guild, you gain certain benefits that your membership provides.

- ❖ **Income:** As long as you practice your craft or trade, you earn a modest lifestyle.

- ❖ **Jurisdiction:** The Steelshade guild wields tremendous political power. They may offer you aid if it is worth their time. You might be able to gain access to powerful figures through the guild if you are a member in good standing. Such connections might require payment from the guild, in the form of donations of coins or valuable items to the guild's coffers.
- ❖ **Residence:** Your fellow guild members will provide you with lodging and food if necessary. In some cities and towns, a guildhall offers a central place to meet other members of your profession, which can be a good place to meet potential patrons, allies, or hirelings. In the cities that the Steelshade own there are several guild establishments that you gain full access to.

Bond: In The Guild Books

Your name is written in your guild's manifest, along with your hometown, your characteristics, loved ones, exploits, and talents. The guilds of Stormholme's most crucial demand of you is your loyalty. If they consider this loyalty to be broken, they will punish you. Worst case scenario, you pissed them off somehow, and now they are coming for you to silence you.

Stormgarde Scout

Origin: Stormholme

One Stormgarde scout is never like another Stormgarde scout. Stormgarde is the guild of individuality, after all, and you are free to explore your passions and talents, as long as it produces some kind of influence or wealth for the guild. You could be a horse master, priding yourself to be as good as any Creekish rider, focusing on fast and safe deliveries of messages. You could be an excellent sailor, feeling more at home on the high seas than dry land. You could be a brave explorer, searching for your next big discovery. No matter your specialty, as long as you follow the few orders sent by the Stormgarde guild and continue to pay your fee, you are free to be yourself.

Skill Points: You gain six skill points, assign them in any skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: A random trinket from the Trinket Random table, an insignia of your guild and rank, a tool, kit, or musical instrument of your choice, a set of common clothes, and a belt pouch containing 15 gp.

Background Trait: Guild Membership

As an established and respected member of your guild, you gain certain benefits that your membership provides.

- ❖ **Income:** As long as you practice your craft or trade, you earn a modest lifestyle.
- ❖ **Jurisdiction:** The Stormgarde guild wields tremendous political power. They may offer you aid if it is worth their time. You might be able to gain access to powerful figures through the guild if you are a member in good standing. Such connections might require payment from the guild, in the form of donations of coins or valuable items to the guild's coffers.
- ❖ **Residence:** Your fellow guild members will provide you with lodging and food if necessary. In some cities and towns, a guildhall offers a central place to meet other members of your profession, which can be a good place to meet potential patrons, allies, or hirelings. In the cities that the Stormgarde own there are several guild establishments that you gain full access to.

Bond: In The Guild Books

Your name is written in your guild's manifest, along with your hometown, your characteristics, loved ones, exploits, and talents. The guilds of Stormholme's most crucial demand of you is your loyalty. If they consider this loyalty to be broken, they will punish you. Worst case scenario, you pissed them off somehow, and now they are coming for you to silence you.

Sea's Embrace Herald

Origin: Stormholme (most often from the island of Nodensia)

You are one of the few souls on Frostmark that has been unblinded by the Church of Riahn and its lies. You know that the other Enneade are not devils or any less good or evil than Riahn is himself. You might have been a child growing up in the fishing community in Nodensia, hearing about the old legends of worship on the island, and decided to join the growing and secretive guild of the Sea's Embrace of your own volition. Or perhaps you miraculously came across this secret and became so enamored with it that you left your old life to join the guild.

Sea's Embrace has been allowed to thrive by the grace of its ally, Stormgarde, where Tecla herself seems to show a certain degree of curiosity for their teachings. Primarily, Sea's Embrace finds it unfair that the other guilds have all but abandoned religion. They think it should be anyone's right in Stormholme to practice any kind of worship, just as the Stormers are free in most other regards. Religion is not outlawed per se by the four guilds, but they usually see no use in them and only sometimes as a threat.

As a Sea's Embrace member, you must take on a false persona to hide your true intentions. The other guilds are not ready yet for your revelation, and Sacred Arms would brand you as a heretic would they ever discover you. Therefore, you must make your moves in the shadows, slowly changing the playing field to a point where you can openly practice what you preach. Sea's Embrace guild members can have different specialties, but they are often some kind of hybrid priest with dashes of a diplomat, politician, or agent.

Skill Points: You gain six skill points, assign them in the Academics (your choice), Arts & Crafts (your choice), Deception, Occult, Perception, Persuasion, and Subterfuge skills in a manner of your choice.

Equipment: Two tools, kits, or musical instruments of your choice, a hidden insignia of Lapuana, a set of clothing of your choice, and a belt pouch containing 10 gp.

Background Trait: Guild Membership

As an established and respected member of your guild, you gain certain benefits that your membership provides.

- ❖ **Income:** As long as you practice your craft or trade, you earn a modest lifestyle.
- ❖ **Jurisdiction:** The Sea's Embrace guild wields some political power. If you need it they will offer you aid to the best of their ability. You might be able to gain access to powerful figures through the guild if you are a member in good standing.
- ❖ **Residence:** Your fellow guild members will provide you with lodging and food if necessary. In some cities and towns, a guildhall offers a central place to meet other members of your profession, which can be a good place to meet potential patrons, allies, or hirelings. In Nodensia there are several guild establishments that you gain full access to.

Background Trait: Second Life

You have created a second identity for yourself, including all the backstory, disguise, and paperwork you need to make it near immaculate. In addition, you gain a certain knack for falsifying documentation.

Bond: Devotion To The Sea

You have devoted your soul and work to Lapuana and her journey.

Bond: Heretic

If your participation with the occult would come to light, the Sacred Arms inquisitorial agents will attempt to hunt you down and silence you.

STEP 3 – CHARACTER CREATION EXAMPLES

In this section you'll find two player characters, Helos and Rogath, go through the third step in character creation.

“Helos”

Step 3

Eve decides on the background of "Crow Priest" for Helos, and she notes down in his character sheet:

- ❖ Another skill point in Academics (Church of Riahn)
- ❖ A skill point in Academics (Rianish)
- ❖ A skill point in Empathy
- ❖ A skill point in Persuasion
- ❖ In the equipment section, Eve marks down: The holy symbol of Riahn (a gift to Helos when he entered the priesthood), a prayer book, a copy of the Radiance of Geanor, vestments, a Tattoo Kit, a set of common clothes, and a belt pouch containing 15 gp.
- ❖ The background feature of "Partial Soul Drain."
- ❖ The background feature of "Priest of the Sun God."
- ❖ The background bond of "Devotion to the Sun."

Eve thinks that Crow Priest is the obvious choice for Helos. She chooses Empathy and Persuasion for Helos' oratory and social aptitude.

“Rogath”

Step 3

Carl chooses the background of "Soldier" for Rogath as his village was mostly structured like a military organization.

- Two skill points in Athletics
- One skill point Leadership
- One skill point Perception
- One skill point Survival
- In the equipment section Carl marks down: An insignia of his martial rank, a trophy for defeating the most powerful warrior in his village in the form of a piece of their banner, chess set, a set of common clothes, and a belt pouch containing 15 gp.
- The background feature of "Army Hierarchy"
- The background bond of "Military Service"

STEP 4 – ABILITY SCORES

Step four is about assigning values to your character's capabilities, strengths, and weaknesses. The ability scores are a mixture of your character's talent and experiences, represented by a value between 6 and 20. There are three groups of ability scores: **physical**, **mental**, and **social**. Divided up into three categories: **offensive**, **finesse**, and **defensive**.

Physical

Brawn (Br) (Offensive)

Brawn measures bodily power, athletic training, and raw physical force. With Brawn, you can attempt to lift, push, pull, or break something. Examples could be forcing your way through obstacles, breaking free of bonds, hanging on to a rope, etc.

Dexterity (Dex) (Finesse)

Moving nimbly, quickly, or quietly with balance. Examples could be controlling a heavily laden cart on a steep descent, steer a chariot around a tight turn, and wriggle free of bonds.

Vitality (Vit) (Defensive)

Vitality checks with skills are uncommon, as a person's endurance and health are more of a passive trait. Though it should be used when you try to push past your physical limits, like holding your breath, marching or laboring for hours without rest, going without sleep, surviving without food or water, or handling toxins of different kinds.

Mental

Intelligence (Int) (Offensive)

Intelligence is all about memory, education, and knowledge. It is mostly used in conjunction with skills. Though there are some examples when a pure Intelligence check should be done, for instance, when estimating the value of a precious item, recalling information about a subject you are not Proficient in or winning a game of skill through memorized tactics.

Cunning (Cun) (Finesse)

Cunning is all about connecting the dots, to apply the knowledge you have or gathered to a conclusion or a theory. Basically, applying your knowledge and adapting it to your circumstances. Pure Cunning tests could be done when trying to solve a puzzle, win a game of skill by adapting and deceiving, selling wares as expensive as possible, or come to a conclusion after a successful research attempt.

Resolve (Res) (Defensive)

Resolve enables you to go further than what your physical limitations allow—your strength of will. Resolve is the presiding factor whenever you have to keep your Concentration. A character is allowed in critical situations to attempt a Resolve check to push their body and mind a little bit further. It could be everything from clinging on to your life after a failed Death Saving Throw, holding your breath longer than what your Vitality allows, or wrestling for control of another Soul.

Social

Presence (Pre) (Offensive)

To be able to intimidate, seduce, convince, deceive, etc., by only saying a few half-hearted words or even not saying anything at all – that's Presence. Your innate aura of charisma. Pure Presence checks could be gaining attention in the middle of a squabbling crowd, inspiring your troops across the battlefield, or conveying a simple message to another person by only a stare.

Manipulation (Man) (Finesse)

On the other hand, Manipulation needs a silver-tongue to work its magic. Where Presence convinces or deceives through body language, Manipulation does the same through words. Manipulation is mostly performed with skill, but the GM should not be afraid to ask for a pure Manipulation check if they find the situation falling outside of any specific skill.

Composure (Com) (Defensive)

Composure is your strength of character, how well you pay attention to your surroundings, and if and how they affect you. Composure checks could be rolled when you need to stay calm in a stressful environment, to control your emotions during harrowing times, or your ability to stay vigilant no matter your surroundings.

Determining your Ability Scores and Power Level

First of all, the GM must decide upon a general Power Level of their campaign. If they want to play something more down to earth, something grand, or something in between. The Power Level comes with a certain amount of points the player can spend on their ability scores as well as their Proficiencies (see later sections of Character Creation).

Mundane 20 points

Heroic 25 points

Champion 30 points

To determine the ability score (AS) use the table down below and purchase the values that make sense for your character. All ability scores start at 10 and a value of 10 is considered to be average and most people on Frostmark have values that range between 8 and 12. The cost is cumulative, so for example, purchasing an AS of 17 costs $1+1+1+1+2+2=9$ points. Add your racial bonus on top of your bought ability scores in this section.

AS	Modifier	Cost	AS	Modifier	Cost
6	-2	+2	12	+1	-1
7	-2	+1	13	+1	-1
8	-1	+1	14	+2	-1
9	-1	+1	15	+2	-1
10	0	0	16	+3	-2
11	0	-1	17	+3	-2

Determine ability score modifiers

After assigning your ability scores, determine your ability score modifiers using the table above. To determine an ability modifier without consulting the table, subtract 10 from the ability score and then divide the result by 2 (round down). Write the modifier next to each of your scores.

Saving Throws

Each ability score has a corresponding Saving Throw, or simply "Save" that is rolled when your character is threatened in a specific way. Navigate to the rules to read more about them. Intelligence/Cunning and Presence/Manipulation are special because you get to decide which of your ability scores (either Intelligence or Cunning for Int/Cun) is the ability modifier for the saving throw. Which Saving Throws your character possesses is up to you, and you purchase them in the Accomplishment section.

Brawn

Dexterity

Vitality

Intelligence/Cunning (Int/Cun)

Resolve

Presence/Manipulation (Pre/Man)

Composure

Proficiency Bonus

This section will explore what proficiency is, what saving throws are, and during character creation, it will give you a selection of traits and proficiencies to purchase.

Your proficiency bonus depends upon your character's total level. The higher the level the character is, the higher the proficiency bonus is. Proficiency bonus is applied in many circumstances during active play, such as;

- Attack rolls using weapons you're proficient with
- Attack rolls with spells you cast
- Ability checks using skills you have skill ranks in
- Saving throws you're proficient in
- Saving throw difficulty value for spells you cast (explained in the spellcasting section)

Proficiency Bonus

Level	Proficiency	Level	Proficiency	Level	Proficiency	Level	Proficiency
1st	+2	6th	+3	11th	+4	16th	+5
2nd	+2	7th	+3	12th	+4	17th	+6
3rd	+2	8th	+3	13th	+5	18th	+6
4th	+2	9th	+4	14th	+5	19th	+6
5th	+3	10th	+4	15th	+5	20th	+6

STEP 4 – CHARACTER CREATION EXAMPLES

In this section you'll find two player characters, Helos and Rogath, go through the fourth step in character creation.

“Helos”

Step 4

Eve purchases these ability scores:

Br 8 (-1)	Dex 10 (0)	Vit 12 (+1)
Int 15 (+3)	Cun 12 (+1)	Res 17 (+3)
Pre 14 (+2)	Man 15 (+2)	Com 10 (0)

She adds the ability score bonuses Helos gained from the race of human and the feat Theologian so the final ability scores become as follows:

Br 8 (-1)	Dex 10 (0)	Vit 12 (+1)
Int 16 (+3)	Cun 12 (+1)	Res 18 (+4)
Pre 14 (+2)	Man 16 (+3)	Com 10 (0)

When Eve asks her GM which power level the campaign has, she learns that they will be playing with a heroic power level. With the 25 ability score points she gains, Eve wonders what Helos' stats would be. Since Helos will be a spellcaster, Eve considers first what spellcasting ability score Helos will possess and eventually settles on Resolve since Helos is stalwart in his faith. Hence, Eve decides to make this Helos' best ability score. Eve also wants Helos to be able to encourage the masses in the Rianish faith and thus assigns some points to Helos' Presence and Manipulation. Eve thinks that Helos would not be the most intimidating or striking figure, but still shows some confidence, so she gives Helos more Manipulation than Presence.

As Helos has been a scholar all his life, Eve lowers his Brawn to show the neglect of his martial side. However, he has lived a sheltered life where he always has had access to food and excellent healthcare, so Eve increases his Vitality slightly. Helos is sharp and has been given a good education, so Eve wants to invest some points into more of his mental ability scores. The Church does not value nurturing their pupils to think for themselves, so Eve decides that Helos' Intelligence score is higher than his Cunning.

“Rogath”

Step 4

Carl purchases these ability scores:

Br 16 (+3)	Dex 12 (+1)	Vit 16 (+3)
Int 10 (0)	Cun 14 (+2)	Res 15 (+2)
Pre 13 (+1)	Man 8 (-1)	Com 14 (+2)

Carl adds the ability score bonuses Rogath gained from the race of dragonborn so the final ability scores become as follows:

Br 18 (+4)	Dex 12 (+1)	Vit 16 (+3)
Int 10 (0)	Cun 14 (+2)	Res 16 (+3)
Pre 14 (+2)	Man 8 (-1)	Com 14 (+2)

When Carl asks his GM which power level the campaign has, he learns that they will be playing with a champion power level. With the 30 ability score points he gains, Carl wonders what Rogath's scores would be. Carl quickly decides that Rogath will be a Brawn-based fighter, and considering Rogath's grueling upbringing, Carl makes Brawn Rogath's best ability score. Rogath's Vitality score would also be high, from the harsh nature of his home and training. Rogath has never been that agile, but he gained some dexterity through his past workouts.

There wasn't much access to education in Rogath's village, but Cunning is a vital talent to nurture - to survive in the wild, and outsmart your opponents. Resolve is an obvious choice for Rogath, as he is indeed very stubborn and aspirational. His confidence and impressive stature allow him some Presence. But his dogged pursuit of martial prowess has led him to mostly ignore his social aptitudes. His competitive and aggressive nature didn't give him any good friends growing up either. Lastly, his lonesome nature has made him more observant of his surroundings.

STEP 5 – ACCOMPLISHMENT

Step 5 is about proficiencies and extra starting money. Your selection of proficiencies and traits in the table below determines your proficient saving throws, your weapon and armor proficiencies, some of your skill proficiencies, and your starting wealth. Read more about proficiency bonuses in the rules. **Take note that this selection is your primary source of income in character creation, and thus you probably want to invest a few points at least into starting wealth to buy the weapons, armor, and adventuring equipment you want. You may only gain up to three proficiencies in saving throws through this section.**

Number of Accomplishment Points

How many points you have to spend depends on the campaign's power level.

Mundane	14 points
Heroic	16 points
Champion	18 points

Purchase your Accomplishments

Armor

Light	1 point
Light to medium	2 points
Light to heavy	3 points
Shields	1 point

Weapons

2 handpicked weapons	1 point
Axes (battle-axe, handaxe, greataxe)	1 point
Bows (longbows, shortbows)	1 point
Crossbows (hand, heavy, light)	1 point
Bows and Crossbows (hand, heavy, light, long, short)	2 points

Fell-Handed (battle-axe, handaxe, greataxe, maul, warhammer, war pick)	2 points
Finesse (dagger, rapier, scimitar, shortsword, whip)	2 points
Blades (bastard, broad, dagger, greatsword, rapier, saber, scimitar, sickle, short)	3 points
Bludgeons (club, flail, greatclub, light hammer, mace, maul, morningstar, quarterstaff, warhammer)	3 points
Heavy (crossbow heavy, glaive, greataxe, greatsword, halberd, longbow, maul, pike)	3 points
Light (club, hand crossbow, dagger, handaxe, light hammer, rapier, scimitar, shortsword, sickle)	3 points
Primitive (club, fishing net, greatclub, handaxe, javelin, light hammer, quarterstaff, sickle, sling, trident, weighted net, whip)	3 points
Ranged (crossbow hand, crossbow heavy, fishing net, javelin, longbow, shortbow, sling, weighted net)	3 points
Spears (halberd, glaive, javelin, lance, pike, quarterstaff, spear, trident)	3 points
Thrown (dagger, fishing net, handaxe, javelin, light hammer, spear, trident, weighted net)	3 points

Skills

1 skill point	1 point
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Saving Throws

Proficiency in Br, Int/Cun or Pre/Man	1 point
Proficiency in Dex, Vit, Res or Com	2 points

Extra Starting Money

25 gp	1 point
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The player picks their points in the table above in accordance with what would make sense for their character. The GM has the final say if the selection is suitable or not. Skills can be found in the "Skills and Tools section," weapons, armor, and other equipment is found in the "Equipment" section, and saving throws in the "ability score" section.

EXTRA STARTING WEALTH ON HIGHER LEVELS

Depending upon the needs of your adventure and the desires of your players, you might want to start a campaign at a higher level. Starting wealth for your player's characters above 1st level is entirely at your discretion, since you give out treasure at your own pace. That said, you can use this table as a guide. This wealth can be used to pay for magical items, buy property with, hidden in a strongbox somewhere, invested in art and jewelry, etc.

Character Level	Mundane Campaign	Heroic Campaign	Champion Campaign
1st & 2nd	Normal	Normal	Normal
3rd & 4th	200 gp	250 gp	300 gp
5th & 6th	400 gp	500 gp	600 gp
7th & 8th	1500 gp	2000 gp	2500 gp
9th & 10th	3000 gp	4000 gp	5000 gp
11th & 12th	4000 gp	5000 gp	6000 gp
13th	5000 gp	6000 gp	7000 gp
14th	8000 gp	10.000 gp	12.000 gp
15th & 16th	12.000 gp	15.000 gp	18.000 gp
17th	15.000 gp	20.000 gp	25.000 gp
18th	25.000 gp	30.000 gp	35.000 gp
19th	35.000 gp	40.000 gp	45.000 gp
20th	50.000 gp	60.000 gp	70.000 gp

SKILLS

Each ability score covers a broad range of capabilities, including skills. A skill represents a specific aspect of an ability score, and an individual's skill ranks in a skill demonstrate a focus on that aspect. When you create your character, you gain skill points from your character's background (p. 57), the Accomplishment table (p. 100), and potentially through your ability origin picks if you pick the right tag (p. 111).

For example, a Dexterity check might reflect a character's attempt to pull off an acrobatic stunt, palm an object, or move quietly. These aspects of Dexterity have an associated skill: Athletics, Subterfuge, and Stealth, respectively. A character who has skill ranks in the Stealth skill is excellent at Dexterity checks related to sneaking about.

Skills are given as points, which can be used to purchase skill ranks. Which skill ranks you purchase should showcase your character's experience, talent, and training. Possessing no skill ranks in a skill result in making skill checks without adding your

proficiency bonus to that skill check. To increase your aptitude with a skill, you need to acquire more skill points and trade them into skill ranks, which allows you to add your proficiency bonus in different capacities - depending upon the skill rank.

To obtain higher ranks, you must invest more skill points to reach the new level. If you cannot purchase the rank you want with your available skill points, you can store them until you can.

Ranks	Number of invested skill points required
Rank 1	1 skill point
Rank 2	1 skill point
Rank 3	2 skill points
Rank 4	2 skill points
Rank 5	3 skill points

Your character may possess any number of skills with one to three ranks at level 1. At level 4 you may purchase skills of rank 4. Rank 5 can be purchased at 8th level if your character possesses a feat or an ability that explicitly states you are allowed to advance to Rank 5 in that particular skill.

Untrained

No added bonus other than your ability score modifier.
You have never practiced the skill.

Rank 1

Proficiency/2 (rounded up)
You've dabbled in the subject as a beginner.

Rank 2

Proficiency
You feel adept with the skill.

Rank 3

Proficiency *1.5 (rounded up)

You spent a considerable amount of time with the skill and you have become somewhat of an expert.

Rank 4

Proficiency *2
You've become a master with the skill.

Rank 5

Proficiency *2.5 (rounded up)
You have gone above the rank of master into legend.

SKILL LIST

In parenthesis after the name of the skill, you will find one or two ability scores that the skill is usually used with. Which one applies depends on the circumstances and is ultimately up to the GM. Choose your character's skills per their backstory and affinities.

Rank 5 can't be purchased through normal means. Instead, certain feats and abilities unlock this rank for one or more particular skills for a character.

Skills with "Must Be Specified" conveys that the player must specify which specialization the character possesses with the skill when selecting it. What specializations can be chosen are hinted towards in the particular skill's description. Skills with "Must be Specified" can be taken several times with different specializations chosen at every new skill purchase.

Skills with "Spec" means that the ability scores used with the skill are highly varied and depend upon the specific circumstance. A task with the skill might also include several checks with different ability scores used. How these checks are handled is ultimately up to the GM.

Academics (must be specified) (Int)

All bodies of knowledge are considered Academics. The player is free to come up with their own fields of Academics beyond the examples presented here. The more niche the field is, the more detailed the information is. However, the more limited the answers will be.

Examples; A culture, chemistry, an Ennade, history or history about a place or specific time, law, nature, a Realm or the World, etc.

Animal Handling (Cun/Pre)

Animal Handling is both taking care of and handling domesticated animals, as well as dealing with wild beasts, understanding their behavior, and maybe even befriending them.

Arts & Crafts (must be specified) (Spec)

All arts and crafts you can imagine, the broader the term you select, the lesser mastery you gain in the fine details, just like how Academics works. The player is free to come up with their own field of art or craft.

Examples; Acting, Smithing, Painting, Public Speaking, Weaving, Woodcarving, etc.

Athletics (Br/Dex)

Athletics is everything from jumping, swimming, climbing to acrobatics. You use Dexterity when the task requires more body control or agility. Use Brawn when sheer strength is the dominating factor in the task.

Deception (Pre/Man)

The Deception Skill is a social Skill that persuades, intimidate, seduce, and anything in between, but only when the character believes themselves to be lying. Deception is used when trying to persuade someone of an untruth, intimidate someone when you don't believe yourself better, or seduce someone you're not attracted to.

Empathy (Man/Com)

Empathy allows characters to work out the motivations and emotions of those they interact with and manipulate those feelings to their advantage. Composure is primarily used when trying to understand emotions and intentions, and Manipulation is used when trying to nudge them. Examples could be consoling someone grieving, revving up a crowd, or an interrogation attempt with a suspect.

Investigation (Cun)

The investigation skill is understanding cause and effect. Connecting evidence from a murder scene to a working theory, combining prior research into a comprehensive conclusion, or understanding a trap's mechanism and realize how to disarm it.

Leadership (Pre/Man)

Leadership is the knowledge or experience of leadership techniques, as well as the confidence needed to effectively lead and coordinate groups.

Medicine (Int/Cun)

To diagnose and grasp what is ailing a creature is Medicine coupled with Intelligence, but performing surgery or first aid is used with Cunning.

Occult (Int/Cun)

The Occult Skill represents knowledge of the supernatural elements of the Soul and beyond, such as Soul Mastery, Soul Magic, Magic Rituals, etc.

Perception (Int/Com)

Perception is all about spotting things that are out of the ordinary or are of interest to the character. For example, spotting a trap before you spring it. However, Investigation is the skill to use when you want to understand what the trap does and how to disarm it.

Perception is used with Intelligence when perceiving something that is out of the ordinary, finding clues at a murder scene, seeing through illusions, or noticing that your drink doesn't taste as it should. On the other hand, Composure is conjoined with Perception when the character needs to be stalwart and vigilant. Examples can be; traveling through a forest and after a few hours noticing a twig being snapped suspiciously, a guard on a night shift noticing that a particular shadow flickering in the corner of their eye, or picking out the whispering of an incantation in a loud crowd.

Persuasion (Pre/Man)

Persuasion is the opposite of Deception, used when the character believes they are honest. Persuasion is selected when trying to persuade someone of the truth, intimidate someone when you believe yourself better, or seduce someone you're attracted to.

Subterfuge (Dex/Cun)

Subterfuge is all things shady, of luring and fooling people for your gain. Subterfuge includes shadowing, creating disguises, forging, sleight of hand, lock-picking, etc.

Stealth (Dex/Cun)

Stealth showcases the character's ability to go unnoticed, hide, and sneak. Sometimes going unnoticed requires more mental prowess than physical. If so, Stealth is joined with Cunning, for when you need to hide in plain sight or slip between shadows. Dexterity is coupled with Stealth when it is a feat of agility, sneaking silently up to a turned backside,

moving silently over gravel, or jumping across rooftops with an unknowing crowd below.

Survival (Int/Cun)

Survival is the ability to understand and overcome the challenges of more or less inhospitable environments. This often means finding food and shelter in the wild, crafting basic tools from things found in nature, foreseeing pitfalls such as poison edibles, sandpits, etc., navigating unknown territory, reading the weather, and tracking.

PASSIVE PERCEPTION

Passive perception is a special kind of skill that doesn't involve a die roll. Its purpose is to give the GM a secret way to determine whether the characters succeed at spotting something, or handwave a skill check to be too easy to not break the flow of the game. Here is how you calculate your passive perception score;

10 + all perception + composure modifiers that applies

If the GM want to afford advantage to the passive score, they add +5 to the score. They subtract -5 to the passive score if they want to apply disadvantage. The GM may use passive perception at their own discretion. In fact, if they wish to introduce other passive scores they may also do so for the benefit of the narrative they weave.

LANGUAGES

To learn a new language, spend a skill point in Academics, and name it after the language you want to learn. One skill point denotes a basic understanding of the language, and you carry a distinct accent. Two skill points in the Academics skill transforms this knowledge to fluency in the language.

In the Age of Riahn, there were few languages used at large on Frostmark. Modern Markish is the language that has survived to become the common tongue on Frostmark. Priests of Riahn learn Rianish through ancient traditions, but the language is not that widespread. Priests speak it during ceremonies and sermons, and the upper echelon of the Church converses with it as a sign of respect and superiority. Many geographical areas on Frostmark used to have their own language before Empress Leana eradicated most of them. Only Eastcreek has kept their old language, Creekish, and few records of other old languages exist. Maybe a select few scholars in Malgrave or Stormholme may have learned these languages. These languages spawned out of the geographical kingdoms during the Age of the Seven. If you're interested in one of these, ask the GM.

Most common languages of Frostmark: Modern Markish. Rianish and Creekish

Beyond Frostmark there are hundreds of languages who have risen, and some who have already disappeared. The two most important languages of World are Copta, the language of the gods and magic which the Enneade jealously guard, and Ancient Markish which is the trade language between the Realms. Knowing Ancient Markish means that your character had a proper education in the Realms. Modern Markish evolved from Ancient Markish to the language that the inhabitants of Frostmark share today. Modern and Ancient Markish sounds similar but is mostly incomprehensible for a speaker of the

opposite version. Then all the Realms have a common language which their presiding god has created for inter-Realm business.

The most common languages of the Realms: Ancient Markish, Rianish (Eternal Suns), Geran (Progenitor), Teranian (Tu'at), Lapiash (Atlas), Borian (Kess'Aai), Suhlm (Mirrormark) and Vegomish (Qedseba).

Lastly, Enna races or groups of Enna races have developed their own languages. Several races like elves, dwarfs and orcs have created their own languages. Examples of languages shared between races include Sylvan often used amongst fey creatures and Celestial, spoken between Celestial Enna. To find out which languages Enna speak, consult their race description in the race section or navigate to the adversary section.

TOOLS

A tool helps you perform specific tasks that require your skill and the usage of specialized instruments. Examples include crafting or repairing an item, forging a document, picking a lock, etc. You may be well versed with the mechanics of locks, but without the proper lockpicking tools, no lock can be pried open. When a tool is required to solve a specific task, your GM decides which ability score and skill is applicable to roll at that moment like a normal skill check but it also requires that the character has access to, and experience with, the tool in question.

$1d20 + \text{applicable ability score} + \text{applicable skill} + \text{access to tool}$ vs. DV of the task

Which skill is used in tandem with a tool depends upon the circumstances. But there are some common pairings, such as the Subterfuge skill with the Lockpicking Tool. Sometimes one set of tools can be used for tasks that it was not originally set out to solve. This should be dealt with on a case-by-case basis.

Some backgrounds provide you with a tool at character creation or grants you the option to choose one or several. If your background provides you with tools, it also automatically grants you experience with that tool.

To acquire a tool outside of backgrounds, you must buy the tool through character creation or later in play. However, purchasing a tool doesn't necessarily mean that the character knows how to use it. A character using a tool with no experience with it, they only make skill checks with the tool with their applicable ability score modifier, even if they have skill ranks in the applicable skill. If experience with a tool has been mentioned in the backstory of a character, a GM is free to judge if the player is allowed to roll checks with not only their ability score but also the appropriate skill rank when using the tool. If the experience is lacking, a GM is free to limit what the character can do with a tool or lower their skill rank when rolling checks with the tool. The player can build up experience with the tool by simply practicing and using the tool, and the GM declares when full proficiency with the tool has been reached.

For the purposes of buying and selling tools, navigate to the Equipment section.

Tool Example	Corresponding Skill
Alchemist Supplies	Academics: Alchemist/Chemist
Brewer's Supplies	Arts & Crafts: Brewer
Calligrapher's Supplies	Arts & Crafts: Writer/Painter or Subterfuge (Forging)
Carpenter's Supplies	Arts & Crafts: Carpentry
Cartographer's Supplies	Academics: Cartography
Cobbler's Supplies	Arts & Crafts: Cobbling
Cook's Utensils	Arts & Crafts: Cooking
Glassblower's Supplies	Arts & Crafts: Glassblowing
Jeweler's Tools	Arts & Crafts: Goldsmithing
Leatherworker's Tools	Arts & Crafts: Leatherworking
Mason's Tools	Arts & Crafts: Masonry
Painter's Supplies	Arts & Crafts: Painting
Potter's Tools	Arts & Crafts: Pottery
Smith's Tools	Arts & Crafts: Smithing
Tinker's Tools	Arts & Crafts: Tinkering
Weaver's Tools	Arts & Crafts: Weaving
Woodcarver's Tools	Arts & Crafts: Wood Carving

GM if you have ideas. Modifiers coupled with gaming sets could be very varied, pure Intelligence or Cunning tests, Academics (Strategy/Tactics) or even Subterfuge for sleight of hand.

Healer's Kit

This kit is a leather pouch containing bandages, salves, and splints. The kit has ten uses. Possessing a healer's kit and the knowledge to use it allows you and your allies to regain health points on short rest by spending one of the kit's uses, and the ability to diagnose and treat illnesses and diseases. As an action, if you have at least one rank in medicine,

List of Tools

This section introduces the tools (or tool groupings), what they commonly contain and if the tool has any common skill pairings. Skills that are more broad in their application, such as Medicine skill for Poisoner's kit, will not grant the character as much mastery as Academics (Poison) would.

Artisan's Tools

These special tools include the items needed to pursue a craft or trade. The table shows examples of the most common types of tools, each providing items related to a craft. These are only examples of Artisan's Tools, the player is free to come up with their own together with the GM.

Disguise Kit

This pouch of cosmetics, hair dye, and small props lets you create disguises that change your physical appearance. Commonly paired with the Subterfuge skill or Art & Craft (Actor/Makeup/Prosthetics/Tailor).

Forgery Kit

This small box contains a variety of papers and parchments, pens and inks, seals and sealing wax, gold and silver leaf, and other supplies necessary to create convincing forgeries of physical documents. Commonly paired with the Subterfuge skill or Art & Craft (Forging).

Gaming Sets

This item encompasses a wide range of game pieces, including dice and decks of cards. Common gamings sets can be dice, chess and playing cards. Other gaming sets can exist in the World - consult with your

you can expend one use of the kit to stabilize a creature that has 0 health points, without needing to make a Medicine (Cun) check. Most commonly used with the Medicine skill.

Herbalism Kit

This kit contains a variety of instruments such as clippers, mortar and pestle, and pouches and vials used by herbalists to create remedies and potions. This kit has 5 uses. Possessing an herbalism kit as well as the knowledge of using one allows you to identify and apply herbs, as well as create antitoxins. In addition, you may spend one of the kit's uses to regain health points and help your allies regain health points on a short rest if you possess at least one rank in Medicine or any other applicable Academic skills. Most often used with the Medicine skill or Academics (Herbalism/Nature).

Musical Instruments

Depending upon how you word your musical Arts & Craft skill it decides your familiarity with one or several instruments. A more broad wording, like Arts & Crafts (Stringed Instruments) allows you to play any stringed instrument but you will never attain the musical mastery of someone who has a Arts & Crafts (specific instrument). However, choosing a specific instrument makes you less able to play anything else than your chosen instrument.

Navigator's Tools

This set of instruments is used for navigation at sea. Possessing a navigator's tools as well as the knowledge of using one allows you to chart a ship's course, follow navigation charts and avoid getting lost at sea. Commonly paired with Academics (Navigation) or Survival.

Poisoner's Kit

A poisoner's kit includes the vials, chemicals, and other equipment necessary for the creation of poisons. Most commonly paired with Academics (Chemistry/Poisons/Alchemy).

Tattoo Kit

This kit comes in a sturdy wooden box of some description and contains a variety of various colored inks, needles, even some black ink infused with gold that is used for religious ceremonies of Riahn, and medical supplies needed for sterilization. The kit may also include a sketchbook filled with original tattoo designs that the tattooist may find on their journeys. Most commonly paired with Arts & Crafts (Painting/Tattooing).

Thieves' Tools

This set of tools includes a small file, a set of lock picks, a small mirror mounted on a metal handle, a set of narrow-bladed scissors, and a pair of pliers. Possessing a thieves' tools as well as the knowledge of using one allows you to pick locks and disarm traps. Most commonly paired with Subterfuge but could also be used with Academics (Engineering).

STEP 5 – CHARACTER CREATION EXAMPLES

In this section you'll find two player characters, Helos and Rogath, go through the fifth step in character creation.

“Helos”

Step 5

Eve has 16 points to spend on Accomplishments as the power-level of the campaign is heroic. She spends it on:

- ❖ The armor proficiency of light armor (1 point)
- ❖ The weapon proficiency of crossbows (1 point)
- ❖ Another skill point in Empathy (1 point)
- ❖ A skill point in Investigation (1 point)
- ❖ Two skill points in Leadership (2 points)
- ❖ A skill point in Medicine (1 point)
- ❖ A skill point in Occult (1 point)
- ❖ Another skill point in Persuasion (1 point)
- ❖ Proficiency for Resolve saving throws (2 points)
- ❖ An extra 125 gp (5 points)

As Helos haven't needed to practice that much martial self-defense, Eve only assigns him proficiency with light armor and crossbows. She spends 7 points in skills, improving his Empathy and Persuasion, and gives him some more social and utility skills that he has come across in his education. Eve spends two points on the Resolve saving throw to empathize his confidence. As a priest blessed with celestial ancestry in Crowhill, Helos' would earn a handsome salary. Thus, it makes sense to invest the rest of the Accomplishments points into money.

“Rogath”

Step 5

Carl has 18 points to spend on Accomplishments as the power-level of the campaign is champion. She spends it on:

- ❖ The armor proficiency of light armor to heavy armor (3 points)
- ❖ The weapon proficiency of heavy (3 points)
- ❖ The weapon proficiency of thrown (3 points)
- ❖ A skill point in Medicine (1 point)
- ❖ Another skill point in Survival (1 point)
- ❖ Proficiency for Brawn saving throws (1 point)
- ❖ Proficiency for Resolve saving throws (2 points)
- ❖ An extra 100 gp (4 points)

Rogath has been training with weapons and armors his whole life, so Carl assigns many points in armor and weapon proficiencies. Rogath prefers powerful and heavy weapons but has taught himself to throw weapons too – to ensure that he can defend himself with a ranged option as well. There have been many scrapes and bruises from all the training, duels, and the savage land he grew up in. Therefore, it makes sense for Rogath to have rudimentary experience with Medicine. Carl picked another skill point in Survival from his experience helping the village to hunt and survive. Carl also decides that Rogath should have two saving throws, Brawn and Resolve. Rogath has focused a lot on his physique, so Brawn is an obvious choice, and so is Resolve due to Rogath's exceptionally stubborn nature. Lastly, the rest of the Accomplishment points are put into money since Rogath has earned good arms and armor from the village as a reward his prowess.

STEP 6 – LEVEL UP

It's time to assign powerful abilities to your character by leveling up to level 1, or beyond. In many other RPGs, you choose a class, and that class provides your character with as they level up. Instead, Frostmark is driven by your character's backstory. Depending upon the backstory contents, your character will have access to a different set of ability origins (AO) and dictates which abilities you can pick within the AOs. Which ability origins fit with your character is determined through a conversation with your GM in step 1 of character creation - where both of you discuss which AOs would make sense .

Which ability origins and which abilities?

An AO is a group of leveled abilities with a theme. Thereby, your character should only have access to AOs that fit your character's theme. This can take the form of different activities in their backstory or simply be in the character's biology. Consider what the character has been trained in, what their careers are, special events that shape them, or simply, what their approach to obstacles and danger can be. A character who faces issues through careful deliberation could have access to [Tactics] or [Finesse] perhaps, but an AO like [Power] wouldn't make sense with their personality. The same goes for abilities. Whenever you are picking abilities, pick them in accordance with your character's theme and backstory, and confer your choices with your GM.

What does ability origin do?

When you and your GM have settled on one two four AOs for your character, you may pick abilities from those AOs whenever your character levels. The ability you choose for the level (and its parent ability origin) decides your characters health points, their talent with spellcasting, and if they receive extra skill points. Always take note of which AO you choose at any given level up and mark it down in your character sheet.

Ability origin choices are not finite

As your game goes on, depending upon your character's choices and actions, access to ability origins may change. Most often, this takes the form of acquiring access to another AO by focusing on specific training, finding a master, or a special event that occurs in play. In very rare cases, a character can also lose access to an AO. For example, this could happen when a [Divine Oath] taker breaks his or her oath. This is ultimately up to the GM to decide which consequences it will have, both storywise and mechanically.

One to four ability origins

A character can have access to one to four AOs at any given time. If a character has only one AO and loses access to it, the GM and the player must immediately decide upon giving the character access to another AO. Possessing several AOs does not necessarily make your character stronger, just less specialized as you can pick abilities from several different themes (AOs).

AO Tags

All ability origins have three "tags." They determine which health dice your character gains for the level if they receive additional skill points and how much spellcasting they will be able to purchase. Remember, for each level, you pick an ability from another ability origin than the last level, the tags your character gains for the level might change.

Health dice

Every time you level up, your character gains a health dice. The health dice are rolled when you level up to increase your character's total health points (HP) and can be used to recover health points during a short rest. The size of the health dice and the roll result will determine your character's health point gain.

At level 1, your character gains the maximum amount of HP, which is the full HD value modified by the character's Vitality modifier. For every level after that, roll the HD given by the AO you pick. If you would roll a number that is half or lower than half, add half of the maximum value of the HD to the result.

If your HD for a level is 1d8 and you roll a 4 (half), add 4 to the result (half of the maximum value of the HD).

Your HD, depending upon your AO picks, may change on different levels. You do not reroll your whole HP pool with the new HD. The HD you gain when you level up only adds to your HP total. Keep track of your different HD values and how many of each your character possesses. This changes how your character recovers HP from a short rest. Read about HD and short tests in the "Rules" section.

If you pick an AO with a 1d8 for level 3, you add upon the HP total with the 1d8. If you switch over to a 1d10 for level 4, you add upon your HP total with the 1d10.

Bonus Skill Points

If you select an ability from an AO with the tag "Bonus Skill Points: None," it has no effects, and you can ignore this tag. When you select an AO's ability with the tag "Bonus Skill Points: Extra" for the first time, you receive four skill Points to assign in skills of your choice. This bonus does not activate again if you pick an ability from another AO with the same tag. Additionally, every four times you pick an ability from an AO with the "Bonus Skill Points: Extra" tag, not including the first level, you receive two skill points to assign in skills of your choice. All AO levels with the tag "Bonus Skill Points: Extra" counts towards these rewards.

If you choose an [Tactics] on level 1 (has the extra skill point tag), you receive 4 skill points. If you would pick [Artistry] on level 2 (who also has the extra skill point tag), you do not gain 4 skill points again. However, after 3 levels of [Tactics] and 2 levels of [Artistry] (level 5 total), you gain 2 skill points as you have picked 4 abilities from AOs with the extra skill point tag.

Spellcasting

To acquire spellcasting (Soul Magic), the character must first have a plausible reason in their backstory to have gained a Soul Mark. Read more about this requirement in the "Acquiring Magic" section, under "Spellcasting." The GM can also give characters opportunities to gain spellcasting later in play. As soon as the GM agrees that your character has spellcasting, you can purchase Soul Magic with the Potential you gain from the last tag.

The spellcasting tag generates a pool of Potential for each level up. If your character possesses spellcasting, you can use your Potential to purchase cantrips, spell slots, and spells known or spent on Exaltation. If you don't possess spellcasting, your character still

gains Potential at every level and can be spent on Exaltation. Read more under the "Potential" section.

Activating AO's Tags

After choosing an ability (or two if it was level 1, 2, or 3), you activate the tags you gained from that ability's AO. Activating the tags means to;

- ❖ Increase your health point total with the HD tag
- ❖ Check if you received any extra skill points from the bonus skill point tag
- ❖ Note how much Potential you gained from the spellcasting tag, possibly spending that Potential immediately on spellcasting or saving it from future purchase or Exaltation.
- ❖ On level 1 to 3, you receive two abilities per level up, one Primary Selection ability and one Secondary Selection ability. Only the "Primary Selection" ability can activate your tags. The three tags cannot be activated during one level up.

If you would pick an [Artistry] ability at level 5;

- You receive a 1d8 to calculate your new HP total
- Check if you received any extra skill points
- See how much Potential you gained from the Moderate spellcasting tag and purchase spellcasting/Exaltation now or later

How to navigate the Ability Origins

Whenever you level up, you get to pick your character's ability from an ability origin your character has access to. This section outlines rules when you pick abilities.

You must meet the requirements of the ability

You can't pick an ability that requires or refers to another ability that you do not possess.

For example, suppose you have access to [Discipline]. In that case, you cannot pick the level 5 ability "Stunning Strike" (requires the expenditure of "Mastery" points) if you do not already possess the level 2 ability "Mastery" (which gives the character "Mastery" points). Likewise with [Finesse]'s "Dashing Courage" ability that refers to "Sneak Attack." If you do not have "Sneak Attack," you cannot pick the "Dashing Courage" ability.

Total level vs. [AO] levels

Any ability that refers to "total level" describes your character's total level (all ability origin levels added together). On the other hand, "[AO] level" asks for the specific number of levels your character possesses in one ability origin.

For example, a character might have 3 levels in [Devotion] ([AO] level) but also 2 levels in [Divine Oath] and 1 level in [Predator], giving them a total level of $3+2+1 = 6$.

Pick abilities equal to your total level

You can pick Abilities from an ability origin you have access to from an equal or lower level than your total level.

For example, if you have a character that just leveled to level 10, they may pick abilities that are level 10 or below.

No need to start from level 1

If you pick another ability origin next level, you do not have to pick an ability from level 1 in the new ability origin. You pick according to your total level.

For example, if you have a [Tactics] character that just leveled to 7 and through roleplay, your character gains access to the [Pact] AO as well, you can pick an ability in [Pact] that is level 7 or below that you meet the requirements of.

Level 1, 2, and 3 has Primary and Secondary Selection

Level 1, 2, and 3 in an AO provide your character with two abilities instead of just one, a Primary Selection (PS) ability and a Secondary Selection (SS) ability. However, only the Primary Selection ability activates your tags for the level. The Secondary Selection ability is only an extra ability your character receives and does not activate tags. The Secondary Selection ability does not count towards any [AO] levels or your total level. If your character has a total level higher than 3 and wants to pick a Primary or Secondary Selection ability (an ability that is level 1 to 3 in that AO), the character always gains a Primary and Secondary Selection ability.

Primary and Secondary Selection don't need to be from the same AO

The Primary and Secondary Selection abilities on levels 1 to 3 in an AO do not need to be picked from the same AO, nor do they have to be the same level as long as they are equal or lower to your total level.

For example, if you possess [Tactics] and [Finesse] and your character is total level 3, you can pick Primary Selection in [Tactics] at level 2 and Secondary Selection [Finesse] from level 1.

One ability per selection and/or level

If a level or a Selection offers several choices of abilities, you can only pick one.

For example, if you have a level 1 character and you want to pick your Primary Selection ability from [Divine Oath], you must choose between "Divine Sense" and "Proclaim Judgement." If you want to pick your Secondary Selection in [Artistry] instead of [Divine Oath], you must choose one of the three available abilities in that Selection. Next level, if you want to, you can go back to the same Primary and Secondary Selections and choose the abilities you did not pick up as long as the abilities do not state otherwise.

You can't pick abilities with the same name twice (some exceptions)

You can't pick an ability twice with the same name, even if they are present in two ability origins. There are some exceptions to these rules, which are explained further in this section. The exceptions are:

- ❖ Subtypes
- ❖ ASI or Feat
- ❖ Fighting Style

Subtypes

All ability origins have subtypes. A subtype is a further specialization into one aspect of an AO. The subtypes are always expressed as bullet points with a repeatable title ("College" for [Artistry], "Vow" for [Soul Oath], etc.) and subtype titles that repeat ("Charmer" from "College" and "Aegis" from "Vow," etc.). If you pick subtype ability in one AO for your character, you cannot pick abilities of another subtype in that AO. However,

you can pick other subtypes from other AOs. "Pact Boon" options ("Blade", "Bond", etc.) work the same way as a subtype, after you have chosen, for example, "Blade" you cannot pick another "Pact Boon" option.

For example, if your character picks "Protective Pomp" in the "Charmer" subtype from [Artistry]'s "College" (name of the section detailing the subtypes), they cannot pick any other "College" options than the "Charmer" abilities in [Artistry].

ASI or Feat

Level 4 in all ability origins offers the same ability, "ability score improvement or feat" (ASI or Feat). Be mindful that you may choose any ability origin that you have access to when you pick this ability (if you haven't already picked ASI or Feat in that AO on that AO level) if you want to activate any specific tags. You can only pick ASI or Feat for a specific AO a number of times equal to how many times that AO offers the ability to you, still abiding by the level requirement of abilities.

For example, if you have access to [Artistry] you can pick ASI or Feat five times with that AO when you reach a total level of 19. With [Tactics] levels, seven times at total level 19. If you have access to both [Artistry] and [Tactics], you can pick ASI and Feat with [Artistry] on level 4, gaining its tags, and then on level 5 pick ASI and Feat again with [Tactics], but gaining the tags of [Tactics]. The level 4 ASI and Feat for either [Artistry] and [Tactics] cannot be picked again. You can pick ASI and Feat again with [Tactics] when your character becomes level 6 or above as [Tactics] offers another ASI and Feat on that level.

Fighting Style

"Fighting Style" is a special ability that grants your character bonuses with specific styles of combat. Underneath "Fighting Style" are several bullet points, such as "Defense" and "Archery." When you pick "Fighting Style" for the first time, you can only choose one of the listed effects. If you have or gain access to another ability named "Fighting Style" in another AO, on another level, or in another Selection, you can pick another ability, choosing a new effect each time.

For example, on level 2 in [Divine Oath], you can choose to gain a "Fighting Style" instead of "Smite" in the Primary Selection. Then, in the Secondary Selection, you can choose another effect from the "Fighting Style" presented there.

Free Accomplishment Points

Every time your character gain a higher proficiency bonus through leveling, they also receive 2 free Accomplishment points to be spent in the Accomplishment section.

Retroactive levels

If you pick an ability at a later level that has an effect that becomes stronger the higher total level you are or, the more [AO] levels you have (the ability's AO), you count your total level or the [AO] levels you have for the purposes of that ability.

Location of "See below" abilities

Some abilities ask you to choose between several other abilities and end with the term; "See below." These abilities can be found below that AO's level 20 ability.

General Upgrade

If you have no ability options that your character meets the requirements of when you level up, or there are no abilities that suit your character, you can always exchange your ability (Primary as well as Secondary Selection) with a General Upgrade. If an AO has no new ability to offer on a given level (Primary as well as Secondary Selection), there is already a General Upgrade listed there. General Upgrades are called "Magical Upgrade" or "Martial Upgrade" in the AOs, depending upon if the AO has minor spellcasting ("Martial Upgrade") or moderate to major spellcasting tag ("Magical Upgrade").

General Upgrade [Artistry] [Devotion] [Discipline] [Divine Oath] [Finesse] [Occult Learner] [Pact] [Power] [Predator] [Soul Oath] [Soul Weapon] [Tactics] [Unique Ancestry] [World Magic]

Gain one of your choice:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

If you are higher level than 3 and want to pick a Primary and a Secondary Selection ability from level 1 to 3 in an AO, you cannot exchange both the Primary and the Secondary Selection ability to the General Upgrade.

Improved Upgrades

After special total levels, 5, 10, and 15, you can pick the Improved Martial Upgrade or Improved Magical Upgrade instead of a normal ability or a General Upgrade in your AOs. The Improved Upgrade can only be chosen once across all your AOs, and you must meet the total level requirements of them. If an AO has no ability on level 5, 10, or 15, an Improved Martial Upgrade or an Improved Magical Upgrade is presented there instead.

Improved Martial Upgrade [Discipline] [Finesse] [Power] [Soul Oath] [Tactics]

Gain one of your choice:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ +1 to an ability score
- ❖ Pick an additional feat from the feat list

Improved Magical Upgrade [Artistry] [Devotion] [Divine Bestowal] [Divine Oath] [Occult Learner] [Pact] [Predator] [Soul Weapon] [Unique Ancestry] [World Magic]

Gain one of your choice:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential
- ❖ +1 to an ability score
- ❖ Pick an additional feat from the feat list

STEP 6 – CHARACTER CREATION EXAMPLES

In this section you'll find two player characters, Helos and Rogath, go through the fifth step in character creation.

“Helos”

Step 5

Level 1 - Primary Selection (PS);

Lvl 1 PS [Devotion] - Divine Domain - Law - Voice of Authority

Level 1 - Secondary Selection (SS);

Lvl 1 SS [Divine Bestowal] - General Upgrade (+10 Potential)

Activated tags of Devotion

HP: 9/9

Extra skill points: none

Potential: 60

Eve levels Helos to level one. She picks [Devotion] as Helos Primary Selection for this level. Since Eve has chosen Order as Helos' Divine Domain, Helos can't pick any other Divine Domains in the future. Eve does not think that [Devotion]'s Secondary Selection Ability, heavy armor proficiency, suits Helos. Since [Unique Ancestry] doesn't have anything suitable for Helos in the Second Selection either, Eve takes a General Upgrade instead, choosing extra Potential.

Eve also activates her tags for the level. Since [Devotion] was her Primary Selection pick, she activates the tags of [Devotion];

Tags

HD: 1d8

Bonus Skill Points: None

Spellcasting: Major

Since it is level one, Helos receives the full value of his health dice plus his Vitality modifier. That puts him at 8+1 HP. [Devotion] does not receive any extra skill points, so Eve simply ignores that part. [Devotion] is, however, a “Spellcasting: Major” AO, which means she receives 60 Potential on level 1 according to the “Potential Gain per Level and Tag” table.

“Rogath”

Step 5

Level 1 - Primary Selection (PS):

Lvl 1 PS [Tactics] - Action Surge

Level 1 - Secondary Selection (SS):

Lvl 1 SS [Tactics] - Second Wind

Activated tags of [Tactics]

HP: 13/13

Extra skill points: 4 skill points

- ❖ Another 2 skill points to Athletics
- ❖ One skill point to Animal Handling
- ❖ One skill point to Persuasion

Potential: 20

Carl levels Rogath to level one. Due to Rogath's strictly martial upbringing, Carl and his GM agree that [Tactics] makes the most sense to start with. The abilities of Action Surge and Second Wind suit Rogath splendidly, so Carl simply picks both abilities as his Primary and Secondary Selection for the level.

Carl also activates his tags for the level. Since [Tactics] was his Primary Selection pick, he activates the tags of [Tactics];

Tags

HD: 1d10

Bonus Skill Points: Extra (4 skill points)

Spellcasting: Minor

Since it is level one, Rogath receives the full value of his health dice plus his Vitality modifier. That puts him at 10+3 HP. [Tactics] receive extra skill points, so Carl assigns 2 skill points in Athletics, once again to hammer home his martial power. He puts a point in Animal Handling to represent the time he spent helping to take care of the village-owned animals. And a point in Persuasion, from practicing intimidation and mind games in combat. Rogath also gains 20 Potential since [Tactics] is a minor spellcasting AO.

[ARTISTRY]

HD: 1d8

Bonus Skill Points: Extra

Spellcasting: Moderate

Level 1

Level 1 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Inspiration [Artistry]

You can use a bonus action on your turn to choose one creature other than yourself within 12 m of you who can hear you. That creature gains one Inspiration die, a d6.

Once within the next 10 minutes, the creature can roll the die and add the number rolled to one ability check, attack roll, or saving throw it makes. In addition, the Inspiration die can be added to a damage or a healing roll from casting a spell. The creature can wait until after it rolls the d20 before deciding to use the Inspiration die but must decide before the GM says whether the roll succeeds or fails. Once the Inspiration die is rolled, it is lost. A creature can have only one Inspiration die at a time.

You can use this ability a number of times equal to your 1 + Presence modifier or Manipulation modifier (a minimum of once). You regain any expended uses when you finish a long rest. Your Inspiration die changes when you reach certain levels in [Artistry]. The die becomes a d8 after 5 level picks, a d10 after 10 level picks, and a d12 after 15 level picks.

Secondary Selection

Master of Some [Artistry]

You gain 5 skill points in at least 4 different skills. With this ability, you cannot increase any skill rank beyond rank 2. One skill point you must spend in Academics and one in Arts & Craft. In addition, you also add half your proficiency bonus (rounded up) to your initiative checks. If you pick Master of Some, you cannot pick Jack of all Trades.

Jack Of All Trades [Artistry]

In skills you do not already have any skill points invested in, except for Academics and Arts & Craft skills, you can add half your proficiency bonus (rounded up) to your skill checks. In addition, you also add half your proficiency bonus (rounded up) to your initiative checks. If you pick Jack of all Trades, you cannot pick Master of Some.

Unarmored Defense [Artistry]

While you are not wearing any armor or wielding a shield, your armor value equals 10 + your Dexterity modifier + your Presence or Manipulation modifier. The Dexterity and the Presence/Manipulation modifier cannot exceed your proficiency bonus individually.

Level 2

Level 2 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

College [Artistry]

- ❖ **Charmer - Protective Pomp:** You inspire resilience in your allies, making them more determined to stand firm. When you pick this ability, choose either Presence or Manipulation. As a bonus action, you can spend two uses of Inspiration and choose a number of creatures (minimum 1) that can either see you (Presence) or hear you (Manipulation). The designated creatures receive 5 temporary health points and they can immediately use their reactions to move up to half their speed. This movement does not provoke attacks of opportunity. The number of temporary health points increases when you reach certain total levels, increasing to 10 at 5th total level, 15 at 10th total level, and 20 at 15th total level.
- ❖ **Connoisseur - Cutting Words:** When a creature that you can see within 12 m of you makes an attack roll, an ability check, or a damage roll, you can use your reaction to expend one of your uses of Inspiration, rolling an Inspiration die and subtracting the number rolled from the creature's roll. You can choose to use this ability after the creature makes its roll, but before the GM determines whether the attack roll or ability check succeeds or fails, or before the creature deals its damage. The creature is immune if it can't hear you or if it's immune to being charmed.
- ❖ **Dancer - Ballet of Blades:** Whenever you make an attack action on your turn, your walking speed increases by 2 m until the end of your turn. Additionally, once per turn, you may apply a Ballet of Blades option to a successful melee weapon attack:
 - **Waltz:** You can expend one use of your Inspiration dice to cause the melee weapon attack to deal more damage equal to the number rolled on the Inspiration die. In addition, you may add the result of your Inspiration die to your AV, or to an ally of your choice within 6 m of you that can see or hear you, until the start of your next turn.
 - **Conga:** You can expend one use of your Inspiration dice to cause the melee weapon attack to deal more damage equal to the number rolled on the Inspiration die. In addition, you deal damage to any other creatures within 1 m of you that you can see equal to the number rolled on the Inspiration die.
 - **Tango:** You can expend one use of your Inspiration dice to cause the melee weapon attack to deal more damage equal to the number rolled on the Inspiration die. In addition, you can push the target up to 1 m + half the number rolled on the Inspiration die (minimum 1) away from you. Immediately after, you can spend your reaction to move up to half your speed to an unoccupied space within 1 m of the target, or as close as possible. Alternatively, instead, you can allow an ally within 6 m of you that hears or sees you to spend their reaction and to move up to half their speed to an unoccupied space within 1 m of the target.
- ❖ **Duelist - Inspiring Bravado:** A creature that has been given an Inspiration die from you can add the Inspiration die to weapon damage rolls. Additionally, you may spend a bonus action and an Inspiration die to heal yourself or an ally within

6 m of you that can see or hear you, equal to the number rolled on the Inspiration die plus half your proficiency bonus (rounded up).

- ❖ **History - A Ghost Story:** You can use a bonus action to expend one use of your Inspiration and roll on the Ghost Story table below using your Inspiration die to determine the story history directs you to tell. You retain the story in mind until you bestow the story's effect or you finish a short or long rest.

You can use an action to choose one creature you can see within 6 m of you (this can be you) to be the target of the story's effect. Once you do so, you can't bestow the story's effect again until you roll it again.

You can retain only one of these stories in mind at a time, and rolling on the Ghost Story table immediately ends the effect of the previous story.

If the story requires a saving throw, the DV equals your spell save DV.

1. **Story of the Clever:** For the next 10 minutes, whenever the target makes a mental or social ability check, the target can roll an extra die immediately after rolling the d20 and add the extra die's number to the check. The extra die is the same type as your Inspiration die.
2. **Story of the Warrior:** You make a melee spell attack against the target. On a hit, the target takes force damage equal to two rolls of your Inspiration die + your Presence or Manipulation modifier.
3. **Story of the Lover:** The target and another creature of its choice it can see within 1 m of it gains temporary health points equal to a roll of your Inspiration die + your Presence or Manipulation modifier.
4. **Story of the Nimble:** The target can immediately use its reaction to teleport up to 6 m to an unoccupied space it can see. When the target teleports, it can choose a number of creatures it can see within 6 m of it up to your Presence or Manipulation modifier (minimum of 0) to immediately use the same reaction.
5. **Story of the Vengeful:** For 1 minute, any creature that hits the target with a melee attack takes force damage equal to a roll of your Inspiration die.
6. **Story of the Ranger:** The target gains temporary health points equal to a roll of your Inspiration die + your total level. While it has these temporary health points, the target's walking speed increases by 2 m and it gains a +1 bonus to its AV.
7. **Story of the Occultist:** The target must succeed on a Int/Cun saving throw or take psychic damage equal to two rolls of your Inspiration die, and the target is incapacitated until the end of its next turn.
8. **Story of the Specter:** The target becomes invisible until the end of its next turn or until it hits a creature with an attack. If the target hits a creature with an attack during this invisibility, the creature it hits takes necrotic damage equal to a roll of your Inspiration die and is frightened of the target until the end of the frightened creature's next turn.
9. **Story of the Gladiator:** Each creature of the target's choice it can see within 6 m of it must make a Brawn saving throw. On a failed save, a creature takes thunder damage equal to three rolls of your Inspiration die and is knocked prone. A creature that succeeds on its saving throw takes half as much damage and isn't knocked prone.
10. **Story of the Wyrms:** The target spews fire from the mouth in a 6 m cone. Each creature in that area must make a Dexterity saving throw, taking fire damage equal to four rolls of your Inspiration die on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one.
11. **Story of the Celestial:** The target regains health points equal to two rolls of your Inspiration die + your Presence/Manipulation modifier, and you end

one condition from the following list affecting the target: blinded, deafened, paralyzed, petrified, or poisoned.

12. Story of the Abberation: The target must succeed on an Resolve saving throw or take psychic damage equal to three rolls of your Inspiration die and be stunned until the end of its next turn.

- ❖ **Mummer - Subjugation:** Whenever a creature rolls a saving throw from an enchantment or illusion spell you cast that only targets one creature and requires a saving throw, you may use your bonus action and an Inspiration die to lower the result of the saving throw equal to the number rolled on the Inspiration die. You may spend an Inspiration die this way after the saving throw is rolled but before the GM declares if the creature succeeded or not.
- ❖ **Wit - Cause Doubt:** As a bonus action, you can expend one Inspiration die, roll it, and choose one creature you can see within 12 m of you. The creature must subtract the number rolled from the next saving throw it makes before the start of your next turn (or within the next five seconds).

Secondary Selection

College [Artistry]

- ❖ **Charmer - Hypnotic Work:** If you perform for at least 1 minute, you can attempt to hypnotize an audience by singing, reciting a poem, dancing, etc. At the end of the performance, choose a number of humanoids within 12 m of you who watched and listened to all of it, up to a number equal to your Presence or Manipulation modifier (minimum of one). Each target must succeed on a Composure saving throw against your spell save DV or be charmed by you. While charmed in this way, the target idolizes you, it speaks glowingly of you to anyone who talks to it, and it hinders anyone who opposes you, although it avoids violence unless it was already inclined to fight on your behalf. This effect ends on a target after 1 hour, if it takes any damage, if you attack it, or if it witnesses you attacking or damaging any of its allies.
If a target succeeds on its saving throw, the target has no hint that you tried to charm it.
Once you use this ability, you can't use it again until you finish a short or long rest.
- ❖ **Connoisseur - Bonus Proficiencies:** You gain four skill points. At least two of these skill points must be spent on Academics, Animal Handling, Art&Craft, Occult, Subterfuge or Survival skills.
- ❖ **Dancer - Bonus Proficiencies:** You gain proficiency with medium armor, heavy armor, and one weapon category of your choice.
- ❖ **Duelist - Bonus Proficiencies:** You gain proficiency with medium armor, shields, and one weapon category of your choice.
- ❖ **History - Learn From Their Example:** You learn the Guidance cantrip. When you cast Guidance you roll the 1d4 bonus with advantage.
- ❖ **Mummer - Psychic Blades:** When you hit a creature with a weapon attack, you can expend one use of your Inspiration to deal an extra 2d6 psychic damage to that target. You can do so only once per round on your turn.
- ❖ **Mummer - Words of Dominance:** Once per short or long rest, you can attempt to enforce your will upon a humanoid by talking uninterrupted with the target for 1 minute. When the conversation ends, the humanoid must succeed on a Resolve saving throw (frighten) or a Composure saving throw (charm) against your spell save DV or be frightened or charmed by you or another creature of

your choice. The target remains frightened or charmed until it is attacked or damaged until it witnesses its allies being attacked or damaged or until an hour passes. The target has no hint that you tried to frighten or charm it if the target succeeds the saving throw.

In addition, if you possess the Psychic Blades ability, the extra damage you deal increases with 1d6 when you're total level 5.

- ❖ **Wit - Always The Right Words:** When you make a Persuasion (Pre/Man) or Deception (Pre/Man) skill check, you can treat a d20 roll of 9 or lower as a 10.

Level 3

Level 3 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Serene Display [Artistry]

Once per long rest, you can make your allies more serene with a special performance as an action. For 3 rounds, whenever you or an ally within 6 m of you that can hear and see you, casts a healing spell that targets you or an ally within 6 m of you, the spell heals an extra amount equal to your proficiency bonus multiplied by the level of the spell slot used. The range of this ability increases to 12 m after 9 level picks of [Artistry]. If you pick Compelling Display, you cannot pick Serene Display.

Compelling Display [Artistry]

Once per long rest, you can make your allies more serene with a special performance as a bonus action. Until the start of your next turn, whenever you or an ally within 6 m of you that can hear and see you, casts a healing spell that targets you or an ally within 6 m of you, the spell heals for its maximum amount. The range of this ability increases to 12 m after 9 level picks of [Artistry]. If you pick Serene Display, you cannot pick Compelling Display.

Secondary Selection

Expertise [Artistry]

You gain two skill points in two skills of your choice, and you may gain rank 5 for both of the chosen skills.

Level 4

Ability Score Improvement or Feat [Artistry]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 5

Font of Inspiration [Artistry]

You regain all of your expended uses of Inspiration when you finish a short or long rest.

Level 6

Snap Out [Artistry]

As a reaction, you can start a performance. Until the start of your next turn, you and any friendly creatures within 6 m of you have an advantage on any mental or social saving throws they make. A creature must be able to hear you to gain this benefit. The performance ends early if you are incapacitated or silenced or if you voluntarily end it (no action required).

Level 7

College [Artistry]

- ❖ **Charmer - Sublime Splendor:** Once per long rest, you can transform into a form of transcendent beauty by casting Command as a bonus action. This cast of Command is considered Soul Mastery. Your transformation lasts for 10 rounds or until you lose your concentration (as if you were concentrating on a spell). As long as you remain in this form, you can cast Command as a bonus action once on each of your turns as Soul Mastery.
- ❖ **Connoisseur - Peerless Skill:** You can expend one Inspiration die to give yourself Inspiration. When you make an ability check, you can also expend one use of Inspiration. Roll an Inspiration die and add the number rolled to your ability check. You can choose to do so after you roll the die for the ability check, but before the GM tells you whether you succeed or fail.
- ❖ **Dancer - Extra Attack:** You can attack twice, instead of once, whenever you take the attack action on your turn.
- ❖ **Duelist - Extra Attack:** You can attack twice, instead of once, whenever you take the attack action on your turn.
- ❖ **History - Fragmented Magic Memory:** You can conduct an hour-long ritual channeling knowledge from Soul fragments lingering within an Ennnade or the World (which can be done during a short or long rest). At the end of the ritual you learn a spell you otherwise don't know. The spell you choose must be of a level equal to or lower than your proficiency bonus, and from the school of Divination or Vismancy. You know the chosen spell until you start a long rest. Once you perform the ritual, you can't do so again until you start a long rest.
- ❖ **Mummer - Mask Maker:** If you possess the Psychic Blades ability, the extra damage you deal increases with 2d6 when you reach total level 9. In addition, once per short or long rest, when a humanoid dies within 6 m of you, you can use your reaction to capture their mask. You keep their mask until you use it or you finish a long rest. You can use the mask as an action and gain a number of benefits:
 - You look exactly like the dead humanoid, but healthy and alive.
 - Whilst in the disguise, you gain access to all information that the humanoid would freely share with a casual acquaintance. Such information includes general details on its background and personal life but doesn't include secrets.
 - A creature can attempt to peer past your mask by contesting you with your Dec (Man) with their Emp (Com). You gain a +5 bonus on this check.
 - Your disguise lasts for 1 hour or until you end it as a bonus action.
- ❖ **Wit - You Will Hear Me:** Once per short rest and as an action, choose one or more creatures within 12 m of you, up to a number equal to your Manipulation modifier (minimum of one creature). The chosen creatures can magically

understand you, regardless of the language you speak, languages they speak (if any), if they are deaf or otherwise unable to hear you, for 1 hour.

Level 8

Ability Score Improvement or Feat [Artistry]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 9

General Upgrade [Artistry]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 10

Expertise [Artistry]

You gain two skill points in two skills of your choice, and you may gain rank 5 for both of the chosen skills.

Level 11

Magical Secrets [Artistry]

Choose two spells of level 3 or below or one spell of level 4 or below. You can cast these spells as Soul Mastery once per long rest.

Level 12

Ability Score Improvement or Feat [Artistry]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 13

General Upgrade [Artistry]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential

Level 14

College [Artistry]

- ❖ **Charmer - Regal Visage:** Once per short or long rest, you may ooze nobility and majesty for 10 rounds as a bonus action. For the duration, whenever any creature tries to target you with a weapon or spell attack for the first time on a turn, the attacker must make a Composure saving throw against your spell save DV. On a

failed save, it can't attack you on this turn, and it must choose a new target for its attack or the attack is wasted. On a successful save, it can attack you on this turn, but it has a disadvantage on any saving throw it makes against your spells on your next turn.

- ❖ **Connoisseur - Consistent Expertise:** Choose two spells that you know. When casting the two spells, you have advantage to hit if the spell has an attack roll or one target affecting by the spell has disadvantage to a saving throw the spell forces them to make.
- ❖ **Dancer - Grand Ballet:** Whenever you use a Ballet of Blades option, you can roll a d6 and use it instead of expanding an Inspiration die.
- ❖ **Duelist - Spellsword Mastery:** When you use your action to cast a spell, you can make one weapon attack as a bonus action.
- ❖ **History - Weave Through History:** Whenever you roll on the Ghost Story table, you can roll the die twice and choose which of the two effects to bestow. If you roll the same number on both dice, you can ignore the number and choose any effect on the table.
- ❖ **Mummer - Unknowing Blackmail:** If you possess the Psychic Blades ability, the extra damage you deal increases with 3d6.
In addition, once per long rest, you may attempt to unknowingly blackmail another creature. Choose a creature within 6 m of you that can hear you and share a language with you. As an action, you magically whisper a phrase that only your target can hear after which the target must make a Composure saving throw against your spell save DV. On a successful saving throw, your whisper sounds like unintelligible mumbling and has no effect. On a failed saving throw, the target suffers a number of effects:
 - The target believes you know a mortifying secret of theirs, and becomes charmed by you for the next 8 hours, or until you or your allies attack it, damage it, or force it to make a saving throw.
 - You gain no knowledge of this secret, but the target is convinced you know it.
 - The charmed creature believes it is blackmailed by you and follows your commands in fear that you will reveal their secret. It won't risk its life for you unless it was already inclined to do so, but it treats you like a close friend and may offer you favors and gifts.
 - When the effect ends, the creature does not remember why they were afraid of you, but they remember everything else that happened during the duration of this ability.
- ❖ **Wit - Spread the Word:** When a creature within 12 m of you adds one of your Inspiration dice to its ability check, attack roll, or saving throw and the roll succeeds, you can use your reaction to encourage a different creature (other than yourself) that can hear you within 12 m of you, giving it an Inspiration die without expending one of your Inspiration dice.
You can use this reaction a number of times equal to your Manipulation modifier (minimum of once), and you regain all expended uses when you finish a long rest.

Level 15

Magical Secrets [Artistry]

Choose two spells of level 4 or below or one spell of level 5 or below. You can cast these spells as Soul Mastery once per long rest.

Level 16

Ability Score Improvement or Feat [Artistry]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 17

General Upgrade [Artistry]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential

Level 18

Magical Secrets [Artistry]

Choose two spells of level 5 or below or one spell of level 6 or below. You can cast these spells as Soul Mastery once per long rest.

Level 19

Ability Score Improvement or Feat [Artistry]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 20

Superior Inspiration [Artistry]

When you roll Initiative or cast a spell of 5th level or higher, and have no uses of Inspiration left, you regain one use.

DEVOTION

HD: 1d8

Bonus Skill Points: None

Spellcasting: Major

Level 1

Level 1 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Divine Domain [Devotion]

Pick according to your chosen Enneade's Domains.

- ❖ **Animation - Lifegiver:** Whenever you use a spell of 1st level or higher to restore health points to a creature, the creature regains additional health points equal to 2 + the spell's level.
- ❖ **Ardor - Distracting Flash:** A brilliant flash of light erupts from your hand, distracting your attacker. As a reaction, you may impose disadvantage on an attack roll targeting you by a creature within 6 m of you. An attacker who cannot be blinded is immune to this ability. You can use this ability a number of times equal to your Resolve modifier (a minimum of once). You regain all expended uses when you finish a long rest.
- ❖ **Athanasia - Deny Death:** When you restore health points to a creature at 0 health points with a spell, the dice you would normally roll now heal for the highest number possible for each die. In addition, you learn Spare the Dying cantrip as Soul Mastery. If you cast it this way, it has a range of 6 m, and you can cast it as a bonus action.
- ❖ **Battle - Initiate of War:** When you take the attack action, you can make one weapon attack as a bonus action. You can use this ability a number of times equal to your Resolve modifier (minimum 1). You regain all expended uses when you finish a long rest.
- ❖ **Community - Urban Soul:** You may gain advantage to Persuasion (Man) checks whilst you are within an urban environment a number of times equal to your Manipulation modifier (minimum 1). You regain any expended uses when you finish a long rest.
- ❖ **Craft - Blessed Armory:** At the end of a long rest, you may bless a nonmagical suit of armor or a nonmagical weapon. Until the end of your next long rest, the armor becomes magical and receives a +1 to its AV. If you bless a weapon, it becomes magical and receives a +1 to hit and damage until the end of your next long rest. Once you use this ability, you can't use it again until you finish a long rest. In addition, you gain two skill points with Arts & Craft (smithing). You may gain skill rank 5 with that skill.
- ❖ **Deceit - Grace of Covertiness:** You can give one willing creature advantage on Stealth checks (Dex/Cun) for an hour (or until you use this ability again) by a mere touch.
- ❖ **Harmony - Act as One:** When you take the Help Action and choose to give advantage to an ally's attack roll, you can make one weapon attack as a bonus action. You can use this ability a number of times equal to your Composure modifier (minimum 1). You regain expended uses when you finish a long rest.

- ❖ **Law - Call for Order:** If you cast a spell of 1st level or higher and target an ally with that spell, that ally can use their reaction immediately after the spell to make one weapon attack against a creature of your choice that you can see. If the spell targets more than one ally, you choose the ally who can make the attack. You also gain two skill points in the Persuasion skill and you may gain rank 5 in that skill.
- ❖ **Lore - Sophisticated Mind:** You learn two languages of your choice at Academics skill rank 2. You also gain three skill points in two Academic skills of your choice. You may gain rank 5 in those Academics skills.
- ❖ **Might - Worshiper of Strength:** When you take the attack action, you can make one weapon attack as a bonus action. You can use this ability a number of times equal to your Resolve modifier (minimum 1). You regain all expended uses when you finish a long rest.
- ❖ **Nature - In Tandem with Nature:** You learn one nature-themed cantrip of your choice. You also gain four skill points in one of the following skills of your choice: Animal Handling, Academics: Nature, or Survival. You may gain rank 5 in this skill.
- ❖ **Passion - Fervor:** When you take the attack action, you can make one weapon attack as a bonus action. You can use this ability a number of times equal to your Presence modifier (minimum 1). You regain all expended uses when you finish a long rest.
- ❖ **Preservation - Stalwart Defender:** When a creature within 1 m of you is attacked, you can spend your reaction to impose disadvantage on the attack roll. For the purposes of this ability, you must be able to see both the attacker and the target.
- ❖ **Radiance - Distracting Flash:** A brilliant flash of light erupts from your hand, distracting your attacker. As a reaction, you may impose disadvantage on an attack roll targeting you by a creature within 6 m of you. An attacker who cannot be blinded is immune to this ability. You can use this ability a number of times equal to your Presence modifier (minimum 1). You regain all expended uses when you finish a long rest.
- ❖ **Ruin - Bringer of Death:** You learn one cantrip from the school of vismanancy of your choice. When you cast a vismanancy cantrip that normally targets only one creature, the spell can instead target two creatures within the range of the spell as long as the two creatures are within 1 m of each other.
- ❖ **Storm - Tempestuous Retribution:** When you are successfully attacked by a creature that you can see and is within 1 m of you, you can spend your reaction to hurt them with a shock of lightning or blast of thunder. The creature must roll a Dexterity saving throw against your spell save DV. On a failed save, the creature takes 2d8 lightning or thunder damage (your choice but you can only choose once), and half as much damage on a successful one. You can use this ability a number of times equal to your Presence modifier (minimum 1). You regain all expended uses when you finish a long rest. In addition, you gain proficiency with two weapons of your choice.
- ❖ **Thaumaturgy - Magical Instruction:** You gain two skill points in Occult, and you may gain rank 5 in this skill. In addition, you gain two cantrips and one first level spell from the spell list of your choice.

Secondary Selection

Divine Domain [Devotion]

- **Athanasia - Vision of Death:** As an action, you can give yourself a Vision of Death until the end of your next turn. Whilst you have Vision of Death activated, you know the location of any undead within 12 m of you that isn't behind total cover and isn't protected from Divination magic. You do not learn what kind of undead it is nor any of its capabilities. You can use this ability a number of times equal to your Resolve modifier (minimum 1). You regain all expended uses when you finish a long rest.

Bonus Proficiency [Devotion]

You gain proficiency with heavy armor.

Level 2

Level 2 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Channel Divinity [Devotion]

For a short moment, you can channel the divine essence of your God through yourself. Channel Divinity is not an ability you can pick normally. Instead, options in the Divine Domain may include Channel Divinity options. Any ability in the Divine Domain list that includes "CD" in its name is a Channel Divinity ability. Divine Domain abilities that are also Channel Divinity possess these rules:

- ❖ Each Channel Divinity option provided by your [Devotion] explains how to use it.
- ❖ When you use your Channel Divinity ability, you choose which option to use.
- ❖ You must then finish a short or long rest to use your Channel Divinity again. After 6 level picks of [Devotion] you can use it twice per day, and after 18 level picks of [Devotion] thrice.
- ❖ Some Channel Divinity effects require Saving Throws. When you use such an effect from this Origin, the DV equals your spell save DV.
- ❖ You may expend a use of Channel Divinity as a bonus action to regain one expended spell slot of first level.

Divine Domain [Devotion]

- ❖ **Animation - CD Hope for the Hopeless:** As an action, you can restore health points equal to five times your [Devotion] level. Choose any number of creatures within 6 m of you, and divide those health points among them in a manner of your choice. This ability can restore a creature to no more than half of its health point maximum, and you cannot use this ability on a construct.
- ❖ **Ardor - CD Sever Shadow:** As an action, you may confuse your enemies by creating an illusion of yourself which grants you a number of benefits:
 - The ability lasts for 10 rounds or until you lose your concentration as if you were concentrating on a spell (if you cast a spell that requires concentration, this ability immediately ends).
 - You may summon the illusion within 6 m of yourself in an unoccupied space you can see.
 - As a bonus action, you may move the illusion up to 6 m, but it cannot be further away from you than 24 m.

- For the duration, you can cast spells through your illusion, as if you were in the illusion's space, but you must still abide by your own senses.
- Considering how confusing it is to see both you and your illusion, you gain advantage on attack rolls against any creature that you and the illusion are within 1 m of.
- ❖ **Athanasia - CD Curse the Hopeless:** As an action, you choose one creature you can see within 1 m of you, cursing it until the end of your next turn. The next time you or an ally of yours hits the cursed creature with an attack, the creature has vulnerability to all of that attack's damage, and then the curse ends.
- ❖ **Battle - CD Moment of Destiny:** You can use your Channel Divinity to grant yourself a +10 bonus to an attack roll, ability check, or saving throw of your choice. You may add this bonus to a roll after you see it, but before the GM says whether the roll succeeds or fails.
- ❖ **Community - CD Towncrier:** As an Action, each hostile creature within 6 m of you must make a Composure saving throw as you cry out to the city to defend you. On a failed save, the creature is knocked prone or restrained (your choice) by urban animated utilities and objects, such as tangling plants, stonework falling over, or splashing water from buckets and wells. A restrained creature can escape by making a successful Athletics (Br/Dex) check (their choice) against your spell save DV. What objects or utilities aid you in this way and how is up to the GM.
- ❖ **Craft - CD Metal Transmutation:** You can transmute a nonmagical object that at least has some metal in its construction and is worth no more than 100 gp. By conducting a 1-hour ritual and supplying any kind of metal equal to the worth of the creation, you can magically transmute the metal to other materials and form. Once the ritual is over, the object is transmuted irrevocably. The ritual can duplicate an item if you have access to the original during the ritual.
- ❖ **Harmony - CD Hope for the Hopeless:** As an action, you can restore health points equal to five times your [Devotion] level. Choose any number of creatures within 6 m of you, and divide those health points among them in a manner of your choice. This ability can restore a creature to no more than half of its health point maximum, and you cannot use this ability on a construct.
- ❖ **Law - CD Authoritative Demand:** As an action, you can attempt to charm each creature within 6 m of you that can see or hear you. A creature in range must make a Composure saving throw, and on a failed save is charmed by you until the end of your next turn or until the charmed creature takes any damage. When a creature fails this saving throw, you can also command it to drop whatever it is holding.
- ❖ **Lore - CD Divine Epiphany:** As an action, choose one skill and you gain three skill points with it for 10 minutes.
- ❖ **Might - CD Herculean Task:** You can use your Channel Divinity to grant yourself a +10 bonus to an attack roll, ability check, or saving throw using brawn of your choice. You may add this bonus to a roll after you see it, but before the GM says whether the roll succeeds or fails.
- ❖ **Nature - CD Invoke the Mother:** As an action, you may attempt to charm each animal, beast, or plant creature within 6 m of you that you can see. The creature must roll a Composure saving throw. On a failed save, the creature is charmed by you for 10 rounds or until it takes damage. While it is charmed by you, you may designate other creatures the animal or plant must be friendly towards.

- ❖ **Passion - CD Burst of Violence:** Instead of rolling damage dice, you may use your Channel Divinity to deal maximum damage with a spell or ability that deals fire or lightning damage.
- ❖ **Preservation - CD Lustrous Retaliation:** As an action, you may punish a creature who attacks one of your allies. Choose one ally within 6 m of you, the next time that ally is hit by an attack within the next 10 rounds, the attacker takes radiant damage equal to 2d10 + your level of [Devotion].
- ❖ **Radiance - CD Dawn of Illumination:** As an action, you may dispel any magical darkness within 6 m of you. Additionally, each hostile creature within 6 m of you must make a Vitality saving throw. On a failed save, the creature suffers Radiant damage equal to 2d10 + your level of [Devotion]. A creature that has total cover from you is immune to this effect.
- ❖ **Ruin - CD Ravage:** Using your Channel Divinity, you can deal extra necrotic damage to the target equal to 5 + twice your level of [Devotion] when you hit a creature with a melee attack.
- ❖ **Storm - CD High Voltage:** Instead of rolling damage dice, you may use your Channel Divinity to deal maximum damage with a spell or ability that deals thunder or lightning damage.
- ❖ **Thaumaturgy - CD Reject the Impure:** You may turn one celestial, elemental, fey, or fiend of your choice within 6 m of you as an action. The creature must be able to hear and see you. The creature must make a Resolve saving throw and on a failed save, it is turned for 10 rounds or until it takes any damage. Turn creatures suffer these effects:
 - It must spend its turns trying to move as far away from you as it can, and it can't willingly end its move in a space within 6 m of you.
 - It can't perform any reactions.
 - As an action, it can only take the dash action.
 - If it cannot move further away from you, it may use the dodge action instead.

After 5 level picks of [Devotion], this ability banishes instead of turns (as in the Banishment spell but no concentration required) if it is not within its home Realm. You cannot banish a creature this way if its challenge rating is at or below certain thresholds, as shown below:

Level picks in [Devotion]	Banishes creatures of CR
5	1/2 or lower
8	1 or lower
11	2 or lower
14	3 or lower
17	4 or lower

Secondary Selection

General Upgrade [Devotion]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 3

Level 3 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

General Upgrade [Devotion]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Secondary Selection

General Upgrade [Devotion]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 4

Ability Score Improvement or Feat [Devotion]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 5

Improved Magical Upgrade [Devotion]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential
- ❖ +1 to an ability score of your choice
- ❖ Pick an additional feat from the feat list

Level 6

Divine Domain [Devotion]

- ❖ **Animation - Great Animator:** When you cast a spell of 1st level or higher that restores health points to a creature other than you, you regain health points equal to 2 + the spell's level.
- ❖ **Ardor - CD Escape Route:** As an action, you may become invisible until the end of your next turn or until you attack or cast a spell.
- ❖ **Athanasia - Negate Aggression:** You may turn a critical hit into a normal hit targeting you or an ally within 6 m of you as a reaction. Any effects triggered by the critical hit are canceled. You can use this ability a number of times equal to your Resolve modifier (minimum 1). You regain all expended uses when you finish a long rest.

- ❖ **Battle - CD Benediction of Conflict:** Using your Channel Divinity, you may grant a creature within 6 m of you a +10 bonus to their attack roll as a reaction. You make this choice after you see the roll, but before the GM says whether the attack hits or misses.
- ❖ **Community - Street Smart:** While in an urban environment, you are considered to have two skill points in the Empathy and Perception skills (in addition to your existing points). You cannot go beyond rank 5. With this ability, you may ignore the level requirements for skill ranks. You may gain rank 5 in those skills.
- ❖ **Craft - Devoted to the Forge:** You gain resistance to fire and you gain +1 AV when you are wearing heavy armor.
- ❖ **Deceit - Cloak of Shadows:** As an action, you may become invisible until the end of your next turn or until you attack or cast a spell.
- ❖ **Harmony - Benediction of Conflict:** Using your Channel Divinity, you may grant a creature within 6 m of you a +10 bonus to their attack roll as a reaction. You make this choice after you see the roll, but before the GM says whether the attack hits or misses.
- ❖ **Law - Epitome of Order:** For a number of times per long rest equal to your Resolve modifier (minimum 1), you can change the casting time of one enchantment spell of at least 1st level or higher from an action to a bonus action.
- ❖ **Lore - CD Pervade Mind:** As an action, you can attempt to read the surface thoughts of a creature within 12 m of you that you can see. The creature must roll a Composure saving throw, on a failed save, you can read thoughts that are foremost in its mind for 10 rounds as long as the creature is within 12 m of you. As long as you are reading its mind and within 12 m of the creature, you can spend an action to cast Suggestion on the creature as Soul Mastery. The target automatically fails its saving throw against the spell. If the creature succeeds on the saving throw, you cannot use this ability on the creature again until you finish a long rest.
- ❖ **Might - CD Benediction of Conflict:** Using your Channel Divinity, you may grant a creature within 6 m of you a +10 bonus to their attack roll as a reaction. You make this choice after you see the roll, but before the GM says whether the attack hits or misses.
- ❖ **Nature - Align to Element:** You can give resistance to yourself or a creature within 12 m of you against one instance of acid, cold, fire, lightning, or thunder damage you or the creature takes as a reaction.
- ❖ **Passion - Fiery Burst:** You can push a Large or smaller creature 2 m away from you when you deal lightning or fire damage to that creature.
- ❖ **Preservation - Reciprocated Gift:** When you cast a spell of 1st level or higher that restores health points to a creature other than you, you regain health points equal to 2 + the spell's level.
- ❖ **Radiance - Improved Flash:** When a creature other than you within 6 m of you is targeted with an attack, you may use your Distracting Flash ability to impose disadvantage on the attack.
- ❖ **Ruin - Ineludible Carnage:** You ignore resistance against necrotic with damage dealt by your spells and any Channel Divinity ability you possess.
- ❖ **Storm - Electric Burst:** You can push a Large or smaller creature 2 m away from you when you deal lightning damage to that creature.
- ❖ **Thaumaturgy - Restoring Dismissal:** You may end the effects of a spell on an ally of your choice by casting a spell of 1st level or higher that restores health points to that ally. The level of the spell you end must be equal to or lower than the level of the spell slot you use to cast the healing spell.

Level 7

General Upgrade [Devotion]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 8

Ability Score Improvement or Feat [Devotion]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 9

Divine Domain [Devotion]

- ❖ **Animation - Deistic Punishment:** Once on each of your turns when you hit a creature with a weapon attack, you may deal an extra 1d8 radiant damage to the target. After you have picked 14 levels of [Devotion], the extra radiant damage increases to 2d8.
- ❖ **Ardor - Willful Cantrips:** When you deal damage with any cantrip you deal extra damage equal to your Resolve modifier (minimum 1).
- ❖ **Athanasia- Vigorous Cantrips:** When you deal damage with any cantrip you deal extra damage equal to your Vitality modifier (minimum 1).
- ❖ **Battle - Deistic Punishment:** Once on each of your turns when you hit a creature with a weapon attack, you may deal an extra 1d8 of the same damage type of the weapon to the target. After you have picked 14 levels of [Devotion], the extra damage increases to 2d8.
- ❖ **Community - Deistic Punishment:** Once on each of your turns when you hit a creature with a weapon attack, you may deal an extra 1d8 psychic damage to the target. After you have picked 14 levels of [Devotion], the extra psychic damage increases to 2d8.
- ❖ **Craft - Deistic Punishment:** Once on each of your turns when you hit a creature with a weapon attack, you may deal an extra 1d8 fire damage to the target. After you have picked 14 levels of [Devotion], the extra fire damage increases to 2d8.
- ❖ **Deceit - Deistic Punishment:** Once on each of your turns when you hit a creature with a weapon attack, you may deal an extra 1d8 poison damage to the target. After you have picked 14 levels of [Devotion], the extra poison damage increases to 2d8.
- ❖ **Harmony - Deistic Punishment:** Once on each of your turns when you hit a creature with a weapon attack, you may deal an extra 1d8 of the same damage type of the weapon to the target. After you have picked 14 levels of [Devotion], the extra damage increases to 2d8.
- ❖ **Law - Deistic Punishment:** Once on each of your turns when you hit a creature with a weapon attack, you may deal an extra 1d8 psychic damage to the target. After you have picked 14 levels of [Devotion], the extra psychic damage increases to 2d8.
- ❖ **Lore - Acute Cantrips:** When you deal damage with any cantrip you deal extra damage equal to your Intelligence modifier (minimum 1).

- ❖ **Might - Deistic Punishment:** Once on each of your turns when you hit a creature with a weapon attack, you may deal an extra 1d8 bludgeoning damage to the target. After you have picked 14 levels of [Devotion], the extra bludgeoning damage increases to 2d8.
- ❖ **Nature - Deistic Punishment:** Once on each of your turns when you hit a creature with a weapon attack, you may deal an extra 1d8 cold, fire, or lightning damage to the target (your choice). After you have picked 14 levels of [Devotion], the extra damage you chose increases to 2d8.
- ❖ **Passion - Deistic Punishment:** Once on each of your turns when you hit a creature with a weapon attack, you may deal an extra 1d8 of the same damage type of the weapon to the target. After you have picked 14 levels of [Devotion], the extra damage increases to 2d8.
- ❖ **Preservation - Deistic Punishment:** Once on each of your turns when you hit a creature with a weapon attack, you may deal an extra 1d8 radiant damage to the target. After you have picked 14 levels of [Devotion], the extra radiant damage increases to 2d8.
- ❖ **Radiance - Confident Cantrips:** When you deal damage with any cantrip you deal extra damage equal to your Presence modifier (minimum 1).
- ❖ **Ruin - Deistic Punishment:** Once on each of your turns when you hit a creature with a weapon attack, you may deal an extra 1d8 necrotic damage to the target. After you have picked 14 levels of [Devotion], the extra necrotic damage increases to 2d8.
- ❖ **Storm - Deistic Punishment:** Once on each of your turns when you hit a creature with a weapon attack, you may deal an extra 1d8 thunder damage to the target. After you have picked 14 levels of [Devotion], the extra thunder damage increases to 2d8.
- ❖ **Thaumaturgy - Acute Cantrips:** When you deal damage with any cantrip you deal extra damage equal to your Intelligence modifier (minimum 1).

Level 10

Aid of the Gods [Devotion]

You can call out to your Enneade to ask for aid. Describe the assistance you seek, and roll percentile dice. If you roll a number equal to or lower than your level in [Devotion], your Enneade offers aid. The GM chooses the nature of the aid. If your deity offers aid, you can't use this ability again for 7 days. Otherwise, you can use it again after you finish a long rest.

Level 11

General Upgrade [Devotion]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential

Level 12

Ability Score Improvement or Feat [Devotion]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 13

General Upgrade [Devotion]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential

Level 14

General Upgrade [Devotion]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential

Level 15

Improved Magical Upgrade [Devotion]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 30 Potential
- ❖ Three skill points to assign in any skill or skills of your choice, or to store.
- ❖ +1 to an ability score of your choice
- ❖ Pick a feat from the feat list

Level 16

Ability Score Improvement or Feat [Devotion]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 17

Divine Domain [Devotion]

- ❖ **Animation - Supreme Healing:** When you restore health points with a spell, you heal the maximum value of the dice instead of rolling them.
- ❖ **Ardor - Improved Severance:** You can create up to four illusions of yourself, instead of one, when you use your Sever Shadow ability. On your turn, you may move any number of them up to 6 m as a bonus action, to a maximum range of 24 m.
- ❖ **Athanasia - Reap Rewards:** When an enemy you can see dies within 12 m of you, you or one creature of your choice that is within 12 m of you regains health points equal to the enemy's number of health dice. You can use this ability only if you aren't incapacitated. Once you use it, you can't do so again until the start of your next turn.
- ❖ **Battle - Avatar of Strife:** You gain resistance to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage from nonmagical attacks.

- ❖ **Community - Public Transport:** You can teleport from one specialized building, a tavern, marketplace, barracks, shop, bathhouse, etc., within a city, as if you had cast a Teleport spell whose destination is a permanent Teleportation Circle you know. Once you use this ability, you must finish a short or long rest before using it again.
- ❖ **Craft - Soul of the Forge:** You gain the following benefits:
 - You gain immunity to fire damage.
 - While you're wearing heavy armor, you have resistance to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage from nonmagical attacks.
- ❖ **Deceit - Improved Severance:** You can create up to four illusions of yourself, instead of one, when you use your Sever Shadow ability. On your turn, you may move any number of them up to 6 m as a bonus action, to a maximum range of 24 m.
- ❖ **Harmony - Supreme Healing:** When you restore health points with a spell, you heal the maximum value of the dice instead of rolling them.
- ❖ **Law - Judge, and Jury:** When you deal damage to a creature with your Deistic Punishment ability, you can additionally curse that creature until the start of your next turn. Whilst the creature is cursed, the next time one of your allies hits the creature with an attack, the ally deals an additional 2d8 psychic damage. The curse then ends. You can also curse a creature with this ability once per turn.
- ❖ **Lore - The Knowledge of Stars:** Once per short or long rest, if you spend 10 uninterrupted rounds in meditation, you receive visions of recent events. You can meditate in this way for a number of minutes equal to your Intelligence score (minimum 1) and must maintain concentration during that time as if you were casting a spell. Choose one option below when you use this ability:
 - **Object Reading:** Holding an object as you meditate, you can see visions of the object's previous owner. After meditating for 10 rounds, you learn how the owner acquired and lost the object, as well as the most recent significant event involving the object and the owner. If the object was owned by another creature in the recent past (within a number of days equal to your Intelligence score, minimum 1), you can spend 1 additional minute for each owner to learn the same information about that creature.
 - **Area Reading:** As you meditate, you see visions of recent events in your immediate vicinity (a room, street, tunnel, clearing, or the like, up to a 10 m cube), going back a number of days equal to your Intelligence score (minimum 1). For each minute you meditate, you learn about one significant event, beginning with the most recent. Significant events typically involve powerful emotions, such as battles and betrayals, marriages and murders, births, and funerals. However, they might also include more mundane events that are nevertheless important in your current situation.
- ❖ **Might - Avatar of Strife:** You gain resistance to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage from nonmagical attacks.
- ❖ **Nature - In Harmony with Nature:** You can verbally command what actions each creature charmed with your Invoke your Mother ability will do on their turns as a bonus action.
- ❖ **Passion - Blaze of Zeal:** Once per long rest, when you are reduced to 0 health points (even if you would die) ""by an attacker you can see, you can use your reaction to move up to your speed toward the attacker and make one melee weapon attack against it, as long as the movement brings it within your reach. You make this attack with advantage. If the attack hits, the creature takes an

extra 5d10 fire damage and an extra 5d10 damage of the weapon's type. Then you fall unconscious and begin making death saving throws as normal (or die if the damage was sufficient).

- ❖ **Preservation - Indomitable Defense:** You gain resistance to two damage types of your choice, choosing from bludgeoning, necrotic, piercing, radiant, and slashing. Whenever you finish a short or long rest, you can change the damage types you chose. Additionally, you can transfer one resistance to an ally you touch as an action. The creature keeps the resistance until the end of your next long rest or until you transfer it back to yourself as a bonus action.
- ❖ **Radiance - Aura of Resplendence:** As an action, you can shine like a small sun for 10 rounds or until you dismiss it as an action. Your aura emits bright light in a 12 m radius and dim light 6 m beyond that. Enemies inside of the bright light aura suffer disadvantage on saving throws against any spell that deals fire or radiant damage.
- ❖ **Ruin - Improved Bringer of Death:** Whenever you cast a spell of the vismancy school of at least 1st level but not higher than 5th level, the spell can instead target two creatures within range and within 1 m of each other. If the spell consumes Souls, you must provide them for each target.
- ❖ **Storm - Stormborn:** As long as you are not underground or indoors, you gain a flying speed equal to your walking speed.
- ❖ **Thaumaturgy - Arcane Mastery:** You choose four spells, one from each of the following levels: 6th, 7th, 8th, and 9th. You add them to your list of spells.

Level 18

General Upgrade [Devotion]

Gain one of your choices:

- Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- 20 Potential

Level 19

Ability Score Improvement or Feat [Devotion]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 20

Greater Aid of the Gods [Devotion]

Your Aid of the Gods ability succeeds automatically, no roll required.

[DISCIPLINE]

HD: 1d12

Bonus Skill Points: None

Spellcasting: Minor

Level 1

Level 1 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Martial Arts [Discipline]

You gain the following benefits while you are unarmed or wielding a quarterstaff, and you aren't wearing armor or wielding a shield:

- When you make a melee weapon attack or an unarmed attack, you may use your Dexterity modifier instead of your Brawn modifier to hit and deal damage.
- You may change the damage die of your unarmed strike or quarterstaff weapon to a 1d4. This die increases as you pick levels in [Discipline], to a 1d6 after 5 level picks, 1d8 after 11 level picks, and a 1d10 after 17 level picks.
- When you attack unarmed or with a quarterstaff, you can make one unarmed strike as a bonus action.

Secondary Selection

Unarmored Defense [Discipline]

While you are not wearing any armor or wielding a shield, your armor value equals 10 + your Dexterity modifier + your Composure modifier. The Dexterity and the Composure modifier cannot exceed your proficiency bonus individually.

Level 2

Level 2 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Mastery [Discipline]

You have gained a singularly pure connection to your Soul which allows you to draw upon Soul power within to strengthen and empower your body. You gain a number of Mastery points. Your [Discipline] level determines the number of points you have. When you pick this ability you gain 2 Mastery points and for every level pick of [Discipline] after this one, this increases by 1. Mastery points possess these features:

- ❖ **Abilities:** You can spend Mastery point to fuel certain abilities. When you take this ability you gain five such abilities. You can learn more Mastery abilities as you pick levels in [Discipline].
- ❖ **Recover:** You regain all expended Mastery points when you finish a short or long rest. During these rests, you must spend at least 30 minutes meditating to allow your Soul to recover, and in extension regenerate your Mastery points.

- ❖ **Saving Throws:** Some of your Mastery abilities requires your target to make a saving throw to resist the ability's effects. Your Mastery DV equals 8 + your proficiency modifier + your Composure modifier.

You gain these Mastery abilities:

- ❖ **Farseeing:** Until the end of your next turn, by spending 1 Mastery point you may ignore disadvantage imposed when attacking with a ranged weapon at long range.
- ❖ **Greater Aggression:** Immediately after you take the attack action on your turn, you can spend 1 Mastery point to make two unarmed strikes as a bonus action.
- ❖ **Greater Agility:** If you spend 1 Mastery point, your jump distance is doubled for the turn and as a bonus action you can take the disengage or dash action as a bonus action on your turn.
- ❖ **Greater Reflexes:** You can use the dodge action as a bonus action on your turn if you spend 1 Mastery point.
- ❖ **Self-Healing:** As a bonus action, you may spend 2 Mastery points to regain health points equal to 1d6 + your proficiency modifier.

Secondary Selection

Unburdened Celerity [Discipline]

Your walking speed increases by 2 m if you are not wearing armor or wielding a shield. This bonus increases after a certain amount of [Discipline] level picks, to 3 m after 6 level picks, 4 m after 10 level picks, 5 m after 14 level picks, and 6 m after 18 levels. After 9 level picks of [Discipline], you gain the ability to move along vertical surfaces and across liquids on your turn without falling during the move.

Level 3

Level 3 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Mold Soul [Discipline]

- ❖ **Embodiment of Enlightenment - Radiant Bolt:** As a ranged spell attack, you can hurl a ball of Soul energy at an enemy. The spell attack has a range of 6 m, you are proficient with it, and you add your Dexterity modifier to its attack and damage rolls. Radiant Bolt deals 1d4 radiant damage (plus your Dexterity modifier). The damage of Radiant Bolt increases as you pick levels in [Discipline] equal to how your unarmed strikes and quarterstaff gains damage from the Martial Arts ability.
In addition, when you take the attack action on your turn and use this ranged spell attack as part of it, you can spend 1 Mastery point to make the spell attack twice as a bonus action. If you pick the Extra Attack ability, this spell attack can be used for any of the attacks you make as part of the attack action.
- ❖ **Embodiment of Inevitability - Silver Lining:** When you reduce a creature within 1 m of you to 0 health points, you gain temporary health points equal to your Composure modifier + your [Discipline] level (minimum 1).
- ❖ **Embodiment of Serenity - Channel Soul:** Whenever you heal a creature with one of the attacks granted by your Greater Aggression, you can impose one of the following effects on that target:

- It must succeed on a Dexterity saving throw or be knocked prone.
- It must make a Brawn saving throw or be pushed 3 m away from you.
- It cannot take reactions until the end of your next turn.
- ❖ **Embodiment of Solemnity - Spell Mastery:** You can cast Minor Illusion as Soul Mastery. In addition, you can cast Darkness, Darkvision, Pass Without Trace, and Silence as Soul Mastery by spending 2 Mastery points.
- ❖ **Embodiment of Triumph - Extension of the Soul:** On the path of finding complete harmony with your Soul, you practice your discipline in the heat of battle. You gain the following benefits:
 - **Mastery Weapons:** Choose one ranged weapon and one melee weapon to be your Mastery Weapons. Your Mastery Weapons can be any weapon that lacks the heavy and special properties (the longbow is an exception to this rule). You gain proficiency with these weapons if you do not already possess them. Many abilities in the Embodiment of Triumph requires the use of your Mastery Weapons. After you have picked 6 levels, 11 levels, and 17 levels of [Discipline], you can choose another ranged or melee weapon to be counted as a Mastery Weapon for you, following the limitations above.
 - **Defensive Arms:** If you make an unarmed strike as part of the attack action on your turn and you are wielding a melee Mastery Weapon, you gain a +2 bonus to your AV until the start of your next turn. During this time the weapon must be in your hand and you cannot be incapacitated.
 - **Deadly Shot:** As a bonus action, you may increase the damage of your ranged weapon attacks with an extra 1d4 of the weapon's damage type. You keep this benefit until the end of your current turn.

Secondary Selection

Deflect Missiles [Discipline]

As a reaction, you can reduce the damage of a ranged weapon attack targeting you by $1d10 + \text{Dexterity modifier} + \text{your [Discipline] level}$. If you reduce the damage to 0, you can catch the missile if it is small enough for you to hold in one hand and you have at least one hand free.

If you reduce the damage to 0, you can catch the missile if it is small enough for you to hold in one hand and you have at least one hand free. If you catch a missile in this way, you can spend 1 Mastery point to make a ranged attack (4/6 m) with the weapon or piece of ammunition you just caught, as part of the same reaction. You make this attack with proficiency, and the missile counts as unarmed for the attack.

Level 4

Ability Score Improvement or Feat [Discipline]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 5

Extra Attack [Discipline]

As part of your attack action, you can make two attacks instead of one. You must possess at least 1 level of [Discipline] to be eligible for this ability (excluding this level).

Stunning Strike [Discipline]

When you hit another creature with a melee weapon attack, you can spend 1 Mastery point to attempt a Stunning Strike. The target must succeed on a Vitality saving throw or be stunned until the end of your next turn.

Level 6

Soul-Infused Strikes [Discipline]

Your unarmed strikes count as magical for the purpose of overcoming resistance and immunity to non-magical attacks and damage.

Mold Soul [Discipline]

- ❖ **Embodiment of Enlightenment - Fiery Outburst:** Immediately after you take the attack action on your turn, you can spend 2 Mastery points to cast the Burning Hands spell as a bonus action and Soul Mastery.
You can spend additional Mastery points to cast Burning Hands as a higher-level spell. Each additional Mastery point you spend increases the spell's level by 1. The maximum number of Mastery points (2 plus any additional points) that you can spend on the spell equals half your [Discipline] level.
- ❖ **Embodiment of Inevitability - Face Fate:** As an action, each creature within 6 m of you that can see you must succeed on a Resolve saving throw or be frightened of you until the end of your next turn.
- ❖ **Embodiment of Serenity - Wholeness of Body:** As an action, you can regain health points equal to three times your [Discipline] level. You must finish a long rest before you can use this ability again.
- ❖ **Embodiment of Solemnity - Shadow Step:** You gain the ability to step from one shadow into another. When you are in dim light or darkness, as a bonus action you can teleport up to 12 m to an unoccupied space you can see that is also in dim light or darkness. You then have advantage on the first melee attack you make before the end of the turn. You can use this ability a number of times equal to your Composure saving throw (minimum 1) per long rest.
- ❖ **Embodiment of Triumph - Master of Arms:** Your mastery of your Soul and arms deepens, granting you the following benefits.
 - **Magic Mastery Weapons:** Your attacks with your Mastery Weapons count as magical for the purpose of overcoming resistance and immunity to nonmagical attacks and damage.
 - **Soul Enchanted:** When you hit a target with a Mastery Weapon, you can spend 1 Mastery point to cause the weapon to deal extra damage to the target equal to the damage die of unarmed strikes and the quarterstaff of your Martial Arts ability. You can use this ability only once on each of your turns.

Level 7

Evasion [Discipline]

When you are subjected to an effect that allows you to make a Dexterity saving throw to take only half damage, you instead take no damage if you succeed on the saving throw, and only half damage if you fail.

Stillness of Mind [Discipline]

As an action, you can end one effect on yourself that causes you to be charmed or frightened.

Level 8

Ability Score Improvement or Feat [Discipline]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 9

Slow-Fall [Discipline]

As a reaction, you can reduce the damage you take from falling by an amount equal to five times your [Discipline] level.

Level 10

Purity of Body [Discipline]

You become immune to disease and poison.

Level 11

Tradition [Discipline]

- ❖ **Embodiment of Enlightenment - Soul Bomb:** As an action, you can create an orb and hurl it at a point you choose within 30 m, where it erupts into a sphere of radiant light. Each creature in a 4 m radius sphere must succeed on a Vitality saving throw or take 2d6 radiant damage. A creature doesn't need to make the save if the creature is behind total cover that is opaque.
You can increase the sphere's damage by spending Mastery points. Each point you spend, up to a maximum of 3, increases the damage by 2d6.
- ❖ **Embodiment of Inevitability - Vigor of the Soul:** When you are reduced to 0 health points, you can expend 1 Mastery point to have 1 health point instead. You can use this ability a number of times equal to your Resolve modifier (minimum 1) per long rest.
- ❖ **Embodiment of Serenity - Tranquility:** At the end of a long rest, you gain the effect of a Sanctuary spell that lasts until the start of your next Long Rest (the spell can end early as normal).
- ❖ **Embodiment of Solemnity - Soul Obscurity:** When you are in an area of dim light or darkness, you can use your action to become invisible. You remain invisible until you make an attack, cast a spell, or are in an area of bright light.
- ❖ **Embodiment of Triumph - Greater Mastery Weapon:** As a bonus action, you can expend up to 3 Mastery points to grant one Mastery Weapon you touch a bonus to attack and damage rolls equal to the number of Mastery points you spent. This bonus lasts for 10 rounds or until you use this ability again. This ability has no effect on a magic weapon that already has a bonus to attack and damage rolls.

Level 12

Ability Score Improvement or Feat [Discipline]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 13

True Understanding [Discipline]

You understand all spoken languages. Moreover, any creature that can understand a language can understand what you say.

Level 14

Incorruptible Purity [Discipline]

You are proficient in all saving throws. Additionally, whenever you make a saving throw and fail, you can spend 1 Mastery point to reroll it, but you must use the new result.

Level 15

Supreme Spirit [Discipline]

You suffer no penalties of old age and you cannot be aged magically, but you can still die of old age. In addition, you no longer need food or water.

Level 16

Ability Score Improvement or Feat [Discipline]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 17

Tradition [Discipline]

- ❖ **Embodiment of Enlightenment - Shield of Brilliance:** You shed bright light in a 6 m radius and dim light for an additional 6 m. You can extinguish or restore the light as a bonus action. If a creature hits you with a melee attack while this light shines, you can use your reaction to deal radiant damage to the creature. The radiant damage equals 5 + your Composure modifier.
- ❖ **Embodiment of Inevitability - Touch of Atrophy:** As an action, you can touch a creature within 1 m of you and attempt to wither their body and soul with necrotic damage by spending Mastery points. The creature must make a Vitality saving throw. On a failed save, it takes necrotic damage equal to 2d10 per Mastery point spent. You can spend 1 to 10 Mastery points. On a successful save, the creature suffers half of the damage.
- ❖ **Embodiment of Serenity - Soul Infection:** When you hit a creature with an unarmed strike, you can spend 3 Mastery points to leave this Soul power hidden in the creature's body. The Soul power persists in the creature for a number of days equal to your [Discipline] level. As an action, you may explode the Soul power within the creature's body. When you use this action, the creature must

make a Vitality saving throw. If it fails, it takes 10d10 necrotic damage. If it succeeds, it takes half damage.

You can have only one creature under the effect of this ability at a time. You can choose to release the Soul power harmlessly without using an action. To use this ability, you and the creature must be within the same Realm.

- ❖ **Embodiment of Solemnity - Patient Opportunist:** Whenever a creature within 1 m of you is hit by an attack made by a creature other than you, you can use your reaction to make a melee attack against that creature.
- ❖ **Embodiment of Triumph - Superb Accuracy:** Once per turn, you may reroll one missed attack made with a Mastery Weapon.

Level 18

Formless Spirit [Discipline]

You can use your action to spend 4 Mastery points to become invisible for 10 rounds. During that time, you also have resistance to all damage but force damage.

Level 19

Ability Score Improvement or Feat [Discipline]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 20

Nirvana [Discipline]

When you roll for initiative and have no Mastery points remaining, you regain 4 Mastery points.

[DIVINE OATH]

HD: 1d10

Bonus Skill Points: None

Spellcasting: Moderate

Level 1

Level 1 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Divine Sense [Divine Oath]

As an action, for 10 rounds, you know the location of three creature types of your choice within 12 m of you that is not behind total cover. You know the type of any being whose presence you sense, but not its identity. Within the same radius, you also detect the presence of any place or object that has been consecrated or desecrated (been sanctified by either celestial forces or fiendish forces). You can use this ability a number of times equal to 1 + your Resolve modifier (minimum 1). When you finish a long rest, you regain all expended uses.

Proclaim Judgement [Divine Oath]

Once per long rest, you may Proclaim Judgement as a bonus action. This ability is activated as long as you are in combat or until combat ends. You can only have one Judgement active at one time. When you Proclaim Judgement, choose one effect:

- ❖ **Ire:** You will not let this slight against your Enneade go unpunished. You gain a +1 bonus on all damage rolls you make. Once per combat, when you score a critical hit, you may choose to double your static damage bonuses as well as your damage dice.
- ❖ **Conviction:** Your divine conviction nourishes your Soul. You heal 2 points of damage at the start of your turn as long as you have not fallen unconscious.
- ❖ **Righteousness:** Your blade is as sharp as your righteousness. You gain a +1 bonus on all attack rolls you make. In addition, you gain a critical hit range increase of 19-20.
- ❖ **Serenity:** You remain serene and confident in your dedication. Your spell saves DV increases with +1.
- ❖ **Indignation:** You will suffer no indignation. Your AV gains a +1 bonus.
- ❖ **Contempt:** Heretics fill you with nothing but contempt. You gain a +1 bonus on all saving throws you make. This bonus is doubled for any vitality saving throws you make.
- ❖ **Defiance:** Losing is not an option. You gain resistance against one elemental damage type (acid, cold, fire, lightning, or thunder). When you Proclaim this Judgement, choose one. You must possess at least 10 level picks of [Divine Oath] to choose this judgment.

- ❖ At 4th level and every three level picks thereafter of [Divine Oath] you can use this ability one additional time per long rest.

Secondary Selection

Lay on Hands [Divine Oath]

You have a pool of healing power that replenishes when you take a long rest. With that pool, you can restore a total number of health points equal to your [Divine Oath] level x 5. As an action, you can touch a creature and draw power from the pool to restore a number of health points to that creature, up to the maximum amount remaining in your pool.

Alternatively, you can expend 5 health points from your pool of healing to cure the target of one disease or neutralize one poison affecting it. You can cure multiple diseases and neutralize multiple poisons with a single use of Lay on Hands, expending health points separately for each one. This ability does not affect constructs.

Level 2

Level 2 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Divine Smite [Divine Oath]

You gain the ability to purchase special spell slots with your Potential, Smite spell slots. You purchase them just like your normal spell slots with Potential, but you must use Potential you gain from Divine Oath to buy them. Smite spell slots must abide by the normal number of spell slot limitations but do so exclusively from normal spell slots. For example, you may have seven normal spell slots of level 1 and seven Smite spell slots of level 1 with Moderate Spellcasting at the same time. Smite spell slots do not require a Soul Mark, Soul Power nor a Soul Check when used. You regain all your spent Smite spell slots on a long rest. After you attack a creature with a melee weapon attack, you may expend a Smite spell slot to deal extra damage to that target, in addition to the weapon's damage. The type of the damage equals one of your Enneade's favorite damage types. When you gain this ability you choose which damage type your Smites will deal with for the rest of the game. The extra damage is 10 for a first level spell slot, plus 5 for each spell level higher than 1st, to a maximum of 25 extra damage. The damage increases by 5 if the target is a favored enemy of your Enneade, to a maximum of 30 damage. You cannot use Smite more than once per round.

Enneade	Favorite Damage Type (Choose one)	Favored Enemy
Riahn	Fire or radiant	Fiends and undead
Gera	Acid or poison	Constructs and undead
Teranis	Lightning or necrotic	Celestials and fiends
Lapuana	Force or thunder	One creature type of your choice
Borias	Bludgeoning or cold	Celestials and fey
Suhlmis	Fire or slashing	Monstrosities and oozes
Vegomo	Piercing or psychic	Animals and beasts

Fighting Style [Divine Oath]

- ❖ **Archery:** +2 attack rolls made with ranged weapons.
- ❖ **Defense:** While you're wearing armor, you gain a +1 bonus to AV.
- ❖ **Dueling:** When you're wielding a melee weapon in one hand and no other weapon, you gain a +2 bonus to damage rolls with that weapon.
- ❖ **Great Weapon Fighting:** When you roll a 1 or 2 on a damage die for an attack you make with a melee weapon that you're wielding with two hands, you can reroll the dice and must use the new results.
- ❖ **Protection:** When a creature you can see attacks a target other than you that is within 1 m of you, you can use your reaction to impose disadvantage on the attack roll. You must be wielding a shield.
- ❖ **Two-Weapon Fighting:** When you engage in two-weapon fighting, you can add your ability modifier to the damage of the second attack.

Secondary Selection

Fighting Style [Divine Oath]

- ❖ **Archery:** +2 attack rolls made with ranged weapons.
- ❖ **Defense:** While you're wearing armor, you gain a +1 bonus to AC.
- ❖ **Dueling:** When you're wielding a melee weapon in one hand and no other weapon, you gain a +2 bonus to damage rolls with that weapon.
- ❖ **Great Weapon Fighting:** When you roll a 1 or 2 on a damage die for an attack you make with a melee weapon that you're wielding with two hands, you can reroll the dice and must use the new results.
- ❖ **Protection:** When a creature you can see attacks a target other than you that is within 1 m of you, you can use your reaction to impose disadvantage on the attack roll. You must be wielding a shield.
- ❖ **Two-Weapon Fighting:** When you engage in two-weapon fighting, you can add your ability modifier to the damage of the second attack.

Level 3

Level 3 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Sacred Oath [Divine Oath]

Your oath allows you to channel divine energy to fuel magical effects. Each Channel Divinity option provided by your oath explains how to use it.

When you use your Channel Divinity, you choose which option to use. You must then finish a short or long rest to use your Channel Divinity again. After 6 level picks of [Divine Oath] you can use it twice per day, and after 18 level picks of [Divine Oath] thrice.

Some Channel Divinity effects require saving throws. When you use such an effect from this class, the DV equals your spell save DV.

In addition, you may expend a use of Channel Divinity as a bonus action to regain one expended spell slot of the first level.

❖ **Riahn:** You gain the following two Channel Divinity options.

- **Sacred Weapon:** As an action, for 10 rounds you add your Resolve modifier to attack rolls made with a weapon of your choice (with a minimum bonus of +1). The weapon also emits bright light in a 4 m radius and dim light 4 m beyond that. If the weapon is not already magical, it becomes magical for the duration. You can end this effect on your turn as a bonus action. If you are no longer holding or carrying this weapon, or if you fall unconscious, this effect ends.
- **Turn the Unholy:** You can force any undead or fiends within 6 m of you to make a Resolve saving throw or become turned as an action. On a failed save, the creature is turned for 10 rounds or until it takes damage. A turned creature suffer a number of penalties:
 - It cannot take reactions.
 - Every turn the creature is turned it must move as far as possible away from you.
 - It cannot willingly move within 6 m of you.
 - Any actions it takes must be dash actions to try and escape from you and the effect
 - If it cannot move further away from you, it can only use the dodge action.
 - If the creature is using an illusion or a shapeshifting effect to conceal its true form, its true form is revealed as long as it is turned.

❖ **Gera:** You gain the following two Channel Divinity options.

- **Burgeoning Tangle:** You can attempt to restrain a creature within 2 m of you by causing magical vines to spring forth as an action. The target breaks free from the vines, which vanishes) if it succeeds on a Brawn or Dexterity saving throw (it's choice). While restrained by the vines, the creature repeats the saving throw at the end of each of its turns.

- **Alpha's Dominance:** You can force any undead or constructs within 6 m of you to make a Resolve saving throw or become turned as an action. On a failed save, the creature is turned for 10 rounds or until it takes damage. A turned creature suffer a number of penalties:
 - It cannot take reactions.
 - Every turn the creature is turned it must move as far as possible away from you.
 - It cannot willingly move within 6 m of you.
 - Any actions it takes must be dash actions to try and escape from you and the effect.
 - If it cannot move further away from you, it can only use the dodge action.
 - If the creature is using an illusion or a shapeshifting effect to conceal its true form, its true form is revealed as long as it is turned.
- ❖ **Teranis:** You gain the following two Channel Divinity options.
 - **Calculated Strike:** After you make an attack roll, but before the GM declares it to be a hit or a miss, you may add +10 to the result of your roll.
 - **Mantle of Anguish:** As an action, you can force one creature of your choice within 6 m of you to make a Resolve saving throw or become frightened of you. This condition lasts for 10 rounds or until the creature succeeds on another Resolve saving throw they can make if they are more than 6 m away from you at the end of their turn. If the creature cannot move more than 6 m away from you, it can still roll the saving throw if it has moved as far away as possible away from you.
- ❖ **Lapuana:** You gain the following two Channel Divinity options.
 - **Test their Mettle:** As an action, you can taunt an enemy. A creature of your choice within 6 m of you must make a Composure saving throw. On a failed save, it can't willingly move more than 6 m away from you. This effect ends if you are incapacitated, dead or if the creature was unwillingly moved more than 6 m away from you.
 - **A New Beginning:** You can restore a number of health points equal to 1d6 + your Presence modifier to each creature of your choice within 6 m of you as a bonus action. You can only restore health points of creatures who currently have no more than half of its health points this way.
- ❖ **Borias:** You gain the following two Channel Divinity options.
 - **Subdue the Unliving:** As an action, you can force one undead creature of your choice within 6 m of you to make a Resolve saving throw or be forced to follow your commands. This effect lasts for 24 hours or until you use this Channel Divinity option again. You cannot target an undead creature with a challenge rating that is equal to, or greater than your [Divine Oath] level with this ability.
 - **Mantle of Power:** As an action, you can force one creature of your choice within 6 m of you to make a Resolve saving throw or become

frightened of you. This condition lasts for 10 rounds or until the creature succeeds on another Resolve saving throw they can make if they are more than 6 m away from you at the end of their turn. If the creature cannot move more than 6 m away from you, it can still roll the saving throw if it has moved as far away as possible away from you.

- ❖ **Suhlmis:** You gain the following two Channel Divinity options.
 - **Disarming Smile:** As an action, you can force one creature of your choice within 12 m of you to make a Composure saving throw or become charmed by you for 10 rounds. Humans worshipping Teranis and Enna of Teranis suffer disadvantage on this saving throw. While charmed, the creature's speed is 0, and It can't benefit from any bonus to its speed. At the end of each of the creature's turns, it can repeat the saving throw to end this effect on itself.
 - **Act of Aggression:** You can target one creature of your choice within 2 m of you with your Aggression as a bonus action. You gain advantage on attack rolls for 10 rounds against a creature targeted this way, or until the creature is defeated.
- ❖ **Vegomo:** You gain the following two Channel Divinity options.
 - **Peaceful Solution:** You can grant yourself a +5 bonus to Persuasion (Pre) checks for 10 minutes as a bonus action.
 - **Pacify:** Immediately after another creature within 6 m of you is dealt damage from an attack that did not originate from you, you can spend your reaction to force the attacker to make a Resolve saving throw. On a failed save, the attacker takes psychic damage equal to the damage it just dealt. On a successful save, it takes half as much damage.

Secondary Selection

General Upgrade [Divine Oath]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 4

ASI or Feat [Divine Oath]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 5

Extra Attack [Divine Oath]

As part of your attack action, you can make two attacks instead of one. You must possess at least 1 level of [Divine Oath] to be eligible for this ability (excluding this level).

Level 6

Aura of Protection [Divine Oath]

Whenever you or a friendly creature within 2 m of you must make a saving throw, the creature gains a bonus to the saving throw equal to your Presence modifier (minimum 1 but maximum +3). You must be conscious to grant this bonus. At 18th total level, the range of this aura increases to 6 m.

Level 7

Sacred Oath [Divine Oath]

- ❖ **Riahn - Aura of Radiant Awe:** You and friendly creatures within 2 m of you have advantage on mental and social saving throws while you are conscious. At 18th total level, the range of this aura increases to 6 m.
- ❖ **Gera - Defender of the Pack:** When a creature within 2 m of you takes damage, you can use your Reaction to magically take that damage, instead of that creature taking it. This ability doesn't transfer any other effects that might accompany the damage, and this damage can't be reduced in any way. At 18th total level, the range of this aura increases to 6 m.
- ❖ **Teranis - Scheming Generosity:** You, your allies, any celestial and fiends within 2 m of you, gain a bonus to their weapon damage rolls equal to your Cunning modifier (minimum 1). A creature can benefit from this ability from only one source at a time. At 18th total level, the range of this aura increases to 6 m.
- ❖ **Lapuana - Harmony:** When a creature within 2 m of you takes damage, you can use your Reaction to magically take that damage, instead of that creature taking it. This ability doesn't transfer any other effects that might accompany the damage, and this damage can't be reduced in any way. At 18th total level, the range of this aura increases to 6 m.
- ❖ **Borias - Harbinger of Ruin:** As long as you are not incapacitated, creatures who are frightened and are within 2 m of you that you can see and hear, suffer a number of penalties:
 - Their speed becomes 0.
 - If the creature starts its turn within your range, it takes cold damage equal to half your [Divine Oath].At 18th total level, the range of this ability increases to 6 m.
- ❖ **Suhlmis - Fervent Persecution:** Whenever you successfully hit an opportunity attack, you can immediately move up to half your speed as part of the same reaction. This movement doesn't provoke opportunity attacks.

- ❖ **Vegomo - Queller of Violence:** You and friendly creatures within 2 m of you have resistance to damage from spells. At 18th total level, the range of this aura increases to 6 m.

Level 8

ASI or Feat [Divine Oath]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 9

Divine Health [Divine Oath]

You become immune to disease and gain resistance against poison damage.

Level 10

Aura of Courage [Divine Oath]

You and friendly creatures within 2 m of you can't be frightened or charmed while you are conscious. At 18th total level, the range of this aura increases to 6 m.

Level 11

Improved Divine Smite [Divine Oath]

Whenever you hit a creature with a melee weapon, the creature takes an extra 5 damage of one of your Enneade's favorite damage types (choose once). If you also use your Divine Smite with an attack, you add this damage to the extra damage of your Divine Smite. If you've not already taken Divine Smite, you gain Divine Smite instead.

Level 12

ASI or Feat [Divine Oath]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 13

General Upgrade [Divine Oath]

Gain one of your choice:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential

Level 14

Cleansing Touch [Divine Oath]

You can use your action to end one spell on yourself or on one willing creature that you touch. You can use this ability a number of times equal to your Cunning modifier (a minimum of once). You regain expended uses when you finish a long rest.

Level 15

Sacred Oath [Divine Oath]

- ❖ **Riahn - Purity of Spirit:** You gain resistance against necrotic and radiant damage.
- ❖ **Gera - Survival of the Fittest:** If you end your turn in combat with fewer than half of your health points and you are not incapacitated, you regain a number of health points equal to 1d6 + half your [Divine Oath].
- ❖ **Teranis - Resilient Duality:** You gain resistance to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage from nonmagical weapons.
- ❖ **Lapuana - Unperturbed Wanderer:** You have advantage on saving throws to avoid becoming paralyzed or stunned.
- ❖ **Borias - Immortal Will:** Once per long rest, when you drop to 0 health points but not killed outright you can choose to drop to 1 health point instead. Additionally, you suffer none of the drawbacks of old age, and you can't be aged magically.
- ❖ **Suhlmis - Nemesis:** When a creature under the effect of your Act of Aggression makes an attack, you can use your reaction to make a melee weapon attack against that creature if it is within range.
- ❖ **Vegomo - Guilty Conscience:** As long as you are not incapacitated, whenever a creature hits you with an attack, that creature takes psychic damage equal to your Presence modifier (minimum of 1).

Level 16

ASI or Feat [Divine Oath]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 17

General Upgrade [Divine Oath]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential

Level 18

General Upgrade [Divine Oath]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential

Level 19

ASI or Feat [Divine Oath]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 20

Sacred Oath [Divine Oath]

- ❖ **Riahn - Holy Nimbus:** As an action, you can emanate light. For 10 rounds, a bright light shines from you in a 6 m aura radius, and dim light shines 6 m beyond that. Whenever an enemy creature starts its turn in your 6 m bright light aura, the creature takes 10 radiant damage. In addition, for the duration, you have advantage on saving throws against spells with cold damage. Once you use this ability, you can't use it again until you finish a long rest.
- ❖ **Gera - Verdant Warden:** Once per long rest, as an action, you can transform into a powerful champion of the wilds. For 10 rounds you gain the following benefits:
 - At the start of each of your turns, you regain 10 health points.
 - Whenever you cast a spell that has a casting time of 1 action, you can cast it using a bonus action instead.
 - Enemy creatures within 2 m of you have disadvantage on saving throws against your spells and Channel Divinity options.
- ❖ **Teranis - Beacon of Death:** Once per long rest, you can cloak yourself in mighty shadows as an action. For 10 rounds you gain a number of benefits:
 - You reduce bright light in a 6 m radius around you to dim light.
 - Whenever an enemy that is frightened by you starts its turn within 6 m of you, it takes 4d10 necrotic damage.
 - Creatures other than you, that rely on sight have disadvantage on attack rolls against creatures within 6 m of you.
 - You can use a bonus action on your turn to cause your shadows to attack one creature within 6 m of you. Make a melee spell attack against the target. If the attack hits, the target takes necrotic damage equal to 3d10 + your Cunning modifier (minimum 1).
- ❖ **Lapuna - Lunar Paragon:** Once per long rest, you can give yourself a number of benefits that last for an hour by spending an action.
 - You have Resistance to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage from nonmagical weapons.

- Your allies have advantage on death saving throws while within 6 m of you.
- You have advantage on Resolve saving throws, as do your allies within 6 m of you. This effect ends early if you are incapacitated or die.
- ❖ **Borias - Embodiment of Winter's Cruelty:** Once per long rest, you become the embodiment of winter as an action. For 10 rounds you gain a number of benefits:
 - You have resistance to all damage.
 - When you take the attack action on your turn, you can make one additional attack as part of that action.
 - Your melee weapon attacks gain an increased critical hit range of 19 to 20.
- ❖ **Suhlmis - Merciless Avenger:** Once per long rest, as an action, you can transform into an avatar of vengeance. For 10 rounds you gain the following benefits:
 - You gain a flying speed of 12 m as wings of fire appears on your back.
 - The first time any enemy creature moves within 6 m of you or starts its turn within 6 m, the creature must succeed on a Resolve saving throw or become frightened of you for 10 rounds or until it takes any damage. Attack rolls against the frightened creature have advantage.
- ❖ **Vegomo - Arbiter of Peace:** As an action, you can awaken your mind's eye. For 10 rounds you gain a number of benefits:
 - You have resistance to all damage dealt by other creatures (their attacks, spells, and other effects).
 - Whenever a creature hits you with an attack, it takes psychic damage equal to half the damage you take from the attack.
 - If you attack a creature, cast a spell on it, or deal damage to it by any means but this ability or Guilty Conscience ability, neither benefit works against that creature until you finish a long rest.

[FINESSE]

HD: 1d10

Bonus Skill Points: None

Spellcasting: Moderate

Level 1

Level 1 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Sneak Attack [Finesse]

When you attack a creature with a weapon attack you can deal an extra 1d6 damage to it if you attack with a finesse or ranged weapon and if you had advantage on the attack. You don't need advantage on the attack roll if another enemy of the target is within 1 m of it, that enemy isn't incapacitated, and you don't have disadvantage on the attack roll. The amount of the extra damage increases with 1d6 as you pick levels in [Finesse], at every uneven level pick of [Finesse] (counting only [Finesse] levels). You can only Sneak Attack once per turn.

Secondary Selection

Unarmored Defense [Finesse]

While you are not wearing any armor or wielding a shield, your armor class equals 10 + your Dexterity modifier + your Cunning modifier. The Dexterity and the Cunning modifier cannot exceed your proficiency bonus individually.

Expertise [Finesse]

You gain two skill points in two skills of your choice, and you may gain rank 5 for both of the chosen skills.

Level 2

Level 2 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Cunning Action [Finesse]

You can use your bonus action to take the dash, disengage, or hide action.

Secondary Selection

General Upgrade [Finesse]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 3

Level 3 offers two Selections

Primary Selection

Roguish Archetype [Finesse]

- ❖ **Cutthroat - Slay:** You gain two skill points with Academics: Poison and two skill points with Subterfuge. Any successful attack you make against a surprised creature is an automatic critical hit. In addition, you have advantage on attack rolls against creatures who have not taken a turn in combat yet.
- ❖ **Divining Rogue - Wise Engagement:** You may gain Sneak Attack against a target even if you don't have advantage on the attack roll, as long as you do not have disadvantage. Spend a bonus action and target a creature that is not incapacitated. You gain this benefit for 10 rounds if the target fails a Persuasion (Man) versus your Empathy (Int) check. You can only target one creature with this ability at the same time. If a creature succeeds on the check they are immune until you finish a long rest.
- ❖ **Fencer - Slippery Maneuvers:** An opponent cannot make opportunity attacks against you for the rest of your turn if you make a successful attack against that opponent during your turn.
- ❖ **Occult Prowler - Spectral Sleight of Hand:** You learn to cast Mage Hand as Soul Mastery. When you cast Mage Hand this way it earns a number of additional benefits. Your Mage Hand is invisible and it can perform tasks unnoticed if you succeed on a Subterfuge (Dex/Cun) versus your target's Perception (Com). In addition, you can use the bonus action granted by Cunning Action to control the hand.
You can perform the following additional tasks with it:
 - You can stow one object the hand is holding in a container worn or carried by another creature.
 - You can retrieve an object in a container worn or carried by another creature.
 - You can use Thieves' Tools to pick locks and disarm traps at range.
- ❖ **Operator - Master of Strategy:** You can use the help action as a bonus action and with a 6 m range as long as your target can see or hear you.
- ❖ **Spy - Agile Mobility:** As a reaction, you can move up to half your speed whenever an enemy ends their turn within 1 m of you. This movement doesn't provoke opportunity attacks.
- ❖ **Thief - Fast Hands:** You can use the bonus action given by your Cunning Action ability to make a Subterfuge (Dex/Cun) check, use your Thieves' Tools, or take the use an object action.

Secondary Selection

Roguish Archetype [Finesse]

- ❖ **Divining Rogue - Discerning Eye:** You can use a bonus action to make a Perception (Int) check to spot a hidden creature or object or to make an Investigation (Cun) check to uncover or decipher clues. In addition, whenever you make an Empathy (Com) check to determine whether a creature is lying, treat a roll of 7 or lower on the d20 as an 8.

- ❖ **Fencer - Dashing Courage:** You learn another way to perform sneak attack. As long as you do not have disadvantage on the attack, you are within 1 m of the opponent and no other creature is within 1 m of you. All the other rules for Sneak Attack still apply to you. In addition, you gain a bonus to your initiative rolls equal to your Manipulation modifier.
- ❖ **Occult Prowler - Cantrips:** You learn two cantrips of your choice as Soul Mastery. After ten level picks of [Finesse] you learn a level 1 spell of your choice as Soul Mastery.
- ❖ **Operator - Web Spinner:** As long as you know the language, you can pass yourself off as a native speaker of a culture if you hear it spoken for at least 10 rounds. In addition, you gain two skill points in Subterfuge and one skill point in Academics (strategy).
- ❖ **Spy - Crafty:** You gain two skill points in the Academics (nature) and Survival skills. You may reach rank 5 in these skills.
- ❖ **Thief - Second-Story Work:** You are immune to the first 2d6 damage you take by falling. Climbing no longer costs you extra movement. In addition, when you make a running jump, the distance you cover increases by a number of meters equal to half your Dexterity modifier (rounded up and minimum 1 m).

Level 4

ASI or Feat [Finesse]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 5

Expertise [Finesse]

You gain two skill points in two skills of your choice, and you may gain rank 5 for both of the chosen skills.

Level 6

Uncanny Dodge [Finesse]

When an attacker that you can see hits you with an attack, you can use your reaction to halve the attack's damage against you.

Level 7

Evasion [Finesse]

When you are subjected to an effect that allows you to make a Dexterity saving throw to take only half damage, you instead take no damage if you succeed on the saving throw, and only half damage if you fail.

Level 8

ASI or Feat [Finesse]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 9

Archetype [Finesse]

- ❖ **Cutthroat - Blend In:** By spending seven days and 25 gp you can give yourself a new identity by establishing history, profession, and affiliations. You can't establish an identity that belongs to someone else. Other creatures believe you to be this identity until they are given an obvious reason not to.
- ❖ **Divining Rogue - Accurate Perception:** As long as you do not move no more than half your speed on your turn, you gain advantage on any perception or investigation check you make.
- ❖ **Fencer - Swagger:** Against a creature that can hear you and shares a language with you, you can spend an action to make a Persuasion (Man) contested by your target's Empathy (Com). The effect of this ability lasts for 10 rounds if your check is successful and depends upon if the creature you targeted is hostile or not. s
Against a hostile target, this ability causes that creature to have disadvantage on attack rolls against targets other than you and can't make opportunity attacks against targets other than you. This effect ends immediately if you or your companions attack the target or affects it with a spell, or until you and the target are more than 12 m apart.
Against a target that is not hostile to you, the creature becomes charmed by you. While charmed, it regards you as a friendly acquaintance. This effect ends immediately if you or your companions do anything harmful to it.
- ❖ **Occult Prowler - Arcane Conniving:** Until the end of your turn, creatures gain disadvantage against any saving throws from spells you cast if you are hidden from the creature.
- ❖ **Operator - Informed Schemer:** If you interact or observe another creature outside of combat for at least a minute, you learn some of their capabilities. Choose two characteristics from below, your GM tells you if they are superior, inferior, or equal compared to you:
 - Intelligence score
 - Composure score
 - Presence score
 - AO levels (if any)
 - At the GM's option, you might also realize you know a piece of the creature's history or one of its personality traits, if it has any.
- ❖ **Spy - Greater Maneuverability:** Your walking speed increases by 2 m. If you have a climbing or swimming speed, this increase applies to those speeds as well.
- ❖ **Thief - Supreme Sneak:** You gain advantage on Stealth (Dex/Cun) checks if you move no more than half your speed on the same turn.

Level 10

ASI or Feat [Finesse]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 11

Reliable Talent [Finesse]

Whenever you make an ability check that lets you add your proficiency bonus, you can treat a d20 roll of 9 or lower as a 10.

Level 12

ASI or Feat [Finesse]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 13

Roguish Archetype [Finesse]

- ❖ **Cutthroat - Changeling:** If you spend three hours studying another creature's speech, writing, and behavior you can mimic these traits with impeccable accuracy. If a creature would become suspicious of you, you gain advantage on Deception (Man) checks you roll to avoid detection.
- ❖ **Divining Rogue - Faultless Attention:** As long as you are not deafened or blinded, you know when an illusion effect is trying to deceive you. Within 6 m of you, spend an action and you can sense the presence of illusions, shapechangers not in their original form, or magical effects designed to fool the senses. You do not learn who, where or what is the cause of the effect, but you learn that something is amiss in your radius of awareness. You can use this ability a number of times equal to your Cunning modifier (minimum of 1), and you regain all expended uses of it when you finish a long rest.
- ❖ **Fencer - Fancy Stunt:** As a bonus action, you grant yourself advantage on the next Athletics check you make this turn. Alternatively, you can grant yourself advantage on the first dexterity saving throw you make until the start of your next turn.
- ❖ **Occult Prowler - Gifted Prowler:** You can choose one creature within 1 m of your Mage Hand cantrip as a bonus action. Against the chosen creature you gain advantage on attack rolls until the end of your turn.
- ❖ **Operator - Feint:** If another creature is within 1 m of you and provides cover for you against an attack targeting you, you can use your reaction to have that attack target the creature covering you instead of hitting you.
- ❖ **Spy - Waylay Virtuoso:** You gain advantage on initiative rolls. Until the end of your next turn, your allies receive advantage on their attack rolls against the first creature you hit on the first round of combat.
- ❖ **Thief - Use Magic Device:** You ignore all ability origin, race, and level requirements on the use of magic items. In addition, you can cast Identify as Soul Mastery.

Level 14

Blindsense [Finesse]

If you can hear, you are aware of the location of any hidden or invisible creatures within 2 m of you.

Level 15

Slippery Mind [Finesse]

You gain proficiency in one mental or social saving throw of your choice.

Level 16

ASI or Feat [Finesse]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 17

Roguish Archetype [Finesse]

- ❖ **Cutthroat - Murderous Intent:** Whenever you deal damage against a creature that is surprised, that creature must make a Vitality saving throw against 8+ your dexterity modifier + your proficiency bonus, or take double the damage from your attack.
- ❖ **Divining Rogue - Discover Flaw:** Your Sneak Attack damage increases by 3d6 against a creature you have targeted with your Wise Engagement ability.
- ❖ **Fencer - Charming Mercenary:** Once per short or long rest, you can reroll a missed attack with advantage.
- ❖ **Operator - Spirit of Manipulation:** Your mind becomes as slippery as your soul. You gain a number of benefits:
 - Whenever your mind is being read, you can present false thoughts if you succeed on a Deception (Man) contested by the mind readers Empathy (Com).
 - You can not be compelled to tell the truth by magic.
 - You become immune to charm effects.
- ❖ **Occult Prowler - Spell Thief:** Once per long rest, you attempt to steal a spell. When a creature casts a spell that targets you or includes you in its area of effect you can spend your reaction and force that creature to make a saving throw using its spellcasting ability modifier against your spell save DV. On a failed save, you negate the spell's effect against you. In addition, if the spell is of a level you can cast and is at least 1st level, you can cast that spell using your spell slots for the next 8 hours. During this duration, the creature you stole the spell from cannot cast it. You can use this ability once per long rest.
- ❖ **Spy - Out of Nowhere:** If you take the attack action on your turn, you can make one additional attack as a bonus action. This attack can benefit from your Sneak Attack even if you have already used it this turn, but you can't use Sneak Attack against the same target more than once in a turn.
- ❖ **Thief - Thief's Reflexes:** You can take two turns during the first round of any combat. You take your first turn at your normal initiative and your second turn at your initiative minus 10. You can't use this ability when you are surprised.

Level 18

Elusive [Finesse]

No attack roll has advantage against you while you aren't incapacitated.

Level 19

ASI or Feat [Finesse]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 20

Stroke of Luck [Finesse]

If your attack misses a target within range, you can turn the miss into a hit.

Alternatively, if you fail an ability check, you can treat the d20 roll as a 20. Once you use this ability, you can't use it again until you finish a short or long rest.

[OCCULT STUDENT]

HD: 1d6

Bonus Skill Points: Extra

Spellcasting: Major

Level 1

Level 1 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Arcane Tradition [Occult Student]

- ❖ **Abjuration - Protective Ward:** Once per long rest, you can tease out more power from the Souls you use when you cast abjuration spells. Whenever you cast an abjuration spell of 1st or higher you also create a protective Ward that soaks up damage for you. The Ward functions like this:
 - It has health points equal to twice your Intelligence modifier plus the number of level picks you to possess in [Occult Student].
 - Whenever you take damage, your Ward takes the damage instead.
 - If the damage you take succeeds the health points your Ward possesses, you take the remaining damage.
 - When your Ward is reduced to 0 health points it persists until you finish a long rest.
 - The ward regains health points whenever you cast an abjuration spell of 1st level or higher equal to twice the level of the spell.
- ❖ **Conjuration - Conjure Minor Item:** As an action, you can conjure an inanimate object into your hand or unto the ground in an unoccupied space that you can see within 2 m of you. The object cannot be larger than 0.5 m or weigh more than 5 kg. You must have seen the object before to be able to conjure a copy. It is visibly magical and sheds dim light in a 1 m radius. The object immediately disappears if you attempt to deal damage with it, or it takes damage. The object persists for an hour or until you use this ability again.
- ❖ **Divination - Premonition:** Whenever you finish a long rest, you roll two d20 and save the numbers you rolled. At any point, until you finish a long rest, you can swap one of the numbers you rolled with any attack roll, saving throw, or ability check you make. You must swap out a number this way before the GM declares the check to be a success or a fail. You can only swap out a result this way once per turn and a saved number can only be used once.
- ❖ **Enchantment - Mesmerize:** You can hypnotize a creature within 1 m of you that you can see by spending an action. If the target can see you too, they must succeed on a Composure saving throw against your spell save DV or becomes incapacitated and have their speed be reduced to 0 until the end of your next turn. You can choose to maintain this effect by spending another action on your subsequent turn and continue hypnotizing your target until the end of your next turn. The target can make another saving throw every time you choose to maintain this effect. The hypnotized condition ends if you move more than 1 m away from the target, the target is forced to make another saving throw or it is dealt damage. The target becomes immune to this ability until you finish a long rest if they succeed on their saving throw against this effect.

- ❖ **Evocation - Sculpt Spells:** When you cast an evocation spell that affects other creatures that you can see, you can choose a number of them equal to 1 + the spell's level. The chosen creatures automatically succeed on their saving throws against the spell, and they take no damage if they would normally take half damage on a successful save.
- ❖ **Illusion - Illusionist's Stratagem:** You learn the Minor Illusion cantrip as Soul Mastery. In addition, whenever you cast Minor Illusion you can both create a sound and an image with a single cast of the cantrip.
- ❖ **Necromancy - Siphon Vitality:** Once per turn, when you kill one or more creatures with a spell of 1st level or higher, you regain health points equal to twice the spell's level, or three times its level if the spell belongs to the school of necromancy. You don't gain this benefit when killing constructs or undead.
- ❖ **Transmutation - Alchemical Secrets:** You can cast a version of Fabricate once per short rest as Soul Mastery. This version of Fabricate can only create an object that is no larger than 0.5 m or weigh more than 5 kg. This use of Fabricate only lasts for 1 hour before it reverts to its original form.
- ❖ **War Magic - Minor Shield:** You can use your reaction to gain a +2 bonus to your AC against an attack that hits you, or alternatively gain a +4 bonus to a failed saving throw. If you decide to use either benefit from this ability, you cannot cast any spells other than cantrips until the end of your next turn.

Secondary Selection

Arcane Tradition [Occult Student]

- ❖ **War Magic - Quick Mind:** You can give yourself a bonus to your initiative rolls equal to your Intelligence modifier.

Spellbook [Occult Student]

You gain a Spellbook where you can copy down spells into and gain them as spells known. When you find a spell of first level or higher in a Spellbook or any other source you can copy from, you can add it to your Spellbook, and your spells known if the spell's level is lower than your current level.

The process takes 2 hours per level of the spell and consumes Soul points equal to the level of the spell to copy it down.

Level 2

Level 2 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Arcane Recovery [Occult Student]

Once per long rest, as an action, you can recover one spell slot. The spell must have a level that is equal to or less than half your [Occult Student] level (rounded up), the slot can't be 8th level or higher.

Secondary Selection

General Upgrade [Occult Student]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 3

Level 3 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

General Upgrades [Occult Student]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Secondary Selection

General Upgrade [Occult Student]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 4

ASI or Feat [Occult Student]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 5

Improved Magical Upgrade [Occult Student]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential
- ❖ +1 to an ability score of your choice
- ❖ Pick an additional feat from the feat list

Level 6

Arcane Tradition [Occult Student]

- ❖ **Abjuration - Generous Ward:** Whenever a creature within 6 m of you that you can see takes damage, you can use your reaction to cause your Protective Ward to absorb the damage dealt with that creature. If your Ward would be reduced to 0 health point this way, the creature you warded takes any remaining damage.

- ❖ **Conjuration - Juxtapose:** As an action, you can teleport up to 6 m to an unoccupied space that you can see. Alternatively, you can choose a space within range that is occupied by a Small or Medium creature that is willing. You both teleport by swapping places with each other. You can use this ability once per long rest, but if you cast a conjuration spell of 1st level or higher you regain one usage of it.
- ❖ **Divination - Effortless Visions:** When you cast a divination spell of 2nd level or higher using a spell slot, you regain one expended spell slot. The slot you regain must be of a level lower than the spell you cast and can't be higher than 5th level.
- ❖ **Enchantment - Reverence:** If you spend a reaction you can cause an attack that was targeting you to target another creature instead. The attacker must succeed on a Composure saving throw against your spell save DV, or it must attack another viable target. The attacker targets a creature that is closest to it but cannot attack itself or you. If several creatures are closest to the attacker, the attacker chooses which one to target. If there are no viable targets for the attack, the attack is wasted. You must choose to use this ability before knowing whether the attack hits or misses. On a successful save, the attacker becomes immune against this ability until you finish a long rest. Creatures that are immune to the charmed condition can not be affected but this ability.
- ❖ **Evocation - Potent Cantrips:** When a creature succeeds on saving throws against a cantrip you cast, the creature takes half the cantrip's damage (if any) but suffers no additional effect from the cantrip. In addition, damage you deal with cantrips with a spell attack gains a bonus equal to your proficiency bonus.
- ❖ **Illusion - Dreamscape:** When you cast an illusion spell that has a duration of 10 rounds or longer, you can use your action to change the nature of the form of that illusion (using the spell's normal parameters for the illusion), provided that you can see the illusion.
- ❖ **Necromancy - Infuse Vessel:** You learn to cast Animate Dead. In addition, you can cast Animate Dead once per short rest as Soul Mastery but you must still pay the Soul consumption. When you cast Animate Dead, you can target one additional corpse or a pile of bones, creating another zombie or skeleton, as appropriate. Whenever you create an undead using a necromancy spell, it has additional benefits:
 - The undead's health point maximum is increased by an amount equal to your total level.
 - The undead adds your proficiency bonus to its weapon damage rolls.
- ❖ **Transmutation - Alchemist's Stone:** You gain two skill points in Academics (alchemy). If you spend 8 hours practicing alchemy you can create an Alchemist's Stone. When you create the Stone, choose the benefit from the following options:
 - Darkvision out to a range of 12 m.
 - As long as the creature is not over-encumbered, their speed increases by 2 m.
 - Advantage with Vitality saving throws.
 - Resistance to acid, cold, fire, lightning, or thunder damage (your choice whenever you choose this benefit).

You can benefit from the Stone yourself or give it to another creature. Each time you cast a transmutation spell of 1st level or higher, you can change the effect of your Stone if the Stone is on your person. If you create a new Alchemist's Stone, the previous one ceases to function.
- ❖ **War Magic - Overcharge:** Whenever you successfully end a magical effect by casting Dispel Magic or prevent a spell from being cast with Counterspell, you absorb some fleeting Soul energy from the magical effects you terminate by

gaining one use of Overcharge. In addition, whenever you complete a short rest, you gain one use of Overcharge. Once per turn, whenever you deal damage with a spell you cast you may spend one use of Overcharge to deal more damage. The bonus damage equals half your total level and is of one of the damage types the spell you cast deals (your choice). You can store a number of Overcharge uses equal to your Intelligence modifier (minimum of 1). When you complete a long rest, you lose all uses of Overcharge you have stored except for one.

Level 7

General Upgrade [Occult Student]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 8

ASI or Feat [Occult Student]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 9

General Upgrade [Occult Student]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 10

Arcane Tradition [Occult Student]

- ❖ **Abjuration - Potent Denial:** Whenever you cast an abjuration spell that requires you to make an ability check as part of the spell's description, you receive a bonus to the ability check equal to your proficiency bonus.
- ❖ **Conjuration - Unrivaled Focus:** You cannot lose your concentration by taking damage when you are concentrating on a conjuration spell.
- ❖ **Divination - Mind's Eye:** Once per short or long rest, you may gain a benefit to your perceptive ability that lasts until you start a short or long rest, or until you are incapacitated. Spend an action and choose one benefit below:
 - **Darkvision:** You gain darkvision out to a range of 12 m.
 - **Ethereal Sight:** You can see into the Ethereal Plane out to a range of 12 m.
 - **Greater Comprehension:** You can read any language.
 - **See Invisibility:** You can see invisible creatures and objects within 6 m of you that are within line of sight.
- ❖ **Enchantment - Twice the Charm:** You can target an additional creature whenever you cast an enchantment spell of 1st level or higher that targets only one creature.
- ❖ **Evocation - Empowered Evocation:** Once per turn, you can add your Intelligence modifier to one damage roll of any evocation spell you cast.

- ❖ **Illusion - Duplicate:** Once per short or long rest, you may interpose an illusory duplicate of yourself in front of an attack that would hit you. As a reaction, the illusion takes the hit, the attack misses you, after which the illusion dissipates.
- ❖ **Necromancy - Un-lifeforce:** Your health point maximum can't be reduced, and you receive resistance to necrotic damage.
- ❖ **Transmutation - Biomancy:** Once per long rest, you can cast Polymorph as Soul Mastery. This casting of Polymorph allows you to target an additional creature.
- ❖ **War Magic - Defensive Chant:** While you maintain concentration on a spell, you gain a +2 bonus to AV and all saving throws.

Level 11

General Upgrade [Occult Student]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential

Level 12

ASI or Feat [Occult Student]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 13

General Upgrade [Occult Student]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential

Level 14

Arcane Tradition [Occult Student]

- ❖ **Abjuration - Prismatic Ward:** You gain advantage on saving throws against spells, and you gain resistance against damage dealt by spells.
- ❖ **Conjuration - Bolster:** Any creature that you summon or create via a conjuration spell receive 30 temporary health points.
- ❖ **Divination - Epiphany:** You roll three d20 for your Premonition ability, rather than two.
- ❖ **Enchantment - Memnomancy:** When you cast an enchantment spell that causes one or more creatures to be charmed by you, you can prevent one charmed creature from realizing that it is charmed. In addition, once before the spell expires, you can attempt to erase memories of one charmed creature. Spend an action and target one creature currently being charmed by you. The creature must succeed on Int/Cun saving throw against your spell save DV. On a fail, the creature forgets a number of hours equal to 1 + your Manipulation modifier (minimum 1). You decide which hours the creature forgets of its time being charmed and you can decide to make the creature forget less time. The amount of time can't exceed the duration of your enchantment spell.

- ❖ **Evocation - Overchannel:** When you cast a spell of 5th level or lower (excluding cantrips) that deals damage, you can deal maximum damage with that spell. The first time you do so, you suffer no adverse effect. If you use this ability again before you finish a long rest, you take 2d12 necrotic damage for each level of the spell, immediately after you cast it. Each time you use this ability again before finishing a long rest, the necrotic damage per spell level increases by 1d12. This damage ignores resistance and immunity.
- ❖ **Illusion - Delusions of Grandeur:** As a bonus action, you may make one inanimate, nonmagical object that is a part of an illusion real when you cast an illusion spell of 1st level or higher. The object becomes tangible for 10 rounds. The object can't deal damage or otherwise directly harm anyone.
- ❖ **Necromancy - Necromantic Mastery:** Target an undead that you can see within 12 m of you and spend an action. That undead must succeed on an Int/Cun saving throw or become friendly to you. If the undead succeeds this saving throw it cannot be targeted again by this ability. How effective this ability depends upon the undead's intelligence ability score.
 - If the undead you target possesses an Intelligence score of 8 or higher, the undead receives advantage on the saving throw.
 - If the undead you target possesses an Intelligence score of 12 or higher and fails its initial saving throw, it can repeat the saving throw at the end of every hour until it breaks free from this ability.
- ❖ **Transmutation - Mystic Release:** As an action, you can release the power within your Alchemist's Stone to create one powerful effect of your choice:
 - **Flexible Transmutation:** You can transmute one nonmagical object—no larger than a 1 m cube into another nonmagical object of similar size and mass and of equal or lesser value. You must spend 10 minutes handling the object to transform it.
 - **Elixir:** You remove all curses, diseases, and poisons affecting a creature that you touch with the Alchemist's Stone. The creature also regains all its health points.
 - **Regeneration:** You cast the Raise Dead spell on a creature you touch with the Alchemist's Stone as Soul Mastery.
 - **Restore Youth:** You touch the Alchemist's Stone to a willing creature, and that creature's apparent age is reduced by 3d10 years, to a minimum of 13 years. This effect doesn't extend the creature's lifespan.

When you use this ability, your Alchemist's Stone is destroyed and can't be remade until you finish a long rest.
- ❖ **War Magic - Arcane Veil:** Whenever you use your Minor Shield ability, up to three creatures of your choice that you can see within 12 m of you each take force damage equal to half your total level.

Level 15

Improved Magical Upgrade [Occult Student]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 30 Potential
- ❖ Three skill points to assign in any skill or skills of your choice, or to store
- ❖ +1 to an ability score of your choice
- ❖ Pick a feat from the feat list

Level 16

ASI or Feat [Occult Student]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 17

General Upgrade [Occult Student]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential

Level 18

Spell mastery [Occult Student]

Choose a 1st-level spell and a 2nd-level spell. You can cast those spells at their lowest level as Soul Mastery.

Level 19

ASI or Feat [Occult Student]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 20

Superior Spell Mastery [Occult Student]

You gain mastery over two powerful spells and can cast them with little effort. Choose two 3rd-level spells that you know. Once per short or long rest, you can cast them as Soul Mastery.

[PACT]

HD: 1d10

Bonus Skill Points: None

Spellcasting: Moderate

Level 1

Level 1 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Patron [Pact]

- ❖ **Angelic - Mending Warmth:** Your Soul oozes a warmth that reinvigorates your allies. You gain a number of d6s equal to 1 + your level picks of [Pact]. You can heal other creatures by spending a bonus action and dice from your pool. You roll the dice, add it together, and restore that many health points. You can only spend a number of dice equal to your Presence modifier (minimum of 1) on your turn. You regain all your spent dice when you complete a long rest.
- ❖ **Explorer - Energy Field:** Once per short or long rest, a swirling field of energy surrounds you. As a bonus action, you gain resistance against all damage and you deal radiant damage equal to your [Pact] + your Intelligence modifier to all hostile creatures who end their turn within 2 m of you until the end of your next turn.
- ❖ **Fey - Beguiling Aura:** Once per short or long rest you may frighten or charm (your choice) all creatures in a 2 m cube originating from you as an action. The creatures in the area make an Int/Cun saving throw against your spell save DV. On a failed save, the creature suffers the condition until the end of your next turn.
- ❖ **Fiend - Violent Nourishment:** When you reduce a hostile creature to 0 health points, you gain temporary health points equal to your Presence modifier + your level picks in [Pact] (minimum of 1).
- ❖ **Lurker - Jinx:** Once per short or long rest, you can curse one creature that you can see within 6 m of you as a bonus action. The curse lasts for 10 rounds or until you or the creature becomes incapacitated. As long as the curse is in effect you gain these benefits:
 - A bonus to your damage from both spell attacks and weapon attacks equal to your proficiency bonus.
 - Your critical range increases to 19 against the cursed target.
 - If the target dies whilst it is cursed, you recover health points equal to your level picks in [Pact] plus your Manipulation modifier.
- ❖ **Psychic - Ascension:** As long as a creature knows one language and is within 6 m of you, you can telepathically communicate with it and the creature will understand you. The creature cannot reply.
- ❖ **Undead - Deceased Familiarity:** Any undead must first succeed a resolve saving throw against your spell DV before targeting you directly with an attack or spell that deals damage, or be forced to target somebody else, potentially forfeiting the attack or spell. The undead creature becomes immune to this ability for 24 hours if it succeeds the saving throw and if you target the undead with an attack or a spell that deals damage. In addition, you learn the Spare the Dying cantrip as Soul Mastery and you receive advantage to all saving throws against disease.

Secondary Selection

General Upgrade [Pact]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 2

Level 2 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Absorbed Soul Aspect [Pact]

When you pick this ability you gain two Absorbed Soul Aspects. For every third level of [Pact] you possess you may learn another Absorbed Soul Aspect. If you picked this ability at level 2 you receive another Absorbed Soul Aspect at 4th, 7th, 10th, 13th, 16th, and 19th pick of [Pact] to a maximum of 8 Aspects. Additionally, when you pick a level of [Pact], you can choose one of the Aspects you know and replace it with another Aspect that you could learn at that level.

Secondary Selection

General Upgrade [Pact]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 3

Level 3 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Pact Boon [Pact]

- ❖ **Blade:** As an action, you can create a melee [Pact] weapon of your choice in your hand. These rules apply to your [Pact] weapon:
 - **Proficient:** You are proficient with it while you wield it.
 - **Magical:** This weapon counts as magical for the purpose of overcoming resistance and immunity to nonmagical attacks and damage.
 - **Duration:** Your [Pact] weapon disappears if it is more than 1 m away from you for 10 rounds or more. It also disappears if you use this ability again, if you dismiss the weapon (no action required), or if you die. You can dismiss the weapon, shunting it into an extradimensional space, and it appears whenever you create your [Pact] weapon thereafter.
 - **Transform:** You can transform one magic weapon into your [Pact] weapon by performing a special ritual while you hold the weapon. You perform the ritual for over 1 hour, which can be done during a short rest. You can't affect an artifact or a sentient weapon in this way. The weapon ceases being your [Pact] weapon if you die, if you perform the 1-hour ritual on a

different weapon, or if you use a 1-hour ritual to break your bond to it. The weapon appears at your feet if it is in the extradimensional space when the bond breaks.

- ❖ **Bond:** You learn the Find Familiar spell and can cast it as a ritual and Soul Mastery.
 - When you cast the spell, you can choose one of the normal forms for your familiar or one of the following special forms: Imp, Pseudodragon, Quasit, or Sprite.
 - Additionally, when you take the attack action, you can forgo one of your own attacks to allow your familiar to use its reaction to make one attack of its own.
- ❖ **Tome:** Your patron gives you a spellbook. When you gain this ability, choose three cantrips from the spell list. While the book is on your person, you can cast those cantrips at will. They don't count against your number of cantrips known. If you lose your spellbook, you can perform a 1-hour ceremony to receive a replacement from your patron. This ceremony can be performed during a short or long rest, and it destroys the previous book. The book turns to ash when you die.
- ❖ **Stellar Bond:** If you have chosen Explorer as your patron you can select this Pact Boon. This Pact Boon grants your character a chain forged in starlight and whilst this chain is on your person you gain two benefits:
 - Once per short or long rest, you gain advantage to one Intelligence check or a skill check including Intelligence.
 - You can cast the Augury spell as Soul Mastery but only as a ritual. The chain disappears if you would die. Once per short or long rest, you can perform a 1-hour ritual to replace your star chain if it is lost.

Secondary Selection

General Upgrade [Pact]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 4

ASI or Feat [Pact]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 5

Improved Magical Upgrade [Pact]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential
- ❖ +1 to an ability score of your choice
- ❖ Pick an additional feat from the feat list

Level 6

Patron [Pact]

- ❖ **Angelic - Heart of Gold:** Whenever you cast a spell that deals fire or radiant damage to one target, you add your Presence modifier to the damage. In addition, you gain resistance to radiant damage.
- ❖ **Explorer - Star Step:** Once per long rest, you can temporarily teleport into the Stellar Expanse as an action. You return at the end of your turn and then your turn ends, but before then you can cast two spells that target yourself. This movement does not trigger an attack of opportunity.
- ❖ **Fey - Fade Out:** Once per short or long rest, you become invisible and teleport up to 12 m to an unoccupied space you can see if you take combat damage. You remain invisible until the end of your next turn or until you take a hostile action.
- ❖ **Fiend - Fiendish Luck:** When you make an ability check or a saving throw, you can use this ability to add 1d10 to your roll. You can do so after seeing the initial roll but before any of the roll's effects occur. Once you use this ability, you can't use it again until you finish a short or long rest.
- ❖ **Lurker - Ghost Caller:** Once per long rest, you can cause a Soul to rise as a ghost from a humanoid creature you killed this turn. The Soul that rises has the statistics of a specter but with a few differences:
 - It gains a bonus to its attack roll equal to your Manipulation modifier.
 - It gains temporary health points equal to half your total level.
 - The specter obeys your commands and rolls its own initiative. The Soul returns to the world after you finish a long rest.
- ❖ **Psychic - Mind Over Matter:** Once per short or long rest, you can spend a reaction to give an enemy attacking you disadvantage to the attack roll. Before the end of your next turn, you may make your next attack roll with advantage if you caused the attack to miss this way.
- ❖ **Undead - Escape Fate:** Once per long rest, when you stabilize a creature with the Spare the Dying cantrip, you can heal them for 1d8 + your Vitality modifier. Alternatively, when you succeed on a death saving throw, you can heal yourself for 1d8+ your Vitality modifier (minimum 1).

Level 7

General Upgrade [Pact]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 8

ASI or Feat [Pact]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 9

General Upgrade [Pact]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 10

Patron [Pact]

- ❖ **Angelic - Radiant Fortitude:** When you finish a short or long rest, you and up to ten allies are filled with celestial fortitude. You gain temporary health points equal to your total level plus your Presence modifier. Your allies receive temporary health points equal to half your level picks in [Pact] plus your Presence modifier.
- ❖ **Explorer - Resilient Voyager:** You gain resistance to both fire and cold damage, and you no longer need to breathe.
- ❖ **Fey - Iron Will:** When another creature attempts to charm you they must succeed a Composure saving throw against your spell save DV or be charmed by you instead of for 10 rounds or until the creature takes damage from an hostile action. In addition, you are immune to the charm condition.
- ❖ **Fiend - Fiendish Resilience:** You can choose one damage type when you finish a short or long rest. You gain resistance to that damage type until you choose a different one with this ability. Damage from magical weapons or silver weapons ignores this resistance.
- ❖ **Lurker - Jinx Aegis:** You can roll a d6 as a reaction. If the result is 4 or higher the creature afflicted by your Jinx ability that hits you with a successful attack roll misses their attack instead.
- ❖ **Psychic - Telepathic Wall:** Whenever you are dealt psychic damage from another creature, that creature suffers as much psychic damage you do. Your thoughts cannot be read unless you allow it. In addition, you gain resistance against psychic damage.
- ❖ **Undead - Eternal Existence:** Every ten years your body only ages 1 year and you are immune against magical age effects. You do not require food, water, or breathing. You still receive the benefits of a short or a long rest and you must rest to remove the exhaustion condition.

Level 11

Absorb Innate Spellcasting [Pact]

Choose one 6th-level spell that is not Soul Consumption. You can cast this spell as Soul Mastery once per long rest.

Level 12

ASI or Feat [Pact]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 13

Absorb Innate Spellcasting [Pact]

Choose one 7th-level spell that is not Soul Consumption. You can cast this spell as Soul Mastery once per long rest.

Level 14

Patron [Pact]

- ❖ **Angelic - Blazing Dedication:** Once per long rest, when you make a death saving throw you may instantly stabilize, gain health points equal to your half your health point maximum and stand up. All creatures of your choice within 6 m of you take radiant damage equal to your Presence damage plus 2d8 and are blinded until the end of your next turn.
- ❖ **Explorer - Isolated in the Expanse:** Once per long rest, you may transport yourself and up to ten willing creatures into the Stellar Expanse by performing a 5-minute ritual. You can stay in the Stellar Expanse for the duration of a short rest. If a creature uses this time to take the rest action, they regain the full value of any spent health dice and they gain advantage on one skill check, saving throw, or attack roll of their choosing. The advantage must be used within 4 hours after the rest is complete. You can apply the advantage after you have rolled the check but before the GM declares a success or a fail. When the duration is over, all creatures are returned to their original location.
- ❖ **Fey - Sinister Hallucinations:** Once per short or long rest, you can target one creature within 12 m of you and cause them to hallucinate. The target hallucinates that they are in an empty, misty realm where they can only hear themselves and you, but not see anything else. The target suffers these effects for 10 rounds or until your concentration is broken (as if you were concentrating on a spell) if they fail a Resolve saving throw or a Composure saving throw (your choice) against your spell save DV.
- ❖ **Fiend - Hurl Through Hell:** Once per short rest, when you hit a creature with an attack, you can use this ability to instantly make the target hallucinate about long gone realms once home to fiends. The creature disappears to the Stellar Expanse and in their mind falls through a nightmare landscape. At the end of your next turn, the target returns to the space it previously occupied or the nearest unoccupied space. If the target is not a fiend, it takes 10d10 psychic damage as it reels from its horrific experience.
- ❖ **Lurker - Jinx Savant:** As long as you are not incapacitated, you can transfer your Jinx to another target within 6 m of you after your currently Jinxed target dies as a bonus action. You can transfer your Jinx like this three times per short rest.
- ❖ **Psychic - Instant Slave:** You can charm an incapacitated humanoid by simply touching them and spending an action. You can communicate telepathically with the charmed creatures as long as the both of you are within the same Realm. The charm condition persists until you use this ability again or by a Remove Curse spell.
- ❖ **Undead - Everlasting Soul:** If you regain health points from any source you can reattach body parts. Once per short or long rest, you may spend a bonus action and regain health points equal to 1d8 + your total level.

Level 15

Absorb Innate Spellcasting [Pact]

Choose one 8th-level spell that is not Soul Consumption. You can cast this spell as Soul Mastery once per long rest.

Level 16

ASI or Feat [Pact]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 17

Absorb Innate Spellcasting [Pact]

Choose one 9th-level spell that is not Soul Consumption. You can cast this spell as Soul Mastery once per long rest.

Level 18

General Upgrade [Pact]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential

Level 19

ASI or Feat [Pact]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 20

Sibling Soul [Pact]

You can spend 10 rounds entreating your patron for aid to regain either all your spell slots that recover after a long rest, or all your spell slots that recover after a short rest. Once you regain spell slots with this ability, you must finish a long rest before you can do so again.

EXTRA ABILITY ORIGIN CONTENT

Absorb Soul Aspect [Pact]

Your connection to your patron allows you to glimpse aspects of power from your patron's Soul, and then, with time, embody them yourself. When you gain a level in [Pact], you can choose one of the Soul aspects you know and replace it with another Soul aspect that you could learn at that level. If an aspect has prerequisites, you must meet them to learn it. You can learn the Soul aspect at the same time that you meet its prerequisites.

Agonizing Blast

Prerequisite: Ranged spell attack cantrip

When you cast a ranged spell attack cantrip of your choice, add your Cunning or Manipulation modifier of your choice (choose once) to the damage it deals on a hit.

Arcane Sight

You can cast Detect Magic as Soul Mastery.

Armor of Shadows

You can cast Mage Armor as Soul Mastery.

Beast Speech

You can cast Speak With Animals as Soul Mastery.

Beguiling Influence

You gain 2 skill points in the Deception and Persuasion skills and you may gain rank 5 with those skills.

Book of Ancient Rituals

Prerequisite: Pact of the Tome ability

You can now inscribe magical rituals in your spellbook. Choose two 1st-level spells that have the ritual tag. The spells appear in the book and don't count against the number of spells you know. With your spellbook in hand, you can cast the chosen spells as rituals. You can't cast the spells except as rituals unless you've learned them by some other means. You can also cast your normal spells you know as a ritual if it has the ritual tag.

On your adventures, you can add other ritual spells to your spellbook. When you find such a spell, you can add it to the book if the spell's level is equal to or less than half your [Pact] level (rounded up) and if you can spare the time to transcribe the spell. For each level of the spell, the transcription process takes 2 hours and costs Soul points equal to the level of the spell inscribed, those Soul points are consumed.

Bountiful Recovery

Prerequisite: Pact of the Bond ability

Whilst your familiar is within 30 m of you, whenever you are targeted with a spell or ability that rolls dice to regain health points, you regain health points equal to the maximum value of those dice instead of rolling.

Embrace of Dithore

Prerequisite: Ranged spell attack cantrip

You can move one target you have hit with your a ranged spell attack cantrip of your choice 2 m towards you in a straight line. You can only use this Soul Aspect once per turn.

Enhanced Pact Weapon

Prerequisite: Pact of the Blade ability

As long as your [Pact] weapon does not have a +1 bonus to attack rolls and damage rolls already, it receives a +1 bonus to attack and damage rolls. Additionally, the [Pact] weapon you conjure can be a short bow, longbow, light crossbow, or heavy crossbow.

Eyes of An'her

You can see normally in darkness, both magical and nonmagical, up to a distance of 24 m.

Eyes of Sokari

You can read all written text.

Force Spear

Prerequisite: Ranged spell attack cantrip

If you cast a ranged spell attack cantrip of your choice, its range is 60 m.

Gaze of Two Minds

You can use your action to touch a willing humanoid and perceive through its senses until the end of your next turn. As long as the creature is within the same Realm as you, you can use your action on subsequent turns to maintain this connection, extending the duration until the end of your next turn. While perceiving through the other creature's senses, you benefit from any special senses possessed by that creature, and you are blinded and deafened to your own surroundings.

Jinx of Imenta

Once per long rest, you can cast Bane as Soul Mastery.

Lunar Trance

Prerequisite: Pact of the Tome

You cannot fall asleep anymore, not even by magical means. You can still gain the benefits of a long rest but you must spend it only doing light activity.

Mask of Many Faces

You can cast Disguise Self as Soul Mastery.

Misty Visions

You can cast Silent Image as Soul Mastery.

Repelling Blast

Prerequisite: Ranged spell attack cantrip

When you hit a creature with a ranged spell attack cantrip of your choice, you can push the creature up to 2 m away from you in a straight line.

Spear of Torpor

Prerequisite: Ranged spell attack cantrip

You can reduce the speed of one target you have hit with a ranged spell attack cantrip of your choice by 2 m until the end of your next turn. You can only use this Soul Aspect once per turn.

Vigor of Labda

You can cast Armor of Life as 1st level spell on yourself as Soul Mastery.

Voice of the Master

Prerequisite: Pact of the Bond ability

You can communicate telepathically with your familiar and perceive through your familiar's senses as long as you are within the same Realm. Additionally, while perceiving

through your familiar's senses, you can also speak through your familiar in your own voice, even if your familiar is normally incapable of speech.

Aggravating Jinx

Prerequisite: 5 level picks in [Pact], Hex spell or, any spell or ability that curses
You can deal psychic damage with a bonus action against a creature you have cursed by a spell or ability you possess. The damage also afflicts all creatures within 1 m of it and equals your Cunning or Manipulation modifier of your choice (choose once, minimum 1).

Coffin of Khei

Prerequisite: 5 level picks in [Pact]

Once per short or long rest, when you suffer damage in combat you may entomb yourself in an icy coffin. Whilst in this icy coffin you gain a number of effects:

- ❖ You gain 10 temporary health points per total level you possess. These temporary health points soak up as much as possible of the damage you took before triggering this ability.
- ❖ Your speed is reduced to 0.
- ❖ You are incapacitated.
- ❖ You suffer vulnerability to fire damage.

This icy coffin melts at the end of your next turn and all effects, including the temporary health points, ends.

Favor of the Waves

Prerequisite: 5 level picks in [Pact]

Once per long rest, you can cast Water Breathing as Soul Mastery. In addition, you gain a swimming speed equal to your walking speed and you can breathe underwater.

Menacing Aura

Prerequisite: 5 level picks in [Pact]

Once per short or long rest, you may spend a bonus action and gain a menacing and poisonous aura. The form your aura takes is up to you (buzzing flies, sickly green water, black tendrils of shadows, etc). The radius of your aura is 1-m radius but it cannot go through total cover. Your aura gives you two benefits:

- ❖ Creatures who start their turn in your aura suffer poison damage equal to Cunning or Manipulation (minimum of 1) your choice (choose once).
- ❖ You gain advantage on any intimidation attempts you make with Persuasion or Deception skill checks. All other social checks you make have disadvantage.

Mire the Mind

Prerequisite: 5 level picks in [Pact]

Once per long rest, you can cast Slow as Soul Mastery.

One with Shadows

Prerequisite: 5 level picks in [Pact]

When you are in an area of dim light or darkness, you can use your action to become invisible until you move, take an action, or a reaction.

Sign of Ill Omen

Prerequisite: 5th level picks in [Pact]

Once per long rest, you can cast Bestow Curse as Soul Mastery.

Thirsting Blade

Prerequisite: 5 level picks in [Pact], Pact of the Blade ability

You can attack with your [Pact] weapon twice, instead of once, whenever you take the attack action on your turn.

Bewitching Whispers

Prerequisite: 7 level picks in [Pact]

Once per long rest, you can cast Compulsion as Soul Mastery.

Dreadful Word

Prerequisite: 7th [Pact] level

Once per long rest, you can cast Confusion as Soul Mastery.

Inexorable Jinx

Prerequisite: 7 level picks in [Pact], Hex spell or, any spell or ability that curses

Against a target you have cursed through a spell or an ability you possess, you can teleport within 1 m of them as a bonus action. You can only teleport this way as long as you can see them and they are within 6 m of you.

Phantom Vision

Prerequisite: 7 level picks in [Pact]

Once per short or long rest, for 10 rounds you gain the ability to see through objects. This vision has a range of 6 m and within that range, you also gain darkvision.

Sculptor of Flesh

Prerequisite: 7 level picks in [Pact]

Once per long rest, you can cast Polymorph as Soul Mastery.

Tactical Retreat

Prerequisite: 7 level picks in [Pact]

Once per long rest, you can cast Freedom of Movement as Soul Mastery.

Ascendant Step

Prerequisite: 9 level picks in [Pact]

You can cast Levitate on yourself as Soul Mastery.

Exceptional Pact Weapon

Prerequisite: 9 level picks in [Pact], Pact of the Blade ability

As long as your [Pact] weapon does not have a +2 bonus to attack rolls and damage rolls already, it receives a +2 bonus to attack and damage rolls. Additionally, the [Pact] weapon you conjure can be a short bow, longbow, light crossbow, or heavy crossbow.

Minions of the Primordials

Prerequisite: 9 level picks in [Pact]

Once per long rest, you can cast Conjure Elemental as Soul Mastery.

Otherworldly Leap

Prerequisite: 9 level picks in [Pact]

You can cast Jump as Soul Mastery.

Whispers of the Grave

Prerequisite: 9 level picks in [Pact]

You can cast Speak With Dead as Soul Mastery.

Wrath of the Taskmaster

Prerequisite: 9 level picks in [Pact], Pact of the Bond ability

Spend your bonus action and you can command your familiar to make an attack.

Affliction of Galene

Prerequisite: 12 level picks in [Pact], Pact of the Blade ability

When you hit a creature with your [Pact] weapon, the creature takes extra lightning damage equal to your Cunning or Manipulation modifier (your choice, choose once, minimum 1).

Chains of Amaknuphis

Prerequisite: 15th [Pact] level, Pact of the Bond ability

You can cast Hold Monster as Soul Mastery but you can only target a celestial, fiend, or elemental. You must finish a long rest before you can cast Hold Monster like this against the same creature again.

Cloak of Darkness

Prerequisite: 15 level picks in [Pact]

Once per long rest, you can **cast** Invisibility as Soul Mastery.

Master of Myriad Forms

Prerequisite: 15 level picks in [Pact]

You can cast Alter Self as Soul Mastery.

Transcendent Pact Weapon

Prerequisite: 15 level picks in [Pact], Pact of the Blade ability

As long as your [Pact] weapon does not have a +3 bonus to attack rolls and damage rolls already, it receives a +3 bonus to attack and damage rolls. Additionally, the [Pact] weapon you conjure can be a short bow, longbow, light crossbow, or heavy crossbow.

Visions of Distant Realms

Prerequisite: 15 level picks in [Pact]

You can cast Arcane Eye as Soul Mastery.

Witch Sight

Prerequisite: 15 level picks in [Pact]

You can see the true form of any shapechanger or creature concealed by illusion or transmutation magic while the creature is within 6 m of you and within line of sight.

[POWER]

HD: 1d12

Bonus Skill Points: None

Spellcasting: Minor

Level 1

Level 1 offers two Selection.

Primary Selection

Rage [Power]

On your turn, you can enter a Rage as a bonus action. While raging, you gain the following benefits if you aren't wearing heavy armor:

- ❖ You have advantage on all Brawn checks and Brawn saving throws.
- ❖ When you make a melee weapon attack using Brawn, you gain a bonus to the damage roll that increases as you pick levels in [Power], which starts at +2, increases to +3 at 9th and +4 at 16th.
- ❖ You have resistance to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage.
- ❖ If you can cast spells, you can't cast them or concentrate on them while raging.

Your Rage lasts for a whole combat if the combat does not have any distinct pauses in the violence, this is up to the GM to decide. You can also end your Rage early by spending a bonus action. You can rage twice per long rest when you pick this ability, and the number of times you can Rage increases as you gain total levels. At 3rd total level, you can Rage thrice, four times at 6th, five times at 12th, six times at 17th, and unlimited at 20th.

Secondary Selection

Unarmored Defense [Power]

While you are not wearing any armor or wielding a shield, your armor class equals 10 + your Vitality modifier + your Resolve modifier. The Vitality and the Resolve modifier cannot exceed your proficiency bonus individually.

Second Wind [Power]

Once per short or long rest, you may regain health points equal to 1d10 + your level in [Power] as a bonus action.

Level 2

Level 2 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Reckless Attack [Power]

When you make your first attack on your turn, you can decide to attack recklessly. Doing so gives you advantage on all melee weapon attack rolls using Brawn during that turn, but attack rolls against you are rolled with advantage until the beginning of your next turn.

Secondary Selection

Danger Sense [Power]

You have advantage on Dexterity saving throws against effects that you can see. You do not gain this benefit if you are blinded, deafened, or incapacitated.

Survival Instincts [Power]

Choose two Skills between Animal Handling, Athletics, Medicine, Perception, or Survival, you gain 2 skill points in both of them and you may gain rank 5 with both of those skills.

Level 3

Level 3 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Primal Path [Power]

- ❖ **Beast Channeller - Bestial Nature:** You study an animal or beast of your choice to channel their ferocity in battle and gain their ancient wisdom. The animal or beast of your choice must fit one of the categories below and be native to your home region. On subsequent levels, if you pick up more Beast Channeller abilities you may choose the same animal or a different one. But you still must abide by the guidelines above when you do so. In addition, you learn Beast Sense and Speak as Animals but you can only cast them as rituals.
 - **Lumbering:** As long as you have activated your Rage ability, you have resistance to all damage except psychic damage.
 - **Flying:** As long as you are not wearing heavy armor you can use the dash action as a bonus action. Additionally, other creatures have disadvantage when targeting you with opportunity attacks.
 - **Pack:** As long as you are using your Rage ability, all your companions receive advantage when they target a creature within 1 m of you with a melee attack.
- ❖ **Berserker - Frenzy:** You can go into a Frenzy when you Rage. If you do so, for the duration of your Rage you can make a single melee weapon attack as a bonus action on each of your turns after this one. When the Rage ends you gain one level of exhaustion.
- ❖ **Fanatic - Blessed:** As long as you are using your Rage ability, your first successful weapon attack on each of your turns receives a bonus to its damage. The damage equals 1d6 plus half your [Power] level, rounded up. You choose the damage type and it will remain that damage type for the rest of your campaign.
- ❖ **Natural Harbinger - Child of the Natural World:** Whilst raging, you can activate an aura with a 2 m radius. On subsequent turns whilst you are raging, as long as you spend a bonus action, the aura is activated until the start of your next turn. This aura cannot pierce through total cover. If any effects within Natural Harbinger would require a saving throw, your DV would equal your Vitality modifier plus your proficiency modifier. Choose one:
 - **Arid:** All creatures but you take 2 fire damage when you activate your aura with a bonus action. The damage increases with +1 at every 5 level picks of [Power].
 - **Ocean:** When you spend a bonus action to reactivate your aura, choose a creature within your aura's range. That creature makes a dexterity saving throw. On a fail, the creature suffers 1d6 lightning damage and on a

success, they suffer half that damage. The damage increases with +1d6 at every 5 level picks of [Power].

- **Arctic:** All allies within range become strengthened by your icy aura and gain 5 temporary health points. The temporary health points increase with +5 at every 5 level picks of [Power].
- ❖ **Shaman - Defenders:** On your turn, the first creature you hit with a weapon attack whilst you are raging becomes distracted by spirits. That creature has disadvantage to any attack it makes when targeting one of your allies instead of you. If it would successfully hit one of your allies anyway, your ally receives resistance to the damage it receives. This effect lasts until the start of your next turn or until you stop raging.

Secondary Selection

Fast Movement [Power]

Your speed increases by 2 m while you aren't wearing heavy armor.

Level 4

ASI or Feat [Power]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 5

Extra Attack [Power]

As part of your attack action, you can make two attacks instead of one. You must possess at least 1 level of [Power] to be eligible for this ability (excluding this level).

Level 6

Primal Path [Power]

- ❖ **Beast Channeller - Animalistic Virtue:** Your Soul swells with the virtues of an animal or beast of your choice. Choose one:
 - **Lumbering:** All knockback effects increase with 1 m for you and all attempts to knock you prone or knock you back suffer disadvantage. In addition, you double your carrying capacity.
 - **Flying:** Dim light does not impose disadvantage on your perception checks. Without obstacles, you can see up to 2 km away from you and you can discern fine details up to 30 m away from you.
 - **Running:** If you are traveling at a normal pace you can still move stealthily and if you are traveling at a fast pace you can still track other creatures.
- ❖ **Berserker - Mindless Rage:** You can't be charmed or frightened while raging. If you are charmed or frightened when you enter your Rage, the effect is suspended for the duration of the Rage.
- ❖ **Fanatic - Zealous Perseverance:** Once per Rage, you can reroll a failed saving throw but you must use the new result.
- ❖ **Natural Harbinger - Soul of the Wild:** You gain benefits even if your aura is not active. Choose one:
 - **Arid:** You can light on fire flammable objects with a mere touch of your hand. If you want to light on fire an object that is being worn or carried

you must first perform a successful grapple on the target and then a bonus action to ignite the spark. If the creature does not remove the item or douse the fire with action before the end of their next turn, they suffer 1d10 fire damage. In addition, you gain resistance to fire damage.

- **Ocean:** You can breathe underwater and you gain a swimming speed of 6 m. In addition, you gain resistance to lightning damage.
- **Arctic:** You do not suffer any adverse effects in extreme cold, you do not leave any footprints in snow and you gain advantage on Survival checks made to track creatures in the snow. In addition you gain resistance against cold damage.
- ❖ **Shaman - Phantom Armor:** When you are raging and you see an ally take damage within 6 m of you, you may spend your reaction and lower that damage by 2d6. This reduction in damage increases twice with 1d6. Once after 10 level picks of [Power] (to 3d6), and once again after 14 levels picks of [Power] (to 4d6).

Level 7

Feral Instinct [Power]

You have advantage on initiative rolls. Additionally, if you are surprised at the beginning of combat and aren't incapacitated, you can act normally on your first turn, but only if you enter your Rage before doing anything else on that turn.

Level 8

ASI or Feat [Power]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 9

Brutal Critical [Power]

You can roll one additional weapon damage die when determining the extra damage for a critical hit with a melee attack.

Level 10

Primal Path [Power]

- ❖ **Beast Channeller - Listen to the Wild:** You gain the ability to cast Commune With Nature as a ritual.
- ❖ **Berserker - Intimidating Presence:** As an action, you may attempt to frighten a creature that you can see or hear you within 6 m of you. The creature must succeed on a Resolve saving throw (DV equal to 8 + your proficiency bonus + your Presence modifier) or be frightened of you until the end of your next turn. On subsequent turns, you can use your action to extend the duration of this effect on the frightened creature until the end of your next turn. This effect ends if the creature ends its turn out of line of sight or more than 12 m away from you. If the creature succeeds on its saving throw, you can't use this ability on that creature again for 24 hours.
- ❖ **Fanatic - Kindle the Spark:** Once per long rest, you can unleash a holy emboldening shout that gives up to ten allies within 12 m of advantage to all attack rolls and saving throws they make until the start of your next turn.

- ❖ **Natural Harbinger - Shelter:** All creatures of your choice within your aura also gain your resistance that you received from the Soul of the Wild ability.
- ❖ **Shaman - Commune with the Forebearers:** Once per short or long rest, you can cast Augury or Clairvoyance as Soul Mastery. For the purposes of Clairvoyance, rather than creating a sensor, you send one of your spirits to the location instead.

Level 11

Relentless Rage [Power]

If you drop to 0 health points while you're raging and don't die outright, you can make a DV 10 Vitality saving throw. If you succeed, you drop to 1 health point instead. Each time you use this ability after the first, the DV increases by 5. When you finish a short or long rest, the DV resets to 10.

Level 12

ASI or Feat [Power]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 13

Brutal Critical [Power]

You can roll one additional weapon damage die when determining the extra damage for a critical hit with a melee attack. If this is not the first time you have picked this ability, you gain another die.

Level 14

Primal Path [Power]

- ❖ **Beast Channeller - Beast Bond:** Choose one:
 - **Lumbering:** Any creature within 1 m of you and is hostile to you suffers disadvantage on all attack rolls when they target other creatures other than you. This ability is in effect as long as you are raging, the affected creature can see or hear you, and the creature isn't immune to being frightened.
 - **Flying:** As long as you are raging, you gain the ability to fly in short bursts. Your flying speed equals your walking speed. If you would end your turn up in the air you would immediately fall.
 - **Running:** If you spend your bonus action when you hit a creature with a melee weapon attack you may knock the creature prone. You can only knock a creature prone this way if you are raging and the target is Large or smaller.
- ❖ **Berserker - Retaliation:** As a reaction, you may make one melee weapon attack against a creature that is within 1 m of you and damages you.
- ❖ **Fanatic - Endless Anger:** If you are brought down to 0 health points or less but not killed outright when you are raging, you do not fall unconscious. You still suffer damage as normal and make death saving throws as normal. If you die from your death saving throws you can still keep on fighting until your rage ends or 10 rounds has passed, whichever is faster.

❖ **Natural Harbinger - Force of Nature:** Choose one:

- **Arid:** As a reaction, you can force one creature to make a Dexterity saving throw after it hits you with an attack. If the creature fails this saving throw it takes fire damage equal to half your total level.
- **Ocean:** As a reaction, you can knock a creature prone if you successfully hit them with an attack within your aura. A successful Brawn saving throw prevents the creature from being knocked prone by the rolling wave of force you unleash.
- **Arctic:** Whenever you spend a bonus action to reactivate your aura, you can choose one creature to make a Brawn saving throw. On a failed save, the creature's speed is reduced to 0 until the start of your next turn as they become afflicted by frostbite. The creature must be within your aura and you must be able to see it.

❖ **Shaman - Ruthless:** Whenever you use your Phantom Armor ability to reduce damage against an ally of yours, the attacker suffers force damage equal to the damage your Phantom Armor ability averted.

Level 15

Innate Aggression [Power]

As a reaction, you may move up to half your total movement towards a creature that ended their turn within 3 m of you. This movement does not trigger attacks of opportunity.

Level 16

ASI or Feat [Power]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 17

Brutal Critical [Power]

You can roll one additional weapon damage die when determining the extra damage for a critical hit with a melee attack. If this is not the first time you have picked this ability, you gain another die.

Level 18

Indomitable Might [Power]

If your total for a Brawn check is less than your Brawn score, you can use that score in place of the total.

Level 19

ASI or Feat [Power]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 20

Primal Champion [Power]

Your Brawn and Vitality scores increase by 4. Your maximum for those scores is now 24.

[PREDATOR]

HD: 1d10

Bonus Skill Points: None

Spellcasting: Moderate

Level 1

Level 1 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Favored Enemy [Predator]

Choose one creature type between, animal, beast, celestial, construct, dragon, elemental, fey, fiend, giant, human, humanoid, monstrosity, ooze, plant, or undead.

Against the creature type of choice you receive a number of benefits:

- ❖ When you do a weapon attack against your creature type you receive a +2 bonus to both attack rolls and damage rolls.
- ❖ Advantage to any Survival checks you perform to track the creature type of your choice.
- ❖ Advantage to any Intelligence checks to recall information about the creature type of choice.

Secondary Selection

Natural Explorer [Predator]

Your soul vibrates at the same frequency as the natural world. When you take this ability you gain advantage on attack rolls against creatures who have not yet acted on your first turn in combat. You gain advantage to initiative rolls and you ignore difficult terrain.

When you travel for an hour or more you and your group receive the following benefits:

- ❖ Difficult Terrain doesn't slow your group's travel.
- ❖ Your group can't become lost except by magical means.
- ❖ Even when you are engaged in another activity while traveling, you remain alert to danger.
- ❖ If you are traveling alone, you can move stealthily at a normal pace.
- ❖ When you forage, you find twice as much food as you normally would.
- ❖ While tracking other creatures, you also learn their exact number, their sizes, and how long ago they passed through the area.

Level 2

Level 2 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Fighting Style [Predator]

- ❖ **Archery:** +2 attack rolls made with ranged weapons.
- ❖ **Defense:** While you're wearing armor, you gain a +1 bonus to AC.
- ❖ **Dueling:** When you're wielding a melee weapon in one hand and no other weapon, you gain a +2 bonus to damage rolls with that weapon.

- ❖ **Great Weapon Fighting:** When you roll a 1 or 2 on a damage die for an attack you make with a melee weapon that you're wielding with two hands, you can reroll the dice and must use the new results.
- ❖ **Protection:** When a creature you can see attacks a target other than you that is within 1 m of you, you can use your reaction to impose disadvantage on the attack roll. You must be wielding a shield.
- ❖ **Two-Weapon Fighting:** When you engage in two-weapon fighting, you can add your ability modifier to the damage of the second attack.

Secondary Selection

General Upgrade [Predator]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 3

Level 3 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Conclave [Predator]

- ❖ **Butcher of Behemoths - Butcher's Intuition:** Choose one creature that you can see within 12 m of you and spend an action. As long as the creature is not protected from Divination magic you learn the creature's vulnerabilities, resistances, and immunities. If it is protected, you sense the creature has no vulnerabilities, resistances, and immunities. You may perform this ability a number of times equal to your Cunning modifier (minimum of 1) before you complete a long rest.
- ❖ **Exterminator of Woe - Ghastly Executioner:** On your first turn each combat you gain a number of benefits.
 - As part of your attack action that turns you can make an additional attack.
 - You can dash as a bonus action.
- ❖ **Hunter - Hunter's Prey:** you gain one of the following benefits of your choice.
 - **Colossus Slayer:** When you hit a creature with a weapon attack, the creature takes an extra 1d8 damage if it's below its health point maximum. You can deal this extra damage only once per turn.
 - **Giant Killer:** When a Large or larger creature within 1 m of you hits or misses you with an attack, you can use your reaction to attack that creature immediately after its attack, provided that you can see the creature.
 - **Horde Breaker:** Once on each of your turns when you make a weapon attack, you can make another attack with the same weapon against a different creature that is within 1 m of the original target and within range of your weapon.
- ❖ **Ranger - Partner of the Wild:** You gain a bonus to your initiative equal to your Cunning modifier. In addition, you learn how to bond an animal's or beast's Soul to yours, and through your bond strengthen their Soul. To bond with the partner you must perform an 8-hour Soul Consumption ritual with at least one Soul

potency. This ritual is Soul Mastery but Soul potency must still be consumed. If you do not have a Soul Mark, the Soul can be consumed from a Soul Gem or directly from a recently dead corpse within 6 m of you during the full length of the ritual. At the end of the ritual, the partner you chose appears and befriends you. You can bond with any animal or beast that possesses a CR rating of ½ or below and is native to the area that you perform the ritual in.

When a Partner of the Wild is bound to your Soul it obeys certain rules:

- Your partner obeys your commands to the best of its ability and shares your goals.
- You determine your partner's actions, personality, and behavior.
- If you would be incapacitated or away from your partner, it acts on its own per the personality and behavior you gave it.
- You roll initiative separately for your animal partner.
- The benefits you receive from your Natural Explorer ability also applies to your partner.

When you have bonded with a partner, its character sheet changes:

- If your animal partner possesses multiattack actions, it loses it.
- It uses your proficiency bonus rather than its own.
- It adds your proficiency bonus to its AV, to its attack rolls, and the damage it deals from natural weapon attacks.
- It gains two skill points in two skills of your choice.
- It gains proficiency with all saving throws.
- You calculate your partner's new HP by rolling health dice equal to your total level. The size of its health dice is equal to the health dice size it already possesses. Whilst rolling for the new HP as you pick this ability up or for a level up, you abide by the same rules as when you roll your health dice.
- Whenever you pick an "Ability Score Improvement or Feat" ability, your partner may increase one of its ability scores with +2, or two ability scores can receive +1. Your partner cannot increase an ability score above 20 unless its description allows it to do so. In addition, it gains one skill point in a skill of your choice.

Due to the nature of your bound Souls, your partner cannot die as long as you are alive. As long as you are not incapacitated you can call back your partner's Soul from their Enneade, even if you possess no parts of their body. Through redoing the ritual and consuming a Soul of at least 1 Soul potency, your partner's Soul gains a body and revives. This way, you can also change which animal or beast body your partner inhabits by abiding by the character sheet rules above.

- ❖ **Realm Marshal - Champion of the Realm:** Choose a creature within your weapon's range or reach and spend a bonus action. The next time you successfully hit that creature with a weapon attack action on this turn, you deal more damage. The damage you make with your weapon attack becomes force damage and you deal an extra 1d8 force damage. When you have picked 11 levels of [Predator] the extra damage increases to 2d8 force damage.

Secondary Selection

Primeval Awareness [**Predator**]

You gain the ability to sense your Favored Enemy through Soul Mastery. If you spend an uninterrupted minute as if you were concentrating on a spell, you can sense your Favored Enemy within a 10 km radius. You sense how many of your Favored Enemy is within the range, their general direction as well as distance (in km) from you. If you have

several Favored Enemies your senses can differentiate between them and you learn about them separately with one use of Primeval Awareness.

In addition, you gain a form of primitive communication with animals and beasts. As an action, you may understand, or you may convey to an animal or beast:

- ❖ A simple request.
- ❖ Emotional state.
- ❖ Current intent.
- ❖ Desires (such as shelter, safety, or food).
- ❖ Physical state (such as being hurt, or affected by magic).

Conversing with an animal or beast you attacked recently may not be receptive to you.

Level 4

ASI or Feat [Predator]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 5

Extra Attack [Predator]

You can take an attack action an extra time during your turn. You must possess at least 1 level of [Predator] to be eligible for this ability (excluding this level).

Conclave [Predator]

- ❖ **Ranger - Synchronized Strike:** As long as your partner can see you, it can use its reaction to make a natural weapon attack against any creature within its range when you use an attack action on your turn. If you decide to spend your partner's reaction this way, they receive a bonus to hit equal to your Cunning modifier.

Level 6

Greater Favored Enemy [Predator]

Choose another creature type for a second Favored Enemy. If you have two Favored Enemy creature types, damage you deal with your Favored Enemies increases to +4 and you gain advantage on all saving throws you make against abilities, traits, and spells your Favored Enemy uses.

Level 7

Conclave [Predator]

- ❖ **Butcher of Behemoths - Marked Foe:** Mark one creature within 12 m that you can see and spend a bonus action. Once on each of your turns, the first successful weapon attack you make against your marked creature gains more damage. The damage increases with a 1d8 and after eleven level picks of [Predator] it increases to 2d8. This bonus lasts until you are incapacitated or your marked creature is. You can also dismiss this effect with a bonus action. You can mark one creature with this ability once per long rest.
- ❖ **Exterminator of Woe - Steel Will:** You gain proficiency in a mental or social saving throw of your choice.
 - **Hunter - Elusive Stalker:** You gain one of the following abilities of your choice:

- **Escape the Horde:** Opportunity attacks against you are made with disadvantage.
- **Multi-attack Defense:** When a creature hits you with an attack, you gain a +4 bonus to AV against all subsequent attacks made by that creature for the rest of the turn.
- ❖ **Steel Will:** You gain proficiency in a mental or social saving throw of your choice.
- ❖ **Ranger - Feral Fury:** As long as your partner can see you it gains another attack action and receives advantage to all saving throws.
- ❖ **Realm Marshal - Extra-Planar Glide:** As a bonus action, you can cast *Etherealness* as *Soul Mastery* but with a duration of one minute. You regain the ability to cast *Etherealness* when you complete a long rest.

Level 8

ASI or Feat [Predator]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 9

Excellent Footwork [Predator]

As a bonus action on your turn, you can take the dash action.

Level 10

Natural Stealth [Predator]

As a bonus action, you may cast *Invisibility* as *Soul Mastery* once per short or long rest.

Camouflage [Predator]

Whenever you make a Stealth (Cun) check you do so with advantage. In addition, if you haven't moved this turn and take the hide action, creatures attempting to spot you do so with disadvantage. You lose this effect as soon as you take another action or you move.

Level 11

Conclave [Predator]

- ❖ **Butcher of Behemoths - Sorcerer's Bane:** When a creature teleports or casts a spell within 12 m of you, you can spend your reaction and try to counter it. The creature must roll a Resolve saving throw against your spell save DV. If the creature fails, their teleportation attempt or their spell fails. You can perform this ability again after you complete a short or a long rest.
- ❖ **Exterminator of Woe - Exterminator's Promise:** Once per turn you may reroll a missed weapon attack as part of the same attack action. You may perform this ability a number of times per long rest equal to your proficiency modifier.
 - **Hunter - Relentless Chaser:** You gain one of the following abilities of your choice.
 - **Volley:** You can use your action to make a ranged attack against any number of creatures within 2 m of a point you can see within your weapon's range. You must have ammunition for each target, as normal, and you make a separate attack roll for each target.

- **Whirlwind Strike:** You can use your action to make melee attacks against any number of creatures within 1 m of you, with a separate attack roll for each target.
- ❖ **Ranger - Whirlwind Strike:** As one natural weapon attack action, your partner may make an attack roll against all enemies within its range and deal damage as normal to all creatures that were hit successfully.
- ❖ **Realm Marshal - Flicker Attack:** Once per turn you may teleport 3 m to an unoccupied space you can see by temporarily displacing yourself in the Ethereal Plane. This movement does provoke an attack of opportunity if you teleport out of threat range.

Level 12

ASI or Feat [Predator]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 13

General Upgrade [Predator]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential

Level 14

Vanish [Predator]

You can use the hide action as a bonus action on your turn. Also, you can't be tracked by nonmagical means, unless you choose to leave a trail.

Level 15

Conclave [Predator]

- ❖ **Butcher of Behemoths - Butcher's Riposte:** If a marked creature by your Marked Foe ability forces you to roll a saving throw you may immediately make an attack roll against the marked creature if the creature is within your range or reach. If your attack successfully hits the marked creature, you deal damage as normal and you automatically succeed the saving throw.
- ❖ **Exterminator of Woe - Eluding Shade:** If you spend a reaction you may impose disadvantage on an attack roll targeting you as long as the attack wasn't made with advantage. You may perform this ability a number of times per long rest equal to your proficiency modifier.
- ❖ **Hunter - Superior Elusive Stalker:** You gain one of the following Abilities of your choice.
 - **Evasion:** When you are subjected to an effect that allows you to make a Dexterity saving throw to take only half damage, you instead take no damage if you succeed on the saving throw, and only half damage if you fail.

- **Stand Against the Tide:** When a hostile creature misses you with a melee attack, you can use your reaction to force that creature to repeat the same attack against another creature (other than itself) of your choice.
- **Uncanny Dodge:** When an attacker that you can see hits you with an attack, you can use your reaction to halve the attack's damage against you.
- ❖ **Ranger - Superior Feral Fury:** Your partner may spend a reaction to halve the damage from an attack it can see. In addition, all-natural weapon attacks your partner makes receives a bonus to hit equal to your Cunning modifier.
- ❖ **Realm Marshal - Ethereal Armor:** If you spend a reaction you may gain resistance against the damage type of an attack targeting you. You may perform this ability a number of times per long rest equal to your proficiency modifier.

Level 16

ASI or Feat [Predator]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 17

General Upgrade [Predator]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential

Level 18

Feral Senses [Predator]

When you attack a creature you can't see, your inability to see it doesn't impose disadvantage on your attack rolls against it. You are also aware of the location of any invisible creature within 6 m of you, provided that the creature isn't hidden from you and you aren't blinded or deafened. In addition, your Primeval Awareness' range increases to 20 km.

Level 19

ASI or Feat [Predator]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 20

Foe Slayer [Predator]

Each of your weapon and spell attacks receives a bonus to hit and damage equal to Cunning modifier.

[SOUL OATH]

HD: 1d12

Bonus Skill Points: None

Spellcasting: Minor

Level 1

Level 1 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Threaten [Soul Oath]

Choose a Soul Oath from below. Once per long rest as a bonus action, you can Threaten a creature that you can see. Threaten lasts you are incapacitated, until the target is incapacitated, or 10 rounds have passed.

Against a Threatened creature, you deal extra damage on weapon attacks equal to 1 + your [Soul Oath] level divided by 5 (rounded up and minimum 2). Threaten also includes an Oath effect that can be found below. You can Threaten one more time per long rest at every five-level picks of [Soul Oath] (including this level) to a maximum of four Threaten uses per long rest.

Secondary Selection

Born to Ride [Soul Oath]

Riding has become as easy as eating and breathing for you. You gain a number of benefits:

- ❖ You gain advantage on saving throws made to avoid falling off your mount.
- ❖ If you fall off and descend no more than 2 m, you land on your feet and you do not lose any movement as long as you are not incapacitated.
- ❖ Mounting or dismounting only costs 1 m of movement instead of half your speed.

Level 2

Level 2 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Vow [Soul Oath]

- ❖ **Aegis - Steadfast:** If you are wearing heavy armor, you can spend your reaction to gain resistance against bludgeoning, piercing, slashing until the start of your next turn. You can use this ability once per short rest. After 6 level picks of [Soul Oath], you can perform Steadfast twice per short rest, and after 14 level picks of [Soul Oath] thrice.
- ❖ **Aspiration - Braggadocio:** Once per short rest, as an action you may demoralize an opponent. Choose one creature within 6 m of you and make a Persuasion check with one ability score of your choice (once you have chosen it will remain that ability score for the rest of the game) against that creature's Empathy (Com). If your roll is higher than the creature's, they become demoralized for 1d4 turns. A demoralized target suffers -2 to its attack rolls, saving throws, and skill checks

for the duration. In addition, against demoralized targets, you gain a +2 bonus to your attack rolls.

- ❖ **Chivalry - Pristine Honor:** You gain proficiency with a saving throw of your choice. In addition, once per short rest, you may reroll one failed saving throw but you must keep the new result.
- ❖ **Loyalty - Got Your Back:** Whenever you use the help action to aid an ally they also receive advantage on any saving throw or skill check they make until the start of your next turn.
- ❖ **Templar - Uplifting Prayer:** As an action, you can mutter a prayer to yourself and receive a bonus equal to your Resolve modifier to one skill check, attack roll, or a saving throw of your choice at any point within 10 rounds. You must declare that you are using this ability before the roll is made. You can use this ability up to four times per long rest.
- ❖ **Vassalage - Call of the Monarch:** Once per short rest, all allies that can hear you and are within 12 m of you, receive advantage on saving throws against charm and fear effects for a number of rounds equal to the number of levels picks you to possess in [Soul Oath]. They also receive advantage to one attack roll of their choice that they can use at any point during the same duration. In addition, if a creature that can hear you and is within range has the charm or frightened condition when you activate this ability, they can immediately make another saving throw to resist the effect if that is allowed.

Secondary Selection

Fighting Style [Soul Oath]

- ❖ **Archery:** +2 attack rolls made with ranged weapons.
- ❖ **Defense:** While you're wearing armor, you gain a +1 bonus to AC.
- ❖ **Dueling:** When you're wielding a melee weapon in one hand and no other weapon, you gain a +2 bonus to damage rolls with that weapon.
- ❖ **Great Weapon Fighting:** When you roll a 1 or 2 on a damage die for an attack you make with a melee weapon that you're wielding with two hands, you can reroll the dice and must use the new results.
- ❖ **Protection:** When a creature you can see attacks a target other than you that is within 1 m of you, you can use your reaction to impose disadvantage on the attack roll. You must be wielding a shield.
- ❖ **Two-Weapon Fighting:** When you engage in two-weapon fighting, you can add your ability score modifier to the damage of the second attack.
- ❖

Level 3

Level 3 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Cavalry Charge [Soul Oath]

If you are mounted, you gain advantage on a weapon attack you make immediately after you move at least 2 m in a straight line.

Secondary Selection

Mighty Steed [Soul Oath]

You gain the Partner of the Wild ability from [Predator] but it can only take the form of a beast or animal you can ride into battle with.

Level 4

ASI or Feat [Soul Oath]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice.

Level 5

Extra Attack [Soul Oath]

As part of your attack action, you can make two attacks instead of one. You must possess at least 1 level of [Soul Oath] to be eligible for this ability (excluding this level).

Level 6

Master Handler [Soul Oath]

You receive a skill point with Animal Handling and you can gain rank 5 with it. In addition, mounts you are currently riding receive advantage to any mental or social saving throw.

Level 7

Vow [Soul Oath]

- ❖ **Aegis - Curb the Onslaught:** You gain the Sentinel feat.
- ❖ **Aspiration - Kill Steal:** You can make a free attack of opportunity against a target you are currently engaged in melee with immediately afterward another creature scores a critical hit against it.
- ❖ **Chivalry - Mounted Mastery:** Whenever you are mounted and an opponent makes a weapon attack roll against your mount, you may divert the attack by spending a reaction and making an attack roll of your own. If your attack roll is higher, you parry the attack and your mount takes no damage. You can use this ability a number of times per long rest equal to your Cunning modifier and you can only redirect a strike from a creature no more than one size larger than you.
- ❖ **Loyalty - Together:** Once per short rest, as an action you can give all allies within 6 m (including yourself) who can see and hear you a benefit for one round that you choose. Choose one benefit which ally receives (and choose one for yourself):
 - +2 to AC.
 - +2 to all attack rolls.
 - Move up to their speed without spending a movement action.
- ❖ **Templar - In the Service of the Divine:** For three rounds, you and all allies within 6 m of you that share your faith gain a bonus to your attack rolls and damage rolls equal to your Resolve modifier (minimum 1) by calling out the name of your Enneade as a bonus action. You can use this ability once per short rest, plus one additional time per short rest at 12 level picks of [Soul Oath] and every four level picks thereafter of [Soul Oath].

- ❖ **Vassalage - For the Crown:** For three rounds, you and all allies within 6 m of you that share your loyalties gain a bonus to your attack rolls and damage rolls equal to your Presence modifier (minimum 1) by calling out the name of your sovereign as a bonus action. You can use this ability once per short rest, plus one additional time per short rest at 12 level picks of [Soul Oath] and every four level picks thereafter of [Soul Oath].

Level 8

ASI or Feat [Soul Oath]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 9

Bonus Feat [Soul Oath]

Gain a bonus feat.

Level 10

Relentless Assault [Soul Oath]

If you hit a creature with a melee attack after you moved at least 2 m in a straight line whilst mounted, that target must succeed on a Brawn saving throw (DV 8 + your proficiency bonus + your Brawn modifier) or be knocked prone. You can use this ability only once on each of your turns.

Level 11

Great Charge [Soul Oath]

Gain the Charger feat. You may exchange one feat you possess for another.

Level 12

ASI or Feat [Soul Oath]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 13

Oppressive Threat [Soul Oath]

Targets that you have Threatened and are within your melee reach take -2 penalty to their AV from attacks made by anyone other than you.

Level 14

Unshakeable Focus [Soul Oath]

While the creature you have Threatened is within 1 m of you, it has disadvantage on any attack roll that doesn't target you.

Level 15

Vow [Soul Oath]

- ❖ **Aegis - Defend Feeble:** Once per short rest, you can spend a reaction to move up to your speed (or your mount's speed if you are mounted) towards an opponent and make one melee weapon attack. This movement must end adjacent to an enemy and it triggers attacks of opportunity as normal.
- ❖ **Aspiration - Push the Advantage:** Once per long rest, you gain a bonus equal to your proficiency bonus on your AV, ability checks, attack rolls, damage rolls, saving throws, and skill checks for a number of rounds equal to your Cunning modifier (minimum of 1).
- ❖ **Chivalry - Sacred Threat:** Once per long rest, you may increase the potency of your normal Threat ability to a Sacred Threat. When you use Sacred Threat you add your Resolve modifier to all attack rolls and damage rolls made against the target of your Threat. In addition, you gain a critical range of 18-20 against the target of your Threat.
- ❖ **Loyalty - United:** Once per short rest, if you spend an action you can grant all allies within 6 m of you that can hear and see you move up to their speed and make a melee attack as a reaction.
- ❖ **Templar - Avenger:** When you or an adjacent ally is hit with a melee attack, you may make an attack of opportunity with advantage against that creature. If they hit you or your ally suffered was a critical hit, you gain all benefits from your Threat ability against that creature for the purposes of your attack of opportunity, even if you are currently Threatening another creature. You can use this ability a number of times per long rest equal to your Resolve modifier.
- ❖ **Vassalage - Royal Bulwark:** As a reaction, you can redirect an attack made against a creature adjacent to you or yourself to another creature adjacent to you within reach or yourself. This ability must be declared before the attack roll is made. The attack is made against the new AV and defenses, even if the creature could not normally reach or attack the new target. You can use this ability a number of times per long rest equal to your Composure modifier (minimum 1). In addition, allies adjacent to you receive a +2 to their AC.

Level 16

ASI or Feat [Soul Oath]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 17

Bonus Feat [Soul Oath]

Gain a bonus feat.

Level 18

Acute Guardian [Soul Oath]

You gain another reaction per round in combat. This second reaction can only be used to make attacks of opportunity. You cannot use both of your reactions on the same turn.

Level 19

ASI or Feat [Soul Oath]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 20

Peerless Charge [Soul Oath]

Whenever you use the Charger feat you gain advantage on the attack and an improved critical range of 18-20. In addition, if you roll a critical hit on a charge attack while mounted, the target is stunned for 1d4 rounds.

EXTRA ABILITY ORIGIN CONTENT

Oaths [Soul Oath]

When you pick the Threaten ability or a Vow ability, you must choose an Oath and follow its decrees. If your GM considers you have broken your Oath, you lose the ability to Threaten. You can reclaim the ability to do so if you repent in a way your GM finds acceptable.

Aegis

You devote yourself to protect those who cannot protect themselves. Defending the common folk from danger and exploitation. You must offer your help when the meek calls for you, and give alms when needed. You cannot endanger or hurt the defenseless.
Threat: When you Threaten a creature you receive a +2 bonus to attack rolls against the creature you have Threatened. The bonus to attack rolls increases with +1 for every 6 level picks of [Soul Oath].

Aspiration

You swear an oath to yourself only and you care foremost about your own needs and goals. If the opportunity presents itself, you cannot refuse the chance to elevate yourself, be it wealth, status, or power. You cannot decline a reward or sacrifice your objectives for another cause.

Threat: If an ally would successfully hit the creature you have Threatened with a weapon attack, you may immediately spend a reaction and make a weapon attack of your own against that Threatened creature. You do not add your ability score modifier to the damage roll for the purposes of this weapon attack.

Chivalry

You devote your life to the Sacred Code, upholding its tenets to the best of your abilities.

"I will keep faith in the face of hopelessness

Be honest against my own benefit

Valorous despite my fear

Remain loyal to my oaths

Be honorable until my soul leaves me

Answer any challenge that stands before me

And protect the weak and the deserving"

Threat: Against creatures that have a higher CR rating than you do or are one size larger than you, you receive +2 to your attack rolls and +2 bonus to your weapon attack

damage against the creature if you have Threatened it. Every 6 level picks of [Soul Oath] both bonuses increase with +1.

Loyalty

You devote yourself to the virtue of loyalty, you commit yourself to a cause or a small number of allies, always having their back. All for one, and one for all. You must always offer aid to those you are loyal to, in or out of combat, even sacrificing yourself if necessary.

Threat: Your allies receive a +1 to their weapon attack rolls to hit the creature you have Threatened. Once per short rest, you can use the help action as a free action. You receive an additional free usage of the help action after 11 level picks of [Soul Oath] and the bonus your allies receive to hit increases to +2.

Templar

You devote yourself to an Enneade, its church, and its members. You must uphold the tenets of your Enneade, aid your church, and protect its members.

Threat: When you Threaten a creature you receive a +2 bonus to all saving throws as long as you are engaged in combat. The bonus to your saving throws increases with +1 for every 6 level picks of [Soul Oath].

Vassalage

You have sworn yourself to authority and devoted yourself to their cause. You must fight for your authority's interests, defend their territory, and protect their life.

Threat: When you Threaten a creature you receive a +1 bonus to your AV against attacks made by the creature you have Threatened. The bonus to your AV increases with +1 for every 6 level picks of [Soul Oath].

[SOUL WEAPON]

HD: 1d10

Bonus Skill Points: None

Spellcasting: Moderate

Level 1

Level 1 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Martial Arcanist [Soul Weapon]

You learn how to intertwine flinging spells and wielding weapons in combat. If you use your action to make one or several unarmed, melee weapons or ranged weapon attacks, you may cast a spell with a ranged or melee attack and a casting time of one action as a bonus action as long as you have a hand free for your casting. The highest level spell you can cast this way equals [Soul Weapon] level divided by 5 (rounded up and minimum level 1).

Both the unarmed or weapon attacks and the spell attack receive a -2 penalty to hit. If you use any Extra Attack, all the Extra Attacks and the spell attack receive an extra -1 penalty for each Extra Attack used in a turn.

Secondary Selection

Infuse Soul [Soul Weapon]

Once per long rest, you gain the ability to infuse your weapon with the power of your own Soul. As a bonus action, you may give your weapon a first level enhancement, +1 to hit and +1 to damage, for 10 rounds plus your Intelligence modifier (minimum of +1).

Level 2

Level 2 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Soul Weapon Archetype [Soul Weapon]

- ❖ **Cabalist - Undermine:** Instead of making a spell attack as part of the Martial Arcanist ability, you can choose to cast an enchantment or illusion spell that requires a saving throw, targets only one creature, and normally has a casting time of an action, as a bonus action. If you choose to cast an enchantment or illusion spell this way, your spell save DV is lowered by -2. If you use the Extra Attack ability, the penalty increases to -3.
- ❖ **Rival - Parry:** As a reaction, you may attempt to parry a melee attack targeting you if you are wielding a melee weapon of your own. Roll an opposed melee weapon attack with a +2 bonus to hit. If you roll higher than the incoming attack roll, you parry the attack and it does not deal damage to you. You can use this ability a number of times equal to your proficiency modifier per long rest and you can only parry Small or Medium-sized creatures this way.

- ❖ **Sage - Body, and Mind:** You gain the Martial Arts ability from the [Discipline] AO with some modifications and you replace all instances of [Discipline] with [Soul Weapon] for the purposes of the Martial Arts ability. The modifications are:
 - The armor you wear can now be up to medium armor.
 - This ability only applies to unarmed attacks, not attacks with the quarterstaff.
 - You do not gain the ability to make an unarmed attack as a bonus action if you use your action to make an unarmored attack.
 - You may apply your Infuse Soul ability on your unarmored attacks.
- ❖ **Soul Blade - Animated Weapon:** You learn to cast the spell Find Familiar as Soul Mastery once per long rest. You must still abide by the Soul Consumption requirement. When you cast Find Familiar this way, you add the flying sword to the list of creatures you can summon with the spell. If you summon a flying sword with this ability it gains a few changes:
 - The flying sword keeps its construct creature type.
 - The flying sword only has 4d6 HD.
 - The flying sword cannot speak and has no emotions, but it understands your commands and you can still communicate commands telepathically to it.
 - By spending your attack action you can command the flying sword to make a melee weapon or spell attack if it is within 20 m of you. This attack spends the flying sword's reaction.
- ❖ **Vanguard - Absorb:** You may add the AV bonus of a shield you are using to any saving throw you make against a spell or spell effect. In addition, you gain the War Caster feat.

Secondary Selection

Fighting Style [Soul Weapon]

- ❖ **Archery:** +2 attack rolls made with ranged weapons.
- ❖ **Defense:** While you're wearing armor, you gain a +1 bonus to AC.
- ❖ **Dueling:** When you're wielding a melee weapon in one hand and no other weapon, you gain a +2 bonus to damage rolls with that weapon.
- ❖ **Great Weapon Fighting:** When you roll a 1 or 2 on a damage die for an attack you make with a melee weapon that you're wielding with two hands, you can reroll the dice and must use the new results.
- ❖ **Protection:** When a creature you can see attacks a target other than you that is within 1 m of you, you can use your reaction to impose disadvantage on the attack roll. You must be wielding a shield.
- ❖ **Two-Weapon Fighting:** When you engage in two-weapon fighting, you can add your ability modifier to the damage of the second attack.

Soul Weapon Archetype [Soul Weapon]

- ❖ **Soul Blade - Health Infusion:** Your flying sword familiar gains a number of extra health points equal to your level in [Soul Weapon].

Level 3

Level 3 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Greater Soul Gift [Soul Weapon]

You unlock two minor magical powers in your Soul. Choose two Soul Gifts from the Soul Gift list. See below.

Secondary Selection

General Upgrade [Soul Weapon]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 4

ASI or Feat [Soul Weapon]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice.

Level 5

Extra Attack [Soul Weapon]

As part of your attack action, you can make two attacks instead of one. You must possess at least 1 level of [Soul Weapon] to be eligible for this ability (excluding this level).

Level 6

Soul Weapon Archetype [Soul Weapon]

- ❖ **Cabalist - Subtle Charmer:** Whenever you cast Charm Person you do not require a Verbal component. In addition, if you successfully afflict another creature with the effects of Charm Person, they do not know they were charmed by you after the spell ends.
- ❖ **Rival - Riposte:** If you successfully parry an attack using your Parry ability, you may immediately make an attack of opportunity with a +2 bonus to hit if the attacker is within your range as part of the same reaction.
- ❖ **Sage - Spellfist:** Your unarmed strikes count as magical. If you cast a spell as a bonus action first and use your attack action to make unarmed attacks as part of the Martial Arcanist ability, the unarmored damage you deal is converted into the spell's damage type.
- ❖ **Soul Blade - Power Infusion:** The damage your flying sword familiar makes is considered magical. In addition, your flying familiar gains first level weapon enhancement, +1 to hit, and damage. After 11 level picks of [Soul Weapon] this bonus increases to +2, and after 16 level picks it increases to +3.
- ❖ **Vanguard - Elemental Resilience:** If you possess a shield you may add an elemental resistance to that shield after you have rested. When you finish a long

rest, as an action, choose between cold, fire, or lightning. As long as you are wielding the shield, you gain resistance against the chosen damage type until you finish a long rest.

Level 7

Soul Gift [Soul Weapon]

You unlock one minor magical power in your Soul. Choose one Soul Gifts from the Soul Gift list. See below.

Level 8

ASI or Feat [Soul Weapon]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice.

Level 9

General Upgrade [Soul Weapon]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 10

Action Surge [Soul Weapon]

On your turn, you can take one additional action on top of your regular action and a possible bonus action. Once you use this ability, you must finish a short or long rest before you can use it again.

Level 11

Soul Weapon Archetype [Soul Weapon]

- ❖ **Cabalist - Thought Cutter:** Against creatures that are either charmed by you or affected by at least one of your enchantment or illusion spells that targets only one creature and requires a saving throw, you gain a number of benefits:
 - Your critical hit range increases 19-20 against the creature.
 - You gain advantage on your first attack roll against the creature on each of your turns.
- ❖ **Rival - Spell Parry:** You gain the ability to also parry spells that require an attack roll and targets you with your Parry ability. You oppose the spell attack roll with your melee attack roll. You may still use your Riposte ability in retaliation if the caster is within your range.
- ❖ **Sage - Enlightenment:** Whenever you use the Martial Arcanist ability to cast a melee or ranged attack spell that is of 1st level or higher as a bonus action, you may immediately cast a cantrip that requires a melee spell attack as part of the same bonus action. The cantrip suffers the same penalties to hit as your normal spell attack when using the Martial Arcanist ability.
- ❖ **Soul Blade - Alacrity Infusion:** While your flying weapon familiar is within 2m of you, your flying weapon can attack one additional time per turn.

- ❖ **Vanguard - Arcane Reflection:** As a reaction, you may attempt to reflect a spell that would hit you back at its caster. To reflect a spell this way, the spell must require a melee or ranged spell attack roll, it must target only you and you must wield a shield. Roll an opposed melee spell attack. If you roll higher than the incoming spell attack roll, you reflect the spell back at the caster and the spell deals damage to the caster instead of you. You can use this ability a number of times equal to half your proficiency modifier (rounded up) per long rest and you can only reflect spells that are less than, or equal to $\frac{1}{4}$ of your total level (rounded up) this way.

Level 12

ASI or Feat [Soul Weapon]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice.

Level 13

Soul Gift [Soul Weapon]

You unlock one minor magical power in your Soul. Choose one Soul Gifts from the Soul Gift list. See below.

Level 14

Greater Martial Arcanist [Soul Weapon]

Your insight into the mysteries of the occult and the martial broadens. When you use your Martial Arcanist ability your unarmed or weapon attacks and spell attack receive a penalty to hit equal to -1, instead of -2. The extra penalty from using Extra Attacks is still in effect.

Level 15

Counterstrike [Soul Weapon]

Whenever an opponent casts a spell whilst engaged with you, you may use your reaction to make an attack of opportunity against that target.

Level 16

ASI or Feat [Soul Weapon]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice.

Level 17

Soul Gift [Soul Weapon]

You unlock one minor magical power in your Soul. Choose one Soul Gifts from the Soul Gift list. See below.

Level 18

General Upgrade [Soul Weapon]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential

Level 19

ASI or Feat [Soul Weapon]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice.

Level 20

Arcane and Martial Mastery [Soul Weapon]

Your martial and arcane powers swell. You gain one more use of Action Surge. In addition, whenever you cast a spell whilst you are engaged in melee or ranged combat, you gain a benefit to that spell casting of your choice:

- ❖ Increase your spell save DV with +2.
- ❖ Ignore one damage resistance.
- ❖ Your spell attack gains a +2 to hit.

EXTRA ABILITY ORIGIN CONTENT

Soul Gifts

Whenever you pick a level in [Soul Weapon] you exchange one Soul Gift for another.

Agile Foresight

You add double your Dexterity modifier to your Dexterity saving throws.

Aquatic Alteration

You can breathe underwater for a number of minutes equal to 10 * your Intelligence modifier (minimum 1).

Delivery System

If you deliver a spell through a ranged weapon attack, the range of the spell becomes equal to the range of the weapon if that is greater than the spell's range.

Deny Magic

Once per short rest, when you make a melee or ranged attack, you may infuse your weapon attack with the Dispel Magic spell as Soul Mastery, delivering the spell through the weapon attack you make. If your attack misses, the Dispel Magic spell is wasted.

Divinatory Aptitude

You may learn one ability score value, one saving throw value, one resistance damage type, one immunity damage type, or a vulnerability damage type of a creature, when you perform a critical hit against it.

Elemental Strikes

You may turn your melee or ranged weapon damage to all fire, cold, or lightning damage a number of times per short rest equal to your Intelligence modifier (minimum 1).

Empowered Spell

Once per short or long rest, you may cast one spell with the Empowered Metamagic ability without sorcery points.

Enduring Soul Infusement

Your Infuse Soul ability now lasts for 10 rounds plus twice your Intelligence modifier (minimum 2).

Great Focus

Once per short or long rest, you may choose to succeed on a failed concentration check of your choice.

Holy Strikes

You may turn your melee or ranged weapon damage to all radiant or necrotic damage a number of times per short rest equal to your Intelligence modifier (minimum 1).

Martial Prowess

Once per long rest, for one full combat you gain +2 to your AV as a bonus action.

Martial Sprint

Once per long rest, you may cast Haste on yourself as a bonus action. If you do not already possess Haste as a spell known, you may add it to your spells known.

Occult Absorption

Gain one elemental resistance of your choice.

Precise Strikes

For a number of times equal to your proficiency modifier per long rest, you may add a bonus to hit with a melee attack equal to your Intelligence modifier.

Quickened Spell

Once per short or long rest, you may cast one spell with the Quickened Metamagic ability without sorcery points.

Schemes of Teranis

You gain two skill points in Deception and Stealth. You may gain rank 5 with both of these skills.

Subtle Spell

Once per short or long rest, you may cast one spell with the Subtle Metamagic ability without sorcery points.

Take Advantage

When you score a critical hit on your turn and haven't spent your bonus action, you may spend it and immediately cast a free melee spell attack as a bonus action if the critical hit was performed with a melee weapon, or as a free ranged spell if the critical hit was performed with a ranged weapon, as long as the spell delivered has a casting time of an action or less.

[TACTICS]

HD: 1d10

Bonus Skill Points: Extra

Spellcasting: Minor

Level 1

Level 1 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Action Surge [Tactics]

Once per short or long rest, you gain one more action in addition to your regular action on your turn.

Secondary Selection

Second Wind [Tactics]

Once per short or long rest, you may regain health points equal to 1d10 + your level in [Tactics] as a bonus action.

Level 2

Level 2 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Fighting style [Tactics]

- ❖ **Archery:** +2 attack rolls made with ranged weapons.
- ❖ **Defense:** While you're wearing armor, you gain a +1 bonus to AC.
- ❖ **Dueling:** When you're wielding a melee weapon in one hand and no other weapon, you gain a +2 bonus to damage rolls with that weapon.
- ❖ **Great Weapon Fighting:** When you roll a 1 or 2 on a damage die for an attack you make with a melee weapon that you're wielding with two hands, you can reroll the dice and must use the new results.
- ❖ **Protection:** When a creature you can see attacks a target other than you that is within 1 m of you, you can use your reaction to impose disadvantage on the attack roll. You must be wielding a shield.
- ❖ **Two-Weapon Fighting:** When you engage in two-weapon fighting, you can add your ability score modifier to the damage of the second attack.

Secondary Selection

Indomitable [Tactics]

Once per long rest, you may reroll a saving throw if you fail it. If you do so you must use the new roll.

Level 3

Level 3 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Martial Archetype [Tactics]

- ❖ **Beast Slayer - Slayer Technique:** You gain four Slayer Technique dice that are d8s. You regain all expended dice after you complete a short or long rest. You can spend one Slayer Technique die after you make the check but before the GM declares if it's a success or a fail:
 - An attack roll
 - A damage rollYou can spend Slayer Technique dice before or after you make:
 - A saving throw you are proficient in
 - A Perception check
 - An Empathy check
- ❖ **Bruiser - Savage Aggression:** If you deal damage through a weapon attack you deal an extra 1d4 damage.
- ❖ **Champion - Improved Critical:** Increase your critical range to 19. Whenever you score a critical hit you gain a number of temporary health points equal to 1d6 + your proficiency bonus.
- ❖ **Grandmaster - Weapon Techniques:** You learn three Weapon Techniques of your choice from below. You can apply one of your Weapon Techniques to an attack action you make. For your Weapon Techniques, you also gain a 4d8 Technique Die that you spend when you use a Weapon Technique. You acquire an additional 1d8 Technique Die after 7 level picks of [Tactics] and an extra 1d8 Technique Die after 15 level picks of [Tactics]. After you complete a long rest you regain all your spent Technique Dice. When you pick another level of [Tactics] you may exchange one Weapon Technique for another.
- ❖ **Spellblade - Soul Link:** You can perform a 1-hour ritual that allows you to link your soul to one weapon of your choice that you are holding. The ritual can be performed during a short rest and you can link with up to two weapons. A weapon that is linked to your Soul can be magically teleported to your hand as a bonus action as long as you are not incapacitated and the weapon resides in the same Realm as you. You can only teleport one weapon at a time. If you wish to link with another weapon, you can exchange one weapon for another by performing another ritual.
- ❖ **Spellbow - Arcane Projectile:** You learn two Arcane Projectile options. Once per turn, whenever you make a ranged weapon attack, as part of that attack action, you may apply an Arcane Projectile option to that projectile. Some Arcane Projectile options must be declared before the attack roll is made, others can be used after the ranged weapon attack is declared a hit. You may use this ability twice per short or long rest. See below.
- ❖ **Standard Bearer - United We Stand!:** You know how to rally your allies to inspire them to fight past their limits. Choose up to 3 allied creatures that are within 12 m of you and that can hear you. When you use your Second Wind ability each creature you chose gains health points equal to your [Tactics] level.

Secondary Selection

Martial Archetype [Tactics]

- ❖ **Beast Slayer - A Slayer's Secrets:** Once per long rest you can cast Protection from Radiant and Necrotic as Soul Mastery. In addition, you learn to cast Detect Magic as a ritual with Soul Mastery.
- ❖ **Spellblade - Arcane Talent:** You learn two cantrips.
- ❖ **Spellbow - Crucial Knowledge:** You gain two skill points in either Occult or Survival, your choice, and you may gain rank 5 with that skill. You learn either Prestidigitation or Druidcraft as Soul Mastery. Alternatively, you may take both skills (2 skill points in two skills, and can gain rank 5 with both) or learn both cantrips.

Level 4

ASI or Feat [Tactics]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 5

Extra Attack [Tactics]

As part of your attack action, you can make two attacks instead of one. You must possess at least 1 level of [Tactics] to be eligible for this ability (excluding this level).

Level 6

ASI or Feat [Tactics]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 7

Martial Archetype Abilities [Tactics]

- ❖ **Beast Slayer - Scourge of Giants:** Whenever you roll damage you may add two Slayer Technique Dice instead of one. If you damage a celestial, fey, fiend, monstrosity, or an undead you deal the maximum damage with your Slayer Technique Dice.
- ❖ **Bruiser - Fierce Resilience:** You may add 1d6 and add the result to any saving throw you make. This bonus applies to death saving throws as well. If your result to a death saving throw would be 20 or above this way, treat the result as a natural 20.
- ❖ **Champion - Olympic Vigor:** When you make a running long jump, the distance you can cover increases by a number of meters equal to half your Brawn or Dexterity modifier (your choice, rounded up, minimum 1). In addition, whenever you take the dash action you may make one melee or ranged weapon attack as a bonus action a number of times per long rest equal to your Vitality modifier (minimum 1).
- ❖ **Grandmaster - Knowledge is Power:** If you interact or observe another creature outside of combat for at least a minute, you learn some of their capabilities.

Choose two characteristics from below, your GM tells you if they are superior, inferior, or equal compared to you:

- Brawn score
 - Dexterity score
 - Vitality score
 - Armor Class
 - Current health points
 - Total level/CR
 - [Tactics] class levels, if any
- ❖ **Spellblade - Battle Focus:** By spending a bonus action you can make one weapon attack and cast a cantrip as an action.
 - ❖ **Spellbow - Enchanted Projectiles:** Projectiles from your ranged weapon attacks are considered magical for the purposes of overcoming resistance and immunity or nonmagical attacks and damage. After the projectile misses or hits, it immediately ceases to be magical. In addition, when you make a ranged weapon attack and do not hit, you may spend a bonus action to reroll the attack check against another target within 6 m of the original target.
 - ❖ **Standard Bearer - Illustrious Emissary:** You gain two skill points in two skills of your choice, and you may gain rank 5 for both of the chosen skills.

Level 8

ASI or Feat [Tactics]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 9

Bonus Feat [Tactics]

Gain a bonus feat, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 10

Martial Archetype [Tactics]

- ❖ **Beast Slayer - Improved Slayer Technique:** Your Slayer Technique Dice upgrades from d8s to d10s.
- ❖ **Bruiser - Improved Savage Aggression:** Upgrade your Savage Aggression's bonus damage one step. If you have taken all Savage Aggression abilities before this one you gain a 1d6 instead of a 1d4.
- ❖ **Champion - No Weaknesses:** Once per long rest, when the result on a weapon attack roll is a 1, you may change the result to a 19.
- ❖ **Grandmaster - Improved Technique:** Your Technique Dice upgrades from d8s to d10s.
- ❖ **Spellblade - Bewitching Force:** Until the end of your next turn, a creature is forced to roll any saving throw with disadvantage against spells you cast if you dealt the creature damage with a weapon attack.
- ❖ **Spellbow- Improved Arcane Projectile:** You learn another Arcane Projectile option of your choice.
- ❖ **Standard Bearer - Embolden:** Choose one allied creature that is within 12 m of you and that can hear you. When you use your Action Surge ability that creature can make one melee or ranged weapon attack as a reaction.

Level 11

Improved Extra Attack [Tactics]

As part of your attack action, you can make three attacks instead of one. You must possess at least 7 levels of [Tactics] to be eligible for this ability (excluding this level).

Level 12

ASI or Feat [Tactics]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 13

Indomitable [Tactics]

Once per long rest, you may reroll a saving throw if you fail it. If you do so you must use the new roll. If this is not the first time you have picked this ability, you gain another use of Indomitable per long rest.

Level 14

ASI or Feat [Tactics]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 15

Martial Archetype [Tactics]

- ❖ **Beast Slayer - Unrelenting:** If you have no Slayer Technique Dice left and you roll initiative, you regain one die of it.
- ❖ **Bruiser - Improved Savage Aggression:** Upgrade your Savage Aggression's bonus damage one step. If you have taken all Savage Aggression abilities before this one you gain a 1d8 instead of a 1d6. In addition, if you score a critical hit with a weapon attack you may add a bonus to the damage equal to your level picks of [Tactics]. You gain this benefit if you have picked all prior Savage Aggression abilities.
- ❖ **Champion - Greater Critical:** Your critical range increases to 18-20. In addition, when you score a critical hit you gain advantage on the next weapon attack you make.
- ❖ **Grandmaster - Unyielding:** If you have no Technique Dice left when you roll initiative, you regain one Technique Dice.
- ❖ **Spellblade - Sorcery Surge:** Before or after you use your Action Surge ability you may teleport up to 6 m to an unoccupied space you can see.
- ❖ **Spellbow - Keen Recovery:** If you have no uses of Arcane Projectile left and you roll initiative, you gain one use of it.
- ❖ **Standard Bearer - Bastion:** Choose one allied creature that is within 12 m of you and that can hear you. When you use your Indomitable ability to reroll a mental or social saving throw that creature can also reroll a mental or social saving throw against the same effect. Your chosen creature must keep the new result.

Level 16

Indomitable [Tactics]

Once per long rest, you may reroll a saving throw if you fail it. If you do so you must use the new roll. If this is not the first time you have picked this ability, you gain another use of Indomitable per long rest.

Level 17

Action Surge [Tactics]

Once per short or long rest, you gain one more action in addition to your regular action on your turn. If this is not the first time you have picked this ability, you gain another use of Action Surge per long rest.

Level 18

Martial Archetype [Tactics]

- ❖ **Beast Slayer - Improved Slayer Technique:** Upgrade your Slayer Technique Dice one step. If you have taken all Slayer Technique abilities before this one you gain a 1d12 instead of a 1d10.
- ❖ **Bruiser - Last One Standing:** Unless you have more than half your health points left or you are incapacitated, you regain health points equal to 5 + your Vitality modifier (minimum of +1) at the start of each of your turns. You do not gain this benefit if you have 0 health points. In addition, upgrade your Savage Aggression's bonus damage one step. If you have taken all Savage Aggression abilities before this one you gain a 1d10 instead of a 1d8.
- ❖ **Champion - Survivor:** At the start of each of your turns, you regain health points equal to 5+ your Vitality modifier if you have no more than half of your health points left. You do not gain this benefit if you have 0 health points.
- ❖ **Grandmaster - Improved Technique:** Your Technique Dice upgrades from d10s to d12s.
- ❖ **Spellblade - Improved Battle Focus:** You can now make a weapon attack as a bonus action whenever you use your action to cast a spell of any level.
- ❖ **Spellbow- Improved Arcane Projectile:** You learn another Arcane Projectile option of your choice.
- ❖ **Standard Bearer - Improved Embolden:** When you use your Embolden ability you can choose up to two allies within 12 of you instead of only one.

Level 19

ASI or Feat [Tactics]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 20

Greater Extra Attack [Tactics]

As part of your attack action, you can make four attacks instead of one. You must at least possess 17 levels of [Tactics] to be eligible for this ability.

EXTRA ABILITY ORIGIN CONTENT

Grandmaster: Weapon Techniques [Tactics]

Some of the Weapon Techniques require a saving throw. It equals 8 + proficiency bonus + Brawn or Dexterity modifier (your choice).

Accurate Strike

You can increase the accuracy of a weapon attack roll you make by spending a Technique Die before or after you make an attack roll, but before the GM declares the attack to be a hit or a miss. Roll your Technique Die and add it to your attack roll.

Assail of the Captain

During your attack action on your turn, you may spend a Technique Die and a bonus action to let an ally that you can see and hear immediately make a weapon attack action as a reaction. The ally receives the result of your Technique Die to their attack's damage die.

Block

You can reduce the damage of a melee attack that damages you by spending a Technique Die and a reaction. The damage is reduced by your Dexterity modifier in addition to the result of your Technique Die.

Dizzying Bash

You can attempt to disarm your target by spending a Technique Die when you successfully hit a creature with a weapon attack. The creature rolls a Brawn saving throw and on a fail drops an object to its feet of your choice. You add your Technique Die to the damage you deal with your weapon attack.

Drive Back

You can push a target back by spending a Technique Die when you successfully hit a creature with a weapon attack. The creature rolls a Brawn saving throw and on a fail gets pushed back 3 m away from you. You add your Technique Die to the damage you deal with your weapon attack.

Eluding Movement

You can add the result of one Technique Die to your AV when you spend movement this turn. When you stop moving you lose this benefit.

Encourage

You can encourage an ally of your choice by spending a Technique Die and a bonus action. A creature of your choice that can see gains temporary health points equal to your Presence modifier in addition to the result of your Technique Die.

Extended Strike

You can increase the reach of one melee weapon attack you make on your turn by spending one Technique Die. You add your Technique Die to the damage you deal if you hit with your melee weapon attack.

Falling Strike

You can knock a target prone by spending a Technique Die when you successfully hit a creature with a weapon attack. If the creature is large or smaller, it rolls a Brawn saving

throw and on a fail the target is knocked prone. You add your Technique Die to the damage you deal with your weapon attack.

Intimidating Strike

You can frighten a creature by spending a Technique Die when you successfully hit a creature with a weapon attack. The creature rolls a Resolve saving throw and on a fail becomes frightened of you until the end of your next turn. You add your Technique Die to the damage you deal with your weapon attack.

Misleading Attack

You can give an ally an opening for an attack by spending a Technique Die when you successfully hit a creature with a weapon attack. Until the start of your next turn, the next attack roll an ally makes has advantage. You add your Technique Die to the damage you deal with your weapon attack.

Plotting Strike

You can move one ally into a new position by spending a Technique Die when you successfully hit a creature with a weapon attack. An ally of your choice that can see and hear you can use its reaction to immediately move up to half its speed without provoking opportunity attacks from the target you hit with Plotting Strike. You add your Technique Die to the damage you deal with your weapon attack.

Provoking Strike

You can attempt to provoke a creature to attack you by spending a Technique Die when you successfully hit a creature with a weapon attack. The creature rolls a Composure saving throw and on a fail, until the end of your next turn, receives disadvantage on all of its attack rolls against targets other than you. You add your Technique Die to the damage you deal with your weapon attack.

Retort

You can immediately make a melee weapon attack against a creature that misses you with a melee attack by spending a Technique Die and a reaction. You add your Technique Die to the damage you deal if you hit with your melee weapon attack.

Ruse Strike

You may expend a Technique Die and a bonus action to receive advantage on the next weapon attack roll you make before the end of your turn. You add your Technique Die to the damage you deal if you hit with your weapon attack.

Spellbow: Arcane Projectile [Tactics]

Arcane Projectile is a magical effect that represents each school of Soul Magic. The assortment of Arcane Projectile options is presented here in alphabetical order. If you have not chosen an ability score for your spellcasting, choose one when you decide on your Arcane Projectile options.

Projectile of Charm

You infuse your projectile with Enchantment magic. Choose an ally within 6 m of the target hit by your projectile. The target must succeed on a Composure saving throw or be charmed by your chosen ally. The condition lasts for 5 rounds. The target may roll the saving throw again at the end of their turns to end the effect early. In addition to the

normal damage the Projectile of Charm deals, the target suffers an extra 2d6 psychic damage.

After you have picked 18 levels of [Tactics], the target suffers 4d6 psychic damage instead, in addition to Projectile of Charm's effects.

Projectile of Debilitation

You infuse your projectile in Necromantic magic. You force a creature hit by the projectile to roll a Vitality saving throw. On a failure, the target's weapon attacks deal half damage. The condition lasts for 5 rounds. The target may roll the saving throw again at the end of their turns to end the effect early. In addition to the normal damage the Projectile of Debilitation deals, the target suffers an extra 2d6 necrotic damage.

After you have picked 18 levels of [Tactics], the target suffers 4d6 necrotic damage instead, in addition to Projectile of Debilitation's effects.

Projectile of Exile

You infuse your projectile with Abjuration magic. You force a creature hit by the projectile to roll a Presence saving throw. On a failure, you temporarily banish the creature until the end of its next turn to their home Realm. They appear in a safe location where they are considered incapacitated and their speed is zero. The creature reappears again in its original spot if it is unoccupied. If not, the creature reappears in the closest vacant spot.

After you have picked 18 levels of [Tactics], the creature also suffers 2d6 force damage in addition to Projectile of Exilement's effects.

Projectile of Explosion

You infuse your projectile with Evocation magic. After your projectile successfully hits its target, the target and all other creatures in a 2 m radius take 2d6 force damage each. After you have picked 18 levels of [Tactics], creatures suffer 4d6 force damage instead.

Projectile of Hunting

You infuse your projectile with Divination magic. When you use this Arcane Projectile option you do not roll an attack roll. The projectile is flung towards a target that you saw less than a minute ago and is within your ranged weapon's range. It weaves and turns around corners if it has to, and ignores half and three-quarters cover. If the projectile reaches its target, the target makes a Dexterity saving throw. If the saving throw is a success, you learn their current location and the target takes your normal ranged weapon attack damage plus an additional 1d6 force damage. If the saving throw is a success you do not learn their location and they only suffer half damage.

After you have picked 18 levels of [Tactics], the target suffers 2d6 force damage instead, in addition to Projectile of Hunting's effects.

Projectile of the Phantasm

You infuse your projectile with Transmutation magic. When this projectile is fired it can move through objects and cover, and it flies like a 1 m wide and 6 m long line. When you use this Magical Discharge option you don't roll an attack roll for your attack action. Any creature within the trajectory of the projectile must succeed on a Dexterity saving throw or take the damage of the projectile plus additional 1d6 piercing damage. On a success, the creatures in the trajectory take half damage.

After you have picked 18 levels of [Tactics], the target suffers 2d6 piercing damage instead, in addition to the Projectile of the Phantasm's effects.

Projectile of Shade

You infuse your projectile with Illusion magic. If your projectile hits its target, the projectile obscures their vision until the start of your next turn. Your target must make a successful Resolve saving throw or take 2d6 psychic damage and not be able to see anything farther than 1 m away.

After you have picked 18 levels of [Tactics], the target suffers 4d6 psychic damage instead, in addition to Projectile of Hunting's effects.

Projectile of Thorns

You infuse your projectiles with Conjunction magic. The creature hit with your projectile is wrapped in thorny and poisonous vines. This effect lasts for 10 rounds or until the target or any other creature within 1 m of your target attempts to remove them. A successful Brawn: Athletics check against your spell DV ends the effect early.

On a hit, the target takes an extra 2d6 poison damage. As long as the vines are wrapped around the target its speed is reduced by 2 m and the first time on each of the target's turns when the target moves more than 1 m without teleporting, it takes an additional 2d6 slashing damage.

After you have picked 18 levels of [Tactics], the target suffers 4d6 poison and slashing damage instead, in addition to Projectile of Thorns' effects.

[UNIQUE ANCESTRY]

HD: 1d8

Bonus Skill Points: None

Spellcasting: Major

Level 1

Level 1 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Origin [Unique Ancestry]

- ❖ **Celestial - Blessed:** Once per short or long rest, you can roll a 2d4 and add it to a failed attack roll or saving throw, possibly exchanging failure for success.
- ❖ **Draconic - Natural Armor:** Your skin hardens and becomes more scale-like. When you aren't wearing armor, your AV equals 13 + your Dexterity modifier.
- ❖ **Flames - Ablazed Soul:** When you tap into your magical powers your very Soul becomes ablaze. As soon as you cast a spell that is of level one or higher, creatures of your choice within a 2 m radius centered on you take fire damage equal to half your [Unique Ancestry] level.
- ❖ **Penumbra - Shadow's Resilience:** If combat damage would bring you down to 0 health points you make an Int/Cun saving throw where the DV equals 5 plus the damage taken. If the saving throw is successful you remain at 1 health point instead. The saving throw is an automatic fail if the damage dealt was a critical hit or radiant damage. You may roll this saving throw again after you complete a long rest.
- ❖ **Tempest - Elevated Soul:** When you tap into your magical powers your Soul unleashes the storm within. Before or after you cast a spell that is of level one or higher, you gain 2 meters of flight by elemental gusts of wind. This movement does not provoke opportunity attacks.
- ❖ **Titan - Dictate of Order:** You gain three spells known at levels 1 and 3 of [Unique Ancestry]. The spells known you gain depends upon which true giant you possess a heritage of. Choose one:
 - **Cloud Titan:** At level one, you gain Fog Cloud and Minor Illusion, and at level 3 you gain Invisibility.
 - **Fire Titan:** At level one, you gain Burning Hands and Fire Bolt, and at level 3 you gain Flaming Sphere.
 - **Frost Titan:** At level one, you gain Armor of Cold and Frostbite, and at level 3 you gain Hold Person.
 - **Hill Titan:** At level one, you gain Heroism and Shillelagh, and at level 3 you gain Enlarge/Reduce.
 - **Stone Titan:** At level one, you gain Entangle and Resistance, and at level 3 you gain Spike Growth.
 - **Storm Titan:** At level one, you gain Shocking Grasp and Thunderwave, and at the third level you gain Gust of Wind.

Secondary Selection

Origin [Unique Ancestry]

- ❖ **Draconic - Draconic Ancestry:** Any ability check you make involving Presence or Manipulation when interacting with dragons is considered to possess at least four skill points in the appropriate skill. You gain 2 skill points in Academics (the draconic language). Additionally, you gain +1 to your health points now, and +1 health points whenever you level up.
- ❖ **Penumbra - Vision of the Deep:** You learn the Darkness spell as Soul Mastery when you reach level 3 of [Unique Ancestry]. You may cast Darkness by spending 2 sorcery points, if you do, you can see through the magical darkness you created with the spell. In addition, you gain a darkvision with a range of 24 m.
- ❖ **Tempest - Tongue of the Primordials:** Any ability check you make involving Presence or Manipulation when interacting with elementals are considered to possess at least four skill points in the appropriate skill. You gain 2 skill points in Academics (the Primordial language). Additionally, you gain +1 to your health points now, and +1 health points whenever you level up.
- ❖ **Titan - Giants' Endurance:** Any ability check you make involving Presence or Manipulation when interacting with giants are considered to possess at least four skill points in the appropriate skill. You gain 2 skill points in Academics (the giant language). Additionally, you gain +1 to your health points for every level you possess, and +1 health points whenever you level up.

Level 2

Level 2 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Font of Magic [Unique Ancestry]

You have 2 sorcery points, and you gain one additional point every time you pick a level of [Unique Ancestry], to a maximum of 20 sorcery points at level 20. You can use your sorcery points in three ways:

- ❖ **Spend Sorcery Points for Spell Slots:** You can transform unexpended sorcery points into one spell slot as a bonus action on your turn. The created spell slots vanish at the end of a long rest. A level 1 spell slot cost 2 sorcery points, and every level thereafter for the spell cost costs an additional 1 sorcery point. You can create spell slots no higher in level than 5th.
- ❖ **Spend Spell Slots for Sorcery Points:** You can transform unused spell slots into sorcery points as a bonus action on your turn. The created sorcery points vanish at the end of a short rest. A level 1 spell slot creates 2 sorcery points, and every level thereafter generates an additional 1 sorcery point.
- ❖ **Metamagic or Abilities:** You can spend sorcery points on abilities and metamagic options.

You regain all spent sorcery points when you finish a long rest.

Secondary Selection

General Upgrade [Unique Ancestry]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 3

Level 3 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Metamagic [Unique Ancestry]

You gain two of the following Metamagic options of your choice. You can use only one Metamagic option on a spell when you cast it unless otherwise noted.

- ❖ **Careful Spell:** When you cast a spell that forces other creatures to make a saving throw, you can protect some of those creatures from the spell's full force. To do so, you spend 1 sorcery point and choose a number of those creatures up to your Presence modifier (minimum of one creature). A chosen creature automatically succeeds on its saving throw against the spell.
- ❖ **Distant Spell:** When you cast a spell that has a range of 1 m or greater, you can spend 1 sorcery point to double the range of the spell. When you cast a spell that has a range of touch, you can spend 1 sorcery point to make the range of the spell 6 m.
- ❖ **Empowered Spell:** When you roll damage for a spell, you can spend 1 sorcery point to reroll a number of the damage dice up to your Presence modifier (minimum of one). You must use the new rolls.
- ❖ You can use Empowered Spell even if you have already used a different Metamagic option during the casting of the spell.
- ❖ **Extended Spell:** When you cast a spell with a duration of 10 rounds or longer, you can spend 1 sorcery point to double its duration, to a maximum duration of 24 hours.
- ❖ **Heightened Spell:** When you cast a spell that forces a creature to make a saving throw to resist its effects, you can spend 3 sorcery points to give one target of the spell disadvantage on its first saving throw made against the spell.
- ❖ **Hunting Spell:** A spell you cast that requires a Dexterity saving throw or an attack roll ignores three-quarters and half cover by spending 1 sorcery point.
- ❖ **Quicken Spell:** When you cast a spell that has a casting time of 1 action, you can spend 2 sorcery points to change the casting time to 1 bonus action for this casting.
- ❖ **Primordial Spell:** You may change the damage type of a spell by spending 1 sorcery point. You may change the damage type of a spell that deals acid, cold, fire, lightning, or thunder to another damage type mentioned in this list.
- ❖ **Subtle Spell:** When you cast a spell, you can spend 1 sorcery point to cast it without any somatic or verbal components.
- ❖ **Twinned Spell:** When you cast a spell that targets only one creature and doesn't have a range of self, you can spend a number of sorcery points equal to the spell's level to target a second creature in range with the same spell (1 sorcery point if the spell is a cantrip).

To be eligible for Twinned Spell, a spell must be incapable of targeting more than one creature at the spell's current level.

Secondary Selection

General Upgrade [Unique Ancestry]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 4

ASI or Feat [Unique Ancestry]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 5

Improved Magical Upgrade [Unique Ancestry]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential
- ❖ +1 to an ability score of your choice
- ❖ Pick an additional feat from the feat list

Level 6

Origin [Unique Ancestry]

- ❖ **Celestial - Potent Recovery:** Once per turn you may reroll dice from a spell that restores health points that you or an ally cast within 1 m of you. If you aren't incapacitated, you may spend 1 sorcery upgrade to reroll any number of dice that restore health points and you must keep the new result.
- ❖ **Draconic - Elemental Affinity:** If you have not already done so, choose one chromatic or metallic dragon as your ancestor. When you cast a spell that deals damage of the type associated with your draconic ancestry, add your Presence modifier to that damage (minimum 1). The damage bonus applies to one damage roll of a spell, not multiple rolls. At the same time, you can spend 1 sorcery point to gain resistance to that damage type for 1 hour.
- ❖ **Flames - Blood on Fire:** Spells you cast ignore resistance to fire. Once per long rest you can dash action as a free action. In addition, once per short rest, you may increase your movement speed by 3 m for one turn.
- ❖ **Penumbra - Dire Shade:** If you spend 3 sorcery points you can summon a spectral hound as a bonus action. The Dire Shade uses the dire wolf's statistics with a few changes:
 - Choose a target for the Dire Shade. The Dire Shade can only move directly towards its target, attack, and perform opportunity attacks against its target.
 - You can summon the Dire Shade up to 24 m away from you in an unoccupied space you can see. However, the Dire Shade cannot be summoned within 6 m of the target.

- When the Dire Shade appears, roll initiative for it.
- It's health point total equals half your total level.
- The Dire Shade can move through objects as they were thick liquid. The Dire Shade treats any square with a creature or an object as difficult terrain. However, if it would end its turn inside of an object or a creature, the Dire Shade takes 5 force damage.
- The Dire Shade always knows its target's location, regardless of any invisibility, hidden conditions, etc.
- The Dire Shade's target has disadvantage against any spell you cast as long as the spectral hound is within 1 m of its target.
- The Dire Shade is a medium creature and counts as a beast.
- When the Dire Shade is brought down to 0 health points, its target is brought down to 0 health points, or 5 minutes has passed, it disappears.
- ❖ **Tempest - Lightning Veins:** When you tap into your tempestuous powers your Soul crackles with lightning. As soon as you cast a spell that deals lightning or thunder damage and is of level one or higher, creatures of your choice within a 2 m radius centered on you take lightning or thunder damage (you may choose which damage type every time you use this ability) equal to half your [Unique Ancestry] level. In addition, you are resistant to lightning and thunder damage.
- ❖ **Titan - Mark of Ouskira:** Depending upon your Dictate of Order ability, you gain a benefit whenever you cast one of the spells given by the ability.
 - **Cloud Titan:** As a bonus action you can teleport up to 2 + your Vitality modifier (minimum +1) m away to an unoccupied space you can see. This benefit triggers immediately after you cast any of your Dictate of Order spells.
 - **Fire Titan:** Your Dictate of Order spells gain a bonus to their damage equal to your Vitality modifier (minimum of +1).
 - **Frost Titan:** You gain temporary health points equal to your Vitality modifier (minimum 1). If the spell cast was Armor of Cold, you instead increase its temporary health points equal to your Vitality modifier (minimum of +1). This benefit triggers immediately after you cast any of your Dictate of Order spells.
 - **Hill Titan:** Within 1 m of you, you can target up to two creatures you can see and force them to make a Brawn saving throw against your spell save DV. If a creature fails this saving throw, willingly or not, they are pushed a number of m away from you equal to 1 + your Vitality modifier (minimum +1). This benefit triggers immediately after you cast any of your Dictate of Order spells.
 - **Stone Titan:** Until the end of your next turn, your AV receives a bonus equal to your Vitality modifier (minimum +1). This benefit triggers immediately after you cast any of your Dictate of Order spells.
 - **Storm Titan:** Choose up to three creatures you can see within 6 m of you, they take lightning damage equal to your Vitality modifier (minimum 1). This benefit triggers immediately after you cast any of your Dictate of Order spells.

Level 7

General Upgrade [Unique Ancestry]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 8

ASI or Feat [Unique Ancestry]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 9

General Upgrade [Unique Ancestry]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 10

Metamagic [Unique Ancestry]

Gain another Metamagic option.

Level 11

General Upgrade [Unique Ancestry]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential

Level 12

ASI or Feat [Unique Ancestry]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 13

General Upgrade [Unique Ancestry]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential

Level 14

Origins [Unique Ancestry]

- ❖ **Celestial - Take Flight:** Your back sprouts a pair of spectral wings, in a style of your choosing, as a bonus action. Whilst you possess your wings you gain a flying speed of 6 m. The wings persist until you dismiss them as a bonus action, you become incapacitated or die.
- ❖ **Draconic - Dominate the Skies:** Your back sprouts a pair of draconic wings as a bonus action. Whilst you possess your wings you gain a flying speed equal to your current walking speed. The wings persist until you dismiss them as a bonus action, you become incapacitated or die. You can't manifest your wings while wearing armor unless the armor is made to accommodate them, and clothing not made to accommodate your wings might be destroyed when you manifest them.
- ❖ **Flames - Heated Ire:** You gain resistance to fire damage. In addition, you can use your reaction to deal fire damage equal to your total level to a creature who hit you by a melee attack.
- ❖ **Penumbra - Slippery Darkness:** As a bonus action, you can teleport up to a spot you can see within 24 m of you. To teleport, you must be in darkness or dim light, and the spot you teleport to must also be in darkness or dim light. You can teleport a number of times per long rest equal to your proficiency bonus.
- ❖ **Tempest - Retributional Discharge:** You can use your reaction to deal lightning damage equal to your total level to a creature who hit you by a melee attack. The creature must also succeed in a Brawn saving throw against your spell save DV or be pushed 4 m away from you in a straight line.
- ❖ **Titan - Soul of Ouskira:** For 10 rounds or until you are incapacitated, when you expend a spell slot and start casting a spell, you gain all of the following benefits:
 - Your size and your equipment's size increases by one category.
 - Your reach increases by 1 m.
 - Your health points total gains a number of health points equal to your total level.
 - Your walking speed increases with 1 m.
 - You gain advantage on any Brawn checks and saving throws.
 - Your melee weapon attacks deal more damage equal to your Vitality modifier (minimum 1).

You can use this ability again after you complete a short or long rest.

Level 15

Improved Magical Upgrade [Unique Ancestry]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 30 Potential
- ❖ Three skill points to assign in any skill or skills of your choice, or to store
- ❖ +1 to an ability score of your choice
- ❖ Pick a feat from the feat list

Level 16

ASI or Feat [Unique Ancestry]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 17

Metamagic [Unique Ancestry]

Gain another Metamagic option.

Level 18

Origin [Unique Ancestry]

- ❖ **Celestial - Ethereal Resurgence:** You can regain a number of health points equal to half your health point maximum as a bonus action, if you have been brought down to less than half of your health point maximum. After you use this ability, you must complete a long rest before you can use it again.
- ❖ **Draconic - Draconic Presence:** If you spend 5 sorcery points, you may ooze an aura of awe or fear with a range of 12 m as an action. For 10 rounds or until you lose your concentration (as if you were concentrating on a spell), each hostile creature that starts its turn in this aura must succeed on a Composure saving throw (if you chose awe) or a Resolve saving throw (if you chose fear) or be charmed by you or frightened of you until the aura ends. A creature that succeeds on this saving throw is immune to your aura for 24 hours.
- ❖ **Flames - Flaming Spirit:** Any spell or effect you create treats immunity to fire damage as resistance, and ignores resistance to fire damage. Additionally, you gain immunity to fire damage.
- ❖ **Penumbra - Form of Shadows:** As a bonus action you can transform yourself into a form of shadows that lasts for 10 rounds or until you are incapacitated. You can end this effect early if you spend a bonus action. By spending 6 sorcery points you gain resistance to all damage, excluding radiant and force damage. You can move through creatures and objects as if they were only difficult terrain but if you end your turn within an object or creature you suffer 5 force damage.
- ❖ **Tempest - Spirit of Storms:** The wind allows you to always soar. You gain a flying speed of 12 m. You can command the air to lift up a number of creatures of your choice equal to 3+ your Cunning modifier (minimum 1) as an action. They can fly with you for up to an hour but your flying speed, and their flying speed, equals 6 m for the duration. You must complete a short or long rest to use this ability again on other creatures than you. Additionally, you are immune to lightning and thunder damage.
- ❖ **Titan - Titanic Favor:** You can use your Soul of Ouskira ability two times more in between rests, but not whilst a use of Soul of Ouskira is in effect. Additionally, your Vitality score increases with +2, to a maximum of 22.

Level 19

ASI or Feat [Unique Ancestry]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 20

Unsealed Ancestral Power [Unique Ancestry]

Regain four sorcery points when you finish a short rest and you may apply two Metamagic effects on one spell.

[WORLD MAGIC]

HD: 1d8

Bonus Skill Points: None

Spellcasting: Major

Level 1

Level 1 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Wild Shape [World Magic]

As an action, you can transform into an animal or beast that you have seen before. Your level picks in [World Magic] determines the beasts and animals you can transform into.

Level	Max CR	Limitations	Example
1st	1	No swim or fly speed	Wolf
4th	2		Crocodile
8th	3		Giant Eagle

You can remain transformed with Wild Shape for a number of hours equal to half your [World Magic] level picks (rounded down). You then revert to your normal form unless you use this ability again. You can revert to your normal form earlier by using a bonus action on your turn. You automatically revert if you fall unconscious, drop to 0 health points, or die.

If you would use this ability twice per short or long rest, the second transformation is less potent than the first. Subtract one health dice from the total health dice pool of the animal or beast every time you use this ability except for the first transformation, and use the new health point total. This penalty resets when you finish a long rest. However, this penalty can not reduce a transformation to lower than 1 health dice.

You can use this ability once per short or long rest. After 2 level picks of [World Magic] you can use this ability twice per short or long rest.

While you are transformed, the following rules apply:

- ❖ Your game statistics are replaced by the statistics of the beast or animal, but you keep your mental and social ability scores, as well as your personality. You also keep all of your skill points and saving throw proficiencies, in addition to gaining those of the creature. If the creature has the same proficiency as you and the bonus in its stat block is higher than yours, use the creature's bonus instead of yours. If the creature has any legendary or lair actions, you can't use them.
- ❖ When you transform, you assume the animal or beast's health points and health dice. When you revert to your normal form, you return to the number of health points you had before you transformed. However, if you revert as a result of dropping to 0 health points, any excess damage carries over to your normal form. For example, if you take 10 damage in a Wild Shape form and have only 1 health

point left, you revert and take 9 damage. As long as the excess damage doesn't reduce your normal form to 0 health points, you aren't knocked unconscious.

- ❖ You can't cast spells, and your ability to speak or take any action that requires hands is limited to the capabilities of your Wild Shape form. Transforming doesn't break your concentration on a spell you've already cast, however, or prevent you from taking actions that are part of a spell, such as Call Lightning, that you've already cast.
- ❖ You keep the benefit of any ability from your AOs, race, or other source and can use them if the new form is physically capable of doing so. However, you can't use any of your special senses, such as darkvision, unless your new form also has that sense.
- ❖ You choose whether your equipment falls to the ground in your space, merges into your new form, or is worn by it. Worn equipment functions as normal, but the GM decides whether it is practical for the new form to wear a piece of equipment, based on the creature's shape and size. Your equipment doesn't change size or shape to match the new form, and any equipment that the new form can't wear must either fall to the ground or merge with it. Equipment that merges with the form does not affect you until you leave the form.

Secondary Selection

Cantrips [World Magic]

Gain two cantrips of your choice.

Level 2

Level 2 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

Circle [World Magic]

- ❖ **Athronna - Mythical Resilience:** As an action, you can recover one spell slot of the 2nd level or two spell slots of 1st level. After 10 level picks of [World Magic] you can recover a 3rd level spell slot or two 2nd level. You can't use this ability again until you finish a long rest.
- ❖ **Pateph- Toxic Response:** As a reaction, you can fire toxic matter at other creatures on your turn. (You choose how your Toxic Response ability looks, examples include spikes, spores, fumes, grenades, etc.) This ability deals 3 poison damage to one creature within 2 m of you that you can see. This damage increases to 6 poison damage after 6 level picks of [World Magic], 9 poison damage after 9 level picks of [World Magic], and 12 poison damage after 14 level picks of [World Magic].
- ❖ **Verhet - Spirit Companion:** You delve into the mysteries of the dead Enneade of spring and learn how to summon incorporeal spirits. Once per short or long rest, you can summon a spirit on an unoccupied space you can see within 12 m of you as a bonus action. On subsequent turns, you can move it up to 12 m to another point you can see by spending a bonus action. Even if the spirit takes the form of a creature, it does not count as a creature, nor an object. The spirit remains for 10 rounds or until you are incapacitated. The spirit possesses an aura of 6 m radius that grants effects depending on its type.
Choose the spirit's form and aura from below when you summon it:

- **Mother Ursa:** All creatures of your choice within the range of the aura gain temporary health points equal to your total level + 5 when this spirit appears. All creatures of your choice within the aura also receive advantage on Brawn checks and Brawn saves as long as they remain within the aura.
- **The Vigilant Eagle:** All creatures of your choice within the range of the aura have advantage on all Perception checks when this spirit appears. If an ally would make an attack roll against a target within the aura, you can spend your reaction to give your ally advantage on the attack roll.
- **Python of Binding:** All creatures of your choice within the range of the aura have advantage on ability checks made to detect other creatures within the aura when this spirit appears. Whenever you cast a spell that heals health points of allies both within and outside of the aura, all creatures of your choice within the aura also gain a number of health points equal to your total level.
- ❖ **Vettias - Circle Transformations:** You focus your connection to the World to understand the nature of Souls and how to transform your Soul's physical expression. You must still abide by all limitations of Wild Shape, but you can now use your Wild Shape to become an animal or a beast of challenge rating 1 or less. Your bonuses increase as you pick levels in [World Magic]. After 6 level picks of [World Magic] you can transform into an animal or a beast of a challenge rating equal to your level in [World Magic] divided by 3 (rounded down). Any transformation into a beast or animal of challenge rating higher than 1 receives a harsher penalty to its health dice. For every transformation after the first, lower the health dice by two instead of one.
- ❖ **Zestos - Agent of Preservation:** Your connection with the World has allowed you to tap into the powers of preservation. You have a healing pool of d6s equal to your level picks of [World Magic]. As a bonus action, you can heal a creature of your choice within 24 m. You roll the dice, add the results together and your target regains health points equal to the result. Your target also receives a number of temporary health points equal to the number of dice you roll from your healing pool. You can't spend more than half your healing pool on one turn and you regain your spent healing dice after a long rest.

Secondary Selection

Circle [World Magic]

- ❖ **Pateph- Toxic Awakening:** Whenever you use your Wild Shape ability you can choose to transform as per normal or honor Pateph, the dead Enneade of disease and pestilence, by awakening your toxicity instead. If you do, you gain a number of benefits that last for 10 minutes or until you activate your Wild Shape ability again.
 - If you possess the Toxic Response ability its damage doubles.
 - You gain temporary health points equal to 3 times your level picks in [World Magic].
 - Any successful melee weapon attack deals an extra 1d6 poison damage.
- ❖ **Vettias - Improved Wild Shape:** Your connection to the dead Enneade of wisdom and skill broadens. You can now transform with Wild Shape as a bonus action. In addition, whilst using Wild Shape you can spend a bonus action to regain health points by expending one spell slot. The health points gained equals an 1d8 per level of the spell slot expended.

Level 3

Level 3 offers two Selections.

Primary Selection

General Upgrade [World Magic]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Secondary Selection

General Upgrade [World Magic]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 4

ASI or Feat [World Magic]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 5

Improved Magical Upgrade [World Magic]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential
- ❖ +1 to an ability score of your choice
- ❖ Pick an additional feat from the feat list

Level 6

Circle [World Magic]

- ❖ **Athronna - Summer's Stride's:** Moving through nonmagical difficult terrain costs you no extra movement. You can also pass through nonmagical or magical plants without being slowed by them and without taking damage from them if they have thorns, spines, or a similar hazard.
In addition, you have advantage on saving throws against plants that are magically created or manipulated to impede movement, such as those created by the Entangle spell.
- ❖ **Pateph- Spread the Disease:** If your Toxic Response ability would kill a humanoid it is transformed into a zombie. The zombie animates at the end of your turn and its turn in the initiative order is immediately after yours. You can command the zombie telepathically but the only action the zombie can take is one melee attack action per turn. The zombie collapses when it is either defeated in combat or after an hour.

- ❖ **Verhet - Potent Conjurer:** Beasts, animals, and fey conjured by you are more potent. Creatures conjured by you gain a bonus to their health points equal to +2 for each health dice they possess. In addition, their natural weapon attacks are now considered magical for the purpose of overcoming immunities and resistance to nonmagical attacks and damage.
- ❖ **Vettias - Magical Excellence:** When you use your Wild Shape ability, your natural weapon attacks are considered magical for the purpose of overcoming resistances and immunities to nonmagical attacks and damage.
- ❖ **Zestos - Dome of Recuperation:** Whenever you start a rest, you may touch a location and a 6 m radius sphere of obscuring magic appears on that point. The sphere is invisible and is blocked by total cover. Sources of light from within the sphere are not visible outside of it. In addition, any number of creatures of your choice inside the sphere gain a +5 bonus to Perception and Stealth checks. This effect disappears whenever you leave the sphere or your rest is over.

Level 7

Greater Wild Shape [World Magic]

You gain another use of Wild Shape per short rest.

Level 8

ASI or Feat [World Magic]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 9

General Upgrade [World Magic]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ One point to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 10 Potential

Level 10

Circle [World Magic]

- ❖ **Athronna - Summer's Ward:** You can't be charmed or frightened by elementals or fey, and you are immune to poison and disease.
- ❖ **Pateph - Infest:** Instead of using your Toxic Response ability you can hurl all your projectiles into a 2m cube to a point you can see up to 6 m away as a reaction. The cube persists for 10 rounds or until you use this ability again, and whilst it is active you cannot use your Toxic Response ability. Any creature that starts its turn inside of the cube takes damage from your Toxic Response.
- ❖ **Verhet - Spring's Embrace:** If a fey, animal, or beast that you have conjured ends their turn inside of your Spirit Companion's aura, that summoned creature may recover a number of health points equal to half your total level.
- ❖ **Vettias - Primordial Kinship:** You gain the ability to transform into an air, earth, fire, and water elemental, by expending two uses of your Wild Shape ability at once.

- ❖ **Zestos - Moment of Salvation:** You can teleport up to 12 m to an unoccupied space you can see as a bonus action. You may bring a willing creature with you as you teleport but then you must spend an action instead of a bonus action. You can use this ability a number of times equal to your Cunning modifier (minimum 1), and you recover all your expended uses of it when you finish a long rest.

Level 11

General Upgrade [World Magic]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 20 Potential

Level 12

ASI or Feat [World Magic]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 13

Greater Wild Shape [World Magic]

You gain another use of Wild Shape per short rest.

Level 14

Circle [World Magic]

- ❖ **Athronna - Summer's Sanctuary:** When a beast, animal, or plant creature attacks you, that creature must make a Composure saving throw against your spell save DV. On a failed save, the creature must choose a different target, or the attack automatically misses. On a successful save, the creature is immune to this effect for 24 hours. The creature is aware of this effect before it makes its attack against you.
- ❖ **Pateph - Master of Disease:** If you are dealt damage from a critical hit you do not suffer the extra damage of the critical hit. In addition, you are immune to the conditions of blinded, deafened, frightened, and poisoned.
- ❖ **Verhet - Loyal Companions:** Once per long rest, whenever you are incapacitated against your will you may cast conjure animals as a 9th level spell for free. In this case, the spell requires no concentration or components. The spell conjures four beasts or animals of challenge rating 2 or lower. They protect you and attack any enemies until they can receive other orders from you. This ability lasts until you dismiss it, no action required, or for an hour.
- ❖ **Vettias - Endless Expression:** You can cast the spell Alter Self as Soul Mastery and at will.
- ❖ **Zestos - Path to Salvation:** Once per long rest, you can cast either Scrying or Teleportation Circle as Soul Mastery when you have finished a short rest. The cast of Teleportation Circle is different. Instead of teleporting to another Teleportation Circle, it opens a gateway to the last location where you completed a long rest if you remain within the same Realm. If you have not finished a long rest in the Realm, the cast of the spell fails but this ability is not wasted.

Level 15

Improved Magical Upgrade [World Magic]

Gain one of your choices:

- ❖ Two points to use in the Accomplishment section or to store for later purchase in the same section
- ❖ 30 Potential
- ❖ Three skill points to assign in any skill or skills of your choice or to store
- ❖ +1 to an ability score of your choice
- ❖ Pick a feat from the feat list

Level 16

ASI or Feat [World Magic]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 17

Nurture of Nature [World Magic]

For every 10 years that pass, your body ages only 1 year.

Level 18

Bestial Magic [World Magic]

You can cast any spell, regardless of somatic or verbal components, as long as it does not require Soul consumption whilst you are transformed with your Wild Shape ability.

Level 19

ASI or Feat [World Magic]

You can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or two by one. Or gain a feat of your choice, you must meet the prerequisites of it.

Level 20

The World's Herald [World Magic]

You can use your Wild Shape an unlimited number of times (except for elementals where you still need to spend Wild Shape uses like normal) but you still suffer the health dice penalty as normal. Additionally, when you are transformed with your Wild Shape ability you ignore the verbal and somatic components of spells.

STEP 7 – POTENTIAL

Step 7 is about purchasing spellcasting or establishing your Exaltation options and pool.

The spellcasting tag of an ability origin either states, “Minor,” “Moderate,” or “Major,” which corresponds to a value of Potential. You can spend the Potential you accumulate on Exaltation or spellcasting (if you and your GM has agreed you have it). The amount of Potential you receive every level depends upon your spellcasting tag and your total level.

POTENTIAL GAIN PER LEVEL AND TAG

Minor

Level 1-5: 20 Potential per level
Level 6-10: 30 Potential per level
Level 11-15: 40 Potential per level
Level 16-20: 50 Potential per level

Moderate

Level 1-5: 40 Potential per level
Level 6-10: 50 Potential per level
Level 11-15: 60 Potential per level
Level 16-20: 70 Potential per level

Major

Level 1-5: 60 Potential per level
Level 6-10: 100 Potential per level
Level 11-15: 140 Potential per level
Level 16-20: 180 Potential per level

SPEND POTENTIAL ON EXALTATION

All characters can exalt their Soul to push themselves further than what they normally can achieve. By digging deep into your own Soul, you can manifest your own power to enhance yourself, some spend their Potential on spellcasting, others on short bursts of strength. When reaching for greater power than what you currently possess, parts of your Soul burn to fuel you as your eyes shine brightly with your Soul's colors.

Whenever you exalt your Soul, depending upon your level, there is a cap of how much you can spend. This cap equals the Potential given per level for major spellcasting ability origins, so minor, moderate and major spellcasting levels grant the same amount of Potential for Exaltation.

Level 1-5: 60
Level 6-10: 100
Level 11-15: 140
Level 16-20: 180

Whenever you spend Potential on Exaltation options presented below, your Soul requires 7 days of recovery to regain your Potential pool for Exaltation. When you level

up, your Potential for Exaltation is automatically recovered (or increased on certain level ups), however, any Potential for Exaltation that you still have stored is exchanged by the Potential you gain on a level up.

If you spend Potential on Spellcasting during a level up, you cannot use Potential on Exaltation. Furthermore, if you gained access to spellcasting during, even if you spend Potential on Exaltation, on a level up, you may recover the Potential you received last level and add it on the Potential you receive this level to purchase spells slots and spells known with.

Dirty Inspiration

Once per long rest, you may spend 40 Potential to grant yourself advantage on any check. In comparison to normal Inspiration, using Dirty Inspiration must be declared before you make the check.

Skill Rank Boost

Once per long rest, you may spend 20 Potential to give yourself one more skill rank with a skill of your choice for one check. With this Exaltation option, you can gain Skill Rank 6 for one skill check, modifying your proficiency bonus with x3. You must spend Potential on this Exaltation option before you make the skill check.

[Artistry] - Empowered Inspiration

If you possess the Inspiration ability from [Artistry], you may spend 40 Potential to upgrade the size once of one of your Inspiration dice this turn. If you already have 1d12 as your Inspiration dice, with this Exaltation option you roll your Inspiration dice with advantage instead.

[Artistry] - Rebounded Inspiration

Once per long rest, if you possess the Inspiration ability from [Artistry], you may spend 40 Potential to grant yourself one more Inspiration die to use this turn.

[Devotion] - Rebounded Channel Divinity

Once per long rest, if you possess the Channel Divinity ability from [Devotion], you may spend 60 Potential to grant yourself one more use of it this turn.

[Discipline] - Empowered Martial Arts

If you possess the Martial Arts ability from [Discipline], you may spend 40 Potential to upgrade the size one of your weapon damage dice for your unarmed or quarterstaff attacks this turn. If you already have 1d10 as your weapon damage dice, with this Exaltation option you roll your weapon damage dice with advantage instead.

[Discipline] - Rebounded Mastery

If you possess the Mastery ability from [Discipline], you may spend 20 Potential to grant yourself one more Mastery Point to use this turn.

[Divine Oath] - Rebounded Divine Smite

Once per long rest, if you possess the Divine Smite ability from [Divine Oath], you may spend 40 Potential to grant yourself one more level 1 Smite spell slot. You can spend an additional 20 Potential for each spell slot higher that you want to recover, to a maximum of 100 Potential for a level 4 Smite spell slot.

[Finesse] - Empowered Sneak Attack

If you possess the Sneak Attack ability from [Finesse], you may spend 30 Potential to grant yourself two more Sneak Attack dice when you successfully Sneak Attack this turn.

[Occult Student] - Rebounded Arcane Recovery

Once per long rest, if you possess the Arcane Recovery ability from [Occult Student], you may spend 40 Potential to recover a level 1 spell slot with Arcane Recover this turn. You can spend an additional 20 Potential for each spell slot higher that you want to recover, to a maximum of 180 Potential for a level 8 spell slot.

[Pact] - Rebounded Absorb Innate Spellcasting

Once per long rest, if you possess the Absorb Innate Spellcasting ability from [Pact], you may spend 40 Potential to cast a level 1 spell as Soul Mastery this turn. You can spend an additional 20 Potential for each spell slot higher that you want to cast as Soul Mastery, to a maximum of 180 Potential for a level 8 spell slot.

[Power] - Empowered Rage

If you possess the Rage ability from [Power], you may spend 40 Potential to grant yourself +3 Rage damage and you roll any weapon attack with advantage this turn.

[Predator] - Empowered Favored Enemy

Once per long rest, if you possess the Favored Enemy ability from [Predator], you may spend 40 Potential to grant yourself +2 bonus to your attack rolls and damage rolls against your favored enemy for 3 turns.

[Predator] - Extended Favored Enemy

Once per long rest, if you possess the Favored Enemy ability from [Predator], you may spend 60 Potential to choose another creature type to become your favored enemy for 5 turns.

[Soul Oath] - Empowered Threaten

Once per long rest, if you possess the Threaten ability from [Soul Oath], you may spend 40 Potential to grant yourself +3 bonus to your damage rolls against your favored enemy for 3 turns.

[Soul Oath] - Rebounded Threaten

Once per long rest, if you possess the Threaten ability from [Soul Oath], you may spend 60 Potential to grant yourself one more use of Threaten to activate this turn.

[Soul Weapon] - Precise Martial Arcanist

Once per long rest, if you possess the Martial Arcanist ability from [Soul Weapon], you may spend 40 Potential to ignore the penalties to hit with all your attacks this turn.

[Tactics] - Rebounded Action Surge

Once per long rest, if you possess the Action Surge ability from [Tactics], you may spend 60 Potential to grant yourself one more use of Action Surge to activate this turn.

[Unique Ancestry] - Rebounded Font of Magic

If you possess the Font of Magic ability from [Unique Ancestry], you may spend 40 Potential to grant yourself one more sorcery point to use this turn.

[World Magic] - Empowered Wild Shape

Once per long rest, if you possess the Wild Shape ability from [World Magic], you may spend 60 Potential to transform into a +1 CR creature for maximum 10 minutes.

SPEND POTENTIAL ON SPELLCASTING

If you possess spellcasting, you can spend Potential during character creation or during a level up to purchase **cantrips**, **spells known** and **spell slots** in a manner that fits your character. Take a look at the Spellcasting Quick Guide down below or the spellcasting section to learn more.

Cantrip

1 cantrip	10 Potential
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Spells known

One spell known of level x	10 Potential * level of spell
----------------------------	-------------------------------

Spell slots

One spell slot of level X	10 Potential * level of spell slot
---------------------------	------------------------------------

Storing Potential

After you have leveled up your character, you can't store more Potential than the value you acquired during your current level up. For example, if you receive 40 Potential during your level-up, you can only store 40 Potential until the next time you level your character.

Level and spell slot limitation

You may not pick a spell known or a spell slot that is of a higher spell level than your total level. You cannot purchase an unlimited amount of spell slots. Consult the table below.

Number of spell slots per spell level table

If you have different spellcasting tags (Minor, Moderate, and Major), the limitations below only apply to your Potential spending with your current level's spellcasting tag status. For example, if you choose an AO with the Major spellcasting tag this level, you may spend your Potential with the Major spell slot limitations. If you would choose an AO with Moderate spellcasting next level, you may only purchase spell slots that do not exceed the Moderate table's limitations. Therefore, only Major Potential can be used to purchase level 8 spells and above.

Potential that has been stored for a later level changes its tag status to the current spellcasting tag. For example, storing Moderate Potential to the next level where you choose Major spellcasting, the stored Moderate Potential transforms into Major Potential and can now be used to purchase an 8 level spell slot.

Minor		Moderate		Major	
1st	6	1st	7	1st	8
2nd	5	2nd	6	2nd	7
3rd	5	3rd	6	3rd	7
4th	3	4th	5	4th	6
5th	2	5th	4	5th	5
6th	-	6th	3	6th	4
7th	-	7th	2	7th	3
8th	-	8th	-	8th	2
9th	-	9th	-	9th	2

Gaining Spellcasting at Later Levels

If you would gain spellcasting at a later level, you reclaim some spent Potential. The next time you level up your character you can purchase spellcasting with this reclaimed Potential. The amount equals half the Potential you have received at every level up except for this level (rounded up to nearest 10 value, half of 30 becomes 20). You must spend this Potential with the normal level requirements and number of spell slots limitations. Start at level one, spend the Potential you reclaimed for that level, abiding by the requirements. Then do the same for level two, and so on, until you reach your current level up. Then activate your spellcasting tag like a normal spellcaster this level up and level ups to come.

For example, if you only have Moderate spellcasting tags and you gained spellcasting after level 4, you refer to the Moderate Potential gain table. From level 1 to 5, Moderate spellcasting receives 40 Potential per level. You first return to level 1, halving the Potential to 20 and spending it as if you were level one. Then 20 Potential at level 2 and level 3. At your 4th level up, you can spend the Potential you gain as normal.

SOUL MARK

Any character with the ability to cast spells with spell slots possesses a Soul Mark - a magical tattoo somewhere on the caster's body. The Soul Mark stores Potency used to cast spells. The tattoo's style for your character you decide, but it should be aligned with your character's theme and spells. For example, a character with many fire spells could have a tattoo with some kind of fiery design. The size of the tattoo grows and swells with the proficiency of the caster. A first-level character would start with a tattoo the size of a small symbol. For a level 20 character, the tattoo will cover most of a body part (a whole arm, leg, chest, back, etc.).

Your Soul Mark will light up as you cast spells, and thus, if you don't cover it up, it will reveal you as a caster. If you cast a spell with no somatic or verbal requirements, such as casting a spell with the Subtle Metamagic option, the Soul Mark does not shine. Because of the Soul Marks, tattooing is a normal decoration in the World. Therefore, as long as you do not cast a spell, the unactivated Soul Mark does not automatically reveal you as a caster if it is visible.

In the Realm of Frostmark, the guilds of Stormholme like to tattoo their followers to keep their loyalty. Amongst the Creekish, it is commonplace to mark their body with their life experiences. Many royal families all over Frostmark enjoy tattooing their noble heritage onto their bodies.

Starting Soul Potency

If you gain a Soul Mark in character creation you start with a number of Souls and Potency depending upon your starting level and your spellcasting tag. Depending on which spellcasting tag you have, you will gain an amount of Souls and Potency equal to your level. Using the following tables, you will find how much Potency you gain whilst creating your character to power your spellcasting.

Minor Starting Soul Potency Table

Level / Potency	1	2
Level 1	2 Souls	
Level 2	2 Souls	
Level 3	3 Souls	
Level 4	1 Soul	1 Soul
Level 5	1 Soul	1 Soul

Level / Potency	1	2
Level 6	2 Souls	1 Soul
Level 7	2 Souls	1 Soul
Level 8	2 Souls	1 Soul
Level 9	1 Soul	2 Souls
Level 10	1 Soul	2 Souls

Level / Potency	1	2
Level 11	1 Soul	2 Souls
Level 12	2 Souls	2 Souls
Level 13	2 Souls	2 Souls
Level 14	2 Souls	2 Souls
Level 15	3 Souls	2 Souls

Level / Potency	1	2
Level 16	3 Souls	2 Souls
Level 17	3 Souls	2 Souls
Level 18	2 Souls	3 Souls
Level 19	2 Souls	3 Souls
Level 20	2 Souls	3 Souls

Moderate Starting Soul Potency Table

Level / Potency	1	2
Level 1	2 Souls	
Level 2	3 Souls	
Level 3	3 Souls	
Level 4	2 Souls	1 Soul
Level 5	2 Souls	1 Soul

Level / Potency	1	2	3
Level 6	2 Souls		1 Soul
Level 7	2 Souls		1 Soul
Level 8	1 Soul	1 Soul	1 Soul
Level 9	1 Soul	1 Soul	1 Soul
Level 10	2 Souls	1 Soul	1 Soul

Level / Potency	1	2	3
Level 11	2 Souls	1 Soul	1 Soul
Level 12	3 Souls	1 Soul	1 Soul
Level 13	3 Souls	1 Soul	1 Soul
Level 14	2 Souls	2 Souls	1 Soul
Level 15	2 Souls	2 Souls	1 Soul

Level / Potency	1	2	3
Level 16	2 Souls	1 Souls	2 Souls
Level 17	2 Souls	1 Souls	2 Souls
Level 18	3 Souls	1 Souls	2 Souls
Level 19	3 Souls	1 Souls	2 Souls
Level 20	2 Souls	2 Souls	2 Souls

Major Starting Soul Potency Table

Level / Potency	1	2	3	4	5
Level 1	2 Souls				
Level 2	3 Souls				
Level 3	4 Souls				
Level 4	2 Souls	1 Soul			
Level 5	3 Souls	1 Soul			

Level / Potency	1	2	3	4	5
Level 6	2 Souls	1 Soul	1 Soul		
Level 7	3 Souls	1 Soul	1 Soul		
Level 8	3 Souls	1 Soul		1 Soul	
Level 9	3 Souls	1 Soul			1 Soul
Level 10	2 Souls	2 Souls			1 Soul

Level / Potency	1	2	3	4	5
Level 11	2 Souls	1 Souls	1 Soul		1 Soul
Level 12	3 Souls	1 Souls	1 Soul		1 Soul
Level 13	2 Souls	2 Souls	1 Soul		1 Soul
Level 14	2 Souls	2 Souls		1 Soul	1 Soul
Level 15	3 Souls	2 Souls		1 Soul	1 Soul

Level / Potency	1	2	3	4	5
Level 16	3 Souls	1 Soul	1 Soul	1 Soul	1 Soul
Level 17	2 Souls	2 Souls	1 Soul	1 Soul	1 Soul
Level 18	3 Souls	2 Souls	1 Soul	1 Soul	1 Soul
Level 19	3 Souls	1 Souls	2 Souls	1 Soul	1 Soul
Level 20	2 Souls	2 Souls	2 Souls	1 Soul	1 Soul

Maximum Soul Potency in your Soul Mark

Your Soul Mark is not an infinite prison for Potency and attempting to fill your Soul Mark with more than the maximum amount will cause the Soul to disappear. As your character gains levels, the Soul Mark will grow with you and increase its capacity for Potency. Consult the table below:

Max Potency in Soul Mark per Level

Level	Potency	Level	Potency	Level	Potency	Level	Potency
1	5	6	16	11	31	16	46
2	7	7	19	12	34	17	49
3	9	8	22	13	37	18	52
4	11	9	25	14	40	19	55
5	13	10	28	15	43	20	58

SPELLCASTING QUICK GUIDE

This is a guide to spellcasting with the basic rules for casting spells. For more information, check out the spellcasting section.

You can cast a spell if your character has a Soul Mark on your turn in combat or anytime during roleplay. Each spell is different and can help you overcome various obstacles in play.

Spell Level and Cantrips

Every spell has a level between 0 and 9 which decides its power. Cantrips, level 0 spells, are the easiest to cast. As your character gains levels, you will be able to cast higher-level spells.

Spells Known

Spells you have available to cast are your "spells known." You can gain spells known through race traits, feats, and abilities. You can also purchase spells known by spending Potential.

Spell Slots

Cantrips, you can cast how many times you want per short rest (about an hour's rest) or long rest (about 8 hours rest).

Level 1 spells and above, you cannot cast an unlimited time per short or long rest. Instead, with the Potential you gain every level up, you buy "spell slots." Spell slots are leveled between 1 and 9. The amount of spell slots you have of a certain level decides how many times you can cast spells of that level per short or long rest.

Level 4 spell slots and below you recover on a short rest, while level 5 spell slots and above are reclaimed on a long rest.

For example, if you have four level 1 spell slots, you can cast level 1 spells known in any combination four times per short rest.

Spell Attack and Saving Throws

Some spells say that you must make a "spell attack" against a target. You calculate and roll your spell attack like this:

1d20 + spellcasting ability modifier + proficiency bonus vs. creature's AV (your GM will tell you if your spell hit or not)

Some spells say that the target of your spell must make an "X saving throw against your spell save DV." Your GM makes the roll this time to see if your spell affects the target. Your GM rolls against your spell save DV that you calculate like this:

8 + your spellcasting ability modifier + your proficiency bonus

Soul Potency Requirement

In addition to spell slots, you also must have enough Potency in your Soul Mark to cast. **You need Potency in your Soul Mark at least equal to the spell's level that you cast.** It doesn't matter how many Souls you have or their Potency (except for higher-level spells, see below), as long as they equal at least to the level of the spell.

If you cast a level 3 spell, you require a level 3 spell slot and at least 3 Potency.

Spells of level 4 and above require specific Potency values.

- ❖ When you cast a level 4 or 5 spell, you must have at least one Potency 2 Soul in your Soul Mark.
- ❖ When you cast a level 6 or 7 spell, you must have at least one Potency 3 Soul in your Soul Mark.
- ❖ When you cast a level 8 spell, you must have at least one Potency 4 Soul in your Soul Mark.
- ❖ When you cast a level 9 spell, you must have at least one Potency 5 Soul in your Soul Mark.

Helos wants to cast Greater Restoration, a level 5 spell. He needs at least one Potency 2 Soul, so he brings that out of his Soul Mark together with three Potency 1 Souls, which together equals Potency 5. Helos could also cast the spell with a Potency 3 Soul and two Potency 1 Souls. Another possibility is three Potency 2 Souls.

Soul Fragments

Sometimes you can gain Souls smaller than Potency 1 from creatures; these little Souls are called Soul Fragments. Three sizes of Soul Fragments exist in 1/4, 1/2, and 3/4 Potency.

Soul Fragment requirements:

- ❖ To cast a cantrip (level 0 spell), you don't need any spell slots but at least 1/2 Soul Potency.
- ❖ You can't use 1/4 Soul Fragment Potency when you cast a level 2 or 3 spell (but for level 1 and cantrips, you can)
- ❖ Level 4 spells and above cannot be cast with any Soul Fragment Potency at all.

Soul Fragments can be transformed to create larger Soul Fragments or full Potency values. Read more about that in the spellcasting section.

Soul Check and Soul Consumption

Whenever you cast level 1 spell and above (not ritual spell), you must roll a Soul Check.

1d20 + spellcasting modifier + proficiency bonus vs DV 12 + spell's level

If your check is equal to or higher than the DV, you cast it as normal. If you fail the Soul check, you lose one random Soul that you used in the casting.

This is important to keep track of, as if you would fail too many Soul Checks or you would randomly lose a critical Soul, you can run out of Potency necessary to cast higher level spells or spells at all.

Soul Consumption is a special requirement for some spells, written as "SC" in the spell's description. When you cast a spell with Soul Consumption, you lose all Souls you used in the spell's casting - they are consumed.

Soul Mastery casting

Some feats, race traits, or abilities might give you the ability to cast a spell with "Soul Mastery," often worded as "spell X as Soul Mastery." When casting a spell with Soul Mastery, you ignore Potency requirements, Soul Checks, and the need to have a Soul Mark.

Some Soul Mastery abilities may allow you to cast the Soul Mastery spell without spell slots even. They are often worded as: "X times per short/ long rest." Thus, you can cast the spell "for free" that number of times per rest, without spell slots or Soul related requirements.

Some Soul Mastery spells can say that you can cast "at will." This means you can cast the spell as if it was a cantrip, and you ignore all Soul related requirements.

If you gain a Soul Mastery spell with "X times per short/long rest," but it doesn't state that you "learn" the spell or you get to add it as a "spell known," - you can only cast that spell with Soul Mastery. As it is not a spell known, you cannot use spell slots to cast it. However, you can purchase it as a spell known and gain the ability to cast the spell both with Soul Mastery and normally with spell slots.

Soul Drain Ritual

Whenever you come upon a corpse that hasn't been dead for more than 6 minutes, or you have a Soul Gem in your hands, you can use an action to drain the corpse or the Soul Gem of one Soul and place it in your Soul Mark. Your GM will tell you the Potency of the Soul.

STEP 7 – CHARACTER CREATION EXAMPLES

In this section you'll find two player characters, Helos and Rogath, go through the seventh step in character creation.

“Helos”

Step 7

Eve uses Helos' Potential to buy cantrips, spell slots and spells for Helos;

Cantrips

Sacred Flame

Spare the Dying

Thaumaturgy (from background)

Spell Slots

3 x Level 1

Spells Known

Level 1: *Command*

Level 1: *Ceremony* (from background)

Level 1: *Healing Word*

Level 1: *Sanctuary* (from background)

Souls: Two Potency 2

Since Helos has been given a Soul Mark and been taught spellcasting in his backstory as a Crow priest, Eve is free to purchase spells with her Potential pool. At first level, Eve chose [Devotion] as her Primary Selection, meaning that Helos gains major spellcasting at this level. Therefore, the Potential pool equals 60, but Helos receives an extra +10 Potential from the General Upgrade Eve taken on Secondary Selection. She purchases three spell slots of level 1 for 30 potential and then picks two cantrips and two level 1 spells for an additional 40 potential. Furthermore, Helos starts with two level 1 Souls in his Soul Mark.

“Rogath”

Step 7

Carl notes down in Rogath's character sheet that he has 20 Potential stored.

Since Rogath has no Soul Mark, he cannot possess spellcasting. After all, his village didn't have the resources or knowledge to bestow something so valuable unto Rogath. Even if Rogath cannot spend his Potential for spellcasting, Carl still keeps the Potential in mind. When Carl gets to play with Rogath in a session, he can spend his Potential to give Rogath small boosts. See Exaltation on page 239.

STEP 8 – EQUIPMENT

From the fresh food markets of Applegate to the hammering smithy districts of the Armathainian plateaus to the seedy black markets of Stormholmish alleyways, Frostmark offers a wide variety of equipment and items if you know where to look. Most village markets offer items such as torches, rope, and rations, but getting your hands on quality arms and armor often entails traveling to a large city market. This section offers details about items that might be of interest to an adventurer, which can be found in the Realm of Frostmark.

When you create a character, you gain a list of starting equipment from the background you choose, some starting money, and, in the Accomplishment section, you may acquire a bit of extra coin. You will find the items given to you by your background here. You may spend your starting money purchasing more items that make sense for your character. Buying items with your starting money doesn't necessarily have to mean that they came into your possession just recently or that you purchased them. They could have been given to you, found by you, or even stolen. Nevertheless, your total amount of starting money is the maximum value of items you can start your journey with. It may be fortuitous to keep some loose coin in your purse for the occasional tavern stay or tankard of ale.

Wealth and Coin

Wealth doesn't need to be measured in the number of coins you possess. Indeed, most trade in villages and beyond is made through trading objects and services. Wealth can be measured in land, how much cattle you own, the right to exploit natural resources, etc.

In all history records in Frostmark, there is no recollection of who created the coins, one of copper, one of silver, one of gold, and one of platinum, or how their values were set. Records say that they all look the same today as they did hundreds of years ago. The Church claims that the wealth of humanity, the civilized way of conducting trade through coins were bestowed to humanity by Riahn. Researchers of the Enneade from other Realms argue that the coins and their concept were created by several Enneade sometime after the creation of the human.

As described above, trade doesn't always take the form of coins exchanging hands, but the common practice is to value items in their respective coin count, whichever is the most efficient. A coin weighs about 10 gr, for example, a kg of gold is valued as a hundred gold pieces (gp). All coins have a small hole in the middle for easy transportation by threading them onto a short string. In addition, they have all been stamped by a particular pattern that is universal for all coins of the same material.

A copper coin (cp) has the lowest value. With one coin, you could purchase a candle, a torch, or a piece of chalk. The copper coin is shaped like an ellipse with a rainfall pattern on one side.

A silver coin (sp) is worth 10 copper pieces. With one coin, you could purchase a laborer for a day or a night's stay in a modest inn. The silver coin is crescent-shaped with a star pattern on one side.

A gold coin (gp) is worth 10 silver pieces. With one coin, you could purchase a goat, a sickle, or a bedroll. The gold coin is rectangular shaped, with soft edges and a pattern of a branch with leaves on one side.

A platinum coin (pp) is worth 10 gold pieces. You could purchase a fine bottle of wine, a shield, or light leather armor with one coin. The platinum coin is shaped like a pentagon with a fiery pattern of a large bonfire on one side.

SELLING TREASURE

It is common for adventuring parties to stumble upon a treasure, be it coin or items. Normally, you can sell your treasure and trinkets when you return to a town or other marketplace, provided that you can find buyers and merchants interested in your loot.

Arms, Armor, and other Equipment

As a general rule, undamaged weapons, armor, and other equipment fetch half their cost when sold in a market. Weapons and armor used by monsters are rarely in good enough condition to sell.

Magic Items

Selling magic items is problematic. Finding someone to buy a potion or a scroll isn't too hard, but other items can only be bought by only the filthy rich. Likewise, besides some particular common magic items, you won't normally come across them to purchase. The value of magic is far beyond simple gold and should always be treated as such. Many merchants upon Frostmark don't even know what magic is, and because the Church controls most markets, the Church can easily confiscate magical items. Trade with magical items in Frostmark is near impossible.

Gems, Jewelry, and Art Objects

These items retain their full value in the marketplace, and you can either trade them to acquire coins or use them as currency for other transactions. The GM might require you to find a buyer in a large town or larger community for exceptionally valuable treasures.

Trade Goods

Beyond urban areas, the most common form of trading is through exchanging objects and services. Trade goods, like bars of iron, bags of salt, livestock, and so on, keep their full value in the market and can be used as currency.

ARMOR

Armor Table	Cost	Armor Value	Brawn	Stealth	Weight
Light					
Padded	5 gp	11 + Dex mod		Dadv.	4 kg
Leather	10 gp	11 + Dex mod			5 kg
Reinforced Leather	45 gp	12 + Dex mod			7 kg
Medium					

Hide	10 gp	12 + Dex mod (max +2 mod)			6 kg
Chain Shirt	50 gp	13 + Dex mod (max +2 mod)			10 kg
Scale Mail	50 gp	14 + Dex mod (max +2 mod)		Dadv.	24 kg
Breastplate	400 gp	14 + Dex mod (max +2 mod)			10 kg
Half-Plate	750 gp	15 + Dex mod (max +2 mod)		Dadv.	20 kg
Heavy					
Ringmail	30 gp	14		Dadv.	20 kg
Chain Mail	75 gp	16	13	Dadv.	25 kg
Splint	200 gp	17	15	Dadv.	30 kg
Plate	1,500 gp	18	15	Dadv.	35 kg
Shield					
Shield	10 gp	+2			3 kg

Frostmark offers a variety of armor types, examples ranging from leather armor to chain mail to costly plate armor. The armor table collects the most commonly available types of armor found on Frostmark and separates them into three categories: light armor, medium armor, and heavy armor. Many warriors supplement their armor with a shield, which gives them further defenses.

Armor Proficiency

Anyone can put on a suit of armor or strap a shield to an arm. Only those proficient in the armor's use know how to wear it effectively, however. You must determine your armor proficiencies in the "Proficiencies and Skills" section first. If you wear armor that you lack proficiency with, you have disadvantage on any ability check, saving throw, or attack roll that involves brawn or dexterity, and you can't cast spells.

Armor Value (AV)

Armor protects its wearer from attacks. The armor, and shield, you wear determines your base armor value.

Heavy Armor

Heavier armor interferes with the wearer's ability to move quickly, stealthily, and freely. If the armor table shows "Br 13" or "Br 15" in the Brawn column for an armor type, the armor reduces the wearer's speed by 3 m unless the wearer has a Brawn score equal to or higher than the listed score.

Stealth

If the armor table shows “disadvantage” in the stealth column, the wearer has disadvantage on Stealth (Dex) checks.

Shields

A shield is made from wood or metal and is carried in one hand. Wielding a shield increases your armor value by 2. You can benefit from only one shield at a time.

Light Armor

Made from supple and thin materials, light armor favors agile warriors. It offers some protection without sacrificing mobility. If you wear light armor, you add your Dexterity modifier to the base number from your armor type to determine your armor value.

Padded

Padded armor consists of quilted layers of cloth and batting.

Leather

The breastplate and shoulder protectors of this armor are made of leather that has been stiffened by being boiled in oil. The rest of the armor is made of softer and more flexible materials.

Reinforced Leather

Made from tough but flexible leather, studded leather is reinforced with thin metal plates in key areas.

Medium Armor

Medium armor offers more protection than light armor, but it also impairs movement more. If you wear medium armor, you add your Dexterity modifier, to a maximum of +2, to the base number from your armor type to determine your Armor Value.

Hide

This crude armor consists of thick furs and pelts. It is commonly worn by tribal warriors and other folks who lack access to the tools and materials needed to create better armor.

Chain Shirt

Made of interlocking metal rings, a chain shirt is worn between layers of clothing or leather. This armor offers modest protection to the wearer's upper body and allows the sound of the rings rubbing against one another to be muffled by outer layers.

Scale Mail

This armor consists of a coat and leggings (and perhaps a separate skirt) of leather covered with overlapping pieces of metal, much like the scales of a fish. The suit includes gauntlets.

Breastplate

This Armor consists of a fitted metal chest piece worn with supple leather. Although it leaves the legs and arms relatively unprotected, this armor provides good protection for the wearer's vital organs while leaving the wearer relatively unencumbered.

Half Plate

The half-plate consists of shaped metal plates that cover most of the wearer's body. It does not include leg protection beyond simple greaves that are attached with leather straps.

Heavy Armor

Of all the Armor categories, heavy armor offers the best protection. These suits of armor cover the entire body and are designed to stop a wide range of attacks. Only proficient warriors can manage their weight and bulk. Heavy armor doesn't let you add your Dexterity modifier to your Armor Value, but it also doesn't penalize you if your Dexterity modifier is negative.

Ring Mail

This armor is leather armor with heavy rings sewn into it. The rings help reinforce the armor against blows from swords and axes. Ringmail is inferior to chain mail, and it's usually worn only by those who can't afford better armor.

Chain Mail

Made of interlocking metal rings, chain mail includes a layer of quilted fabric worn underneath the mail to prevent chafing and to cushion the impact of blows. The suit includes gauntlets.

Splint

This armor is made of narrow vertical strips of metal riveted to a backing of leather that is worn over cloth padding. Flexible chain mail protects the joints.

Plate

Plate consists of shaped, interlocking metal plates to cover the entire body. A suit of plate includes gauntlets, heavy leather boots, a visored helmet, and thick layers of padding underneath the armor. Buckles and straps distribute the weight over the body.

Getting Into and Out of Armor

The time it takes to don or doff armor depends on the armor's category.

Don

This is the time it takes to put on armor. You benefit from the armor's AV only if you take the full time to don the suit of armor.

Doff

This is the time it takes to take off armor. If you have help, reduce this time by half.

Category	Don	Doff
Light armor	1 minute	1 minute
Medium armor	5 minutes	1 minute
Heavy armor	10 minutes	5 minutes

Shield	1 action	1 action
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WEAPONS

Melee Weapons Table	Cost	Damage	Weight	Properties
Bastard Sword	15 gp	1d8 slashing	1.5 kg	Versatile (1d10)
Battle-Axe	10 gp	1d8 slashing	2 kg	Versatile (1d10)
Broadsword	12 gp	1d8 slashing	1.5 kg	
Club	1 sp	1d4 bludgeoning	1 kg	Light
Dagger	2 gp	1d4 piercing	0.5 kg	Finesse, Light, Thrown (4/12)
Flail	10 gp	1d8 bludgeoning	1 kg	
Glaive	20 gp	1d10 slashing	3 kg	Heavy, Reach, Two-handed
Greataxe	30 gp	1d12 slashing	3.5 kg	Heavy, Two-handed
Great club	2 sp	1d8 bludgeoning	5 kg	Two-handed
Greatsword	50 gp	2d6 slashing	3 kg	Heavy, Two-handed
Halberd	20 gp	1d10 slashing	3 kg	Heavy, Reach, Two-handed
Handaxe	5 gp	1d6 slashing	1 kg	Light, Thrown (4/12)
Javelin	5 sp	1d6 piercing	1 kg	Thrown (6/24)
Lance	10 gp	1d12 piercing	3 kg	Reach, Special
Light Hammer	2 gp	1d4 bludgeoning	1 kg	Light, Thrown (4/12)
Mace	5 gp	1d6 bludgeoning	2 kg	
Maul	10 gp	2d6 bludgeoning	5 kg	Heavy, Two-handed
Morningstar	15 gp	1d8 piercing	2 kg	
Quarterstaff	2 cp	1d6 bludgeoning	2 kg	Versatile (1d8)
Pike	5 gp	1d10 piercing	2.5 kg	Heavy, Reach, Two-handed

Rapier	25 gp	1d6 piercing	1 kg	Finesse, Light
Saber	30 gp	1d8 slashing	1.5 kg	
Scimitar	25 gp	1d6 slashing	1.5 kg	Finesse, Light
Shortsword	10 gp	1d6 piercing	1 kg	Finesse, Light
Sickle	1 gp	1d4 slashing	1 kg	Light
Spear	2gp	1d6 piercing	1.5 kg	Thrown (4/12), Versatile (1d8)
Trident	5 gp	1d6 piercing	2 kg	Thrown (4/12), Versatile (1d8)
War Pick	5 gp	1d8 piercing	1 kg	
Warhammer	15 gp	1d8 bludgeoning	1 kg	Versatile (1d10)
Whip	2 gp	1d4 slashing	1.5 kg	Finesse, Reach

Ranged Weapons Table	Cost	Damage	Weight	Range	Properties
Crossbow Hand	75 gp	1d6 piercing	1.5 kg	6/24	Ammunition, Light, Loading
Crossbow Heavy	50 gp	1d10 piercing	9 kg	20/80	Ammunition, Heavy, Loading, Two-handed
Crossbow Light	25 gp	1d8 piercing	2.5 kg	8/64	Ammunition, Loading, Twohanded
Fishing Net	25 cp	-	0.5 kg	2	Special, Thrown
Longbow	50 gp	1d8 piercing	1 kg	30/120	Ammunition, Heavy, Two-handed
Shortbow	25 gp	1d6 piercing	1 kg	8/64	Ammunition, Two-handed
Sling	1 sp	1d4 bludgeoning	0.5 kg	6/24	Ammunition
Weighted Net	4 gp	-	5 kg	3	Special, Thrown

AMMUNITION

Ammunition Table	Cost	Weight
Arrows, a bundle of 20	1 gp	0.5 kg
Crossbow bolts, a bundle of 20	1 gp	0.75 kg
Sling bullets, a pouch of 20	4 cp	0.75 kg

Whether you favor a longsword or a longbow, your weapon and your ability to wield it effectively can mean the difference between life and death. The weapons table shows the kinds of weapons that exist on Frostmark, their price and weight, the damage they deal when they hit, and any special properties they possess. Every weapon is classified as either melee or ranged. A melee weapon is used to attack a target within 1 m of you, whereas a ranged weapon is used to attack a target at a distance.

Weapon Proficiencies

Proficiency with a weapon allows you to add your proficiency bonus to the attack roll for any attack you make with that weapon. If you make an attack roll using a weapon with which you lack proficiency, you do not add your proficiency bonus to the attack roll.

Weapon Properties

Many weapons have special properties related to their use, as shown in the weapons table.

Ammunition

You can use a weapon that has the ammunition property to make a ranged attack only if you have ammunition to fire from the weapon. Each time you attack with the weapon, you expend one piece of ammunition. Drawing the ammunition from a quiver, case, or other container is part of the attack (you need a free hand to load a one-handed weapon). At the end of the battle, you can recover half your expended ammunition by taking a minute to search the battlefield.

If you use a weapon that has the ammunition property to make a melee attack, you treat the weapon as an improvised weapon (see “improvised weapons” later in this section). A sling must be loaded to deal any damage when used in this way.

Finesse

When attacking with a finesse weapon, you use your choice of your Brawn or Dexterity modifier for the attack and damage rolls. You must use the same modifier for both rolls.

Heavy

Small creatures have disadvantage on attack rolls with heavy weapons. A heavy weapon's size and bulk make it too large for a Small creature to use effectively.

Light

A light weapon is small and easy to handle, making it ideal for use when fighting with two weapons.

Loading

Because of the time required to load this weapon, you can fire only one piece of ammunition from it when you use an action, bonus action, or reaction to fire it, regardless of the number of attacks you can normally make.

Range

A weapon that can be used to make a ranged attack has a range in parentheses after the ammunition or thrown property. The range lists two numbers. The first is the weapon's normal range in m, and the second indicates the weapon's long-range. When attacking a target beyond the normal range, you have disadvantage on the attack roll. You can't attack a target beyond the weapon's long-range.

Reach

This weapon adds 1 m to your reach when you attack with it, as well as when determining your reach for opportunity attacks with it.

Special

A weapon with the special property has unusual rules governing its use, explained in the weapon's description (see "special weapons" later in this section).

Thrown

If a weapon has the thrown property, you can throw the weapon to make a ranged attack. If the weapon is a melee weapon, you use the same ability modifier for that attack roll and damage roll that you would use for a melee attack with the weapon. For example, if you throw a handaxe, you use your Brawn, but if you throw a dagger, you can use either your Brawn or your Dexterity, since the dagger has the finesse property.

Two-Handed

This weapon requires two hands when you attack with it.

Versatile

This weapon can be used with one or two hands. A damage value in parentheses appears with the property—the damage when the weapon is used with two hands to make a melee attack.

Improvised Weapons

Sometimes characters don't have their weapons and have to attack with whatever is at hand. An improvised weapon includes any object you can wield in one or two hands, such as broken glass, a table leg, a frying pan, a wagon wheel, or a dead goblin. Often, an improvised weapon is similar to an actual weapon and can be treated as such. For example, a table leg is akin to a club. At the GM's option, a character proficient with a weapon can use a similar object as if it were that weapon and use his or her proficiency bonus.

An object that bears no resemblance to a weapon deals 1d4 damage (the GM assigns a damage type appropriate to the object). If a character uses a ranged weapon to make a melee attack or throws a melee weapon that does not have the thrown property, it also

deals 1d4 damage. An improvised thrown weapon has a normal range of 4 m and a long range of 12 m.

Silvered Weapons

Some monsters that have immunity or resistance to nonmagical weapons are susceptible to silver weapons, so cautious adventurers invest extra coin to plate their weapons with silver. You can silver a single weapon or twenty pieces of ammunition for 100 gp. This cost represents not only the price of the silver but the time and expertise needed to add silver to the weapon without making it less effective.

Special Weapons

Weapons with special rules are described here.

Lance

You have disadvantage when you use a lance to attack a target within 1 m of you. Also, a lance requires two hands to wield when you aren't mounted.

Fishing Net

A Large or smaller creature hit by a fishing net is grappled until it is freed. A net does not affect formless creatures or creatures that are Huge or larger. A creature can use its action to make a DV 10 Brawn check, freeing itself or another creature within its reach on a success. Dealing 5 slashing damage to the net (AV 10) also frees the creature without harming it, ending the effect and destroying the net.

Weighted Net

A Large or smaller creature hit by a weighted net is restrained until it is freed. A net does not affect formless creatures or creatures that are Huge or larger. A creature can use its action to make a DV 14 Brawn check, freeing itself or another creature within its reach on a success. Dealing 10 slashing damage to the net (AV 12) also frees the creature without harming it, ending the effect and destroying the net.

TOOLS, KITS, AND MUSICAL INSTRUMENTS

Artisan's Tools	Cost	Weight
Alchemist Supplies	50 gp	4 kg
Brewer's Supplies	20 gp	4.5 kg
Calligrapher's Supplies	10 gp	2.5 kg
Carpenter's Supplies	8 gp	3 kg
Cartographer's Supplies	15 gp	3 kg
Cobbler's Supplies	5 gp	2.5 kg
Cook's Utensils	1 gp	4 kg

Glassblower's Supplies	30 gp	2.5 kg
Jeweler's Tools	25 gp	1 kg
Leatherworker's Tools	5 gp	2.5 kg
Mason's Tools	10 gp	4 kg
Painter's Supplies	10 gp	2.5 kg
Potter's Tools	10 gp	1.5 kg
Smith's Tools	20 gp	4 kg
Tinker's Tools	50 gp	5 kg
Weaver's Tools	1 gp	2.5 kg
Woodcarver's Tools	1 gp	2.5 kg

Kits Table	Cost	Weight
Disguise Kit	25 gp	1.5 kg
Forgery Kit	15 gp	2.5 kg
Healer's Kit	5 gp	1.5 kg
Herbalism Kit	5 gp	1.5 kg
Navigator's Tools	25 gp	1 kg
Poisoner's Kit	50 gp	1 kg
Tattoo Kit	50 gp	2 kg
Thieves' Tools	25 gp	0.5 kg

Gaming Set Table	Cost	Weight
Dice	1 sp	-
Chess	1 gp	0.25 kg
Playing Cards	5 sp	-

Musical Instrument Table	Cost	Weight
Bagpipes	30 gp	3 kg
Drum	6 gp	1.5 kg
Dulcimer	25 gp	5 kg
Flute	2 gp	0.5 kg
Lute	35 gp	1 kg
Lyre	30 gp	1 kg
Horn	3 gp	1 kg
Pan Flute	12 gp	1 kg
Shawm	2 gp	0.5 kg
Viol	30 gp	0.5 kg

A tool helps you perform specific tasks that require your skill and the usage of specialized instruments. Examples include crafting or repairing an item, forging a document, picking a lock, etc. You may be well versed with the mechanics of locks, but without the proper lockpicking tools, no lock can be pried open. When a tool is required to solve a specific task, your GM decides which ability score and skill is applicable to roll at that moment like a normal skill check but it also requires that the character has access to, and experience with, the tool in question.

1d20 + applicable ability score + applicable skill + access to tool vs. DV of the task

Which skill is used in tandem with a tool depends upon the circumstances. But there are some common pairings, such as the Subterfuge skill with the Lockpicking Tool.

Sometimes one set of tools can be used for tasks that it was not originally set out to solve. This should be dealt with on a case-by-case basis.

Some backgrounds provide you with a tool at character creation or grants you the option to choose one or several. If your background provides you with tools, it also automatically grants you experience with that tool.

To acquire a tool outside of backgrounds, you must buy the tool through character creation or later in play. However, purchasing a tool doesn't necessarily mean that the character knows how to use it. A character using a tool with no experience with it, they only make skill checks with the tool with their applicable ability score modifier, even if they have skill ranks in the applicable skill. If experience with a tool has been mentioned in the backstory of a character, a GM is free to judge if the player is allowed to roll checks with not only their ability score but also the appropriate skill rank when using the tool. If the experience is lacking, a GM is free to limit what the character can do with a tool or lower their skill rank when rolling checks with the tool. The player can build up experience with the tool by simply practicing and using the tool, and the GM declares when full proficiency with the tool has been reached.

Artisan's Tools

These special tools include the items needed to pursue a craft or trade. The Artisan's Tools table shows examples of the most common types of tools, each providing items related to a craft. These are only examples of Artisan's Tools, the player is free to come up with their own together with the GM.

Disguise Kit

This pouch of cosmetics, hair dye, and small props lets you create disguises that change your physical appearance.

Forgery Kit

This small box contains a variety of papers and parchments, pens and inks, seals and sealing wax, gold and silver leaf, and other supplies necessary to create convincing forgeries of physical documents.

Gaming Set

This item encompasses a wide range of game pieces, including dice and decks of cards. Common gaming sets can be dice, chess and playing cards. Other gaming sets can exist in the World - consult with your GM if you have ideas.

Healer's Kit

This kit is a leather pouch containing bandages, salves, and splints. The kit has ten uses. Possessing a healer's kit and the knowledge to use it allows you and your allies to regain health points on short rest by spending one of the kit's uses, and the ability to diagnose and treat illnesses and diseases. As an action, if you have at least one rank in medicine, you can expend one use of the kit to stabilize a creature that has 0 health points, without needing to make a Medicine (Cun) check.

Herbalism Kit

This kit contains a variety of instruments such as clippers, mortar and pestle, and pouches and vials used by herbalists to create remedies and potions. This kit has 5 uses. Possessing an herbalism kit as well as the knowledge of using one allows you to identify

and apply herbs, as well as create antitoxins. In addition, you may spend one of the kit's uses to regain health points and help your allies regain health points on a short rest if you possess at least one rank in Medicine or any other applicable Academic skills.

Musical Instrument

Several of the most common types of musical instruments are shown on the table as examples.

Navigator's Tools

This set of instruments is used for navigation at sea. Possessing a navigator's tools as well as the knowledge of using one allows you to chart a ship's course, follow navigation charts and avoid getting lost at sea.

Poisoner's Kit

A poisoner's kit includes the vials, chemicals, and other equipment necessary for the creation of poisons.

Tattoo Kit

This kit comes in a sturdy wooden box of some description and contains a variety of various colored inks, needles, even some black ink infused with gold that is used for religious ceremonies of Riahn, and medical supplies needed for sterilization. The kit may also include a sketchbook filled with original tattoo designs that the tattooist may find on their journeys.

Thieves' Tools

This set of tools includes a small file, a set of lock picks, a small mirror mounted on a metal handle, a set of narrow-bladed scissors, and a pair of pliers. Possessing a thieves' tools as well as the knowledge of using one allows you to pick locks and disarm traps.

CLOTHING

Clothing Table	Cost	Weight
Common	5 sp	1.5 kg
Costume/Uniform	5 gp	2 kg
Fine	15 gp	3 kg
Traveler's	2 gp	2 kg

ADVENTURING EQUIPMENT

Adventuring Equipment Table	Cost	Weight
Acid Vial	25 gp	0.5 kg

Alchemist's Fire Flask	50 gp	0.5 kg
Antitoxin Vial	50 gp	-
Backpack	2 gp	2.5 kg
Bedroll	1 gp	3.5 kg
Belt	3 sp	0.5 kg
Blanket	5 sp	1.5 kg
Caltrops, a bag of 20	1 gp	1 kg
Chain (3 m)	5 gp	5 kg
Climber's Gear	25 gp	5.5 kg
Crowbar	2 gp	2.5 kg
Grappling Hook	2 gp	2 kg
Hunting trap	5 gp	12 kg
Lamp	5 sp	0.5 kg
Lantern Bullseye	10 gp	1 kg
Lantern Hooded	5 gp	1 kg
Manacles	2 gp	3 kg
Mess Kit	2 sp	0.5 kg
Piton	5 cp	0.1 kg
Poison Basic Vial	100 gp	-
Pouch	2 sp	0.5 kg
Quiver	1 gp	0.5 kg
Ram, Portable	4 gp	18 kg
Rations (1 day)	5 sp	1 kg

Rope, Hempen (15 m)	1 gp	5 kg
Rope, Hempen (10 m)	6 sp	3 kg
Rope, Hempen (5 m)	3 sp	1.5 kg
Rope, Silk (15 m)	10 gp	2.5 kg
Rope, Silk (10 m)	6 gp	1.5 kg
Rope, Silk (5 m)	3 gp	0.8 kg
Rucksack	10 gp	5 kg
Sack	1 cp	0.25 kg
Satchel	1 gp	1.5 kg
Spikes, Iron (10)	1 gp	2.5 kg
Spyglass	1,000 gp	0.5 kg
Tent for two	2 gp	10 kg
Tinderbox	5 sp	0.5 kg
Torch	1 cp	0.5 kg
Vial	8 sp	-
Waterskin	2 sp	2.5 kg (full)
Whetstone	1 cp	0.5 kg

GENERAL ITEMS

General Items Table	Cost	Weight
Abacus	2 gp	1 kg
Amulet	5 gp	-
Banner	2 gp	4 kg

Barrel	2 gp	35 kg
Basket	4 sp	1 kg
Bell	1 gp	-
Block & Tackle	1 gp	2.5 kg
Book	25 gp	2.5 kg
Bottle of Glass	2 gp	1 kg
Bucket	5 cp	1 kg
Candle	1 cp	-
Case for crossbow bolts	1 gp	0.5 kg
Case for map or scroll	1 gp	0.5 kg
Chalk (1 piece)	1 cp	-
Chest	5 gp	12 kg
Emblem	5 gp	-
Fishing Tackle	1 gp	2 kg
Flask or Tankard	2 cp	1 kg
Hammer	1 gp	1.5 kg
Hammer, Sledge	2 gp	5 kg
Hourglass	25 gp	0.5 kg
Ink (25 grams bottle)	8 gp	-
Ink Pen	2 cp	-
Jug or Pitcher	2 cp	2 kg
Ladder (2 m)	1 sp	12 kg
Lock	10 gp	0.5 kg

Magnifying Glass	100 gp	-
Mirror of Metal	5 gp	0.25 kg
Notebook	2 gp	-
Oil, Flask	1 sp	0.5 kg
Paper (one sheet)	2 sp	-
Parchment (one sheet)	1 sp	-
Perfume (one vial)	5 gp	-
Pick (for miners)	2 gp	5 kg
Pole (2 m)	5 cp	3.5 kg
Pot, Iron	2 gp	5 kg
Robes	1 gp	2 kg
Scale, merchant's	5 gp	1.5 kg
Sealing Wax	5 sp	0.5 kg
Shovel	2 gp	2.5 kg
Signet Ring	5 gp	-
Soap	2 cp	-

Acid

As an action, you can splash the contents of this vial onto a creature within 1 m of you or throw the vial up to 4 m, shattering it on impact. In either case, make a ranged attack against a creature or object, treating the acid as an improvised weapon. On a hit, the target takes 2d6 acid damage.

Alchemist's Fire

This sticky, adhesive fluid ignites when exposed to air. As an action, you can throw this flask up to 4 m, shattering it on impact. Make a ranged attack against a creature or object, treating the alchemist's fire as an improvised weapon. On a hit, the target takes 1d4 fire damage at the start of each of its turns. A creature can end this damage by using its action to make a DV 10 Dexterity check to extinguish the flames.

Antitoxin

A creature that drinks this vial of liquid gains advantage on saving throws against poison for 1 hour. It confers no benefit to undead or constructs.

Backpack

A backpack can hold 0.03 cubic meter or 15 kg of gear. You can also strap items, such as a bedroll or a coil of rope, to the outside of a backpack.

Banner

A banner is essentially a quarterstaff with a flag attached to it. Attacking with the banner has disadvantages. As a bonus action, a character can rip off the flag or wrap it around the quarterstaff. Afterwards you can attack with the quarterstaff normally.

Barrel

A barrel can hold 150 liters of liquid or 0.1 cubic meter of solids.

Basket

A basket holds 0.6 cubic meter or 20 kg of gear.

Belt

A strong belt meant for attaching equipment to. It can support up to 5 kg of equipment.

Block and Tackle

A set of pulleys with a cable threaded through them and a hook to attach to objects, a block and tackle allows you to hoist up to four times the weight you can normally lift.

Book

A book might contain poetry, historical accounts, information pertaining to a particular field of lore, diagrams and notes on contemporary contraptions, or just about anything else that can be represented using text or pictures.

Bottle of Glass

A bottle holds 1 liter of liquid.

Bucket

A bucket holds 10 liters of liquid or 0.01 cubic meter of solids.

Caltrops

As an action, you can spread a bag of caltrops to cover a square area that is 1 m on a side. Any creature that enters the area must succeed on a DV 15 Dexterity saving throw or stop moving this turn and take 1 piercing damage. Taking this damage reduces the creature's walking speed by 2 m until the creature regains at least 1 health point. A creature moving through the area at half speed doesn't need to make the save.

Candle

For 1 hour, a candle sheds bright light in a 1 meter radius and dim light for an additional 1 meter.

Case, Crossbow Bolt

This wooden case can hold up to twenty crossbow bolts.

Case, Map, or Scroll

This cylindrical leather case can hold up to ten rolled-up sheets of paper or five rolled-up sheets of parchment.

Chain

A chain has 10 health points. It can be burst with a successful DV 20 Brawn check.

Chest

A chest holds 0.3 cubic meter or 140 kg of gear.

Climber's Gear

A climber's gear includes special pitons, boot tips, gloves, and a harness. You can use the climber's gear as an action to anchor yourself; when you do, you can't fall more than 5 m from the point where you anchored yourself, and you can't climb more than 5 m away from that point without undoing the anchor.

Crowbar

Using a crowbar grants advantage to Brawn checks where the crowbar's leverage can be applied.

Fishing Tackle

This kit includes a wooden rod, silken line, corkwood bobbers, steel hooks, lead sinkers, velvet lures, and narrow netting.

Flask or Tankard

A flask or tankard holds 0.5 liter of liquid.

Grappling Hook

When tied to the end of a rope, a grappling hook can secure the rope to a battlement, window ledge, tree limb, or other protrusion.

Hunting Trap

When you use your action to set it, this trap forms a saw---toothed steel ring that snaps shut when a creature steps on a pressure plate in the center. The trap is affixed by a heavy chain to an immobile object, such as a tree or a spike driven into the ground. A creature that steps on the plate must succeed on a DV 13 Dexterity saving throw or take 1d4 piercing damage and stop moving. Thereafter, until the creature breaks free of the trap, its movement is limited by the length of the chain (typically 1 m long). A creature can use its action to make a DV 13 Brawn check, freeing itself or another creature within its reach on a success. Each failed check deals 1 piercing damage to the trapped creature.

Jug or Pitcher

A jug holds 4 liters of liquid.

Lamp

A lamp casts bright light in a 3 meters radius and dim light for an additional 6 meters. Once lit, it burns for 6 hours on a flask (0.5 l) of oil.

Lantern, Bullseye

A bullseye lantern casts Bright Light in a 12 meters cone and dim light for an additional 12 meters. Once lit, it burns for 6 hours on a flask (0.5 l) of oil.

Lantern, Hooded

A hooded lantern casts bright light in a 6 meters radius and dim light for an additional 6 meters. Once lit, it burns for 6 hours on a flask (0.5 l) of oil. As an action, you can lower the hood, reducing the light to dim light in a 1 meter radius.

Lock

A key is provided with the lock. Without the key, a creature in the possession of thieves' tools and the knowledge to use them can pick this lock with a successful DV 15 Dexterity check. Your GM may decide that better locks are available for higher prices.

Magnifying Glass

This lens allows a closer look at small objects. It is also useful as a substitute for flint and steel when starting fires. Lighting a fire with a magnifying glass requires light as bright as sunlight to focus, a tinder to ignite, and about 5 minutes for the fire to ignite. A magnifying glass grants advantage on any ability check made to appraise or inspect an item that is small or highly detailed.

Manacles

These metal restraints can bind a Small or Medium creature. Escaping the manacles requires a successful DV 20 Dexterity check. Breaking them requires a successful DV 20 Brawn check. Each set of manacles comes with one key. Without the key, a creature with thieves' tools can pick the manacles' lock with a successful DV 15 Dexterity check. Manacles have 15 health points.

Mess Kit

This tin box contains a cup and simple cutlery. The box clamps together, and one side can be used as a cooking pan and the other as a plate or shallow bowl.

Notebook

The notebook has a soft cover and 10 sheets of parchment folded in two, giving the notebook 20 pages.

Oil

Oil usually comes in a clay flask that holds 1 pint. As an action, you can splash the oil in this flask onto a creature within 1 meter of you or throw it up to 4 meters, shattering it on impact. Make a ranged attack against a target creature or object, treating the oil as an improvised weapon. On a hit, the target is covered in oil. If the target takes any fire damage before the oil dries (after 1 minute), the target takes an additional 5 fire damage from the burning oil. You can also pour a flask of oil on the ground to cover a 1 meter square area, provided that the surface is level. If lit, the oil burns for 2 rounds and deals 5 fire damage to any creature that enters the area or ends its turn in the area. A creature can take this damage only once per turn.

Poison, Basic

You can use the poison in this vial to coat one slashing or piercing weapon or up to three pieces of ammunition. Applying the poison takes an action. A creature hit by the

poisoned weapon or ammunition must make a DV 10 Vitality saving throw or take 1d4 poison damage. Once applied, the poison retains potency for 1 minute before drying.

Pot, Iron

An iron pot holds 4 liters of liquid.

Pouch

A cloth or leather pouch can hold up to 20 sling bullets or 50 blowgun needles, among other things.

Quiver

A quiver can hold up to 20 arrows.

Ram, Portable

You can use a portable ram to break down doors. When doing so, you gain a +4 bonus on the Brawn check. One other character can help you use the ram, giving you advantage on this check.

Rations

Rations consist of dry foods suitable for extended travel, including jerky, dried fruit, hardtack, and nuts.

Rope

Rope, whether made of hemp or silk, has 2 health points and can be burst with a DV 17 Brawn check.

Rucksack

A rucksack can hold 0.10 cubic meter or 50 kg of gear. You can also strap items, such as a bedroll or a coil of rope, to the outside of a backpack.

Sack

A sack can hold up to 0.03 cubic meter or 15 kg of gear.

Satchel

A satchel can hold 0.02 cubic meter or 10 kg of gear. You can also strap items, such as a bedroll or a coil of rope, to the outside of a backpack.

Scale, Merchant's

A scale includes a small balance, pans, and a suitable assortment of weights up to 1 kg. With it, you can measure the exact weight of small objects, such as raw precious metals or trade goods, to help determine their worth.

Spyglass

Objects viewed through a spyglass are magnified to twice their size.

Tent

A simple and portable canvas shelter, a tent sleeps two.

Tinderbox

This small container holds flint, fire steel, and tinder (usually dry cloth soaked in light oil) used to kindle a fire. Using it to light a torch—or anything else with abundant, exposed fuel—takes an action. Lighting any other fire takes 1 minute.

Torch

A torch burns for 1 hour, providing bright light in a 4 meter radius and dim light for an additional 4 meter. If you make a melee attack with a burning torch and hit, it deals 1 fire damage.

Vial

A vial can hold up to 100 ml of liquid.

Waterskin

A waterskin can hold up to 2 liters of liquid.

PACKS

A collection of pre-made equipment packs with a method of carrying all of it, a calculated weight and cost. You may purchase these handy packs as is, or modify them to your hearts content - re-calculating its cost and weight.

Basic Pack (11 gp, 15.5 kg)

Includes a backpack (2 gp, 2.5 kg), bedroll (1 gp, 3.5 kg), 10 m of hemp rope (6 gp, 1.5 kg), 3 rations (15 sp, 1.5 kg), soap (2 cp), tinderbox (5 sp, 0.5 kg), 2 torches (2 cp, 1 kg), waterskin (2 sp, 2.5 kg).

Entertainer's Pack (18 gp, 9.5 kg)

Includes a satchel (1 gp, 1.5 kg), bedroll (1 gp, 3.5 kg), costume/uniform (5 gp, 2 kg) flask (2 cp, 1 kg), ink bottle (8 gp), ink pen (2 cp), notebook (2 gp), 3 rations (15 sp, 1.5 kg), soap (2 cp).

Hunter's Pack (18 gp, 22.5 kg)

Includes a rucksack (10 gp, 5 kg), belt (3 sp, 0.5 kg), dagger (2 gp, 0.5 kg), hunting trap (5 gp, 12 kg) 3 rations (15 sp, 1.5 kg), waterskin (2 sp, 2.5 kg), whetstone (1 cp, 0.5 kg).

Knight's Pack (50 gp, 8.5 kg)

Includes a satchel (1 gp, 1.5 kg), amulet (5 gp), book - Radiance of Geanor (25 gp, 2.5 kg), emblem/signet ring (5 gp), hooded lantern (5 gp, 1 kg), ink bottle (8 gp), ink pen (2 cp), oil flask (1 sp, 0.5 kg), 5 sheets of paper (1 gp), sealing wax (5 sp, 0.5 kg), soap (2 cp), waterskin (2 sp, 2.5 kg).

Merchant's Pack (30 gp, 8 kg)

Includes a satchel (1 gp, 1.5 kg), abacus (2 gp, 1 kg), flask (2 cp, 1 kg), ink bottle (8 gp), ink pen (2 cp), lamp (5 sp, 0.5 kg), lock (10 gp, 0.5 kg), merchant's scale (5 gp, 1.5 kg), notebook (2 gp), oil flask (1 sp, 0.5 kg), 5 sheets of parchment (5 sp), 3 rations (15 sp, 1.5 kg), soap (2 cp).

Naturalist's Pack (11 gp 5 sp, 13 kg)

Includes a backpack (2 gp, 2.5 kg), bedroll (1 gp, 3.5 kg), dagger (2 gp, 0.5 kg), herbalism kit (5 gp, 1.5 kg), 3 rations (15 sp, 1.5 kg), 2 torches (2 cp, 1 kg), waterskin (2 sp, 2.5 kg).

Priest's Pack (39 gp, 14 kg)

Includes a backpack (2 gp, 2.5 kg), amulet (5 gp), bedroll (1 gp, 3.5 kg), book - Radiance of Geanor (25 gp, 2.5 kg), healer's kit (5 gp, 1.5 kg), 3 rations (15 sp, 1.5 kg), soap (2 cp), waterskin (2 sp, 2.5 kg).

Scholar's Pack (40 gp, 13 kg)

Includes a backpack (2 gp, 2.5 kg), bedroll (1 gp, 3.5 kg), book (25 gp, 2.5 kg), ink bottle (8 gp), ink pen (2 cp), lamp (5 sp, 0.5 kg), notebook (2 gp), oil flask (1 sp, 0.5 kg), 5 sheets of parchment (5 sp), 2 rations (1 gp, 1 kg), soap (2 cp), waterskin (2 sp, 2.5 kg).

Soldier's Pack (26 gp, 28 kg)

Includes a rucksack (10 gp, 5 kg), bedroll (1 gp, 3.5 kg), 10 m of hemp rope (6 gp, 1.5 kg), hooded lantern (5 gp, 1 kg), mess kit (2 sp, 0.5 kg), oil flask (1 sp, 0.5 kg), 3 rations (15 sp, 1.5 kg), tent for two (2 gp, 10 kg) tinderbox (5 sp, 0.5 kg), 2 torches (2 cp, 1 kg), waterskin (2 sp, 2.5 kg), whetstone (1 cp, 0.5 kg).

Trickster's Pack (18 gp, 17.5 kg)

Includes a backpack (2 gp, 2.5 kg), bedroll (1 gp, 3.5 kg), crowbar (2 gp, 2.5 kg), grappling hook (2 gp, 2 kg), bullseye lantern (10 gp, 1 kg), 1 ration (5 sp, 0.5 kg), 10 m hemp rope (6 sp, 3 kg), waterskin (2 sp, 2.5 kg).

FOOD, DRINK, AND LODGING

The Food, Drink, and Lodging section gives prices for individual food items and a single night's lodging. These prices are included in your total lifestyle expenses.

Alcohol

Alcohol Table	Cost
Ale, Gallon	2 sp
Ale, Mug	4 cp
Wine, common (a pitcher)	2 sp
Wine, fine (bottle)	10 gp

Food

Food Table	Cost
Banquet (per person)	10 gp
Bread, loaf	2 cp
Cheese, hunk	1 sp
Meat, chunk	3 sp

Inn stay (per day)

Inn Stay Table	Cost
Squalid	7 cp
Poor	1 sp
Modest	5 sp
Comfortable	8 sp
Wealthy	2 gp
Aristocratic	4 gp

Meals (per day)

Meals Table	Cost
Squalid	3 cp
Poor	6 cp
Modest	3 sp
Comfortable	5 sp
Wealthy	8 sp
Aristocratic	2 gp

SERVICES

Adventurers can pay nonplayer characters to assist them or act on their behalf in a variety of circumstances. Most such hirelings have fairly ordinary skills, while others are masters of a craft or art, and a few are experts with specialized adventuring skills.

Some of the most basic types of hirelings appear on the services table. Other common hirelings include any of the wide variety of people who inhabit a typical town or city when the adventurers pay them to perform a specific task. For example, a soldier might commission a blacksmith to forge a special sword. A performer bard might pay a tailor to make exquisite clothing for an upcoming performance in front of nobility.

Other hirelings provide more expert or dangerous services. Mercenary soldiers paid to help the adventurers take on a bandit camp are hirelings, as are researchers paid to research history. If a high-level adventurer establishes a stronghold of some kind, he or

she might hire a whole staff of servants and agents to run the place, from a castellan or steward to menial laborers to keep the stables clean. These hirelings often enjoy a long-term contract that includes a place to live within the stronghold as part of the offered compensation.

Services

Services Table	Cost
Coach Cab	
Between Towns	3 cp per km
Within a City	1 cp
Hireling	
Skilled	2 gp per day
Untrained	2 sp per day
Messenger	2 cp per km
Road or Gate Toll	5 cp to 5 sp
Ship's passage	1 sp per mile

MOUNTS AND OTHER VEHICLES

A good mount can help you move more quickly through the wilderness, but its primary purpose is to carry the gear that would otherwise slow you down. The table below shows each animal's speed and base carrying capacity.

An animal pulling a carriage, cart, chariot, sled, or wagon can move weight up to five times its base carrying capacity, including the weight of the vehicle. If multiple animals pull the same vehicle, they can add their carrying capacity together.

Barding

Barding is armor designed to protect an animal's head, neck, chest, and body. Any type of armor shown on the Armor table can be purchased as barding. The cost is four times the equivalent armor made for humanoids, and it weighs twice as much.

Saddles

A military saddle braces the rider, helping you keep your seat on an active mount in battle. It gives you advantage on any check you make to remain mounted.

Saddlebags

Constructed into two satchels which are connected, to distribute weight evenly on the mount. Together they can hold 0.03 cubic meter or 15 kg of gear. You can also strap items, such as a bedroll or a coil of rope, to the outside of a saddlebag.

Vehicle Proficiency

If you have proficiency with a certain kind of vehicle (land or water), you can add your proficiency bonus to any check you make to control that kind of vehicle in difficult circumstances.

Rowed Vessels

Keelboats and rowboats are used on lakes and rivers. If going downstream, add the speed of the current (typically 5 km per hour) to the speed of the vehicle. These vehicles can't be rowed against any significant current, but they can be pulled upstream by draft animals on the shores. A rowboat weighs 50 kg, in case adventurers carry it overland.

Mount and Animal Table	Cost	Speed	Weight
Donkey or mule	8 gp	8 m	200 kg
Horse, draft	50 gp	8 m	250 kg
Horse, riding	75 gp	12 m	220 kg
Mastiff	25 gp	8 m	90 kg
Pony	30 gp	8 m	100 kg
Warhorse	400 gp	12 m	240 kg

Equipment for Mounts and Vehicles

Equipment for Mounts and Vehicles	Cost	Weight
Barding (armor for mounts)	×4 original price	×2 original weight
Bit and bridle	2 gp	0.5 kg
Carriage	100 gp	270 kg
Cart	15 gp	90 kg
Chariot	250 gp	90 kg
Animal Feed (per day)	5 cp	5 kg
Saddle, Military	20 gp	15 kg

Saddle, Pack	5 gp	7.5 kg
Saddle, Riding	10 gp	12 kg
Saddlebags	4 gp	4 kg
Sled	20 gp	140 kg
Stabling (per day)	5 sp	–
Wagon	35 gp	180 kg

Waterborne Vehicles

Ship Table	Cost	Speed
Galley	30,000 gp	6.5 km/h
Keelboat	3,000 gp	1.5 km/h
Longship	10,000 gp	5 km/h
Rowboat	50 gp	2.5 km/h
Sailing ship	10,000 gp	3 km/h
Warship	25,000 gp	4 km/h

ART OBJECTS

250 gp Art Objects

Gold ring with 100 gp gem, bone or ivory statuette, gold bracelet, silver necklace, bronze crown, silver-plated sword, silk robe

1,500 gp Art Objects

Gold ring with 1,000 gp gem, gold or silver statuette, gold bracelet with 500 gp gems, gold necklace with 100 gp gems, silver tiara or crown with 100 gp gems, ivory comb with 500 gp gems, cloth of gold vestments

2,500 gp Art Objects

Gold or platinum ring with 1,000 gp gems, gold or silver statuette with 500 gp gems, gold necklace with 500 gp gems, gold crown with 500 gp gems, gold chalice with 100 gp gems, ceremonial gold breastplate

7,500 gp Art Objects

Platinum ring with 5,000 gp gem, gold statuette with 1,000 gp gems, mithral necklace with 1,000 gp gems, adamantine crown with 1,000 gp gems, adamantine box containing elemental flame, black tunic woven of pure shadow

15,000 gp Art Objects

Mithral ring with an astral diamond, gold statuette with 5,000 gp gems, gold necklace with 5,000 gp gems, mithral tiara with 5,000 gp gems, cup of celestial gold that glows with a soft inner light, silvery cloak of astral thread, enormous emerald or sapphire

Gemstones

100 gp Gems

Amber, amethyst, garnet, moonstone, jade, pearl, peridot, turquoise

500 gp Gems

Alexandrite, aquamarine, black pearl, topaz

1,000 gp Gems

Emerald, fire opal, sapphire

5,000 gp Gems

Diamond, jacinth, ruby

TRADE GOODS

Most wealth is not in coins. It is measured in livestock, grain, land, rights to collect taxes, or rights to resources (such as a mine or a forest). Guilds, nobles, and royalty regulate trade. Chartered companies are granted rights to conduct trade along certain routes, to send merchant ships to various ports, or to buy or sell specific goods. Guilds set prices for the goods or services that they control, and determine who may or may not offer those goods and services. The table below shows the value of commonly exchanged goods.

Trade Goods Table	Cost	Weight
Wheat	2 cp	1 kg
Flour or one chicken	4 cp	1 kg
Salt	1 sp	1 kg
Iron or 1 sq. m. of canvas	2 sp	1 kg
Copper or 1 sq. m. of cotton cloth	10 sp	1 kg
Ginger or one goat	2 gp	1 kg
Cinnamon or pepper, or one sheep	4 gp	1 kg

Cloves or one pig	6 gp	1 kg
Silver or 1 sq. m. of linen	10 gp	1 kg
Silk or one cow	20 gp	1 sq. m
Saffron or one ox	30 gp	1 kg
Gold	100 gp	1 kg
Platinum	1000 gp	1 kg

EXPENSES, INCOME AND LIFESTYLE

Lifestyle expenses provide you with a simple way to account for the cost of living in Frostmark. They cover your accommodation, food and drink, and all your other necessities. Furthermore, expenses cover the cost of maintaining your equipment so you can be ready when adventure next calls.

At the start of each week or month (your choice), choose a lifestyle from the expenses table and pay the price to sustain that lifestyle. The prices listed are per day, so if you wish to calculate the cost of your chosen lifestyle over a monthly period, multiply the listed price by 49.

Your lifestyle might change from one period to the next, based on the funds you have at your disposal, or you might maintain the same lifestyle throughout your character's career. Your lifestyle choices can have consequences. Maintaining a wealthy lifestyle might help you make contacts with the rich and powerful, though you run the risk of attracting thieves. Likewise, living frugally might help you avoid criminals, but you are unlikely to make powerful connections.

Wretched

You live in inhumane conditions. With no place to call home, you shelter wherever you can, sneaking into barns, huddling in old crates, and relying on the good graces of people better off than you. A wretched lifestyle presents abundant dangers. Violence, disease, and hunger follow you wherever you go. Other wretched people covet your armor, weapons, and adventuring gear, which represent a fortune by their standards. You are beneath the notice of most people.

Squalid

You live in a leaky stable, a mud-floored hut just outside town, or a vermin-infested boarding house in the worst part of town. You have shelter from the elements, but you live in a desperate and often violent environment, in places rife with disease, hunger, and misfortune. You are beneath the notice of most people. Most people at this lifestyle level have suffered some terrible setbacks. They might be disturbed, marked as exiles, or suffer from disease.

Poor

A poor lifestyle means going without the comforts available in a stable community. Simple food and lodgings, threadbare clothing, and unpredictable conditions result in a sufficient, though probably unpleasant, experience. Your accommodations might be a room in a flophouse or the common room above a tavern. You benefit from some protections, but you still have to contend with violence, crime, and disease. People at this lifestyle level tend to be unskilled laborers, costermongers, peddlers, thieves, mercenaries, and other disreputable types.

Modest

A modest lifestyle keeps you out of the slums and ensures that you can maintain your equipment. You live in an older part of town, renting a room in a boarding house, inn, or temple. You don't go hungry or thirsty, and your living conditions are clean, if simple. Ordinary people living modest lifestyles include soldiers with families, laborers, students, priests, and the like.

Comfortable

Choosing a comfortable lifestyle means that you can afford nicer clothing and can easily maintain your equipment. You live in a small cottage in a middle-class neighborhood or a private room at a fine inn. You associate with merchants, skilled tradespeople, senior members in the church, and military officers.

Wealthy

Choosing a wealthy lifestyle means living a life of luxury, though you might not have achieved the social status associated with the old money of nobility or royalty. You live a lifestyle comparable to that of a highly successful merchant, a favored servant of royalty, or the owner of a few small businesses. You have respectable lodgings, usually a spacious home in a good part of town or a comfortable suite at a fine inn. You likely have a small staff of servants.

Aristocratic

You live a life of plenty and comfort. You move in circles populated by the most powerful people in the community. You have excellent lodgings, perhaps a townhouse in the nicest part of town or rooms in the finest inn. You dine at the best restaurants, retain the most skilled and fashionable tailor, and have servants attending to your every need. You receive invitations to the social gatherings of the rich and powerful and spend evenings in the company of politicians, guild leaders, high priests, and nobility. You must also contend with the highest levels of deceit and treachery. The wealthier you are, the greater the chance you will be drawn into political intrigue as a pawn or participant.

Lifestyle Price/Day

Lifestyle Table	Cost
Wretched	-
Squalid	1 sp
Poor	2 sp

Modest	1 gp
Comfortable	2 gp
Wealthy	4 gp
Aristocratic	10 gp at min

Expenses and income can just be expressed in the table above. But if the GM or the group is looking for a bit more in-depth economics, they can consult the table below instead. As an RPG, Frostmark is not meant to become too detailed when it comes to economics and the table above is certainly enough unless your group wants something more detailed.

The table below describes monthly (49 days) income instead of daily, assumes values for upkeep costs for rents, food, tools, hirelings, etc., and assumes that taxes are set to 10%. Taxation is something that certainly exists in Frostmark and it varies from area to area, but this book will not explore this topic further than a flat rate of the tenth. A group or a GM is free to make up their own thoughts about this topic if they wish.

These values are only represented in coins, but people can also be paid, or pay taxes, by exchange of goods and services. The table is calculated for monthly income, but regionally payment could be collected in other ways.

Social status	Min income/49d	Lifestyle/49d	Upkeep/49d	Taxes/49d	Profit/49d
Poor	10 gp	5 gp	3 gp	1 gp	1 gp
Modest	50 gp	25 gp	15 gp	5 gp	5 gp
Comfortable	100 gp	50 gp	30 gp	10 gp	10 gp
Wealthy	200 gp	100 gp	60 gp	20 gp	20 gp
Aristocratic	500 gp	250 gp	150 gp	50 gp	50 gp

Self Sufficiency

The expenses and lifestyles described here assume that you are spending your time between adventures in town, availing yourself of whatever services you can afford, paying for food and shelter, paying townspeople to sharpen your sword and repair your armor, and so on. Some characters, though, might prefer to spend their time away from civilization, sustaining themselves in the wild by hunting, foraging, and repairing their own gear.

Maintaining this kind of lifestyle doesn't require you to spend any coin, but it is time-consuming. One rank in Survival allows you to live in the equivalent of a poor lifestyle,

two ranks is the equivalent of a modest lifestyle, and three ranks in a comfortable lifestyle.

RANDOM TRINKET TABLE

Some Backgrounds in this book offer you to pick a random trinket from the Random Trinket table. Simply roll a 1d100 and consult the table below. These trinkets are slightly touched by mystery and are a tool for you and your GM for roleplay opportunities. The trinkets below may hint towards the truth about the Enneade or Frostmark's history, but any trinket or object with origins and effects obviously magical or foreign has been mostly purged by the Inquisition already. If you picked a Background that is devoted to the Church or Riahn, keeping a trinket that is suspiciously heretical in nature requires some kind of explanation for your character's actions. The GM may also use this table outside of Backgrounds, to introduce interesting objects when it suits them.

Random Trinket Table

Roll	Trinket
01	A small charm made out of seashells strung onto a leather necklace
02	A piece of crystal that faintly glows in the moonlight
03	A gold coin minted in an unknown land or time
04	A bundle of fragrant smelling herbs that, when burnt, release a relaxing aroma
05	A brass ring that never tarnishes
06	An old chess piece made from glass
07	A piece of stone that changes color based on the mood of its owner
08	A list of five people's names, the last smudged and crossed through
09	A set of tarot cards depicting each figure on the cards as a skeleton
10	A wolf-skin cloak that sometimes causes the wearer to growl under his breath
11	A 50 gr block made from an unknown material
12	A parchment showing the constellations in the night sky
13	A tooth from an unknown beast

14	An enormous scale, perhaps from a dragon
15	A horseshoe that never becomes worn or needs replacing
16	An old divination card bearing your likeness
17	A gold coin that always comes up heads when flipped
18	A crystal that refracts light strangely and has an odd dark deposit at its center
19	A playbook from a performance where many of the audience died in a suspicious fire
20	The script for a never-published play about an author going mad, the writing gets noticeably less neat and more frantic, it stops abruptly before the finished page
21	A tapestry depicting a mythological scene
22	A small wooden statuette of a small, smug, and strange person
23	A brass orb etched with strange runes
24	A set of spectacles that give everything an amber hue when worn
25	A tiny silver icon of a raven

26	A set of leather riding gloves with the initials J.M. branded onto them
27	A shard of obsidian that always feels warm to the touch
28	A dragon's bony talon hanging from a plain leather necklace
29	A metal branding iron with the design of a dragon's wing
30	A blank book whose pages refuse to hold ink, chalk, graphite, or any other substance or marking
31	A silver badge in the shape of two stars connected by a ring
32	A knife that belonged to a relative
33	A wooden puzzle box you have not solved

34	A box containing a mold for a cast iron key
35	A small jewelry box containing three perfectly round and smooth stones
36	A vest with one hundred tiny pockets
37	A small weightless stone block
38	A map with a large path of ocean torn out
39	An empty glass vial that smells of perfume when opened
40	A gemstone that looks like a lump of coal when examined by anyone but you
41	A scrap of cloth from an old banner
42	A rank insignia from a lost soldier
43	A horn when blown through produces no sound
44	A bouncing ball made of a strange spongy wood
45	A letter from a relative addressing you by a different name
46	A right-arm of a broken off from a statue
47	A metal can that has no opening but sounds as if it is filled with liquid, sand, spiders, or broken glass (your choice)
48	A small piece of fabric that still holds the scent of a lost love
49	A silver spoon with an M engraved on the handle
50	A whistle made from gold-colored wood

51	A dead scarab beetle the size of your hand
52	Two toy soldiers, one with a missing head
53	A small stone amulet with a carving of a strange and unknown beast
54	A candle that can't be lit

55	A small rabbit-fur pouch filled with ceremonial herbs and incense
56	An old key
57	An indecipherable treasure map
58	A hilt from a broken sword
59	A rabbit's foot
60	A glass eye
61	A cameo carved in the likeness of a hideous person
62	A silver skull the size of a coin
63	An alabaster mask
64	A small dark glass corked bottle filled to the brim with a powerful liquor
65	A nightcap that, when worn, gives you pleasant dreams
66	A single caltrop made from bone
67	A gold monocle frame without the lens
68	A perfect forgery of a small masterpiece work of art
69	A crystal knob from a door
70	A merchant's scale you can adjust with a handwave to weigh slightly in your favor
71	A fragment of a beautiful song, written as musical notes on two pieces of parchment
72	A silver teardrop earring
73	An unfinished autobiography
74	A fan that, when unfolded, shows a sleeping cat
75	A bag of one-hundred marbles, ninety-nine are white and the other is black

76	A four-leaf clover pressed inside a book discussing manners and etiquette
77	A copper locket containing a portrait whose eyes and mouth have been scratched out
78	An ornate scabbard that fits no blade you have found so far
79	An invitation to a party where a murder happened
80	A sealed letter addressed to you, but your name is preceded by an unfamiliar title
81	A purple handkerchief embroidered with the name of a powerful, but dead, noble
82	Half of a floorplan for a temple, castle, or some other structure
83	A signed not promising one free drink at the nearest tavern or bar
84	A seal which imprints a mysterious, unknown coat of arms
85	A diary with seven missing pages
86	An empty silvery snuffbox bearing an inscription on the surface that says "dreams"
87	A shark tooth covered in tiny etched words from an unknown language
88	A book that tells the story of a legendary hero's rise and fall, with the last chapter missing
89	A small stone cube that acts as a magnet when placed against another stone
90	An ancient arrow-head of unknown design
91	A needle that never bends
92	An ornate brooch of unknown design
93	A charred chisel with an unfamiliar symbol stamped into its base
94	A mosaic tile with a multicolored, glazed surface
95	A faceless doll made of driftwood

96	A black pirate flag adorned with a dragon's skull and crossbones
97	A small comb made of blue coral
98	A small needle that points in the direction of the nearest drinkable water
99	A ancient piece of an urn, its paint faded but depicts picture and symbols on it
100	A metal urn containing ashes

STEP 8 – CHARACTER CREATION EXAMPLES

In this section you'll find two player characters, Helos and Rogath, go through the seventh step in character creation.

“Helos”

Step 8

Eve adds these items to Helos' character sheet:

- Reinforced leather armor (45 gp)
- Light crossbow (25 gp)
- A bundle of 20 crossbow bolts (1 gp)
- Bedroll (1 gp)
- Healer's Kit (5 gp)
- Priest's Pack (19 gp)
- Tent (2 gp)

Savings: 42 gp

From Helos' background (15 gp) and the Accomplishment table (125 gp), Eve has a total of 140 gp to purchase Helos' equipment. She chooses the best armor for him in the light armor category as Helos would have no issues accessing that quality of arms as he comes from a big city and holds an influential career. Helos is quite physically weak, so Eve picks up a light crossbow for him, a weapon he would be more comfortable using in a pinch. For travelling purposes, Helos has a tent, a bedroll and a Priest's Pack. When accidents happen, Helos likes having easy access to a Healer's Kit.

“Rogath”

Step 8

Carl adds these items to Rogath's character sheet:

- Chain Mail (75 gp)
- Dagger (2 gp)
- Explorers' Pack (10 gp)
- Halberd (20 gp)
- Four javelins (2 gp)

- Tent (2 gp)
 - Two whetstones (2 cp)
- Savings: 3 gp, 9 sp, 8 cp

From Rogath's background (15 gp) and the Accomplishment table (100 gp), Carl has a total of 115 gp to purchase Rogath's equipment. Most of Rogath's is invested into his chain mail armor, the best that his village can provide him with. In this case, an heirloom that the former strongest warrior wore - now Rogath's. Next up, Carl chooses the Halberd as Rogath's main weapon, a powerful tool but still elegant in its execution. Carl also gives Rogath four javelins for Rogath's thrown weapon proficiency. The Explorer's Pack provides Rogath with almost all the tools he would have brought with him when he left his village. Carl adds to this pack a tent for more comfortable camping and whetstones, so Rogath can keep his weapons sharp and deadly. That leaves Rogath with some pocket change left, a sum that is reasonable for a person who has grown up in a small and isolated village to possess.

STEP 9 – CALCULATE IMPORTANT VALUES

In this second to last step its time to clean up and finalize your character sheet. The official Frostmark character sheet is great tool to help you record all the immersive choices you've made so far when creating your character, but also great for finding the right thing at the right time when it truly matters - having fun in your session. That efficiency and speed also depends upon your diligence to note all the values, capabilities and stats down, as well as presenting those blurbs of information in a manner that you can easily grasp in the heat of the moment.

Towards that end, there are a number of important values that you will probably use often in play. If you haven't calculated the values below and presented them in an easy to read spot, its time to do so now. They are as follow;

ARMOR VALUE (AV)

Your armor value will notify you if an attack against your character is successful or not. The armor value starts at 10, but there are many ways to increase this value. First of all, you get to add your Dextirty modifier on top of the base armor value. If you purchased armor it may increase this further, or even swap out your starting value. A shield will increase it even further with an extra +2 added to the value. Unarmored Defense abilities from some Ability Origins will grant another Ability Score's modifier to be added on top of your starting armor value with Dexterity's bonus. Lastly, there might be other abilities or feats that can grant you extra bonuses. If you discover you haven't chosen anything that changes your base armor value or adds bonuses to it, consider heading back in the character creation process and see if you can pick up something.

HEALTH POINTS (HP)

Your Health Points decide how much damage your character can take before they are out of commission. At level 1, your character gets the maximum amount of the Health Dice they get from your Ability Origin of choice that level, plus your Vitality modifier. For every level thereafter, you roll the Health Dice you receive from the Ability Origin, adding your Vitality modifier to the result. If you would roll a number that is half or lower than half on the Health Dice, add half of the maximum value of the HD to the result you rolled. Keep in mind that there are Feats, Races and Abilities that might increase your HP pool beyond this.

INITIATIVE

The initiative order dictates the order of actor's turn in a high stake moment, such as a combat. Your initiative bonus equal your Dexterity modifier but there might be some abilities, traits or features that may increase that value. Keep your initiative value close at hand so you can quickly to react to the call of action.

WEAPON ATTACK MODIFIER

Your weapon attack modifier is another value that is good to have on hand for all your weapons you're in possession of. The basic weapon attack modifier is calculated as "(Proficiency Bonus +) weapon Ability Score modifier". To be able to add your Proficiency Bonus to your weapon attack modifier you must purchase proficiency with the particular type of weapon you're wielding through Accomplishment points, or otherwise get it from other Abilities and traits. The weapon Ability Score modifier is

determined by what kind of weapon you're using. Most weapons either rely on Brawn or Dexterity.

SPELL ATTACK MODIFIER

If your character possesses spellcasting, having a calculated spell attack modifier will be useful. When rolling a direct melee or ranged spell attack against a target, it is your spell attack modifier you'll be using. Your spell attack modifier is calculated as your "Proficiency Bonus + your spellcasting Ability Score modifier". By this point you should have decided upon a spellcasting Ability Score for your magic, but if you haven't - do so now with your GM. Your spell attack modifier is also what you use when determining if your character succeeds on a Soul Check or not. Read more about Soul Checks in the Spellcasting section.

SPELL DIFFICULTY VALUE (SPELL DV)

Secondly, if your character possesses spellcasting, a spell DV will also come in handy. When targeting enemies with some spells they might force an enemy to make a saving throw against your Spell DV. In other words, they will try to evade your might with magic through various physical, mental and social challenges. Your Spell DV is not something you roll in the moment, but something targets roll against and compare their result to. You calculate your spell DV as "8 + spell attack modifier".

OTHER VALUES

There might be other values that are pertinent to your character that you should take the time to calculate before play. They may include but not limited to; money, Souls, encumbrance, various Ability resources, etc. Page 2 of the official Frostmark character sheet is an excellent place to track your various Ability Origin resources such as Rage, Inspiration Dies, Sorcery Points, Mastery Points, etc.

STEP 10 – BACKSTORY

The last step in Frostmark character creation is to finalize your backstory is it is ready to be used by you in game. If this is not your first time roleplaying, you know best how to make a backstory that works for you. Just be sure to have an active dialogue with your GM so you can more expertly tailor your character to the narrative they want to spin. If this is your first time making a backstory use your GM for help and guidance.

CHARACTER CREATION EXAMPLES

In this section you'll find two player characters, Helos and Rogath, whose character creation process is presented below, step by step.

“HELOS”

Step 1 - Concept and AOs

Eve wants to create a priest of Riahn character, so she starts to tinker with the broad-strokes of her character's backstory;

Helos Alkis is a young but gifted man. Born and raised in Goldbank, the headquarters of the Church of Riahn in Crowhill. Helos grew up in the social cast of the Warmth, which ensured him a solid education. His piousness and talent allowed him to seek a career within the Church of Riahn. As an apprentice priest, he discovers that he possesses a hidden heritage, celestial blood. Helos became elated and believed himself to be one of Riahn's chosen. A few years later, Helios graduates as a full-fledged priest, ready to accept any position and duty he is given.

Helos' player, Eve, and her GM together decide upon [Devotion] and [Unique Ancestry] for Helos' starting AOs.

Step 2 - Race

Eve decides that Helos is a human and notes down what he gains from the race;

- ❖ Resolve ability score +1
- ❖ Manipulation ability score +1
- ❖ Helos devotes his Soul to Riahn.
- ❖ Helos picks the feat Theologian;
 - Increase Intelligence ability score by +1
 - Helos gains one skill point in Academics (Church of Riahn)
 - Helos gains three Soul Mastery spells, Thaumaturgy, Ceremony, and Sanctuary. He can cast Ceremony and Sanctuary at level 1 once per long rest.

Eve wanted to create a priest from Crowhill, so the race of "human" is the only race that makes sense with the setting and her wishes. Humans receive two +1 in two ability scores of their choice, so Eve considers what would fit for Helos. Helos has exceptional faith, so Eve argues that his Resolve score should gain one +1. Eve also wants Helos to be an excellent public speaker and gives Manipulation +1. As for the "Freedom of Devotion" trait that humans obtain, Eve decides that Helos has devoted his Soul to Riahn. The Theologian feat fits Helos' background the best, in Eve's opinion, so she notes down that his Intelligence score gain +1, it gives him a skill point in Academics (Church of Riahn), and he learns three Soul Mastery spells.

Step 3 - Background

Eve decides on the background of "Crow Priest" for Helos, and she notes down in his character sheet:

- ❖ Another skill point in Academics (Church of Riahn)
- ❖ A skill point in Academics (Rianish)
- ❖ A skill point in Empathy
- ❖ A skill point in Persuasion
- ❖ In the equipment section, Eve marks down: The holy symbol of Riahn (a gift to Helos when he entered the priesthood), a prayer book, a copy of the Radiance of Geanor, vestments, a Tattoo Kit, a set of common clothes, and a belt pouch containing 15 gp.
- ❖ The background feature of "Partial Soul Drain."
- ❖ The background feature of "Priest of the Sun God."
- ❖ The background bond of "Devotion to the Sun."

Eve thinks that Crow Priest is the obvious choice for Helos. She chooses Empathy and Persuasion for Helos' oratory and social aptitude.

Step 4 - Ability Scores

Eve purchases these ability scores:

Br 8 (-1)	Dex 10 (0)	Vit 12 (+1)
Int 15 (+3)	Cun 12 (+1)	Res 17 (+3)
Pre 14 (+2)	Man 15 (+2)	Com 10 (0)

She adds the ability score bonuses Helos gained from the race of human and the feat Theologian so the final ability scores become as follows:

Br 8 (-1)	Dex 10 (0)	Vit 12 (+1)
Int 16 (+3)	Cun 12 (+1)	Res 18 (+4)
Pre 14 (+2)	Man 16 (+3)	Com 10 (0)

When Eve asks her GM which power level the campaign has, she learns that they will be playing with a heroic power level. With the 25 ability score points she gains, Eve wonders what Helos' stats would be. Since Helos will be a spellcaster, Eve considers first what spellcasting ability score Helos will possess and eventually settles on Resolve since Helos is stalwart in his faith. Hence, Eve decides to make this Helos' best ability score. Eve also wants Helos to be able to encourage the masses in the Rianish faith and thus assigns some points to Helos' Presence and Manipulation. Eve thinks that Helos would not be the most intimidating or striking figure, but still shows some confidence, so she gives Helos more Manipulation than Presence.

As Helos has been a scholar all his life, Eve lowers his Brawn to show the neglect of his martial side. However, he has lived a sheltered life where he always has had access to food and excellent healthcare, so Eve increases his Vitality slightly. Helos is sharp and has been given a good education, so Eve wants to invest some points into more of his mental ability scores. The Church does not value nurturing their pupils to think for themselves, so Eve decides that Helos' Intelligence score is higher than his Cunning.

Step 5 - Accomplishments

Eve has 16 points to spend on Accomplishments as the power-level of the campaign is heroic. She spends it on:

- ❖ The armor proficiency of light armor (1 point)

- ❖ The weapon proficiency of crossbows (1 point)
- ❖ Another skill point in Empathy (1 point)
- ❖ A skill point in Investigation (1 point)
- ❖ Two skill points in Leadership (2 points)
- ❖ A skill point in Medicine (1 point)
- ❖ A skill point in Occult (1 point)
- ❖ Another skill point in Persuasion (1 point)
- ❖ Proficiency for Resolve saving throws (2 points)
- ❖ An extra 125 gp (5 points)

As Helos haven't needed to practice that much martial self-defense, Eve only assigns him proficiency with light armor and crossbows. She spends 7 points in skills, improving his Empathy and Persuasion, and gives him some more social and utility skills that he has come across in his education. Eve spends two points on the Resolve saving throw to empathize his confidence. As a priest blessed with celestial ancestry in Crowhill, Helos' would earn a handsome salary. Thus, it makes sense to invest the rest of the Accomplishments points into money.

Step 6 - Choose abilities from AOs

Level 1 - Primary Selection (PS);

Lvl 1 PS [Devotion] - Divine Domain - Law - Voice of Authority

Level 1 - Secondary Selection (SS);

Lvl 1 SS [Divine Bestowal] - General Upgrade (+10 Potential)

Activated tags of Devotion

HP: 9/9

Extra skill points: none

Potential: 60

Eve levels Helos to level one. She picks [Devotion] as Helos Primary Selection for this level. Since Eve has chosen Order as Helos' Divine Domain, Helos can't pick any other Divine Domains in the future. Eve does not think that [Devotion]'s Secondary Selection Ability, heavy armor proficiency, suits Helos. Since [Unique Ancestry] doesn't have anything suitable for Helos in the Second Selection either, Eve takes a General Upgrade instead, choosing extra Potential.

Eve also activates her tags for the level. Since [Devotion] was her Primary Selection pick, she activates the tags of [Devotion];

Tags

HD: 1d8

Bonus Skill Points: None

Spellcasting: Major

Since it is level one, Helos receives the full value of his health dice plus his Vitality modifier. That puts him at 8+1 HP. [Devotion] does not receive any extra skill points, so Eve simply ignores that part. [Devotion] is, however, a "Spellcasting: Major" AO, which means she receives 60 potential on level 1 according to the "Potential Gain per Level and Tag" table.

Step 7 - Spellcasting

Eve uses Helos' Potential to buy cantrips, spell slots and spells for Helos;

Cantrips

Sacred Flame

Spare the Dying

Thaumaturgy (from background)

Spell Slots

3 x Level 1

Spells Known

Level 1: *Command*

Level 1: *Ceremony* (from background)

Level 1: *Healing Word*

Level 1: *Sanctuary* (from background)

Souls: Two Potency 2

Since Helos has been given a Soul Mark and been taught spellcasting in his backstory as a Crow priest, Eve is free to purchase spells with her Potential pool. At first level, Eve chose [Devotion] as her Primary Selection, meaning that Helos gains major spellcasting at this level. Therefore, the Potential pool equals 60, but Helos receives an extra +10 Potential from the General Upgrade Eve taken on Secondary Selection. She purchases three spell slots of level 1 for 30 potential and then picks two cantrips and two level 1 spells for an additional 40 potential. Furthermore, Helos starts with two level 1 Souls in his Soul Mark.

Step 8 - Equipment

Eve adds these items to Helos' character sheet:

- Reinforced leather armor (45 gp)
- Light crossbow (25 gp)
- A bundle of 20 crossbow bolts (1 gp)
- Bedroll (1 gp)
- Healer's Kit (5 gp)
- Priest's Pack (19 gp)
- Tent (2 gp)

Savings: 42 gp

From Helos' background (15 gp) and the Accomplishment table (125 gp), Eve has a total of 140 gp to purchase Helos' equipment. She chooses the best armor for him in the light armor category as Helos would have no issues accessing that quality of arms as he comes from a big city and holds an influential career. Helos is quite physically weak, so Eve picks up a light crossbow for him, a weapon he would be more comfortable using in a pinch. For travelling purposes, Helos has a tent, a bedroll and a Priest's Pack. When accidents happen, Helos likes having easy access to a Healer's Kit.

Step 9 - Calculate important statistics

Eve makes sure that Helos' statistics, abilities and spells are all in order.

Armor Value (p.252): 12 (Reinforced leather armor)

Health points (p.111): 9 (1d8+1)

Speed (p.18): 6 m

Initiative (p.290): +0

Passive Perception (p.104): 10

Saving throws (p. 98)
Res +7

Skills (p. 102)

Aca2 (Church of Riahn) +5 (Int), **Aca1** (Rianish) +4 (Int), **Emp2** +5/+2 (Man/Com), **Inv1** +2 (Cun), **Lead2** +4/+5 (Pre/Man), **Med1** +4/+2 (Int/Cun), **Occ1** +4/+2 (Int/Cun), **Pers2** +4/+5 (Pre/Man)

Light crossbow attack roll (p. 256 and p. 290): +2

Spell attack roll (p. 247 and p. 290): +6

Spell DV (p. 247 and p. 290): 14

Helos have reinforced leather armor, which allows his AV to be 12 plus his Dexterity modifier (+0), which results in an AV of 12. Since it is level 1, Helos receives the full value of his health dice plus his Vitality modifier. That puts him at 8+1 health points. Helos' initiative bonus is +0 because of his Dexterity modifier.

To calculate Helos' skills and saving throws, Eve adds the appropriate ability score modifier and Helos' proficiency bonus of +2, which might be modified by skill ranks. Helos have no proficiencies with melee weapons, so Eve does not note anything down, but if Helos attacked in melee, his attack roll would receive a -1.

His ranged attack roll is somewhat higher as he carries a light crossbow for which he has proficiency with, making his modifier equal his proficiency bonus (+2) plus his Dexterity modifier (+0).

As a spellcaster, Helos uses his Resolve for his spellcasting. His spell attack modifier equals his proficiency bonus (+2) in addition to his Resolve modifier (+4), a total of +6. Helos' spell DV is calculated 8 plus the +6 modifier, which equals 14.

Step 10 - Finishing touches

Eve searches for a character portrait for her character, finishes Helos' backstory, and double-checks the character sheet. She shares her character with her GM, who eventually declares that Eve is ready to play!

“ROGATH”

Step 1 - Concept and AOs

Carl wants to create a character that is not from Frostmark and who is martial in his theme. Eventually, he comes with this character concept to his GM;

Rogath is a black dragonborn from Borias' Realm of Kess'Aai. He was born in a small, but capable, dragonborn village on one of the smaller islands in the archipelagos on Kess'Aai. The village had a strong martial background, teaching all citizens who could hold a weapon to defend themselves. Rogath was born with great talent, and he quickly surpassed his peers when he was but a child. From an early age, all Rogath knew was achievement and praise, so he grew quickly prideful. In his late teenage years, the village felt boring for him as he felt his progression stagnate in the lack of challenge. Despite the villagers begging him to

not go, either because of familial love or fear of the loss of a great warrior, Rogath still set out on his own. He seeks to challenge and the limit of his own potential.

Carl and his GM decide that Rogath has [Tactics] and [Soul Oath] as his ability origins due to his martial background and focused mindset.

Step 2 - Race

Carl decides that Rogath is a black dragonborn and notes down what Rogath receives from the race:

- ❖ Brawn ability score +2
- ❖ Resolve ability score +1
- ❖ Presence ability score +1
- ❖ Darkvision 12 m
- ❖ Rogath has a Draconic Breath that deals acid damage (2d6, 6 m line, DV 13 Dex ST)
- ❖ Rogath gains resistance to acid damage.

Carl had a pretty clear picture of wanting to create a theme of a "black knight." The black dragonborn is not only physically a perfect match for this but also emotionally suitable. Dragonborn are stubborn and goal-oriented, and the black variant is especially competitive - perfect for the personality and backstory of Rogath.

Step 3 - Background

Carl chooses the background of "Soldier" for Rogath as his village was mostly structured like a military organization.

- ❖ Two skill points in Athletics
- ❖ One skill point Leadership
- ❖ One skill point Perception
- ❖ One skill point Survival
- ❖ In the equipment section Carl marks down: An insignia of his martial rank, a trophy for defeating the most powerful warrior in his village in the form of a piece of their banner, chess set, a set of common clothes, and a belt pouch containing 15 gp.
- ❖ The background feature of "Army Hierarchy"
- ❖ The background bond of "Military Service"

Step 4 - Ability scores

Carl purchases these ability scores:

Br 16 (+3)	Dex 12 (+1)	Vit 16 (+3)
Int 10 (0)	Cun 14 (+2)	Res 15 (+2)
Pre 13 (+1)	Man 8 (-1)	Com 14 (+2)

Carl adds the ability score bonuses Rogath gained from the race of dragonborn so the final ability scores become as follows:

Br 18 (+4)	Dex 12 (+1)	Vit 16 (+3)
Int 10 (0)	Cun 14 (+2)	Res 16 (+3)
Pre 14 (+2)	Man 8 (-1)	Com 14 (+2)

When Carl asks his GM which power level the campaign has, he learns that they will be playing with a champion power level. With the 30 ability score points he gains, Carl wonders what Rogath's' scores would be. Carl quickly decides that Rogath will be a Brawn-

based fighter, and considering Rogath's grueling upbringing, Carl makes Brawn Rogath's best ability score. Rogath's Vitality score would also be high, from the harsh nature of his home and training. Rogath has never been that agile, but he gained some dexterity through his past workouts.

There wasn't much access to education in Rogath's village, but Cunning is a vital talent to nurture - to survive in the wild, and outsmart your opponents. Resolve is an obvious choice for Rogath, as he is indeed very stubborn and aspirational. His confidence and impressive stature allow him some Presence. But his dogged pursuit of martial prowess has led him to mostly ignore his social aptitudes. His competitive and aggressive nature didn't give him any good friends growing up either. Lastly, his lonesome nature has made him more observant of his surroundings.

Step 5 - Accomplishments

Carl has 18 points to spend on Accomplishments as the power-level of the campaign is champion. She spends it on:

- ❖ The armor proficiency of light armor to heavy armor (3 points)
- ❖ The weapon proficiency of heavy (3 points)
- ❖ The weapon proficiency of thrown (3 points)
- ❖ A skill point in Medicine (1 point)
- ❖ Another skill point in Survival (1 point)
- ❖ Proficiency for Brawn saving throws (1 point)
- ❖ Proficiency for Resolve saving throws (2 points)
- ❖ An extra 100 gp (4 points)

Rogath has been training with weapons and armors his whole life, so Carl assigns many points in armor and weapon proficiencies. Rogath prefers powerful and heavy weapons but has taught himself to throw weapons too - to ensure that he can defend himself with a ranged option as well. There have been many scrapes and bruises from all the training, duels, and the savage land he grew up in. Therefore, it makes sense for Rogath to have rudimentary experience with Medicine. Carl picked another skill point in Survival from his experience helping the village to hunt and survive. Carl also decides that Rogath should have two saving throws, Brawn and Resolve. Rogath has focused a lot on his physique, so Brawn is an obvious choice, and so is Resolve due to Rogath's exceptionally stubborn nature. Lastly, the rest of the Accomplishment points are put into money since Rogath has earned good arms and armor from the village as a reward his prowess.

Step 6 - Choose abilities from AOs

Level 1 - Primary Selection (PS):

Lvl 1 PS [Tactics] - Action Surge

Level 1 - Secondary Selection (SS):

Lvl 1 SS [Tactics] - Second Wind

Activated tags of [Tactics]

HP: 13/13

Extra skill points: 4 skill points

- ❖ Another 2 skill points to Athletics
- ❖ One skill point to Animal Handling
- ❖ One skill point to Persuasion

Potential: 20

Carl levels Rogath to level one. Due to Rogath's strictly martial upbringing, Carl and his GM agree that [Tactics] makes the most sense to start with. The abilities of Action Surge and Second Wind suit Rogath splendidly, so Carl simply picks both abilities as his Primary and Secondary Selection for the level.

Carl also activates his tags for the level. Since [Tactics] was his Primary Selection pick, he activates the tags of [Tactics];

Tags

HD: 1d10

Bonus Skill Points: Extra (4 skill points)

Spellcasting: Minor

Since it is level one, Rogath receives the full value of his health dice plus his Vitality modifier. That puts him at 10+3 HP. [Tactics] receive extra skill points, so Carl assigns 2 skill points in Athletics, once again to hammer home his martial power. He puts a point in Animal Handling to represent the time he spent helping to take care of the village-owned animals. And a point in Persuasion, from practicing intimidation and mind games in combat. Rogath also gains 20 Potential since [Tactics] is a minor spellcasting AO.

Step 7 - Spellcasting

Carl notes down in Rogath's character sheet that he has 20 Potential stored.

Since Rogath has no Soul Mark, he cannot possess spellcasting. After all, his village didn't have the resources or knowledge to bestow something so valuable unto Rogath. Even if Rogath cannot spend his Potential for spellcasting, Carl still keeps the Potential in mind. When Carl gets to play with Rogath in a session, he can spend his Potential to give Rogath small boosts. See Exaltation on page 239.

Step 8 - Equipment

Carl adds these items to Rogath's character sheet:

- ❖ Chain Mail (75 gp)
 - ❖ Dagger (2 gp)
 - ❖ Explorers' Pack (10 gp)
 - ❖ Halberd (20 gp)
 - ❖ Four javelins (2 gp)
 - ❖ Tent (2 gp)
 - ❖ Two whetstones (2 cp)
- Savings: 3 gp, 9 sp, 8 cp

From Rogath's background (15 gp) and the Accomplishment table (100 gp), Carl has a total of 115 gp to purchase Rogath's equipment. Most of Rogath's is invested into his chain mail armor, the best that his village can provide him with. In this case, an heirloom that the former strongest warrior wore - now Rogath's. Next up, Carl chooses the Halberd as Rogath's main weapon, a powerful tool but still elegant in its execution. Carl also gives Rogath four javelins for Rogath's thrown weapon proficiency. The Explorer's Pack provides Rogath with almost all the tools he would have brought with him when he left his village. Carl adds to this pack a tent for more comfortable camping and whetstones, so Rogath can keep his weapons sharp and deadly. That leaves Rogath with some pocket change left, a sum that is reasonable for a person who has grown up in a small and isolated village to possess.

Step 9 - Calculate important statistics

Carl makes sure that Rogath's statistics and abilities are all in order.

Armor value (p. 252): 16 (chain mail, disadvantage Stealth)

Health points (p. 111): 13 (1d10+3)

Speed (p. 18): 6 m

Initiative (p. 290): +1

Passive Perception (p. 104): 13

Saving throws (p. 98)

Br +6

Res +5

Skills (p. 102)

AniH1 +3/+3 (Cun/Pre), **Athl3 +7/+4** (Br/Dex), **Lead1 +3/+0** (Pre/Man), **Med1 +1/+3** (Int/Cun), **Perc1 +1/+3** (Int/Com), **Pers1 +3/+0** (Pre/Man), **Sur2 +2/+4** (Int/Cun)

Halberd attack roll (p. 256 and p. 290): +6

Thrown javelin attack roll (p. 256 and p. 290): +3

Rogath wears chain mail, which grants him an AV of 16. Chain mail has a Brawn requirement to wear comfortably of 13, which Rogath easily surpasses. Carl also notes that Rogath receives disadvantage on Stealth checks while wearing this heavy armor. Since it is level 1, Rogath gains the full value of his health dice plus his Vitality modifier. That puts him at 10+3 health points. Rogath's initiative bonus is +1 because of his Dexterity modifier. To calculate Rogath's skills and saving throws, Carl adds the appropriate ability score modifier and Rogath's proficiency bonus of +2, which might be modified by skill ranks. When Rogath rolls an attack roll with a melee weapon he is proficient with, he adds +6 to the roll (+2 proficiency and +4 Brawn ability modifier). His ranged attack rolls with thrown weapons become +3 (+2 proficiency and +1 Dexterity ability modifier)

Step 10 - Finishing touches

Carl searches for a character portrait for his character, finishes Rogath's backstory, and double-checks the character sheet. Carl shares Rogath's character with his GM, who eventually declares that Carl is ready to play!

LEVEL UP EXAMPLES

Over time your character will become more competent. This is represented by leveling up your character. Your GM decides when you level through milestones you achieve through play. Eve and Carl play a few sessions, and both their characters progress to level 5. In this section, we will explore the advancement process for Helo and Rogath for all five levels.

Depending on your character's total level, their proficiency bonus may have increased. See page 98.

HELOS

Step 1: Pick your abilities

Eve carefully reads the rules and instructions about ability origins in the “Level Up” section before she begins picking Helos’ abilities.

Level 2

Lvl 2 PS [Unique Ancestry] - Font of Magic

Lvl 2 SS [Unique Ancestry] - General Upgrade (+10 Potential)

Level 3

Lvl 2 PS [Devotion] - Channel Divinity - Law - Authoritative Command

Lvl 2 SS [Devotion] - General Upgrade (+10 Potential)

Level 4

Lvl 3 PS [Unique Ancestry] - Metamagic

Lvl 3 SS [Unique Ancestry] - General Upgrade (+10 Potential)

Level 5

Lvl 1 PS [Unique Ancestry] - Celestial - Blessed

Lvl 1 SS [Unique Ancestry] - General Upgrade (+10 Potential)

Eve chooses [Unique Ancestry] as Helos’ level 2 primary selection ability to signify his discovery of his special heritage. Since Helos is total level 2, he can pick abilities from his AOs ([Devotion] and [Unique Ancestry]) that are level 2 or below (but cannot pick two abilities twice unless otherwise stated). Eve thinks that “Font of Magic” makes more sense as it is not as obvious of an ability as “Blessed,” the level 1 primary selection ability in [Unique Ancestry]. Eve wants it to be a gradual reveal for Helos.

On level 3, Eve opts for [Devotion]. During level 2, Helos had been doing several prayers and ceremonies for Riahn rather than spending much time with self-discovery. Therefore, [Devotion] makes more sense as the level 3 pick. As Helos has now picked a “Channel Divinity” option, “Law,” he cannot take an ability from any other “Channel Divinity” options in [Devotion].

At level 4, Eve can decide to give Helos “ASI or feat,”; to increase his ability scores or gain a feat. Eve argues that Helos haven’t picked up any special talents (feats) during play so far. Instead, he has been focusing inward to unlock his magical potential from within. As Helos is now a total level 4, he can choose any ability in his AOs level 4 or below. At level 4, Eve decides to take “Metamagic” to give Helos’ Font of Magic ability an upgrade.

Then at level 5, where she could have given Helos an “Improved Magical Upgrade” (see the “General Upgrade” rule in the “How to navigate the Ability Origins” section), Eve thinks it is finally time that Helos’ heritage is made obvious. She gives him the “Blessed” ability, all the way back from level 1. As Eve picks abilities from level 1 to 3 at higher total levels (level 4 and 5), Helos also gains a second selection ability from each such pick. Eve hasn’t found any second selection option that she thinks makes sense for Helos (that is not already a “Magical Upgrade.”) So, at every level, she gives Helos extra Potential from the “Magical Upgrade” ability that can always be swapped out for a primary or secondary selection. She argues that Helos focuses greatly on his spellcasting, especially since he tries to uncover the magic he harbors from within. Therefore, more Potential from the “Magical Upgrade” is aligned with Helos.

She also notes that at level 5 Helos gains a higher proficiency bonus and two extra Accomplishment points.

Step 2: Activate your HD tag

[**Devotion**] and [**Unique Ancestry**] have the same health dice tag, 1d8, so Eve rolls a 1d8 each time Helos levels up to increase his health points.

Level 2: Eve rolls a 2. She adds 4 to the result.
 $HP\ 9\ (+2+4)\ +1 = HP\ 16$

Level 3: Eve rolls a 1. She adds 4 to the result.
 $HP\ 16\ (+1+4)\ +1 = HP\ 22$

Level 4: Eve rolls a 4. She adds 4 to the result.
 $HP\ 22\ (+4+4)\ +1 = HP\ 31$

Level 5: Eve rolls a 6.
 $HP\ 31\ (+6)\ +1 = HP\ 38$

Whenever Eve rolls a value that is half or less of a health dice, she adds half the health dice value to the result. Half of 1d8 is 4. Therefore, whenever Eve rolls a result of 4 or below, she adds 4 to the result. Every time she rolls the health dice to increase Helos’ HP, she also adds Helos’ Vitality modifier to the result, which is a +1.

Step 3: Check your Bonus Skill Points tag

Both [**Devotion**] and [**Unique Ancestry**] have the tag “Bonus Skill Points: None,” so Helos do not receive any extra skill points.

Step 4: Tally your Potential

[**Devotion**] and [**Unique Ancestry**] possess the same spellcasting tag, “Major,” so every level Helos receives the same 60 Potential no matter from which AOs he acquires abilities from. Helos also gains extra 10 Potential each level up as his Secondary Selections between levels 2 and 5 all have Secondary Selection of “Magical Upgrade,” where Eve chose extra Potential from. Thus, Eve has 60 +10 Potential per level, which she uses to purchase cantrips, spells known, and spell slots for.

Eve cannot purchase spells known or spell slots higher than Helos' current level, and she cannot store more Potential than what Helos received during his current level. If Helos would level to 6 with [Devotion] or [Unique Ancestry], he would gain 100 +10 Potential instead.

ROGATH

Step 1: Pick your abilities

Carl carefully reads the rules and instructions about ability origins in the "Level Up" section before he begins picking Rogath's abilities.

Level 2

Lvl 1 PS [Soul Oath] - Threaten - Oath of Aspiration

Lvl 2 SS [Tactics] - Indomitable

Level 3

Lvl 2 PS [Soul Oath] - Vow - Aspiration - Braggadocio

Lvl 2 SS [Soul Oath] - Fighting Style - Great Weapon Fighting

Level 4

Lvl 3 PS [Tactics] - Fighting Style - Defense

Lvl 3 SS [Tactics] - General Upgrade (+1 skill point Persuasion)

Level 5

Lvl 5 PS [Tactics] - Extra Attack

Once Rogath left his village, he was on the search for challenges and duels. Thus, Carl and his GM think that the "Threaten" ability would fit very well for his next ability. With the "Threaten" ability, Carl must choose an "Oath," and the choice of "Oath of Aspiration" is a no brainer. As Carl has picked Aspiration as his Oath, he cannot pick another "Oath" and must choose "Aspiration" for the selection of abilities underneath "Vow" from now on. For his Secondary Selection, Carl rejects the [Soul Oath] at level 1 and 2, Rogath has no experience with mounts nor care for them. Instead, he looks to [Tactics], and Carl picks "Indomitable," a good fit with Rogath's stubborn nature.

Carl finds "Braggadocio" a natural development for Rogath, as yet, no one has been able to kill him in Carl's roleplay sessions. "Great Weapon Fighting" is something Rogath learns through the continuous use of his halberd.

At level 4, Carl may pick "ASI or Feat" but finds another Fighting Style to suit Rogath better. Note here that Fighting Style can be picked several times, each time choosing another option in the list, if the player has access to another Fighting Style ability. In Rogath's case, he picked "Great Weapon Fighting" as one "Fighting Style" from level 2 SS [Soul Oath], and later "Defense" from level 3 PS [Tactics].

For level 5, Carl wants to pick "Extra Attack" as Rogath has so far in the roleplay been in many combats and increased his martial aptitude. Rogath also fulfills the requirement of "Extra Attack," possessing at least 1 level in [Tactics]. Since "Extra Attack" is an ability available on a level higher than 3, there is no Secondary Selection.

Step 2: Activate your HD tag

[Tactics] and [Soul Oath] do not have the same health dice. [Tactics] has a 1d10, whilst [Soul Oath] has a health dice of 1d12. Carl rolls a 1d10 whenever Rogath levels up with a [Tactics] Primary Selection ability and a 1d12 whenever Rogath levels up with a [Soul Oath] Primary Selection ability.

Level 2 [Soul Oath]: Carl rolls a 1. He adds 6 to the result.
HP 13 (+1+6) +3 = HP 23

Level 3 [Soul Oath]: Carl rolls an 11.
HP 23 (+11) +3 = HP 37

Level 4 [Tactics]: Carl rolls a 4. He adds 5 to the result.
HP 37 (+4+5) +3 = HP 49

Level 5 [Tactics]: Carl rolls an 8.
HP 49 (+8) +3 = HP 50

Whenever Carl rolls a value that is half or less of a health dice, he adds half the health dice value to the result. Half of 1d10 is 5, and half of 1d12 is 6. Therefore, whenever Carl rolls a result that is 5 or below on a [Tactics] level, he adds 5 to the result, respectively 6 for [Soul Oath]. Every time he rolls the health dice to increase Rogath's HP, he adds Rogath's Vitality modifier to the result, which is +3.

Step 3: Check your Bonus Skill Points tag

[Soul Oath] has the tag "Bonus Skill Points: None," so Rogath does not receive any extra skill points from it. [Tactics], on the other hand, has the [Bonus Skill Points: Extra] tag, which can give Rogath more skill points.

A character receives 2 skill points after 4 level picks of an AO with the extra skill point tag (excluding the first level), but Rogath only has 2 levels in [Tactics] after level 1. If Rogath would in the future have gathered 4 levels in [Tactics] (excluding the first level), he would gain the 2 skill points.

Step 4: Tally your Potential

[Tactics] and [Soul Oath] possess the same spellcasting tag, "Minor," so every level Rogath receives the same 20 Potential no matter from which AOs he acquires abilities from. Rogath still possesses no Soul Mark and therefore cannot cast spells. Thus, Carl keeps the Potential for active use in the sessions he plays in, spending Potential to give Rogath bonuses in critical moments.

Carl cannot store more Potential than what Rogath received during his current level. If Rogath would level to 6 with [Tactics] or [Soul Oath], he gains 30 Potential instead.

THE WORLD OF FROSTMARK

[This](#) chapter explores why you should be playing Frostmark and presents inspiration to create your character by exposing the essentials of the lore of the World and Frostmark itself.

THE AGES

Many historical events, people, and places have been lost to time. Still, this section outlines common knowledge for non-human scholars and those intelligent beings who concern themselves with this topic. For the humans living within Frostmark in the post-imperial year of 744, most of this knowledge is unattainable or a potential death sentence.

Quick Overview

Creation of time - The Age of Genesis

The Enneade emerges, creating the World, the Mark, the animals, the human, the Realms, and the Enna.

49 years - The Age of Collapse

Disagreements over laws and the power shifts caused by humans' devotion leads to war. The war survivors are only seven Enneade who divide the spoils and the human population between each other.

3543-0 - The Age of the Seven

Humans become imprisoned within Frostmark, and their population's size is controlled as the Seven attempts to keep the peace between each other.

1-106 - The Age of Geanor

A hero arises that conquers all of Frostmark under the banner of Riahn. Riahn gains nearly all human devotion and becomes the strongest of the remaining Seven Enneade.

1-744 - The Age of Riahn

Riahn creates the Fiery Barrier to keep the other six Enneade's influence out of the Realm and prevents Enna to travel to Frostmark. Geanor dies, and his daughter Leana establishes the Empire, the Duchies, the Church, and the Sacred Arms' inquisitorial forces. The Empire forces all Enna to leave Frostmark and eradicates those who refuse. Moreover, they execute

any magic-user who is not a priest of Riahn and destroy all records, items, and memories of magic and the other gods. After 600 years of imperial rule, the Empire falls apart, and the eleven duchies become independent kingdoms. A turbulent time of conflict and wars ensues.

744-? - The Age of Resurgence

136 years after the Empire, tensions between kingdoms have alleviated somewhat. But one day in the year of 744 AEF, Frostmark will be plunged into renewed chaos as the Fiery Barrier is weakening, and the other six Enneade are preparing to reclaim their lost influence over humanity.

The Ages in Detail

The Age of Genesis

Once upon a time, there was nothing but the void. For reasons unknown, beings of miraculous power emerged from it, accompanied by the mysterious constant of time. Later known as the Enneade, these beings created the World - space to form as they pleased. The Enneade spent their first year discovering their incredible powers and each other. They realized that their personalities were connected to their specific talents and dispositions, which were later named their "Spheres" of influence. With their power and their Spheres, they created all-natural laws and physical objects. First, the Mark was made by all Enneade, a precursor Realm where they could walk and physically interact with each other. Then, other Realms were created, often in the image of one or several of the Enneade.

For what reason the Enneade created other creatures varied, nonetheless they spawned several races into existence. Besides the Spheres, the Enneade is also blessed with an immense amount of magical energy, later named Soul Power. Whenever a living creature is born, its creator Enneade supplies a small amount of Soul Power to that creature to give them the spark of life. The Soul Power is then returned to the Enneade at the time of the creature's death. The legend goes that Gera created animals because she was lonely, and then other Enneade marveled at the miracle and joined

her in experimentation. The animals became successively more complex, and the Enneade continued to explore with rising fascination.

Some Enneade wanted to discover if they could create images of themselves, lesser gods, or even a creature equal to them in power. Others found this idea to be preposterous and dangerous. The task of creating an independent creature ensued either way, but the feat of unlocking the mysteries of self-awareness was both exhausting and intricate. It took seven Enneade and their combined power to create the first, pure, self-conscious being. The human. Because of their complexity, humans required more Soul Power than any animal they had made so far. However, the human possessed the unique feature to expand their sliver of Soul Power given to them at their birth. Their Soul swelled and grew from their experiences and struggles. And thus, the balance of the Soul Power equation turned positive for the Enneade after some time. Most Enneade welcomed this feature, as they had spent copious amounts of Soul energies creating the World.

The human was born with another trait. A trait that neither of them realized how much trouble it would cause during humanity's creation—the trait of free will. Humans were born with the ability to choose their masters. Considering the Soul Power equation, a significant group of humans could generate a substantial amount of Soul Power to the Enneade they decide to devote themselves to. Humans do not need to devote themselves to any Enneade, however. Instead, the humans who remain neutral release their Soul Power to the natural World's unconscious concept.

When the Enneade discovered this accidental side effect, it sent ripples of emotion in their community. Never before had all the Enneade gathered to discuss and parlay with each other in the World's history. The discussion took days to complete. Some called for the immediate destruction of the human race, deeming their existence to be too problematic to go on. Others thought that the race should be created anew, this time without free will. Some saw an opportunity in the creation of

humanity and argued for their continued existence, musing upon the possibilities of Soul Power they could generate for the Enneade. Others defended the human, calling it immoral to eliminate them and pointing out it was the Enneades' fault to begin with. In the end, the defenders of humanity won the negotiations. Furthermore, the Enneade agreed to protect the human's free will for the sake of fairness. They could worship whoever they wanted in whichever way they pleased. The Mark was repurposed as the human population grew to fit their needs, while the Enneade retreated to their paradises.

After creating humanity, many Enneade occupied their time exploring and creating races on their own, collectively known as the Enna. The Enneade had gained experience and wisdom from their prior mistakes. Thus, all Enna are created without freedom of worship. Enna was also significantly easier to create, as the trait of free will requires both energy and expertise from the Enneade. A new concept was created, "Soul templates." Once the Enneade has created a race of Enna, they could reuse many of the basic features of Enna when they create another, like a blueprint. Reusing the foundation of a race could be considered as a template for further creation. Enna, who share the same template, have "Soul aspects" in common and can be seen as cousins. Influential templates included the "celestials," the "fiends," and the "elementals," to name a few. Once the Enneade started to share these templates, as alliances and groups were formed, the creation of Enna exploded. Hundreds of Enna were created in a comparatively short amount of time.

Since it is "cheaper" for the Enneade to create creatures without complete free will, the Enna are bestowed less Soul Power when they are born than the human. Furthermore, the growth potential is also less than it is for humans, as they start with a smaller amount. Enna cannot escape the fate that in their death, their Soul will power their creator Enneade. Moreover, to different degrees, the Enna are often susceptible to the will of their creator Enneade. Be it forced upon them through mechanisms in their Soul or from the fact that Enna are often mirrors of their creators.

Usually, Enna shares many personality traits and tendencies with its creator.

There is no recollection of just how long this age lasted.

The Age of Collapse

The initial wonder the Enneade possessed about their potential, their optimism, and unity decayed over time. More or less insignificant squabbles turned progressively more severe. After the Age that spawned the World and large quantities of lifeforms, the age that came afterward would be the most cataclysmic event to date. A war on an astronomical scale. Even if the Enneade had agreed upon the sanctity of the human's free will, complaints and frustration returned with force. Several Enneade were less popular with the humans, and some of these gods certainly felt threatened by the unfair balance of Soul Power amongst the Enneade.

Even among these godlike beings, a power hierarchy started to emerge. Several disagreements of codes of conduct, morality, and law between the Enneade caused factions and alliances to solidify. These factions sought to consolidate their power and influence, usually from a perspective of self-defense. In the end, the war was inevitable.

No matter the origin of the conflicts between the Enneade, the war waged over all the Realms of the World, No being, Enneade or not, was left unaffected. When another Enneade vanquishes an Enneade, the victor has a chance to absorb the fallen's power and Sphere. But only if the traits of the Sphere are not in conflict with the Spheres of the victor. The absorption of Soul Power was another feature of the Enneade also present in humans and Enna. Through the right means, this power could be utilized for humans and Enna when fighting each other or protecting their Enneade. Soul Magic was created and developed during the war.

One after the other, Enneade, Realms, Enna, animals, and many humans were consumed or blasted out of existence. The Enneade who were eradicated, but not had their influence absorbed by another, had their Spheres fall into the World's hands, dormant, and therefore not a concern for

the warring Enneade. It quickly became clear that the more popular Enneade among the humans had the advantage.

History would reveal that the Enneade, who survived in the end, were capable of both good and evil. Those radical and stubborn were prone to self-destruction, refusing to give up their principles. During the War of Collapse, the Mark's largest landmass had been shifted further towards the northern pole, cooling the climate down significantly. The continent was henceforth named Frostmark in the common tongue.

And so, in the end, only a handful of Realms remained: a few million races of animals, a few hundred or so races of Enna, a decimated human population, and seven Enneade. As Enna's existence is impossible without an Enneade patron, the survival of many of the Enna races depended upon their talents and luck, as one of the Seven could choose to offer their patronage. The Enna didn't need to accept the offer, but not choosing at all would lead to their certain death. This era was also an age of migration, as dozens of Realms collapsed and decayed without an Enneade's upkeep, millions upon millions of Enna and animals were required to relocate to one of the victor's Realms. One independent Realm was spared death. Inet'Saret became a shared burden between the Seven, to be neutral ground where negotiations could be held.

This age lasted for 49 years, where ten years were devoted to a tense cold war and arms race.

The Age of the Seven

The seven Enneade that had won the War of Collapse ruled now the new World. They all established a shaky peace between themselves and clear borders to reduce the risk of more destruction. To diminish their rivalry, they made agreements to control the human population and divide them up between themselves, creating a fair playground. Therefore, all humans in the World were forced to live their lives in the Realm of Frostmark only, where the Seven could easily control them. The Enneade assured fairness between their human populations by different tactics. Some of these tactics included forcing humans to live in hostile areas, sending civilization-ending

catastrophes, or demanding sacrifice. Together with the trapped humans, Enna walked Frostmark with them. This era was an age of great heroes and sorcerers, of discovery and science, but also of disaster and peril for the human race, as they basked in the Seven's attention, both good and bad.

This age lasted for a couple of thousand years. Today, the Age of the Seven is counted backward, measured to have started 3543 years before the Empire's founding (BEF).

The Age of Geanor

Legend foretells that Geanor was an exceptional human, strong, wise, and brave. He was gifted both in the art of Soul Mastery and Soul Magic. Geanor dreamed of crusading all over Frostmark to unify all under one Enneade, Riahn. To set humanity free and unite humanity under one banner. If Geanor acted with direct, indirect, or no guidance from his chosen Enneade, Riahn, is generally unknown. Riahn maneuvered to keep the other Enneade in the dark as long as possible, denying involvement and claiming that Geanor is exercising his own free will. This was enough for Geanor to gain extensive ground, and when the other Enneade realized the threat and joined the fray, Geanor had already gained significant momentum. But no Enneade, not even Riahn, dared to leave their safe Realm to risk their own life; there were only seven left of them after all. This struggle was a battle of influence over humanity.

The campaign ensued, the crusade of Geanor, and it lasted decades. The other six Enneade found it impossible to ally with each other against Riahn ultimately. Thus, they were defeated as Riahn's power swelled from his new followers one after the other. The six Enneade grew so weak that they could not contest Riahn for a presence on Frostmark at all. The six Enneade teleported their temples of worship out of Frostmark as one last act of protection. Riahn became the strongest Enneade henceforth in creation.

Geanor was born 106 BEF (before the Empire's founding) and lived for 106 years.

The Age of Riahn

At the very end of the long and extended life of the blessed Geanor, his followers wrote

the Radiance of Geanor, which became the foundation of the religion of Riahn in Frostmark. After his death, his daughter, Leana, became the Empress of Frostmark, a unified world Geanor who only had a few years to enjoy at the end of his life. Legends describe that Leana split the Soul of Geanor and infused it into Geanor's ten closest seconds, and named them Dukes of their own lands to help her govern the new Empire of Frostmark. Leana herself took the most central lands as her own. As one of her first proclamations as Empress was the order that the crown of the Empire and the duchies were not to be passed down hereditary; instead, the current Emperor, Empress, duke, or duchess would name a worthy soul as their heir.

She also established the Church of Riahn and repurposed the Sacred Arms. The Sacred Arms were Geanor's highly successful army that was left without purpose after the war. With the Church's support, the Sacred Arms became an inquisitorial force tasked with aiding the Empire with expelling Enna from its borders. Riahn assisted in this task by creating the Fiery Barrier, a magical wall around Frostmark. The Fiery Barrier blocked all travel between Frostmark and the other Realms and significantly made it harder for the other Enneade to influence Frostmark. The intelligent and cooperative Enna was first asked to leave Frostmark repeatedly with increasing hostility. Those who refused and those who they were unable to parlay with were engaged in battle. Sometimes this led to surrender from the Enna, and sometimes this resulted in death. Riahn also assisted Leana and the Sacred Arms in this endeavor. The purge took almost Leana's whole life, but she successfully created a Realm with only humans and animals before she was laid to rest.

Another change in the new world order was the complete banning of Soul Magic, except for clerical magic bestowed upon loyal priests of Riahn, as it was seen as a threat to the Realm's security. Every magical practitioner was hunted down and executed. Furthermore, the Church confiscated all magical items, most of which were expelled from the Realm to Eternal Suns. Any remaining locations that alluded to the other six Enneade, Enna, or magic were destroyed. Books were rewritten or burnt, certain

topics became outlawed, and henceforth only a select few in the government and the Church would be allowed to know the truth to carry the torch on to the next generation.

After only a century or two, Frostmark had all but forgotten the existence of the other Enneade, magic, and the Enna. The Empire survived for about six centuries. After several Emperors and Empresses had come and gone after Leana's rule, the Empire started to fall apart at the seams slowly. The most significant reason being Leana's wish for non-hereditary entitlement. Many nobles resisted the Empire for their children's sake. The Empire couldn't solve the situation, and after 600 years of control, most of the duchies were in open rebellion against the current Emperor, Rainer. Rainer gave in to the duchies without much bloodshed to keep the peace of the Realm.

From an Empire falling apart, Frostmark turned into a squabbling continent of eleven kingdoms, where most rulers had vastly different ideas about how a kingdom should be governed. It's true that king Rainer of Malgrave avoided a full out war, but instead, he doomed Frostmark to a century-long struggle for power, money, and influence. Five kingdoms grew significantly more potent than the others by stealing resources and land from their neighbors and expanding their economic and military might. Miraculously, no smaller kingdom was absorbed entirely as they came to serve as buffer lands in between the mightier nations.

The new timekeeping started at Geanor's death and the same year that Empress Leana established the Empire. The Empire lasted from year 1 to year 608 after the Empire's founding (AEF).

A New Age of Resurgence

A hundred or so years later, the state of the kingdoms of Frostmark remains the same, as a favor and misfortune has ebbed and flowed for all. Although wars have turned rare these last few years, with a stalemate settling in, there is still considerable tension between the kingdoms, and there are always those who plot in the shadows. The inhabitants of Frostmark awake to an inconspicuous and ordinary day, but something momentous has changed. For

what was once only legends have returned to bring Frostmark into a new age of discord, or the age of newfound harmony. The Fiery Barrier is breaking, and the six Enneade are preparing themselves for retaliation.

At the start of a classical Frostmark campaign, the year will be 744 AEF, 136 years after the Empire's collapse.

Timeline for Recent Events

1 to 608 AEF - The Empire

The Empire was formed, the ten dukes were appointed and, the ten dukedoms were established. Destroying the other gods' temples, burning religious books of the other Enneade, and confiscating magical artifacts began almost immediately after the coronation. The Empire would remain in power for six centuries.

3 AEF - Sacred Arms

The reformation of Sacred Arms' forces was officially finalized, and they received their formal order to eradicate all spellcasters on Frostmark who weren't priests of Riahn. The Sacred Arms's headquarters in Aynor was established.

4 to 18 AEF - Rewriting History

Empress Leana ordered that the history of Frostmark would be rewritten to remove the memory of the other gods and Soul Magic. This venture was regarded as essentially complete 14 years later.

608 AEF - Fall of the Empire

Emperor Rainer officially releases the ten dukedoms from the Empire, ending an era. For almost half a century, constant armed conflicts have plagued nearly all dukedoms, and the Empire slowly but surely loses control. When Rainer gave the order, only Greenfield still supported the Empire. After the order was delivered, the dukes became kings and queens, and Emperor Rainer became king of Malgrave.

608 to 609 AEF - Overthrown Dukes

Both Beornhelm and Oldwood storm their respective royal households and murder many of them. The first Warchieftain of Beornhelm was established and brought stability for a few years in Beornhelm. Soon afterward, it kickstarted the rapid tradition of changing the head of state in Beornhelm.

Oldwood, on the other hand, fell into almost a decade of chaos as the Woodlings repeatedly failed to rule themselves.

610 to present-day AEF - Raids of Beornhelm

Beornhelm starts raiding northern Greenfield, Oldwood, and Sirendale, and the three kingdoms suffer heavy losses.

614 AEF - The Northern Front

Greenfield, Oldwood, and Sirendale successfully formed the Northern Front after years of negotiation. The allegiance aims to share information, aid, and military power to defend themselves against Beornhelm. For as long as the Northern Front was active, the Beornish incursion was abated to a significant degree but not completely eradicated. This resulted in a rough period for Beornhelm, with common food shortages during the cold winter months and an increased frequency of Warchieftain cycling. This forced some Beornish settlements to change strategy and focus more on trade, which ensured the continued might and survival of the kingdom of Beornhelm.

616 to 618 AEF - Lysander

Oldwood admits their shortcomings and accepts parts of the governing strategy that was forced upon them by the Empire. Through the Northern Front, they asked the brother of the Queen of Sirendale, a member of Lysander's royal house, to become their new regent because of his intimate experience with the crown. Prince Lysander required many platitudes and assurances that he and his family would not meet the same fate as the former royal household of Oldwood met. After two years of negotiations, both parties agreed, and Prince Lysander became King Lysander of Oldwood. The ties of the Northern Front deepened, and King Lysander could bring some stability to Oldwood. He was not wholly successful; however, the western coast and the northern territories of Oldwood often resisted royal decrees in surprising stubbornness, a phenomenon still presents to this day.

632 to 634 AEF - Applegate Invasion

Armathain suffers failed harvests and cannot sustain its population like usual. They turn their eyes towards their fertile neighbor,

Applegate, and quickly launch an invasion. Soon afterward, Karthmere does the same for strategic reasons. Karthmere does not want Armathain to gain too much land and power. It is also the worst outcome for Karthmere is to become direct neighbors with Armathain. Due to the military might of Armathain and the sheer size of Karthmere's army, Applegate stands no chance and loses a quarter of its size to Armathain in the north and a quarter of its size to Karthmere in the south in just 2 years.

634 to 641 AEF - The Armathain and Karthmere War

After the two kingdoms reduced Applegate to half its original size, the distance between Armathain and Karthmere continued to shrink, and the two powers turned their attention to the other. Armathain and Karthmere would test their might against each other on and off for five years, and Applegate was their battlefield. During this conflict, the royal household of Applegate was murdered as collateral damage. No clear winner came out of this conflict. Instead, large pieces of both Armathain's and Karthmere's armies were destroyed, and the war turned more and more half-hearted to a point it simply died out. Armathain and Karthmere settled in and were satisfied, in the end, with their share of Applegate's land and the fact that the rest became a buffer zone between the two giants.

639 AEF - The Royal Family of Applegate is Murdered

On their way to escaping from a town under siege by Armathain and Karthmere, the whole royal family runs into a bandit group who murders them all.

637 to present-day - Economy Reform in Stormholme

Stormholme changes some of its trade rules as guilds grow in power and pressure the government, causing the guilds to become more affluent. These transformations would create an unstoppable spiral of guilds continuing to siphon political and economic power from the government of Stormholme.

639 to 641 AEF - Political Revolution in Malgrave

Ever since Emperor Rainer lost complete control of the Empire, the upper class of

Malgrave has continued to express their disappointment of how the now dead Emperor and his closest advisors handled the situation, as well as the politics they enacted. As Malgrave enjoyed many economic and structural benefits, being the high seat of the Empire, the upper class of Malgrave was perhaps the most educated and bored group in all of Frostmark. Soon the group turned their internal culture and focus to philosophical studies. And as soon as Emperor Rainer was dead, they took the opportunity to change the political system of Malgrave rather than electing a new king. The new system was in effect by 641 AEF, and during the same year, the first Prime Servant was elected.

642 AEF - The Peelers take out their Frustrations on their Nobles

A chaotic year in Applegate's history as the peasantry take out their frustrations on their noble families that were supposed to protect them during the war. Many noble houses disappear during these years either by exile, theft, or murder, and only a handful of noble houses are allowed to go on.

643 AEF - Applegate Recovers

Applegate starts the long process of rebuilding from almost destruction. It's a long and slow process due to both their extensive wounds and the small economy of the kingdom, a process that is still not complete to this day. Applegate decides not to allow another royal household to rule over the kingdom; instead, the most powerful noble houses come together and form a council of sorts. In general, the war changes Applegate's culture from something similar to Karthmere's culture to something more practical, cooperative, and frugal.

644 to 647 AEF - Relocation of the Church and Sacred Arms

The Church of Riahn and Sacred Arms tried for many years to oppose, as well as reverse, the changes of the Malgravian government structure and the new direction Malgravian culture was taking. Due to the diminishing power that the Church and Sacred Arms experienced in Malgrave, they ultimately surrendered and relocated the whole structure to the still impressively pious kingdom of Crowhill in 644 AEF. Goldbank became the Church's and Sacred Arms' new headquarters officially. In just a short

amount of time, the Church segmented its influence over Crowhill's society.

663 AEF - Northern Front Falls

Due to political disagreements of aid and military intervention, the Northern Front falls after a few years of internal disputes. In the years that follow, Sirendale broadens its relationship with Armathain, and Greenfield does the same with Malgrave. Oldwood, on the other hand, remains independent to this day.

667 AEF - The Great Ransack of Mistshear

The year after the Northern Front falls, the raids of Beornhelm immediately resumes in Sirendale. At first, quite timidly, as if the Beornish were testing the waters. The raids were soon picked up in ferocity, and Sirendale was a prime target due to their weak military might and prosperous production. In 667 AEF, one particular sizeable raiding party was so successful and gathered so much momentum that they pierced far south into the kingdom.

This momentum gathered more Chieftain to the cause, and by autumn that year, the Beornish sieged the capital of Sirendale and quickly after that brought the city to its knees. It is a great tragic event in Siren history, where many Siren's died or had their whole livelihood stolen or destroyed. The Lysander royal household, who had defended Mistshear the best they could and refused to leave the capital after conquering, were executed by the Beornish raiders.

The Beornish stayed and ruled the capital and many other cities in the north of Sirendale until spring the next year. At that point, internal disputes made it impossible for the Beornish raiders to keep their control, and they simply left with all their treasure and thralls and returned to Beornhelm. It would take Sirendale almost three decades to rebuild and recover from the event. But just like Applegate, they elected not to appoint another ruler to become king or queen of Sirendale again, instead of creating a council of influential nobles.

680 to 695 The Stormholmish Guild Wars

As the guilds of Stormholme continued to amass power, the royal household became more of a puppet to the guilds than a ruler.

In 680 AEF, a rival guild assassinated the royal family of Stormholme, which was the start of the complete political overhaul of the kingdom. The guilds took over the legislative powers, and from one day to the other, the nobles lost the little protection and power they had left. A very chaotic time followed, where guilds fought for control and influence, sometimes leading to widespread bloodshed. In 695, four guilds came out on top of the power struggle and secured monopolies in different areas. For business' sake, they realize that continued open civil war is non-profitable, and so Stormholme entered finally into a shaky cease-fire. But in the years to come, the four guilds sometimes participate in minor conflicts and sometimes violence with each other up to the present day.

683 to 690 AEF - The Karthmere and Malgrave War

At the same time guilds were growing rampantly powerful in Stormholme, the same process was beginning in Karthmere. Several guilds became prominent in Karthmere during this time and pushed for political change, similar to how the Stormholmish guilds did back in the 630s. Many historians argue that this was one of the primary reasons why the royal household of Arundell initiated the war against Malgrave, to distract the kingdom and unify around the royal family.

It didn't succeed. The flourishing class of merchants became a necessity in the war, and new regional rulers were required for the very rapidly growing kingdom. The Arundell family tried to compromise and passed the "Representative Act" in 687. But neither camp was satisfied. The traditional rulers, the noble houses, were furious about their power loss, and the guilds just wanted more. At the same time, Karthmere started to lose the war against Malgrave. Dissension grew to a boiling point until a mob stormed the royal castle and terminated their royal family in 690 AEF. Karthmere tried to keep on fighting, but the chaos within the kingdom made it impossible, and they surrendered later that year. Malgrave, despite not starting the war, gained a lot from the conflict. As they had the upper hand in the negotiations, they could seize a large part of northern Karthmere.

685 AEF - Malgrave Grabs Influence over Greenfield

During the war, Malgrave enlisted help from their old valiant ally, Greenfield. At first, this was merely a friendly alliance, but as Malgrave required more and more aid in the war against Karthmere, Malgrave realized that it was easy to exploit the smaller kingdom and fell for the temptation. Malgrave forced Greenfield to pass several laws that benefited Malgrave and its citizens within Greenfield. For example, Malgravian citizens could not be trialed by Greenfield authorities, Malgravians do not need to pay as much tax to the Greenfield government and, in many cases, can avoid tolls and fines. After the war, this practice just carried on, and Malgrave, to this day, continues to siphon money and resources from Greenfield.

691 AEF - Era of Somerset

The current matriarch of the small but affluent noble house of Somerset served as castellan to the Arundell family during the war and the uprising. They took the side of the people against Arundell. Their resources, as well as extensive experience, alleviated the chaotic times that followed the regicide. Eventually, both the noble houses and the merchant guilds supported crowning the matriarch of Somerset, queen of Karthmere, due to their noble heritage and the mercantile world's support. In the years that would come, the royal house of Somerset sought absolution and harmony between the nobles and the guilds, which has created many years of peace, albeit a tense one.

702 to 705 AEF - Invasion of Eastcreek

After the Karthmerian and Malgravian war, the kingdoms of Frostmark entered into a period of comparative peace, where even smaller conflicts became unusual. The Church of Riahn, now firmly integrated into Crowhill, had a moment of respite and an opportunity to prepare for their plans. For some time, the Church had their eyes set on Eastcreek, sending several emissaries and missionaries to the kingdom, testing the waters, and acquiring intel on its internal affairs. From their new strategic location on the map of Frostmark, Eastcreek was the perfect target for the Church to expand its influence. In 702 AEF, they launched their invasion, and because of their extensive precautions, as well as the difference in

technology levels between the two kingdoms, Crowhill swept easily away Eastcreek's defenders. In mere 3 years, Crowhill had almost complete control of the kingdom, but it required many years to integrate large parts of Eastcreek's population to the Crow way of life.

703 AEF - Armathain Grabs Influence over Sirendale

During this peaceful period in Frostmark's timeline, Armathain did not reduce its military industry despite the lack of conflict and the heavy toll on the Armathainan economy. For many years, the Armathainian government ignored the consequences of their pride and traditions, but by 703 AEF, the situation was running so much out of hand that Armathain had to search for ways to increase its budget size without sacrificing its values. Armathain was inspired by how Malgrave had peacefully exploited Greenfield for their benefit and did the same to Sirendale, which started in 703 AEF.

731 AEF - Ravenmoors Come to Power in Eastern Oldwood

Rumor starts to circulate in the early weeks of 731 AEF of Count and Countess Ravenmoor's rise to nobility in western Oldwood. Later that year, the news that the Ravenmoors had become the new rulers of Fenby Town reached the capital of Oldwood. A year later, their influence swells to encompass much of the western coast. Alderholt City becomes the couple's new seat of power. Over the next couple of years, the Ravenmoors start to ignore the crown's voice, and the Ravenmoor house flourishes under the crown's distractions. Nevertheless, attempts of diplomacy and later threats were delivered and ignored by both sides.

733 AEF - The Nightstrider and Steelshade Conflict

Through a string of minor disagreements and clashes in the business between the Nightstrider Guild and the Steelshade Guild, minor frustration escalates to a tipping point. Minor incidents where the Guilds go out of their way to frustrate each other turn to a shadow war with open warfare events sprinkled about. Early on, it was obvious that Nightstriders were on the backfoot in the conflict, unable to outmatch the Steelshade

mercenaries. This war raged on and off until 738 AEF, when Nightstriders' guild leader, Domizio, found his daughter assassinated by Steelshade. This event rallies the spirits of the Nightstriders, and it turns the conflict around for the Guild. Two bloody years follow where the Nightstrider fight with no inhibition in their preferred arena. The arena of assassination and subterfuge. By the year of 740 AEF, Steelshade paid for peace very dearly to find an end to their heavy losses. After the conflict was over, Domizio changed for the worse as he mourned his daughter's death.

734 AEF - Agatha Rotleigh Rises to Power in Armathain

Joy Rotleigh, at the time, the Master of Coin and matriarch of the Rotleigh family, dies in a fire with her child. Her younger sister, Agatha and becomes head of the family. The following year, she marries the late husband of her dead sister's late husband and later conceives a child with him.

738 AEF - Beornhelm Invades Northern Greenfield

A particularly vicious raid, spearheaded by Chieftain Idris, afflicts northern Greenfield in 738 AEF. The raiding party pierces far into the kingdom through a string of crucial victories, and the raiding party is rewarded handsomely. When winter comes, Idris makes the historic decision not to return home with their spoils; instead, she entrenches herself in their ransacked territories. Unlike the great raid on the capital of Sirendale, Idris manages to keep her people happy and cooperative with her, and come spring, she continues her onslaught on the northern territories. Until this day, she continues this tactic, and every year her Beornish troops claim another sliver of the panicked kingdom of Greenfield.

739 AEF - Duke Grimcolt Takes Control of Northern Oldwood

Year 739 AEF, Duke Grimcolt of northern Oldwood loses faith in the crown of Oldwood. The catalyzing event was his brother's and most of Grimcolt's company's death as they were defending Aramore Town because reinforcements from the capital did not arrive in time. This causes the Duke to ignore Queen Lysander's orders, and he takes the protection of the north into his own hands. He starts a campaign to gather

support from all northern villages and towns, which he secures quickly and easily. In the years that follow, he builds an impressive defensive structure in northern Oldwood. In 742 AEF, news has spread that Grimcolt has started the outstanding and laborious project of building a wall at the Oldwood border.

739 AEF - Ivone Coming to Power

Ivone wins the hearts and minds of a large part of the lower and middle class of Malgrave, mostly due to her romantic and conservative rhetoric about Malgrave's imperial history, to such a degree that she is voted Prime Servant by the Council in the year of 739 AEF.

740 AEF - Beauport Takes Control of Pearlbay in Applegate

The Count of Pearlbay goes raving mad and abuses his power over Pearlbay City's citizens. The Baron of Beauport, the neighboring island and town, takes his soldiers and money and rids the city of the Count. The people of Pearlbay is grateful enough to accept his leadership over their island as well.

742 AEF - Queen Lysander's Husband Dies on the Road

In one attempt to seek diplomacy with the Ravenmoor household on the western coast of Oldwood, Queen Mirnova Lysander sends her husband on a diplomatic mission to Alderholt City. On his way back from this journey, his escort is mysteriously attacked. Queen Lysander only finds his body a few weeks after his reported disappearance. Understandably, the Queen grows suspicious and substantially more chilly towards the Ravenmoors, but no clues tying the Count or Countess to the tragedy could be found. Simultaneously, disturbing rumors have reached her ears from the west coast that the source of Ravenmoors' control of the area is supernatural. Only caution and confusion has kept her from following through on her threats, but an attack on the Ravenmoors' could be imminent.

742 AEF - Pearnelly Rises to Power in Applegate

Duchess Evelyn Pearnelly trades her old quiet life for an ambitious venture. She sells her mansion to purchase a festival for the un-governed capital of Applegate. She wins

over the populace and takes over as its ruler.

742 AEF - Queen Fairfax of Greenfield is Betrayed

By the year of 742 AEF, the Beornish occupation of Greenfield's northern area has shaken up the kingdom's hope and economy to the point that Idris dare to plot the demise of Greenfield in one fell stroke boldly. She sends secret correspondence to some high nobles of Greenfield that she suspects can be bought. She offers them position and power in the new government of Greenfield if they support her. The only thing they had to do to prove their loyalty was to kidnap the Queen and her son and deliver them to her. The plan was a half success. The Queen was successfully kidnapped and brought to Idris, but her son, Melchior, escaped the plot with Sir Kiara, the Stalwart's help. The Queen is publicly executed as Idris hoped that the spirit of the kingdom would die with her. However, the young son is crowned and reclaims control, hunts down the backstabbing nobles, and executes them on his side of the fence. In the end, the new king has somehow been able to keep the loyal parts of Greenfield together. And thus, the war continues.

743 AEF - Falconer Disobeys the Warchieftain

Chieftain Soren Falconer, former closest ally and advisor to Warchieftain Kynemund, makes the bold decision to resist the Wardchieftain rule after his son dies with dreams of a more peaceful and prosperous Beornhelm. To this day, Soren is trying to transform the areas he controls in eastern Beornhelm following his son's dreams.

743 AEF - First Beornish Raids in Armathain and Karthmere

The first villages on the coast of Armathain and Karthmere reports to their respective authorities that they have been robbed and raided by Beornish boats for the first time in history.

743 AEF - Queen Underworth's Boat Accident

Queen Irena Underworth heads out on a party boat with several young nobles and otherwise influential youth of Crowhill. The boat comes upon a terrible storm and capsizes. Miraculously, Irena is the only one

who survives the accidents and hasn't been herself since.

744 AEF - Rumors of a trade deal between Seyland and Falconer

Rumors spread that Viscount Seyland of northern Sirendale and Chieftain Soren Falconer has entered into a peace and trade agreement with each other, much too many citizens of both Beornhelm and Sirendale's surprise, as well as dismay.

744 AEF - The Fiery Barrier Breaks

In the night's sky, one fateful evening in the year of 744 AEF, the Fiery Barrier becomes visible for all inhabitants of Frostmark. Burning like a great net, basking the continent in an orange to red light, it forces both rich and poor to pay attention. Before the shocked expressions of the Souls of Frostmark, the Fiery Barrier snaps open and fades away, like it never existed. What wonderful and terrible events will befall Frostmark next?

CALENDAR

The year starts at the Spring Equinox, the day where the night and day are equal. A year on Frostmark is 343 days long.

There are seven months during the year. Each month contains seven weeks with seven days.

- ❖ Larek (Day 1-49) (Late March - to the beginning of June)
- ❖ Rirek (Day 50-98) (Beginning of June - middle of July)
- ❖ Surek (Day 99-147) (Middle of July to August)
- ❖ Gerek (Day 148 - 196) (September - to the middle of October)
- ❖ Terek (Day 197 - 245) (Middle of October - Beginning of December)
- ❖ Borek (Day 246 - 294) (Beginning of December - to January)
- ❖ Verek (Day 295 - 343) (February - to late March)

Weekdays

- ❖ Lamesen
- ❖ Rimesen
- ❖ Sumesen
- ❖ Gemesen
- ❖ Temesen
- ❖ Bomesen
- ❖ Vemesen

THE SEVEN REMAINING ENNEADE

The Enneade, or “the gods,” as the common people often call them, are wondrous beings of Soul Power. Half tangible, half intangible, these beings are composed of pure Soul energies taken physical form if they so, please. No Enneade has been born after the seventy Enneade emerged from the void, and whilst no Enneade has openly discussed the issue, most assume that they are unable to have children. They are immortal and tough to vanquish. Historically, only other Enneade have been able to destroy another Enneade. Still, there have been examples in history of mythical heroes and majestic monsters being able to hold their ground against them.

Each Enneade possesses authority over a “Sphere of influence,” physical objects, or metaphysical subjects, where they hold dominion and expertise like no other Enneade. Some scholars of the Enneade argue that their Sphere of influence originates from the personality traits of the particular Enneade, as an Enneade can only absorb another Enneade’s sphere of influence if it “matches” with their own. Other scholars would raise their voice in disagreement; How can that be true if a Sphere of influence can be physical objects such as the sun, the moon, or the sea? The argument will carry on, but none can deny the existence of the Spheres.

The Enneade, who died during the Age of Collapse, but their Sphere wasn’t absorbed by another God, had their power be transferred to the World. The World is the collective term for time, which no Enneade has ever been able to control in an impactful way, and space, something that the Enneade created with their Soul Power, trading their Soul energies for life and substance. As such, the World has collected many Spheres of influences and large amounts of Soul energies at the end of the War of Collapse.

The few scholars that have the privilege of such information are starting to wonder about the consequences of the World gaining so much power.

Humans are born of the latent energies of the World, born without any Enneade’s direct influence. During their life, the human may devote themselves to any Enneade, performing deeds and services and giving them their Soul Power in death. The Enna, on the other hand, is directly born of the Soul energies of their parent Enneade, either their creator Enneade or their adopted one. Normal reproductive actions of the race of Enna are still required, but they gain the spark of life from their Enneade. Thus, Enna is from birth tied to the will of their Enneade.

How this takes form in play can vary and depends on the level of intelligence of the Enna. A monstrous creature with no higher intelligence than an animal is practically enslaved by their Enneade. An Enna with the equivalent intelligence of a Human can certainly refuse some direct orders, but some of their basic disposition and attitude aligns with their guardian Enneade. See more under the GM section.

The Enneade has varying dispositions and traits. Some stayed in their humanoid form others took on fantastical ones. Some interacted readily with the Humans and the Enna. Others thought it beneath them. All had their unique agendas and goals, but there are only seven left of them after the War of Collapse.

The stated concepts below of the gods are in no particular order.

RIAHN

The Law Giving God of the Sun

Spheres: Honor, Unity, Order, the Sun and Warfare

Appear As: Masculine

Favorite Damage Types: Radiant and Fire

Rival: Riahn despises Borias for his uncivilized behavior, seeing him as nothing more than a misguided brute.

Domains: Battle, Community, Law, Radiance

Riahn has always been in the middle of politics between Enneade and the leader of powerful coalitions. Confident and radiant, Riahn is charismatic, honorable, but also arrogant. Riahn originally held the Spheres of “Honor,” “Order,” and “Unity” and has always been the protector of trade, law, and relationships. Due to the actions of Geanor, Riahn is currently the most powerful Enneade in existence.

Realm of Eternal Suns

Eternal Suns is a desert world with one major source of fresh water welling up into a massive lake that spawns several rivers. The largest city in the World surrounds this wellspring of life, The Eye. In the city, several races live together in a strict society with a complicated bureaucracy. Your family can be doomed to serve as slaves for several generations or be blessed with an empire, owning several palaces with armies of servants, advisors, and bodyguards. Outside the city’s confines, beasts roam the desert, angels inhabit flying cities, and underground caverns hide discrete monsters. The three suns of the Realm, one yellow, one blue, and one red, not only make it, so there is no night on Eternal Suns but also infuses the land with life. The blue sun blesses water to sprawl plant life forth, the yellow sun lifts the inhabitants’ spirits to strive upwards, but the red sun curses the sand-sea with undeath to keep the inhabitants of Eternal Sus strong and prepared.

Playable Enna: Dragonborn dwarf, genasi, gnome (usually rock gnome), halfling, half-elf, garden elf, malakhim

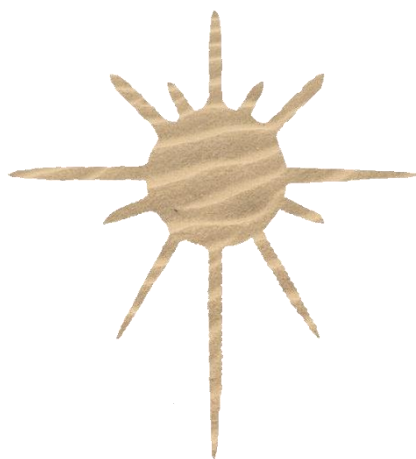
Other Enna: Desert living creatures such as insects, worms, and snakes. Undead creatures also roam the sand-sea. There are water-living creatures in the lakes and rivers, such as crocodiles, fish, and frogs. The deepest caverns underneath the deserts are filled with freshwater caves that can sport more outlandish monsters. Angels and angelic creatures roam the skies with birds and the occasional dragon. And if you’re lucky, or unlucky, you might spot the occasional sphinx, genie, or hydra.

Tenets

Strength in unity

To lead others with grace and justice, you must first lead yourself to grace and honor.

Without honor and justice, a victory is nothing but hollow and meaningless.



GERA

The Animating Goddess of Nature

Spheres: Nature, Animals, Fertility, Plants, Mischief

Appear As: Feminine

Favorite Damage Types: Poison and Acid

Rival: Gera despises Suhlmi because she encourages and assists creatures in destroying the paradise she gave them.

Domains: Animation, Deceit, Nature, Harmony

Gera was the primary creator of animals and instrumental in the creation of humans. However, as progressive she was when she pushed life's creation, she is as traditionalistic when it comes to development. Gera abhors industry and complex technology, such as agriculture, mining, and hydropower. She fears that it will eventually lead to destruction and suffering. Instead, she wishes all life would trust their base instincts and live in harmony with nature.

Realm of Progenitor

Gera's Realm has four ecosystems, tropical savanna to the desert in the north, temperate fields and forests to the west, tropical rainforest to the east, and boreal forest with mountains and tundra in the south. All four within a gigantic circular continent, with abrupt and unnatural shifts in climate between the ecosystems. Gera forbids complex technology, but this decree is somewhat tempered by the level of intelligence of the Enna. More primitive races are hardly allowed anything whilst more sophisticated races are allowed some tools of the trade. For example, elves, halflings, and half-elves are allowed some smithing and agriculture. Nature on Progenitor is especially savage. The closer you get to the continent's central parts, the more rampant life's energies become, turning the landscape more or less alive.

Playable Enna: Dragonborn, genasi, goliath, halfling, half-elf, half-orc, wood elf

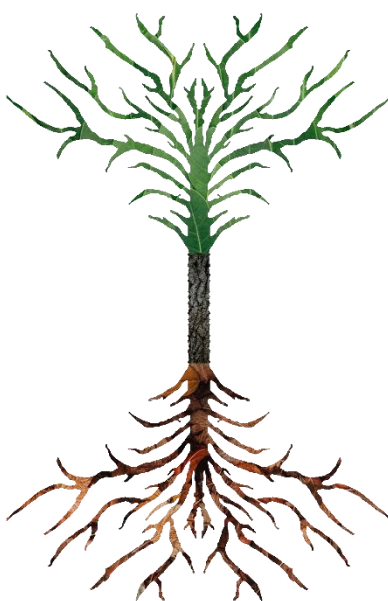
Other Enna: Many different beasts, animals, and monstrosities, all located in their home ecosystem. Examples include; centaurs, dragons, sea-monsters, venomous snakes and insects, giants, orcs.

Tenets

Trust your instincts.

Find peace with nature around and nature within.

Be satisfied with what you have, or forever chase your joy.



TERANIS

The God of Change and Duality

Spheres: Change, Chaos, Storms, Destruction, Restoration, and Healing

Appear As: Masculine

Favorite Damage Types: Lightning and Necrotic

Rival: Teranis despises Riahn for his stagnation of the World.

Domains: Animation, Deceit, Ruin, Storm

Teranis has often stood alone, either misunderstood or feared as the messenger of change. One of Teranis' core beliefs is that everything needs to be constantly tested and contested. If it were destroyed, let it decay and be redefined into something else, something stronger. Teranis is almost impossible to predict, his plans and actions always adapting to new circumstances and ideas. But once the final objective of his desires stands before him, he unleashes all his might and fury to obtain it.

Realm of Tuat

Tuat is a chaotic world where the energies of destruction and creation are locked into an eternal battle. Mysterious nodes of the two powers pop up regularly to change the landscape in their image. Any type of civilization is constantly tested against the two different energies, and thus the landscape is dotted with ruins and abandoned homesteads. Teranis welcomed the marooned Enna races of either celestial or fiendish natures to Tuat. He allows them to continue the conflict of the War of Collapse, to discover which side is truly superior. Teranis promises his active support and attention to whichever side prevails.

Playable Enna: Dwarf (usually mountain dwarf), elf, genasi, gnome, halfling, half-elf, half-orc, malakhim, tiefling

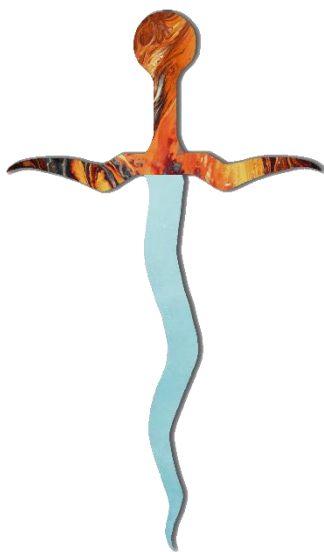
Other Enna: Tuat is a world of stark contrasts, with extremely community-oriented and generally kind Enna, to extremely ruthless and destructive Enna. Outside of curious monsters and beasts, there are a plethora of celestial and fiendish Enna.

Tenets

Your mistakes and flaws can be your greatest strengths and victories.

Complacency is the first step towards stagnation and disaster.

When you truly understand your enemy, you love them.



LAPUANA

The Sea Goddess of Beginnings

Spheres: Wisdom, Innocence, Voyages, Potential, The Sea, the Moon,

Appear As: Feminine

Favorite Damage Types: Force and Thunder

Rival: Lapuana despises Vegomo because he lost the mysteries of time and the Enneade.

Domains: Ardor, Harmony, Preservation, Storm

Lapuana possesses quite a childish personality. She is the personification of her Sphere of influence, the protector of growth, journeys, innocence, and childish wisdom. Lapuana started as quite the minor Enneade, but in the end phase of the Age of the Collapse, she snatched both the sphere of “the Sea” and the sphere of “the Moon,” two spheres that makes her the powerhouse that she is today. Lapuana possesses both that unique clarity a child can possess but also the temper of one.

Realm of the Atlas

Atlas is a vast sea Realm, with only a few tropical islands as overwater landmarks. Most settlements can be found underwater; some adapted for air-breathing creatures, others only for water-breathing beings. The most populated areas are situated in colorful reefs and relatively shallow water. The further you descend, the more hostile the environment becomes. There is always a bigger fish. The deepest point, the Unending Trench, is a perilous journey and strangely beautiful in its alien allure. At the bottom of the trench, Lapuana has created her palace.

Playable Enna: Dwarf (usually hill dwarf), genasi, halfling, half-elf, rock gnome

Other Enna: Most Enna is sea-living, sharks, whales, fish, jellyfishes, squids, etc. Then you have various amphibians like lizards, crocodiles, crustaceans, and frogs. There are also many sea-birds, a few tropical birds, and tropical land-living creatures on the islands like snakes, monkeys, critters, and insects.

Tenets

Do not yearn for things lost.

Do not take time for granted.

Fulfill your potential and encourage it in others.



BORIAS

The God of the North Wind

Spheres: Preservation, Vigilance and Strength, Winter and Mountains

Appear As: Masculine

Favorite Damage Types: Cold and Bludgeoning

Rival: Borias despises Lapuana for her innocent and unserious ways.

Domains: Athanasia, Battle, Might, Preservation

Borias cares little for anyone else than himself, as he believes that each person can only create their fate. What is, in his mind, respect, others usually see as indifference. Borias believes a person needs to go through struggles to become stronger, like iron forging into steel. The strongest one to emerge from their furnace has the right to utilize their strength over themselves and others. Borias is, however, quite brash and hotheaded; the finer arts hold little meaning to him. Borias also inspires to be alert, stalwart, and ready, as the most important Soul in the world is yourself, and you should fight to your dying breath to protect it, or risk becoming fuel for another Soul.

Realm of Kess'Aai

Kess'Aai is fair but dangerous, livable but still a struggle. This is exactly what Borias wants; To create strong and stalwart people who fight for their continued existence and prosperity and enjoy every day of their existence. Kess'Aai is a large archipelago, with islands of different sizes with temperate to arctic climates. Creatures of destructive power roam the lands. Food is attainable but scarce, and therefore often a commodity, along with every other basic resource. In Kess'Aai, many different civilizations, tribes, alliances, or coalitions can be found. All who try to vie for power in their way, but hundreds more just like them have already fallen.

Playable Enna: Dragonborn, dwarf, elf (wood elves), genasi, gnome, goliath, half-elf, half-orc, tiefling

Other Enna: In Kess'Aai, you find creatures of land, sea, and sky that make their home in northern latitudes. Dragons, giants, sea monsters, dusk elves, hags, undead, vampires are only examples of this Realm's variety.

Tenets

You shape your destiny and your world.

Don't live your life for others, and don't let others live their life for you.

Fight to preserve your life.



SUHLMIS

The Twin Goddess of Passion

Spheres: Passion, Crafting, Art, Fire, and Wealth (Simlhus represent vengeance and loss)

Appear As: Feminine

Favorite Damage Types: Fire and Slashing

Rival: Suhlmis despises the most Teranis because he is willingly destructive.

Domains: Community, Craft, Passion, Ruin

Suhlmis is passionate and creative. She inspires her followers to enjoy their day like it was their last. To see and create beauty in everything. Suhlmis is the protector of all kinds of crafts and arts and is a grand artist and craftsman herself. She is profusely curious, and she lives decadently and luxuriously, and thus also represents materialistic wealth. She loves deeply and passionately until something or someone bores or displeases her. If it even angered her, it immediately triggers her other self, Simlhus. Moreover, one day every complete phase of the moon, Suhlmis transforms naturally into her second state. Simlhus is a raw force of anger, pain, suffering, and wanton need to destroy, all to try and soothe the pain and wrath of hers, but never succeeding. The ruin of vengeance.

Realm of Mirrormark

The Mirrormark is a mirror Realm of the Mark but sports some differences in landscape and another flora and fauna. Every time Suhlmis transforms into her violent state of Simlhus, be it either naturally or through anger, she destroys everything in her path. Hosting the goddess is, therefore, a risky event. Suhlmis enriches the community, but Simlhus could eradicate it. Mirrormark is tremendously rich in resources and has a plethora of different societies. People from Mirrormark generally value artistic abilities, memory, and knowledge, both due to the inclinations of their patron but also the circle of creation and destruction she causes.

Playable Enna: Dragonborn, dwarf, elf (garden and wood elves), genasi, gnome, halfling, half-elf, half-orc, malakhim, tiefling

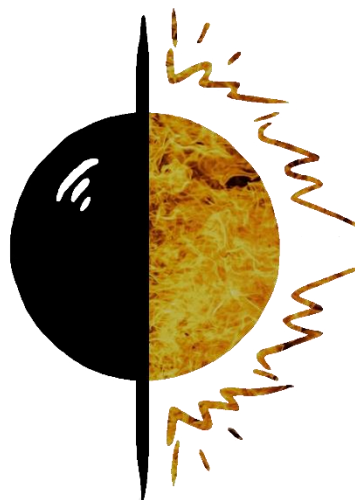
Other Enna: Mirrormark is a savage world full of dinosaurs and majestic monsters. The cities can offer unique and exotic encounters with clock-work servants. Roaming bands of nomads and orcs dot the landscape.

Tenets

Create things that can outlast the rage of time.

In love, passion is the fire, the forge its dedication.

The flame of vengeance burns a heart to ash.



VEGOMO

The Lost God of Starlight

Spheres: Knowledge, Ideals, the Voice, the Stars, and Dreams

Appear As: Both masculine and feminine

Favorite Damage Types: Psychic and Piercing

Rival: Vegomo despises Gera for her archaic and crude view of passions and progress.

Domains: Ardor, Lore, Radiance, Thaumaturgy

Both a starry-eyed dreamer and a seeker of knowledge, Vegomo is the care-taker of the stars. Every mystery, story, or secret they unearthed, they created a star in the night sky for, to forever remind themselves of its lesson and message. Vegomo shared their wisdom and knowledge with humans and Enna through dreams. But they couldn't keep up with current events and all bodies of knowledge. It was just too much, even for an Enneade. They asked Suhlmi to forge them two new eyes, using their two greatest stars, the stars holding the secret of time and the secret of the Enneade. Vegomo lost their ability to create more stars and maintain them in the process, so whenever a star falls, a story or a secret is lost. But now Vegomo could see and know everything that is and has been. This rendered Vegomo quite mad as they were assailed with a constant stream of information. Their dreams could now turn to nightmares when Vegomo loses focus. Though most of the time, Vegomo is absent-minded or even paralyzed.

Realm of Qedseba

Qedseba is a Realm made from the Stellar Expanse, where mind over matter rules. If you are proficient, you can create anything out of this void. You can find anything on Qedseba if you only know how to look for it, as different societies have created pocket dimensions of their design.

Playable Enna: Dragonborn, dwarf, elf, genasi, gnome, halfling, half-elf, malakhim, tiefling

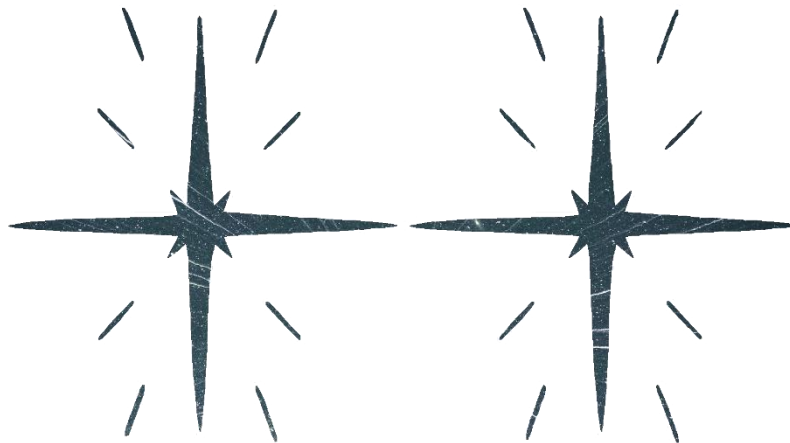
Other Enna: "Normal" creatures of low intelligence have a hard time surviving in this environment. However, monsters with high intellect and favorable abilities can be devastating upon the listless wanderer or societal biome.

Tenets

Strive to fulfill your dreams.

Be mindful of the consequences of your actions.

The will of the heart takes precedence over the work of the mind.



INET'SARET

When Enneade fell in the Age of Collapse, many of their Enna did as well. But those who survived that chaotic time had two choices before them. Try to survive godlessly or give their loyalty to another Enneade. Not many lone wolves or communities have survived to this day without an Enneade, but those who have managed to migrate to Inet'Saret, a rare Realm that a group of Enneade created together that never had a clear owner. Of the destroyed Realms, the Seven kept this Realm as a neutral meeting ground for any business they didn't want to conduct on Frostmark. As Riahn took over Frostmark, Inet'Saret is mostly upheld and used by the six uncast Enneade. However, they seldom discuss and parlay with each other.

Inet'Saret, or the Valley of Wisdom, is a large oval-shaped valley, with a broad river running through it, pooling into a clear lake in the middle. The valley's central parts are gently rolling hills and plains, which changes into leaf forests as the ground elevates slightly. This transforms to pine, which reaches as far up as possible on the mountains around the valley. The mountain chain around gets progressively mightier, but at one point, the highest mountains give way abruptly to a black sand sea that suddenly ends and turns into the Stellar Expanse.

Inet'Saret is the smallest Realm still in existence. Even so, several communities try to share this Realm, some harmoniously, others not. The Wise People protect the central areas around the lake, the plains, and the leaf forests. The Wise People is a group of different Enna banding together to make a life for themselves whilst trying to keep themselves neutral between the Seven. Those Enna who has not joined this alliance tend to want to be left alone to their own devices.

Playable Enna: All races, but the most common races are dragonborn, dwarf, elf, gnome, halfling, and half-elf.

Other Enna: Almost anything can be found living in Inet'Saret. However, if it is a less intelligent race of Enna, only those who can survive in this biome can be stumbled upon. The lands of central Inet'Saret are mostly devoid of dangerous monsters, but who knows what wanders the pine forests and the mountains, both on top of and [within](#).

THE CHURCH OF RIAHN

The Church of Riahn is the god's primary channel of influence in Frostmark, as Riahn seldom interacts directly with his worshippers. Even if the Church varies slightly from nation to nation and holds a varying amount of influence in them, the Church is its own organization that spans national borders. You need to swear off your old earthly possessions and bonds to secure the strongest bond to Riahn himself to enter the Church. In practice, many second or third scions of noble or influential families infiltrate the Church to favor their families. Therefore, this rule has turned more ceremonial than official.

Many different ranks exist within the Church, from the simplest village apprentice to the Solar priest itself, who is the Church's chosen leader. The priests' actions differ between areas. Sometimes they are educators, relief personnel, doctors, or even advisors or negotiators. But their core function is to hold religious ceremonies of Riahn (celebrating the birth of a child (the Naming), coming of age (the Rising), marriage (the Union), and funerals (the Farewell), as well as to purge any corruption of magic and of the other gods, which they refer to as the Horrid Devils. The Church is stalwart with destroying anything that alludes to the other Enneade and magic. Priests, books, temples, and rituals are all quickly and mercilessly destroyed or ruined. In Crowhill, even adhering to an old custom will get you whipped or even executed. Speaking the true name of a Horrid Devil will often lead to apprehension and interrogation.

In past times the Church was the crusading force of Geanor, tasked after the war with hunting down every single priest, magician, tome, temple, and Enna, to erase them from history. What was first a mentality to genuinely save humanity from this madness turned into a zealous inquisitorial pursuit of "purity." From the aftermath of Geanor, the Church still has military forces, the Sacred Arms, but it has more and more become adapted towards an inquisition of sorts. Civilian units and small special cells hunting down any concerning rumors. The Church holds both lands and owns businesses in

some nations, but they also thrive on taxes and charity.

The Radiance of Geanor

The Radiance of Geanor is the primary religious text of Riahn and his champion Geanor. The book is divided into three distinct chapters. The first is a recollection of Geanor's life and his ventures, explaining in detail his status of being Riahn's chosen and the lessons that Geanor passed on through his words and deeds.

The second chapter is the edicts of the Riahn faith, with rules of what to do and not to do. What is central within these rules is the sanctity of the Soul. It is plainly stated how perverse it is to control a Soul that is not your own, especially without consent. Some passages give clear providence to a ruling class, nobles, to reign over others. There are justifications for why nobles hold this influence, stating that their Souls are more powerful and adept than others. Some religious interpretations are more liberal with defining "noble," claiming that competent Souls are noble and not something you inherit from birth.

Of course, there are general ethical edicts, such as abhorrence for violence and stealing, plus encouragement for respect for elders and the union (marriage). As Riahn is attributed to bonds of all kinds, there is a surprising number of rules for marriage and relationships between children and parents, and peasants and nobles. The nature of the edicts are rather strict. However, some sections would allude to that nobles are exempt or should be punished less harshly.

The third chapter is a basic description of how business deals should be made, how the judicial system should be ordered, and the decrees of war. This chapter is taken more or less seriously by the ruling class, as the law and traditions of the kingdoms may clash with some areas of the third chapter.

The Blessings of the Priests

After some time of dedication to the cause of the Church and Riahn, priests slowly start to receive magical powers to work Riahn's miracles. The kind of miracles is quite uniform within the Church. One of the

simplest miracles of Riahn is the power of light. Healing diseases, poisons, and wounds are common blessings, where stronger priests can perform even grander medicinal miracles. There can also be various fire blessings, from simply lighting a candle to sending balls of purifying fire upon the heretics.

In other terms, a newly initiated apprentice in the Priesthood is not granted Soul Magic immediately. Upon initiation, the apprentice is given a small tattoo in the form of a black and golden sun in the middle of their forehead, signifying their devotion to Riahn and rank within the Church. As the apprentice learns and grows older, they start conducting their own ceremonies as assistants or full-fledged priests. This is when their tattoo absorbs Soul Power and transforms into a Soul Mark over some time.

The specific ritual that Riahn shared with the newly-born Church after Geanor's conquests, used for their initiations of new priests, is unique. A majority of Soul Mark rituals require a limited window of opportunity for the Soul Mark to form, whilst the ritual that the Church jealousy protects is specifically designed for the priests to transform their tattoo into a Soul Mark through a longer period and Partial Soul Drain in their various religious services. This way, the Church can argue that the magic is given as a reward for their loyalty and long service of Riahn, instead of a specific ritual. The fact that the spells taught to the new priests usually are the same is frankly because Riahn usually teaches the same kind of spells through their clerical bond.

Ceremonies and Blessings

The symbol of the Church, and Riahn, is a simple and stylized sun that is preferably clad in leaf gold. This symbol can be found in the form of pendants around the believer's necks or tattooed on the body to eternalize the divine vow.

Churches are usually built in an amphitheater-style with many glassed windows to ensure as much sunlight in the building as possible. The architectural style believes that all the witnesses of a ceremony should have a clear view of the altar and the

priests. The grand churches of Frostmark have stained windows that display different events of the Radiance of Geanor and depictions of Riahn and other celestial beings. The church is further built with a lot of reflective surfaces. The richer parishes clad everything they can in leaf gold to make light dance inside the structure.

A ceremony of Riahn should take place in direct sunlight, if that is not possible, in the light of day. Ceremonies conducted during the night are seen as dubious but can be considered legal if there is a large light source, like a bonfire. The existence of light is important for the ceremony as it is supposed to shine on the vows, words, and actions of those who partake in it to ensure it is true and just and not dishonest. The more expensive ceremonies are scheduled at dawn to capture those first tentative rays of light, which are considered the holiest of light sources. Furthermore, a ceremony requires at least three witnesses to make sure that nothing dishonorable or heretic took place.

The ceremonies are mostly spoken in Rianish by the priests, and a few select words of importance can even be said in Copta. Priests are taught Rianish on a rudimentary to mediocre skill level. Few can speak the language like a native. However, no priest would know what the words spoke in Copta mean, but they learn to recite them when the particular ceremony requires it. Moreover, the ceremonies are full of traditional movements, vows, and acts that must be precise and haven't changed for several hundred years. The eldest speaks first in the ceremonies and the youngest last, be it priests or participants. Participants of the ceremony should kneel when recognized by the priest to show humility and somberness.

Tattooing is one of the two central acts of a major ceremony. A tattoo is crafted by the highest priest present to enact the bond and the blessing of Riahn. It is tattooed with special ink which has traces of gold leaf in it. The richer the person is, the higher the content of gold is. Most often, names in Rianish and symbols are tattooed on the recipient. During the Naming ceremony, the parents are tattooed with the name of their child. During the Rising ceremony, the child

is tattooed with the name of the parents. The Union tattoos consist of the spouses' names. And the Farewell changes how the tattoo looks like for someone who has the deceased's name tattooed on them. The recipient is somewhat in control of how the tattoo will look and some control of where it is placed, but there are several rules involved, and the Church must first approve it. The more intricate the tattoo recipient orders, the more costly it is.

The second major element is some kind of sacrifice the recipient makes for their community. What kind of shape and magnitude this takes is up to the individual. The Church of Riahn claims that it will affect the strength of the ceremony's blessing, how successful a Union will be, or how fortunate a child will be growing up, depending upon how heartfelt and great the sacrifice was. A recipient can use this opportunity to make a political move by donating coins to a specific faction, maybe even the Church itself, whilst someone with no coins to spare often offers to do communal labor.

Holidays

Spring Equinox (Day 1, the first day of Larek)
Summer Solstice (Day 86, 36 days into Rirek)
Autumn Equinox (Day 171, 23 days into Gerek)
Winter Solstice (Day 257, 11 days into Borek)
Unity's Day (Day 316, 21 days into Verek)

Death and the Afterlife

If a human has lived a virtuous and devoted life to Riahn, they attain the honor of entering his Solar Realm, a paradise of righteousness and light. But it isn't all sunshine. The six Horrid Devils and their master, Darkness, never rest in overthrowing Riahn and throwing Frostmark into chaos and destruction. In the afterlife, when you're not enjoying the fruits of Riahn's Realm, you'll receive the honor of fighting, or supporting in any way you can, the forces of Darkness. Slain humans of this divine war return then to Frostmark, reincarnating with no memory of their past life. But once Riahn can gather enough Souls to stand by him in the war, they could defeat Darkness once and for all so all Souls could remain forever in the Solar Realm, in complete peace and ecstasy. The Souls who

lose their direction or never find the light of Riahn, but don't sell their souls to one of the six Devils, simply reincarnate to Frostmark, missing out on the bliss of living in Riahn's Realm for some time. However, those who sell their Souls to Darkness are doomed to be tortured in the six Devils' Realms and forced to fight Riahn's armies and supporters.

The Horrid Devils of Riahn's Church

Gera - The Feral Devil - The Snake

Under the Snake's rule, all would be turned into animals. Unable to be selfless, with no control of their actions, just reverting to their base instincts, reason lost. Just how birds' prey on mice, brother will turn on brother for scraps of meat. The Snake would further send pestilence, sickness, and earthquakes to all that dare to stand on two legs.

Teranis - The Ruinous Devil - Ill Fortune

The Devil of Ill Fortune arrives with one simple purpose; To destroy. Under his rule, everything you've built shall crumble, with no regard to the sanctity of life and Soul.

Lapuana - The Reckless Devil - The Devil's Child

The Devil's Child is a force without maturity, unable to control, or want to control, her powers. She will unleash the full force of the seas to drown all who triggers her fickle whims.

Borias - The Cold Devil - Winter's Cruelty

The antithesis of Riahn, the Cold Devil, suppresses all that is warm, loving, and nurturing. He wants to cloud the sun through harsh storms of winter and turn honor and virtue into apathy and careless sins.

Suhlmis - The Devil of Temptation - Obsession's Ruin

Under the rule of this devil, no one would be able to control their emotions, inclinations, and caprice. Forgiveness is lost, temperance forgotten, and restraint is gone with the winds of frenzy and obsession. The Devil of Temptation is the one that whispers into the ears of weak-willed men and women to betray their union and virtue.

Vegomo - The Devil of Insanity - The Prince of Greed

The Devil of Insanity lusted for powers beyond their capabilities and stole all the stars in the heavens from Riahn. The stars then punished them for their greed and split their mind asunder, turning the greedy Devil insane as well. All the stars managed to escape, but the two brightest stars of the night sky remained to ensure their punishment would be eternal. Nightmares are now the Devil's living revenge against Riahn, corrupting his pleasant and benevolent dreams. Under this Devil's rule, even the waking world will be nothing but nightmares.

Remnants of the Six

Today only very few artifacts remain readily at hand, hidden away as family artifacts or recovered and protected in cults. But as the six are returning in force to Frostmark, from biding their time and recovering power, so are the artifacts, creatures, and mystical locations. These locations are places that were consciously moved to another Realm by the presiding god, to not let its mysteries fall into the hands of Riahn and his followers.

From the start of the Age of Geanor, very few remain with knowledge of the other six gods, but as the winds of change are blowing, they turn bolder by the hour. Cults are forming once more, vying for power and giving influence to their chosen Enneade. Beornhelm is particularly brazen in recent years. They have grown even more chilly towards the Church of Riahn and turned more gregarious towards their old mountain patron.

For the unknowing inhabitants of Frostmark, many old customs and traditions still linger, even if they don't know their origin. Sailors might give a gift to a child to ask for safe passage before a voyage, concerned mothers might get overjoyed in thunderstorms as they hover over their feverous child, and some smiths leave a coin in the fire for Suhlmi before starting a new project.

Rebirth - The Truth

When a human fetus is forming, the mother initially gives the child its spark of sentience.

The mother gives the child a part of their Soul, which then triggers the World and the Enneade with devotional Souls to equally give Soul Power to the new child.

Knights and the Sacred Code

As Geanor created and evolved his army, he created the modern concept of Knighthood. A Knight is a special kind of soldier who possesses noble blood and willingly subjects themselves to certain vows. The concept has its roots in the Age of the Seven in the area governed by Riahn. Back then, there was an elite force called the Night's Sentinels who were picked from that society's upper echelons. They were trained to protect Riahn's kingdom against the "Night" forces, as many monsters and troops of other Enneade were denoted as.

In Geanor's army, there were several Sentinels, many of who were veterans, and thus, quite a few became his advisors and trusted seconds. Indeed, many Sentinels were dubbed one of the ten Dukes by Empress Leana, tasked with governing one of the Empire's duchies. As Geanor's army was conquering part after part of Frostmark, he needed loyal soldiers and leaders to govern and protect areas he had already conquered.

The Sentinels' vows were focused on protecting Riahn's kingdom in particular and its nobility. He needed a force that could swear themselves to any ruler and protect all within it, so he reformed the Night's Sentinels' vows. One of the most impactful changes was that almost anyone could become a Night's Sentinel, which had before been exclusively noble scions. The change was not popular initially, but Geanor needed to vastly increase the numbers of Sentinels the more land he covered. After the Empire was formed, the Knights became the Sacred Arms leaders and spearheaded the purge of Frostmark of anything foreign to the new world order. They also became stalwart protectors of the Empire.

The Night's Sentinel title was shortened over time to the modern title of Knight, but its traditions have withstood to this day in some kingdoms of Frostmark. Members are still Knighted from the ranks of nobility, but exceptional soldiers can be promoted to the

position. The practice has survived within the Sacred Arms ranks, where most of the leadership are Knighted, as well as within the nobility of Armathain and Karthmere. The vows have been aptly named the Sacred Code.

Having a Knight's rank grants the person high rank within both the nobility and the military, joining the two factions. In the kingdoms where the practice has survived, the Knight enjoys a certain amount of freedom to execute justice in a manner they see fit.

The Sacred Code

*"I will keep faith in the face of hopelessness.
Be honest against my benefit.
Valorous despite my fear.
Remain loyal to my oaths.
Be honorable until my Soul leaves me.
Answer any challenge that stands before me.
And protect the weak and the deserving.*

FROSTMARK'S KINGDOMS

[The](#) cultural areas of Frostmark have changed over the ages, and the current geopolitical landscape was formed by the Empire. Empress Leana was mindful of the already existing cultures dotting the map of Frostmark and adequately formed them into kingdoms for her dukes to govern.

In Applegate, Peelers live.
In Armathain, the Armathainians (Thainians) live.
In Beornhelm, the Beornish live.
In Crowhill, the Crow live.
In Eastcreek, the Clans and the Iskerians, or Easters, live.
In Greenfield, the Greens or the Fieldish live.
In Karthmere, the Karthmerians (Merians) live.
In Malgrave, the Malgravians (Gravians) live.
In Oldwood, the Woodlings live.
In Sirendale, the Sirens or Dalish live.
In Stormholme, the Stormish live.



APPLEGATE



Location: West coast, south of Armathain, north of Karthmere, west of Malgrave

Authority: Council of nobles for kingdom affairs and elected town councils for local affairs

Geography

Applegate is dominated by the Qettam Meadow, a great fertile biome with gentle hills or flat landscape. This kingdom possesses two bays of interest, the long bay of the Recess of Hanue, which has mainly shallow beaches, and the Appelies' Gulf that is deeper and slightly rocky. By Appelies' Gulf and south of it, natural harbors can be found. Applegate has three large islands, Wenet, Beau, and Pearl. All three have a heartland of hills and forests, which is outlined by fertile flatlands. The shore is either shallow with beaches or moderately to slightly rocky with deeper waterfronts. These islands receive a lot of sea traffic.

The great river of Teima that splits into Teinir acts like Applegate's border to Malgrave, respectively Karthmere. Teima river runs moderately fast whilst Teifar runs moderately slow. Along the river Teinir in the far south, the edge of the Gallant Grove forest can be found, which is moderately thick. Along the Teinir river, roughly from the forking of Teifar river to the settlement of Hartkin, there is also a ridge of hills. The ridge takes a turn by Hartkin city and runs through the Qettam Meadow towards Wenet Island. The forest around Hartkin city is dominated by a great number of Elder trees.

Summary

Applegate is Frostmark's smallest kingdom, nestled in between Karthmere and Armathain. It has served as the main battleground between the two powerful

kingdoms, losing their royal family, territory, and crucial infrastructure in the process. The war resulted in no victor between Karthmere and Armathain. A stalemate settled in for a few months. Eventually, both kingdoms retreated and were satisfied with their conquered part of Applegate, preferring to keep what was left of Applegate as a buffer zone between them.

Despite the collapse of the government and infrastructure of what was left of Applegate, Peelers, as they call themselves, did not succumb to complete lawlessness nor despair. After the war, there was a period of disgruntled peasants, tormented by war and famine, that unleashed their displeasure on their own bourgeois. Many noble families of Applegate turned extinct, but some survived. The remaining aristocracy banded together for safety and pooled their resources to rebuild Applegate.

Applegate is incredibly fertile, and its soil is mineral-rich, which has allowed for impressive agricultural bounties. In return for cheap food transports to Crowhill and

Applesate



Eastcreek, the Church invests in Applegate's infrastructure and education. Today, the culture of Applegate mostly surrounds the community. It is everyone's duty to work for the general welfare of the kingdom. Peelers are often wary of foreigners. They find most foreigners strange and foul as they often seek personal gain rather than communal gain. Peelers can seem very open and considerate on the outside, but often they hide a judgmental mind and a superior sense of morality.

Living in Applegate

Applegate was once a proud nation, with equal parts forest and equal parts fields. Through the Empire's leadership, Applegate was steadily cleared of its forest to increase its food production capabilities. Today, Applegate is dominantly fields and orchards, producing fruits, grain, and vegetables. In the aftermath of Emperor Rainer's surrender, where the Empire was split into eleven kingdoms, Armathain was without food transports from Applegate and Sirendale. Armathain's highlands and woods only allowed for limited food production, and so the Empire supplied them with transports of grain and other foodstuffs. This caused Armathain's population to grow, so when the food imports stopped, Armathain experienced famine. They invaded Applegate with the intent to conquer its fertile fields to sustain their population.

After Armathain attacked Applegate, Karthmere got cold feet. They did not want the militaristic kingdom at their doorstep with Applegate's land's food production abilities. Karthmere attacked from the south, and eventually, they met Armathain in the heartland of Applegate. For seven years, they clashed. Sometimes Karthmere gained ground, and sometimes Armathain did. In the last two years, the battle was more of a stalemate than open combat. Eventually, the two kingdoms lost interest and simply retreated. In the last days of the lingering war, Applegate's royal family died to an unfortunate bandit attack outside a town being besieged by two armies. Still, Armathain had gained some land of Applegate, barely enough to stabilize its food production, and Karthmere took some territory as well. Today, Applegate is roughly

half the size it once was. Its infrastructure was also badly abused. Forts, castles, towers, roads, warehouses, industry, etc., have either been reduced to rubble or have been severely damaged or exploited. Some castles, roads, and other structures have been rebuilt or are in the process of being rebuilt, but none will return to their old splendor for a very long time.

The past struggles have evolved into a robust community in Applegate, where brother should offer brother help, and blatant greediness or selfishness is harshly dissuaded. Everybody is supposed to share the little they have. The great damage to Applegate's infrastructure has led to an uphill battle to restore some profitability and quality of life. No one is alive today who witnessed this war first hand, but the bitterness is still afoot within the Applegate society, mainly because of their fall from grace and their heavy labor of rebuilding what they lost. Though, some of the younger population, especially those who see no future in poor Applegate, have warmed up the atmosphere. Some might even be supporting the idea of joining Applegate with Armathain or Karthmere. The most unfortunate souls, who only encounter squalor in Applegate, usually migrate to Karthmere to find some kind of livelihood.

There are mixed emotions about the death of the royal family. Many thought them to be decent that they tried their best despite the current outlook. At the same time, they were also regarded as part of the problem. They were part of the system that caused Armathain and Karthmere to attack Applegate, to begin with, and how they are suffering now. The greed of two royal families caused Applegate to be in this position, and it is a system most Peelers never want Applegate to return to. After the royal family's death and the little defensive troops the country had left fell into disarray, many noble households were attacked and looted and publicly punished for their alleged selfish ways. Only the most popular noble members who still controlled some resources and who adapted to the new culture were allowed to keep most of their belongings, most of their influence, and their lives. And therein lies the political power of the four significant noble families of Applegate, possessing the competence to

lead and organize, as well as a sliver of resources to invest and rebuild. Applegate's social hierarchy is very flat. Outside of the four noble families, there are few official titles and ranks. Healers, priests, educators, and master craftsmen usually hold more influence than many others considering contributing to the community. Despite this, Applegate lacks many key structures, traveling is slow, and most of the population doesn't have access to education in any form.

Relation to other Kingdoms

Applegate communities are exceptionally close. Foreigners often find themselves having an uncomfortable stay within Applegate's borders. Wherever they go, they are discreetly watched, and behind polite smiles, mistrust hides. Technically, they welcome trade and diplomacy from anyone who offers, but due to their relationship to the Church of Riahn, they are excluded from dealing with anyone who refuses to adhere to the Rianish faith. Moreover, they conduct trade on their terms. Even if this has led to a string of unsuccessful deals and negotiations, Applegate refuses to sell out or welcome too much foreign influence. Applegate has endured for a century, and if they have to wait a bit longer to receive something specifically on their terms, they will easily endure the wait.

Education

Children growing up in Applegate are quickly put to work. Often, children inherit the profession of their parents, learning through natural apprenticeship. If somebody is born with exceptional talent, it is a worrisome event. The child is given extra attention to instilling humility within them. No individual is more important than the community of Applegate. The literacy rate is the lowest in all of Frostmark. Sometimes, parents cannot offer their children any form of education. Only through the Church can education be obtained in Applegate today, given to influential children through deals their parents make with the Church, sometimes it is given as charity to select members of the community, and sometimes it is offered freely to those the Church wishes to induct into the priesthood.

Relation to the Church

They possess a strong relationship with the Church of Riahn as well as Crowhill. Even if they do not tolerate any snobbish Crow nobles or corrupt bishops in their lands, they are still grateful to the Church for aiding them. The faith of Riahn is strong and old in Applegate. There are also many Peelers in the Church, which is considered a lucky career choice.

Military

After the decimation of Applegate's organized military, they have been able to establish an effective watch once more. This watch force is structured independently by the respective village or town, upheld through taxes. A proper army is currently seen to be too expensive to build and maintain. As a farming community with no ore sources within their territory, the most common armor type is leather. Some lucky officers might have the resources to obtain chains. Weaponry often takes the shape of bows and spears, whereas swords are only feasible investments for the most prosperous.

Two unique martial traditions hail from Applegate. One is the old Wardens, said to be a direct descendant of Geanor's ranged company. When Applegate was covered in lofty leaf forests, these rangers were the personal bodyguards and agents of the dukes and duchesses of Applegate, and later the royal family. As there is no central government to swear fealty to and hardly any woods to operate from anymore, this once-proud tradition has almost become extinct.

The other unit is a far more recent invention, more suitable for an urban environment and the cultural environment that reigns today. The Bloodhound is a part of Applegate's watch organization specializing in investigation and combat with a hound. The hound finds, drags out, or corners the Bloodhound's target, whilst the Bloodhound uses a bow or spear to deal deadly wounds or nets to apprehend.

Applesate



House Hartkins

Ruler: Baroness Auphrey (63 years)

Family: Baron (60 years), sister (55 years), brother (54 years), and a daughter (37 years)

Rule: Hartkins city, Maplemere town, and Sunwick town

The Hartkins family has been a respected noble house since the fall of the Empire. The Hartkins family is known for their hard work and undying loyalty. They were very active during the Armathainian and Karthmerian war and have devoted themselves to Applegate's safety and order ever since it ended. Auphrey took over the family's duty at a young age after her father succumbed to all war wounds.

The baroness is known as "Ironheart" for her stern, traditionalistic and efficient work-style. The Baroness Ironheart is also known for her piousness. There's little time for fun and games in the Hartkins household, something that Auphrey's daughter, who is more soft-hearted, has suffered under. There is a constant struggle for the baroness to toughen up her daughter before becoming the new Baroness of Hartkins. Hartkins town is the ancestral home of this family, yet when the capital was left without a noble to oversee it, Baroness Hartkins saw it as her duty to take on the responsibility. For several years, she has negotiated with the elected city council of Lightbrook capital, trying to make them accept her as their caretaker. However, out of the blue, Duchess Pearnelly appeared in the capital with a carnival at her side. She quickly whisked away Hartkins' price as the capital's ruler, which has left relations between the two houses chilly at best. Hartkins often cooperates with the Bridesmith household, but it is more suspicious towards the new Beauport.

House Pearnelly

Ruler: Duchess Evelyn (22 years)

Family: None

Rule: Lightbrook capital and Honeymoon city

Duchess Pearnelly is the sole survivor of her noble house. Her family escaped the chaos of the frustrated peasantry by moving out on the countryside, close to Littlehear Town. They foresaw the violence before it started

and dedicated themselves to quietly living out their lives in a modest mansion located there. The house was on the brink of losing all power and resources when the young Duchess Pearnelly suddenly decided to risk it all. Selling the mansion and everything she owned, she orchestrated a large festival in the capital and wooed the crowd to become their noble caretaker. She is more progressive than the likes of the Bridesmiths and Hartkins. With her charismatic ways and sense for the coin, she has cemented her position in the capital and strengthened its economy.

House Bridesmith

Ruler: Viscountess Katrina (35 years)

Family: Viscount (46 years) and a brother (49 years)

Rule: Bridesmith town, Littlehear town, Verdale city

About 15 years ago, a severe drought endangered the north of Applegate. It almost drove all the inhabitants to flee their home and hearth to greener pastures. The noble of Littlehear of that time had carelessly sold all the town's stored grain to the Church. After the war, the Bridesmith house denounced their nobility but was still a considerable landowner in the area. The Bridesmith house decided to do something about the drought and generously gave away most of their bounty and stored grain, eliminating the famine. Littlehear quickly got rid of their old noble household and invited the Bridesmith's back into nobility. Today Bridesmith has claimed back their old town and gained Verdale, which makes them more or less equal to the other three large noble houses still surviving in Applegate today. Many wonder why the Viscountess hasn't born any children, and some are even starting to become suspicious of how close she is to her twin brother. The Viscountess is known to be a rather mellow and sensitive person.

House Beauport

Ruler: Baron Geffroi (39 years)

Family: Baroness (30 years) and a son (8 years)

Rule: Beauport town, Pearlbay city, and Evershire town

Since any Peeler can recall, the house of Beauport is the original stewards of the town of Beauport and has for many centuries lived a rather isolated life there, managing the area and the island in peace. A few years ago, the Count of Pearlbay, living in the city of Pearlbay on the twin-island of Beauport and in control of Wenet island as well, suddenly went raving mad. The count made several harmful rules, squandered

money, and sent his guards to raid innocent citizens of the island of Pearlbay. The Baron of Beauport quickly opened his coffers to help stabilize his neighbor and assisted in capturing the Count. Before the trial, the count bit off his tongue and bled out. After the event, the citizens of Pearlbay were so grateful for the aid of the baron and impressed by his quick decisions and his generous ways that he naturally became the noble caretaker of all three islands. The Baroness of Beauport mostly remains in their mansion in Beauport, and there are rumors that the couple is not on good terms. The baron himself is known to be an intelligent man who is well-read and not afraid to act when opportunities arise.

ARMATHAIN



Location: West coast, north of Applegate, west of Malgrave, northwest of Greenfield, south of Sirendale

Authority: Regent and nobility

Geography

Armathain's geography is dominated by the presence of the high and steep Moqard Sierra mountain chain. This mountain chain contains iron ore, as well as silver and gold veins. In the eastern shadow of the Moqard Sierra is a high and vast grassy highland that is windy, and rainfall is very uncommon. The elevation of the Melangar Highlands decreases slowly to the east but abruptly to the south. The less elevated grasslands to the west are named the Bicides Veldt, which experiences a bit more rainfall and is less windy. South of the eastern tip of the Moqard Sierra, rain is more common, which has created the Nemarra Thicket, a dense and rocky evergreen forest. The Melangar Highlands are pierced by mighty mountain rivers that split the soft highland terrain in steep v-shaped valleys. The mountain rivers of Teima, Krime, Yveima, Raima, and Teigri all flow too fast for river travel, however, they are an excellent source of fish in the autumn. The Armathainish displace and pump water up on the valley walls to create terraces for farming.

The northern and western shadow of the Moqard Sierra is far steeper. The great elevation of the mountain change quickly gives way for a swamp, the Patkov Marsh, or woodland to the northwest and along the western coast. The evergreen forest that stretches along the west coast is named the Sum Wald, which is very rocky

and moderately thick. The Topaz Cove offers deep waters but only a slightly rocky shoreline. The Armathainians have succeeded at creating a few profitable farmlands around this bay. The Hierac Strait is even deeper than the Topaz Shore, with rocky shores that offer many natural harbors. The land around the Hierac Strait is equally craggy and rocky. The south is mostly covered in farmlands, the northern part of the Qettam Meadow, with moderately high, but still gentle, rolling hills.

Summary

In Armathain name, wealth and tradition hold the most power. If you were born a noble, it is your ancient right to remain such, with all the perks and duties it comes with. Not adhering to tradition and hierarchy is social and economic suicide in Armathain. Armathain believes their culture to be superior. There is a reluctance in Armathain to share their resources and advantages with other kingdoms, which has built up quite the national debt, mostly with Stormholme. In Armathain, your life's path is chosen by your parents' profession and what social rank you were born into. Armathain is dominated by a dramatic topography with a mighty mountain chain rich in ore. Food is either fished from the coast or rivers, farmed from hillside terraces, or found in animal husbandry of sturdy highland cattle, sheep, or goats. Armathain is known for its superb steel and excellent arms and armor smiths.

Armachonin



Living in Armathain

The Radiance of Geanor's passages about the value of Souls is taken very seriously in Armathain. There is a widespread belief that the Soul properties are mostly hereditary, and thereby it is the child's fate and destiny to inherit one of their parent's life's path and the value of their Soul. Queen Armcaster, the matriarch of the royal house of Armathain, is almost the direct descendent of Duke Armcaster, the last custodian of the Duchy of Armathain before the Empire fell apart.

The people of Armathain supported the Empire as much as they abhorred it. Culturally, the right for your child to inherit your title and wealth is very significant for Armathainians. Moreover, Armathain has a history of conservative politics and traditionalistic viewpoints. So the part of the Empire that promised adherence to traditions, order, and stability was greatly appreciated, but Armathainians could never reconcile with the imposed law of meritocracy. Thus, Armathain rebelled, sometimes violently.

Armathain is a nation rich in natural resources, harboring strong pines on the coast, easy access to stone, as well as high-quality iron, silver, and gold ore in their mountains. They have access to fish and shellfish, both from the sea and from river fish that travel from Karthmere to play and mate in the high rivers of the Armathainian plateau. Their terrain is mostly rocky and craggy, which has proven a good foundation for the infrastructure of Armathain. However, their natural food sources have proven themselves sometimes not enough to feed the kingdom's swelling population. When the Empire fell, the food relocation program within the Empire ceased, which some duchies relied on. Armathain was one of them.

Eventually, Armathain experienced a few years of poor harvests, which drove Armathain to invade Applegate. Consequently, this sparked the Armathainian and Karthmerian war. Due to Armathain's presence in Applegate, Karthmere felt forced to attack Applegate themselves, unwilling to give Armathain more land and power. Ultimately, the two opposing forces met each other in

Applegate, and their attention turned to each other rather than the central Applegate. At the end of this war, Armathain and Karthmere were able to conquer about a fourth each of Applegate. The rest acting as a buffer between the two mighty kingdoms. Armathain felt victorious in the end, as their new fertile southern territories gave them much-needed farmland.

Armathain doesn't export much of its natural resources, especially not its precious metals, as they see it as strategically catastrophic. They do not want other countries to share their military advantage. Despite this isolationist approach to their export, Armathain still imports goods. The Armathainian elite is made of a proud stock who wants to flaunt their power and prestige, and this is encouraged by the upper echelons of leadership. It is seen as an important propaganda tactic to safeguard the Armathainians' sense of self-worth, superiority, and love for their own country. This has resulted in quite the national debt, mostly to Stormholme, and many of the nobility's pockets are running dangerously low.

Armathain's technology level is both sophisticated and outdated. Even if most professionals are taught well in their respective areas, Armathain is slow to adopt new inventions after the Empire's fall. In Armathain, you're more often than not taught that there is a true and tried way, and the rest is inferior.

The Marks

The Naming ceremony, where a newborn child is blessed in a Church of Riahn and given its name, is not only a tradition in Armathain. It is mandatory. If you can pay the fee, that is. The ceremony serves two important tasks in Armathainian society, it allows for a national archive of its people, their profession, and rank, but also ensures the tattooing of your social "mark." Several dots are tattooed on the newborn baby's neck, signifying which social rank the baby will belong to for now. Later, in their teenage years, during the ceremony of the Rising, these dots are tattooed into small suns instead, and their social rank will be finalized and confirmed. Criminals are often robbed of their marks to join the ranks of

the Unmarked. The rest of the Unmarked are simply too poor to pay the fee of the Naming ceremony. Falsifying your mark is considered a grave crime.

Unmarked

Those without a Mark lack basic civil rights. This includes barely any protection in the Armathainian law, no right to enter any kind of education, no right to own proper houses, establishments, animals, vehicles, ore, etc., and often no right to sell produce at markets or enter towns with walls. The Unmarked are also not allowed to leave Armathain. The lack of protection and rights usually ends up in exploitation, black markets, and slave labor. Those unfortunate enough to be born Unmarked or turned Unmarked usually live outside of society and often find themselves at an early grave.

The Humility Mark

The first mark is made up of the bulk of the Armathainian population, and they possess basic civil rights. However, these civil rights are weaker than what, for example, a Malgravian citizen would enjoy. There are also some restrictions in place of what kind of buildings, tools, arms, etc., they can own, what kind of education they can acquire, and what kind of areas they can enter without the permission of a higher mark. Those within the Humility Mark often work as servants, farmhands, laborers, fishermen, loggers, tanners, spinners, herders, ranchers, etc.

The Diligence Mark

In the Diligence Mark, you can find simple craftsmen, privates in the army, merchants, hunters, basic scribes, low ranking priests, farm owners, cattle owners, boat owners, etc. This category enjoys the full basic protections of the law and is often allowed into most places and educations, but there are still areas off-limits to this social rank. This concerns especially how far they can advance in their career. A Diligent private in the army can never gain a higher rank than those of the lowest order.

Integrity Mark

What primarily divides the Integrity Mark from the Diligent Mark is salary and office. Whilst accessibility and rights are largely the same, an Integrity marked man or woman has access to higher-paid careers and higher

positions. This includes more prestigious crafters such as goldsmiths, steel smiths, gourmet chefs, posh hatmakers, luxurious cobblers, etc. It also includes more wealthy merchants, farmland owners, fish boat fleet owners, cattle owners, and other kinds of business owners. In addition, medium ranked scribes, soldiers, and priests.

The Distinct Mark

The Distinct Mark is the first mark of nobility a person can display, and this mark includes the lowest of nobles. The higher positions in the Church, military, and government. Being a part of the Distinct Mark opens up many doors and often leads to well-paid and significant careers.

The Valiant Mark

Only the highest of priests, soldiers, and government officials can be found in this circle, those who work tightly with the two higher marks. It is also where we can find nobles of intermediate influence. Being a part of the Valiant Mark allows you to enter circles surrounding the high nobles and the crown.

The Eminent Mark

This mark encompasses the five regional governor families of the "The Five Duchies," Arndal, Coppertree, Gilstrong, Highward, and Rotleigh. This mark entails great leniency yet constant oversight with no privacy and the great duty to supervise an Armathainian duchy.

The Radiant Mark

The Radiant Mark is only given to members of the royal family, which signifies their purity of blood and Soul. There are only a handful of this rank members, and they wield great power yet shoulders the most duty and responsibility.

The Mark system is rather simple, a Radiant has a small tattoo of a sun, whilst an Eminent has two, a Valiant three, etc. This makes it possible to add a lower rank but impossible to gain one once marked.

One significant ceremony is the Rising ceremony, which is celebrated when a child turns 15. In this ceremony, outside of celebrating the transformation of becoming an adult, your life's career and purpose must be nailed down by your family and the

authorities. If this life path is considered not to be on par with their current mark, their mark level is lowered. This function is in place to not crowd certain ranks. Part of what ensures the privilege of certain ranks is their size. Not everyone can live as an Eminent noble, and therefore it is in the Eminent nobles' concern to keep the number of their ranks consistent and somewhat sustainable.

Matriarchs and patriarchs of families have certain powers and rights within the law to control their family members. For example, being in control of their family fortune and possessing influence over the family's Unions. Sometimes people enter into the Union in between marks, foremost to gain some kind of advantage. The children of the highest marked parent usually inherit their level, whilst their spouse technically remains in their original rank but could enjoy higher privileges if the higher mark wants and could arrange it. A prime example is the regent of Armathain, their spouse, and their children. The regent cannot marry someone of their rank as there would be none eligible. Usually, this husband or wife is chosen from the Eminent Mark. As the regent spouse, you would still be considered Eminent, certainly higher than other Eminent, but not a pure Radiant either. The regent children must inherit the Mark of Radiant to possibly be able to rule one day.

Marks and Society

Besides these social ranks, there are other social rules. A child of a priest is expected to become a priest themselves, shoemakers turn to shoemakers, farmers into farmers, soldiers into soldiers, etc. This also applies to the five great noble houses, where it is their duty to both govern their region and their respective sectors. Interestingly, it is mostly the Humility mark and nobles of Distinct Mark who enjoy the most freedom in this society if they are born into a family with many siblings. The eldest is foremost responsible for carrying on the family's tradition and profession, but it certainly becomes easier with siblings helping to carry that burden. Moreover, as the youngest or one of the youngest of a large family, you might not necessarily be needed within the family's profession and can be

assigned something new due to local shortages.

Through the marks, the government of Armathain has created a consistent system where it is relatively easy to gain oversight over trade and production, which has somewhat eliminated the need for guilds. Sometimes a region's production grows too small, perhaps through the disappearance of key production families, then it is the Master of Heritage's duty to elevate or shift heritage around, so the local area keeps on functioning as it should. For example, if there is a shoemaker family who disappeared in a certain region, a younger child of another region is given a new name and is moved to become the new shoemaker family in the first region.

The system is also known for its rigidity and inefficiency. This inefficiency usually stems from the people who lack particular inclinations and passions being forced into professions and stations they're not suited for. This is especially detrimental for the higher ranks. A noble can be horrible ill-suited to rule, and very little can remove them from power. Furthermore, as businesses and noble governance are run in the family, it can create a lot of discord as the family can be the worst kind of people to be actively working with.

After all of this, Armathain's culture is steeped in traditions and rituals. Depending upon your mark, you don't even try to speak to some other marks or even look upon them, as it can invite trouble. Festivals, holidays, and ceremonies are significant to prove your station and the nobility of your Soul, no matter your mark, because all marks have something to lose. Dressing, acting, socializing, etc., is often done with the single goal in mind to prove you belong to your mark. However, accidentally overstepping your boundaries by flaunting as if you belong to a higher mark will often catch the attention of someone with more influence than you. The higher marks jealousy safeguard what they have, to protect their power and rights.

One prevalent fashion in Armathain for middle to higher marks is showing off their neck. Women part their hair or gather it in fashionable hairstyles that leave the neck

bare. Fashion is often tailored to show off the neck area. Even greeting someone formally is bowing down deep and twisting slightly to give the other a clear shot of their mark if the difference in rank is unknown between the two. Otherwise, only the lower rank has to bow. Any scarring or other tattoos close to your mark is immediately seen as suspicious and can lead to inquiries at the guard's office.

Relation to the Church

The relation to the Church of Riahn is relatively strong. Whilst religion and tradition are a constant in Armathainian lives, there is a hard limit to what the Church can do in Armathain's society. Every marked citizen is expected to give Riahn and the Church homage and participate in the various ceremonies. To not would lead to a quick road to the removal of the mark. The Church also has a monopoly of certain functions in society, such as medical work, the legitimacy of a myriad of things, and of course the Naming, the Rising, the Union, and the Farewell.

After a marked child is old enough to walk and speak, they must head to their designated Church approximately an hour or two after sunset for clerical education. This is an opportunity for the Church to impart good and sound morals to the children. Of course, different marks are kept away from each other. But as mentioned above, if the Church would overstep any of its privileges or duties, word would travel quickly to the five noble houses of the Eminent Mark and the crown. Any attempt to encroach on their power is emphatically stomped out.

Relations to other Nations

Armathain, with their superiority complex, usually finds it hard to work on equal terms with any other kingdom. Decades ago, Armathain conquered farmland from Applegate but had to battle against Karthmere to acquire it. This historical struggle with Karthmere is still alive and brooding to this day. Karthmere is frequently slandered in public for being undisciplined and impure, or just "simple".

In recent years, attention has shifted to Sirendale, whose defenses have mostly

crumbled against the vicious raids of Beornhelm, especially after the Great Ransack of Mistshear. To say that Armathain's military presence in Sirendale was uniformly welcomed is a stretch of the truth. However, Sirendale has still benefited from the extra muscle. Armathain had another motive involving themselves in the politics and defense of Sirendale; Money. As Armathain's coffers are running low, despite the raids, Sirendale is flourishing. In a sense, Armathain is holding parts of Sirendale's economy hostage through their military presence. Obey us, pay us taxes, or else we will leave you defenseless to Beornhelm, or worse, use our troops differently. It might be that only Sirendale is keeping Armathain from complete economic ruin.

Though, Armathain is also cautious about their presence in Beornhelm. They do not want to overextend too far and take too heavy losses from the Beornish presence, or worse, get dragged into another war. Therefore, Armathain is more prevalent in the southern and central areas of Sirendale; they tread far more carefully in the north. It is their hope that their presence alone is enough for Beornhelm to waiver. To a degree, this tactic has worked well enough.

There is one more reason why Armathain is not completely committing, which is not openly discussed; The fear of Malgrave. Armathain holds begrudging respect for their neighboring kingdom, despite their shared history during the Imperial years. Armathain both hates Malgrave with a passion and harbors respect for their might. There is also a constant struggle to upstage Malgrave, proving themselves better, but using Armathain's traditional methods rather than Malgrave's progressive agenda.

There is a strong distrust of Stormholme. Whilst they do a lot of business with them, they fear their influence in the country. If a Stormholme ship is docked in an Armathainian port, it is swiftly put under heavy guard, and the crew is given rigid restrictions to their stay.

Military

Armathain has a long tradition of training a standing army of quite some size. The standing army is composed of professional soldiers, which in peacetime serves as guards, scouts, and messengers in Armathain or Sirendale. Whilst soldier families can be stationed in all of Armathain, the grand Arndalian military academy is the core training ground for all nation troops. Military families tend to not have a grounded family house. Instead, the government supplies small houses to them. Higher ranked soldiers receive less foundation training due to lessons in tactics, strategy, supplies, etc.

The units of the army are incredibly disciplined with a strict hierarchy. The average quality of a soldier is relatively high, both considering training and equipment. For the higher positions in the army, this varies widely. While the quality of education is high, it is hard to teach someone into a hardened general if they faint at the sight of blood. The tactics of Armathain are often sound and sharp, but the complexity of the troop's maneuvers and the rigidity of the lines of command leaves little room for flexibility and creativity under the current dogma. However, without a doubt, Armathain possesses the highest quality of arms and armor in all of Frostmark. Armathain has a few warships, but they are mostly moving troops around rather than open sea battle.

One designated unit of the army is the skirmish contingent. They are equipped with throwing spears as well as infantry spears and a shield. They engage the enemy viciously and quick, then retreat behind a shield wall to regroup and commit to flanking positions. The standard unit of Armathain is a well armored and shielded infantry with spears and short swords that alternate front lines. Soldiers of higher rank instead of opting for a different approach. They enter into combat as extremely well-armored knights on top of massive armored warhorses, charging into weak points and wreaking havoc from above with their greatswords or longswords. Assigned to every knight are two battle squires with shield and sword, whose sole purpose is to protect their liege's life. There are also special arbalist units, equipped with heavy

crossbows. They are designed to destroy the enemy's tanks or create openings for their knights. The mounted knights serve out of the war as bodyguards for the higher nobility and entertain them through knightly games.

Armathain's army excels inside its borders and in defensive positions. Armathain is demanding to invade, as their naturally hilly and craggy landscape brings a disadvantage to an attacking force. Furthermore, the vast resources of stone and labor have built many fortified positions that scatter the Armathainian landscape in tactical positions.

Armathain is divided into six districts, where five Eminent households govern duchies. The capital and a generous amount of land around it are governed by the crown family. Each Eminent household is also given a nation-wide area of responsibility. These families lack the attention to governing their vast lands and their respective responsibility effectively. Therefore their regional power is mostly ceremonial. The real ownership and oversight over the land are divided between a hierarchy of nobles underneath them. The duchies are divided into marches, which are divided into counties, which divides into viscounties, and lastly, into a myriad of baronies. The nobility often hires offspring from families underneath them to assist them as ministers in their work. Some civilians are born into stations within the government, but these never hold any power to make executive decisions.

ARMARCHAIN



Royal House Armcaster

Ruler: Queen Bernadette (45 years)

Family: King (53 years) and a son (16 years)

Coat of Arms: Diagonal fields, one of blood red, the other field black, and in between the fields a band of gold with a single silver sun in the middle.

Rule: Armcaster Capital, Boltcrest City, and Steepbarrow Town

Queen Bernadette Armcaster has been loved by the Armathainian people since her childhood. Elegant, brilliant, and scrupulous, queen Armcaster seems to be a robot, performing her duties with punctuality and excellence. Some Armathainians worship her to the point they would claim that she harbors a piece of Geanor's Soul within her. From her predecessor's opulent and more arrogant ways, queen Armcaster is significantly more frugal and pragmatic. Bernadette has been able to stabilize Armathain's economy somewhat by cementing their presence in Sirendale, a project her father began with.

The king of Armathain, the original heir to the Highward family, gave up his duke's future title to become the queen's consort. In his early days as king, Xaver Highward showed some potential, but the queen eventually out-shined him and came to even save him from his own mistakes on some occasions. It is no secret that the king has turned somewhat bitter these days. The heir to the throne, Prince Tedric Armcaster, adores his mother and much Armathainian hope that queen Armcaster can depart some of her splendor unto the prince.

House Arndal, Master of the Army

Ruler: Duke Elyas (21 years old)

Family: None

Coat of Arms: Diagonal fields, one of blood-red with a stylized castle displayed in black, the other field black, and in between a line of gold separate the two fields.

Rule: Arndal City, Oldharbour Town, and Rustrun Town

House Arndal has been plagued with a string of unsuccessful marriages. In the past decades, the title of Duke or Duchess of Arndal has been passed between several old

family members as one after the other submitted to disease and death. In the end, the only legitimate family member left was a male heir of 17, Elyas. He now shoulders the heavy responsibility of leading Armathain's army and spearheading its security. In the present day, the duke has ruled as duke for 4 years, and despite his young age and lack of experience, he has shown a remarkable talent for management and strategy. However, it is no secret that the lanky and young duke is no burly fighter, despite his tutor's best attempts.

Duke Arndal is a devoted soul who spends most of his waking hours reading and writing impressive insight into the army's operations. Though, he's never been known to be an eloquent courtier, to most suitors' disappointment. His position has left him pressured, non-sociable and ill-tempered. Duke Arndal has behind him a whole retinue of experienced generals who counsel him often. General Thoston, an experienced but relatively young female general, rarely seems to leave the duke's side.

House Rotleigh, Master of Coin

Ruler: Duchess Agatha (32 years)

Family: Duke (49 years), deceased sister (46 years), deceased niece (15 years), and a daughter (7 years)

Coat of Arms: Diagonal fields, one of gold with two silver suns displayed, the other field black with a golden coin displayed.

Rule: Rotleigh City, Ironvault Town, and Silverhall Town

The earlier Duchess, Joy Rotleigh, was a gentle and beloved woman with the most adorable daughter and loving husband. Many looked at the Rotleigh family with high hopes, and thereby the tragedy of their death impacted Armathain even harder. Joy and her daughter's fate was also a terrible one, burning to death in their favorite summer house. Fortunately, the consort of the late Duchess, duke Ludovic, was not present with them as he was still in town for business. Next in line was the younger sister, Agatha, who is known for her sharp wit, lively personality, and domineering attitude. An internal decision was made within the family, and the Church agreed upon remarrying the duke to the new Duchess,

who has since then birthed a daughter with him.

It took some time for the house's allies to warm up to Agatha after the loss, partially because she handles her duchess duties more than adequately. However, in recent years, duchess Agatha has grown more and more paranoid that someone is trying to kill her as well. She often isolates herself and her family with only a few trusted servants and refuses to participate in state affairs and socializing.

House Coppertree, Master of Faith

Ruler: Duke Leonard (23 years)

Family: Two brothers (20 years, 14 years) and one illegitimate daughter (5 years)

Coat of Arms: Diagonal fields, one of blood red, the other field black, in between a thick band of silver with a copper oak tree displayed on it

Rule: Coppertree City, Goldyard Town, and Ebongrasp City

Duke Coppertree is causing many headaches for his house. He is ill-suited for his position and cares very little for his duties and duke. Within the Coppertree family, it is common to coerce the duke to perform those duties that he absolutely must perform. Duke Coppertree is a young and handsome man who prefers the company of entertainers, "escorts," and artists of both genders. Even if the elite strongly dislikes his frivolous ways, the lower class's men and women that get the pleasure of his company would eagerly remark on his good humor, caring nature, and passion for life.

A few years ago, Duke Coppertree fell in love with a lower-class woman who had a daughter with him. The duke loved them both and was ready to go to war against his house to legitimize his daughter and lover. The situation turned more chaotic by the hour until the duke's lover sent a message to the duke claiming she can't handle courtly life and that she was moving to Kathmere with their daughter. Leonard has been even more troublesome after their departure, usually in between fits of melancholy and depression.

House Highward, Master of Heritage

Ruler: Duchess Sigrith (16 years)

Family: Duke (25 years)

Coat of Arms: Diagonal fields, one of blood-red with a stylized castle with a golden crown above displayed in black, the other field black, and in between a thinner band of gold with three white suns displayed in a row along with it.

Rule: Highward City, Topazshore Town, and Northwall Town

Duchess Highward is the sole niece of king Xaver Highward. Her parents died of a disease when she was little and has, therefore, leaned on Xaver as a sort of father figure. Xaver and Sigrith are very close, and the king often travels to Highward City to advise her. The Duchess herself is young and inexperienced but a woman who knows what she wants and can be extremely persuasive. At her worst, she acts spoiled and pretentious. At her best, she is efficient and determined.

House Gilstrong, Master of Infrastructure

Ruler: Duke Thurstan (22 years)

Family: Deceased Duchess (25 years), sister (19 years), brother (17 years), and a daughter (3 years)

Coat of Arms: Diagonal fields, one of blood red with three stylized castles displayed in black, the other field black with three stylized blood-red castles displayed, and in between a thin line of gold that separates them.

Rule: Gilstrong City, Bronzewish City, and Steelpost Town

Duke Thurstan is another young charming, and powerful noble of Armathain. Like duke Leonard Coppertree, Thurstan greatly enjoys parties and revelries. Thurstan is way more clever however, he makes sure to take care of his duties adequately to get it out of his way, seemingly not caring an awful lot about his responsibility.

Thurstan is not the one to visit the lower ranks, like Leonard, he keeps close tabs on his company's status. An infamous suitor, many noble girls, have been left heartbroken

as he claims that none is good enough for him. In the end, his family forced him to marry, and Thurstan was less than thrilled. He hardly spent any time with her or the daughter the two of them had together. Two years later, after their daughter's birth, his

wife succumbed to a sudden and vicious disease. Many whisper conspiracy theories about her death, but no evidence points the duke out as a culprit. After the funeral had blown over, the duke was quick to return to his old lifestyle.

BEORNHELM



Location: North Greenfield, north of Sirendale, north of Oldwood, and coast to the north, west, and east.

Authority: Autocracy by a Warchieftain and chieftains

Geography

Beornhelm's most remarkable geographical feature is the great mountain range of Orean's Hand. It is the tallest and longest mountain range in Frostmark. The northern arm of Beornhelm is an arctic landscape with all year long snow, ice, and glaciers. Along the coast of the Bay of Nechim, the islands of Nechim, and the western coast, the climate is slightly warmer by the grace of warm ocean currents pressed upwards into the bay of Nechim, by Selzissa island. Along the southern coastline of the bay of Nechim and on the islands of Nechim, there may be small human settlements, primarily surviving on seal and whale hunting.

Further south, the Orean's Hand is broken up into what is commonly named the Orean's Fingers. These sprawling mountain ranges are sporadically divided by deep and fast sea and mountain rivers. Over the millennia, they have pierced through weak points in the mountains and created v or u valleys, depending upon whether the river ever freezes into glaciers during the winters or colder periods. The biome in central to southern Beornhelm is boreal taiga. There are three vast valleys in between Orean's Fingers, Devatti Dale, Razyak Dale, and Prexarros Dale. These valleys' edges are covered in evergreen trees, but the center experiences so low precipitation that it is mostly covered in resilient grass and bush species. The diminished chances of snowfall

in the winter make these valleys easy to travel through and ideal for herding.

The southwest is the warmest region in Beornhelm, where there might be some profitable farmlands by the Eagle's Straight. In between the Scyris and Thetian river, there is an old and coveted redwood forest. The rest of the south is covered in the Oldberry Woods, a thick temperate forest that is hilly, rocky, and may hide small swamps here and there. The Oldberry Woods is dominated by pines, firs, and birches, but other cold-resistant trees can also be found. The eastern and western

shoreline is mostly deep and rocky, so natural harbors are easy to find, but there are also stony beaches with more shallow waters occasionally.

Summary

The land of Beornhelm is cold, mountainous, windy, and progressively more arctic. There is little opportunity to farm in these lands. Instead, they survive on animal husbandry, fishing, and taking the rest from each other or through raiding other kingdoms. This harsh land has created equally fierce and sturdy people who share a practical mindset and a code of honor. There is only one simple rule for the Beornish, honorable might makes right. Therefore, power fluctuates in these lands, either split between local warlords or held in a vice grip of a Warchieftain who has somehow

BEORNHHELM



managed to intimidate all other warlords under them. But no institution of power lasts for long.

As soon as a leader makes too many mistakes, they are swiftly exchanged for another ambitious upstart. The Beornish trade with Stormholme and Karthmere for food and wares and raid kingdoms closer to home for whatever else they require. Unfortunately for the Beornish, Oldwood and Sirendale are becoming harder and harder to raid, Oldwood through its impressive defenses, and Sirendale is now protected by Armathain. For the first time, the beornish are turning their hungry gazes further south, building seafaring boats.

Living in Beornhelm

Due to the low life expectancy in Beornhelm and the paranoid climate, there isn't much of an educational system in Beornhelm. If you're lucky and you have some aptitude, you could be picked up as an apprentice of rare and sought-after masters of different trades. Most things your family must teach you, and if you have none, you must train yourself. Sometimes masters can be kidnapped from another Beornish tribe or another kingdom and then intimidated to spill their secrets to whoever wants to learn them or forced to live and work in their new home village.

The Beornish is a proud and independent people, which says a lot about how harsh a ruler needs to be to exact control over these lands. Loyalty and honor are imperative for any free man or woman, and so is also your word to a fellow honorable Beornish. If you lose your integrity, others will treat you with none. If the Warchieftain believes that a chieftain has abandoned their loyalty, the punishment is swift and merciless.

There are generally four social ranks in Beornish culture: slaves, free folk, masters, and chieftains. Slaves are unlucky souls who have either been kidnapped from another settlement or kingdom or become one through punishment. The free folk is the peasantry, folk who are not professionals in a trade or full-time warriors. Masters gather more respect than the rest of the free folk, either from the fear of pissing off someone

who can quickly kill you or losing someone who contributes significantly to the community. Examples of masters can be exceptional hunters, smiths, healers, warriors, leatherworkers, distillers, builders, etc. The chieftains are simply bold warriors or masters who believe their influence might be grander than anyone else's.

Relation to the Church

The Church of Riahn has struggled to regain its foothold in Beornhelm ever since the Empire fell. Being assigned to Beornhelm is often regarded as a fool's errand or a death sentence for any priest who isn't a naive zealot. Depending upon the current ruler of Beornhelm, the attitude towards the Church can be chilly or antagonistic. Most Beornish see no reason to participate in the rianish faith. Any attempt for the Sacred Arms to work within the border of Beornhelm is met with open hostility as they are regarded as foreign forces. Historically, people have been able to worship whatever they want in Beornhelm, but most practices have been forgotten after the invasion of Geanor purged other religions.

Relation to other Kingdoms

Raiding is a relatively common summer activity for warriors and free folk of Beornhelm. If there is no reward in raiding another village or town in Beornhelm, they raid their neighboring kingdoms instead. Sirendale, Greenfield, and Oldwood have significantly suffered from these raids and, as a result, despise the Beornish. Trade still happens between these kingdoms and Beornhelm, but it is only conducted when the Beornish believes they would lose more from attacking. Sometimes, trade ships from Stormholme and Karthmere appear on Beornhelm's coast, which the Beornish trade rigorously with. Attacking these vessels would not benefit the Beornish, as Karthmere and Stormholme would stop sending trading ships to them in response. In recent years, as the Armathainian presence in Sirendale has intimidated Beornhelm and chieftain Falconer has changed his ways, Sirendale has started to warm up to the idea of a transformed Beornhlem in Falconer's hands. Greenfield is the king who has the most reason to hate Beornhelm. Chieftain Idris turned a

successful summer raid into an invasion and occupation that has lasted for years. Today, the chieftain controls most of the northern territories of Greenfield and the northeastern region of the kingdom.

Beornhelm has also been dissuaded from attacking Oldwood. Duke Grimcolt has created an impressive defense of the northern border and is currently in the process of building a wall. As the invasion of Greenfield has entered into a bit of a stalemate recently, and Sirendale and Oldwood are not profitable raid targets anymore, the absence of influx of slaves, food, gold, and other sought-after wares, has undoubtedly been felt by the Beornish. To keep the Beornish people's respect, the Warchieftain Kynemund is now forced to find other means of prosperity for those loyal to him. He has started a grand project of building seafaring boats, and already a few prodding raid parties have been sent to the coast of Armathain and Applegate.

Military

The military might of Beornhelm is composed of chieftains' forces, which the Warchieftain can take control over when he or she issues orders. Most commonly, the Warchieftain's army is the largest. If another chieftain would build an army that could rival that of the Warchieftain, the Warchieftain might expect trouble in their future. To remain in power as a Warchieftain often means to show off your strength and a constant game of intimidation, which hopefully keeps other chieftains from plotting to take their spot. It is up to the individual chieftain to train and organize their troops. Possessing no military prowess is just an invitation for another chieftain or chieftain to be, to take what is yours. However, a valid excuse to attack another chieftain or Warchieftain is required to justify your cause, to ensure that your honor remains intact. A common way of achieving this is to claim that the chieftain has lost their honor.

In the past, Beornhelm has only needed riverboats and smaller trading or fishing vessels for their coastal region. With the change in the political landscape around Beornhelm, they are now experimenting

with creating ships that could carry raiding parties and bounties on longer sea voyages. Beornish warriors carry leather with some complimentary items of iron or steel, most commonly a helmet of metal. The most common weapons are axes, bows, and spears. Though chieftains love to get their hands on Armathainian steel to outfit themselves with. It is unusual to see a chieftain or successful warrior outfit themselves in a full set of plates, as the Beornish prefer a more aggressive and dynamic fighting style.

The specific types of warriors in Beornhelm vary between chieftains. However, some common archetypes of warriors exist, like that of an infantry unit with a round shield and who carries axes or spears. Another distinct unit type is muscular marauders with two-handed mauls or axes who utilize their brute strength to create openings in the enemy's frontline. As hunting is a common way to feed your family, archers are a common occurrence in Beornhelm. Chieftains like to bring a number of them to pick on the flanks or shoot down any opportunist who break from the round shield formation.

Beornhelm



Warchieftain Kynemund

Ruler: Warchieftain Brand Kynemund (33 years)

Family: Female partner (22 years) and a son (3 years old)

Coat of Arms: A black shield with a forest green diagonal cross above it, displayed in the middle an outline of a mound with a black bull passant with vicious horns standing upon it.

Rule: Frostborn capital

Brand Kynemund is an exceptional fighter, as Warchieftain's tend to be. He served as a raid commander under the last Warchieftain. He experienced firsthand how Oldwood tightened their borders, Greenfield grew too desolate, and how Sirendale gained support and protection from Armathain. He saw how their coffers slowly became drier, how their number of thralls decreased and how Beornish raiders growing increasingly restless, turning to rampant civil unrest. In the end, Kynemund considered the last Warchieftain had failed their task of leading Beornhlem. He gathered support in secret, and one decapitated head later, the power was his.

Kynemund couldn't immediately try to mend Beornhelm's circumstances but had to for a few years consolidate power, gain loyalty from chieftains, or create new ones where he had to. But this last year has finally allowed him to turn his gaze outwards. Kynemund is determined to bring Beornhelm back to its former glory by boldly raiding further south than they have ever done before. Kynemund is protective of Beornish traditions and culture, passionate for his cause, and ruthless to his enemies.

Chieftain Falconer

Ruler: Chieftain Soren Falconer (36 years)

Family: Female partner (33 years) and a deceased son (15 years)

Coat of Arms: A black shield with a forest green diagonal cross above it, displayed in the middle a copper falcon rampant.

Rule: Eaglemouth city, Sleetforest town

Soren Falconer arose to the position of chieftain on the west coast, ruling over quite a substantial area, by the grace of his honor

and his sharp aptitude for tactics. Soren has been one of Kynemund's closest allies, often raiding together in their youth. Soren supported Kynemund when he plotted the last Warchieftain's death and has been an essential advisor to Kynemund during his reign.

Soren was ecstatic when his son was born. Like every other Boernish chieftain, he attempted to turn his child into an accomplished warrior who could inherit the chieftain's title. Instead, Aelric turned out to be a great shame for Soren, as the little runt was incredibly sensitive, preferring to stay inside to read books. There were many quarrels in Soren's household as he continued to fail at molding Aelric into what was expected of him. As Aelric grew older, he became more and more intelligent and secretly collected rare books, which his mother assisted him with. Aelric wanted nothing more than to tell his father the stories he read about other countries and what they have achieved, discussing their systems of education, trade, and law. All the while, Aelric wished he had been born in Malgrave or Karthmere.

Then, Aelric fell ill simultaneously as Soren was ordered by Kynemund to oversee another attempt to raid Sirendale. Aelric's mother begged Soren not to go, informing him that the fever could be fatal. Soren's last words to his dying son were that he would stay and stand vigil over a child that does not possess a single bone in his body. When he eventually came home, Aelric had already passed. Despite his harsh words, the death of his son made him realize how much he had loved him even if he was not cut from the same personality Soren possessed. It was a profound moment for Soren, as he started to doubt everything that he believed in.

He isolated himself from Kynemund, claiming he was busy with internal affairs in his chiefdom. During this time, Soren discovered his son's books and read a few of them. He reevaluated his beliefs and principles. He realized that he disagreed with how things were done in Beornhelm, the constant cycle of life and death that only led to stagnation. Maybe the old traditions weren't as beneficial as he once thought. Soren now believed that what would be best

for Beornhelm is to steer it in the other contemporary kingdoms' direction and become more like them, more peaceful and prosperous. Merely a year ago, he declared his open rebellion against Kynemund, staking his claim on the position of

Warchieftain. So far, Kynemund has only sent Soren messages, asking if he is earnest and begging him not to continue with this foolish action, seemingly in disbelief and, so far, reluctant to fight his old friend.

CROWHILL



Location: South of Eastcreek and east of Stormholme

Authority: Monarchy but also considerably influenced by the Church of Riahn

Geography

Crowhill's islands all experience a hot-summer Mediterranean climate with winter monsoons that appear every seventh year. Besides the main island, two other islands are large and moderately populated, the Bright island and the Sembra island.

All three islands share some similar features. The coastlines are intermittently beaches of white sands or stone and white shallow or deep waters, or rocky shorelines with either shallow or deep waters. The has always been an important sou-rce of resources for the Crow, so all the most suitable harbors had a village, town, or city grown around it. They all share the feature of some sort of mountain range, but Menas Ridge on the main island is the tallest and longest of the three. Neither mountain range is taller or mightier than the Moqard Sierra in Armathain or Orea's Hand in Beornhelm and Oldwood. Signs of erosion are visible on these mountain ranges, thus, in the past, they might have been taller. Menas Ridge is known to contain gems as well as veins of silver and gold.

The different biomes you can find on these islands are either rocky desert-like areas where only the hardest kind of fauna and flora can be found incredibly fertile farmlands around freshwater rivers and lakes or arid grasslands. The main island has several great bays, Crow's Basin, Bay of Aurum, and the White Strait.

Summary

The kingdom of Crowhill inhabits the largest island on Frostmark and a few other smaller islands. Its geography is craggy, only river dales and the flat shoreline offer ground to build towns and agriculture. The rest are steep cliffs that rise and rise towards the mountain chain, Menas Ridge, that runs through the island like a spine.

Crowhill is the most religious kingdom on Frostmark. The Riahnish faith has been integrated into the crow society to the point that the higher position of the Church is the country's true nobility. Two major contributions to the kingdom's wealth are mined rare gems from Menas Ridge and radiant pearls from the island's waters. Most of the profit lands in the Church's hands through high taxes. Several lavish cathedrals dot the island, while most of the general population of Crowhill slave away in the mines, fields, or fishing boats.

Due to an effective legal apparatus in Crowhill and a strict culture, petty and violent crimes are surprisingly rare in Crowhill. On the other hand, the Church struggles with corruption, both from within the Church and within the bourgeois. However, expressing concern about corruption is discouraged publicly, individuals who have experienced abuse of power are often threatened or bought off to remain silent. Despite this, the Church is

Bright Island

White Strait

Bay of Aurum

Menas Ridge

Crowhill

Chapel Cove

Crow's Basin

Sembra Islands



kept in genuinely high regard in Crowhill, even if you disregard the fact that the population and the Church share the same faith. One reason for this admiration is the extensive social welfare the Church funds. Offering relief for the poor, education for those who desire it, childcare for those who need it, and elderly care for those desperate.

Living in Crowhill

The island of Crowhill is a nation of extreme economic differences. Here lies the headquarters of the Church of Riahn and the residence of the Solar priest, the highest authority within the Church. Crowhill is faithful to the letter of all three chapters of the Radiance of Geanor, which sets it apart from the other kingdoms of Frostmark, who interpret the book per their traditions and culture.

In the spirit of the sacred texts, there are three social classes in Crowhill; The Sphere (peasants), the Warmth (professionals), and The Shining (nobility). The divide comes from the intrinsic strength and purity of their Souls. Somebody born within the Shining class is considered to have a more pristine Soul than somebody born within the Sphere ranks in Crowhill. Specific rights and duties are given to these classes. It is a Shining's duty to lead, illuminate the dimmer Souls, and shine the way forward. It is the Warmth's duty to safeguard Souls, minds, and bodies, warming those who falter and fall. Sphere's duty is to be the foundation of the system and build a strong and prosperous way of living. In rare cases, a person can prove that their Soul is different from the social class they were born into, rising or falling within the ranks due to ill-conduct or great talent. The difference between the Sphere class and the class of Warmth is mainly a question about taxes, legal rights, and license. The Warmth pay less in taxes, they enjoy greater protection under the law, and they mainly gain certain professions' license. The Warmth' professions include captains of the guard, knights of the sacred arms, priests, scribes, artisans, and legal experts.

The Church struggles to find its rightful place in this hierarchy. Their sacred text details exactly what their duty is in society,

but when the Shining leads astray from the path of Riahn, the wise souls of the Church want to help steer them in the right direction again. Historically, this has been the source of many heated debates within the Church, but ever since the Church relocated their headquarters to Crowhill, the consensus is that the Church must stain themselves in these troubled times. Once Frostmark is back to the Empire's harmony, with one people, one faith, and one God, the Church can fully reclaim their old duties. For now, involving themselves with politics is only for the greater good of Frostmark.

Besides the taxes, there is peer pressure in crow society to donate to their local Church or offer their services to it. Priests are treated with the utmost respect, seen as paragons of virtue and vessels of Riahn's warming light. Ceremonies and rituals are vital in everyday life. Some of the Sphere save their whole lives to afford religious ceremonies for themselves and their family. And somehow prices rise now and then. Official work is done in the hours when the sun shines. After it sets, it is Riahn's will for his people to settle as well and rest. Only businesses that require work during the dark hours of the day are exempt from this. At least twice per week, all crows are expected to attend the local chapel's daily sunrise ceremony. To reject any of the things stated above is social and economic suicide. If you're lucky, you are fined. If you are unlucky, your social status might be downgraded one step. If you are already one of the Sphere and therefore cannot descend anymore, agents of the Sacred Arms come knocking on your door, and you will never be heard of again.

Even if taxes and rules are strict, there are several free services and functions that the Church runs for free. Elderly care, medical attention, supplying guards, educated consultation, therapy, and giving basic education to the Sphere's and Warmth's children as the parents are often busy working during daylight hours. Noble children and children of very successful Warmth members are granted further aid from the Church through advanced schooling. The children of the higher nobility are even assigned a personal priestly tutor. Like every peasant household is assigned a local chapel to worship, every

noble household is assigned a personal priest for private support. It is considered a strange ordeal for the nobility to not involve their house's priest in matters of importance. If a noble doesn't act per the law or the Rianish faith, their house priest informs the Church of their crude behavior. The Church can then deploy several tactics to push the noble in the right direction. This could be forcing donations, withdrawal of privileges, or even public squander. Tools were all created to keep the nobles in line with the Church's agenda.

The technology level in Crowhill is not the highest in Frostmark as new inventions are met with large quantities of suspicion. The core of the issue is the Church's wish to ensure crow society's safety and purity. The elite, and often secret, units of the Sacred Arms are not given the same scrutiny level. In the quest to root out the Six Horrid Devils' corruption, no expense or method is too outlandish. Education and knowledge are treated the same way. The Church carefully selects what knowledge is available to whom and why. Peasants may be taught skills, work ethics, morals, and the basics of the Rianish faith. Members of the Warmth acquire the education needed for their future line of work, intermediate knowledge about the faith of Riahn (unless they are a priest), and basic academics. It is only the most vital profession, nobles, inquisitors, and priests who receive a full education.

Relations with other Kingdoms

The Church has effectively taken over the government of Crowhill. The Solar priest practically runs the kingdom, while the regent is more of a figurehead. They can't overthrow the monarchy directly due to passages in Radiance of Geanor. This section does not only explain Crowhill's relationship with other nations but also the Church's.

When Applegate stabilized after the Malgravian and Karthmerian war, Crowhill started to send relief their way. This mostly takes the form of building materials, engineers, educators, and medical attention. In return, Crowhill receives generous exports of food and cloth. Today the food exports are crucial for Crowhill and their military machine, and Crowhill certainly

does not overlook the opportunity to rebuild Applegate in their preferred fashion.

The Church holds a lot of influence in Armathain, but it is restricted to areas where Armathain believes the Church holds precedence, like medical or ceremonial matters. In most areas of government, the Church is promptly excluded. The Church of Riahn has tried many times to send missionaries to Beornhelm. Depending upon the ruler, it has been more or less successful. Today, with Kynemund as the chieftain, Sacred Arms is not welcomed at all in Beornhelm and is treated as a hostile force.

The Church is equally not allowed to have any influence in Stormholme. Only a handful of congregations exist, but only underground. Malgrave, Oldwood, and Sirendale tolerate the Church's presence but keep them a distance away from state business. Greenfield has been historically very welcoming of the Church, but since Malgrave has become more interested in their country and Beornhelm occupying almost half of the kingdom, these relations have been mostly put on hold as the Church is currently too occupied to deal with the troubled kingdom.

Eastcreek is occupied by Crowhill and an extension by the Church of Riahn. The official statement describes that Crowhill pushes Eastcreek into the modern age to bring modern healthcare and education to them. The remaining free tribes would describe the situation differently. They claim that Crowhill is slowly but surely eliminating the tribal traditions and forcing upon them the religion of Riahn.

Military

The backbone of Crowhill's watch and the military is supplied, managed, and funded by the nobility. These units include guards, escorts, and ship escorts. The Church is in charge of the main offensive force of Crowhill, the Sacred Arms. Once upon a time, the Sacred Arms were a powerful force that waged war with Geanor and conquered all of Frostmark with him. The ancient fortress and headquarters of Sacred Arms were located in Aynor in Malgrave during the Imperial years, but after the Empire split

apart, the Church fell out of favor in Malgrave. Eventually, the Church relocated with Sacred Arms to Crowhill, and new headquarters were constructed in Goldbank. Ever since the Empire cleansed Frostmark of spellcasters, artifacts, and Enna, Sacred Arms transformed large portions of their army into agents rather than soldiers. Once lethal force was no longer needed, oversight, intelligence, and control became progressively more important. This new branch of the Sacred Arms was nicknamed the Inquisition among the peasantry.

Traditionally, from the age of Geanor, the Sacred Arms consists of four military branches and one civilian one. The three military branches are the heavy infantry, the light cavalry, the heavy cavalry, and the versatile artillery branch. The heavy infantry uses spears, shortswords, and shields. They are capable of several different formations and engage the enemy with alternating frontlines. The light cavalry is equipped with spears meant for both throwing and melee engagement. Their primary purpose was to harass and pressure flanks and weak points if the terrain allowed it. Behind the infantry, the archer units stood with longbows, utilizing impressive cloud shooting techniques, as well as axes if they had to defend themselves in melee. Preferably, the artillery disperses if they are assailed by infantry, using their very light encumbrance to retreat and then resume ranged attacks. The heavy infantry was the legendary Knights of the Sacred Code. As a whole, this unit is small, mostly encompassing nobility and ridden leadership, but well-armored with excellent training.

In the beginning, the Sacred Arms' civilian branch consisted of engineers, smiths, stable hands, chefs, caravaneers, etc. It has grown to include spies, assassins, informants, inquisitors, scouts, scribes, and other agents. All considered top secret by the Church's leadership. They are equipped and trained for their purpose and tactics. These units operate with various amounts of jurisdiction depending upon the kingdom they visit. In some kingdoms, they can execute their justice in broad daylight. In others, they need to ask permission from the local peacekeeping forces and might have to cooperate with them. In some cases, they operate completely outside of the law,

assassinating, stealing, and destroying what they have to.

What was revolutionary for Geanor's army in his time was the advanced formations and tactics of his infantry, their art of alternating their front lines, and their extensive discipline and teamwork training. Most other armies around before the Empire focused their attention on the individual's training instead of the group's teamwork and tactics. Due to this advantage, the army's versatility and overall discipline, Geanor's inspirational figure, as well as his mind for tactics, ensured the Sacred Arms' victories.

The Sacred Arms' military branches have shrunk somewhat as they haven't been in the business of conquering something for a long time. However, they have regained some of their numbers ever since the Church initiated the Eastcreek project. Sacred Arms still trains their soldiers in the same way as they have always done. Their equipment is solid and functional, however, their mindset and strategies haven't changed one iota since Geanor.



Crowhill



Royal House of Undersworth

Ruler: Queen Irena Undersworth (17 years)

Family: Twin sisters (both 14 years)

Coat of Arms: A white shield, in the middle, a golden crown is displayed with a golden corona above it, in the middle of two black crow wings.

Rule: All of Crowhill

Irena's parents died when she was little, one to disease and the other to suicide. She grew up with her younger twin sisters in Crowhill's decadent palace in Crow's Rising, pampered and removed from any of the world's hardships. Irena loves parties and glamour. Balls are a common occurrence in the palace. Despite her significant protection, the kingdom thought they lost her when she was celebrating her 17th birthday. The party was held on a pleasure cruise out at sea, and while all-weather specialists had ensured the palace that the weather would be calm and cloud-free for many days, a terrible storm surprised the entourage. The ship went under, and many of the nobility's children died. The morning after, they miraculously found Irena on the closest beach to the shipwreck as the sole survivor. The Church claims that Riahn protected her against a storm called by the Six Horrid Devils. After her near-death experience, Irena hasn't been the same, she

matured a small amount, and she pays more attention to the affairs of Crowhill. In small ways, she has started to disagree or even disobey the Solar Priest, something the Church is desperately trying to keep secret and in control.

Solar Priest

Ruler: Demetria Atha (54 years)

Family: Deceased male partner (32 years), brother (44 years), sister (34 years), and a son (11 years)

Coat of Arms (Solar Priest): A white shield, in the middle a golden sun with an all surrounding golden corona

Rule: Officially the leader of the Church of Riahn in all of Frostmark

Demetria is beloved amongst the faithful on Frostmark. Many describe her deeds and demeanor as a concerned and protective mother, and she considers all Frostmark, her children. She has managed to keep the respect and support of the majority of the clergy. Demetria has also been able to alleviate some of the corruption issues that distract the Church. When it comes to Eastcreek, she has mostly devoted her time to ensure peace and stability in the region. She also started a huge project to reeducate the populace, focusing on the children first.

EASTCREEK



Location: West coast, south of Oldwood, east of Malgrave, north of Stormholme, northeast of Crowhill.

Authority: Normally clans with a temporary elected unified representative in time of need. Today a noble from Crowhill officially sits as governor over the area.

Geography

The south of Eastcreek is covered by the Iskerian Boondocks, a thick evergreen leaf forest that experiences wet summers and dry winters. From Nastemi Point to the Imara river, there is elevated terrain with moderately high hills. The coastline around Nastemi Cove and Nastemi Point is far drier than the forest, it is also moderately rocky, and the water is generally deep, creating many natural harbors. Teigri and Teiko river composes Eastcreek's southern border to Stormholme. It runs broadly and slowly, experiencing a great deal of river trading between kingdoms.

The heartland of Eastcreek is composed of a great and dry grassland, called the Zakaru Prairie. This grassland is generally flat, experiences little rainfall, and is either covered by bare rock, grass, or bushes. The borderlands to Malgrave become gradually more rainfall rich and allows for farming. This border between the Zakaru Prairie and the Qettam Meadow is not greatly defined, but Malgrave decisively claims they control all the land where agriculture is possible.

The coastline, the Silver Cliffs Ridge, is 20 to well over 150 meters high and consists of white marble. By the sea's erosion, this coastline is constantly eroded, where rocks or large parts of it breaks sporadically. The

depth of the shoreline below depends upon the tides, sometimes there may be dozens of meters you can walk on the wet sand and rock beach, and other times the water rests high against the cliffs. The Imara river is fed by a hill ridge in the Nastemi Point and the rainfall over the Iskera Boondocks. It pierces through the relatively soft bedrock and creates an incredibly steep v valley, and the river continues to bite deeper and deeper. At some points, the height difference can be towards a 100-meter sheer cliff wall.

The north is more varied. The eastern border to Oldwood is defined by a windy, rocky and thin pine forest. In the central north, Frostmark's largest lake can be found, the Sky Mirror. The Sky Mirror is large enough to be its sea, with unique flora and fauna within. There are a few islands within the Sky Mirror, but there is only one at Oldlake town with any significant size. The north of the Sky Mirror, in the northwest, the Bazken Moor can be found.

The Bazken Moor is incredibly wet, fueled by precipitation and the rivers of Thetsini, Thetanor, Thetra, and Thetmar. There are occasionally dry spots within the marsh, covered by bushes and pine. The rivers mentioned above also mark Eastcreek's northern border to Malgrave and Oldwood. These rivers run very broadly and slowly,



they also sometimes change their shape. A moderate amount of river trading still braves the swamp to arrive at the Sky Mirror lake's harbors. The borderlands between the Bazken Moor and the Zakaru Prairie and the border between the Zakaru Prairie and the Iskera Boondocks are the only regions in Eastcreek that allow for profitable agricultural pursuits.

Summary

The grass plains of Eastcreek stretches far and wide. Only the thin remnants of the Oldberry woods and its stony hills in the north give the Clans of the Zakaru Prairie a source of building materials. Eastcreek possesses the rare feature of an incredibly long and high white marble coastline, but the stone is regarded as holy. The Easters do not usually use the marble for their own devices, instead only using it ceremoniously to build temples and sacred halls. While many would like to buy their marble resources, the Easters seldom sell it, and then only at very steep prices. The large arid grass sea has turned Easters into herders and horse masters. Indeed, horses of Eastcreek is the finest breed in all of Frostmark.

In its ancient cradle, Eastcreek had no stable settlements. Instead, tribes moved around with their herds and the seasons. As time went by, the Easters evolved to create a tribal society where tribes moved between semi-permanent settlements. This has shaped the face of their aristocracy as well, where the wise and gifted naturally became the cultural leaders. In the time of necessity, the tribes gather in their main sacred temple on the Blessed Isle, which is considered neutral ground for all Easters. Suppose the Easters call for a unified action between the tribes. In that case, a temporary representative is chosen among the clan leaders for the crisis's duration. As soon as it is diverted, the Clans return to being self-governed. About 40 years ago, Eastcreek was invaded by Crowhill, who seeks to modernize and save the Easters from their savage ways. The war was quick and brutal, and Eastcreek is today ruled by Crowhill, which is changing their society slowly but surely.

Living in Eastcreek

The steppe landscape of Eastcreek hasn't changed this ancient tribal community, and Easters seem to prefer that way. Before the Empire, Eastcreek had no name. Instead, they called themselves the "Clans of the Great Grass Sea." It was Empress Leana that named the region Eastcreek when she finalized the imperial system of governance. It was only an official name that the Easters for many centuries rejected. Today the name is widely used around Frostmark. The tribes of this vast Grass Sea live and die by their herds and the seasons. Usually, the Clans move their cattle, goats, and horses between a summer and a winter camp. Food can also originate from a small amount of summer farming that can be had in the south and fishing in the winter in the Sky Mirror, the largest lake on Frostmark.

Traditional settlements are composed of leather tents, communal fireplaces, and several work areas. Easters cannot waste anything their environment gives them. Even the feces of their animals are used to stock their fires. There is a shortage of wood in Eastcreek, which is another reason for their nomadic lifestyle. Eastcreek's shore is a marvel of the world. A majority of Eastcreek's shoreline is composed of high marble cliffs. The marble could have been a wonderful building material if not, it was considered highly sacred. Only a few temples and sacred halls have been built with this material, and fewer still stand today. The most significant of these buildings is the ancient temple on the Blessed Isle, within the Sky Mirror and close to Oldlake town. The ancient temple has been the sacred meeting place of the tribes of Eastcreek for thousands of years. No tribe may wear weapons or ill intent on the Blessed Isle, especially not in the temple. Here the tribes meet to discuss politics, external worries, and war.

The Easters are known for their respect for nature, their elders' admiration, and their adherence to their tradition. The leader of the clans are not military leaders, but spiritual ones, called Visions. Another unique tradition of the tribes of Eastcreek is the selection of mates for their Union, something the Easters call the Bird Dance. When there is a significant number of

marriageable girls and boys in peacetime, the tribes gather huge communions. The men who wish to marry spend three whole days impressing the women they have eyes for, with gifts, compliments, hunting trophies, entertainment, etc. Any skills the man possesses, he flaunts. At the end of the three days, women state to the Visions who they want to marry, with the only restriction that the blood tie can't be too close.

If two women choose the same man and their both adamant about stepping down, they gain two wives. In times of war, when husbands become short at hand, widows are expected to choose from the remaining men at hand through secondary selections. If a man wasn't chosen, he needs to improve his skills and capabilities for the next Bird Dance to try to impress a new female. A woman who won't choose a man eventually draws shame on herself and is exiled to put herself before the tribe. In the Union, it is the man's primary duty to protect the woman while she is pregnant and taking care of a newborn baby, if he is unable to fulfill this duty, the woman has the right to break their Union. Likewise, if no child is procured after a few years, the woman has failed her duty, and the man can break their Union. This system is in place to ensure the continued survival of the tribes and exchange members of their tribes to keep a healthy population.

Easters have mostly minded their own business through the ages, outside of exiled tribal members poaching Oldwood over the border and occasional trading with Stormholme. Eastcreek's history has been marked by several small wars between the tribes, but as quick they have been to engage in war, they have been to issue peace once more. About 40 years ago, this changed when Crowhill and the Church of Riahn forcibly wanted to give the Easters a better way of life. After the collapse of the Empire, the Church's headquarters migrated to Crowhill. The new location and politics on Frostmark gave the Church other priorities. After the post-imperial wars had died down, the Church of Riahn gazed towards Eastcreek. Eastcreek had been seen as a backwater and inconsequential region during the imperial age. On top of it, Empress Leana, on behalf of the Empire, had entered an extensive contract with the

Easters. In return for allowing the Easters to keep some parts of their way of life, culture, and religion, the Easters would supply the Empire with meat, leather, and trained horses. The contract was automatically abolished as the Empire fell. Thus, nothing kept the Church of Riahn back in "modernizing" and "straightening up" the country, so-called city-states, which may consist of one settlement or several. These city-states elect their leaders and are somewhat independent of each other. They share strong trade agreements, and city-states may ask another for aid, but it is up to the individual city-state to answer affirmatively or negatively. The free city-states were not amused when divided into two dukedoms, but those who ended up on the Eastcreek side have found some catharsis. Most would say that they prefer living in the Clans' shadow rather than have to lose their whole identity to the Stormish. Still, Iskerians always thought the Clans to be isolated from the world, and they looked to their prosperous neighbor Stormholme and were jealous of their advances.

After the Empire fell, the free city-states took advantage, and slowly they have started to catch up with Stormholme or Malgrave in development. They do not feel any bitterness towards the Clans of the Zakaru per se, but they do not experience any kinship either. Sometimes the Iskerians and the Clans have done trade or exchanged information. Still, as long as the Clans respect the Iskerian's territory and do not meddle in their business, Iskerians give the Clans the same courtesy. That is also the free city-states of Iskera's disposition against any other kingdom that makes contact with them or sends their trade ships to other shores.

When it comes to Crowhill and the invasion, the relationship between Crowhill and Iskera is at the beginning of a business deal. If they allowed Crow troops to be transported between their shores to the Zakura Prairie, Iskera would not be attacked by Crowhill. After some years of secret negotiations, the free city-states all agreed to the pact. In recent years, Crowhill has started to meddle in the affairs of Iskerians more and more, increasing their political pressure on the free city-states to comply with Crowhill's will. This can mostly be noticed by exploiting

Iskera's resources and Crowhill strongly recommending the Rianish faith. Iskera was, of course, faithful to the Church of Riahn during the imperial years, but after the fall, this piousness has somewhat diminished in popularity. Some do not mind the stronger Church's presence, as they were already aligned with the faith. Other Iskerians are growing more and more restless, seeing Crowhill's presence as a silent occupation, and jealousy guards their freedom of choice. Some rumors have even started to circulate that some Iskerian's aiding Iron Raven in secret.

Relations with the Church

The relationship Crowhill and the Church of Riahn have with Easters vary. The faith of Riahn was introduced during the Empire, but Easters were given the freedom to worship their way. Some Easters openly reject the faith of Riahn, some secretly so, others begrudgingly accept under threat, some have willingly submitted, and some of the new generations of Easters has grown up with the faith of Riahn as their single religion.

Relations with other Kingdoms

Crowhill occupies Eastcreek. Some Easters believe this to be ultimately good as Crowhill offers better education and living standards, others see it as oppression. Historically, Easters have been wary of both Stormholme and Oldwood, fending off and removing such presence from their lands. Some Easters hold feelings of gratitude towards Malgrave, as the Empire's leadership allowed Eastcreek some leniency with their traditions. Furthermore, trade flourished between them because of their contract.

Military

The traditional army of the tribes of Eastcreek has mounted combatants, composed of light cavalry with expert riders, equipped with different simple throwing weapons, short-bows, spears, shields, and clubs. A normal tactic for these riders is several passes with ranged weapons, and when their ammunition runs out, or the enemy is weakened, they jump upon their enemy from horseback and assault them

with clubs or spears. How Easters deal with enemy cavalry that possesses better armor often attempts to lure such cavalry into traps, using the natural landscape to their advantage or simply tiring them out by relying on their superior speed.

Easters also have another combat tradition, hand to hand. This fighting style, called the Flowing River, attempts to awaken Soul Mastery from within to achieve supernatural effects. This tradition is usually not utilized in open warfare, as it is seen as more of a ceremonial fighting style. When two individuals enter into an argument that can't be easily solved, one solution is a duel in the Flowing River.

Eastcreek has 6 major Clans, whereas three are larger than the other. The Clans who have all but assimilated to Crowhill's society and disappeared were called Stone Claw, First Sun, and Silent Spear. The three Clans who still have enough members to continue resisting Crowhill are Red Stag, Iron Raven, and Swift Fox. The Crowhill occupation has brought Sacred Arms forces and agents of different kinds to the country.



House Vitelli, Governor of Eastcreek

Rule: Marquess Andronikos (22 years)

Family: Two brothers (19 years and 13 years)

Coat of Arms: A white shield with a golden star displayed in the middle of six black crow wings (three on each side).

Rule: Technically, all of Eastcreek

Marquess Andronikos Vitelli has been a genius since birth. He matured at an alarming rate, and he is known for his aptitude for manipulation, something he has flaunted from a very young age. He was able to amass quite the influence in his late teens and arrived in Eastcreek as a general. From there, when the position became vacant, he advanced to the governor of the whole region. There is no secret that Vitelli is extremely pious, and he is hellbent on flushing out heresy among the Easters. His two younger brothers never stood a chance in the wake of their brother's cleverness and mind games, today serving as his loyal lackeys.

Clan Red Stag

Ruler: Vision Tide (male, 24 years)

Family: Two sisters (21 years and 16 years)

Coat of Arms: A shield divided into two horizontal fields, the lower green, the higher of blue with a red stag passant displayed.

Rule: Unofficial control of Fleetbury Town

Clan Red Stag has endured a lot since Crowhill's occupation. Before, Red Stag was the largest clan by population, but it has dwindled greatly to the occupation. But Red Stag was also the most traditionalistic clan of them all, which has been the primary reason for their continued existence out on the Grass Sea. Interestingly, they refuse to fight fire with fire and insist on calmly waiting for the storm out. The Vision of Red Stag is said to be exceptionally wise and caring but is likewise accused of being a coward for not standing up against the invaders, for which Clan Red Stag refused to fight. This is seen as a great betrayal by both the Clans of Iron Raven and Swift Fox.

Clan Iron Raven

Ruler: Vision Mesa (Female, 38 years)

Family: Partner (38 years), sister (27 years), and a daughter (20 years)

Coat of Arms: A shield divided into two horizontal fields, the lower green, the higher of blue with a black raven rising displayed.

Rule: Holds unofficial control of Cliffby Town

Originally, Iron Raven was a smaller but wealthier clan. They are experts in tool and weaponsmithing, working with limited traditional techniques and minimal iron access through red sand. Today, they have stolen resources and learned from their enemy and have become through it the main resistance force against Crowhill. Despite the gap in development between the countries, Iron Raven has been doing fairly well with mysterious luck on their side. Vision Mesa is loyal to a fault to her tribe, stubborn, and not afraid of sacrifices.

Clan Swift Fox

Ruler: Vision Zinnia (Male, 28 years)

Family: None

Coat of Arms: A shield divided into two horizontal fields, the lower green, the higher of blue with a red fox rampant displayed.

Rule: Holds unofficial control of Swiftlight Town

The Swift Fox clan has always been superb hunters of the game that roams the Grass Sea of Eastcreek. Mildly said, they took a strong dislike to everything foreign when the occupation started, turning their backs on everything that wasn't familiar. Now they roam Eastcreek as a stealthy shock guerilla, who seeks to destroy everything that would harm or infect Eastcreek. Iron Raven welcomes other parties' support and resources, Swift Fox does not. They don't shy away from either from removing Easters who have betrayed the tribes. Vision Zinnia is a personification of Swift Fox's recent actions, judgmental, rash, and unwillingness to admit defeat.

GREENFIELD



Location: South of Beornhelm, east of Sirendale, west of Oldwood, north of Malgrave

Authority: A weak crown, Beornhelm raid Chieftain, lawless areas, and Malgrave supervision

Geography

The north of Greenfield consists of a hilly and moderately rocky boreal forest with both evergreens and deciduous leaf trees. The Selkir and Iodin rivers act like Greenfield's western respectively eastern, both of them run moderately fast and fiercely. Around Newthorpe Town, spruce trees are uncommon. Instead, the forest around the town consists mostly of asps, oaks, and maple trees. The central and western regions of the kingdom are dominated by a large fertile basin, the Green Elder Valley. The climate is mildly temperate here, and the earth has proven ideal for agriculture. The population density within the Green Elder Valley is greater than the other biomes of Greenfield.

The boreal forest of the Oldberry woods in the north sits on generally higher terrain than the Green Elder Valley. The Thetis river slices through the Oldberry Woods and creates a broad valley for which Greenfield's capital rests within. Greenfield possesses several smaller lakes and one major lake, called Thetil. The major river of Thetanor runs broadly and moderately slow, ideal for river trading from Sirendale to Eastcreek and Malgrave. In the southwest, the border of the Oldberry Woods swells over from Oldwood into Greenfield. This part of the Oldberry Wood is less rocky, with more deciduous trees and a milder climate. Greenfield also shares the most northern tip of the Bazkeen Moor's swamplands in the

central south and the Bicides Veldt's plains in the central south to the southwest.

Summary

Greenfield has had the poor fortune of being the battleground between many kingdoms and been the target of many Beornish raids due to their rich natural production and their central position in Frostmark. Greenfield has been torn asunder by war and strife time and time again, their infrastructure falling apart, and crime runs rampant where the monarchy's guards don't dare to tread. The areas around the cities in the south and the capital are the most stable, but as soon as you venture outside of this protected fold, prepare to defend what you own and your own life. The monarchy is desperately trying to keep the kingdom held together, accosted by Beornhelm from the north, exploited by Malgrave from the south, and plagued by bandits in the middle.

Living in Greenfield

Greenfield is a torn kingdom by war and political exploitation. During the imperial age, Greenfield was able to lift itself as a peaceful and unified country by the grace of the Empire's protection. Greenfield became the Empire's most zealous and loyal ally. They realized that as long as they were preserved under the Empire's peace and laws, they could continue to flourish.

Greenfield



Greenfield did indeed prosper a great deal during the imperial age. They could root out corruption, take firm control of their natural resources, build a military, and ensure their roads' safety.

Greenfield desperately tried keeping the Empire alive, not wanting to return to their precarious position on the geopolitical landscape, but the Empire was doomed to fall in the end. Greenfield tried to adapt to the post-imperial age and rally its citizens and soldiers against those who want to claim their prosperity. But they are gradually being beaten down. Much of the progress that Greenfield has enjoyed under the imperial rule is slowly crumbling away. The north and the east have more or less been occupied by a Beornish Chieftain, and in the south, Malgrave is negotiating mercilessly for influence and their natural resources.

Only in the southwest, crime is more controlled, and Greenfield can be somewhat Greenfield. Merchants, artisans, and even most of the priesthood have fled the lawless areas, and some have even fled the kingdom completely. Now the populace is divided into two parts. Those who have given up and turned to lawlessness or defected to the Beornish presence in the north, and those who keep on fighting for the dream of a peaceful and united Greenfield. Greenfield's bastions are still holding somewhat strong in the west and south, but many look to the future with depressing thoughts. It will take a miracle to turn the tide in Greenfield's favor.

Relations with the Church

Greenfield has been stalwart faithful and good friends with the Church of Riahn, but the country's chaos and insecurity have made the Church less inclined to give them attention. Currently, the Church is occupied with their Eastcreek project and keeping Karthmere a monarchy.

The distance between the Church's headquarters and Greenfield certainly does not aid Greenfield's cause either. Yet, the Church does send charity their way. However, relief supplies sometimes arrive at the intended target and sometimes in somebody else's pocket. Parts of the priesthood remain to support Greenfield,

but only the bravest and selfless priests dare venture close to troubled areas or within Chieftain Idris' territory.

Relations with other Kingdoms

In the past, Greenfield has had a strong relationship with Malgrave as the seat of the imperial throne, but recent events have deteriorated Greenfield's opinion of Malgrave. This is mainly because of its cutthroat exploitation of Greenfield and the fact that Malgrave hasn't protected Greenfield, something that Greenfield stalwartly did during the Empire's collapse.

The kingdom has friendly and strong ties to Oldwood and Sirendale after their alliance, the Northern Front. Some nobles of Greenfield migrated to Oldwood to help their infrastructure float after Oldwood mistakenly "cleansed" themselves of regional rulers put into power by the Empire. Oldwood was bitter that the Empire disrespected their autonomy. Still, after centuries of the imperial governing style, some areas realized that they needed the nobility to continue working their infrastructure after the cleansing.

Greenfieldish nobles were more welcomed in Oldwood than the imperial ones. Many of these nobles that offered aid traveled back and forth from their duties in Oldwood and their families in Greenfield. After the Beornish presence, most Greenfield nobles cannot revisit their families or return to Oldwood, as the border is too perilous to cross. Most of the Greenfieldish people are openly hostile towards Beornhelm. Others have turned to their side for a better life. There is also a great deal of suspicion towards Armathain due to past armed invasions directed towards Malgrave in the last years of the imperial age. Armathain's rebellion against the Empire was, after all, instrumental in the fall of the Empire.

Military

Greenfield's army was influenced heavily by the Sacred Arms as Greenfield created their standing army during the imperial age. Greenfield also had their subdivision of the Sacred Arms. The Sacred Arms units that did not follow the Church to Crowhill after the collapse of the Empire and the rest of

Greenfield's standing army have suffered from Greenfield's wars, the occupation, and the dwindling coin purses. Today, Greenfield's army has significantly shrunk. They are not as well equipped, new soldiers aren't trained as well, and they are generally stretched thin.

Greenfield



Royal House Fairfax

Ruler: King Melchior (19 years)

Family: Queen (17 years) and a brother (4 years)

Coat of Arms: A green shield, a golden pale with three silver crossed swords.

Rule: Technically all of Greenfield, but realistically only the southern and western parts of the kingdom

Two years ago, Idris became frustrated over the stalemate in her offensive. Greenfield had bowed over and given her the northern territories, but they were far more resilient when defending their farmlands in central Greenfield. Idris started to communicate secretly with nobles she had identified as less loyal to the Queen. She offered them positions in the new Greenfield she would create after conquering it, if the nobles used their security forces to kidnap the Queen and her only child. Most of them accepted, and the operation was on its way. To Idris, the Queen was delivered, but her son had managed to slip out of the grip of the traitorous nobles. Idris thought that perhaps it was enough to squash the Greenfieldish people's will, so she publicly executed the Queen with quite the show.

The son, Melchior, was crowned king and tried to take the reins of the country. He started with publicly executing the traitorous nobles in turn and gave loyalists the territories they ruled. Greenfield was apprehensive at first towards the young king. Worry spread that he wasn't experienced enough to lead them. Idris did win many clashes between her raiders and Greenfield's soldiers, but Melchior matured and adapted quickly to his new position. After a while, Greenfield could breathe a bit more easily once more as loyalists could wholeheartedly trust their new regent. A queen was selected for him to quickly ensure the safety of his royal bloodline, but the match was less than a happy one, and the queen and king spend most of their time in separate parts of the Fairfax castle despite

the desperate cries of the Greenfield people. King Melchior of Fairfax is still stubbornly trying to do the impossible of ruling this crumbling kingdom, even though he is struggling against his inexperience and shy nature.

Beornish Chieftain

Ruler: Idris (27 years)

Family: A male lover of (19 years) and a brother (23 years)

Coat of Arms: A black shield with a forest green diagonal cross above it, displayed in the middle a silver lynx passant.

Rule: Taken over the northern and eastern areas of Greenfield. In control of Stagwell City, Lastborn Town, Newthorpe Town, Esterby Town, and the Kei Hills City.

Idris is an ambitious Beornish chieftain who lusts for power and lands. She is known for her cunning, passion, and mind for warfare. As Beornhelm's recent raids against Sirendale and Oldwood have been met with more resistance, Duke Grimcolt organizing an impressive defense in Oldwood and Armathain stopping their advances in Sirendale, she is instead trying to cement Beornish influence at their southern border to Greenfield.

Her brutal tactics, clever schemes, and promises of power together with safety to those who defect have given her almost half of Greenfield. Yet, the capital halts her advance, which has started to make her increasingly frustrated. To pierce through the stalemate, she is launching more and more bold strategies against Greenfield, constantly requesting more warriors from Warchieftain Kynemund, who is becoming progressively displeased with her recent actions. He does not wish to aggravate Malgrave enough to the point they will march into the kingdom as that would immensely decrease their chances for conquest.

KARTHMERE



Location: South of Applegate, south-west of Malgrave, and west of Stormholme

Authority: Royal household and elected governors

Geography

Karthmere is distinguished by the great Geris Pasture, a large stretch of fertile flatlands. This fertile soil is split by numerous slow and broad, flowing rivers. The largest among them is the Teima river. After the snow and ice melt in Armathain during the spring, the rivers in Karthmere swell before the summer, creating tremendously fertile fields around the rivers after the spring flood has ended. After the Teima river eventually closes in on the southern coastline, it forks into hundreds of smaller rivers of different sizes, creating a vast and marshy delta. The northern and eastern outline of Karthmere is covered by the Gallant Grove, a deciduous to evergreen leaf forest with gently rolling hills. The forest is moderately thick by the border to both Applegate and Malgrave but is otherwise thinly grown.

Karthmere is generally flat. The border to both Applegate and Malgrave is slightly more elevated than the Geris Pasture's fertile basin. In between the river Teima and Teiran, a stony ridge of hills run and swells towards the coast. On the southwestern tip of Karthmere, Heden's Height, the landscape elevates to a cliffy coastline and craggy hills between the Viola city and Southwich town. The coastline of Karthmere is mostly shallow with sandy to stony beaches. The long Nalon's Beach is a vast bay full of soft white

beaches. There are natural harbors close to the border to Applegate, around Heden's Height, and the southeastern coast.

Summary

Until a recently lost war to Malgrave, Karthmere has been the largest kingdom on Frostmark, but Karthmere still holds the largest population record. The geography is mostly composed of fertile fields, gently flowing rivers and a lofty leaf forest that becomes slightly smaller for each year that passes. Karthmere has always tried to build a fleet to rival Stormholme's, and even though Karthmere's fleet is larger today, they have never been able to rival the seamanship of their neighboring kingdom.

Karthmere has many towns, many nobles, many newly rich city dwellers, and a huge population. As guilds became more prevalent in Stormholme, they made their existence known in Karthmere, too, by challenging the nobles' power. Karthmere was divided into election districts when it became clear that some nobles were unable to govern their areas in a fashion that the crown wanted. A simple popular vote was cast by a group of representatives from the district to establish a competent region leader. This quickly became corrupted, and the wealthiest soul around could simply buy his or her victory, noble or otherwise. The royal family was saved from this treatment, as the masses of Karthmere find a break from their simple lives by gossiping and swooning over their



fair and strong royal household. The Church of Riahn also has extensive influence in Karthmere.

Living in Karthmere

Karthmere is fertile and mild, which has been ideal for any civilization settling down within its borders. Despite Malgrave recently won a territorial battle with Armathain and absorbed some land from Karthmere, the nation still possesses the largest population on Frostmark, close second by Malgrave. Karthmere is the continent's breadbasket, with farmlands as far as the eye can see over gently rolling hills and vast expanses of flat and fertile land. The central and northern areas were once home to a large and deep leaf forest, but they need to rival Stormholme on the seas has greatly diminished these woods. Now hunting is a rare food source and strictly controlled by the elite in their protected reserves.

The great river of Teima flows from the Armathainian mountains' foot through Karthmere and brings with it life and easily accessible irrigation. Farming is excellent around the rivers as they swell and shrink with the seasons, leaving nutrients and silt on the farmlands around them. In the south, the Teima river transforms into a giant delta that seems to change its form from year to year. Due to the impossibility of farming around the delta, the area is sparsely populated.

Karthmere has always been culturally influenced, for better or worse, by Stormholme. As Stormholme naturally progressed to a more guild controlled social structure due to their monetary influence, Karthmere inevitably followed suit. The guilds didn't take over completely in Karthmere as they did in Stormholme, as the presence of the Church of Riahn ran deep within the soul of the kingdom, and many nobles early on raised their voices in protest. There was little support coming from the royal family of that time, Arundell, who was seen as aloof and uncaring by the Karthmerian people.

In the decade of 680 AEF, the country was spiraling down a dangerous road. The reality was that the kingdom was growing rapidly,

and there were simply not enough adequately rich nobles who could manage such areas. In other parts of the country, the already established nobles were unprepared and without the resources to maintain their growing populations. Where the nobles failed, the guilds smelled opportunity. They pressured Arundell, claiming that they had the resources and applicable experiences to govern these failing areas. At this point, the Karthmerian people wanted safety and prosperity. First of all, They thought Arundell was failing as the regent if he could not even ensure half-competent leadership in all regions of Karthmere. Arundell did not wish to lose their power as the Stormholmish royal family had, and desperation was running high within the palace's corridors.

In 683 AEF, Karthmere started a surprise war against Malgrave. The reasons for this were multiple, but the most comprehensive reason was it was a distraction. Arundell thought that the war would rally the Karthmerian people under their banner, and a victory would increase their popularity and support. More sinister rumors abound as well, one claiming that the Arundell household was purposely controlling the size of the population by having Karthmerian's die in the war. The official reason given to Malgrave was that they wished to conquer more woodlands for their shipbuilding.

Malgrave did not yield as Arundell had hoped. After some initial success for Karthmere, Malgrave caught up with them after they recovered from the surprise attack. The war grew longer than Karthmere had anticipated. The new merchant class became instrumental for Karthmere's economy during it, which was the opposite of what the ruling class of Karthmere wanted. In the end, it was Arundell who had to yield to the guild, but it was done through a compromise. The "Representative Act" was signed and implemented by Arundell in 687 AEF, which allowed non-nobles to govern areas of Karthmere.

The Representative Act allowed regions to vote into power their rulers, noble or not. This gave the royal household some breathing room, as the Representative Act did resolve the immediate crisis. The system

was far from perfect, however. The voting system soon became corrupt, and the lower classes in Karthmere started to suffer from the Act's exploitation. On the other side of the coin, noble families grew hostile towards the crown as they lost their absolute position of power, where some families even fell into the disgrace of poverty. The guilds only wanted more after the small taste of power, consistently pointing to their colleagues' guilds in Stormholme and demanding to acquire what they possess. Amid this political turmoil, the war raged on against Malgrave.

In the end, in 690, the bomb went off, and the royal castle was stormed by an angry mob. The royal family of Arundell was overthrown. In the chaos that ensued, Karthmere started to lose the war against Malgrave, and general lawlessness was breaking out. The former castellan of Arundell, the minor noble house of Somerset, was one of the contenders that stepped forward and raised their voice for control of the country. Somerset had gathered a lot of support from the capital citizens, no matter their social class, from their generosity and warmth. In the end, Somerset won this struggle by the grace of their reputation, experience of the kingdom's governance, and the fact that they were only a minor noble house. This appeased both parties, the new merchant class and the conservative nobles. However, they stepped into a precarious situation. The war against Malgrave had turned into a complete disaster. The guilds were running rampant, corrupt officials governing significant areas of Karthmere and many bitter noble houses.

Somerset performed several drastic and quick changes. They negotiated for peace with Malgrave without losing more ground than what would have been catastrophic. They removed some outrageous corrupt officials by swapping them out for some disgruntled noble peers. They gave them leaner tax burdens and generous territories to improve their economic situation. Here the Church of Riahn was willing to step in and offer aid, as the Church staunchly believed that only a noble has a divine right to rule. Laws were implemented that slightly favored nobility in trade and regulated the power and influence of the guilds. In the

end, Karthmere ended up with placation from all sides, a stronger noble presence but also influential guilds and merchants, balancing with each other. Though, even to this day, some areas are rightfully governed by a non-noble. A House of Representatives was established. It consisted of both nobles and influential merchants tasked with advising the king or queen in royal matters to further appease Karthmere's power institutions. The regent possesses certain veto rights in certain areas within the House of Representatives.

Somerset was also clever to generate love and support from their citizens, making sure to earn their favor wherever they go. They adopted a very low-class friendly rhetoric and spearheaded many projects like schools, hospitals, and elderly care. They try to act with grace and care and adopt the latest fashion to look their best. All in all, they succeeded in making the general population of Karthmere swoon and gossip about the royal family. This project should not be taken lightly, as it is a constant effort for the Somerset family to keep high approval ratings.

The kingdom has a large population and moderately well-armed units. However, their land is hard to defend, both due to the soft, open terrain and gentle rivers. The growth rate of urban settlements is also running away from the speed of building defensive structures, such as walls and towers. Karthmere's army was fashioned similar to the Sacred Arms, but they usually sport more heavy cavalry. Knighthood is indeed popular in Karthmere. Their warships are usually equipped with light catapults and light infantry with bows.



Royal House of Somerset

Ruler: King Fleurence (36 years)

Family: Queen (41 years), two sisters (24 and 19 years old), a son (14 years), and two daughters (6 and 2 years old)

Coat of Arms: A purple shield with four conjoined golden griffin heads

Rule: Controls formally all of Karthmere but has administrative control of Somerset Capital and Willowwood Town

King Somerset is highly regarded by the masses to be fair and wise. The royal family is a picturesque and idyllic picture, believed to be loving, compassionate, and loyal to each other. Many of the royal family are in charity work of a different kind and keen on showing themselves to their people. There are also other rumors that the king can be somewhat apathetic and slow, and sometimes he spends several days outside of public attention.

House Wynclair

Ruler: Marchioness Rhoesia (27 years)

Family: Marquess (26 years)

Coat of Arms: A purple shield with four silver eagles chasing

Rule: Wynclair Town, Whithill City, Northpond Town, and Westmeadow City

The Marchioness and the Mistress Nicholberry are the two main spokespersons of the two major political camps of Karthmere, the nobles and the guilds. They are sometimes referred to as "the two wildcats of the podium." And true to those words, Marchioness Wynclair is passionate about her position, that nobles are

necessary to impose principles, moderation, and morality for the people of Karthmere. A pure guild controlled government will only descend into the destruction of tradition and standards, falling to the same fate Stormholme has, which no one wants - or so she claims. Wynclair also wants to prove that nobles can be as competent merchants as the merchant class can be and successfully expand her trade empire. Many, quite violent, criminal acts against the guilds have been tied to her, but no substantial evidence has come to light.

House Nicholberry

Ruler: Governess Giliana (37 years)

Family: Deceased husband (26) and a deceased brother (46)

Business Logo: A black background with Nicholberry written in white and a purple berry at the end of the name

Rule: Millacre Town, Grassborough Town, and Castlebay City

Nicholberry, on the other hand, would argue against Wynclair that they are devolving. If Karthmere would only educate and enrich the population and be the leaders of technology, they could properly surpass Malgrave and Stormholme. The path is forward, not backward - or so she claims. Nicholberry has an iron will to tread on forward. She bounced back from the tragic deaths of her husband and her brother and elevated herself from poverty to a governess. A brilliant merchant and administrator, she has come far in her life. She answers back when Wynclair goes on the offensive against her ideals, answering fire by fire.

MALGRAVE



Location: East of Armathain and Applegate, south of Greenfield, southeast of Oldwood, west of Eastcreek, north of Stormholme, and northeast of Karthmere

Authority: Meritocracy

Geography

The Bazken Moor reins over Malgrave's northeastern geography. A far-reaching swampland with intermittent clusters of pine trees. Just west of the Bazken Moor and Thetenna river is the western border of the Bicides Veldt, a rather infertile and stony grassland. In the middle of the Bicides Veldt, the terrain elevates to several rocky hills, and in the middle of it, one giant mountain, the Zerra Peak. The Zerra Peak rivals that of the Orean's Hand tallest peaks. Zerra Peak possesses a tip that is always covered by snow and ice, and at the base, the Isfort city has half burrowed itself into its stone exterior. At the northeastern border to Armathain, the forest Nemarra Thicket spills its tip into Malgrave. The Nemarra Thicket is a moderately rocky and dense evergreen forest.

In the middle of Malgrave, the Bazken Moor border to the northern tip of the Qettam Meadow, a gigantic belt of fertile soil and a flat landscape with gently rolling hills. In the middle of this northern part of the Qettam Meadow remains what is left of the Esking Holt forest, an evergreen to deciduous forest of pines, firs, and birches, after centuries of rigorous deforestation of materials and to expand the Qettam Meadow. What is left of the Esking Holt is a thin cover of trees around a hilly area for which Esking town sits in the middle.

Qettam Meadow meets another elevated terrain feature at the Teigri river is the Aymnos Ridge. The Aymnos Ridge is a quite steep and jagged ridge of hills which the Teigri river has split into two after thousands of years. At some points along the Teigri river, there may be several meters of sheer cliff wall between the river and Aymnos Ridge.

In the south, the Qettam Meadow and the Gallant Grove dominates. The Gallant Grove in Malgrave is deciduous to evergreen, only slightly rocky, and moderately thick because the Malgravians have not exploited the forest as much as the Karthmerians have. Malgrave's eastern border to Eastcreek and Stormholme is dry and relatively warm, as the Qettam Meadow transforms into the Zakaru Prairie, respectively the Labphrian Steppes. Around the Teisir river at the border to Stormholme, the terrain elevates to very craggy hills. Teigri and Teisir river runs broad and slow as it intersects with the Qettam Meadow, but it can flow furiously within the Aymnos Ridge. This has proven a challenge when transporting goods up to Malgrave's capital, Blackburn, and Armathain beyond the Crow canal. In many cases, goods are offloaded by Aynor city and taken by road to Blackburn, where goods may be loaded onto Teigri river again. Thetenna, Thetanor, Thetsini, Teiga, Teimor, Teima, and Teiran travel relatively slowly and broadly, and almost all of them are important trading rivers.



Summary

Malgrave was the high-seat of the Empire and is the most central kingdom on the continent. There is a saying in Frostmark that all roads lead to Malgrave, and this is partially true. During the imperial age, Malgrave flourished in trade, innovation, and opportunities, creating an impressive infrastructure and wealth. Malgrave has also evolved and changed greatly since the collapse of the Empire. Bitterness was the most common emotion among the Malgravian elite as the Empire was absolved, which fueled hundred-years of Malgrave turning its attention inward. From a pervasive presence in all corners of Frostmark, concerned with their neighbors' politics and troubles, Malgrave mostly retreated into its borders and let the other kingdoms sort themselves out on their own.

Malgrave prides itself on its education. Every soul in the kingdom is granted a basic education as a child. There is great pressure on these students to impress. If they show talent before their graduation day, they may be scouted to different organizations that further their education and ensure a more or less comfortable lifestyle. This ensures that they can properly take care of their parents when they take their pension. If you are not scouted, you are doomed to a life of menial labor, which effectively ends any dreams for an interesting career and good pay.

Malgrave produces competent academics and artisans and is the most technologically advanced kingdom on Frostmark. But after years of improvements and additions, the system is becoming more complex, and every process has bogged down into a swamp of bureaucracy. Malgrave is now trying to cope with the situation where every official action takes an excessive amount of process time. Moreover, Malgrave is currently occupied with trying to assimilate newly won areas of Karthmere, which has made them the largest nation on Frostmark and manipulates Greenfield's small government for their gain.

Living in Malgrave

Malgrave is an area in which many cultures have made their home and later became the Empire's seat. This has undoubtedly made its mark on Malgravian society. After the conquest of Geanor, when Empress Leana took over, she sought to unify all people under a fair and stable rule, a meritocracy. The Church didn't agree with this action, nor did many nobles around the imperial duchies, but Empress Leana's power was absolute. Her predecessors followed the law as it was written because they were impossible to change in the Empire's constitution. In the end, the fact that political power was not inherited in the Empire was the spark that lit the fires of rebellion. Ironically, meritocracy flourished in Malgrave only sometime after the Empire had fallen.

In Malgrave, a child's talents are thoroughly explored, so they practice the trade that suits their aptitudes the most when they are grown. Children are required to attend school from an early age, constantly tested and pressured to perform. Those who fall short are quickly removed after being taught the basics to not waste valuable resources. Those children come home to ashamed parents. Children who do not make it until the graduation day for the final assessment are referred to pick some kind of physical work within the Vocation of Provider, which could be anything from the basic farmer, servant, miner, spinner, tanner, etc.

Those who make it until the assessment day are assigned to a Vocation for further schooling, and eventually, they are expected to become full-fledged practitioners of that Vocation. Some Vocations carry higher prestige than others, like the Explorer Vocation, which includes scribes, academics, scientists, and the Guide Vocation, which encompasses leaders within the civilian and military sectors. Families with the right means invest a great deal of money and time into their children, hoping that they will be chosen for a prestigious Vocation and rise to high positions therein one day. This results in a high-pressure environment for children, something that the current school of thought only sees as character development but has to lead to a rise in mental issues and even, in some cases, suicide.

Malgrave is governed by a "Prime Servant." This individual is selected from the Guide Vocation by the Council. The Council is a formidable group of 49, including the most successful and brilliant leaders from different Vocations. Prime Advisors are also selected from the ranks of the Council, and they become group leaders of factions within the Council. The prime advisors' responsibility is to work side-by-side with the Prime Servant, to advise them and alleviate their duty. The Council elects the Prime Servant between those who have the right background and experience and have declared their willingness to sacrifice themselves as the whole nation's servant. The election occurs either when the Council believes the current Prime Servant has failed their duties or when the current Prime Servant asks to be released from their burden.

The Prime Servant shall represent the country, seek public support, and spearhead politics, but it is the Council that passes laws and makes final decisions in many matters. Though the Prime Servants possess a few and powerful privileges, such as the power to act without the Council's support in a crisis. After many laws and internal praxis have been crafted by this ambitious and orderly society. After they have been changed and changed again by improvements, additions, errata, clarifications, rollbacks, etc., it has caused the whole system to become complex and slow. To perform any significant task or action takes an excessive amount of time and knowledge of the system.

Malgrave still struggles today to properly assimilate the Karthmerian area they claimed by the end of the war with Karthmere (683 to 695 AEF). Even though it has been a while, it is a massive bureaucratic machine trying to properly upgrade the infrastructure and integrate its people into the Malgravian system. Even if Arundell's former royal household initiated the war, Malgrave grew to benefit from the new territory. They required new farmland to feed their growing population. The new territory also has given Malgrave a great influx of cheap laborers.

Relation to the Church

Aynor and its massive fortress were once the headquarters of the Church of Riahn and the Sacred Arms. Malgrave's view of the Church of Riahn has changed rapidly since the imperial days. The Malgravian population's consensus is that the Church has no place in politics or governing, and fewer and fewer people visit the temples as many priorities work over spiritual matters. The faith of Riahn is still the state religion, and all religious ceremonies are expected to be held with a proper priest, but to pay much more attention to the Church than that is uncommon for the middle and high class of Malgrave. The faith is stronger amongst the Provider Vocation members and those who hold the lowest positions in the other Vocations.

The Church of Riahn views the situation in Malgrave with increasing worry. However, their hands are tied to take any drastic measures as they can't afford to lose the little goodwill they have from Malgrave's government. The recent rumors that there are factions within the Council that seek to start an independent state church of Malgrave might upset the Church enough for them to change their approach.

Relation to other Nations

Greenfield has become a bit of a refuge for the ambitious Malgravians, as the country falls outside many of the laws and regulations. Here business deals and meetings of questionable nature can be held in peace. Ceremonies like the Union can be done quickly and privately, and the rule of ethics for experimentation is much lighter, for example, allowing human tests subjects. The relationship with Oldwood is many-faceted, as Malgrave still offers help if allowed (often to get their hands on wood and other resources from Oldwood), but the population of Oldwood is less than thrilled about Malgrave after the imperial occupation.

Malgrave is wary of Karthmere and the risk of revenge, but there is little ill-will towards the kingdom as they rather make trade than war with Karthmere.

Malgrave finds Stormholme to be hazardous and dangerous with their unregulated state and oligarchy. Malgrave possesses strong guilds that often attempt to pressure the Malgravian government to alleviate laws. The Council simply points to the mistakes that Stormholme has made and argues that laws are necessary. In either case, Malgrave possesses strong trade and political ties to the kingdom.

Military

As Malgrave is situated smack down in the middle of Frostmark, an impressive military machine is required to protect its borders. Luckily for Malgrave, they've excelled at this. From their tradition of valuing truth and invention most of all, it has caused the Malgravian army to be the most advanced on Frostmark. Their impressive infrastructure that was introduced when Malgrave became the high seat of the Empire further aided to uphold the apparatus, allowing for quick movement of troops, supplies, and information.

Ever since the war with Karthmere, Malgrave's borders have been left undisturbed, and in later years, a form of stagnation has set in within the military of Malgrave. Peace and slow management have turned the Malgravian army a bit lax. However, Malgrave still possesses impressive defensive structures and a highly-trained army. Equipment-wise, Malgrave guards its steel well as they do not possess a good source of it. Buying it from Stormholme is often expensive, and the bog iron they receive from the Bazken Moor is often not enough to supply the whole kingdom. This has influenced Malgrave to not rely on the metal completely when developing their tactics and training their soldiers.

Light Cavalry

These are primarily scouting units, quickly sent where they need to be to send information back to the main army, skirmish and slow down any incursions. The cavalry is lightly equipped for superior speed. These mounted bowmen utilize the tactic of circling their enemy and firing missiles from a distance without getting close enough for retaliation.

Medium Cavalry

The heavier cavalry is further used to taunt and exhaust the enemy. They ride close and throw heavy javelins that pierce deep within flesh or shield. This can render a shield heavy and can force the unit to drop it out of exhaustion. Once close enough for melee attacks, they switch over to heavy lances, which they run through the enemy lines with, hoping to taunt units to rush after them, rendering them further exhausted.

Medium Infantry

The infantry is well armored with special halberds, crossbows, short swords, and special shields. The infantry marches into position relatively far away from the enemy's lines and brings forth their crossbows. The specialized shields are constructed to have a relatively flat top and a very sharp triangle bottom reinforced with metal. On soft ground, they can thrust the triangle into the ground and let go of the shield. They can flip it around on solid ground and simply have it lean against the specially crafted handle. This creates rows of wooden palisades where they can shoot their crossbows in between or just above. As the enemy comes into melee range, the infantry units switch over to their halberd if that would be more advantageous, for example, when they face cavalry or lightly armored infantry, or use their shields short-swords to face off against heavy infantry.

Siege

Malgrave also possesses an array of siege engines. Catapults, trebuchets, and ballistae either on top of their walls or on wheels once on the battlefield. Some smaller versions of the catapult or the ballista can be mounted on a cart pushed by two horses. This enables quick repositioning for their siege engines. Malgrave also has developed movable siege towers. But since they haven't been in the business of besieging anyone as of late, only a handful exists.



Prime Servant

Ruler: Ivone Swartz (Female, 49 years)

Family: Husband (48 years) and a son (26 years)

Insignia: A round purple field with a silver chained dragon head

Rule: All of Malgrave, though only within the Prime Servant's rights and duties

Ivone's ascendancy to Prime Servant befuddled many government officials and cultural leaders of Malgrave. Her rhetoric was more conservative and not the standard progressive tone that has ruled the country for many decades. Ivone campaigned on the idea that Malgrave should look back to its imperial past. As the most prosperous nation on Frostmark, she questioned why Malgrave hasn't taken a stronger position in the international forum, instead of letting their neighbors decay or be led astray. Ivone used Eastcreek as an example in her arguments, praising Crowhill, a much smaller country than theirs, stepping in and reforming Eastcreek completely and bringing in education and modernization to the region.

Her romantic speeches about the former glory of the Malgravian Empire were moving and won the hearts of the working class, which in turn influenced the Council to elect her. Ivone has proven to be an active Prime Servant and has delivered further progress with integrating the new areas that Malgrave gained from the Karthmerian war. She has been active in Greenfield, cementing Malgrave's influence over the suppressed kingdom, and is searching for approval to go even further and help them get rid of Beornhelm. The Council has been unwilling to grant permission to start a war and does not seem to want to budge anytime soon on the issue. Lastly, she has been openly religious and a friend of the Church of Riahn, trying to seek support in the Council to improve their position in Malgrave's society. She argues that the Church was once their most important ally and holds an important position in Malgravian tradition.

It's no secret that most of the Prime Advisors are not on the best terms with Ivone, except for the Security Advisor, Alard, who shares her views that Malgrave should become more active in Frostmark. Ivone has shown an incredible connection with the

lower classes of Malgrave, a charm that has intimidated some progressive leaders. The people say that they like her stubbornness and aggressiveness to see her policies through.

Economical Advisor

Oversees all financial matters of the nation and works together with the Structural Advisor to oversee trade issues.

Ruler: Elspeth Meyer (Female, 32 years)

Family: Husband (32 years) and two daughters (10 and 8 years)

Insignia: A round golden field with a silver dragon rampant

Rule: All of Malgrave, though only within the Economical Advisor's rights and duties

Elspeth mostly came to power by her brilliant mind. She also hails from a quite influential family, but she doesn't like to think it was their merit that she now holds the position. Elspeth spent quite a few years in the Explorer vocation as an economics scholar but was transferred to the Guide Vocation to put her knowledge to the government's use. And so she has, launching a few tweaks of the economic system, turning Malgrave even richer. One of her changes was limiting and decreasing some financial benefits that the Church of Riahn possesses in Malgrave. Elspeth and the Structural Advisor Muriella are known to be critical of the Church. They belong to the political faction that wants to remove the foreign Church's influence over the country. Elspeth is also known to be quite paranoid and seems unwilling to socialize with both Thierry and Alard.

Security Advisor

Oversees all matters of security, both within and outside of Malgrave. The highest general of the Malgravian army.

Ruler: Alard Witz (Male, 49 years)

Family: Brother (45 years)

Insignia: A round blue field with a silver halberd head

Rule: All of Malgrave, though only within the Security Advisor's rights and duties

It was quite a scandal when Alard was appointed Security Advisor. Not only because his parents both belonged to the

Provider Vocation, but also because of the incident in Greenfield. Alard served as general of a small contingent in Greenfield to protect a few government officials traveling to King Melchior on a diplomatic mission. A Beornish raid group attacked his troops during the stay, and he lost quite many soldiers to the surprise skirmish. When he was questioned about the incident, he argued that the loss was not because of his tactical prowess but because the army had grown soft. His official defense released to the public was more of a passionate speech about Malgrave's military and their moral obligations than an apology.

His message gained some traction, and after a few years of continuously campaigning, he was elected to the position of Security Advisor, the foremost leader of the Malgravian military. Alard is meticulous, authoritative but also a careful man. He has positioned himself neutrally between the members of the Council and is friendly with all of them. He officially supports Prime Servant Ivone's position to take a more active stance on the international stage and advises against giving the Church too much influence. Either way, he is outspoken about the fact that the Malgravian army is growing day by day less experienced and warns that it could be potentially disastrous.

Structural Advisor

Oversees all formal structures of Malgrave, both physical and systemically, for instance, infrastructure and the bureaucratic system. Works together with the Economic Advisor to oversee trade, the Security Advisor to oversee the militaristic system, and the Development Advisor to oversee the education system.

Ruler: Muriella Richenbachs (Female, 39 years)

Family: None

Insignia: A round purple field with a three towered silver castle

Rule: All of Malgrave, though only within the Structural Advisor's rights and duties

Muriella Richenbachs come from one of the most influential families in Malgrave who has had a long history of sitting on important positions in Malgrave's government, all the way back to the imperial times. Muriella winning the election as the Structural

Advisor did not shock Malgrave's government or people. She has for many years worked herself up through the ranks by hard-work and an ambitious mindset. She truly represents the progressive high class of Malgrave. Muriella is creative, clever, and ambitious, and through her work, she has gained favor amongst the anti-Church factions of Malgrave by acting within her position to diminish their power. This she primarily achieved by removing the Church's right to own land in Malgrave. It is commonly known that Muriella works closely with Elspeth, and they seem to have a unified front in their policies. Moreover, Muriella and Thierry seem to be very gregarious towards each other.

Development Advisor

Oversees all development issues of Malgrave, for example, education, foreign relations, new government projects, etc. Works together with the Economic Advisor to oversee new financial policies, the Security Advisor in diplomacy, and the Structural Advisor with new systemic or infrastructure changes. They also handle and fund all Explorers (scientists and researchers) and their inventions. The Structural and Development departments' difference is that the Structural Department handles what is, while the Development department strives towards what can be.

Ruler: Thierry Waller (Male, 33 years)

Family: Brother (31 years) and a daughter (6 years)

Insignia: A round blue field with a silver dragon flying

Rule: All of Malgrave, though only within the Development Advisor's rights and duties

Thierry Waller was the last Development Advisor's first secretary and worked with them when they discovered leaked government information to Stormholme in return for vast sums. The last Advisor was tried and sentenced, but due to several unfinished projects within the Development department that the Advisor had started, Thierry was elected to become the temporary Advisor to see them to their fruition. He performed a solid job, and when the time came to consider a permanent position, he was simply elevated to Prime Advisor. Thierry is extremely loyal to his family, but he refuses to talk about what

happened to his daughter's mother. Lately, he and Muriella have grown increasingly friendly with each other.

OLDWOOD



Location: South of Beornhelm, east of Greenfield, northeast of Malgrave, and north of Crowhill

Authority: Royal family but largely independent towns and regions

Geography

Oldwood is mostly covered by the Oldberry Woods, a moderately rocky, dense deciduous to an evergreen forest where pines, firs, and birch are common. Oldwood has an eastern spine, the mountain chain of Orean's Point, an offshoot range of the Orean's Hand. Orean's Point is not as tall or mighty as the rest of the Orean's Hand, but it still cuts boldly through the kingdom of Oldwood.

Orean's Point's eastern side often experiences windy and stormy weather, the ocean equally tempestuous and cold. Most of the coastline has therefore been relieved of its fertile topsoil to reveal cold stone beneath. Only sturdy evergreen trees like pines and equally sturdy bush and grass species grow successfully in this region. Several bays and inlets exist, two of the major ones being the water channel between the coast and an island. Some of these bays offer some protection against the merciless winds, and you often find settlements there.

The Bay of Birches, between the mainland and Elm island, is known for its intriguing amount of, indeed, birches. Sea-trading is perilous in the Woodish sea, and thus Oldwood's harbors are seldom visited. Due to the low prevalence of agricultural pursuits in the region, herding and fishing are important professions. Most of the coast's settlements have small fleets of

fishing boats, as the sea offers plentiful bounties. Being a sailor along Oldwood eastern's coast is one of the most dangerous professions in Frostmark.

The western side of Orean's Point is protected by the mountain range. Here the weather is more mild and stable. This has allowed for one rather fertile bowl, Meparras Garden, where most of Oldwood's agricultural production comes from. Still, the Oldberry Woods is deep, at many times quite uniform, and the distance between settlements can be great, making the wilderness dangerous in its own way on the western side.

Oldwood borders the Bazken Moor and the Zakaru Prairie in the south, making the forest areas relatively wet, respectively, dry in the overlapping region. Iodin and Iophar rivers are moderately fast-flowing mountain rivers and are, therefore, more of an obstacle than a resource for the Woodish. Despite its cold nature, Iodin lake possesses some fish species, and trade is conducted with Greenfield over it, mostly through Currantcall town. Thetanor river is a far more important river for the Woodish. Here river trading is common, merchants carrying goods in between Eastcreek's Sky Mirror to the highlands of Armathain.

Oldwood



Oldwood's geographical features are dominated by the great mountain range of Orea's First runs like a spine along its eastern coastline. The Orea's First provides some cover from the cold and stormy northeastern sea. The eastern shoreline is rocky and wet, with few natural ports, while the lands west of the Orea's First experience less chaotic weather patterns and is mostly a never-ending sea of pine, birch, and fir. In its central lands, there is one fertile bowl where Oldwood receives most of its agricultural produce. Otherwise, the Woodlings survive on game, herding, and fishing. None surprisingly, Oldwood trade mostly in wood, ore, and stone, resources that can be found aplenty. Villages and hamlets are far in between, which has resulted in an independent spirit within the Woodlings. Oldwood is ruled by a royal household, but the self-sufficient temper of most communities in Oldwood makes the population notoriously hard to govern.

Living in Oldwood

Oldwood is a place of individualism and vast expanses of wilderness. The population density is relatively low, similar to Beornhelm's, and the distance between hamlet, village, town, and the city is vast. Most settlements consist of sturdy houses built with stone and wood, resting alone in a pine sea. The coastal villages are usually smaller or clad heavily in stone to withstand the salty and windy shore. The Woodlings tend to gather in larger communities than to spread out into smaller ones, surviving by the grace of their numbers. This distance between neighboring towns and villages has made the Woodlings' independent and distrustful of strangers. Even if the Woodlings are suspicious around their neighbors, they are even more suspicious around foreigners. Despite the self-reliant disposition of Woodling communities, they will band together to protect their way of life.

Before the Empire, Oldwood was not governed by a single leader or government, nor did they have an aristocracy. Instead, communities were independently governed in a manner that suited the particular settlement. Most of these leaders were either charming governors who won over the hearts of their community, a council of

powerful or elected figures, or authoritarian military leaders who rule by their might. The communities' leaders often organized the settlement's affairs, settled disputes, and ensured its safety. In return, the leaders and their families were given food and gifts from the rest of the community. As soon a Woodling community grows dissatisfied with their leader or leaders, the Woodling usually has no qualms to remove such leadership, which were often bloody affairs. After Geanor conquered Oldwood and Empress Leana established the Empire, several alien features were introduced to the Woodling. One such feature was a national leader, who organized local leaders and armies in turn. Suddenly, Woodling society experienced the same governing system, law, and culture in all their settlements.

The Woodlings were stubborn and uncooperative with these changes for a long time. The effort level from the Empire to make the Woodlings fall in line varied in intensity depending upon the current Emperor or Empress. No matter how the Woodlings struggled, some change to Oldwood was inevitable in the end. The Empire was quite successful with religion. The Riahnish faith's introduction was quite warmly received in Oldwood, mainly due to the Woodlings' love for their community and family. Churches and priests were ordained, the ceremonies and edicts of the Radiance of Geanor were introduced, and slowly but surely, the Woodlings came to accept this new faith instead of their old gods. In today's society in Oldwood, the faith of Riahn is spread far and wide, and the practices of the Church are a part of everyday life, especially in the southwestern parts of Oldwood. Still, the faith holds little political influence in Oldwood. Instead, religion is seen as a private matter. Despite the Empire's success with the Riahnish faith, there might still be lonely communities who stubbornly cling to old traditions or have formed new ones.

During the imperial age, the Empire invested many resources in Oldwood to modernize the area. This came to include proper education and the introduction of state-of-the-art technology. The technology and practical knowledge that was shared was quickly absorbed, but the more "cultural" education was met with more resistance, albeit the least so around the capital. The

education and the teachers given were foremost for the governors, their families, and closest allies, and second for the populace. The population's education was often forced upon them through mass meetings, usually in the village Church. It could be just children or just a slab of the population, depending upon the governor's will. Still, Oldwood prospered with a more educated population.

After the fall of the Empire, Oldwood was assailed on two fronts. Beornhelm raided viciously in the north. Malgrave exacted heavy diplomatic influence to pressure Oldwood to keep their imperial governing system, as Malgrave came to rely upon their iron ore and stone imports. Despite this diplomatic pressure, Oldwood lashed out at the system that had imprisoned them for so long. The duke of Oldwood, his family, and many regional rulers, their families, and their allies was attacked and executed. Oldwood then fell into an age of chaos as rulers and troublemakers rapidly rose and fell. The confusion was absolute. Do they follow the laws and use the infrastructure they all used for six centuries and rely upon, or do they create something new? And if so, what would that be? After this bloody period, most Woodlings transcended their need for vengeance and realized that they had destroyed the very system they all depended upon. From the ashes, they tried to save any piece of the destroyed infrastructure and reinstate old leaders that had been driven into hiding.

And all the while, the raids from Beornhelm continued to bleed the north dry. Oldwood approached Greenfield and Sirendale, who were also experiencing the attacks from Beornhelm, and offered an alliance. Soon, the Northern Front was created. An organization that shared intel, resources, and men to beat back the Beornish. Out of sheer desperation, Oldwood asked Queen Lysander's brother to become their new king and recreate parts of the imperial system in Oldwood. At first, the brother was unwilling, seeing how Oldwood had treated their last duke but was eventually swayed with promises of protection and submission.

King Lysander was a successful ruler. He helped Oldwood rebuild what had been lost, enforced a common set of laws and trade

rules, and established a national army. King Lysander also paid heed to the independent nature of Woodling culture, and he approached governing Oldwood in a different way than the Empire had. With great patience and respect for the pride of the Oldwood's settlements, the new system of Oldwood was a compromise, meeting in the middle between the imperial transformation and the old ways of Oldwood. In practice, King Lysander increased regional power and allowed the regions to create their laws and trade rules in some national law areas. The few teachers that survived the cleansing allied themselves with the new lords and ladies of Oldwood and tried to pass on their knowledge in a similar fashion. As the Lysander family gave much independence to the communities of Oldwood, the tradition of education and technology today varies from area to area.

As a result, Lysander's royal household doesn't wield as much influence over their lands as many other rulers do, both due to their unique set of laws and Oldwood's culture. Just like in the old days, the favor of the Woodlings can fluctuate like the seasons. However, in general, the new system was a success for Oldwood. More noble siblings from Sirendale and Greenfield were also welcomed, filling in vacant positions in regional leadership. Over the centuries, some of these noble houses have risen, and some have fallen in true Woodlings style.

Within the last two generations of the Lysander line, much respect has been lost for the Lysander house. Many Woodlings complain that the Lysander household does not respect Woodling's autonomy as much as before. Indeed, Lysander has recently tried to consolidate power, but their excuse is that some settlements of Oldwood have strayed too far from the national baseline. This has only succeeded in pushing many Woodlings further away. The area around the capital is the most acclimated to royal governance and the Church of Rhian. Still, over Orea's First, in southeastern Oldwood, the house of Ravenmoor has amassed a surprising amount of influence through mysterious ways. To the north, Duke Grimcolt has gone rogue, organizing the area and building fortifications to defend against the onslaught of Beornhelm. An act

that has earned him quite a large amount of respect in many Woodlings' eyes.

The Wayfarers

During the age of the Seven, the Oldberry woods were dangerous to traverse, with natural hazards, monstrosities, and bandits. Normal people required protection while traveling extensive distances in between communities within the Oldberry Woods. In part, this need created the Wayfarers' loose organization, who were all a mixture of wise healers, experienced advisors, and reliable warriors on the road. Before the Empire, each settlement in this forest had at least one Wayfarer. In harmony with the perilous woods, they lived outside of the settlement to encourage and ensure the Wayfarer's duty. As a bridge between the wild and the civilized. As with the community leader, the Wayfarer was also given gifts, supplies, and food for their services. It was considered a great honor to become a Wayfarer, and they are treated with the utmost respect, which often would tip over in fear. Most Wayfarer's lived interesting and comfortable lives, but also lonely ones as they were often set apart from their community.

To ensure immunity for a Wayfarer, they had a stringent rule to not intervene in their settlements' politics. As the war of Geanor was eventually brought to the Oldberry Woods, most Wayfarers did not interfere with the war, even though a victory for Geanor would result in the death of their organization. Some Wayfarers argued that their most important rule must be momentarily broken so they could fight for their existence. These members were shunned from the Wayfarer community, and they created another organization, the Shamans. At this point, the area that would become Oldwood had already been lost to Geanor, and so the Shamans took a final stand with the warriors of Beornhelm, defending their very way of life.

As history foretold, the Shamans and the Beornish lost this war, and the Empire rose from its ashes. Yet, both some Shamans and Wayfarers have survived to this day. As the Shamans' stance is more aggressive, they are hunted down and executed, extremely close to extinction. As the Empire's grip started to loosen, and in the end fall, the Shamans have

bounced back with surprising vigor. The Wayfarers' more peaceful approach allowed them to survive in greater numbers after the Empire was established. But their refusal to participate in a conflict has allowed the Church to discredit their practices to the point that the Wayfarers simply faded away as Oldwood's culture changed. Maybe, one or two traditional Wayfarers still hold in a remote area within the Oldberry woods. The truth for both the Wayfarers and the Shamans during the imperial age was that they could no longer practice Soul Magic if they were to survive. Therefore, Soul Magic's mystery and its science have faded in both the Shaman organization and the Wayfarer organization. Today, both organizations act like natural healers, sages, and advisors to their settlements, where Shamans have no qualms with meddling into politics while the Wayfarers remain traditionally neutral.

Relation to the Church

The Church's influence varies greatly from area to area. Some unique areas rival Crowhill in piousness, while others don't want to hear anything about it. The capital region is generally more devoted than the corners of the kingdom. This influence also varies in practice. In some special areas, the Church can have gained political influence. In others, they are restricted to just the ceremonial and the spiritual. The southeastern coast has been a rather devoted area but has rapidly lost its piousness in the last five years or so. Envoys from Crowhill itself have been sent to find the root of the issue and rectify it. No success has been reported yet from the high-seat of the Church. Strangely little information has been given as to why. Though, the Church of Riahn cannot spend too many resources in Oldwood as they are business elsewhere.

Relation to other Nations

The Northern Front, the alliance between Oldwood, Greenfield, and Sirendale, is still remembered in a warm light by the three kingdoms, despite their shortcomings of cooperating in the last years of the alliance. Many sympathizers have arisen to argue that the Northern Front must be revitalized. However, Sirendale is pressured by Armathain to not involve themselves.

Greenfield has been half taken over by Beornhelm in the north and Malgrave in the south, and Oldwood is losing its cohesion.

Out of all the kingdoms upon Frostmark, Oldwood can somewhat stand the Fieldish, Sirens, and the Clans of the Great Grass Sea more so than other people in Frostmark. The noble families of Oldwood have family and cultural ties to both Greenfield and Sirendale, which improves this relationship further. During the invasion of Greenfield by Beornhelm, Oldwood tried to send relief packages to Greenfield. Still, after a few Beornish raiding parties managed to attack them and rob them while they had passed over the border, Queen Lysander decided to end the effort. After all, Oldwood is facing its challenges. Greenfield had hoped for military help from Oldwood, and the diplomatic ties between the Fairfax royal household and the Lysander house have continued to sour.

Before the Beornish invasion of Greenfield, the aristocracy of Greenfield and Oldwood frequently traveled over the border during celebrations and for business. After the invasion, traversing the northern and central border to Greenfield is considered too dangerous. As for Sirendale, there is no secret that the Lysander family has heard the pleas from the Light of Lysander rebels and are seriously entertaining solutions to their plight.

Contrary to common belief, Beornhelm was allowed to trade in some communities in Oldwood, but only under strict oversight. After Duke Grimcolt took over, this practice changed, and the northern border to Beornhelm, as well as the northern ports, were ordered completely closed. Woodlings don't care much for the Clans, as they have mostly left each other respectfully to their own devices. If one or the other accidentally wander into foreign territory, they are sternly but politely removed by either party.

Military

Oldwood's standing army is today limited to the region surrounding the capital. In comparison to many other kingdoms, it is relatively small and ill-equipped. However, the Woodlings are known for their extreme measures when protecting their lands and

communities, otherwise peaceful citizens showing surprising amounts of bravery and skill for their status. The few times Woodlings have attempted to invade other people, the Woodling army would always lose discipline. As there would be no common goal, in the end, the different factions would simply raid and then return home in boredom, or they would be easily beaten back to the lack of cohesion.

The soldiers of southern Oldwood, controlled by Lysander's royal household, are trained in a version of Sacred Arms tactics. The more independent areas rely on their more traditional guerilla with ax and bow tactics. But the individual community can have their militaristic traditions.

Oldwood



Royal House of Lysander

Ruler: Queen Mirnova (30 years)

Family: Deceased King (31 years), sister (27 years), son (9 years), and a daughter (2 years).

Coat of Arms: A white shield with a horizontal green line displayed in the middle, with half of a green sun displayed just over it, like a green sunrise.

Rule: Officially all of Oldwood, but realistically Oakheart capital, Pinefront city, and Maplepost town.

Queen Mirnova is struggling to keep her kingdom in control. The Queen herself is not a terrible ruler. She is widely admired amongst her supporters, but pressure from Malgrave in the south, western regions growing more distant, and the northern territories almost in open rebellion has forced her to make hard decisions. She had to neglect most of the country to keep control of her home base. This hasn't improved the situation in the north or the east. She is desperately searching for a way to keep Oldwood together, and ever since her husband mysteriously died on his way home from a diplomatic journey to Alderholt city, this has become a personal matter for her. Mirnova has now successfully cemented her control in the central areas of the kingdom and can now finally search for a western problem solution. The Queen is known to be stubborn, full of energy, and prone to worry and stress.

House Grimcolt of the Iron Barricade

Ruler: Duke Valerian (27 years)

Family: Deceased brother (20 years)

Coat of Arms: Coat of Arms: A red and black saltire shield with a green gate displayed in the middle

Rule: Deepgate city, Embersworth city, and Aramore town

Duke Grimcolt's brother died in a Beornhelm raid just a few years ago. Duke Valerian of Grimcolt, his brother, and his soldiers were

tasked with defending Aramore town against a raid even if they were outnumbered. The capital had promised that reinforcement would come, and so the brothers entered the battle. However, the reinforcements didn't arrive in time, Grimcolt's men were decimated, and his brother tragically died while defending the duke.

Somehow, victory was still Valerion's, but it was bittersweet. After that fateful event, the duke decided that the capital was unable to defend the north. He swore to only rely on himself and the lands around him to support their cause. He took control over the towns and villages in the north, trained the troops, and used his tactics. Two years ago, he started his most ambitious project yet, building a wall and coining his forces' nickname, the Iron Barricade. Valerian is said to be a charismatic leader, compassionate to the smallfolk, but ruthless when he has to be.

House of Ravenmoor

Ruler: Count Alexei (32 years) and Countess Larissa (29 years)

Family: None

Coat of Arms: A red and black saltire shield with ravens rising in the black fields

Rule: Alderholt city, Eyke town and Fenby town

The Ravenmoor house has a clouded origin, they arose in the western region to nobility, but no official documents detail their rise or where they come from. Uniquely, the count and countess share the burden of ruling, the overwhelming tradition in Formstkar being one dominant individual within a ruling family. Somehow they rose in power in Fenby town, then took over Alderholt city, an important port city, and soon the town of the island of Eyke joined. There are many rumors of strange events in the region, and scouts who are sent to investigate usually wind up dead. The few accounts that make it out of the southwestern coast say that the Ravenmoor couple is brilliant and visionary, while others describe them as cruel and tyrannical.

SIRENDALE



Location: West coast, south of Beornhelm, west of Greenfield, north of Armathain

Authority: Coalition of nobles and master artisans

Geography

The Green Elder Valley, a huge fertile and flat valley from the coast of Sirendale to eastern Greenfield split Sirendale's two forests into two. From the north, the dense and hilly Oldberry Woods spreads southward, progressively turning thinner the more south you travel. The south is divided into the Patkov Marsh in the southeast, and the forest of Sum Wald in the southwest, an incredibly rocky evergreen forest. Despite the northern latitude that Sirendale is in, the warm ocean currents are pushed up from Karthmere and Applegate through Salzissa Island have made Sirendale surprisingly mild in its climate. Snow still falls during the winter, but the summer is warm enough to create a suitable agricultural environment in the Green Elder Valley.

Thetla river flows moderately fast within the Oldberry Woods but calms down considerably once it flows through the Green Elder Valley. Still, the river trading along the Thetla, Thetanor, and Thetenna rivers starts from Mosshold City and ends in Eastcreek's Sky Mirror lake. Thetanor river provides excellent river trading possibilities, as it flows calmly, and progressively more so, through the Green Elder Valley and later into the Bazken Moor. The shoreline is either rocky and deep or shallow with stony or sandy beaches. The Eagle's Strait inlet is

too jagged on the Sirendale side to allow any significant harbors as it does on the Beornish side of the inlet. Still, this is the busiest region on Frostmark where trade takes place between Beornhelm and another kingdom, even if it is still a shy amount.

Summary

Sirendale, who is nestled between Armathain and Beornhelm, has not gone unaffected from its geographical position. Their royal family was murdered in a bold Beornish raid that turned to a full-scale invasion that pierced the capital. Nowadays, Sirendale has developed a solution like that of Applegate, where several nobles have banded together to protect their kingdom. Still, no one is daring to step forward as the de-facto ruler to have to face both Beornhelm and Armathain's attention.

Despite all of this, Sirendale has fared better than Greenfield, mainly due to their arts and crafts traditions. Both Armathain and Beornhelm have drawn benefits from the fine craftsmen and artists Sirendale produces, which the Sirens use as an advantage. Raids from Beornhelm has also diminished, dissuaded by the large presence of Armathain in the kingdom. As Sirendale is the largest producer of luxury and processed goods, its economy has recovered from its violent past. Sirendale's most striking feature is its large flower fields,



Sirendale

producing perfumes, herbal alcohol, and rich cloth.

Living in Sirendale

50 years after Oldwood successfully negotiated with the Northern Front to give them a new king in the form of Queen Lysander's brother, a daring Beornish coalition of chieftains attacked Sirendale. The raid transformed into more of an invasion after a string of surprising windfalls for the attacking force, and thus, the beornish ransacked northern to central Sirendale. In the end, they reached the capital, and after a short siege, the beornish stormed the city. The royal family of Mistshear in Sirendale was wiped out during this event, refusing to leave the city even after the defeat was obvious. During that winter, the Beornish chieftains couldn't keep the peace between themselves after successfully occupying almost half of Sirendale. Quarrels turned progressively more violent and ended in infighting between the chieftains. When spring came, all the beornish returned home, unable to keep their grip on the kingdom.

After the incident, Sirendale leaned on their neighboring kingdom Armathain, to ensure that another raid of Beornhelm would never become as devastating again. This has given Armathain a strong foothold in the nation, using every opportunity to try and force their culture upon the sirens and squeeze every coin they can through silly taxes and demands. In the north, Beornhelm continues to pester Sirendale but not to the same extent now that Armathain protects the more central areas. Despite this, Armathain hasn't shown any will to protect the northern territories of Sirendale, and here Sirendale must hire mercenaries to withstand the Beornish presence. Some southern Sirendale territories make secret deals with Beornhelm to keep Armathain from completely absorbing the south, turning this whole affair into a tense balance between two super nations and a smaller country caught in the middle.

Sirendale has never been a great militaristic state, instead of surviving on their grace of diplomacy and trade. Art and craft are significant in siren culture, and the area was relatively peaceful before and during the

Empire. The greatest masters in their respective fields of arts or craft became the rulers of Sirendale. After the Empire's influence, masters of their field were given official noble titles. During the Imperial era, Sirendale acquired some Sacred arms troops as protection against the Six Horrid Devils' lingering presence. Most of these forces withdrew when their assignment came to its completion, and more so when the Empire fell. A few remained, though, which has become the core of the small military presence of Sirendale.

Apprenticeship plays a strong role in Siren society. If you're able to impress a Master with your talent and withstand the years of learning, you can ascend to become a Practitioner, someone who is licensed to work their craft or art. If the Practitioner has the means and the will, they can turn into a Journeyman and travel around Frostmark for a few years, seeking inspiration and more knowledge about their craft or art. Once back in Sirendale, a group of Masters comes together to evaluate what the Journeyman has learned and can advance them to the rank of Master, which entails entering the elite of Sirendale's hierarchy and grants them a noble title. Sirendale's traditions and educational prowess with arts and crafts have made it famous throughout Frostmark. Many pay handsomely to get their hands on Siren craftsmanship or a Siren performer. It is quite common that Journeymen never travel home again, employed as private artisans within courts, and live out their days in a very comfortable lifestyle.

Considering the unstable climate in Sirendale, Beornish raids from the north, and Armathain breathing down their necks in from the south, many craftsmen and artists have fled the kingdom. It is quite common to find Siren artists in either Stormholme, Malgrave, or Karthmere. Armathain is often seen as too oppressive and conservative for a free-thinking crafter or artist to feel at home in their society, which infuriates Armathain. Many passionate souls from other kingdoms travel to Sirendale to try to impress a resident Master for an apprenticeship. This has granted the Masters of Sirendale some international immunity when they school influential families' children in the Siren way.

Sirendale's system has also set the tone of similar institutions in other kingdoms.

Relation to the Church

There isn't much to say about the relationship between Sirendale and the Church of Riahn. Both parties don't pay much heed to each other, except when a new cathedral is built, a church needs renovating, or personal requests from the higher priests. The faith of Riahn is the state religion of Sirendale, but the faith is hardly a focus in people's everyday lives. It is more of a tradition and a pleasant place to seek support and help. Armathain's presence in the south has brought pressure to adhere to the Church more than Sirens normally do, and it has indeed influenced some communities in the south.

Relation to other nations

To some Sirens, the royal family of Sirendale, the old Lysanders, is still the kingdom's rightful ruler. Some send romantic and hopeful glances towards Oldwood's branch of the Lysander family, wishing that one day a Lysander will return to Sirendale.

Sirendale has in the past made much trade with Greenfield and has enjoyed a long history of good diplomatic relations, but Greenfield's crumbling system and Sirendale's issues have certainly isolated the kingdoms from each other.

Armathain is pushing into the country through political means to secure as much taxes and trade from Sirendale as possible to feed Armathain's empty coffers. Some Sirens see Armathain as the lesser evil than Beornhelm, and others find both of them as oppressive.

Sirendale is more than chilly towards Beornhelm, the Great Ransack of Mistshear, and the general raids in the northern areas would turn most people sour. But some Sirens swallow their anger to work with Beornhelm to slow down Armathain's silent tyranny.

Military

Before the Empire, Sirendale had a few professional soldiers who saw battle and their weapon of choice to be their art. After the Empire, there are still a small number of Sacred Arms soldiers who carry their tradition to the next generations. Lastly, there is a resistance group, called the Light of Lysander, who wants to free Sirendale from Beornhelm and Armathain. This underground group is the strongest supporter of the Lysander royal household.



House Seyland

Ruler: Viscount Seyland (46 years)

Family: Viscountess (41 years old) and a daughter (11 years)

Rule: Mosshold City and Stillglen City

Master of: Leatherworking and sowing

Viscount Seyland has proven to be bold in his decision to rule the northern territories of Sirendale so brazenly as he is not a fighter at heart. Seyland is known for recklessly trying to keep Sirendale intact and his people safe from danger. This, in the past, has meant deterring beornish raids. Today, however, there are rumors of a shaky peace between a Beornish chieftain and Seyland, which Armathain vehemently denies.

House Cottonport

Ruler: Duchess Cottonport (25 years)

Family: Duke (30 years)

Rule: Cottonport City, Chillvale Town, and Rosewood Town

Master of: Singing and stringed instruments

Duchess Cottonport, hailing from an influential family of Sirendale, ascended to power in Sirendale's most important trade town, by coin and name. Today, Duchess Cottonport is a household name, famous for her nightingale voice. Cottonport is known

to attend and throw parties and only takes an interest in politics when the economy is not flowing as it should. She has been the most welcoming provincial ruler for Armathain and has let them roam her territories unchecked, preferring the stability and safety that they can provide. Today Armathain is almost the true governing force of this area. The Duchess is known to be adventurous but also a bit conceited.

House Bluerow

Ruler: Count (26 years)

Family: Sister (19 years)

Rule: Mistshear Capital, Swanwater Town, and Glimmerdrift Town

Master of: Writing and painting

Bluerow might be the only thing keeping the capital neutral between Armathian and Beornhelm and prevents the sirens from going too anxious about the kingdom's state. He is known to be a dreamer with a great imagination, who prefers to spend his time reading, writing, and painting than deal with too much serious business. Nonetheless, he is the only prominent noble with enough resources to rule Mistshear, and the people seem to enjoy living in a state of status quo. At least they have not been ruined by Armathain, and they have been affected by Beornhelm for a long time.

STORMHOLME



Location: South coast, east of Karthmere, south of Malgrave, north-west of Eastcreek, and west of Crowhill

Authority: Oligarchy

Geography

Stormholme is one of the warmest kingdoms on Frostmark, rivaling Crowhill in that aspect. Running through Stormholme is the mountain chain of the Gallean Rise and the Qebaran Range. Both of them are the largest mountain chains in the south, where the Gallean Rise is the taller and larger of the two. The Gallean Rise is not that rich in ore, but what it provides is highly varied. It is often a surprise what you find if you invest enough money to start a mining operation. Within the Qebaran Range, on the other hand, there are rare trace veins of adamant and mithril. Mithril and Adamant is something that can be randomly stumbled upon in other bedrocks, but the chances of finding one are the greatest within the Qebaran Range.

From the southwestern border to Karthmere, the Gallant Grove forest spills into Stormholme to the northeast side of the Qebaran Range. In between the Gallean Rise and the Qebaran Range, the Nulgan Grove spreads. Technically, the Gallant Grove and the Nulgan Maw are the same woods, but the mountain ridges between them almost isolate the Nulgan Maw part of the forest from the Gallant Grove. The Gallant Grove, and the Nulgan Grove, in Stormholme is moderately rocky close to the mountain ranges but grows progressively less the further you are away from them. Furthermore, Stormholme Gallant Grove is

exclusively evergreen with species of trees that are resistant to heat. The Gallant Grove and the Nulgan Maw have been thinned out significantly from extensive exploitation of its resources.

Both the Qebaran Range and the Gallean Rise creates two arms that, in turn, creates a vast and protected bay called the Nulgan Maw. Within the Nulgan Maw, there are several medium-sized islands and dozens of smaller ones of different sizes. The arms of the Qebaran Range and the Gallean Rise are arid and rocky, where only the most heat resistant and dry resistant flora and fauna of Frostmark can live.

On the eastern side of the Qebaran Range, several smaller mountain rivers flow into each other in a large and confusing web, creating a small delta. The Gallean Rise's arm breaks up into several smaller islands that stretch far into the sea. This biome runs all along the western side of the Gallean Rise's arm and south of the chain proper and named the Hedlon Mesa. The only settlements that thrive in the Hedlon Mesa are around the two rivers of Tahmeneras and Hathenna river, two mountain rivers that run from the Gallean Rise to the coast. On the north side of the Gallean Rise, it rains a bit more than it does over the Hedlon Mesa, but not much. The terrain on this side

Stormholme



of the chain, Labphrian Steppes, is more rocky and hilly around the Teisir river. The Teisir river has dramatically spliced through this rocky landscape, creating a vast canyon. After the Teisir river pools into a high terrain lake, the rest of the Labphrian Steppes are grassy lowlands.

In the easternmost part of Stormholme, past the Gallean Rise, lies the Iskerian Boondocks, an evergreen leaf forest that starts very thin but progressively becomes significantly thicker the closer you get to the border of Eastcreek. Teiko and Teigri rivers are two important trading rivers, where boat traffic travel from the highlands of Armathain to the ports of Crowhill. The shoreline of Stormholme is almost exclusively deep with either rocky or sandy beaches, but most commonly, cliffs. There are many natural harbors along the Stormish coast. Far out in the southwestern sea, Stormholme's largest island can be found. Nodensia is quite isolated from the rest of Frostmark but is similar to Stormholme in nature. Like a spine, the middle of Nodensia island is covered in a highly eroded mountain chain called the Tosian Bluff, incidentally Frostmark's smallest mountain ridge. The north side of the island is covered in forest and fertile grasslands, whilst the south side, which is less populated, is hilly, grassy, and drier. Nodensia has a varied coastline, with both cliffs and beaches, but a deep shoreline is the most common.

Summary

Stormholme is mainly a large bay, a mountain chain, and some islands. Only a fraction of Stormholme's territory can be farmed. Due to their capital and natural affinity for harbors, Stormholme quickly became the largest presence of the seas due to the strategic position of their capital and natural affinity. In recent history, Karthmere has tried to claim domination of the ocean by expanding the size of its fleet. Today, whilst Karthmere owns the largest fleet in Frostmark, Stormholme has kept its crown by the sheer quality of its boats and sailors.

Most settlements of Stormholme can be found around the coastal areas and on the various islands. Fishing and trade have become the most important livelihoods for the Stormish people, which were a

significant reason why Stormholme transformed from a monarchy to an oligarchy. Noble titles remain, but only noble families who have been able to form successful business care to use them anymore. Instead, Stormholme is controlled by four different guilds, each holding monopolies over important aspects of society and production sectors.

Living in Stormholme

Stormholme has always been a geographical center for trade and seamanship due to its large number of islands, long stretches of coast, and the presence of many natural harbors. Trade and coin have for a long time permeated this area. When Stormholme was molded into an imperial duchy, the country became a monarchy. Stormholme, in general, abided by the imperial rule, but the new system didn't allow as much profit and free movement of the coin as it had before. When the Empire was falling apart, Stormholme was quick to abandon the imperial governance style.

Stormholme returned to the ways of the old, but now with more sophistication. After the dust had settled once the Empire had fallen, trade started to flourish. Over a few years, many small guilds popped up, some gathering influence quickly. Even if they were competing against each other, they pressured the monarchy of Stormholme with one voice. The message; Give us simpler and leaner trade laws. Initially, the nobility was enthusiastic about the economic boom, as it favored them, so they agreed. Progressively, the imperial law system changed within Stormholme, and with it, the guilds grew in number and strength.

The point came where the nobles saw fewer benefits than the guilds when they enacted yet another legislative change. The nobility wanted to hit the breaks, realizing how much power they had given away to the guilds of Stormholme. But the cumulative power of the guilds now challenged that of the nobles. What was once a diplomatic spirit from the guilds of enriching both parties, guilds and the nobility of Stormholme, became threats instead. A war of sorts started, nobility trying to reverse the changes made and the guilds trying to

accelerate them. A few tumultuous years went by, where sometimes the guilds were able to force change, and sometimes the nobility was able to roll back laws.

However, the guilds were the victors in the end. Just shy of the year of 680 AEF, the monarchy had become more like puppets of the guilds than regents. Yet, the monarchy had a lot of ceremonial power left. The guilds moved their pawns to a position of checkmate when they assassinated the regent in 680 AEF. Finally, nothing was standing in their way of power, except for each other. Once there was no shred of power or influence left in the nobility, they turned on each other.

The Stormholmish guild wars began quickly after the death of the monarchy. Tyrants, coalitions, and individual guilds rose and fell until there were only four players left. Four immensely powerful coalitions of guilds eventually merged into united entities. A stalemate settled in, and when the four guilds realized they owned a quarter of each of the countries, they decided that civil war was bad for business. Today, they control almost all of Stormholme's markets, coin, military, and production. Due to the guild's colossal size, they are unable to be rivaled by upcoming guilds. If a new player enters the stage, they are either quickly absorbed or promptly ripped apart.

Stormholme was quick to remove any influence the Church had in Stormholme. It both restricted the market system through the rules present in the Radiance of Geanor and could potentially split the loyalty of the Stormish people between the Church and the guilds. Thus, the Church was quickly undermined and, in the end, thrown out. Today only the most generous priests remain in ill-repaired churches, offering aid to the most deprived and poor. They survive on meager charity. As coin became the leading source of influence in Stormholme and the regulating force of the Church of Riahn disappeared, the traditional view of morality disappeared from Stormholme. The guilds operate with almost complete freedom as the only thing regulating their behavior is each other. The guilds cling to their privilege by walking a fine line between ruthlessness and benevolence, and at the

same time, they can't show weakness, but they can't appear like a target either.

Through the years, the four guilds have become something akin to royalty, and more often than not, power is attempted to be consolidated within families of the guilds by inheritance. There is a saying in Frostmark, "Whatever you need, you'll find it in Stormholme". This is mostly true as few laws are regulating the Stormish market. Unsurprisingly, Stormholme is the leading trading hub of the whole continent. Though, on the island of Nodensia, there are whispers of another guild rising, Sea's Embrace. It has somehow managed to grow in strength, and rumors have it that they are spreading the faith in Stormholme once more.

Relations with the Church

The Church of Riahn is very weak in Stormholme, with only a few priests and sanctuaries for the desperate and the sick. The Church often condemn Stormholme for their depravity and treason to Riahn. But due to Stormholme's strong economy and military presence, Sacred Arms doesn't dare to attack the nation for its heresy. Some would even attest to witnessing priests buy favors from Stormholme's open market.

Relations with other Nation

Stormholme is mainly an open trading hub that exchanges goods and services with anyone who offers good business. The largest trading partners are Karthmere, Malgrave, Armathain, and Sirendale. Stormholme has tried to influence Eastcreek in the past, mostly to get their hands on their marble cliffs, but both Eastcreek, and Crowhill in extension, has been "unreasonably suspicious" of the guilds' intentions, or so they say. Crowhill itself is openly hostile towards Stormholme but remains cordial enough to not spark a war.

Military

Every guild has its specialized troops, and so the Stormish military can vary greatly in their features. Their purpose is often to uphold security, escort merchants, and scare off the other guilds. There is a constant arms race between the guilds, but

at the same time, no one wants to become stronger than all the rest to have the other guilds gang upon them. Power is a balancing act in Stormholme.

From Stormholme's history of travel by sea, they have developed an excellent understanding of seamanship. Stormholme's vessels and their sailors possess the highest quality in all of Frostmark. Ship sizes vary between one to three main masts, and they usually sport deterrents such as catapults and ballista. Even if utilizing poison and disease in warfare is a known strategy in Frostmark, it is generally not used due to military traditions that date back to the age of Geanor. These tactics are, however, a common practice in Stormholme. Most agents of the guilds poison their weapons to ensure death after a tumble.

A map of the Three Islands region, showing three main islands: Everhorn, Sandcrow, and Edgecain. The islands are depicted in a stylized, brownish-yellow color against a dark blue background. Several locations are marked with white squares, and a white 'X' is placed on Sandcrow Island. The names of the islands are written in a large, white, serif font, oriented diagonally across the map.



Lowcloaks

The Lowcloaks guild focuses their efforts on scribing and other intellectual professions, as well as the materials it requires an occasional oddity. They also deal with basic resources such as salt and food. They mostly attract guild initiates who value mind over brawn, and they own the finest school system in Stormholme. Sometimes the other guilds have bought education from the Lowcloaks for their members. The Lowcloaks believe that knowledge is power, and therefore they should consolidate it as much as possible, only sharing their knowledge if it benefits them. Their charity work is often expressed through starting schools and giving the less fortunate access to primary education, to foster loyalty and pick up talents where they can. The Lowcloaks can act rather aristocratically, and they look down on those they consider to be mindless fools. At best, the guild is a protector of knowledge and history who wants to see humanity progress forward.

Ruler: Ersilia Cresci (Female, 41 years)

Family: None

Coat of Arms: A blue field with a black chevron with two golden spyglasses aimed towards the chevron's tip (A falcon flying away with a scroll)

Rule: Farport City, Windshire Town, Ironcliff City, Fallpoint Town, Capital Brineholme
Ersilia and the Lowcloaks have mostly been uninvolved in the other three guilds' intrigues and have mostly been dealing with their affairs during her reign. She is known to be clever and unpredictable. Even though the areas of monopoly that the Lowcloaks own are not as directly lucrative as the other guilds, the Lowcloaks still manage to uphold themselves on the same power level as the others, and maybe they have proven themselves the strongest with Ersilia at the wheel. Conflicting witness statements are reporting Ersilia's demeanor. Some call her careful and secretive. Others would describe her to be restless and decisive. Recent events for the Lowcloaks Guild have been fruitful for the guild's coffers' swelling with income. Their recent business partners have both been parties in Malgrave and Armathain.

Nightstriders

The Nightstriders guild focuses on death, all kinds of entertainment, fine food, drugs, and luxury goods. The Nightstriders guild has always been the most ruthless and cold-blooded of the guilds. They allow nothing to stand in their way to power and influence. This, coupled with the lucrative and profitable businesses they specialize in, has given the Nightstriders a stable and powerful position within the guilds. They are certainly the most wealthy, and their ranks include many brilliant merchants and business owners. They are callous thugs at their worst, for which there is no limit to the lengths they would go to see themselves succeed. At its best, the guild supports all kinds of art and wants people to live a life of satisfaction.

Ruler: Zaccheo Domizio (Male, 45 years)

Family: Deceased daughter (14 years) and a son (11 years)

Coat of Arms: A blue field with three chevrons, two of black and one of red in the middle (An hourglass with a black skull resting on it)

Rule: Craghollow Town, Ashyard Town, Highhold City, Bridgeshore City, Wallkeep City, Edgecairn Town

Zaccheo was a promising Guild Master from his first days in office, and the Nightstriders enjoyed a lot of initial success in Zaccheo's reign. A few years later, his leadership was tested by Steelshade. The two guilds were locked into a cold war after several tense events between Steelshade and the Nightstriders. Partially because of Steelshade's sheer combat mastery and excellent equipment, they managed to push the Nightstriders on the back foot. Many members of the Nightstriders despaired, as they thought that Zaccheo had failed them. But after Zaccheo's daughter was assassinated by the Steelshade, the tides of war turned. Zaccheo focused his whole being on revenge, and he became impressively and morbidly creative in his tactics against Steelshade. The guild had also loved his daughter Stella and fought zealously with Zaccheo. Steelshade lost the war and admitted defeat before their losses turned dire.

The Nightstriders guild rejoiced, and so did Zaccheo. However, after the incident, Zaccheo started to change. He turned progressively more unstable and even manic at times. Today, the Guild Master is unpredictable and untrustworthy to even the most loyal members of the guild. Zaccheo seems unafraid of the consequences his actions could cause, but he still somehow manages to keep his position, mainly through domination and merciless retaliation. These days, part of Zaccheo's frustration comes from the sudden jump in capabilities the other guilds have acquired. It's almost like some kind of unnatural luck is on their side. For the first time in decades, the Nightstriders guild struggles to keep their heads above water.

Steelshade

Steelshade's guild focuses on tools, arms, armor, stonemasonry, clay-works, leatherworking, and mercenaries. Hard work and getting your hands dirty is encouraged in this guild. They value productivity and industriousness most of all. They are known for their comradery and loyalty, a unique trait amongst the guilds. They refer to each other as brothers and sisters, and they see the whole guild as their family. At their best, Steelshade is a huge consortium of different craftsmen and soldiers in arms. The guild is further built on discipline, and hard work is fairly rewarded. On the other hand, they can be arrogant, non-inclusive, and revengeful.

Ruler: Ugo Li Volsi (Male, 37 years)

Family: Female partner (41 years), sister (27 years), daughter (15 years), deceased son (12 years), and a son (5 years)

Coat of Arms: A blue field with a black chevron, displayed in it two golden helmets facing each other (two steel gauntlets shaking hands)

Rule: Knightbreak City, Pearlmaw City, Littleshell Town, Falconpeak Town, Sandcross City

Steelshade has had a rocky ride recently. After a substantial cold war with the Nightstriders guild, they initially seem to have the upper hand. But after the death of Zaccheo's daughter, fortune changed viciously, and Steelshade lost the war. Steelshade had to retreat completely from the Nightstriders as they couldn't afford

more losses. Not many years later, they arrogantly entered into another conflict with Stormgarde, hoping to reclaim some power and face. Steelshade is currently on the losing side of that rivalry as well. Despite all the recent hardships, Ugo is still well-liked within the guild as a considerate and capable Guild Master.

Stormgarde

Stormgarde guild focuses on carpentry, animal breeding, shipbuilding, and textiles. Stormgarde is the guild with the most international ties as they are the owners of the biggest and, arguably, the finest trade fleet in Frostmark. It's no secret that Stormgarde is the best shipbuilders of Stormholme, to the point that the other guilds hire or buy ships from them on the regular. It is here where the origins of the reputation of Stormholme's superb fleet and sailors come from. They're also quite good at breeding and training horses, as well as setting up effective and secure messenger systems. Stormgarde is often hired to install, improve, or run messaging systems in other kingdoms. Their weaknesses include their decentralized functions, as it makes the guild scattered, and their spirit. Stormgarde values highly individualism, which can lead to somewhat untrustworthy and elusive behavior from within its ranks. On the other hand, its members are often creative and adaptable. Many explorers and inventors call Stormgarde their home.

Ruler: Tecla Bergamini (Female, 34 years)

Family: Female Partner (35 years)

Coat of Arms: A blue field with a black chevron, displayed in it one side a golden horse and on the other a golden ship (a ship riding a lightning bolt)

Rule: Cavehold Town, Saltwich City, Newrock Town, Dracton Town, Bluecoast City, Smoothtide City, Linmont City
Tecla is beloved by the Stormgarde guild. She is optimistic and lives for exploration. Recently, Stormgarde has divided its attention on the isolated island of Nodensia, which is usually seen as unimportant in the politics of Frostmark. The other Guild Masters are turning their attention to Tecla and her actions, believing them to be strange and unwise, looking for an opportunity to either uncover their secrets or exploiting a weak link.

